

Medicare Shoppers (AEP) — Voices by Theme

Appendix to *Medicare-Shoppers-Research*. For every measured theme, the most engaged voices (up to 20) in full, with replies and source links. Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/medicare-shoppers/research/>

Tab 1 — Fears

Networks, prior authorization and being denied care · 65 documents · 20 voices

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorqh/>

↳ (0): "Plan N offers the same coverage as plan G except excess charges (which aren't allowed in my state anyway) and there is a \$20 co-pay for an office visit and \$50 co-pay for an emergency room visit. The savings with N will cover over 20 co-pays per year based on the rates I was quoted. It is also expected that premium

increases with N will be less than G since plan G is the guaranteed issue plan."

↳ (0): "Good point. Even with all of my appointments, I don't think I ever went over 20 in a single year. If I did, it wasn't by much. Plan N is a good option for those just starting Medicare. Unfortunately, I'm in Massachusetts and this plan is not available."

↳ (0): "Agree whole heartedly on the Medicare supplement plan. My husband is currently undergoing cancer treatment at MD Anderson. He has tonsil cancer, which is an uncommon type of cancer. We came to Houston from Oregon because MD Anderson is an NCI cancer center that treats thousands more cases of tonsil cancer than the one NCI hospital we have in Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now

ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

"This video was so informative. My late husband was blessed to have a Supplement Plan G. Prior to beginning Medicare he began having neurological problems and was diagnosed with ALS. Thankfully we were able to receive the treatments he needed without the stress of co-pays, referrals, or pre authorizations. Instead of the healthcare process being a bear to deal with, it seemed more like leading a lamb."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 98 likes · http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxnPLA_JdSH8Od-IRF4AaABAg

↳ @debbycoffey4788 (7): "You never mentioned underwriting, questions about your health, in order to switch from a MA to Original Medicare if you aren't happy with the Advantage plan you chose. I understand it can be very hard to switch if you have an underlying condition. What are some questions they might ask to deny you from switching?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "So sorry to hear about your husband. Yes, the ease of use is quite different between the two plans. I like your animal analogy 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "@debbycoffey4788 we have a video that goes over switching. And, we just finished filming an update to this video where we go through the medical questions in more detail that we hope to release next week. Hopefully you are subscribed and can see that when it comes out. Here is the existing video: <https://youtu.be/djuGel829M4>";

"So glad we were advised to take a supplement plan when we started Medicare. A few years later my spouse was diagnosed with cancer and was able to go to a hospital that specialized in that one. We never had to worry about being in plan or getting approvals. Paying more upfront meant we had no bills through the years of treatment. I continue using my supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 61 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwhJu-QYROdQEUKL_h4AaABAg

↳ @jimarnold7561 (3): "Can't speak of other advantage plans but I couldn't be happier with my Kaiser senior advantage plan. Low cost, good doctors, modern hospitals, etc."

↳ @txladywolf01 (1): "Same here. Straight Medicare and Medigap plan N...no issues and I travel USA"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "@jimarnold7561 Dream on Jim. The data doesnt support your statement. When you need it most you will discover the mistake you made."

"I signed up for an advantage plan my first year of Medicare and then attended this workshop live in St. Louis. I switched over to regular Medicare with supplements, and I'm thrilled I qualified. I pay more, but I don't have to play "mother may I" with the insurance company. As a physician, I don't want an insurance company to deny life saving therapy should I develop something they don't want to cover. This company is knowledgeable and honest!"

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 30 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Be_bQ04cKzJc&lc=UgyTPvcDti90LupWwSR4AaABAg

"Thank you for this video. I worked for a medical billing company as a surgery medical coder, assigning procedure and diagnosis "codes" for insurance claims. Patients would tell us their stories as they tried to maneuver through the paperwork to try and get their insurance to authorize the surgeries their doctors said they needed to have. My own PCP had worked for an insurance company reviewing claims for medical necessity. When she was hired, they told her she literally had to deny a certain percentage of claims to keep her job. She said she couldn't do it, the claims all met their medical necessity guidelines so she quit in disgust. When it was time for me to go on Medicare I went with a Plan G. Does it cost me more in premiums than an Advantage Plan? Yes, but it is worth it. I know it is the best choice in the long run and I never need to stress over the shameful process of pre-authorization, knowing if the insurance company had a choice between their profit and my life, they'd let me die without so much as a thought. I've even heard of cases where the patient was told to wait until the next "quarter" of the year to ask for authorization and of one patient whose pre-authorization was put off until the following calendar year. It all affects the profit they show to investors, after all, health insurance is BIG business. Personally, I will find a part time job if money to pay the premiums (currently \$129 month not including the \$\$ withheld from my SS check) for my Plan G ever becomes an issue. Piece of mind is priceless."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgxIzKqLKsUUTpu94IR4AaABAg>

↳ @threeftr3349 (6): "An amazing story, thank you for sharing that. I am not of age yet for Medicare. When I worked for an imaging company, I briefly sat by the authorization dept. I was shocked of some of the conversation my co-workers had with elderly patients. The shocker, a person trying to explain, why their insurance company denied their Pet scan, and they had a history of cancer. That test was medically necessary, to determine continue course of treatment for their cancer. Doctors don't have the staff or time to fight these lengthy denials, so it's left for the patient to fight. Unfortunately it's a steep almost impossible hill to conquer"

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "So thrilled to hear that we can be so helpful. Thank you for sharing this we appreciate it so much! Happy to hear that you are getting the coverage and treatment you deserve!"

↳ @Itsgettingcrazy. (0): "@MedicareSchoolWould you recommend a person who is retired and turning 65 stay on their private insurance or get on Medicare part A and B? One person told me if I wasn't working, I had to go on Medicare? I'm happy with my plan. My husband passed 18 years ago and I was able to stay on his insurance."

"Medicare Advantage is being subsidized and promoted to weaken Original Medicare, I think. Health insurers want to get everyone into a plan where they control everything. I thought retirement would improve my health insurance, but now the dreaded private insurer network rules are creeping into Medicare. I am on an Advantage plan, I was seduced by the low premium, but I wish we did not have to make choices like this for health insurance in retirement"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyerDoHLB2gXsjJRLV4AaABAg.ATT6lcfPqnATZbikhLmzv>

"I have a Medigap plan F that is community-rated and offers gym membership, 24-hour call a registered nurse service, and discounts on vision and hearing services. I am very happy with my plan and would never even consider changing to a Medicare (Dis)Advantage plan. I don't want a private insurance agency making health care decisions for me or restricting my access to a particular network of doctors. So many doctors and hospitals accept original Medicare without question and then, of course medigap pays its part. As far as medigap costing a little more, I think you have to ask yourself what your priorities are. My priority is "no hassles, no worries" health care. I am willing to drive an older car and make other sacrifices as necessary because my health comes first."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap | Your TRUE Cost · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugwc4CVdNbp7cUz8Ox14AaABAg>

↳ @Dbb277-2 (3): "My F is costing \$300 a month. Ouch. I have no health issues."

↳ @kciis (1): "You are echoing my moms thoughts! 😊 - Ann"

↳ @4378200 (0): "@Dbb277-2 That's why I did not enroll...I would have given a company thousands to pay for my co-pays for the last 3 years. My MA has worked perfect for me"

"At 39:53, you say, "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, lean towards Medicare Advantage." I feel the unspoken part of that sentence should be: "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, ***AND MUCH MORE LIKELY TO BE DENIED COVERAGE*** lean towards Medicare Advantage." With Medigap, your doctor and Medicare determine what procedures you can get. With Medicare Advantage, the Corporate Healthcare Provider determines what procedures you can get. The Advantage Plan Provider's incentive is to maximize profits. How do they do that? Deny coverage for procedures that they don't want to pay for."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwU_3aKoZJXMaRelzI4AaABAg

"OK that was the BEST run down of Advantage vs Supplemental plans ever. Even though this MI is only an anecdote (and your mom's cancer youtube you also covered) it really helps one to get their brain around the worst case scenarios. I feel like being not risk adverse and in an urban area with great in-network options the advantage plan works pretty well for us, plus we're active, healthy and we take care of ourselves. We were paying nearly \$20k a year for health insurance before retirement - because of our income - for incredibly basic coverage. Your other video comparing Advantage to Supplemental is also a must watch."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare | Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugwd-24iA3Jn-gJGpNB4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "You are too kind! Thank you so much for taking the time to watch a few of these. Makes me glad to know they are helpful :)"

"I want to choose my own doctor when I need him. I don't want to wait for a referral or a wait till my doctor thinks I need a specialist."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BeBQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzScyFbSRKvBEO7UwN4AaABAg>

"There has to be a cost savings and/or risk reduction for the government to push advantage plans. Considering the restrictions involved with advantage (approvals for services, staying within networks, potential high deductible), I don't see the benefit for a relatively slight increase in cost contrasted with traditional Medicare and Medigap policy. Anyway I want to travel and if I need medical services on a trip I can't be worrying about staying within network and getting approval for services. -- Ms. Abt does a great job explaining this stuff."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8Sji0S1o&lc=UgxVqA0ZppghheEgmBt4AaABAg.95PNrwgrN4l9Ftg4stkizC>

"Another extremely valuable post. Are you paying attention kiddies? I love how you (Stephanie) covered the "one way door" on switching between the two. My main reasons to stay with original Medicare is that next largest town to me is in another state. I don't want to have to deal with networks. Also don't want to deal with for profit insurance that has me get prior approvals and can deny me. I'm in great health right now but in the event that things go very wrong the last thing I need is the insurance company causing me headaches. Stephanie, you need to once again post the side by side cost comparison that shows yearly deductibles, max out of pocket, max coverage, co pay comparisons. If I remember correctly, Advantage has more out of pocket (yearly deductible) and less max coverage. IMHO Advantage would be okay if you lived in a large city. But for us rural folks not so much."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxYtDAJ72cFpoJQfD14AaABAg>

"I wish I had educated myself when I turned 65. I chose to stay with my employers retiree health plan which we pay ourselves. This year the price has jumped dramatically and I am looking at marketplace. It looks like I missed out on medigap because I know I would now be turned down if underwritten. I could stay with my employers plan and if they discontinued it I could get medigap, but leaving voluntarily my only option is advantage. I will save 4000 a year by choosing advantage but fear the authorizations/denial process."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyNq-I5E9DgaRdfDEN4AaABAg>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (2): "As someone told me when I was turning 65. You can pay it now (traditional and supp) or pay it later (advantage) as far as costs. As far as quality of care there is no comparison. Advantage Plans kill seniors prematurely by the hundreds every day in the US. And thats a fact"

↳ @ahemphill44 (0): "@JohnJohn-wr1jo That's the most ignorant statement (of many) that I have read on this old post."

"Yes, we went down that route of the high deductible plan G. Works well, especially if you have an HSA. I want to avoid Advantage plans because those plans inject the insurance company into the decision making process for care. While they are supposed to provide everything Medicare does, it's the company, not the doctor, who decides if a procedure is "medically necessary". In addition, I don't want to deal with networks, and we have very few options for plans in the rural area that I live in. But I really wish that the problems with Medicare get addressed. There are also the IRMAA penalties that hit people who are not necessarily high income, such as people who are selling their homes to afford assisted living. Suddenly, they may find themselves paying huge penalties for their Part B and Part D premiums. We need to treat seniors better than this."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgyK1XQQ9pUIg9GRd394AaABAg.A4YsBIUCsnxA4n7dmNx365>

"Regarding pre-approvals. I believe that insurance companies are over using the pre approval process, simply because they know so few people will appeal. Yes you can ask your doctor to appeal, I have been in situations where the doctor's office didn't want to appeal and offered something else, my take was that they did not want to do a peer-peer review with insurance and simply palmed me off. Other than a second opinion there isn't much as a patient you can do in these situations. These issues and concerns are why I was motivated to take original medicare at retirement, I simply don't want to have to deal with pre-approvals. I am happy to pay more so I don't toss and turn in bed at night wondering how to handle an appeal. Unfortunately pre approvals are still there for Part D claims, not much that can be done about that."

— YouTube · The Truth About United Healthcare's Claim Denials and Dr. Oz's Plan to Force Medicare Adva · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LhIMMtQaY0&lc=Ugzs8flwDYfBlpxcHdB4AaABAg>

"CALIFORNIA GAL here so don't poke the BEAR. I just sat for 3 hours with my son on the lesser cost but the insane admin so I'm moving Advantage to Supplemental by January. The stress of approvals, authorizations, then getting the doctor appointment. A terrific imaging facility fell out of network...this threw me into buckets of tears. I've had a couple big accidents in my life and maintenance requires top self specialists. Overall I'm incredibly healthy just busted up. Thank goodness I found you tonight! 🐻 🐻 🐻 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgyrUsb1_bdlrvfyvvZ4AaABAg

"I've thought along the same lines. But based on the meetings I've attended over the years with different insurance companies, I believe the future of Medicare Advantage is going to be heavily weighted toward HMO plans. Last year was a good example of that shift, with many PPO options being pulled from the marketplace. Because of this trend, I actually think it will cause more people to hang on to - and even purchase - Medicare supplements than we might expect, since many don't want to be locked into restrictive HMO networks."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyNSEImQ0NTVmpgkcv4AaABAg.AMN6TrEcJsQAMNOraNjvCT

"I am concerned as those who chose advantage trying to switch back to regular medicare later would be given penalty additional monthly charges and sometimes be denied for pre existing health issues."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw8-92XixbSzst4mnV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "This is not the case in the context of this video"

↳ @gramig0 (1): "Hasn't happened in my experience."

"Great video. My husband turned 65 this year and I turn 65 in February 2024. I worked for many of the Advantage Plans as a Network Development Contractor. I did the actual negotiations with Providers for the Plan. I watched many Specialty Groups and Hospitals term their contracts mid year. So many do not know that the Providers can term with a 90 day notice. This is one of the Big Dis-Advantages on the Plans. Also, the Insurance Plan has a huge Department that reviews the Prior Authorizations and will deny, deny & deny many services. The Free benefits out way the stressful issues that come along with the prior authorizations and Denial that happen with a so called Advantage Plan. My hubby and I will be staying with a supplement. Thank you for this video!!!!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgzCa3liGmGdoa7u0qF4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "You are welcome and thank you for sharing your story."

↳ @buffalo_wings8224 (0): "The stressful issues outweigh the free benefits is what you meant to say"

A big illness and the bills that follow · 65 documents · 20 voices

"My husband was given the sales pitch about how great an advantage plan was. So he switched to Humana and the first two years were good. He was never sick. Then Covid came and he was diagnosed with cancer. We live in NH and the ER put him in an ambulance to go to Dana Farber in Boston (an hour away). Well guess what, the ambulance and hospital was out of network. Ambulance was \$5000. After he was diagnosed he passed away 72 days later. He was laying in the hospital bed stressed out about how I was going to pay all the medical bills when he dies. Sucks pretty bad when you're on your death bed and the only thing you think about is how your surviving spouse is going to pay the medical bills! Needless to say, when I signed up for Medicare I took a supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 92 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgztwkgUWWxR35VyLN4AaABAg>

↳ @rshoe1023 (14): "Sorry for your lose! It really shouldn't be this way for seniors! The whole health care system here in the states is entirely broken!"

↳ @truthhearit1471 (7): "YOU LEGALLY DO NOT HAVE TO PAY HIS MEDICAL BILLS"

↳ @johndoe-ss9bz (1): "Capitalist - Medicine 101.. "Profits First"..."

"Pretty much have decided on original Medicare (A&B) plus N and Part D, whenever I decide to retire. The cost and "perks" of an Advantage plan sound appealing, but not worth the risk of possible out of pocket expenses compared to original Medicare with a supplement plan. Health conditions can change quickly and with us in the over 65 crowd, that's a huge consideration at least in my opinion. And i want my medical decisions to be made between me and my doctor, not an insurance company."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgzloIQWLpLnagmlgkF4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (8): "One point I cut out of this video to keep it from being too long is that a recent study by Medicare showed that about 90% of Advantage plan companies advertise their plans by drawing attention to the extra benefits (I call shiny objects). They do so to take the focus off the healthcare benefits so people assume they are as good as Original Medicare."

"I have plan G and I have never paid a dime other then my Medicare deductible, and I've had to go to the hospital/ER 3 times. Frankly I hate the fact I'm forced to pay for Medicare. I used to have Obama care and pa I d \$1 a month. Now I'm forced to pay what \$170 a month? Then I pay for Medicare Advantage. When I quit working I won't be able to afford anything, even Medicare. I will refuse to go to the hospital because I don't want the gov taking my last dime. I'll just die at home. After working at least 50 yrs, paying taxes, this is how the US treats us? It's disgusting!"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgwMTriMytjoFMpaT6J4AaABAq>

↳ @Reed-2big (1): "If you had a reduced premium under the ACA there is probably a program that I'll reduce your Medicare cost. Please, please seek out help to find that reduced cost plan."

"Never used an agent. When I compared plans I went into Advantage eyes wide open with no regrets. Never really cared about the goodies it offered but what will take what is offered. We have been rather healthy but at our age a medigap plan does not fit in our budget. We are 72. And 80 years old. We contribute to what we call our own "HSA" (no tax advantage) monthly what we can afford. Over the 5plus years on advantage that balance has grown so max out of pocket is not a concern. We have friends who pay 600 plus a month for peace of mind you speak about. Everyone is different. We would rather have the money in our own account than pay for that kind of peace of mind. God willing we will continue to save every year."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugy-HGEYogB5wRrDn8x4AaABAq>

"I am taking the risk. I self insure the 20%. As I see it: the potential, high cost illness is variable. It may happen, it may not. The Plan G Monthly Premium is fixed. It will rise over time. I may use it, I may not. But I will pay for it. Here is a much better idea: At age 65, rather than Plan G supplement, budget \$150 per month for Medical Risk, assume that number rises 6% per year. Put that money into a personal investment account, a safe one but growing too. I will use those funds as protection against the 20% self insurance risk. If I stay healthy, the incentive is a load of money that I own v. the insurance company."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugxt5VAFWFpm7mvH00B4AaABAg

↳ @aa-dz6cr (1): "Self funding is ridiculous if you have assets."

↳ @fl3609 (0): "I think it's a good idea if you are healthy now and can pass underwriting if you need it later."

↳ @jenniferpark2706 (0): "I pay less than \$40 per month for HDG to avoid that risk. I can afford this premium, but I cannot afford the risk for unknown MOOP."

"If you get really sick, you'll be screwed right when you are the most stressed and life is totally hard. As a hospital worker, i would never never never get an Advantage plan. Its not just high co pays, its lots of care and care options that are also closed to you with an Advantage plan. They can and do make any rules they want. Also, once youre really sick, you cant easily get a Medi-gap plan. They can deny you based on your health if you don't get it immediately when you sign up for straight Medicare B. Its subject to underwriting if you try to switch from Medicare Advantage to straight Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgxCOMGGwlmaBd-jTw54AaABAg.AlsB0dvabP3AOaceZUTLDT>

"I'm a fairly healthy 65 year old...took advantage for the 3 allowable months to switch, I'm in IL. Seven years in my 30's was spent in cancer treatment...makes me want a supplement but afraid of the cost in subsequent years. Medicare needs to be simplified and less confusing. Thank you nerds for the plethora of information you provide in this dog eat dog world of insurance."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzXmDr8hmo0YRSr_2d4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! 🤔 it is pretty crazy how complicated it gets"

"Hi Matthew! I am on the cusp (literally, I have 2 weeks left to decide about plans) of getting on Medicare. I have been tortured with this for months now, not understanding any of it totally, even with extensive researching on my own. I do not have anyone with whom I could speak to about a decision, so I am very grateful that you just explained the critical differences between an Advantage plan and a Supplement plan. I can now make an informed decision without ending up as one of the medical system casualties you spoke of! I was actually in tears (of relief) watching this video. My 24 year old son has already had 2 Cancer surgeries, and I really do not want to add to my family's future medical worries any more than necessary. Thank you SO much again! God Bless people like you."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgxMwp6sR0xalT6KFx14AaABAg>

"Okay, you have a Medicare Advantage plan. Do you have a Medicare Dual SNP plan? Or just plain Medicare Advantage? To confirm, the provider is not in network with HumanaChoice PPO. But is in network with CCHP? How were you seeing this provider before? Like how were you able to get scheduled to see them for the initial consult? Is the Medicare new? They are correct that they cannot charge you (a Medi-Cal patient) out of pocket for Medi-Cal covered services, it's illegal. The tricky part is the only way I can see this going forward is if this is NOT a Medicare covered service. Then the CCHP should pay. But it depends on what the surgery is. I can see why they are hesitant... a surgery is significant financial risk that may not get paid."

— r/HealthInsurance · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wk34b0/ca_dual_enrollment_causing_issues_for_upcoming_panurs0/

"Do not, I repeat NOT use United Health Care on the Advantage plan. UHC is a sunburn of a nightmare - a mess and my hospital dropped them. I signed up with the Advantage plan at the hospital. All went smooth until they sent a letter that said Advantage is going away in Oregon? :("

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugys1pC3NFzodwwwYlh4AaABAg_AKdMkH291hCANZVXQWeluI

"If you've been a Medicare agent in 17 states for over a decade, you would know exactly what I'm talking about. You are well aware of the changes our industry is facing, so please do not call this an unfair, fear-based claim. And you're right—I forgot to provide proof and evidence—so here they are. Feel free to look up any of these news outlets to see exactly what I'm referring to if you're not aware of that. Medicare Advantage – The Hidden Risks (2024 Sources) Insurers Dropping Members Millions at risk as carriers pull back—over 1 million patients had to shop for new health plans as insurers and hospitals dropped MA coverage (Stateline, Oct 2024). Hospitals Dropping Contracts 15 health systems ended MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., Aultman, Scripps, WellSpan, etc.) due to denials and slow payments (TheStreet, 2024). 32 health systems dropped or declined to renew MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., CommonSpirit, Vanderbilt Health, Avera Health, etc.) (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). 17 health systems across multiple states did the same—citing administrative burdens—in a Becker's list updated August 2024 (Strategic Healthcare, 2024). HealthPartners left UnitedHealthcare MA network, citing denial rates up to 10x higher than with other insurers (Center for Medicare Advocacy, 2024). Hospitals are dropping MA plans "left and right"—Scripps Health terminated MA contracts affecting 30k seniors; many more followed suit across the country (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). JustCare lists 2024 cancellations (e.g., ECU Health, Comanche Regional, Genesis, Brookings, Memorial Hermann, etc.) (JustCare USA, 2024)."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyfN02DFY0-5fva9L94AaABAg.AMAJEJokT6yAMAm2VxdHH8

"I've had Medicare Advantage for 17 years now. The last two years I've had one that, so far, nothing out of pocket at all, ever, except for one expensive drug. Excellent doctors in my area, that I've been using for years even before I turned 65. First time in my life I've had real "universal" type medical care and I absolutely love it. Never a worry about a co-pay, no charges for surgery. My husband had a stent placement after a heart attack a few years ago. The cost to us was \$0. We went to Georgia to visit our son and my husband got sick while there. He was treated at Emory University Hospital. Charge? \$0. I feel like I'm living in Europe. The first 15 years we had MA, we did have small out of pocket expenses. I have always chosen physicians I knew compared with the benefits of each plan. I will chose a plan that has a co-pay if the doctors and hospitals I want to use are members. All the top physicians my this area accept the plan I have now. I'm happy as a bug in a rug."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugx1dm-lamj-wu1PvoV4AaABAg.9ZCILW366mm9ZHKJcsxpyq>

"Hi Erik. Just to let you know how us folks appreciate all the great content you have provided to us and take the time to answer all of our questions. I, for one, decided to go with an Advantage plan. But, I still have some doubts, as it worries me like if I were to go back home on vacation and get sick or an injury, and have to go to an area hospital, then there would not be any type of medical coverage at all with this plan. Is this correct?"

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgxP-7n9iyXB2EVdsmR4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Appreciate you saying this. Means a lot. To answer your question, it'll depend on your plan. Where is back home?"

↳ @EightyDeuce-x1d (0): "@Theretirementnerds P.R. I just found out earlier today that my Advantage plan is not at all covered there. They only have medicaid, plans provided by some employers, and some private plans from hospitals."

"Thanks for your objectivity. I've been on Advantage for 5 years. It's been great. I checked on Supplement and I was either denied or given monthly costs of \$500. I may regret but not so far. I'm more concerned about catastrophic event coverage. Not office copays of \$35."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgzWbb4UYOvC207K-5N4AaABAg>

"will never have a advantage plan,,, they are almost useless where i am, most doctors dont want them and our 2 hospitals will take them, will keep plan G"

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgzKKoTuFBk3FkPZcCd4AaABAg

↳ @MedicareonVideo (2): "Would always choose Plan G over an advantage plan"

"Having recently become eligible for Medicare I scheduled an annual wellness appointment w/ my provider. During the appt the Dr. suggested I get vaccinated against shingles and I was told the vaccine would be covered by insurance, so I completed the series of two shots several weeks apart. Medicare denied payment and upon investigating why found out the vaccine is not covered under Part B. However, the cost is covered under my Part D and if I'd had received the shots at my local pharmacy instead of the doctors office the claim would have been processed no problem. When I called the Atrium Health billing to request they bill CVS Caremark I was told they will not bill Part D insurance. So now I'm left to navigate the paperwork nightmare of asking Caremark to reimburse me for the \$1k I'm out of pocket."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Claims Issues (and how to avoid them) · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QWGAaZw0d6o&lc=Ugy6AjSxBER0_yljAep4AaABAg

↳ @emc6511 (0): "Email from Medicare this week QUOTE ... Medicare Part D now covers these vaccines and more at NO cost to you: Shingles RSV Tetanus/diphtheria (Td) Tetanus, diphtheria, and pertussis (whooping cough) (Tdap) Hepatitis A Hepatitis B, if you're at low risk for the virus Also, Medicare still covers flu shots, COVID-19 vaccines, and pneumococcal shots."

"This is very helpful and very well laid out and I appreciate that. That said that is why I will continue with my Medicare advantage plan because I'll take the same risk of not having cancer for 10 more years that would mean not paying the supplement and saving that money then if cancer does come, but the difference wasn't that much for something that may or may not happen plus, like you said you didn't talk about the medication's in the Medicare advantage that's free to me along with free dental and vision. It's just very hard to beat now. Yes I understand if I am retiring and I had problems then definitely get the supplement. Great video and I subscribed."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwE4MTxalmlvCPo9OJ4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching and sharing your perspective! Glad to have you along for the ride and hope to keep putting out useful videos for you!"

"Are you licensed in Indiana? I had a triple heart bypass surgery about a year ago and I'm so glad that I had Plan G because I did have the best care and the best doctors. I'm really doing good with my heart surgery. But after that my insurance company is working on me to take a Medicare Advantage Plan and I refuse. That is why I may changed to a Plan N if I'm allowed to. But I'm almost afraid to change given my heart surgery from last year for fear I may lose my supplemental insurance altogether."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plan Reviews ★ (from real people) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nw14VxxHrmM&lc=UgzbGmlaJrbl-CA-REF4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "I do work in IN! You will likely not be able to pass through medical underwriting to change to a Plan N until you are two years out from your heart surgery."

"@AbtInsuranceAgency I thought so, as I'm originally from the Oneida area. You have helped me a great deal and I sincerely appreciate it. Since I'll be turning 65 next month, I just purchased a Medigap Plan G with a stand-alone PDP. Currently, I am on my former employer's group plan, which will roll into an Advantage Plan. Considering limited provider flexibility and the potential maximum yearly out of pocket costs; I didn't feel that it was a good gamble. Once again, thank you for your guidance."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plan Reviews ★ (from real people) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nw14VxxHrmM&lc=Ugz68hX3Ky1k8XyCl654AaABAg.9l-nOPUeqw99oeHF6L8O3H>

"Great video!! Have a known cost vs unknown. I have watched so many older family members literally blow \$100,000+ with Medicare fighting cancer with in-network and out of network drama and fighting for 4-5 years and still dying....For sure have a known cost per year with an advantage plan and a cancer policy vs unknown....It's just not worth it to have the risk of not having it.... My Mom died in 2021 and we are still getting bills-so much drama.... Hope your Mom makes a fully recovery!!!"

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCl8m0OI18&lc=Ugx0gk1y0sGnSUi2Fwx4AaABAg>

Drug costs and Part D · 47 documents · 20 voices

"The Medicare Plan Shuffle: Why NOT Shopping Part D Annually Could Cost Thousands Let's face it—when it comes to Medicare Part D drug plans, there are two types of people: those who compare their options each year... and those who don't. The first group might sleep easy knowing they're not overpaying for their medications. The second? Well, they could be unknowingly flushing hundreds—or even thousands—down the drain every year. We're not trying to scare you... Okay, maybe we are. A little. # The \$0 Trap: It Sounds Good, But... A \$0 monthly premium sounds amazing, right? Like free pie. But what they don't tell you is that the crust costs extra, and the whipped cream? Outrageously priced. That "free" drug plan might not cover your medications—or might do so at sky-high copays. Drugs like **Eliquis**, **Zepbound**, **Wegovy**, **Ozempic**, and **Mounjaro** aren't just pricey—they're plan landmines. Some plans cover them. Some don't. Some charge you your left arm, others your right. We've even seen plans list one of these drugs at over \$1,000 a month while another plan had it at just \$35. Same drug. Different nightmare. # The Annual Game of "Gotcha" Here's the kicker: every year, plans change. They change their premiums. They change their copays. They change what drugs they cover and what tier they're on. That \$10-a-month generic from last year? Surprise! It's now \$85 and mysteriously moved up a tier. Imagine showing up at the pharmacy in January thinking your plan still loves you, only to find out it ghosted your medications over the holidays. # Why This Year is Different (And Maybe Worse) Whispers from Washington are raising eyebrows. With big changes coming to how Medicare negotiates drug prices and funds subsidies starting in 2026, we could be on the edge of a "musical chairs" situation—except instead of chairs, it's coverage for your heart medication, and when the music stops... well, you get the picture. If you're banking on "the government will fix it," remember: these are the same folks who brought you the DMV experience. # The True Villains? The Middlemen & the Markups Let's not forget the real fun part: drug manufacturers and pharmacy benefit managers (PBMs)—the shadowy middlemen who get rich while seniors juggle pills and price tags. They're the ones who make your life-saving medication more expensive in the U.S. than a luxury vacation in Mexico (where, ironically, the same drugs often cost 80% less). So yes, it's not just about "shopping" your plan. It's about taking a stand against a broken system. One click, one form, one chat with your agent could save you thousands. # Moral of the Story? Don't Be That Guy. Every year, we talk to someone who didn't bother to compare plans. They "liked what they had" and "didn't want to mess with it." By February, they're calling us in a panic because their meds are costing more than their rent. Don't be that guy. Reprinted from Lisaknowsmedicare.com. blog posts"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1kyujg6/>

↳ (0): "Basically what I tell all my clients every year. Read your ANOC (Annual Notice of Change) carefully for changes to how your prescriptions are covered, copay changes, etc. Part D plans are super easy to compare on Medicare.gov. Be aware that most PDPs no longer pay broker commissions, so a broker might not be eager to spend valuable time helping you shop around unless you are already a client."

↳ (0): "This right here. I still did reviews for all my existing clients, despite the fact that Aetna, Centene, Cigna, etc. all said no commissions for brokers. I love my clients but this year I'll probably be directing most of them to [Medicare.gov](<http://Medicare.gov>) for Part D reviews and changes."

↳ (0): "Keep in mind that as a broker, sending them to Medicare.gov to enroll proves the carriers point that brokers are not needed. Have them call the carrier to enroll in a plan. Make the carriers pay someone to do the work they won't pay brokers to do."

"@Wildflowerz57 good plan! My parents are both on med advantage and love it, same with my Medicare clients. Advantage isn't for everyone, and I have some clients on supplements because that is their preference and they can afford the premiums, but the vast majority are happily on advantage PPOs with huge networks & solid care. I have also seen older folks paying \$700 plus total monthly for part B, med supplement, and drug plan because they're stuck in an obsolete med supplement and can't qualify for another one, and are scared to move because of videos like this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtlsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABAg.9Zo-abmMTzA9aY40j57arF>

"Dam right , I took it also at 65 . I couldn't wait , self employed , was paying over 1,200month in NJ, no subsidies from Gov, during a pandemic scared to death I would get Covid and have complications or die, had a big deductible and I'm typical healthy on no meds . Medicare - Medigap plan G and a Part D RX plan was a bargain for me. Everyone does not have « employer sponsored health insurance » . Commercial Insurance plans stick it to you in terms of high premiums from age 60- 65 until your Medicare eligible. Everyone's situation is different. Great video- you covered it well."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzdXYe0VCfC-Rf4IWN4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you for sharing your experience!"

↳ @HMC-p6p (0): "Same here ACA premiums 1295 a month for HMO"

"My Advantage Plan has been very good. So far I have had no problems with coverage. Additionally, if one goes with the typical Medicare coverage with part D coverage, there is a risk of entering the doughnut hole with prescriptions if you happen to take a lot of meds. The Advantage coverage I have, there is no doughnut hole. So I hear a lot of mumble jumble on which is the best and things are confusing when I see videos such as this. Consequently, I will stick with the old adage "if it ain't broke, don't fix it"."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugz488YJ9 ANw6ipOuJ4AaABAg>

↳ @jarmstrong2843 (1): "@floridagirl5250 Not according to my former employer and my having spent nearly \$10k in prescriptions and so far no doughnut hole."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (0): "That's a good way to go."

↳ @jeffgoble4761 (0): "Your Advantage plan does have a donut hole. Check the benefit summary."

"I completely understand your logic as I am a former healthcare provider turned Medicare plan broker. My main concern though is the cost of the stand-alone drug plans that go along with the supplements is rising drastically in cost. I suspect drug cost alone will push some clients to Advantage plans."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyNSEImQ0NTVmpgkcV4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (5): "I've thought along the same lines. But based on the meetings I've attended over the years with different insurance companies, I believe the future of Medicare Advantage is going to be heavily weighted toward HMO plans. Last year was a good example of that shift, with many PPO options being pulled from the marketplace. Because of this trend, I actually think it will cause more people to hang on to - and even purchase - Medicare supplements than we might expect, since many don't want to be locked into restrictive HMO networks."

↳ @67redhead (3): "I switched to Rx Wellcare and pay zero."

↳ @bethh4271 (1): "I see people saying plan N is great as well. So what's the difference between plan G and plan N"

"My G plan is autopay from the bank (\$140) and Part D (\$106 w/o ded) is deducted from my SS deposit so I basically don't see the money. I try to not think about it. I really only worry about paying the part B deductible (\$288 for 2026) and the same co-pays for prescriptions when I pick them up. ❤️ I'll keep it as long as I can... (I quit smoking a year ago and apply that money to this)..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw6cM8NcGumoqRYwOF4AaABAg>

↳ @suloget (0): "Your premiums seem very low."

↳ @rogerclark3 (0): "@sulogetThat's what it is. It's Ace Insurance. We'll see what the price increase is..."

"Good video ! However, it points out the disgrace of our health care system. For one it is not health care it is health insurance driven by a profit motive. This is morally wrong. A company that tries to optimize how much money they make off from sick people is just wrong. I have so much anxiety about going on Medicare because there are thousands of diagnosis, lab tests, medications, procedures, etc that I just don't know whether they will be covered or not. If I ever have to go to the hospital I will question every medication they try to give me, every test they want to do, and try to get discharged as quickly as possible to avoid being financially devastated. The whole name Medigap shows how broken Medicare is. If you have parts A and B and have to go to the hospital from a car accident you will be wiped out unless you get Medigap or an Advantage plan so you are forced to do it. Why don't they fix part A and B to cover you ?? This would mean an increase in premiums deducted from your social security check but it would be a far simpler system. Also, there is no coverage for dental, vision, or hearing even with Medigap. When you are older is when you need dental, vision, and hearing the most. And that points out something else. This country doesn't care about their elderly citizens and everything is biased towards younger people. In most Asian cultures the elderly live with their children who take care of them. Here, you will be lucky if they put you in a nursing home. My cousin's husband had kidney cancer and no hospital would take him because he was over 75 and he died. If he would have been a Russian citizen he would have lived. Simply disgraceful."

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=UgypE6d5xS9qF1JCX1x4AaABAg>

"Medicare on Video They work very well, but so do many Advantage plans. Much of the maintenance of Advantage plans comes from changing prescriptions, which an agent doesn't need to be concerned with, because Supplements don't provide prescription coverage. If an Advantage plan has a low yearly maximum-out-of-pocket, it doesn't really matter how well a supplement works, because anyone that can do basic math will figure out there won't be a huge difference in the maximum-out-of-pocket responsibility and what they're paying out in premiums, per year. If you get really sick, just pretend you got a supplement and put a few hundred dollars aside, every month, for your copays. Again, much of this is geography dependent. There's no right and wrong answer for what's better, and what's not. It's dependent on how good the Advantage plan is where they live, and what's important to the person. But to just blanket bash Advantage plans is being pretty disingenuous. If I would've went on a supplement, right when I was eligible, I would've paid out about \$22,000 in premiums, to date. That money is all still in my pocket, and supplement premiums just keep skyrocketing, every year, until you die. The maximum-out-of-pocket for Humana Gold Plus Medicare Advantage Plan in my area is about \$2700 per year, the premium is \$0, and they give me dental, vision, hearing, and an over-the-counter catalog monthly stipend. And the network is huge. There's also a PPO from Aetna with a great network (has like 98% of hospitals in-network) and very reasonable out of network costs. Honestly, I'd have to be a moron to waste extra money, every month, on a premium, PDP plan, and dental/vision/hearing plan."

— YouTube ·  Medicare Advantage vs Medigap - Which to Choose? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rS1cTsTcA8&lc=Ugyrw4nio87nKYS79oN4AaABAg.90qbwNYyi1r90qoZ2szsxC>

"What if there's no specialty pharmacy near me? EDIT: Thank you everyone for informing me of how the mail orders work, I really appreciate it! Talked to my rheum again and she's resubmitting to insurance again. I have to start a biologic medication and have run into nothing but issues. I have Aetna and was told by the Walgreens specialty that I need to go to Acredo or CVS- only there are none remotely near me? Do they make exceptions or am I just boned? I don't even live in a small city... 🙄 "

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wnbtcb/what_if_theres_no_specialty_pharmacy_near_me/

↳ Dramatic_Spinach4189 (8): "Almost all specialty pharmacies operate mail order"

↳ dallasalice88 (6): "Acredo is mail order. That's how my husband's biologic for RA is handled through BCBS. They mail FedEx overnight, so no worries on medication going unrefrigerated. Three years now, no issues. They will handle all the insurance billing and have pretty good customer service. If they do not contact you, call them with your info, did your doctor give you the script? Because it needs to be sent to Acredo. Usually that's laid out in the pre auth the doc has to do."

↳ genesiss23 (4): "Call accredo or CVS speciality and they will assist you."

"I started Medicare A/B and I have Plan F which no longer exists. Your costs are not realistic when you end up getting sick. My monthly gammaglobulin is \$8k per month, I would be dead if I did not have A/B and a secondary and many doctors are not taking Medicare Advantage. Even with Medicare it takes at least three months to get into the doctor. Now without Part D for 2027, I am very concerned!!!!"

— YouTube · What if You Get Cancer? Medicare Advantage vs. Supplement Compared! · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=15lDYGC6Kc4&lc=UgycbpuTDAB4LZjwY-54AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (1): "I'm glad you have something that works for you! Oh man, you need a better agent! Whether our clients have a Medicare Advantage plan or a Medicare Supplement, they aren't waiting 3 months to see their doctor! Yikes."

"THANK YOU for this video. I hope you take time to answer my question. I have not switched over to medicare, because I am still employed and very much enjoy my company-provided benefits. However, a friend of mine recently retired and went on traditional medicare supplements; he is having a horrible experience since his doctor prescribed a 3 month regimen for Eliquis. My friend is expecting close to \$3000 out of pocket expenses for this brief regime. So, while your video was extremely helpful and better prepared me to learn the jargon as well as how to evaluate and discuss the differences between the 2 paradigms, I feel like it ignored a huge elephant in the room, and that is a cost of prescriptions. I don't think anyone questions that traditional medicare is a great choice for medical coverage, but I think people get very nervous when it comes to considering prescriptions, vision, dental, etc. So the most simple way to pose my question is this: how can I use medicare supplements while still protecting myself from high prescription out of pockets? How do I get a plan that is more like the group health plan I currently have with my employer? The cost of prescriptions is frightening"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwtJ1LR-9OnaFgFH-N4AaABAg>

"This is very helpful and very well laid out and I appreciate that. That said that is why I will continue with my Medicare advantage plan because I'll take the same risk of not having cancer for 10 more years that would mean not paying the supplement and saving that money then if cancer does come, but the difference wasn't that much for something that may or may not happen plus, like you said you didn't talk about the medication's in the Medicare advantage that's free to me along with free dental and vision. It's just very hard to beat now. Yes I understand if I am retiring and I had problems then definitely get the supplement. Great video and I subscribed."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwE4MTxalmlvCPo9OJ4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching and sharing your perspective! Glad to have you along for the ride and hope to keep putting out useful videos for you!"

"I have traditional medicare with a plan G supplemental and plan D drug plan and I am perfectly happy, maybe you should not have went with a Medicare Advantage plan because you thought you were beating the system. Trump has been fighting everyone to get lower prices on prescription drugs for seniors, but you don't want to talk about that. Everything Trump does your beloved Democrats file lawsuits to stop him and he stills manages to somehow still get a lot done. Democrats are nothing but a thorn in America's side."

— YouTube · 3 Medicare Changes for 2027 - and how to prepare. #medicare · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GxBa9kBx5cY&lc=Ugxrlbja99ym7lv-qLN4AaABAg.AanYgs_F7BkAatyJNBuTPt

"I just cancelled a give back plan after signing up a few weeks ago. I don't trust any of them, if it's too good to be true it is. I received a letter after initially signing up, and it stated I would continue paying part B, I was like huh? I'm 72, in good health, take two inexpensive meds, and pay for them. I could have used the vision and dental though small, but, oh well. I'm single, alone, no family or kids, pretty scary, probably the reason for being extremely careful."

— YouTube · Medicare Part B Give Back Benefit - What's The Catch? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dMy1JJvQwTs&lc=Ugz8uFITc15-pj_BwJJ4AaABAg

"I agree. I'm more worried about my prescription drug coverage than everything. There's no way to get a good plan!!! Then there's the doughnut hole..."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgynU_VWdRjGTUAWBOR4AaABAg.9tD2TEyb_0M9tX3iGOytBK

"Unfortunately, for those of us on disability we can't afford the \$1,000 - \$1,500 monthly premiums we were quoted when we were first eligible for Medicare (and that was when I was first eligible - no telling what the cost is now). In my case, that would take the majority of my monthly benefit. You run into a problem of not being able to pay the bills necessary to survive and buy groceries if you sign up for one of these supplemental plans. So, for us it's either take original Medicare only (with possibly a drug plan) or sign up for an advantage plan and take the risk of having some major medical expense that the plan won't cover. It's really a lose - lose scenario for us. My plan is ending at the end of this year, so I may check into prices again as they said I qualified for a guarantee issue period - but if it's still that expensive, it's just not going to work for me financially. You've got to be able to pay your bills and eat to survive."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgxYJ1I99gk8jMuy1u54AaABAg>

↳ @saketashol6728 (1): "No supplement plan charges \$1000 to \$1500 per month unless your 150 years old give or take. You must be trolling or an MA agent."

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "We would be happy to help you review once you reach 65, it should be better cost for you at that time. If you need any assistance. Give us a call at 1-800-864-8890."

"This was definitely an eye opener for me and my husband! He was "sold" on a Medicare Advantage plan but I was not. I have been watching your videos for a few years now and I really, really trust you. I can't say that enough. I really trust you! We have now decided NOT to get the advantage plan. Every year at open enrollment I become a nervous wreck and feel sick because I just don't understand so much about Medicare, especially part D. My hubby is now sold on MedigapSeminars!!! If we could afford a supplement, we would get one, but it's not an option for us. Thank you so much. I'm sending you a big hug!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgxiUjwhIN4FkprhbnJ4AaABAg>

"Very well done video!!! KICKing the CAN down the road regarding SS and Medicare has been a blood sport by both parties since at least the Reagan era!! My concern as a traditional Medicare+ supplement + part D user on a fixed income is those premiums are taking more and more of my budget and I WILL NOT go to an advantage plan because I don't feel that model is sustainable in the long term. Raising revenue by raising the maximum income limit to subject wealthier individuals to the tax NOW is the only way I see to deal with this problem. Thank you for your very straightforward unbiased reporting on these issues!!"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSIfc&lc=Ugx3MhiXPv3R3LwHRJp4AaABAg>

"Kick can. Thanks for this. My Medicare Advantage plan has actually been OK, and I could even handle a bit of a cost increase. My concern is with the fact that I'll be moving to another state near the end of this year, and It's not clear whether I'll be able to get a Medicare Advantage plan that provides the same benefits in the state I'm relocating to, or whether they'll provide tier exceptions for my most costly medications, as my current insurance provider does. All of that is likely to be affected by the impending changes. I'll just have to wait and see."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgymYkEvyAiqA63TD_94AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! Yes, moving outside your coverage area does present a possible change in your options for sure :(But... maybe it improves, too!"

"I did not listen to your presentation. I lost two people I knew, one since I was 5 and another I had only known for a short time. They both had medicare advantage plans. I stopped my advantage plans in 2015 and have had original since then. I was somewhat worried about Part D, so I got a plan through CVS. They never covered any of my generic medications. So after three years, I dropped that plan and pay for my own medications. I wouldn't have it any other way now."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgxODIdQO4uwLGdsEhp4AaABAg>

Not being able to afford it on a fixed income · 43 documents · 20 voices

"Medigap Plan G High-Deductible I'm switching from Advantage to Medigap for 2025, but I'm on the fence about whether to go with Plan G or G-HD. Here's my thinking: **Medigap Premium** * Plan G-HD: \$564/year (United American) * Plan G: \$2,292/year (Cigna) * Plan G-HD is **\$1,728** less expensive **All-in cost (premiums plus deductibles)** * Plan G-HD: Part B premium (\$2,088) + Plan G-HD premium (\$564) + Plan G-HD deductible (\$2,800) = \$5,452 * Plan G: Part B premium (\$2,088) + Plan G premium (\$2,292) + Part B deductible (\$240) = \$4,620 * Plan G-HD is **\$823** more expensive However, G-HD costs will vary depending on actual medical expenses, which creates a big opportunity for savings. \$3,538 is effectively the worst case scenario because the Plan G-HD deductible is really an out-of-pocket maximum. Best case is that I don't incur any Part A or Part B costs and I pay as little as \$738 in total premiums, resulting in \$1,728 in relative savings. The spread between the best and worst case scenario is therefore \$2,251/year. Plan G is the clear winner if I'm ever hospitalized, because the \$1,632 Part A deductible, alone, would offset potential savings. G-HD is a clear winner if I stay relatively healthy and incur less than \$1,728/year in out-of-pocket costs. Due to the Part B 80/20 split, I'd need to rack up well over \$8,000 in medicare-approved expenses before my 20% share is \$1,728, which is a lot of medical care. (In fact, it's more than 5 times this year's spending.) I used my 2024 claims history as a way to predict what I might expect going forward, assuming I stay relatively healthy. My current plan has paid out about \$1,500 in Medicare-approved costs so far this year. Assuming I had had G-HD this year, my Part B coinsurance would have been 20% of that, or \$300. If I assume this represents my ongoing average use of medical services, Plan G-HD will save me around \$1,500/year. The choice ultimately boils down to my risk tolerance and budget priorities, but here's what I'm thinking: * Plan G-HD is a very good bet if I assume I can stay healthy most years. Major risks are covered and I save a substantial amount of money. * With G-HD, the savings during one healthy year (\$1,500) offsets the extra cost of having two unhealthy years (\$800/year). In that case, I pretty much break even. * Therefore, it appears Plan G only makes sense if I assume I'm going to have consistently high medical expenses. Any thoughts? Am I missing anything?"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1fxhqz9/>

↳ (0): "Husband and I did G-HD for many of the same reasons you listed. We visit the doctor twice a year for labs. Husband had a few other specialist visits but the total costs were much less than paying plan G premiums. We pay \$48/month each and are in WA. Husband switched from MA plan to this G-HD last year because he wanted more options for doctors and hospitals if things got bad. Medical underwriting was easy as they are looking at serious medical conditions."

↳ (0): "Don't you need to multiply your Part B premium by 12 to get an annual amount?"

↳ (0): "one thing to factor in: increase in Plan G vs G-HD on both the premium and deductible sides of things. even if the percentage increase on G and G-HD is the same, the premium dollars on regular G will be significantly higher than G-HD if you look at it 5 or 10 years down the line. At a 7% increase, in 10 years that regular G is 4213/yr and G-HD is 1037/yr."

"After a year of researching my Medicare options, I chose original Medicare with Plan N. Living in SW Florida, it was a close call between Plans N & High Deductible G, but because of underwriting requirements here, I had to pick the plan that would be best for the long-term. Initially, my HD-G's total costs would be cheaper (if I remain healthy). But after about 10 years, it's likely that my N's total costs would be cheaper as I need more medical services and HD-G's max out-of-pocket would keep getting higher. In the end my decision came down to my concern about HD-G's deductible increasing each year at an unpredictable rate of inflation versus the much more predictable & budgetable N monthly premiums."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyYhExgJdVDH1dnNpp4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (4): "You made a good choice. Pre- 2020 I would have chosen a G-HD myself. But now that inflation is back, it's not a risk I want to take."

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (3): "@robannmateja5000 HDG deductible has gone up 27 percent over 5 years. Having said that most people will not reach that deductible. Remember your paying only 20 percent of Medicare approved charges. Unless you have cancer you simply will not hit that deductible. NY you can switch back and forth so you can play that game. Of course that's why the regular G rates are so high."

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (0): "@MedigapSeminarschoose Plan N to avoid high rate increases of plan G, avoid HDG for inflation and EOB issues, avoid advantage plans and pay dental and vision with an HSA to avoid networks and denials."

"Thank you for what you shared here. I am 67 years old now. I was laid off earlier this year when I was 66 and received a severance package on my termination. I did not go onto Medicare until my full retirement age a few months after being laid off work. I did find contract work to help me, and it has been working out. When I learned about the IRMAA charges for my Parts B & D and how that works, I was really worried about what additional amount they would be charging me in 2028 as I know I could not afford that huge increase. My severance package is what would throw me into the 65% bracket, and I know I would not be able to afford that on what I expect my income to be in 2028. Your information here has help relieve some of the anxiety I have been feeling about dealing with 2028 Medicare payments. Thank you for all you shared with us here. Larry"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgyXZYhPsAL2hvMVIC94AaABAg>

"I am taking the risk. I self insure the 20%. As I see it: the potential, high cost illness is variable. It may happen, it may not. The Plan G Monthly Premium is fixed. It will rise over time. I may use it, I may not. But I will pay for it. Here is a much better idea: At age 65, rather than Plan G supplement, budget \$150 per month for Medical Risk, assume that number rises 6% per year. Put that money into a personal investment account, a safe one but growing too. I will use those funds as protection against the 20% self insurance risk. If I stay healthy, the incentive is a load of money that I own v. the insurance company."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugxt5VAFWFpm7mvH00B4AaABAq

↳ @aa-dz6cr (1): "Self funding is ridiculous if you have assets."

↳ @fl3609 (0): "I think it's a good idea if you are healthy now and can pass underwriting if you need it later."

↳ @jenniferpark2706 (0): "I pay less than \$40 per month for HDG to avoid that risk. I can afford this premium, but I cannot afford the risk for unknown MOOP."

"Well just got the dreaded letter from the state of California regarding my Medicaid. they are reinstating the asset test again, so on Jan 1 I will lose it, I can't afford the medigap plan and the part b premium, so most like me will be forced into a advantage plan, issue is here, is only five choices for advantage plans and plan g and n are about 200.00. I like in a rich zipcode of course! 😞. this is going to be ugly."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxLdnN0qZxAz-3XtwV4AaABAq>

↳ @TenaB-j2l (4): "Check out high deductible plan g that at least will put a lower cap on your out of pocket costs."

↳ @billjones4986 (1): "@TenaB-j2l thanks, could be a idea, I do have funds in the bank, might make sense for me."

"I'm very worried by the time I need Medicare in 3 years it will be unaffordable. Thought this was supposed to be affordable healthcare for the retired population. This is ridiculous!!!!"

— YouTube · Another HUGE INCREASE: Medicare Part D Drug Cap Has JUMPED 20% in 2 Years !! · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C_kBm_imXLg&lc=Ugz7bVvYy2POdB9A7ft4AaABAq

↳ @tmccclafferty (3): "Blame the people who wrote, supported, voted for and signed into law the Big Beautiful Bill, you can follow where your tax dollars are going to"

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "Hi Karen! That worry is completely understandable, especially watching costs climb the way they have across the board. It's worth knowing there's real help built into the system for people who need it. Medicare Savings Programs can cover your Part B premium and sometimes deductibles and copays based on income, and Extra Help does the same for Part D prescription costs — both are worth checking even if you don't think you'd qualify for full Medicaid. Costs also vary a lot depending on how things are set up — comparing carriers, choosing the right plan letter or Advantage option, and knowing which programs you might qualify for can make a real difference in what you actually end up paying. Give us a call at 1-833-833-3032 and we can help you plan ahead now, three years out, so nothing catches you off guard when the time comes."

"I have a cost share plan that allows me to use non-traditional providers. I don't want to lose that, but can't afford to pay for it and Part B. This really sucks."

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzJ-ly-XHyiZVnv9wt4AaABAg>

"Speaking as another sunburn victim, I'd like to say that your content style is exceptional. Thank you for your work. I'm turning 64 and dreading going into Medicare after being a low income Medi-Cal patient in California under the Affordable Care Act. I have some basic assets that will probably put Medi-Cal out of reach now. I'm old enough to know that our health care system in the USA has become a licensed organized crime syndicate. Now our president and his party have seemingly dismantled the Affordable Care Act. I'm afraid. But your content gave me some tools and confidence that I didn't have before. Thank you."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxRTnn-P-VtTYTkhRF4AaABAg>

↳ @wellsorted (1): "Here is my good deed for the day (unfortunately it won't help my transition from CoveredCA Medi-Cal to Medicare 😞) : "In California, Medi-Cal no longer counts assets when determining eligibility for most programs, including those for long-term care. This change, effective January 1, 2024, means that applicants' financial eligibility is now based solely on income, not on the value of their assets." So keep your assets and live long and prosper 🙌"

↳ @xf6657 (1): "@wellsorted , Thanks for that. I've been reading some info which suggests that Newsom may need to deploy "work requirements" and asset checks due to Trump's medicaid cuts. I appreciate the input. Peace."

"I am in the Twin Cities also and just found also this weekend that we don't have typical "G" and lettered plans. My research led me to the same costs as you which worries me how I will afford it. Having multiple medical issues, I don't want to risk being on an Advantage plan for all the reasons stated. I have watched hours and hours of these helpful videos only to find out now that the Minnesota system is the only state that doesn't have the typical Medicare programs."

— YouTube · Medigap vs. Medicare Advantage | Which Is Best for You in 2026? 🤖 · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3bttllCVMms&lc=Ugx6j3V2YrPkBvhAurJ4AaABAg.9uUhWyx4-NN9uUzKuXU9u3>

"Be careful of your assumptions. I considered myself a super healthy 65 yr old. I ate organic home cooked healthy meals, avoided sugar, caffeine and alcohol, exercised daily, was rarely sick and had what anyone would consider excellent health habits. A friend strongly encouraged me to stick to medigap G because she had an unexpected serious illness at 67. Her medicare advantage plan wouldn't cover all she needed, and she ended up with enormous bills. When she attempted to switch back to original medicare she was now high risk and couldn't afford any premiums offered. I am beyond grateful I listened to her because 7 months after going on medicare it was discovered I had a rare, very serious genetic disorder that required out of state specialists (who only took original Medicare). The good news of my health lifestyle is that this showed up 10-20 years later than most people, but had I not taken the medigap G route, I would either be broke, seriously disabled or worse. As it is, I've been averaging \$30,000 a yr or more of bills the last few years but all covered fully. The monthly G payments are a fraction of what I would have had to pay and totally worth it. Virtually every provider I've needed didn't take MA. Original Medicare has literally been a lifesaver. While I certainly hope you remain healthy, insurance is in case something unexpected happens. And sadly, the number of seniors I know with healthy lifestyles who have ended up with serious diseases within the first 10 yrs of medicare is surprisingly high. Healthy lifestyles are important, but there are many other factors for disease that you simply can't control. And once you are ill, your options are much narrower."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugz0SgvxDEbuGlpywyp4AaABAg.A_06NPLSOSTAbOQ4sl8I7c

"Very well done video!!! KICKing the CAN down the road regarding SS and Medicare has been a blood sport by both parties since at least the Reagan era!! My concern as a traditional Medicare+ supplement + part D user on a fixed income is those premiums are taking more and more of my budget and I WILL NOT go to an advantage plan because I don't feel that model is sustainable in the long term. Raising revenue by raising the maximum income limit to subject wealthier individuals to the tax NOW is the only way I see to deal with this problem. Thank you for your very straightforward unbiased reporting on these issues!!"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSl_fc&lc=Ugx3MhiXPv3R3LwHRJp4AaABAg

"@MedigapSeminars But the premiums for the Medicare plans could look a lot different, and with many providers refusing to accept some Medicare Advantage plans, it's difficult to say what I'd choose at this point. Things could change enough to affect my decision. Also, it only took a little over 4 1/2 years for Medicare plans C/F to be phased out. (enacted Apr. 16, 2015 and was in effect on Jan. 1, 2020) and 4.5 - 5 years is how long before I would be enrolling. I don't want a Medicare Advantage plan, so hopefully I'll be able to afford the gap plans."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugw9r3hLXY9zjijG2Kx4AaABAg.AWn7Q47HJQqAWo5ZJrxJhI>

"I have watched a lot of these videos and Minnesota has a lot of differences in cost. \$0 premium plans don't exist for Medicare Advantage or Part D. We also don't have Plans G and N, but we do have Medigap Basic and Extended Basic (similar to G) and \$20 and \$50 copay plan (similar to N). These tutorials were very confusing until I realized that. I am likely going with N to start and don't want to lose original Medicare for as long as I can afford it. This system is ridiculously over complicated."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxsHeiA2kh11FEDi5h4AaABAg>

"do NOT get a Medicare Advantage Plan, my 100 year old father has one and it's been a nightmare dealing with his Aetna Medicare Advantage plan - he never had a problem until he broke his hip. They wanted him back home before he was ready and we had to continually submit paperwork, paperwork, paperwork in order to get him the care he needed. The care home he was in hated these plans as well."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyOn6ydlQ2fyeb0niB4AaABAg

"what about moving down from a G or N to a HDG plan? does that require underwriting? or is an advantage plan the only option if someone has trouble making the rising premium cost. I worry about getting locked into a G and say 5 years down the road i cant afford the premium. Would my only option be an advantage plan to avoid underwriting or could i move to a HDG?"

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=UgwCQTKJJY3aH3-Thth4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (0): "Yes. Even moving from a regular plan G to a high deductible plan G requires underwriting."

"I gave up trying to afford a medigap plan in California, as I lost my Medicaid, feel like I was forced into a advantage plan due to cost, luckily I am relatively healthy should be fine unless I get ill, these plans best not to use them often. kinda like a gamble really. just as people get older illnesses increase."

— YouTube · Everyone's Sick of Medigap Rate Increases...Here's What to Do! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NQHG_o1vxVU&lc=Ugyf5JJ9xB1Gj6zwLWF4AaABAg

"You said it yourself in a previous video that you can't switch to a supplement plan from an advantage plan. Also, what if someone has is younger with disability social security medicare with state medicaid, I believe you can't get a supplement plan but can get an advantage plan 🤔"

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgzDbymb31VdaftkPvR4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "There are a few ways to switch. Not always straightforward, but there are ways. When talking about disability and Medicare pre-65, this varies a lot by state. There are some states that allow and offer Supplement plans to those with a disability. These states are the exception, not the rule. Most states have some form of Advantage plan only and those with a disability must get an Advantage plan. All depends on where you live. Thank you for watching and great question!"

↳ @jdenino6022 (0): "@Theretirementnerds the U.S. is ass backwards with health insurance. 🤔"

"If your social Security is \$1000 a month will I be able to get a supplemental plan or will I be pushed into a Medicaid plan which I absolutely don't want?"

— YouTube · Do I Need Medigap? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7JMcg_PV4Ns&lc=Ugzadf9EM7KyYeyuk0F4AaABAg

↳ @RichM3000 (1): "It's not like ACA, where too low of an income can "force" people into Medicaid (they don't have to enroll in Medicaid, but they can't get subsidized ACA insurance). You get Medicare at 65 and buy supplements on the open market."

"what if you are low income turning 65, I can't afford 185.00 or whatever it is out of my check. is it based on your income. only making 12,000 a year"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1pLq6moM&lc=UgwkEBRmV3hCFzROHXF4AaABAg>

↳ @SheLovesKnowledge (0): "They do have programs to help for poverty level earners. I'm not sure what all it helps with but I know it could cover the cost of Part B, which you HAVE to have. Call social security and find out for sure"

"I'm worried about my 2027 Social Security increase being offset by higher Medicare costs. My monthly budget is already tight."

— YouTube · 2027 Social Security & Medicare ALERT: What You'll Actually Keep · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RIP9lckspiw&lc=UgyWdzeK1jysegnlLqN4AaABAg.AamV3juRhDJAamzST5tRFY>

Stuck: failing underwriting, no way back to a Medigap · 35 documents · 20 voices

"@Wildflowerz57 good plan! My parents are both on med advantage and love it, same with my Medicare clients. Advantage isn't for everyone, and I have some clients on supplements because that is their preference and they can afford the premiums, but the vast majority are happily on advantage PPOs with huge networks & solid care. I have also seen older folks paying \$700 plus total monthly for part B, med supplement, and drug plan because they're stuck in an obsolete med supplement and can't qualify for another one, and are scared to move because of videos like this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtlsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABAg.9Zo-abmMTzA9aY40j57arF>

"I've thought along the same lines. But based on the meetings I've attended over the years with different insurance companies, I believe the future of Medicare Advantage is going to be heavily weighted toward HMO plans. Last year was a good example of that shift, with many PPO options being pulled from the marketplace. Because of this trend, I actually think it will cause more people to hang on to - and even purchase - Medicare supplements than we might expect, since many don't want to be locked into restrictive HMO networks."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyNSEImQ0NTVmpgkcV4AaABAg.AMN6TrEcJsQAMNOraNjvCT

"My question that I can't ever find an answer to is what if you have one or more pre-existing conditions and want to get insurance? Is it possible to even get insurance for part G? All of the videos I find are for 'planning at 65 with minimal health issues'. How much does it cost for 'planning at 67 and I have several health issues that cost a lot every year.' Or are you just turned down? Is there some safety net insurance the government backs?"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans - What's Changed for 2026 · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qQtzKellvpk&lc=Ugzuk426mhTx694navd4AaABAq>

↳ @Inspector.ClueSo (1): "You get a g or n without underwriting no matter what your ailment the first time you sign up within 6 months of signing up for B"

↳ @sfree322 (0): "If you're 67 and already on a Medicare Advantage plan, in most states you'll need to go through medical underwriting (health screening) to switch to a Medicare supplement plan and they have the option to deny you or charge you a much higher premium. But if you sign up for traditional Medicare plus a Medigap supplement when you initially sign up at age 65 there is no health screening requirement. I think there's also a one year exception where you can switch from Advantage plan to a supplement plan without health screening in the first 12 months you're enrolled in Medicare."

"I am concerned as those who chose advantage trying to switch back to regular medicare later would be given penalty additional monthly charges and sometimes be denied for pre existing health issues."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw8-92XixbSzt4mnV4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "This is not the case in the context of this video"

↳ @gramig0 (1): "Hasn't happened in my experience."

"I am beginning to wonder about my BCBS advantage plan. When I got medicare I had no health issues and the sales person said this would be the best for me so I got it. On the second year of having the plan I got stage 1 breast cancer. They pretty much covered everything except they disagreed with my doctor on the number of radiation treatments. They said for my stage of breast cancer I only needed 4 instead of 5 or 6 treatments. So I got the 4. Turns out so far they paid all but 6000+ of my treatment. When I had to have another biopsy done they only covered \$208. of the procedure. They are both still pending and I'm worried I am going to be stuck with the bill totalling over \$10,000."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugynw5nW7W69BUVLOqV4AaABAq>

"I asked A.I to give me a comparison of plan N vs G high deductible. I asked it to include rate increase do to age as well as a break down of years with high medical cost and years with low cost. I hope this is somewhat accurate and helpful. Summary of your Medigap cost comparison Assumptions for the 20-year comparison Initial Premiums (Year 1): \$480 for High-Deductible Plan G (HDG) and \$1,920 for Plan N. Annual Premium Increase: 10% (reflects Oregon's "attained-age" pricing). 20-Year Cost Scenario: A mix of low and high medical costs to reflect variability over time. High-Cost Year (4 years): Assumes you pay the full High-Deductible Plan G deductible (\$2,870) or the Plan N out-of-pocket costs (Part B deductible + copays). Low-Cost Year (16 years): Assumes your out-of-pocket costs are below the HDG deductible. 20-year cost comparison with detailed breakdown

	Year	HDG Premium	HDG Out-of-Pocket	HDG Annual Total	Plan N Premium	Plan N Out-of-Pocket	Plan N Annual Total
1		\$480	\$1,000	\$1,480	\$1,920	\$257*	\$2,177*
2		\$528	\$1,000	\$1,528	\$2,112	\$257*	\$2,369*
3	(High)	\$578	\$2,870	\$3,448	\$2,323	\$357	\$2,680
4		\$636	\$1,000	\$1,636	\$2,555	\$257*	\$2,812*
5		\$699	\$1,000	\$1,699	\$2,811	\$257*	\$3,068*
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
8	(High)	\$930	\$2,870	\$3,800	\$3,745	\$357	\$4,102
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
14	(High)	\$1,659	\$2,870	\$4,529	\$6,664	\$357	\$7,021
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
18	(High)	\$2,427	\$2,870	\$5,297	\$9,754	\$357	\$10,111
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
20		\$2,933	\$1,000	\$3,933	\$11,811	\$257*	\$12,068*

*Note: Out-of-pocket costs are approximations. Total 20-year costs Plan 20-Year Total High-Deductible G ~\$45,176 Plan N ~\$116,020

Final takeaway Choosing between Plan N and High-Deductible Plan G is a trade-off between risk and cost. High-Deductible Plan G is significantly cheaper over the long term, but it exposes you to the risk of being locked into a high-deductible plan if your health deteriorates. Plan N, with its higher premiums, offers greater predictability and protection against future health risks."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=UgyRizFYcM8B2gnVInt4AaABAg>

↳ @janc8199 (0): "One good thing about NY..you're not locked in, you can switch easily with under writing...The bad thing about NY, all the plans are way higher than other States. What else is new."

"I currently have a guaranteed issue right because of Aetna signature PPO leaving the market. I would like to go with a Medigap plan, but I am concerned about blocks closing out and being stuck in that plan due to a pre-existing condition, which in my case is polycythemia vera. Will that prevent me from moving from one Medigap plan to another?"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=Ugy7yHOQjguGz0QJduV4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (7): "Thanks for reaching out. Think of it like this, you just got a once in lifetime opportunity to get on a Medicare Supplement plan. Don't overthink it! To answer your question about moving from one Medigap company to another, yes, unfortunately, that condition would prevent you from passing medical underwriting. Remember two things, ALL, I repeat ALL Medigap companies close blocks, its the nature of the industry. Lastly, if you move to a Medigap plan and it gets to expensive down the road, you can always move back to a Medicare Advantage plan."

"My primary concerns with Advantage Plans are networks and pre-authorization. I think a supplement would be my best option but worry about getting locked in. If you start with a Medicare Supplement, can you switch to an Advantage Plan without qualifying?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgxMIgMN2K6reDQ5j0t4AaABAg>

"I have had a sudden onset of lots of heart problems.....I was in Plan G before it all started. I knew I was paying for the gold standard and not using it...but I was afraid that if I ever did have a major health problem...then I would not be able to get plan G because of underwriting. I am so glad that I paid the extra those years... because now I have no money worries about the cost of these procedures and operations. Without plan G I would be both broke and sick."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzDvnDtpQU21R5cA9V4AaABAq>

"@ThanksForTheLaugh Im just starting in January and Im looking at the HDG as Im worried in 5 years i wont be able to manage a G premium as it is over 300 a month here now and then the only option is a MA plan if I need to avoid underwriting.. so for close to the same price premium as a MA plan, the HDG plan deductible is about 3,000 and where i am and the MA plans are 5,000 to 6,000 max out of pocket. Im still uncertain which is the best risk ratio to try"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugw1Papg7_BLo3AgLm14AaABAq.AOIngKCLjCWAOKaMqj_1b0

"Be careful of your assumptions. I considered myself a super healthy 65 yr old. I ate organic home cooked healthy meals, avoided sugar, caffeine and alcohol, exercised daily, was rarely sick and had what anyone would consider excellent health habits. A friend strongly encouraged me to stick to medigap G because she had an unexpected serious illness at 67. Her medicare advantage plan wouldn't cover all she needed, and she ended up with enormous bills. When she attempted to switch back to original medicare she was now high risk and couldn't afford any premiums offered. I am beyond grateful I listened to her because 7 months after going on medicare it was discovered I had a rare, very serious genetic disorder that required out of state specialists (who only took original Medicare). The good news of my health lifestyle is that this showed up 10-20 years later than most people, but had I not taken the medigap G route, I would either be broke, seriously disabled or worse. As it is, I've been averaging \$30,000 a yr or more of bills the last few years but all covered fully. The monthly G payments are a fraction of what I would have had to pay and totally worth it. Virtually every provider I've needed didn't take MA. Original Medicare has literally been a lifesaver. While I certainly hope you remain healthy, insurance is in case something unexpected happens. And sadly, the number of seniors I know with healthy lifestyles who have ended up with serious diseases within the first 10 yrs of medicare is surprisingly high. Healthy lifestyles are important, but there are many other factors for disease that you simply can't control. And once you are ill, your options are much narrower."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugz0SgvxDEbuGlpwyxp4AaABAq.A_06NPLSOSTAbOQ4sl8I7c

"Ok i went to the link and read. It does say that if say you started with a medigap Plan say plan N and your company went bankrupt (most likely scenario for me) that you are guaranteed to be able to buy a Plan G like you stated and there is no N just like you said. This is confusing in the fact that your not guaranteed to go to another company and just buy another Plan N that you started with. So what if say you start with Plan N and your state has an anniversary rule where you can change companies without underwriting if you think that rates on your company has gotten too high. With an N plan this isn't a Guaranteed possibility so in essence with a Plan N your stuck without undergoing underwriting or another company can turn you down making your states anniversary rule null with a Plan N?"

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgyogOp5XbH5Qjfwk0J4AaABAq.A8KTewJuQnbA8KnRX1ulDr>

"Travel and Soda go hand in hand when I get in the car ! I'm currently on advantage in CT, age 70. Bought a second home in FL. Was told that I can switch to traditional Medicare, and a medigap plan starting Oct.15th while still in CT, THEN, can simply take it with me to FL, if I sold my CT home. I do not want to be subject to underwriting. Is this true that I can " lock in" a plan FIRST in CT, or, is it just better to WAIT until I actually sell the CT home and THEN announce a change of address which would trigger the " guaranteed issue rights" because of moving ? My current advantage plan DOES operate in the area where my FL property is located. Thx !"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgwuTF6Euc2Yei73mqd4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch! 🙏📖 Another video went kind of viral so I'm trying to catch up on comments! If you are officially moving to Florida, you can switch to a supplement plan in Florida without underwriting or... as you stated... you can go on a Supplement plan during the Annual Enrollment Period while in CT (for Part D drug plan reasons is why you'd switch during AEP) and that supplement plan can travel with you to Florida or anywhere else in the US. If your health is good, might as well save some money and wait to switch until you will actually be going to Florida."

"Excellent analysis! I did similar research last year in FL and also picked Plan N with MOO. The other day, I got my first notice of increase, 4%. When I was deciding, I narrowed it down to N or HD-G. I'd love to see your analysis between those two plans. For me, it came down to being too concerned about the unpredictable increases to the HD-G deductible and being unable to pass underwriting to switch plans."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgxZ1a7nVcWBpfz4bEp4AaABAg>

↳ @IwasRetired (3): "See my original video. HD deductibles adjust with CPI every year but Plan N copays are hard coded into law. So I think over time the copays become even more affordable."

↳ @dennislplant95 (2): "@IwasRetired Plan N will remain the best long-term value for most people (depends on ZIP) as long as its premium costs rise at about the same amounts as HD-G and you have an average number of copays."

↳ @dennislplant95 (1): "@IwasRetired You may want to take a look at the Medigap Out-of-Pocket Calculator by State that was made by the people at Medicare Nationwide. It factors in projections based on Kaiser Family Foundation findings and premium and rate increases based on NAIC Medicare Supplement Experience Exhibits."

"15:43 - what are the "certain circumstances" where you lose plan N coverage that you could not enroll in a new plan N without underwriting? For example, if a company cancels their plan N, would you need underwriting to enroll in a new plan n? I'm considering either plan N or high deductible plan G, but I'm concerned about the underwriting question. Great video too, btw."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgyEGMW8I2eM5K0sAo14AaABAq>

↳ @TFM-4ever (1): "@IwasRetired - Thank you so much. I will look into this link. When you have a moment, please also provide a link to your video on high deductible plan G. Appreciate the info."

↳ @IwasRetired (0): "A broker who knows you state laws is best to answer that question. I do know Boomer Benefits has article on guaranteed issue rights."

↳ @IwasRetired (0): "<https://boomerbenefits.com/medicare-supplement-guaranteed-issue/>";

"I am 78 and have a plan f. Unfortunately, my supplement company has become unstable and has been raising my premium 10% a year for several years. My current monthly premium is \$440. Mo. I would like to change to a different company for a lower premium but am afraid I will not pass underwriting due to my weight. I am 5'2" 300 lbs. Any suggestions? My zip code is 60067."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwD0BssDok_O_vK1dd4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Hi Beverly, this is quite common with supplement plans. Would you mind sending me an email to erik@90daysfromretirement.com with your zip code? Where you live will impact the answer to that question. Thank you for watching and sharing your experience."

"what about moving down from a G or N to a HDG plan? does that require underwriting? or is an advantage plan the only option if someone has trouble making the rising premium cost. I worry about getting locked into a G and say 5 years down the road i cant afford the premium. Would my only option be an advantage plan to avoid underwriting or could i move to a HDG?"

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=UgwCQTKJJY3aH3-Thth4AaABAq>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (0): "Yes. Even moving from a regular plan G to a high deductible plan G requires underwriting."

"I have Traditional Medicare with a supplemental plan and my husband has a Medicare Advantage Plan. I am concerned that if my husband switches to Traditional Medicare he will be denied coverage because of pre-existing conditions. As you mentioned, he will be subject to underwriting. So, he will probably will stay with his Medicare Advantage plan."

— YouTube · Unhappy with Medicare Advantage? How to Leave Your Advantage Plan for Original Medicare · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5h5ErGtBYLQ&lc=UgyqC3B06xNpd-KFNcd4AaABAq>

"You said it yourself in a previous video that you can't switch to a supplement plan from an advantage plan. Also, what if someone has is younger with disability social security medicare with state medicaid, I believe you can't get a supplement plan but can get an advantage plan 🤔 "

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgzDbymb31VdafkPvR4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "There are a few ways to switch. Not always straightforward, but there are ways. When talking about disability and Medicare pre-65, this varies a lot by state. There are some states that allow and offer Supplement plans to those with a disability. These states are the exception, not the rule. Most states have some form of Advantage plan only and those with a disability must get an Advantage plan. All depends on where you live. Thank you for watching and great question!"

↳ @jdenino6022 (0): "@Theretirementnerds the U.S. is ass backwards with health insurance. 🤔 "

"@Theretirementnerds My dad had a stroke at 64, and someone got accepted to AARP/UNH's supplemental plan at some point cause he died using the plan at 82, with cancer, in intensive care. No doubt huge cost were run up, yet we never got a bill. That's when I thought, 'that's the plan for me.' But that was 18 years ago, and costs have gone way up. I know how much he was laying cause I've seen his cancelled checks, and it's much more now. But if I could know I wouldn't need surgery or chemo at the time I turned 65, or that my risks were higher for developing cancer, I'd do MA and subject myself to the risk of underwriting later. If you're not accepted, you're still limited to a max-out-of-pocket with a M.A. plan that's not that much more than what you'd pay in supplemental premiums that year anyway. Plus you'd get extra's thrown in with the M.A. plan. I'm just wondering if a drug plan that gets connected to your Medicare, such that Medicare knows you have a qualifying plan so you don't get penalized, benefits from a reduced premium due to it being a Medicare approved plan. Same for vision and dental. I've been told that if you go the M.A. route, the extra stuff can only be the plans that go with that M.A. and you can't choose the terms. But if you go supplement, you can choose, since you're paying extra. Still, I want a discount if I'm choosing from a list of 'available' plans in my area and am not allowed just anything out there in the private market. If you don't get a discount on the extra supplemental plan benefits that you must also pay each month, then I'm not benefitting from it being a Medicare approved plan that's 'available in my area.' Do you get what I'm saying?"

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgzlsHmZ_mR11mtKkBp4AaABAg.9j0yd1aL3aw9o0jy9t4uoM

Choosing wrong, missing a deadline, the penalty · 20 documents · 20 voices

"I've been researching Medicare for the past few months as I am getting ready to have to make some decisions.. I found this video very helpful and informative... I have been so stressed as I don't want to make the wrong decision. This was a great overview and just helped calm my mind a bit. Nothing is easy or straight forward for sure...Thank You!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211lpLq6moM&lc=UgzdEe01DRkZ7syX6od4AaABAg>

"I am concerned as those who chose advantage trying to switch back to regular medicare later would be given penalty additional monthly charges and sometimes be denied for pre existing health issues."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw8-92XixbSzst4mnV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "This is not the case in the context of this video"

↳ @gramig0 (1): "Hasn't happened in my experience."

"Thank you so much. I turn 65 in December of this year and my open enrollment starts on September 1st. I will be honest. I have watched a lot of your videos and they are helpful, but I am now intimidated and pretty frozen with fear of making a mistake I will pay for for the rest of my life. You would think it would be easier on seniors. I hope you can help me."

— YouTube · When To NOT Call A Medicare Broker · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zEYptYsaMGY&lc=Ugyof5Nv7Kmjv---GoB4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "We can help! Call us at 888-465-9728. We look forward to it."

"I do find MA plans to be somewhat deceptive. These plans are also heavily promoted unlike traditional Medicare. A friend went to a free lunch presentation of an MA plan, signed up for it, and abandoned her previous traditional Medicare/Supp. plan. Initially, it was all quite good for her. The MA plan included a senior exercise program and very basic vision/dental benefits which were not included with regular Medicare. Then, she unexpectedly developed a serious illness. She could no longer go to the exercise class. Several of the doctors she trusted dropped out of the approved MA plan network and she had to seek new ones which was very upsetting at a time when she was quite ill. Then, she started having to pay all these charges not covered under her MA plan. Before she passed away, she told me that switching to the MA plan was a huge mistake resulting in undue anxiety and stress for her and her family. An MA plan may be right for you, but be aware of what could happen. There are costs on the back end and you may have to change to an in-network doctor or doctors at some point."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzijlkC4UNmgDhmvTI4AaABAg>

↳ @commonsense6967 (1): "Unfortunately, most people don't check to see whether their doctors, or hopefully, most of the doctors in an area accept their MA plan before they take it, AND they never check the CMS star rating on a plan before signing up for it. Many of the plans people are unhappy with are only rated one, two, or three quality stars, and then they're disappointed by their experiences with the Plan, If they'd pick a 4 or 5 star Plan instead, they'd be much happier with the level of care, cost and choice/number of doctors in the plan. (I know, mine is a 5 star MA and it's a good one. Very few doctors ever leave it.)"

↳ @RudyDoody-z3q (0): "Margaret, you are right! They NEVER tell you about the deductible. They paint such a rosy picture. When you get over 65, you never know when your health is going to be compromised. Prepare for health problems with a Medicare Supplement. Those problems ARE coming, down the road. When you're in the hospital, you don't want to worry about bills and empty bank accounts."

"My favorite animals are my playful dogs. I love this channel and feel that the information provided is excellent. My sister is struggling in her decision on whether to keep her supplement plan or switch to an advantage plan and this video provided very clear unbiased info. The rising costs of the G supplement may force her to go to an advantage plan just because of the upfront monthly cost. When someone has a known issue like previous heart attack or diabetes or a high family risk of cancer, are the out of pocket expense caps the true limit with advantage plans or are there some hidden exceptions or obscure detail to look out for when reviewing options? During the Oct-Dec enrollment period, Can an advantage plan carrier drop you as a client or force you to go to a different plan if you are a high risk or frequent user of benefits?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxCC53QoPhJP40BRLZ4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "The max out of pocket is the cap in that year for approved procedures. If not approved, it is not covered. The insurance company cannot target individuals and kick them off the plan. Insurance companies can end plans at the end of the year but it is for everyone on that plan, not an individual. If this happens, there are several options to get coverage covered in this video here: <https://youtu.be/8Pq6H7UzBbU?is=c-lKjB7Hnl3CANYc>";

"I currently live in Florida and am turning 65 in September. I plan to enroll in a Medigap plan (currently considering G/N) and a Rx plan. I'm new to your channel, so this may have already been covered, but are there any insurance carriers that have consistently received good ratings from people on their plans? Like every other person facing this decision, I don't want to make a mistake I will regret later. Thank you so much for providing all the information you share on your channel. (I am currently in good health and use minimal medication)"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans - What's Changed for 2026 · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qQtzKellvpk&lc=UgyJVK4V9RV1rSFUaBZ4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "We would be happy to advise more on the plans in your specific area! Call my team at 888-465-9728 or email stephanie@abtinsuranceagency.com 😊 "

"I'm so worried that I'll make a mistake. I definitely need original with supplement. Turned 65 in July, I have 3 months to change. If I don't do it now the underwriting will take half my income and I'm already struggling. Wish some kind of goddess could guide me to make sure I don't screw this up. Been on disability for 20 years, I know an advantage plan will bankrupt what little I have. Any advice will help 🙏 "

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugxlg-NfG4v2SjAqjQt4AaABAg>

"Very informative. I'm about to turn 80, enrolled in Plan F 15 yrs ago when it was still available. I had a conversation with a Medigap rep who suggested I should consider switching to a plan G, but I'm concerned I might regret it."

— YouTube · The Medicare Math Nobody Shows You · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LJ3P5gL1JFW&lc=Ugx_F_WW1SMAShauJbJ4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "If you are able to switch to G, it would likely save you money... not everything is about money though"

↳ @jessicamcneil5624 (0): "@Theretirementnerds do you have a video on the differences or do I need to speak with a specialist?"

"Thank you for all your advice. I will soon be a first time medicare person so I'm afraid of making any mistakes."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxCdGlo5Xwn9yEChkB4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (0): "You're very welcome! It's completely normal to feel that way—Medicare can be confusing at first. The good news is, you're asking questions and learning early, which puts you ahead of the game. If you take your time and compare your options carefully, you'll do great! Call us if you need help when the time comes."

"Reply: Hi [User], I understand that navigating Medicare can be overwhelming, but no worries, we're here to help clarify things for you! Highmark is a health insurance company that offers Medicare Advantage plans, among other insurance options. Medicare Advantage plans are private health plans approved by Medicare to provide benefits to Medicare beneficiaries. If your specialist informed you that you're not technically on Medicare, it's possible that you may have enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan offered by Highmark. These plans work differently from original Medicare, but they still provide you with Medicare benefits. If you're concerned about being enrolled in the wrong plan, I recommend reaching out to Highmark or your plan's customer service to further understand the details of your coverage. They should be able to provide you with the necessary information and options available to you. Remember, open enrollment periods may allow you to make changes to your Medicare Advantage plan. It's important to familiarize yourself with your plan's rules regarding enrollment and disenrollment. Consult with a Medicare specialist if needed to make sure you're making the best decision for your healthcare needs. Please don't hesitate to ask if you have any more questions or need further assistance. We're here to support you! Take care, Medicare on Video"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgweyeASuiOtc3eK87l4AaABAg.9wLPxfhgLT9wLR2br1USN>

"I made the biggest mistake ever changing to Cigna Medicare, great doctor, office staff are a nightmare. No major health issues, my annual exam includes a bone density test, mammogram and a ct scan and decided no colonoscopy. All this listed under well care. Decided no colonoscopy, cologuard instead, insurance paid all but \$50, I'm going thru disputing, not hopeful. Chest scan, they want \$300 out of pocket. Referral system is a nightmare, I made 4 calls for the mammogram info, finally talked to someone, it was completed within a few weeks of the Dr putting in the request, I had a conversation with the Dr about it, apologized, it was up to me to follow up. FYI..Cigna sold their Medicare to Health Springs, nothing's going to change next year. This is the worst case of Medicare fraud, I pray for people who have no one to guide them through this nightmare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugz2Q5iboIP8fH8Sj3B4AaABAq>

"Medicare enrollment is not automatic. I did not receive any letter from them. I called 3 mos. before I turned 65 but I was told I was not eligible as I was still working because I had health insurance. 3 mos. after I turned 65, I applied in 2021 again for Medicare as I was afraid I'll get the forever late penalty. Again, I was told that I was not eligible because I had health insurance. After I turned 66 & a month before I retired, I went to SS office and I was informed that I was given a wrong information. I should've been enrolled. I got retiree health insurance from my employer for part B & D. I wrote them a letter about their error but they are still charging me for the late fee. Now, I pay \$430 with IRMAA surcharge."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgwbnsFcBI-Ec_4cxd4AaABAq

↳ @GUITARTIME2024 (0): "Send another letter. Dont give up. You might get lucky and hear good news."

"@noemirivera-m9y- Yikes! That is 4x what we pay here in Vermont for the same plan. And our HC costs are ridiculously high. The plan D problem is that you need to carry one (drug coverage) or risk a big penalty later to try to get on one later if you need to. My wife and I have almost no drug prescriptions at age 68. We both got prescribed statins, and have both decided to get off them. I also have a BP drug that I could probably drop. The only thing doctors do today is put people on drugs. You need to decide what drugs you want to be on."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Plan N Worth It? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V64x-sWEALg&lc=UgzROE-b6k8Z_vsMtO94AaABAq.ARX7uf_d7HAsHEAEEd3nfA

"I'm in the second group of the "don't take medicare" --my spouse is working for a large company and the coverage is better and cheaper than medicare. I understand there won't be penalties if I wait, BUT: will I be able to get a medigap G plan when he retires *without needing to pass a health screening*? I have pre-existing conditions and am concerned that the special enrollment period would still entail a health qualification? Like if people want to switch from an advantage plan to medigap, and have to pass a health qualification to do so."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugx-Zq--moipFVjX_1d4AaABAq

"I have Medicare and anthem Blue Cross is my Supplementary insurance. My Anthem premium is 268.00 per month. I do not have dental or hearing. I will be 90 on the first of December and I am fearful of jumping around and discovering later I made a mistake. I'm on a fixed income and when I pay all my insurances and credit cards and taxes, there is not much left. I do wish I had some help with dental for dental hygiene, etc. Do you have any suggestions or do you think I'm doing the best I can? STEPHANIE WHAT DO YOU THINK?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzB9wGtjWm2yVNotll4AaABAg>

↳ @tonyalexa1120 (0): "Hello 🙌 Roberta... How are you doing today? And happy 😊 thanksgiving to you and your family over there! 😊 "

"@AbtInsuranceAgency Thanks! I am using my wife's company health insurance since I collect social security benifit at 62, So if I don't reject part A I am afraid if I will mess up the hsa. I just want my health insurance as it is for now because I have diabetic type 1. Thanks and appreciate for your help!"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYl75xJnKg&lc=Ugw9LbE2Dy2yKBJX8fR4AaABAg.A2ceqZnKCqCA2eERQ753xX>

"I'm turning 65 in April. I intend to continue working and use my company's group insurance. Also, I have an 18-year old daughter covered on that plan. Do I have to sign up for Medicare Part A? My concern is missing a required window and paying lifetime penalties. Thank you."

— YouTube · What is Medigap? (Medicare Supplement Insurance Explained) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RnXi0LJRNvY&lc=UgxovBvk2zv8XhGzud4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "No, you can delay Part A without penalty. When you go to enroll in Medicare upon retirement, your Part A will be made retroactive."

"Is highmark considered a Medicare advantage? I'm so lost in this. My specialist told me I'm not technically on Medicare so I'm scared I enrolled in the wrong plan. And I can't unenroll?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgweyeASuiOtc3eK87l4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (0): "Reply: Hi [User], I understand that navigating Medicare can be overwhelming, but no worries, we're here to help clarify things for you! Highmark is a health insurance company that offers Medicare Advantage plans, among other insurance options. Medicare Advantage plans are private health plans approved by Medicare to provide benefits to Medicare beneficiaries. If your specialist informed you that you're not technically on Medicare, it's possible that you may have enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan offered by Highmark. These plans work differently from original Medicare, but they still provide you with Medicare benefits. If you're concerned about being enrolled in the wrong plan, I recommend reaching out to Highmark or your plan's customer service to further understand the details of your coverage. They should be able to provide you with the necessary information and options available to you. Remember, open enrollment periods may allow you to make changes to your Medicare Advantage plan. It's important to familiarize yourself with your plan's rules regarding enrollment and disenrollment. Consult with a Medicare specialist if needed to make sure you're making the best decision for your healthcare needs. Please don't hesitate to ask if you have any more questions or need further assistance. We're here to support you! Take care, Medicare on Video"

"What if I move during a plan year and have elected a supplement plan, is there a penalty or medical exam required in my new state?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxyxJSN_dAYhsi1VPp4AaABAg

"My parents with chronic diabetes related health issues like heart failure and kidney disease mistakenly went into the advantage plan nightmare. This was a big mistake in their situation. They started rationing their medicine because of the high costs passed onto them. And once you are in that system you can't get back to original plus supplemental without underwriting. They were basically stuck until they ran out of money all together and ended up on Medicaid. I tell everyone I know how bad advantage is and warn people to stay away from them. They are the biggest scam on retirees from my perspective. They lure people with limited income into these plans because of the low cost premiums. I feel the same way about the High Deductible plans as well. This was a great video to help explain the maze that is Medicare and supplemental plans."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzo7ymquxD-781pCLR4AaABAg>

Travel and care out of state · 13 documents · 13 voices

"There has to be a cost savings and/or risk reduction for the government to push advantage plans. Considering the restrictions involved with advantage (approvals for services, staying within networks, potential high deductible), I don't see the benefit for a relatively slight increase in cost contrasted with traditional Medicare and Medigap policy. Anyway I want to travel and if I need medical services on a trip I can't be worrying about staying within network and getting approval for services. -- Ms. Abt does a great job explaining this stuff."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8Sji0S1o&lc=UgxVqA0ZppghheEgmBt4AaABAg.95PNrwgrN4l9Ftg4stkizC>

"Sunburn: I'm 77, I live in Florida, since starting Medicare (12 years ago!) I've tried many plans. At first while my husband was still working as CFO of the company he owned we just stayed on his company's employee plan. Then I did some calculations and it appeared that not only were WE paying more, but HIS COMPANY was paying more needlessly! HE was shocked. From there we went on plan N, later on G, then Advantage, then G. He passed. Now I'm on Advantage. Since I spend 4 mos/yr in another state, I feared that if I had medical needs there they would not be covered. I see a dermatologist in my other state and this year I only paid \$80 out of pocket for that visit. Until my health deteriorates I plan to stay on advantage. This was the best video on Medicare choices I have ever seen— nor has anyone ever carefully explained the cost differences among the plans. Bravo!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwQ3lPiQ5wr80EKjrp4AaABAg>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (2): "Once your health deteriorates, you may be stuck in your Advantage plan. If you want to move up to a G or N plan....you will probably have to go through medical underwriting.....and they will likely deny you if you have bad health."

↳ @jamesmcconnell2131 (0): "@DankFarrikMe Yes, Always try to be so healthy you wouldn't need health insurance even though you actually have health insurance."

"My medicare advantage provider will, literally, not talk to me when I'm outside my home state. They won't talk on the phone or provide tele-health services. They also block access to their website when I'm outside the country. I can't review test results or make future appointments for when I get home. Considering that I have given up my original part A and B coverage it's gotten scary to travel. A lot of seniors want to travel. This should be a consideration when choosing an advantage plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8Sji0S1o&lc=UgwyZtU41V3f3yXgAy94AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (2): "This is a very good point to consider - thank you for sharing!"

"I'm on Medicare due to permanent disability. I also have Medicaid as a secondary. I like this channel because in time, if I no longer qualify for the Medicaid secondary, I want to know what is out there for me. Unfortunately, I have to wait until I'm 65 (5 more years!) before I can even get a supplemental plan to my Medicare. My biggest concern about an Advantage plan is the limited physicians in the group. I'm in a small town, so it's even worse for me because I have to travel a long distance for specialists. The last thing I need is the insurance company telling me I have to travel to a specialist included in their group that's 3-4 hours away. I prefer to have more power than the insurance company and also, not have to always have a referral for a specialist. Some specialists require them, even on Medicare, like neurologists and doctors like that. I'm definitely team #Ann'smom! :)"

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugz2IUNXNXT99E_hf_54AaABAg

↳ @kciis (1): "Thank you for sharing your experience! Navigating Medicare and Medicaid can be challenging, especially with the limitations in your area. It's great to have a community where we can learn and support each other!"

"Excellent video, especially giving some real-life examples. I'm in a plan N, my wife chose plan G. She got scared of N watching a guy who claims excess charges are growing and a real risk. We both went medigap because we travel extensively, and don't want to worry about away from home illnesses. (She also is a retired PT and doesn't like how advantage handles skilled nursing.) My state (OK) has a birthday rule that lets us switch medigap plans of the same plan each year. I can go N to a different N, she can go G or N. When we get too old to extensively travel there is an advantage plan that covers all the major hospitals and providers locally, we may financially have to switch eventually. We've both been pleased with our medigap coverage, our biggest concern is losing employee dental. Vision and hearing haven't been as big an issue for us."

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=UgyQrL3Hut6z3k3pjF14AaABAg>

↳ @GiardiniMedicare (1): "Thank you for the detailed perspective! Definitely agree with everything you said, and as someone with a wife who is also a PT, I can attest she is not a fan of MA plans relating to skilled nursing (or most things) 😊"

"Kick can. Thanks for this. My Medicare Advantage plan has actually been OK, and I could even handle a bit of a cost increase. My concern is with the fact that I'll be moving to another state near the end of this year, and it's not clear whether I'll be able to get a Medicare Advantage plan that provides the same benefits in the state I'm relocating to, or whether they'll provide tier exceptions for my most costly medications, as my current insurance provider does. All of that is likely to be affected by the impending changes. I'll just have to wait and see."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSIfc&lc=UgymYkEvyAiqA63TD_94AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! Yes, moving outside your coverage area does present a possible change in your options for sure :(But... maybe it improves, too!"

"What if I get a Part D plan in CA at the same time I am getting Part B, but then a year later move to another state, or US commonwealth (such as Puerto Rico)? I assume I would have to apply for another Part D plan in the new location, will I have to pass through medical underwriting? Same question for purchased a Plan G plan in CA and then moving to another state or US commonwealth"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement coverage denied? Why insurance companies deny you (and what to do about) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iHQdxXXdiQo&lc=Ugx2DmBSJ4tbjF_6wJJ4AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (2): "Part D drug plans don't have medical underwriting. If you move out of the state then you will have 63 days to change your Part D plan. For Plan G/Medigap plans, you don't have to change your plan if you move - it works nationwide in the US and its territories. Your plan travels with you. If you do choose to change your plan G when you move, then medical underwriting will apply."

"Sunburn, very educational. I am 73 and always on Medicare plus supplement G, pretty healthy but I travel, and don't want the unexpected costs of deductibles. I never want to have to defer going to an ER for worrying over costs, want to pick my own docs, etc. semi retired RN here. Did go to an advantage plan for one year to help pay for hearing aids only 😊 ."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwNaYh6SuefVkuWJW54AaABAg>

"what if you are still working past 65 and currently live abroad. should I still enroll for Part A? How do I prove I have insurance at my job, to delay Part B and not be subject to penalties? Thank you"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwUVedcmSuAJezf8hl4AaABAg>

"So much is just guesswork. Guess how long you'll live? Guess if you'll get a major illness? Guess how long it will be before you get that major illness? Guess how much it will cost since it goes up every year? It's all guesswork and estimates so run the numbers. ALSO Medicare Advantage Plans are local. If you have a carrier that has a great plan and good network in your area then Medicare Advantage will work just fine. If you travel and have an emergency, ER is always covered and if you're worried, take out a travel insurance plan before you travel. If money is no object then yes, Original Medicare plus Gap plan, drug plan, purchase your own eye, ear and dental plan separately, just know that all the supplement insurance is ALSO administrated by a private health insurance company, same companies that offer the Advantage Plans. Just research the plan carefully. If they cancel the plan, find a new one, not that big of a deal. Same if you move, you'll need a new plan. Also, there is no max out of pocket with original Medicare. With Medicare Advantage Plans they do have MOOP. I'm sorry but if you're healthy and don't have a family history of serious diseases or other health concerns, I would go with MA over the original Medicare, plus supplement plan, plus drug plan, plus dental plan, plus ears and eyes, plus gym membership plus, plus, plus. All the extras that come with the MA plan vs. original Medicare. The Medicare supplement plan only covers the gap in costs. That's it. Nothing more. The key is if you are considering an Advantage Plan, check the doctors, hospitals and pharmacies in that plan. Your going to use local providers so see who that is and ask them what they think of the plan you are considering. Don't rely on salespeople to do the work for you. It's your health and your plan. Al helped me compare plans, run scenarios, check ratings etc. It's a lot to learn but it's pretty easy if you just learn about it in detail. You'll still have a lot of guesswork even with a ton of research because we don't know what the future holds. Best plan is to stay healthy. ♥"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugx-8xnmnvB7u7liCO54AaABAg

"This was very helpful, ! if I understand correctly Medicare & medigap will travel with me when traveling around the country, However what if I decide to move to a different state will I have ti change my medigap. I have medicare A&B and I still have my Medical ins from my job. I need to switch to a medigap or advantage based your information Medigap may be the better choice? so confusing and I do have Immune decency HIV and a family history of Heart disease. I have many medications . I do have your # Im also concerned about being turned down since I never chose a plan due to my health ins. and Adap which covers my co pays in NYC. It's a state HIV funded program. Im. moving to Florida browed county in the new year. if I take a medigap in NYC now I know it will travel with me, will I be able to transfer this to a new state. My HIV meds are very important not to miss. (I know its a lot of stuff)"

— YouTube · Do I Need Medigap? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7JMcg_PV4Ns&lc=Ugw48v0GNAFAiC4o5qx4AaABAg

"Insurance only wants to make money. The number one cause of debt is medical, the number one biggest money maker is insurance. I have plan F I'm in my 30s and it's almost \$500 a month. I don't use that but on occasion I've had serious illness that makes it worth while. We don't practice prevention here and that's why we are sick. A lot of it really is food and sugar and chemicals and stress. Healthcare is no equal the rich can afford the best. I truly want to know if Europe has natural medicine paths and affordable healthcare in young still and if rising costs and no healing is what I have to look forward to I will gtfo because if you got your health you got nothing. It may take me a while to get there but I honestly am working toward it but know nothing of overseas and don't want long wait for healthcare. Also not sure if you can medically retire overseas?"

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgwvL_EwixhNN5Y_-uR4AaABAg

"I like dogs. Thank you for the information. My current plan is with a regional provider, Sentara, which is ending. When I 1st went on Medicare, I chose traditional Medicare and a supplement. While I worry about travelling and the thought of being out of coverage for a needed but not emergency visit, I like the ability to not have several different premiums every month. I also like the perks of the allowances and silver sneakers. I work part time and have dental and vision coverage at a good cost. I am 73 and healthy, but I worry about what the future might bring. I have experience caring for older family members so I have had long term care insurance for over 20 years. My wife and I are meeting with our insurance agent October 24th so we will obtain a new plan then."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzZkJBqSSfapSa01814AaABAq>

Medigap premiums rising until they are priced out · 12 documents · 12 voices

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tbdbvh/>

↳ (0): "Unless you live in a birthday rule state that allows you to switch plans, or you can pass medical underwriting (which is unlikely given your health issues), you're stuck with your current Plan G. If you're stuck, see if your current Plan G insurer will allow you to switch to HD Plan G (high deductible) without medical underwriting. Premiums would be dramatically less. Another option is to move to a Medicare Advantage Plan. Even that may not guarantee any savings because while the premiums are likely to be \$0, there are copays and coinsurance and an out of pocket maximum of \$9250. Given that your current premiums for Plan G are \$5500/year, and that is likely your only out of pocket expense, it might not make sense to move to a \$0/month Medicare Advantage Plan if you end up spending the max out of pocket of \$9250. Even with copays and coinsurance, you'd likely not hit \$9250 (the max out of pocket), but the real question is how likely you are to hit \$5500 (the cost of Plan G premiums). You'd have to look closely at what the out of pocket costs would be for whatever Medicare Advantage Plans you were considering. If you think the cost of copays and coinsurance would be less for Medicare Advantage than the premiums for Plan G, then switch. Of course, if you are low income, then you should also investigate Medicaid options, but just know the income thresholds are pretty low."

↳ (0): "If you really want to go Med Adv, and duplicate the original Medicare as best as possible, gotta go PPO for out-of-network support, and the OOP for that is \$13,900. In 2027 it will be in the neighborhood of \$14,800. Otherwise, one is stuck on networks with HMO. For most stuff that is fine. But, if it's the big C? I had enough money to afford PPO to expand choice closer to original Medicare. It's not really Medigap or Med Adv. It's Medigap, or PPO, or HMO. But, PPO only makes sense if one can operate the plan fully, and that does require a spare \$13,900, although there are cheaper combined OOPs for are PPOs. I saw a \$7400 ppo last fall."

↳ (0): "I'm not a Medicare Advantage nay-sayer, but it's worth pointing out that even with a PPO you can't necessarily go to any provider you want to. Some places don't take PPOs."

"One week ago, I started with Part G, then (after some long thought) I changed four days later to Part N. In my state the price difference is \$106 per month more for Part G, which equates to 5 office visits a month. I usually see my doctor once a year for my yearly exam, so I couldn't see spending the extra money for something I won't use (for now anyway). Also, in my state excess fees are not allowed, and my Part N Plan covers out-of-state excess fees as well. And, I'm sure you know this (but for those who don't) the \$20 copay is for doctor's office visits, not for hospital stays, skilled nursing, or most other covered Medicare services (including Urgent care or out patient care). One other point, the rates for Part G increase faster than Part N. Of course, because of the lack of copays, but also because of "Federal Guaranteed Issue Rights". Most states require carriers to offer Plan G as a guaranteed issue option. Plan N is usually not required to be offered under FGI Rights. People with health issues who use FGI Rights usually go into Plan G, not Plan N. That concentrates sicker, higher-cost members in Plan G. And more claims means premiums rise faster. In contrast, Plan N doesn't absorb as many high-risk enrollees under FGI Rights, so its rate increases tend to be slower. I'm not knocking Part G, but there are just a lot of moving parts people should be aware of."

— YouTube · Should You Switch from Medicare Plan G to Plan N? Here's the Real Tradeoff · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xsEZJVMwY8E&lc=UgxRpS3f2VEzwU7RufR4AaABAg>

↳ @ronaldelliott4373 (2): "Had you looked at Plan G-HD? That's Plan G with a high deductible. I'm just turning 65 and in the process of examining these supplement options. I'm leaning towards G, however yearly rate increases broken into monthly premiums in the recent past are unfavorable if this trend continues. I'm trying to get up to speed on Plans N and G-HD for specific differences among all three. As I'm new to the Medicare System, I'm wanting to make the best possible decision while I have the opportunity to choose, without being denied through underwriting qualifications that hit all of us later if wishing to change from one Plan to another."

↳ @nickt.2825 (0): "Agree and why I also chose plan N. Started Medicare this year and went to several specialists already. I can afford the co-pays and whatever fees I have to pay. I was leaning towards G but like you said premiums increase faster on G and N is still great coverage."

↳ @AndrewKline-v2d (0): "@ronaldelliott4373 I did look at a Part G-HD plan. For my situation the numbers didn't make it that favorable. Even after subtracting the standard Part B deductible (\$257), the high deductible of the G-HD almost equals two years the difference in price of my Part N plan. If I never use it, then the G-HD makes sense, but I know I'll use it (at least once a year). But if something medical does come up, I would be paying almost twice as much out-of-pocket (1 year deductible for Part G-HD vs 1 year of premiums for Part N). And, of course, that's what insurance is for—to cover those unexpected events. One thing about deductibles, you could end up paying it twice for the same event. Say, you have a situation in November. In November and December you are chipping away at the deductible. But January comes along, and for any additional services needed, the high deductible resets. Also, the deductible of the G-HD is for all services, the Part N \$20 copay is only for office visits. Go to urgent care on Part N, there's no copay, but the G-HD high deductible will still need to be satisfied. The final thought that made me consider my Part N plan over Part G-HD was that I am thinking long term. I had to pick a plan that I will be using 20-30 years down the road when I'm sure I'll be using insurance more. I felt that Part N was a good compromise. It's saving me money now (compared to the standard Part G) while I'm healthy, and in my later years, I avoid the high deductible of Part G-HD (which you know will be going up). Again, this is only for my situation, not yours. You have to do what's best for you."

"My Plan N with Mutual of Omaha went up 4%. What I'm really concerned about is the Plan D premium & Rx cost increases."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgwGJkTLDOum38J5pfp4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (3): "4% is good! And yes, big Part D changes coming for 2025."

↳ @BOND007-s6k (0): "@AbtInsuranceAgency Is mutual of Omaha pretty stable with their rate increases over time?"

↳ @jbrokay (0): "My Mutual of Omaha Medigap plan G increase this year (for 2025) is 20%! I sure wish I could change companies!"

"I TRAVEL 570 miles to a cancer specialist. I'm afraid people like me are the reason premiums are skyrocketing. I've had an incurable blood cancer for over 11 years. I'm 66yo male and have a Plan G supplemental policy. My premium is increasing from \$130 to \$152 (17%). This year my insurer has paid \$10829 on my behalf. That's the equivalent of 82 monthly payments and I'm still scheduled for a sedated bone marrow biopsy (with pathology), full body MRI and PET/CT scans in October. In other words, it will take 7 other insures with zero claims before my insurer makes a profit. For the record, about 9 years ago I met my individual high deductible health insurance deductible with my first \$12000 prescription in January. That insurance company doesn't offer individual plans anymore.....in any state. Prescription IV drugs/treatments are the major cause. The US should not be carrying as much of the burden as we are. Great videos by the way."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgygqJQYa3vi8S2vNz14AaABAg>

↳ @4thTimelsTheCharm (1): "@Theretirementnerds I just found a podcast about Zacc's medical journey. I've got a similar attitude about life since my myeloma diagnosis 11 years ago. Zacc crushed it again, this time about life. I'm smart enough to learn from his lead. You don't compete against the best, you work with them. thanks to both of you."

↳ @4thTimelsTheCharm (0): "Travelcontinuation. Last year when I was shopping for medigap policies I was astonished at the practice of UHC and AARP. If you had AARP and signed up for UHC supplemental, you received a 39% discount. That discount decreased 3% over 13 years (simplified). Even with the 39% discount it was equivalent to the policy I chose. So the first year I'd pay 61% of the premium, the next year without any rate increase I'd pay 64%. That's a 4.92% increase from disappearing discount $((3/61)*100)$ alone. It won't be 4.92% every year, but even after 13 years it's over 3% from discount evaporation."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! I hope your treatments are going okay!"

"How have your Plan G premiums changed since you started that coverage? Plan G (or Plan N) provide great coverage but I do worry about being eventually priced out. There's a lot of information about what Plan G/N charge initially, but don't often hear about how the premiums change over time. I'm going to need to watch more of Matthew's content!"

— YouTube · Don't Buy Medigap Plan G Before Watching This ! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tug hWPQP0o8&lc=Ugy_K8nu5GVm-2WNoV4AaABAg.AO9JoNMt_W3AS7glFwJ8KO

"You touched on a concern I have which is medigap premiums rising as I age. Do you have data showing how age is related to premiums? In other words, will I get priced out of medigap and have you switch to Advantage later in life due to rising premiums?"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwgU0AXQaNJVNmY9Q94AaABAq>

"I turn 65 in December of this year and i signed up for Plan N for that very reason you mentioned. I was fearful of being priced out due to the premium increases down the road."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan N vs Plan G - What Are The Hidden Costs? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RcX-i3uZLj0&lc=UgwpcdP5z3PtxlJSK2t4AaABAq.A_BQxorzP4jAbEMaSWf_ey

"As with everything, what plan you should choose depends on your own circumstances. Many people are happy with their advantage plans, as all their doctors accept it and all their medications are covered, and they are usually cheaper than a medigap plan. But, there is always risks regardless of what you choose. My personal doctors told me they don't accept any advantage plan, and none of them available in my state covers all my meds. But it's always possible to get a separate part d. The risk of standard Medicare and medigap is that premiums increase to much. Technically that can happen with advantage as well, but it's more likely with medigap. The risks of advantage are many. Fewer supported doctors (this is just fact), and you hear stories all the time about doctors dropping ma plans. No ability for most people to go back to original Medicare without incurring that 20% and no max out of pocket (ie they won't pass underwriting). If you live in a guaranteed issue state, you have much less risk. And can easily choose the plan that fits your current state of healthcare. But if you don't it's a choose wisely situation because you can't go back for most people after a year. So you have to ask yourself, are you feeling lucky?"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ep6jo4/why_do_people_say_never_get_an_advantage_plan/lhin754/

"@TheretirementnerdsThank you. I was looking forward to retiring later this year but now I need to think twice about it. Premium increases really concern me and I'm afraid I'll be priced out of the market in 10 plus years. I'm 68 live in Washington State which already has very high premiums. I can afford the premiums now, but calculating out 10-20 years at 14% and add on deductible increases, it just doesn't seem like it is sustainable. At least while I am working, I have excellent health care at a very low cost. I wish the medical industry and the county can get their act together and figure out a more sustainable system."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzQQdsX3dXalyeKE-d4AaABAq.AZotk7oV2WOAZowdxvMT7F>

"I take some self insurance risk, but I don't miss Medicare Advantage, Medigap or Plan D - double digit percent premium increase year after year, increasing copay and/or deductibles. Good riddance, there is something inherently wrong with insurance backed healthcare business model."

— YouTube · Shocking Medicare Plan Changes Coming for 2027 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HJ98mctbEC8&lc=UgyfwglMW7MR2Ff-Oh4AaABAq>

"@threefr3349 The small co-pays and rarely see "excess charges" is for now in 2024. Just wait 5-10 years down the road and see. Hope that one is not stuck in a plan that they cannot get out of. For myself, I will not risk it as I can afford plan G and rate increases."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=Ugw8atXRbWaS1ep0Rvp4AaABAq.A4X-8ya7aBOA5dIYkDDPfl>

"Thanks for the content. Good audio. Might want to pull back for the video. I'm concerned about the premium increase in my Plan N.. Just wondering if the plan is to force all of us into MA plans. . THANKS!"

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugxq-RJmlBmEJWvFzMd4AaABAq.9m4wlf6aolPA9E2dpuUyeB>

Excess charges and doctors who won't accept Medicare (argued both ways) · 11 documents · 11 voices

"We picked plan N, to keep the premiums lower. A copay of (UP TO) \$20 for just doctor visits, wasn't a deal breaker for me. I was concerned about the excess charges. But after finding out they're very rare, and we can control that, by simply asking if they take Medicare Assignments."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw2gW4LDQM9jtaWI7I4AaABAq.AOODtS76NJWAOv00hnMCmg>

"Plan N for me here in NC. Excess charges not a concern here. Premium substantially lower than plan G. Plan G is now the guaranteed issue policy. That will most likely keep plan G premium rates rising more than plan N in the future."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=Ugx9K-c4jAv0WjHn6A54AaABAq>

↳ @allanc9472 (0): "What company did you go with?"

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (0): "@allanc9472 AARP UHC. I'll be 67 in November and my premium will increase to \$111 with annual increase."

"My wife and I had been on Plan F but several years ago we switched to Plan N with a different carrier resulting in significantly lower premiums. Switching normally involves medical underwriting but if you do not currently have an expensive condition it should not be hard to qualify. But this does underscore the need to pick a supplement plan for the long term. I'm glad you spoke about excess charges, I think often the risk is grossly overstated. We are both pretty healthy for geezers so don't go to the doctor very often. So even if our health deteriorates we are betting our lifetime supplement cost will be lower with Plan N, but YMMV."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=Ugz2q-iaaj1QqQtkpMd4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Absolutely! Thanks for commenting 😊 "

↳ @Slo-ryde (1): "@tomschmidt381 I was referring to high deductible plan F (which is no longer available to new enrollees)... the whole selling point of F (both types) is that the premiums were lower than N, and if you are someone who does not utilize the healthcare system much, then it would make more sense to have taken F, as the savings are realized by the lower premiums (as is my understanding). But now plan F has been supplanted by plan G (high deductible version)."

↳ @Slo-ryde (0): "How could plan F, a high deductible plan.... Be more expensive than plan N?"

"Would we have to worry about an anesthesiologist billing an excess charge after a procedure being done? I have looked it up and most of the doctors in my area accept the Medicare rate, but not all of the anesthesiologists do. Would I ask the physicians who they use as an anesthesiologist? I turn 65 in March 2025 and I am trying to decide which plan I want – a G or N."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgwdPUY1Xu8yFoystt94AaABAg>

"Excellent video, especially giving some real-life examples. I'm in a plan N, my wife chose plan G. She got scared of N watching a guy who claims excess charges are growing and a real risk. We both went medigap because we travel extensively, and don't want to worry about away from home illnesses. (She also is a retired PT and doesn't like how advantage handles skilled nursing.) My state (OK) has a birthday rule that lets us switch medigap plans of the same plan each year. I can go N to a different N, she can go G or N. When we get too old to extensively travel there is an advantage plan that covers all the major hospitals and providers locally, we may financially have to switch eventually. We've both been pleased with our medigap coverage, our biggest concern is losing employee dental. Vision and hearing haven't been as big an issue for us."

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=UgyQrL3Hut6z3k3pjF14AaABAg>

↳ @GiardiniMedicare (1): "Thank you for the detailed perspective! Definitely agree with everything you said, and as someone with a wife who is also a PT, I can attest she is not a fan of MA plans relating to skilled nursing (or most things) 😊 "

"Choosing between Plan G and N is a no-brainer when looking at co-pays. I'm disappointed that your video doesn't discuss the excess charges which I don't know anything about. It is because of my fear of excess charges that I chose Plan G. I don't know how you can get Plan G in New Jersey for \$153 per month! In New York on Long Island I have Plan G through AARP for \$308 per month and it's going to \$328 per month next January. Additionally, it doesn't seem to be related to age because my stepmother's premium is the same and she is 15 years older than me."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgxiXsdhcyDQdVfuGI94AaABAg>

↳ @IwasRetired (0): "I address excess charges at <https://youtu.be/GRLgcxTEKs4?si=cd4DR8apInTWbJ8y&t=240>, the 4-minute mark. New York will have much higher rates because of insurance regulations in that state vs. NJ. And if I remember right, AARP plans are community rated. Everyone will get the same rates, which will go up by inflation, and most plans are attained age, which means that premiums go up with age and inflation."

"This was great information!!! Im turning 65 in May and am currently looking at all options. I am going back and forth between G and N as well. One point I may have missed here is the excess charges in plan N. I don't recall seeing estimated numbers included. I am from California and see doctors about 5- 6 times a year---and maybe a urgent care. Should I be concerned that the possible excess charges could offset the savings of a plan N?"

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgwkHFBV4X6XEHZKoA14AaABAg>

↳ @Tamedevil (2): "National stats show that only about 3% of providers charge excess charges."

↳ @IwasRetired (1): "Use Medicare.gov to ensure your providers accept Medicare assignments and you will not need to worry about excess charges. Plus there are limits on how much excess charges can be."

↳ @lyndayoung8761 (0): "Psychiatrists and ophthalmologists are two specialties that often charge Excess Charges. Look up doctors and specialists on Medicare.gov and look for "accepts assignment"."

"I live in PA, so without the fear of excess charges I'm leaning towards plan N, but if I see a Dr. in NJ for example, could they charge excess me charges?"

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=UgwwO0XSHjITDwJtA954AaABAg>

↳ @GiardiniMedicare (2): "They could in NJ since it's based on where the services are done"

"This video FAR amplifies the risk of excess charges, IMO. Every medicare agent I've been in contact with has never seen an excess charge for a client outside of mental health providers. Also, ERs can charge up to \$50. Mine locally is \$30 in McKinney, TX. Another example, I had a urology procedure that was \$20. Every followup visit was free with no charge at all, and there were 5 of them. And those are also "up to" \$20, and many times less. In my case, N was \$45 cheaper per month with a lower rate of increase yearly. I don't come close to spending that \$45, and it adds up each year I don't spend it. Calling Plan N "risky" is a huge overstatement, IMO."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan N Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qXRRtPCSPkI&lc=UgwTqFUofSIs3PQHaW54AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (0): "I don't want to get too long-winded since the video explains things already, but, 4% of doctors don't accept assignment and according to Medpac.gov, 3 out of every 1000 claims are billed with excess charges. That means that if the average person has five claims a year, three out of every 200 people could be billed an excess charge. Furthermore, the plan N would not be priced lower if there were no excess charges. The reason it cost less is because it's less risk to the insurance company. Lastly, the Mayo Clinic famously charge his excess charges. As per their own website: <https://www.mayoclinic.org/billing-insurance/glossary>. Inexperienced agents who are telling people that excess charges never happened are doing a major disservice to the public."

"@christinedaley5580 My sister has been on Plan N for 10 years and just got hit with an excess charge. I think she said she had to pay \$65 more than the Medicare amount. She just assumed that since one doctor on the team took Medicare assignment that this Doc did as well. I spoke to my Doc about excess charges and he basically said that doctor practices are being bought up by hospital systems and there is no CPT code to charge more ... CPT codes are CPT codes and bot to worry about excess charges."

— YouTube · Don't Buy Medigap Plan G Before Watching This ! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tughWPQPo08&lc=UgxqJlyXbPi-oV75f594AaABAg.AAWckub9TIQAAY-ChtTUKe>

"Correct! This concern of excess charges is overblown! And in some states, it isn't even allowed. Ohio is one of them, and I live in the state. Very happy with my Plan N."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgwuFKJh1kGzfw9hxxk54AaABAg.AZKSVtk4jWdAb8W1U98tDP>

IRMAA and the income surcharge · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Thank you for what you shared here. I am 67 years old now. I was laid off earlier this year when I was 66 and received a severance package on my termination. I did not go onto Medicare until my full retirement age a few months after being laid off work. I did find contract work to help me, and it has been working out. When I learned about the IRMAA charges for my Parts B & D and how that works, I was really worried about what additional amount they would be charging me in 2028 as I know I could not afford that huge increase. My severance package is what would throw me into the 65% bracket, and I know I would not be able to afford that on what I expect my income to be in 2028. Your information here has help relieve some of the anxiety I have been feeling about dealing with 2028 Medicare payments. Thank you for all you shared with us here. Larry"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgyXZYhPsAL2hvMVIC94AaABAg>

"I guess you gotta think about IRMAA as a a good thing that you have decent income, even though you don't want to pay the extra surcharges"

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA: What Most Retirees Get Wrong About Their Premiums · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w1PM7D2XD84&lc=UgyWwR1drH68EeaWZgF4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Things could be worse I guess... if you are running into IRMAA."

"With my Roth conversions, I've definitely been more concerned with the IRMAA thresholds than tax brackets. Not so much trying to minimize IRMAA while doing Roth conversions, but more ensuring that if I need to push into a higher bracket that I go ahead and do a bit more conversion to fill up the bracket. Also, I've found that while, for my family's circumstances with a disabled child and Social Security disability benefits, Boldin cannot be used to calculate exact Roth conversion numbers, because it cannot account for SSDI and therefor cannot calculate our true MAGI. I can fudge things; so that, it can get me in the ballpark, but I have to do manual calculations myself to generate the exact amount for each of my conversions and exactly how far into the IRMAA brackets I'm going."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: Why Your Medicare Premium Can Suddenly Explode · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R1MRB2YjYDY&lc=UgxNMVajYKlwQif9It54AaABAg>

"@TheMedicareFamily thanks. I thought I could be proactive and apply for the IRMAA reduction (SSA-44 form) as soon as I had a life changing event - retirement - so I dont run the risk that IRMAA would kick in for several months (maybe causing me a cash crunch) before they approve they reduction if I have to wait to apply until they notify me."

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA 2025 Explained (Are a High Income Earner?) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ioM2gA1LLtI&lc=UgwAXZ-l319_HiMcqYZ4AaABAg.AECZRsojVAOAEF73bDqn5x

"If you're making over \$750K, I don't think these people are too concerned about IRMAA"

— YouTube · 8 Ways to Reduce Medicare IRMAA Payments · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z6yhDpaSO9A&lc=UgzEoZjrSXHiZ_5OpL94AaABAg

"Yes I'm worried about the IRMAA penalizes especially the 2 year look back confusion."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgwunWldDzM_M1rUVMN4AaABAg

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Their drugs covered at a price they can pay · 40 documents · 20 voices

"GLP-1 Bridge Program Info As someone that works in a doctors office and submits PAs, I want to clear up some confusion about the GLP-1 bridge program. I want to start by saying I appreciate that this program will get these meds to many people that need it, but it leaves a lot of Medicare beneficiaries behind. If you have type 2 diabetes, moderate to severe obstructive sleep apnea, or MASH you do NOT qualify to use the program. You have to get a GLP-1 medication approved for those conditions through your Part D plan. Even if the Part D copay is astronomical, you still can't use the bridge program if you have any of those 3 diagnoses. It doesn't matter if the provider doesn't even use those diagnoses and only submits the PA for obesity, you still don't qualify. When we submit the PA, the provider has to attest that you do NOT have those conditions. If the provider selects that you DO have any of them, the system automatically denies it and kicks it back saying it has to go through Part D. You can't get around this if you have these conditions because that would be committing Medicare fraud. I submitted multiple of these PAs today and confirmed this is exactly how it's being processed. You do still qualify if you have mild obstructive sleep apnea and meet the other criteria, because mild OSA isn't covered under Part D, only moderate to severe. This is directly from the CMS website info for prescribers and the PA form that I've linked below. I recommend looking over these because this is exactly the guideline providers are following when submitting these PAs. <https://www.cms.gov/glp-1-bridge.pdf> <https://www.cms.gov/files/document/glp-1-prescribers-c-1.pdf> I hope this information is helpful."

— r/medicare · 74 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ulaona/>

↳ (0): "Super helpful - nice to hear from someone actually submitting the forms. People keep asking agents and that's useless :)"

↳ (0): "Great info & great explanation!"

↳ (0): "The pharmacy tech at the Walmart pharmacy i use, had no idea about the bridge program. Someone else tried to help her figure it out I sent a message to my doctor who responded the paperwork has been submitted and awaiting a response This whole thing feels like a mess. I hope it gets straightened out before the program ends Update: I just got notification from Walmart that my prescription is ready at the \$50 copay!"

"COST PLUS DRUGS (Mark Cuban's) I have insurance that I pay \$350. a month for and only one of my drugs is covered, the other three are relatively inexpensive and I pay 100% of the cost. For the other drug it costs me \$2000 a year, and then my insurance pays 100%. Now I signed up for Mark Cuban's Cost Plus drugs. I get the same 4 prescriptions for \$424. a year. I would like to cancel my drug plan, but I guess I have to wait until open enrollment."

— r/medicare · 58 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1qw7vli/>

↳ (0): "You don't want to cancel your Part D unless you are absolutely, totally sure you can use Mark Cuban OR afford to pay all your drug costs out of pocket for the rest of your life OR re-enroll later & pay a penalty for the rest of your life You can voluntarily disenroll or not enroll in a Part D plan during the Annual Enrollment Period (typically Oct 15 – Dec 7) or certain other enrollment periods. Can you try & find a zero or low cost plan next open enrollment? If you can, keep your D even if not actively using it and if you are off for 63 days and ever have to go back on it, then you will be charged a penalty which is: 1% of the national base beneficiary premium for each full month you went without creditable coverage.(\$38.99 in 2026) That amount is rounded to the nearest \$0.10. The penalty is added to your monthly Part D premium — so you pay it every month for as long as you have Part D coverage (even if you switch plans). The longer you go without coverage, the bigger the penalty. This is all up to you, but please think through the implications"

↳ (0): "I'm not sure if you have a Part D drug plan or not, but I have never seen one that costs hundreds of dollars per month. You do have to wait until the enrollment period later in the year to sign up for a different one. My opinion is that it's a good idea to buy the cheapest Part D plan if you are buying generic drugs "off plan" from places like Cost Plus. You can often get a plan for a very small amount. I have never paid more than \$1.40 a month for mine. It just serves as a backstop if I'm prescribed a more expensive drug later."

↳ (0): "Please get some expert advice. No drug Plan costs this much. Get an appointment with SHIP. It's free unbiased expert advice. If you do have a drug Plan and it's costly, if you drop it you'll have a penalty forever. I had a Wellcare drug Plan that had 0 premium and protected me against penalties. This year the premium is \$3.25 a month. Next year I might get a better more expensive plan. Maybe."

"I just want to say the "negotiated" prices Medicare received for the drugs is ridiculous. Canadian's pay way less for these drugs than we do. We need better negotiators."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 51 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgxYuN2b6yzmZ7kxG7J4AaABAq

↳ @SquirrelySquirrel1 (9): "@kenny-tu2bu when you look at the total tax burden—federal, state, and local—the gap between the U.S. and Canada isn't as wide as many assume; for high earners, Canada's combined rates can exceed 50% compared to roughly 35-45% in the U.S., but for middle-income families making around \$60-80K, U.S. rates run 12-22% while Canada sits at about 20-25%, making the difference much smaller in practice—and here's the real issue: Canada uses that tax revenue to fund universal healthcare and robust social programs that simply don't exist in the U.S., meaning Americans often end up paying out-of-pocket for services Canadians get through their taxes, so while the U.S. tax rates might be a little lower on paper, when you factor in what you actually get for your money, we're paying close to what Canadians pay but receiving significantly less in public benefits, leaving more gaps that individuals have to fill themselves."

↳ @kenny-tu2bu (7): "Canada's income tax rate is 20.5% on income from \$58,523 to \$117,045. Why did you leave that part out?"

↳ @robertmeunier9915 (7): "@kenny-tu2bu Because it is irrelevant to the conversation. The conversation is about government negotiated rates. That is before government subsidies for consumers. The tax rate would be relevant to the subsidies the consumers receive from the government. But as you brought it up, US tax rates for a single filer is 22% for income from \$50,401 to \$105,700."

"This is a helpful video, but I'd like to know more about Part D, which was glossed over here. I take quite a few medications for life and would like to know what is and isn't covered and the costs. Do you need Part D with Parts A and B and Medigap? Do you need it with an Advantage plan? I'm confused."

— YouTube · Medicare Parts A B C D Explained - Everything you need to know! · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wci4BBmjXfo&lc=UgxQvikWqXNetLV0YDI4AaABAq>

"I have had original Medicare with Plan N since my LASSO plan discontinued. I like Lasso because I never used it and it gave me money which I still have. I want to quit working one of these days and the supplement and drugs dealers are out when I do. I don't do doctors or drugs and these monthly bills that I have a choice to have or not, are going when I retire. I'm 70 and wanted to be retired by now but I guess it's been pushed to 72 or 73.....I hope!! When I did underwriting, I can say honestly that I have no diseases or medical conditions past and present because I have never been to a doctor to find out anything."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgzG-DjwWI-qrV6ggOV4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you for watching and sharing your experience. There is a newer company doing things similar to LASSO, but all through the employer space. Your employer would need to be using it, not for an individual to just go get."

↳ @CottonWoodBlues (0): "@Theretirementnerds forgive my typos..not sure how you read it, but my employers has no benefits so I guess I am out of luck. That okay..I'll survive. Thanks for your reply"

"Hi Stephanie I find all of your videos so extremely helpful. I turn 65 next August but am starting to do my research now. I have a few questions for you. 1. I want to use your services next year. I live in California. Are you licensed here in California? 2.. When it is time for me to use your services would I be able to use you directly or would U just be using 1 of your agents? 3. I want to have help finding a supplement plan AND also part D plan for my medicines. Would you be helping me to find both? 4. Would I be paying the premiums for the supplement and part D to you or would I pay the company directly that offers the supplement and part D? I look forward to your answers. Thank you so much Bonnie Kent"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=Ugx2ZHttg6Z2MDK-1d4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (2): "Hi Bonnie! We do work in your state and would be happy to help! Typically we like to talk with you about 6 months prior to your 65th birth month to review your options. My personal case load is limited, so if I can't work with you directly I have several agents in my office who have been with me for a long while and whom I trust completely to assist you. We can help you with Medigap AND Part D, and premiums are never paid to us, always to the insurance carrier. I hope this helps!"

↳ @bonniekent4721 (1): "@AbtInsuranceAgency thank you so much for answering all of my questions Stephanie. I look forwarding to being in contact with your company next year prior to my turning 65"

"I received my ANOC for my Part D plan Saturday. My premium is going from \$0 to \$6.30. I hope to find a \$0 premium plan as my goal is to get ZERO drugs through that plan in 2027. The expensive drug goes generic April 1, 2028. So I still have a Q1 2028 issue, maybe 2028 medication tourism."

— YouTube · 50 MILLION Seniors Will Get This Medicare Letter For 2027 🇺🇸 · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jGee266zElk&lc=UgxhNvNkchkqzYueF4AaABAg>

↳ @nonenone7383 (0): "is this for well care"

"I want a supplement plan but have COPD and can't afford my meds on it. So they are telling me that i have to go to Medicare Advantage plan."

— YouTube · Understand Medicare Supplements vs. Advantage Plans in 60 Seconds · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nSFMZ2bVsUs&lc=Ugw7yheQvSd0PSm1Y9Z4AaABAg>

↳ @lynne3989 (0): "I know because I want a supplement plan too. I actually need to change most of my doctors. And I want the freedom to travel (good for health , mentally & physically), in retirement. But on the other hand am on a fixed income & my health is growing more complicated. ... Surely there must be a way to come to some kind of happy situation??!!"

"An extremely informative and well put together video! I appreciate the non-partisan presentation because that is really hurting all of us in this country. That's especially true for seniors who will again be bombarded with those Medicare Advantage ads all day everyday during the Medicare open enrollment. It's true, as you clearly stated, it's either raise taxes or reduce coverage or benefits or other programs, or, one we should all be getting on board with, eliminating the horrible abusive fraud that is in the system. There are apparently billions upon billions of dollars in Medicare fraud of course alone. We need to stop the horrible partisanship, at least in this instance, and demand that our states persist the feds in auditing Medicare beneficiaries and more important, providers since the provider and seems to be where most of the fraud is. But every day I see dates refusing assistance in this area claiming they're already doing it, but that just doesn't make sense, if you can get help, take it! All that aside, I truly appreciate what an amazing job you did on this, I am in original Medicare with a supplement and Medicare part d, so not exactly looking forward to this fall but, hey, could be worse! Kick the Can😂😂 "

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgzVZjooYulDgzYZYF54AaABAg

"It is puzzling because I take two meds not in formulary that are covered by formulary exception by my current plan. It renders the Medicare plan finder tool useless. We have to enroll in a plan first, then afterwards submit a formulary request to cover the meds and hope they will be approved. Last fall, my part D plan carrier dropped all plans in my state for 2026 and through my own research, I found my current plan and it covered all my meds. Even though the premium is going up \$20 per month in 2027, I am inclined to stay with it because of the uncertainty with coverage of my meds. Erik thanks for caring."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Drug Plans: Two Things You NEED to Know · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANgeD3oOJ40&lc=UgxGzYQSnlf5fFQ5xuZ4AaABAg>

"Thank you for the unbiased story that got us to where we are today. I have Humana stand alone and paid \$20/month for my drug plan half of what I paid in 2025. Maybe the tiers changed as you said but I still pay a small amount of money if any for my medications. I would like to say that the insurance companies are not the only ones to give advice for seniors on selecting a drug plan. Office of the Aging is an excellent source to assist with not only drug plans but Medicare in general. I don't care about cut rates for weight loss drugs. Seniors are more concerned with cardiac, blood pressure, and cancer drugs."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgwyudjHeLZ-7WVKHY54AaABAg

"Purple. Thank you for your guidance. I want to make sure others know that there are medications and therapies that Medicare won't cover or only cover for certain persons who meet criteria, but commercial insurance may cover them. For instance, parenteral nutrition coverage by Medicare has strict criteria. Persons who take meds, have chronic health conditions or are planning to have surgery should make sure Medicare will cover care. Not all agents know the criteria so I advise everyone to check with their doctors or pharmacies for their knowledge of Medicare coverage."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgxkxcAh3AmWYuUJsa14AaABAg>

"Dog. Two additional topics I'd like to have seen also addressed are not just denials by Advantage plans but how much are they delaying approvals to where people give up and other topic is drug approvals. With an Advantage plan you have their list of approved drugs (are they typically good) versus as I understand it with a Supplement plan we can pick drug plans that include more drugs we care about (as I understand it, and likely at a higher cost)?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgyD-oMzwQj1jfoLvQp4AaABAg>

"I subscribed to "Blue Advantage" because they offered better coverage on drugs. Now they are imposing more restrictions on what they cover, regardless of your medical needs. I want to go back to Medicare, but can't afford to lose the drug coverage. Any suggestions?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxoCk5CznT8cDbD6494AaABAg>

"Humana has a ppo advantage plan with a 2200. Out of pocket. I would love to have the medigap but then I don't think I can afford the part d. I will be 65 in October. When should I sign up to have insurance effective 11/1"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgxXGEyqXIZI1Tt0l294AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "You should enroll in Medicare as soon as you can during your initial enrollment period (Aug 01) <https://medigapseminars.org/medigap-calculator/> Then, you will get a Medicare number in about 30-days. Once you have a Medicare number, you can apply for your Advantage Plan. Contact us when you have applied for Medicare and we will put you on our schedule: <https://medigapseminars.org/contact-us/>;

"I'm so sorry you're dealing with this, especially while trying to manage a new breathing problem. That sounds incredibly frustrating and scary. One thing I wanted to mention, in case it helps: the Medicare Prescription Payment Plan is available to people with Medicare drug coverage, including Medicare Advantage plans with drug coverage, and Medicare says you can join at any time during the year. The downside is that if you join later in the year, there are fewer months left to spread the costs out, so the payments may still be high—but it may be worth calling your plan directly to ask whether you can still enroll and what your monthly payments would look like. I also wonder whether there may be some confusion about whether you were being asked to meet your plan's deductible versus being quoted the full out-of-pocket cost for the medication. Since every Medicare Advantage plan can have different deductibles and cost-sharing, I would definitely ask the plan to explain exactly how that \$900 was calculated and whether there are any covered alternatives or an exception process available. I really hope you're able to get this sorted out quickly and get the medication your doctor prescribed. Please don't feel like you need to apologize for being frustrated—I think many people would be overwhelmed in that situation. ❤️ "

— YouTube · Medicare Part D 2027: What It Means for GLP-1 Coverage & Costs · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=P7ldgtYBXpA&lc=UgxITeeQLIBWhJ1CH_14AaABAg.A_xcs1v3uVDA_ylzb_a7i

"It was a very good experience using.... It was a very good experience using eHealth for my Medicare 2nd yr enrollment. I had used the website a yr ago when comparing plans, but once I chose Medicare Advantage for a 1yr trial my choice of plans was simple(only 1 plan had all my drs). I decided recently before my trial period was over to switch to Medicare w/ supplements and drug plan. The person helping me was helpful and courtesy, but the biggest plus was him just walking me through the forms for switching.The only area I'd like to see eHealth improve is the Part D plan comparison. Specifically I could not get the web site to let me enter Preferred Mail order as the default pharmacy for comparing total drug cost (premiums + the cost of my specific medications) You can figure it out by clicking on each plans preferred mail order tab and adding your drug cost that way, but to do that with each plan is a real tedious and prone to match errors. Hopefully the eHealth web site will let customers chose their method of getting medications (retail pharmacy or mail order) and then use that choice as a way to compare each plan's estimated yearly cost."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 4★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/608ae92af9f487051033b293>

"I just turned 65 and will be retiring in November. I have had a heart attack already, I have 3 stents, I have had back surgery, a laminectomy, this year I had sepsis due to a UTI and spent time in the hospital and had a prostate surgery to fix that problem. I feel good right now.. ALL of that was done on a 'normal' insurance system.. like medicare advantage.. I had MRIs denied that my doctor had to fight for, but I got them all done, I had some of my medications turned down, but then my doctor got them through, they just had to request them a different way. I have one medication that is very expensive.. on Good RX it would cost almost \$300 a month. I am torn, I am used to the way things work on a program like advantage.. I don't travel in the United states.. we do travel internationally, We aren't moving, we live in Arizona... there are plenty of providers here. in plan. I would like to have dental and vision and prescriptions... ahhhhh... why the hell is this so complicated"

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlg&lc=UgwOrKtez63HKTbJsuV4AaABAq>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (0): "Hey Chris, I'm sorry to hear about all those health challenges. With all that going on, you definitely need to seriously consider the Medicare supplement because there's a chance you wouldn't be able to get it later on. With that said, there are some really awesome Medicare advantage plans from really good companies in AZ. Remember there are also trial rights for you to try out Medicare advantage plan and go to a supplement later, but because you're working past 65 some of them don't apply to you, so make sure you're getting advice from someone who knows what they're doing."

"In my town, Grand Rapids, Minnesota and it's close surrounding towns refuse everyone with Medicare A,B, and D is a joke cuz we still have to pay for our medications, the bill just gets sent to your Medicare D (which we are charged for monthly) and we pay them directly! It makes no sense! Medicare A and B, is not accepted by most of our Doctors and NP's! We have to drive to other distant clinics/hospitals, or pay cash to clinics and hospitals. I actually qualify for extra help from our State and County, but I live in Minnesota, the Tim Walz thief State and thanks to him and Omar we are not allowed to have that extra help! It is very hard to make ends meet month to month on \$1800. a month. I own my own home so I have household bills, house issues here and there, along with medications I need, if I want to stay alive and have see a Dr or NP every 4 months if I want refills for my meds! Money, money, money, I hate it!! No one cares or help's the elderly here!!"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZS1_fc&lc=UgyediQlfy-j8usDGNB4AaABAq

"I have financial resources, good health and low medical usage (for now, but hey I own a horse). I chose traditional Medicare with supplement N and a drug plan because I'd like to travel around the US, possibly snowbird one day, and despise restrictive HMO/most PPO networks and dealing with all the red tape those plans come with. I also was thinking ahead to the day when I may not be able to personally deal with all that deductible/copay/network garbage and have the energy to fight an insurance company. My sister has a MA Advantage and has to deal with all that now. Another thing I like about traditional Medicare is that I'll never be tempted to skimp on care out of fear of high out of pocket costs and inadvertently end up with a serious complication. I saw my mom do that."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugz0z7Y53ScNG-YCGyp4AaABAq>

Switching to a supplement (or to a better plan) next year · 39 documents · 20 voices

"As someone who is about to enter the Medicare minefield I truly appreciate your honest evaluations of Medicare Supplement and Advantage plans. As a senior reaching 65 I have learned a lot and had my eyes opened by your informative videos. Keep up the good work. I hope others do their due diligence on their health care post 65. I wish other states other than the four allow seniors to switch back to original supplement plans. That would immensely help."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugy6mXtwm4ahYY_KrNR4AaABAq

↳ @ckstaff (12): "Don't know the truth on it but in those states you can go back to original I have heard to do so you will be paying a hefty premium to do it. Just take the smart rout and do it right the first time. Don't gamble with your health with taking shortcuts."

↳ @ronbaker8007 (5): "Medicare limits the amount that can be charged; Supplements protect the patient from lack of permission from providers, Med ADV controls permissions and choice."

↳ @kathyd7284 (3): "It is so overwhelming and I was a paralegal for over 40 years. We asked older relatives and decided on regular Medicare Plan N through AARP United Healthcare with Part D through WellCare. We have been so happy with these plans. Hardly anything out of pocket after Medicare yearly deductible paid."

"anyone that is 65 and over must pay for medicare cost that is paid from social security, about \$175 a month. the 20% supplement can cost \$150 a month , plan G and goes up each year with United Health Care. So annually, one pays \$1800 plus the annual deductible of \$240, or \$2000 a year for health insurance. no co-pays and no other expenses to see the doctor or ER visits after the annual deductible is paid, \$240. the original medicare pays up to 60 days in the hospital. 60 days is a long time. In most cases, one will be discharged within 60 days. From age 65 to 75, most seniors would not be staying in the hospital for long periods of time. the goal is to make appointments to see the doctor and do preventive care. take advantage of the plans. the part that I have a problem with is, medicare advantage can change its policy and they are for profit. the medicare advantage tangle carrots like free stuff , some dental work, glasses, and partial payment for hearing aids. plus gym membership which are available on some supplements. some medicare advantage plans do not pay if you leave the network. when the original medicare, I can go to any ER and do not need to worry about a co-pay. with advantage plans, there are doctor visit co-pay and ER co-pays and drugs cost money, with kaiser advantage plans. if one starts with the original medicare, you are guaranteed , no need to qualify. if you start with an advantage medicare plan with zero to little monthly fee with some free stuff, if you wish to go back to the original medicare plan, you have to be screened and qualify. the questions, do you wish to pay \$2,000 a year that gradually increases with the annual \$240 deductible , then unlimited doctor visits and ER visits? or be nickled and dime with office visit cost, ER cost , and subject to having the advantage plan approving your bill with possible surprises? I have to make a choice soon, nothing is free in life. All I know, I am currently paying \$1000 a month with kaiser and it cost me \$\$\$ for office visit, lab work and if I need to go to the ER. if I have to have a test performed, I have to still pay. So the \$200 a month supplement is reasonable with the original medicare. Again, Nothing in life is FREE, especially when our congress is swayed by private insurance companies trying to get a larger piece of the business. I hear many horror stories with private advantage medicare plans. they surprise Americans with large bills since the coverage does not pay for certain treatments. IMO"

— YouTube · Original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage: What's the Difference? · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=weO1WkquA3s&lc=Ugzaix7JeWu8Hgkw-fB4AaABAg>

↳ @ESMEE_4EVERR (0): "Jvgknftiokfpmgibdhcujjgbjjg"

↳ @AIH-p2u (0): "I'm surprised you think it's okay to pay 2400\$ a year plus dental plus vision plus medication and think it's everyone's best option. Many ppl are healthy and can save 2400\$ etc for 5-10 yrs then go into a chronic plan with little max out of pocket saying you thousands but if you're ill and have my doctors then supp is the way to go UHC offers both mapd pdp and supp I am contracted with them"

↳ @bozomonster (0): "The math doesn't workout in your if your paying \$1,000 per month to Kaiser. The max out of pocket with a Medicare Advantage Plan is \$5,000."

"I HATE doctors. I HATE insurance and I avoid both at all costs. This all makes me cringe. Unfortunately I have to make a decision in a few months and I honestly don't know what to do. I want to choose Traditional Medicare, but with my rent jumping up every year, I'm going to be homeless next summer on Traditional Medicare. There is no way I can afford double digit increases on supplements. I don't like the Advantage plans at all either. What's a Senior supposed to do? Take what I can afford and just die when Advantage denies a procedure is what it's looking like. Great options 🙄 after working our whole lives. It's ALL a racket."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugwcgxlchxqa2pLRBYx4AaABAg

↳ @adoptacat2877 (3): "I'm in the same boat. I hate our healthcare system. As always you only survive if you have a high paying government job or a wealthy person the rest of us lose everything if we get sick and even if you don't get sick right away the copays on these advantage plans are not affordable. We are screwed and that's why so many millions of people die needlessly in our country."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "A lot of moving parts for sure! Appreciate you watching and sharing. Highly recommend working with an agent familiar with your area. Takes a lot of the guesswork and fear out of the equation for you :) Thank you for making it to the end ;)"

↳ @eduardooramaeddie4006 (1): "You could say i agree with this gentleman"

"It sounds like this is talking about switching from plan to plan (e.g., Plan G to H or something like that). Does it also apply if I want to change carriers using the same plan designation (e.g., change from Aetna with Plan G to another carrier with Plan G?"

— YouTube · Can You Change Your Medicare Supplement Anytime? · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p2hlpMKoQZU&lc=UgyjMtzNrKboKguv8Ct4AaABAg>

↳ @BoomerBenefits (3): "All the rules are the same whether you're switching plans or switching carriers. Ultimately, when you switch carriers, you're switching plans too even though you're staying with the same letter."

"You are by far the biggest elephant of them all when it comes to explaining Medicare plans! I have been watching lots of videos recently and I have watched more of yours than anyone else, because they are just better! You do such a great job of explaining things in a way that is understandable! Thank you for the great work you do! I wish you could be my agent to help me make my decisions. I am 71 and have always had Advantage Plan, but, now am wanting to switch to Medigap Plan G. I wish I would have understood how difficult it was going to be later on to get a Medigap, due to the Underwriting process. Advantage has worked well for me so far, but, as I get older, I wish I would have gotten a Medigap during my OEP because I could have gotten one - no questions asked. Oh, well, live and learn. I don't think I will pass Underwriting, but, I may give it a shot just to see. If not, I guess I'm stuck with Advantage forever."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx-H2gJtUrzWO7qf014AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch this video and others! Your kind words mean more than you know, and I've never been so honored to be called the biggest elephant :) 🐘"

"I worked until I was 74 and had a work plan until then. When I looked into using the original plan and a medigap plan I was told that extra plan would cost me \$500/month plus what I was paying for the Medicare insurance. That was and is just not affordable for me. I'm in good health and my drugs are few and generic. I would love to get off the Advantage plan but at this point it I do not have the income to pay that much a month for insurance."
— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwjoDxA_R0EDQMOTTh4AaABAg

↳ @RG-hf4et (0): "Advantage is better than no plan at all."

"I started with a Gap plan but when I moved to Florida, the Advantage plan saved \$6000 a year, I would love to drive that BMW but my Kia plan meets my needs"
— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgxF03TtiOp_XISH3-N4AaABAg

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (4): "Kias dont last and will cost u more in maintenance long term. Same with MA."

↳ @bobjones9653 (0): "@JohnJohn-wr1joI'll take my chances and I live in New York and can change at anytime without underwriting"

↳ @lindabe11a (0): "Pray u don't get cancer or need to see specialists out of network. Medicare advantage plans are just HMOs"

"I'm in the process of getting back to regular Medicare and going on plan F... praying I'll get back to my red white and blue card🙏🙏"
— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwrBVxvBPSie95h-KB4AaABAg.9rLufX7oO009wBRtnBA5wp>

"Let's get our facts straight: If I decide that after a time that I want to change from a Medicare Advantage plan to something else, I have two choices: I can return to original Medicare Parts A & B or I can, given insurability, apply for a Medicare Supplemental plan. I have not "signed away my rights to original Medicare" by choosing a Medicare Advantage plan. Apparently, you haven't seen many of "90 Days from Retirement" videos where they take actual hospital stay cases and compare the coverages of private insurance, original Medicare, Medicare Advantage, and Medicare Supplemental plans. It's surprising how different scenarios give different results depending on the plan you have. There is no clear "winner". During my entire business career, I have been covered by some type of HMO health insurance by the various companies I've worked for. I've been very well-versed in how to get referrals and work within a network. And it's been quite affordable. I'm still working and have chosen a Medicare Advantage plan for my health care coverage. I could easily afford a Medicare Supplemental plan but choose, instead, to save a ton of money for my coverage. There is no "this is better, this is worse" when it comes to choosing. You pick the type of plan that meets your goals. If you want the privilege of choosing your doctor and want to pay for that privilege, then by all means go Supplemental. If you're comfortable with getting referrals and working within a network, then choose Advantage. For me living in Florida, I choose a Medicare Advantage plan. I paid a total out of pocket of less than \$200 for my medical coverage in 2022 and for 2023. Yes, I had some co-pays and the like, but it amounted to significantly less than what I would have paid if I'd had a Medicare Supplemental plan. Essentially, for my Medicare Advantage plan here in Florida, I have a "give back" on my premium that covers all but \$10/month of the Part B premium. I have no deductible, \$0 copay for seeing my primary care physician, and a \$10 copay for specialists. I have a \$60 copay for outpatient surgery and a \$75/night for days 1-5 if I have a hospital stay. \$0 copay for nights after the 1st 5 nights. I have prescription, dental, and vision coverage as well. There are perks such as 48 trips per year to/from doctor appts, a meal plan for two weeks after a hospital stay, and many, many more. I believe many people choose these advantage plans not for as you say, "these are for people with low monthly retirement incomes", but they choose them for using their money wisely."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwTsL3DpxecL9X-mph4AaABAg.9wePF3EAQZI9xjrZGMO-x>

"I signed up for a medicare supplement plan the very first time I went on Medicare. It really didn't so well and I switched to an Advantage plan which has worked great for me many others in the area. My situation changed and I'd like to go back to the original medicare. Am I allowed to do that now,since I signed on first time with them(humana)"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugwob7gm7WTKxOIEyLh4AaABAg.AZt5HpzvfMRAZupu9-W-KH>

"Stephanie, great video and easy to follow. I have a question that I am a bit confused. I am 72 years old in excellent health. I visit doctor 2 times a year max . I do not take medications at all.. I have plan N supplement plan since 2018 and never changed. However, I am thinking to move to an Advantage plan and would like to know if there is a trial period on the Advantage plan in case I want to go back to AARP United Health plan without having to go through underwriting a new policy. Thanks for your time and I am now a subscriber to your channel."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugza4HDsvrf8Z_zeioh4AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (5): "If you have a Medigap Plan N now and you have never had a Medicare Advantage plan prior, then you have a one time one year "Trial Right" in which you can try a Medicare Advantage plan and if at some point in the first 12 months you want to go back to your old Medigap Plan N, you can - with the same insurance company- without any health questions. I hope this helps!"

"After I was hospitalized from December 2020 to late February 2021 & nearly died twice from Covid19 complications, I ditched Humana Medicare DISadvantage...after they left me with thousands of \$ to pay...for doctors consultations for a procedure that I ended up not needing . I switched to Medigap, and hope the deductible on my Age of Entry Plan F-HD stays put. It's almost \$3000 now... which is quite an incentive to stay healthy and visit the doctors as little as possible."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Rule Changes · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1_9jvlyZKrc&lc=UgxcSQHcQFaRIAE1Akl4AaABAg

"I'm 68 years old, currently on an Alignment Advantage plan. I'm healthy as an ox, with the one exception of slightly elevated blood pressure on record. However, since losing 70 lbs of fat and transitioning to a much healthier lifestyle, my blood pressure has normalized on its own and I haven't updated my subscription in about a year. Next March I'll be moving to the wider Asheville/Hendersonville, NC area, and I want to switch from my Advantage plan to A+B+HD-G+D, as long as I'm as fit as I am. Will that be a problem? Thank you."

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=UgxM09_zt8jCcaRwEHt4AaABAg

"I have a Plan G because I have a benign Pineal Gland tumor and it does cost more but... once I meet the Medicare deductible I have no co-pays or deductibles and I can go to any doctor I want and now that I'm on a supplement I will never go off because you might not get back onto the supplement plan. My Plan G does cover 2 cleanings a year and some of my vision if I need glasses."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxK6BFc46ppTtEFg1t4AaABAg>

"Great video, thanks. I have passed it along to a friend who needs to decide what to do this enrollment period. I am 2 years in to Medicare and have a plan G from age 65. My question is if I want to change Plan G providers, or switch to a Plan N with the same company (or a different one) do I have to undergo a medical underwriting review? I live in California. Cheers!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwinIOxE1CRc5C0Z2x4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (0): "Thanks for passing it along."

"Good stuff as usual. I have a question. I'm not 65 until end of this month. But I already had enrolled in Plan N, and made premium payments that have me covered since 10/1. Re-enrollment period has already started (10/15), and I want to switch to Plan G. How much of a headache will this be?"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=UgzSSvgEerdf5NgUi4J4AaABAg>

↳ @christinedaley5580 (3): "@ronharrington8659 Plan N is a great choice for many. The premium shall remain much more stable over time than Plan G. LOL."

↳ @ronharrington8659 (2): "Be careful what you ask for. I chose the N 4 years ago, because of the 6% or so increase in premiums. I started around \$105 per month. It's up to \$132.10 in 4 years. I figure in 10 years it'll be around \$170 per month. \$200 when I reach 80. The G will be much higher than that. The copay of \$20 Doctor, \$50 Emergency, and rarely excess charges don't make sense for me to pay an extra \$360 in premiums. That's from the example listed in this presentation... Hope this helps.. I'm a retired agent..."

↳ @christinedaley5580 (1): "Shouldn't be a headache at all. You are guarantee issue right now for 6 months. Just an informed consumer. 🙄🙄🙄 "

"you're so talented.... all your videos I've watched are excellent! I was born in December 1954... could I get into a Plan F if I want to? thanks !"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=UggyDdnyi4sDkHSdgxl4AaABAg>

↳ @christinedaley5580 (2): "Yes. Must be 65 by January 1, 2020. You would be 65 December 2019. But you do not want it. Overpriced and premiums shall sky rocket. Plan G much better for anyone interested in F. Also look at N.' 🙄🙄🙄 "

↳ @MedicareSchool (1): "Yes you can! But DON'T.... no point to do it. The premiums will go up fast because only older (and presumably) higher users of the plan will be on it."

"What about if I'm on a supplement plan and I want to switch to a different supplement plan? Is there a medical underwriting required?"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxCsITYHR-DaDGhXV94AaABAg>

"I wish you had commented on what if you are 75 and want to go to a Supplemental no Advantage. Is it hard if you are healthy?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgzVHuhDHWOav1HdXOJ4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "Great question. I have a video on that titled "Can You Pass Medical Underwriting?" <https://youtu.be/c29jkM5-6bw>";

"I've had advantage but after watching a few videos, hope I can go back to a supplement."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgwXgLhrD4LgEzGjPeN4AaABAq>

Paying less for the same care · 31 documents · 20 voices

"Excellent information. My suggestion, respectfully, when comparing prices, you did not clearly explain that Supplements "Do Not" include prescriptions and will require an additional PD plan. Which is not a big premium but it is additional monthly dollars. Supplemental plans are Superior if the Senior can handle the monthly premiums. I've worked with some seniors who live social security "paycheck to paycheck" and while there are government programs that help assist, they have to decide premiums or food/medication. I love Medicare. I love our country. I love our Seniors. I pray for affordable, excellent medical care plans for ALL. In the meantime, explaining the Medicare plans as you do, is exemplar!!!! You are my hero 🙌🙌🙌 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgyNdbQBZ9WoEBX6e5V4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (5): "The great advantage to having a Stand-Alone Part D plan, rather than bundled with an Advantage plan, is that the consumer can change Part D Plans annually without any impact on their healthcare. With an Advantage Plan, a person can be left having to choose between the healthcare they want, the doctors they want to see, and low Part D costs. Too often, the best of all three is not in one plan. By the way, when comparing PartD plans it's not the premium that is important, it's the total cost of premium plus prescriptions."

↳ @toriless (0): "Yeah, but do you get decent coverage under a PD plan. The regular one is as crappy as a MOA is for their services. I have lost count how many times I have to pay for a medication because it is not covered. I had a doctor write 3 different prescriptions just so I could test each one to see which gets denied. The one that was approved was one that was previously denied a year before. The difference was \$3 vs \$200 and they only paid another \$8 or something."

"My plan G with AARP in FL (90 miles north of Orlando) just went to \$252 from \$219 from \$194. Massive jumps each year. If it keeps going like this, in 10 years, when I'm 80, my premium could be over \$900. My entire Social Security check is only \$665. With the way the country is going, I'm hoping I check out long before, because the Cadillac won't be affordable by then."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzGX4XNzdnypogFok94AaABAq>

↳ @belindapfaff8902 (5): "It is sad to get older and have to worry about these expensive Medicare plans. Big business wins again. Government wins again. 🙄 "

↳ @Nemo-yn1sp (3): "@belindapfaff8902 People have to start recognizing that government is the PEOPLE unless the people don't get off their asses and vote, speak, call, write,. You know, participate. Democracy is not a spectator sport, and the government is only what we make it. Are we Americans too lazy to both now, just bend the knee and blame?"

↳ @lizadivine3785 (2): "This is a huge sign on a dying empire and the elected don't care."

"Thanks for another great video! I recently switched to a High Deductible Medigap plan. Monthly premium is currently \$67 with an almost \$3,000 out-of-pocket maximum. I'm hoping that it provides the flexibility and predictably that I want with a lower premiums throughout my life. Not too many people choose the High Deductible Medigap plans, but it seems like a good compromise among all the available options."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugx Ct-3YOkOpHjJyLt94AaABAg>

↳ @shirl5953 (6): "YES!!! You found the BONANZA of HDG! Erin did not talk to this but I am hoping she does in her follow up videos!!"

↳ @stevevenn1 (0): "Thx I'm a fan of this kind of choice. A form of mini self insuring just the HD portion. I like that trade off for lower premium."

↳ @scottpearson5871 (0): "If a person has a decently sized (50-100k) HSA this seems to be the best option."

"One thing they never told me when starting Medicare was that if you are basically healthy and pick a cheaper plan you will never be able to switch to a better plan. After you first start Medicare they can deny you based on medical history. I wish someone had told me to go with the most expensive plan I could afford. Thank you for mentioning that risk."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N Compared to Plan G - Which Should You Choose? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3WBOKbvEq9U&lc=Ugy-MHTft3p5p5yT-h14AaABAg>

↳ @carapungo (1): "of course you can change from plans on a yearly basis, specially if you are in good health."

↳ @joycewright5386 (0): "@carapungo yes but what they didn't tell me was if I develop a chronic condition no plan will insure me ever. So I am stuck with whatever plan I picked originally. If I had known that I would have picked a better plan."

↳ @carapungo (0): "@joycewright5386 so which plan do you have now?"

"What's sad is Obama care was supposed to lower the cost of insurance for us before we qualify for Medicare. I can't afford these ridiculous insurance premiums and stupid high deductibles and am hoping to make it to 65 before any major health issues. It's cheaper for me to pay out of pocket for minor stuff than to have insurance."

— YouTube · Medicare Part B Premium Cost - Shocking! What is IRMAA? · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KVh-8gn8aO4&lc=UgzSmc-XX3Z9pFWWhugV4AaABAg>

↳ @MiketheTruckDriver (2): "@theodorejay1046 Then I die earlier than planned."

↳ @2226robin (0): "Obama was a President of USA and also a PAWN for Health Insurance Corporation."

↳ @theodorejay1046 (0): "Ok what if you have a major medical event then 🤔"

"I'm turning 65 in a couple of months I would love to afford a G plan with limited income I'll probably have to chose an advantage plan"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxnPLA_JdSH8Od-IRF4AaABAg.9wSRnrFxFxWiPA0qQBbeCTwe

"What, why, how. Thank you for doing this video. I pray we still have our advantage plan as we just can't afford a supplement plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgzK5p7Fsub3X_7fDaJ4AaABAg

"I'm registered nurse and I have CRPS or what used to be called RSD or reflex sympathetic dystrophy. I had a work injury that caused that illness and I can say it is a devastating pain syndrome. If you don't get it treated within fairly short time maybe a month or two at the most it is very difficult to get it under control and it can spread throughout your entire body. I was covered by workman's comp at the time and so I didn't have any out-of-pocket payments and was very thankful because I was in a pain clinic getting a procedure 3 days a week for about 3 months in addition to physical therapy and many other doctors appointments.. and even with that good care another minor injury to my opposite foot cause it to spread to the second foot. My husband was a cancer patient and we had a very good insurance coverage. Even with that, it was very stressful because there were some things that they didn't want to cover initially until I sent a letter to the president of the company and they finally straightened out the problem. I was much younger then, and it was a huge burden and as we get older having to deal with an insurance company is not something that I would recommend. 😞 . My last comment is that I am currently on disability in part because of the CRPS and I had to go on Medicare Advantage because at a certain point I couldn't afford any other coverage. The supplements in my area for being on disability would cause me approximately \$600 a month and I wasn't a Christian HealthCare sharing plan, but that cost also went up during covid. Next year I will be 65 and I'm hoping that a supplement plan will be affordable, at least for the short-term and hopefully for the long-term!"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgyOPv1Xe-jSMRQsg6B4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (1): "Good thing is when you turn 65, you can switch to a supplement plan without medical underwriting. So you will have another option when your turn 65 to make a change."

"Sunburn. Thank you for this. I would like to add that catastrophic diagnoses come out of nowhere very often and I know this from personal experience. The other big negative about advantage plans is that doctors can leave the network whenever they feel like it and then you're in a position of having to find someone new who is, in fact in the advantage network. Add to this the fact that many doctors are leaving the advantage network because of how it's structured, the fact that this is "Medicare for profit" and that the advantage plans have really erred on the side of denying claims. Traditional Medicare supplements allow you to see any physician you want who participates in Medicare. That is a much more vast choice for consumers than the narrow and narrowing availability of doctors who participate in advantage plans. I personally have invested in a costly but comprehensive Medicare supplement and I'm so glad that I did. We have to remember that we buy car insurance not hoping we have an accident and it pays for itself, but to take care of any financial obligations should we have that accident. This is not any different. You purchased the best coverage you can afford hoping you'll stay healthy, but knowing if you don't that you won't be wiped out financially as a result."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxUo0YS6DvcGfMLZyR4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching and adding your thoughts! 😊 "

"sunburn - worked well past 70 years old to avoid government health insurance. When looking for work I always wanted to get a job with a plan where you could pick almost any doctor and that also had uncomplicated co-pay scheme and had a simple to understand 'out of pocket' max clause so you had an idea what you had to absorb at worst each year. After looking at what was deducted from your pay for that plan and adding your estimated co-pays and adding the out of pocket max you had an idea what you might have to 'self insure' each year. Which of the government schemes is closest to that model ? Sounds like I should hope to be able to afford plan G so will dig into that. AND -- thanks for the comments pointing out that Advantage plans might not be worth 'fighting' with. That is what I really want to avoid."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzCJOqh3yyYXbR7EIB4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching 😊 Plan G has the least amount of administrative hurdles and is the most expensive from a monthly premium perspective compared to the plans in this video 😊 "

"Tried a high deductible G. Total monthly was well over 400 for both premiums and no drug coverage. Went to Advantage because I require groceries and prescription drugs to survive and United Healthcare even pitches in on that. I wish I could afford a supplement's upfront costs because today, I'm betting on staying healthy. A good plan would cost me over \$600/month not including my home and auto plus house taxes. Got to save a few dollars when you can these days."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgwtypdozQWCAbKrUeV4AaABAg>

"SODA Family YT Channel - Hi, I just discovered you today! Thank you so much for what you do! I and my husband have Original Medicare and Supplement Plan F and live in Florida. I sure hope we will be able to continue to afford it. How do you get all this knowledge? What is your connection to the industry? So glad I stumbled on to your channel. Looking forward to checking out your family channel! Thanks, again ❤️ "

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugypym9PCgvPxZ9FXm14AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Thank you so much for tuning in 🙏 I've just been in the healthcare space for most of my adult life 😊 "

"Wow... Great video! This has significant impact on my plans to start Roth Conversions in my 60's to move money out of my traditional 401K. I do feel a bit like I'm between a rock and a hard place though as I was "hoping" to retire early and qualify for Affordable Care Act subsidies until 65 (and then start Roth Conversions). Looks like that might not be the best strategy now."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgxyzB_zz1JEI_5PW0d4AaABAg

"I received my ANOC for my Part D plan Saturday. My premium is going from \$0 to \$6.30. I hope to find a \$0 premium plan as my goal is to get ZERO drugs through that plan in 2027. The expensive drug goes generic April 1, 2028. So I still have a Q1 2028 issue, maybe 2028 medication tourism."

— YouTube · 50 MILLION Seniors Will Get This Medicare Letter For 2027 🇺🇸 · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jGee266zElk&lc=UgxhNvNkchkqzyYueF4AaABAg>

↳ @nonenone7383 (0): "is this for well care"

"Can't afford medigap here in California,lost my Medicaid now forced into an advantage plan,it's fine for how in good health hope I don't have to depend on it for anything major."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgxN3BXyn92kqkh33UI4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "California is an expensive state for Medicare"

↳ @spotonpromotions1 (0): "Too bad you live in California - a beautiful state ruined by democrat policies. Good luck."

"I want a supplement plan but have COPD and can't afford my meds on it. So they are telling me that i have to go to Medicare Advantage plan."

— YouTube · Understand Medicare Supplements vs. Advantage Plans in 60 Seconds · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nSFMZ2bVsUs&lc=Ugw7yheQvSd0PSm1Y9Z4AaABAg>

↳ @lynne3989 (0): "I know because I want a supplement plan too. I actually need to change most of my doctors. And I want the freedom to travel (good for health , mentally & physically), in retirement. But on the other hand am on a fixed income & my health is growing more complicated. ... Surely there must be a way to come to some kind of happy situation??!"

"Hope I'm not too late in posting this. I have a question about the pricing basis that you used for the Plan G and Plan N average premiums. Are they Attained Age pricing, Issue Age pricing, or Community pricing? I have had a Plan N for about 8 or 9 years, now, and live in a Philly suburb; my monthly premium is significantly higher than the average that you quoted (Issue Age pricing, I believe). I'd be grateful for a video that addresses more of the details that go into annual premium adjustments for each of the 3 pricing methods and how that might play out over, say, a 10-year period so that I can guesstimate the total cost of coverage over a longer term. Am wondering whether I want to change to a lower cost policy this year, but don't want to set myself up for ballooning rates over the next several years that end up wiping out any advantage from changing now. Thanks for any thoughts you may have on this topic, and thanks posting this video in which you raise many good points!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugz0A5Y179J8GVLPxKp4AaABAq>

↳ @medicare365 (0): "I appreciate the long question and comment. I can say this with certainty. There is no way for me or anyone else to predict 5 or 10 years from now when it comes to price increases. The truth is attained age, issue age etc is a scam. They all go up in price. The only way to keep the price down is to stay healthy and change your plan every 2 years. Unfortunately, many people believe there is a silver bullet to beat the Medigap increases, but I have been in this space for 20 years and it doesn't happen. The HDG increases have been way less than Plan G and Plan N ... but many people don't like high deductible plans. Hope this helps."

"I am 78 and have a plan f. Unfortunately, my supplement company has become unstable and has been raising my premium 10% a year for several years. My current monthly premium is \$440. Mo. I would like to change to a different company for a lower premium but am afraid I will not pass underwriting due to my weight. I am 5'2" 300 lbs. Any suggestions? My zip code is 60067."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwD0BssDok_O_vK1dd4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Hi Beverly, this is quite common with supplement plans. Would you mind sending me an email to erik@90daysfromretirement.com with your zip code? Where you live will impact the answer to that question. Thank you for watching and sharing your experience."

"I subscribed to "Blue Advantage" because they offered better coverage on drugs. Now they are imposing more restrictions on what they cover, regardless of your medical needs. I want to go back to Medicare, but can't afford to lose the drug coverage. Any suggestions?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugx0Ck5CznT8cDbD6494AaABAq>

"Humana has a ppo advantage plan with a 2200. Out of pocket. I would love to have the medigap but then I don't think I can afford the part d. I will be 65 in October. When should I sign up to have insurance effective 11/1" — YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgxXGEyqXIZl1Tt0l294AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "You should enroll in Medicare as soon as you can during your initial enrollment period (Aug 01) <https://medigapseminars.org/medigap-calculator/> Then, you will get a Medicare number in about 30-days. Once you have a Medicare number, you can apply for your Advantage Plan. Contact us when you have applied for Medicare and we will put you on our schedule: <https://medigapseminars.org/contact-us/>;

Any doctor, any hospital, no approvals · 27 documents · 20 voices

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— r/medicare · 88 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1op2r5b/>

↳ (0): "Bad insurance is great when you don't use it. Medicare Advantage plans work great when they aren't used."

↳ (0): "Exactly this. What happens when (not if) significant chronic conditions coupled with acute conditions accumulate? None of us is getting any younger. Once you're locked into MA, it can be *very* hard to get out, and once they start denying needed care, you will need to start fighting them for your life."

↳ (0): "Nope. Wife and I both have Advantage plans. Her's is used a lot. No problems. I wish people like you would stop making general statements you really know nothing about. It works well for half the Medicare recipients."

"My experience with UHC was that they initially gave me \$3000 for dental the first year, which basically covers cleanings, and filling cavities, then they dropped it by \$500 dollars for the next 2 years. I needed a bridge, which costs a lot more than \$2000, never mind that I would still need my routine care. I finally went back to regular Medicare last fall. My secondary insurance covers my routine dental care. Still no bridge, but at least I do not have to be manipulated by a for-profit advantage care corp. Oh! And I can see any doctor I want and go to any facility that takes Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 37 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflLVCC&lc=UgwjTPflbhOs9e-qKml4AaABAg>

↳ @elizabethconnolly3260 (0): "Exactly! Their "additional benefits" are subpar and have very limited providers."

"I want to choose my own doctor when I need him. I don't want to wait for a referral or a wait till my doctor thinks I need a specialist."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzScyFbSRKvBEO7UwN4AaABAg>

"I dropped United Healthcare Advantage plan last year and went back to original Medicare and Humana supplement plan, I'll never go back, I can go to any doctor or hospital I want to go to it's great, it cost \$120.50 a month here in Oklahoma for Humana plan G, I went to eye doctor yesterday and set it up a cataract surgery, it will be done 7-06-26 no referral and with who I want..."

— YouTube · IT KEEPS HAPPENING I ANOTHER Medicare Advantage Company Cancels ALL Plans · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j2ENvE0j1gc&lc=UgxwrOhvpmwtbvAo0TI4AaABAg>

↳ @ReginaCline-u8i (1): "Thank you for the info, i to plan on keeping A and B. But needed a part D drug program, and had always worked with Etna they are great. With ma as a back up, ma isn't doing it any more. They notified the doctors be for me, and then they started firing volleys at each other then me. That's why i said i needed help. Thanks"

↳ @commonsense6967 (1): "Where I am, ALL the cataract surgeons accept my MA HMO and have since MA plans began."

↳ @pgrut8880 (0): "Yup. Might pay more after adding supplemental plan. But you have much less head aches."

"I have Medicare Advantage and love it. The premiums are low and the deductible is only \$150 with a \$1200 annual out of pocket including the deductible. That is the most I can spend on medical care in a year. I have a very long history of heart trouble with multiple surgeries and catheterization procedures not to mention the very sophisticated constant testing that goes along with it. I have never been refused anything recommended by my doctors. This past January I burned through the \$1200 in the first week. I have paid nothing for medical care since. I have no group nor preferred providers, I see any doctor I want and use any hospital. The coverage is good anywhere in the U.S. Emergency care and required procedures *anywhere in the world* are covered. I don't think it gets any better than this."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgyRPeulc_b6w8Q55up4AaABAg

↳ @kevinm-py1nt (1): "And what is the name of this miracle plan?"

↳ @jamesthompson3099 (1): "@kevinm-py1nt Aetna Medicare Advantage. It was arranged by my employer as a retirement option."

↳ @kevinm-py1nt (0): "Cool, thanks!@jamesthompson3099"

"Erin, I went on Medicare at 65 and got a medigap Plan N for \$91.00 a month. Now 4 years later in 2026 my medigap plan N is \$131.00 a month. Very importantly with Plan N which is way cheaper than Plan G, the only difference is a \$20.00 copay but none of my doctors have charged me the co-pay. I am very adamant about choosing any Doctor I want and flexibility to go anywhere to see a specialist out of state if nessary. I LOVE my Plan N!!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwcrxukaLOJTehg6qV4AaABAg>

"I totally agree, G is definitely the Cadillac plan. I have it & it was a no-brainer as it saved us \$60/mo after the Medicare deductible. We're in AZ & my husband has had a F plan for years, he had a heart transplant 21 years ago so I know we will never be able to change him. It's pretty spendy but we have a good friend who has an Advantage plan & has had multiple health issues over the past two years. He has to jump thru hoops to see anyone other than their PCP & has had tremendous out of pocket due to home health visits, physical therapy visits, etc. To me it's well worth the premiums to have the freedom to go when & where we want and not have any out of pocket. Some of the very best facilities in AZ do not accept Advantage plans. Unless you absolutely cannot afford it, I would NEVER recommend anyone going on a Medicare Advantage plan. Peace of mind is well worth the money."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxCIegHmta-6BbUjzF4AaABAg>

"I have an advantage plan and love it! never denied care or been delayed. I have had it 5 years. and it is a ppo. I can go to any doctor I want anywhere in the United States and I don't need any referrals."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgxaLqomxKqFNno0H0R4AaABAg.A1wcNx6624wA2OL5RyPEkl

"Great info! My daughter is in the medical field, as I approached my 65th birthday a few months ago...I began asking her about medicare options..she said mom just remember plan C stands for "criminal"...that is how she sees Advantage C plan...criminal...that is all I needed to know as I was going with medigap anyways to have the option to go to any doctor in the country I want as I fee thus is essential as I age!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz0_VOA_xQEg_xA6054AaABAg

"I am 75. I did the math at 65, and every year since then. I have had triple bypass surgery and a knee replacement in that time, plus pain management and physical therapy. I have NEVER even come close to the cost of any Medicare Advantage premiums with my out-of-pocket costs after traditional Medicare pays most of my bills. These plans MAY make financial sense to SOME people, but for me, they make NO financial sense. I love traditional Medicare and my free choice of any doctors I want to see. At this point, I cannot even qualify for an Advantage plan, so it's a moot question in my case. Still, I advise healthy retirees to skip the Advantage plans. Just get Part B and D coverage. I have saved roughly \$60,000 in ten years by choosing NOT to have a Medicare Advantage plan. This, by the way, is a GREAT video. Perfect explanation. Superb examples. Thanks to the creator of this content."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxRMkd2TW-71CFSy0V4AaABAg>

↳ @TrippinWithTim (0): "@geraldarcuri9307 Not sure I understand your post. Most Advantage plans have \$0 cost to you. No premium. And many have a maximum out of pocket cost as low as \$900/year. So if your bills were \$20000 or 2 million dollars your total responsibility would be \$900 for the whole year in worst case. With no monthly premiums. Some have higher limits but most are less than \$5000 if your co pays were to ever reach that. Also, all Advantage plans are guaranteed issue every year. I think you are talking about Supplemental plans like plans N, F, G and all the other letters. Those have very high premiums and usually you have to qualify. Not guaranteed issue...."

↳ @SecondSources (0): "@geraldarcuri9307 I just went on MC and my wife and I pay 50 each for high deductible G."

"I like to travel, and while I'm not yet eligible for Medicare (about a year and a half away), I was thinking about not only traveling, but relocating to another state. I currently live in a state with a Birthday rule, but I was considering moving to a state without rules about switching. Basically, I'm not looking to move until after my mom passes away (she's 93), which could happen before I'm eligible or after. From what you said in the video, it sounds like I'd be able to take my plan with me. Sure hope that's true though it sounds like the premium might change in the new locale. I want a Medicare supplement as I like the idea of being able to go to almost any provider and not have to mess with networks and all that junk."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugxspy4XrOwukx53klI4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch! 🙏📦 Another video went kind of viral so I'm trying to catch up on comments! Yes, your supplement plans would travel with you to the new state."

"Did my homework, and decided traditional Medicare was the best choice. In the future, I don't want to face a catastrophic illness, and a large medical bill at the same time, or a provider denying me treatment that a doctor recommended. And I want the freedom of going to the doctor/hospital of my choice. It's more expensive, but it gives me "peace of mind" if the worst happens."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_l8Clhv0iUwr3Eox4AaABAg

"I have a Plan G because I have a benign Pineal Gland tumor and it does cost more but... once I meet the Medicare deductible I have no co-pays or deductibles and I can go to any doctor I want and now that I'm on a supplement I will never go off because you might not get back onto the supplement plan. My Plan G does cover 2 cleanings a year and some of my vision if I need glasses."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxK6BFc46ppTtEFg1t4AaABAg>

"We have a Medigap part G plan with United Healthcare through AARP that pays 100% of what Medicare doesn't pay. My husband says we pay \$81.00 a month for it and we're in Cook County Illinois and things are more expensive in Cook County. It paid 100% of my triple bypass surgery in 2024 and we're able to choose any doctor or hospital we want as long as they accept Medicare."

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=Ugz9zCY7M6BiBSFIYDh4AaABAg_ANlyvNUqRMDANeTiTPk937

"I'd love to see any doctor I want to under Plan N, but the doctors are not open to getting new patients."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgyorvdhNshg8vyklUJ4AaABAg>

↳ @joycelovellmaglothin8449 (0): "Exactly! My long time dr won't take it nor any of the others listed on the plan!"

"I switched to Medicare advantage on January 1st. I switched back to a supplemental plan after watching this episode of John Oliver. I found a similar situation that John had described with my new Medicare advantage insurance plan. I had my primary doctor schedule (referral) a sleep study for me. The sleep center contacted me and told me they did not accept my insurance. I explained that the sleep center was listed on the insurance website as being in network, however, that was not correct. The sleep study center explained that they were not contracted with my insurance. As I found, the Medicare advantage insurance plan has a limited number of available doctors and facilities. Even though the financial incentives are very attractive, I don't want to sacrifice my health. The incentives for the advantage plan includes refunding my monthly Medicare premium, waived the deductible, and included dental and vision. At least now I can see any doctor I want without a referral."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyVG9Ymah-dmbtFjRB4AaABAg>

"@LeeCountySpeedShop This is exactly what I did. I strongly oppose Medicare Advantage. You get what you pay for. It's cheap for a reason. They can deny care, tests, procedures and they have doctor networks. I can go wherever I want, without pre-approval, and see any doctor I want. I also ended up suddenly in the hospital last year and got diagnosed with an autoimmune disease out of the blue. I was a week in the hospital and paid nothing. I got weekly in home nurse and PT visits for 2months after I was home. Without part D I estimate my drug costs would have been >20,000 last year. Instead my costs were capped at 2000 and everything free after that. I had no clue this was going to happen to me. I have been in doctors offices when people came in with their Medicare advantage cards only to be told that office doesn't accept that plan. People think it's the same as traditional Medicare. It is NOT."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211lpLq6moM&lc=Ugygro_vH19Oogf8kHN4AaABAq.ASpIXZR9M9GAWks_vZXDUq

"Have never had one problem with my Advantage plan. Yes, there is a higher annual out of pocket before everything is covered at 100%, but I have been able to go to any doctor I want, as I have yet to find one that doesn't accept my plan. I do not need referrals for specialists. I am in good health. I take no prescription medications. I only go to dr for annual blood work and check up, and I see an ophthalmologist annually, as well as a dermatologist. For people needing ongoing medical care and Rx, I can see why they would want a Medigap plan. If you are healthy and don't need ongoing medical treatment, then it can be to your advantage to be on an Advantage plan. There is a lot of misinformation going on here about advantage plans. Both Medigap and Advantage have their pros and cons."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugz7ZCg8WF1391OtQdJ4AaABAq.ACWjHW9hH_0AYh2NtRXogp

"I have HDG and incentive to stay healthy. I am relatively healthy and so visit doctor for 100% covered annual wellness visit for preventive care and annual checkup only. My HDG is less than \$40 per month. Some years I do not have to pay full amount of annual deductible. The reason why I want to HDG is to avoid risk for potential bad year to set MOOP. I want to keep original Medicare to be able to go any doctors whoever accept Medicare assignment and I do not want to take chance to delay time critical treatment due to appeal process or deny treatment when it is medically necessary."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgzaP4_nahoAP1rqPgB4AaABAq.ALLt1vWRmfZAMfTp4WYqI2

"@sassysaint3096 Absolutely false. So, do tell, where do you get this info from? FAUX SPEWS? I have an advantage plan, and couldn't be happier. Can I see any specialist I want? Yes. I take 7 medications, I pay NOTHING for 6 of them, my lyrica is \$5.00 per month. I need a cat scan? My cost, \$99.00. Need a MRI? I pay \$250.00. My plan paid for BOTH eyes to have cataract surgery. My part? \$200.00. There are advantage plans that are rip offs. But anyone with more than two brain cells can pick a good advantage plan."

— YouTube · Trump Administration to End Medicare Drug Plan Subsidy. #medication #medicare #doctor · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BrOgybQKs-A&lc=UgwjaHVSzGOB5FFnQwJ4AaABAq.AZp6J15nA1eAZpD0-cSF3U>

Staying healthy enough never to need it · 16 documents · 16 voices

"Sunburn. Thank you for this. I would like to add that catastrophic diagnoses come out of nowhere very often and I know this from personal experience. The other big negative about advantage plans is that doctors can leave the network whenever they feel like it and then you're in a position of having to find someone new who is, in fact in the advantage network. Add to this the fact that many doctors are leaving the advantage network because of how it's structured, the fact that this is "Medicare for profit" and that the advantage plans have really erred on the side of denying claims. Traditional Medicare supplements allow you to see any physician you want who participates in Medicare. That is a much more vast choice for consumers than the narrow and narrowing availability of doctors who participate in advantage plans. I personally have invested in a costly but comprehensive Medicare supplement and I'm so glad that I did. We have to remember that we buy car insurance not hoping we have an accident and it pays for itself, but to take care of any financial obligations should we have that accident. This is not any different. You purchased the best coverage you can afford hoping you'll stay healthy, but knowing if you don't that you won't be wiped out financially as a result."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxUo0YS6DvcGfMLZyR4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching and adding your thoughts! 🌞 "

"Great video with much information. I am on original medicare, supplement thru united health, humana for medicare D. Every year I have increase in premiums and only use my insurance for annual visit with pcp and gyn. On very little meds. For once, I would like to see an incentive for less premiums if you stay healthy and take care of yourself!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Math Nobody Shows You · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LJ3P5gL1JFw&lc=UgxIkbP7f9rrukpTygR4AaABAg>

↳ @BruceLee-zw5ue (0): "You and I (the healthy ones) subsidizing the abusers."

"Today is my first day in Medicare plan G. I hope I never have to use it 😊 "

— YouTube · Medicare Broker Reveals 3 Reasons He Chose Supplemental Plan G · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D-ub2E2kShQ&lc=UgyKZWKi3bq7iqjx8IF4AaABAg>

"I am 66 and retired, almost 67. I worked in healthcare as a clinician for over 45 years. I have Medicare with a high deductible G plan and never use it. I realize I am blessed to be on no meds (just supplements I manage), but it gets really old having constant increases when I never even use it. I stay out of the medical system and hopefully will never need it in my lifetime. I just think it is a very broken system. I don't miss it at all! Staying clear of highly processed anything and eating Mediterranean (thanks to my Greek family) has kept me healthy. So has not drinking or smoking, pot, etc. A lot of disease are HIGHLY preventable by making the right decision. It is sad to me that so many people are dependent on this system, many from bad choices they made in the past! I really wish Medicare would look at non users or infrequent users and give us a damn break for the efforts of staying healthy!"

— YouTube · 6 BIGGEST Medicare Changes in 2027!! IMPORTANT 📢 · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1a0IVireAKg&lc=UgyphuHhAt-NKR5cVklZ4AaABAg>

↳ @CalHealth-Insurance (2): "Thanks so much for adding to the discussion, and congratulations on staying so healthy. After 45 years working in healthcare, you've certainly seen the system from a perspective most people haven't! I can understand the frustration of paying increasing premiums when you rarely use your coverage. Medicare and Medigap are generally structured around shared risk, so premiums aren't based solely on how much one individual uses the healthcare system. That can definitely feel frustrating for people who have very low utilization. If your in CA you have the birthday rule where you can switch to the same Medigap plan regardless of health. This allows you to switch to a different carrier with a cheaper rate for an identical plan! What state are you in?!"

↳ @Michael-q7j8s (2): "@CalHealth-Insurance Thanks! I am in WA but my GHD is only 57 a month in addition to paying the medicare premium which I never use."

↳ @CalHealth-Insurance (2): "That's great to hear! That's the best way to use healthcare! Average HDG premiums here in CA are around \$80! Thanks so much for adding to the discussion!"

"Tried a high deductible G. Total monthly was well over 400 for both premiums and no drug coverage. Went to Advantage because I require groceries and prescription drugs to survive and United Healthcare even pitches in on that. I wish I could afford a supplement's upfront costs because today, I'm betting on staying healthy. A good plan would cost me over \$600/month not including my home and auto plus house taxes. Got to save a few dollars when you can these days."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgwtypdozQWCAbKrUeV4AaABAg>

"Can't afford medigap here in California,lost my Medicaid now forced into an advantage plan,it's fine for how in good health hope I don't have to depend on it for anything major."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgxN3BXyn92kqkh33UI4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "California is an expensive state for Medicare"

↳ @spotonpromotions1 (0): "Too bad you live in California - a beautiful state ruined by democrat policies. Good luck."

"I hope you never need rehab or nursing home care then rehab after a knee replacement or heart surgery etc. After week one after a major heart surgery the So called advantage plan decided that was all the care needed for a 100% disabled man in a wheel chair. Then after he returned from the hospital after catching pneumonia and diagnosed with stage 4 cancer he was denied skilled care coverage even upon an appeal. His total stay was about 2 weeks there. Yet if he had traditional Medicare he would have had up to three months if the doctor decided he needed one, two, or three months care. Another relative had a brain aneurysm burst, then surgery. The advantage plan said she wasn't getting well soon enough she was getting discharged. That was appealed, then she started improving and the nursing home recommended she be transferred to a facility for rehabilitation and Dis-Advantage plan decided she progressed so much she didn't need rehab and denied that upon appeal. Their doctors said they needed the care it didn't matter. What a nightmare it was for us. Had they had traditional Medicare each would have had up to three months no denials. I'm glad you and your wife are healthy. I hope you never need a knee or hip replacement because that's when the Disadvantage nightmare will likely begin. I hope all on advantage plans stay healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Experts HATE Advantage Plans! Are they really THAT bad? 😬 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9D3I-X5q5Oc&lc=UgzLVa0yW9HKHReyEut4AaABAq.AOwrD0YKQczA_ATDwLmyxM

"You can't be telling the whole truth. Medicare Advantage plans have deductibles and limits of what you can do and who you can see. If you're healthy and don't see doctors they are great but as you get older many things can happen. My ex husband just got canceled from his Medicare Advantage plan because he has prostate cancer. Lucky for him he can go to Original Medicare with a Medigap Plan and not have to do underwriting. Hope you stay healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=Ugz9iYBAa-W0r8LHK354AaABAq.AKS_Wd0HTYJAOA7VzAOuin

"I've had Humana PPO (A Medicare Advantage Plan) going on five years now and I love it. It actually pays - I forget the exact amount but \$40-60 towards my mandatory Part B (I think that's the one) so I get a bit larger SocSec each month. I've had my "Yearly" grams done and x-rays and have not had to pay a penny for it. No charge to see my doctor (I know my Mother would always get a \$49 or so bill from her doctor (she had United Health) my SIL took care of that, but I don't have to pay for primary doc care. I get \$75/qtr for OTC meds like Vitamins and cold medicine, aspirin, electric toothbrush etc! eye glasses per year same as Medicare. Only downside is my old doctor left it, but being a PPO it pays a % but I've never needed to use it. Just like the Eye Doctor, Dental care is the \$750/yr as Medicare.. Never have had to pay for a Lab test either. PS: Be Aware of "hawks" in Big Box stores, acting like used cars salesmen. I told him I was happy with mine; he asked Who and laughed and said they were junk. Reminds me, I'll get my choice of \$50 gift card (Marshall's) for getting my yearly.! Now if get to where I might ever need a prolonged overnight hospital stay I may look around, but pray I'll never need that. Gonna order my Senior Multi-Vitamins on Humana's online "Pharmacy", pay with my quarterly allowance and get free shipping! God Bless in your search."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwX4Ns-sZFRZLkxzA94AaABAq>

"my advice to those in their 60's look at it this way, my son when in his 30's decided he would save money by not taking the medical insurance the company he worked for because he "never got sick or hurt". then he was in a minor accident with a head injury. went to the emergency room and then he got sticker shock. yes you are "healthy" now but you need to look at your parents. when did they start to go downhill, move slower, need to see the doctor more, what illnesses or medical issues did they have? that will most likely be you at some point. so if you get on an advantage plan now it will be very hard to switch to a supplemental plan later because of underwriting. yes ask about what underwriting is when you talk to an agent. also if you like to travel just in the United States pray you don't get sick or have to go to the emergency room. most advantage plans have very strict rules on where you can go. currently my friend who has an advantage plan and just needs physical therapy discovered that while they lived in Michigan their doctors were all in Michigan but now they moved to Florida and are struggling to find a doc, PT that would be covered by their plan in Florida. my supplemental plan will take any doctor, hospital, PT that accepts medicare. advantage plans take advantage of you."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=UgwHjChLSi_59pFpa6t4AaABAg

"Your insulting rant on Point #6 is completely false. AARP United has a foreign (albeit limited) benefit. I have not checked any others because I don't have to. When I travel out of the USA I buy a very inexpensive BCBS overseas medical plan for the duration I am over there. Costs less than a nice dinner and covers \$2million. I could carve up some of your comments too, but I don't have the time or the inclination - but I can give many examples of people I know on MA plans who unfortunately get long drawn out minor levels of care or previous generation meds (warfarin vs Eliquis) while my doctors compliment me on having all options open for the best care at the best locations. Sorry, some healthy people can save some bucks using a MA plan, good for them, hope they stay healthy...but I planned to have the best options in retirement and I know MA plans are profitable - and those bucks did not come out of thin air."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/the_hidden_dangers_of_medicare_advantage_plans/k7qpe2g/

"If my part D goes up too much, I'm dropping it. I've eliminated all Rx & only occasionally use it anyway. I have Medicare advantage that until 2025 Rx was covered. This year it was charged \$87 in addition to rise in Part B. I'm seriously considering going just Medicare part A & hoping for continuing good health. Otherwise I'll just go on my own terms..I'm disgusted with health insurance & the medical health system."

— YouTube · Another HUGE INCREASE: Medicare Part D Drug Cap Has JUMPED 20% in 2 Years !! · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C_kBm_imXLg&lc=UgypnOp4v-MYpubbmbN4AaABAg

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "That frustration is completely understandable, healthcare costs feel relentless right now. A couple of things worth knowing before making that call: dropping Part D without other creditable drug coverage can trigger a permanent late-enrollment penalty if you ever want it back later, even if you're not using medications now. It might be worth comparing lower-cost Part D options first rather than dropping it entirely, since some plans run just a few dollars a month. We hear this kind of frustration a lot, and we're glad to look at whether there's a more affordable path that still protects you if something unexpected comes up. 1-833-833-3032, no pressure either way."

"I kicked it in gear and subscribed awhile ago. I just want the facts, not the emotional political version of the Medicare news. Being on social security and paying so much money every month for medical insurance should be a reason for subscribing to your channel. I know of people that decided to quit paying for insurance drugs plans because they couldn't afford it. They hope they stay healthy."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgxavazQ6DHh4tpcVy94AaABAq

"I am on a fixed income and have been for 8 years retired. I could not afford part B when I retired and Cobra was 1200 a month. So I don't have supplemental insurance. Yet I make more than the minimum to qualify for the State Health Plan. I am lost in the middle ground where nothing works. Hope I don't get sick."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgzV-4EJEEsE2zkF6kZ4AaABAq>

"Live in Maine, and Medicare Advantage thru United Healthcare. My goal is to stay healthy, and make the most of free gym membership, \$60 OTC benefit, and \$100 subsidy on Part B premium. Just started this month, so to early to either praise or condemn"

— YouTube · 6 BIGGEST Medicare Changes in 2027!! IMPORTANT 📢 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1a0lVireAKg&lc=Ugxi3WU6FwZYJC7yR6R4AaABAq.AalJHJCi5piAb6oEZObOj2>

"I have advantage plan I've never used. Hoping to change although I never used it. Don't get sick, no medications"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxX0dXVxZ_GDjZiMPZ4AaABAq

↳ @gmacone1679 (0): "That's a blessing. You have taken good care of yourself."

Getting it right the first time · 14 documents · 14 voices

"I don't have an anecdote. I just want to learn as much as I can about Medicare before I turn 65. I've been learning about it for 2 years now and I still learn something new every time I watch a video. I'm pretty sure I will go with the supplement. I don't like networks. Plus doctors can leave a network at anytime leaving you to start over with a new doctor. Whoever says they want Medicare for all doesn't know Medicare at all."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgynpQyRNd5K2lg6N-Z4AaABAq>

"Just turned 65. My broker tried to present all options and easy to understand. Very confusing. I appreciate your videos especially when I just watched one of those portraying this business as a DOG eat dog world. Having said that I hope my agent and I made the best choice. I really hate the whole thing. But thnx again for your unbiased presentation"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgycU_NhzSwAnS6aKMI4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! The analysis paralysis and all the marketing messaging creates quite the whirlwind. I'm glad your agent was able to help you! Given they presented all options, rely on them for future decisions. Sounds like they are doing a good job!"

"I agree completely! I'm so glad I requested a quote for my wife recently, and that you reached out to us personally and debunked some of the inaccurate info we had already received from a retiree trust that we were planning to use. I'm very happy with the supplement plan that you and your staff helped us choose, and I'm looking forward to doing it again when I turn 65 next year. Thanks Matthew!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugz0w8k5IZqJSnvw85d4AaABA9.9UjnTroRTKC9UkReofVKaZ>

"This is my primary concern about retirement. I plan to retire at 62 and will not claim SS until 67 or later, so I will be living on portfolio withdrawals alone for at least 5 years. I am also planning to live abroad during this period, but I will still maintain US residency. If I knew I'd never return to the US, I'd just skip ACA and Medicare altogether and just purchase international insurance for less money, but I haven't decided yet whether or not I will return to the US to live. It's a somewhat complicated situation, but there's always right ways and wrong ways to do anything and I want to spend the least I can on health insurance, since I'm very healthy and only need it to get a checkup once per year."

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=UgzUElqywbzbgmWmtGAB4AaABA9>

↳ @randolphh8005 (1): "You can choose to purchase ACA insurance annually. This is not true of Medicare, which has penalties if not enrolled at 65(unless still on employer insurance)"

↳ @RgnLothbrok (0): "You could stay outside of the U.S. with international insurance all year and still retain residency (a home) in the U.S. Just don't stay long enough in one country to qualify for residency there - in most cases that is a tax disadvantage, I think."

↳ @dlg5485 (0): "@FrankGransee That is true, but it's pretty easy to access any of the countries I want to visit on a basic tourist visa, and be able to stay for 90 days or more, depending on the country."

"Cadillac ... I had no idea I couldn't switch my agent down the road, if I were to find my agent wasn't being as much help as I need... that is incredibly distressing. 😞 I have a plan N, & so far, have liked my agent, but have wondered about the possibility of needing to switch, were I to find I was no longer getting the help I need. WOW, this seems SO WRONG & the fact that this is the first time I am hearing I have no option to switch, should I wish to do so, is even more distressing! Yikes! [8.3.2026] [Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? - The Retirement Nerds]"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxDIrsmJubmUe3FZN4AaABA9>

"Thanks for providing this great info! I'm turning 64 in April this year and still working for my own solo LLC on a long term contract. I use ACA insurance now but hoping I can use Medicare when I turn 65. I make a very good living well into the low 6- figures and am also earning passive income from a digital publishing biz I set up. Should I delay taking Medicare if I'm still working a year from now? 😊 I just assumed I'd be eligible at 65 for Medicare even as a solo entrepreneur ?? Is it tied to my income or is it my right upon turning 65?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgzhMS8ScBvMQ6a00Yx4AaABA9>

"very informative information. I have learned a lot from you and the social security expert guy. I will be 67 early next year. I'm still working..I would like to contact Zacc to find out what the best option for me. and contact Erik to help me set up medicare part C. Thank every much for teaching the public regarding the import matters to me over the past few years."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=Ugz8CQHJlvXOO4WOU6d4AaABAq>

↳ @susansu8287 (0): "What are the numbers to call Erik and zacc pls"

"Thank you for this video. Leaving a 🦶 "kick" to let you know I watched all the way through. I'm not quite to Medicare age although my husband is but is still working. So much is confusing for us and we're hoping to understand soon everything we need to to make the best decisions for our future."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSIfc&lc=UgwbjdtaZrMdhprM4-94AaABAq>

"I know the first time I ever had a UTI and pull anything I want to go to the jazz festival down in Houston that afternoon when I first became a nurse and I knew this medical student he was going to school to be a dentist and he put it he told me a pull my name up I want to be out for a weekend he told me I need my full wisdom tooth so he pulled them off all went down there today and I have a knack with you but now I said now OK and the universe is yours that I called his people they tell me insurance for the agents to Shema started to say 123 pool OK now but I have I will get Medicare thing and she told me theyIt's nice that they told me they give me \$500 OK name and I'll go for the x-rays so yeah the 400 wouldn't want to eat she won't tell me what I did he wanted something he doesn't know kind of programs out there I got all the phone number babe relieve me a call around then as soon as I am afraid is calling that Medicaid they call it a boom boom boom boom boom they get everything they won't know they got my money or if I want my money from the time I was 55 on American you tell him you're my baby enough to pay the dentist do you think I need to get a lawyer that will leave you alone it was amazing that we are the same batch as governor they told me the governor's fault but now that my money roll over and I'll kind of stuff I had to put my foot down baby what is your name Stephanie know that I want to call me to clean with clean Mathis a possibility kind of stuff I told Medicare I'm at La Quinta marina Tato next week I don't know what I want to get real time ago that's why 3NNJEJ OK God bless you she's not sure she tried to go to"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAq.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7qE4D49X>

"Your insulting rant on Point #6 is completely false. AARP United has a foreign (albeit limited) benefit. I have not checked any others because I don't have to. When I travel out of the USA I buy a very inexpensive BCBS overseas medical plan for the duration I am over there. Costs less than a nice dinner and covers \$2million. I could carve up some of your comments too, but I don't have the time or the inclination - but I can give many examples of people I know on MA plans who unfortunately get long drawn out minor levels of care or previous generation meds (warfarin vs Eliquis) while my doctors compliment me on having all options open for the best care at the best locations. Sorry, some healthy people can save some bucks using a MA plan, good for them, hope they stay healthy...but I planned to have the best options in retirement and I know MA plans are profitable - and those bucks did not come out of thin air."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/the_hidden_dangers_of_medicare_advantage_plans/k7qpe2g/

"@policyguidesI just started Medigap with Mutual of Omaha plan N. 103.00 a month for the rest of this year. I am in Ohio. Just turned 65. I have till the end of October if I want to change without underwriting so I'll be revisiting again to see if this is still the best plan. At the time I chose this their rate of increase was less than 25% I believe last year. In my ZIP code it was the lowest rate of increase plan. Who knows what it's going to be like next year. I just met my deductible and so far they seem to be okay. I need to be in this type of plan because I have to travel outside of my area for care at the Cleveland Clinic. Can't qualify for the discount because my husband has been on Medicare Advantage UHC for over 10 years or close to it when it first started. He just entered home hospice."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgwB6RPpKWm-6iD-mMp4AaABAq.AWhpWdjz4OOAZWynbZl2aX>

"Hello, I currently have Medicare advantage and Medicaid in NYS. As of November of 2022 I started receiving my pension so I am now receiving SSD which recently had an increase plus my pension. I know that when I update my income medicaid will do a spend down and will probably have to pay medicaid approximately \$200 to \$300 or more in order to continue receiving help from them or just stay with my Medicare advantage. Not sure what to do. Also I do have expensive medications I'm taking and specialist I see regularly. I would like to speak to one of your Medicare agents to see what are my best options."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=Ugxe6uQG8cD7wz14TQx4AaABAq>

"Erin, your explanation is better than any I have seen, including all the YT channels devoted to choosing Medicare plans. I wish I had this when I was making my decision last July, but it was still helpful today because it helped me confirm I did make the right decision, even if it was somewhat a gut decision at the time."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugw8gHpPD4OMDfixMUx4AaABAq>

"Still confused. Should L564 and 40D forms be filled and submitted before 65 or SEP at 67 if I want to retire from my company and its health insurance at age 67?"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxjGSrqynnx5qDlqPJ4AaABAq>

Dental, vision and hearing covered · 13 documents · 13 voices

"When looking for supplemental policies I want it to cover everything Medicare doesn't. I want it to have the ability to pay providers directly. I don't want dental or vision discounts, I want coverage."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgxzaZRDLhsBRTomhbh4AaABAg>

↳ @Malteser00 (0): "No dental "coverage" from anyone. Someone I know has TRICARE just shelled out \$24000 for a set of dental plates."

↳ @annawarner1078 (0): "@Malteser00 Dental insurance (in my opinion) is the scam. Because of the dentists. I have dental as part of Medicare Advantage (up to \$1,500). I purchased by myself Delta Dental . That is nearly \$80 a month for Delta Dental. And still I pay for the dental services."

↳ @sct4040 (0): "Advantagecare pretends to cover everything until the denials stop your treatments. They are a scam. If you can afford it, Supplement plans gives you the most coverage (nationwide) without dealing with preapprovals, denials and appeals. There is a reason why Advantagecare is called Disadvantagecare."

"What if you don't want Medicare at all. I was forced to enroll in this scam. I don't do standard medicine. I want Vision Dental a naturopath and natural medicines. I was told I had to enroll in Medicare or I would be penalized. I think I should be entitled to a refund since they don't offer what I want. I am majorly pissed off. I have been paying into the Plan for 50 years..."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugx5OsbJ2vzX0jjoFzJ4AaABAg>

"Next video you make it should begin with a picture of a lie detector machine lol. I actually went with plan "N" because I can fortunately afford it, good health, and peace of mind. I have a separate dental plan, and part D plan. My wife still works and I am on her vision plan. As for hearing my wife says I need hearing aids but little does she know I only hear what I want to hear when she is talking so I do not need hearing insurance. Now since the percentage is so low on the providers who will bill me the 15% "EXCESS" charge I just thought plan "N" was the way to go for me. Great Video as usual!"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzkpN_uWGtbBrjLX9N4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Well said! Excess charges are quite rare for sure! I appreciate you, my friend!"

"Thanks! I have a Medicare Advantage plan that I love; but I missed the age 65 window to get Medigap with no underwriting. I have more than one health issue; but my doctor says I'm doing well compared to most people my age. I was thinking about moving near Hopkins but good to know they don't take Medicare Advantage. Medicare/Medigap is now so expensive and the economy so bad I can see why many if not most seniors are on Medicare Advantage. I love my plan. I'm not looking forward to paying 180.00 or more for Medigap, plus out of pocket vision and dental. That will be at least 300.00 out of pocket if not more. What's the point of Medicare then? Medicare is no deal for seniors. It just benefits the insurance companies."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzBDlw8S7yJJKnQKq54AaABAg>

"I just turned 65 and will be retiring in November. I have had a heart attack already, I have 3 stents, I have had back surgery, a laminectomy, this year I had sepsis due to a UTI and spent time in the hospital and had a prostate surgery to fix that problem. I feel good right now.. ALL of that was done on a 'normal' insurance system.. like medicare advantage.. I had MRIs denied that my doctor had to fight for, but I got them all done, I had some of my medications turned down, but then my doctor got them through, they just had to request them a different way. I have one medication that is very expensive.. on Good RX it would cost almost \$300 a month. I am torn, I am used to the way things work on a program like advantage.. I don't travel in the United states.. we do travel internationally, We aren't moving, we live in Arizona... there are plenty of providers here. in plan. I would like to have dental and vision and prescriptions... ahhhhh... why the hell is this so complicated"

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlG&lc=UgwOrKtez63HKTbJsuV4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (0): "Hey Chris, I'm sorry to hear about all those health challenges. With all that going on, you definitely need to seriously consider the Medicare supplement because there's a chance you wouldn't be able to get it later on. With that said, there are some really awesome Medicare advantage plans from really good companies in AZ. Remember there are also trial rights for you to try out Medicare advantage plan and go to a supplement later, but because you're working past 65 some of them don't apply to you, so make sure you're getting advice from someone who knows what they're doing."

"Hello Stephanie I live in Maryland. Currently I am eligible for financial assistance for the time been not my choice. Since I am getting this for know and I just 65 so the advantage plan works. I am not collecting social security at moment but I am afraid when I do I will or might loose the assistance. So I am in a rock and a hard place. I will need 3 necessary procedures but been putting them off because I limited on which surgeons I can pick with the advantage plan. Now you work out a price example for plan G in Maryland which includes of course A and B and of D and I would like dental and vision. Do you have any plans for me that would make sense for using plan G those other coverages I need. Currently my max for in network is 8,000.00 per year. Any suggestions? I am worried and concerned. Do I need to spell out my email or can you see it on your side. Thank you."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwszfVUPldZ477apQh4AaABAg>

"@softwarephil1709 -- I should hope you get greater flexibility in provider, facility, and location of where you have coverage given the very high cost of the Original Medicare plus Medigap Plan G or N, plus Part D insurance plus private dental insurance plus private vision-care insurance, not to mention the complexity of dealing with FIVE different "insurance" sources each and every year. I dislike trusting my healthcare entirely to any insurance company, but after eight years on an Advantage plan, I've paid \$0 in premiums, and \$3600 in copays / coinsurance instead of over \$45,000 in premiums for the five different coverages purchased separately as I'd have to do with a Medigap Plan N approach."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEks4&lc=Ugz3idxhwfgtV2obRBZ4AaABAg.A7Udl2TJWlxAA7OP2esEvt>

"I have Medicare and anthem Blue Cross is my Supplementary insurance. My Anthem premium is 268.00 per month. I do not have dental or hearing. I will be 90 on the first of December and I am fearful of jumping around and discovering later I made a mistake. I'm on a fixed income and when I pay all my insurances and credit cards and taxes, there is not much left. I do wish I had some help with dental for dental hygiene, etc. Do you have any suggestions or do you think I'm doing the best I can? STEPHANIE WHAT DO YOU THINK?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgZB9wGtjWm2yVNotll4AaABAg>

↳ @tonyalexa1120 (0): "Hello 🙌 Roberta... How are you doing today? And happy 😊 thanksgiving to you and your family over there! 😊 "

"I have united healthcare advantage dual plan, my plan decreased in 2025, dental, vision, OTC, looks like my going have to visit dental regardless once a year, on my vision, hell where to go to get yearly vision testing, and new glasses that's not going to go over 350, that's going to be impossible, the OTC amount from 187, to160 for food, hope snap program increases , but I doubt it, that's government, well what can u do, can't fight the government"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1f93bec/anyone_else_receive_their_2025_annual_notice_of/lrjvpxh/

"@davidcarp5935 I'm healthy. I do I take 2 meds regularly, had a Ct scan, cot Az one shot, knee physical therapy and never pay a cent. My dental, vision, check ups free. If I want glasses or contact I pay. Medicare allows me 4 free classes in any workout center nearby!"

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugz5U0NbhmvpnoEB4Bl4AaABAg.A2dSZGiXINyA2kpeBFxRCC>

"@policyguides Most of us have been on HMOs our whole working lives. None of MAs quirks (like preauths, etc) are new. I wish I could afford a supplement but with adding Part D, Dental, Vision on top of the Supplement, its a fools errand to go that route."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1SFCZkg&lc=UgwiHp7iSAC2y-eYfCB4AaABAg.AM8sjxPZkEXAOHL5HIINZ->

"I have United healthcare for dental/vision. My vision can be done with Kaiser, but I would like a better dental plan. Can you tell me about those type of plans?"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgXScMyHaAvHxy6Az2R4AaABAg>

"Keith, Great video but wish you could have touched on dental that Advantage covers. I'm on original Medicare but paying through the nose for crowns."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxUCr0DDomjitobiBN4AaABAg>

Knowing exactly what it will cost, no surprise bills · 10 documents · 10 voices

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbjQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

"Thanks for another great video! I recently switched to a High Deductible Medigap plan. Monthly premium is currently \$67 with an almost \$3,000 out-of-pocket maximum. I'm hoping that it provides the flexibility and predictably that I want with a lower premiums throughout my life. Not too many people choose the High Deductible Medigap plans, but it seems like a good compromise among all the available options."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxCT-3YOkOpHjJyLt94AaABAq>

↳ @shirl5953 (6): "YES!!! You found the BONANZA of HDG! Erin did not talk to this but I am hoping she does in her follow up videos!!"

↳ @stevevenn1 (0): "Thx I'm a fan of this kind of choice. A form of mini self insuring just the HD portion. I like that trade off for lower premium."

↳ @scottpearson5871 (0): "If a person has a decently sized (50-100k) HSA this seems to be the best option."

"Erik, first time Medicare 8/1/26 in PA. I have been educating myself for 6 months with your videos which are the CADILLAC of education! Your agent Kelli has been amazing and we are finalizing things next week. I fit Plan G perfectly except I am healthy and want Plan G because I know those big bills and sickness will come one day. I am willing to pay for peace of mind all day long! Thanks!! Keep up the great work and honesty!"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxjVUUJ6-aL8oMLjEN4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much, Lisa! You are awesome and so glad you got to meet with Kelli! 😊 "

"All I want to know is the monthly cost for Plan G in R.I ...What will it cost my boyfriend every month? I do know Part B comes out his check automatically so what else does he pay??"

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgxSgFnaJw69KePAqkt4AaABAg.A6hX98Ryv3jABTFTInxlyW

"I'm going with Plan G after much thought. I know I will pay more in premiums but I want the peace of mind."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzpqjIEwlzDAqwK_Qx4AaABAg

"@whyme5024 I think you mean, "formerly clueless" as, speaking from personal experience, as one of the "responsible spouses" referenced in this video, I found "the retirement nerds" while I was sitting next to my husband's ICU bed during the first couple of weeks of his unexpected illness. (Married for 38 years, 3 kids and 7 grandkids and we started a business together.) Minor annoying knee pain from a cyst turned into full on sepsis and a series of unfortunate sequela for my man which resulted in his checking into the health care theme park with multiple "fun rides" punctuated by some fairly random "side shows" including a couple of return visits to the ICU in between weeks on the med/surg floor and multiple weeks at a rehab hospital due to some paralysis, several months of IV antibiotics, complex PT and OT services and then finally home after installing chair lifts and an access wheelchair ramp in our home that is now, absolutely for sure, our final resting place. I'm thrilled to be able to report that the husband is not only fully recovered, but is back working again with me in the company we started years ago. I had to pull a chunk of funds from my own retirement account for the longer term PT and the "durable medical equipment," the stair chair lift(s) and wheel chair ramp and the ongoing PT/specialized strength and endurance trainer from, fortunately, our expert credentialed neighbor across the street after the initial PT coverage on our original corporate health insurance ran out and when he hit the limit of what we moved him too with his Medicare finally becoming primary. (Note, many very good quality corporate health insurance plans have limited days for rehab stays which, until this happened, I was not aware of.) Both the husband and I are now on Medicare (primary) with supplement plans I carefully chose for each of us based on your guidance and the many videos I watched both from the my husband's bedside and from my hotel/Airbnb room at night while he was hospitalized. (Tertiary care hospital is an hour plus away from our home and the rehab hospital that our insurance covered was 1.5 hours away. I've spent nearly 16 weeks dealing with bills and insurance billing errors during my husband's convalescence which meant more lost time from work for me and further need to use some of my own savings. I was raised in a medical family and worked in public health before starting the company my husband and I own and run together. I can imagine, but don't wish to, how awful this must be for people who don't know how "medical care billing" and insurance companies work/or don't. Our plan to be fully retired by the end of this coming July is now on hold again as our long term employees who are taking over ownership of our company have to wait a bit longer until there is less economic uncertainty and I'm grateful that we're healthy enough to be able to continue to work with them for another year or so until the economic outlook improves and I'm also grateful, especially after last Friday and, likely, after tomorrow, Monday, that I pulled some funds from my savings to pay for the stuff that insurance and Medicare didn't cover. Just trying to say that your information was extremely helpful and has saved our family from a ton of additional hardship and worry. My husband's last surgery was at the end of last August after the theme park event began last March. Even though we live near the ocean and have some of the best beaches on earth near us, I didn't have a chance to get any kind of sunburn last summer, but this summer, I'll be making up for that, but will still be using a proper sunscreen. (If you know the risk, you can mitigate the risk if you plan ahead and make it easier to have the tools needed in hand/easily available when needed. Risk mgmt is also one of the components of public health work.) Thanks to you and your crew for the invaluable service you provide."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgztNfG0dtPVPcNyTvF4AaABAg.AGYUS018ZMFAGbFs7POJen>

"I don't know if you are going to read this comment but you know what's bothering me I feel like they're treating the American people like we are immigrant workers I'm sorry as Americans we have worked the 40 or 20 or 30 hours that they have required and yet we are now had to pay this out-of-pocket and I'm like you know what you won't give us our Medicaid until we get 65 we've got too much money in our account so that disqualifies us so I feel like hurting myself I wish they would make a allowance income so that we could just go ahead and pay for our co-pays up front with an insurance company because person myself just pay as you play Bullshit is stupid I right now have got over \$377 worth of bills on one bill and \$200 on another because of ambulance and I would rather just pay something up front I could take \$1,000 and put it on an a payment and just not have to worry about it sneaking up on me you know kind of like a buffer I mean and none of that but the way I tell them what they want to cut Medicaid and Medicare off anyway does this shit even matter it's like they're trying to leave the American people without insurance anyway so tell me they just guess anyway they're saying we only got 37 more checks to go Medicare Medicaid may not even be even on the table so what are we paying for if it's not going to be there I would rather just make an account my own account so that those out-of-pocket surprise expenses won't be surprised and on top of that you're taking all this money out from us but yet we came and use it on taxes unless we reach something like 37,000 I can't even claim of things are coming out of my paycheck to my tax preparer if I'm paying all this money shouldn't I not least be able to use it as a tax write-off now you said leave a comment I did so I hope that you respond to this comment thank you"

— YouTube · 50 MILLION Seniors Will Get This Medicare Letter For 2027 🇺🇸 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jGee266zElk&lc=UgwnM4vVVoGDncjX30R4AaABAg>

"Excellent video, thank you and be careful about getting sunburn. I avoid doctors and I went with the HD G, thinking I want to make sure I have coverage for any unforeseen high expenses, without paying more than necessary every month and not worry about networks and such. I bite the bullet on the dental and vision. I avoid Advantage because they take your Medicare money and sell you something in return, leave you with the possibility of denial and a potentially higher cost. The main reason however and you missed this in your presentation is that once you are on an advantage plan, you can't easily go back to a supplemental."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwBKx7VCP0Zr9HEq654AaABAg>

↳ @SecondSources (0): "Exactly my logic for going on HTG. Also for many things like cancer or getting smashed up in a car accident the medical community is amazing. But for a whole raft of lesser issues they are pretty worthless and the internet can be a lifesaver. I've had to DIY 2 conditions I've had in the last 5 years because doctors were clueless. I even think these "preventative" programs are mostly worthless. I'm the only one that can really do prevention by wise choices and regular exercise."

"For the year 2026 there was a zero dollar premium for Part D , do you know if they have this for year 2027 ? I did not know and paying \$100 premium for part D for 2026 , I am healthy , so I want \$0 premium for 2027 , Thank you"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywc4myaw&lc=UgwRns-VmxdMXlrcEdx4AaABAg>

"I would like to know how much the Federal Government pays Insurance companies to insure people and pay ALL of their claims on their Medicare Advantage plans. Thanks, Bobby Coln, A former Independent Agent, CLU and Lutcf."

— YouTube · Unhappy with Medicare Advantage? How to Leave Your Advantage Plan for Original Medicare · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5h5ErGtBYLQ&lc=Ugz2ZAKBjSvVq1IBIGd4AaABAg>

Retiring, or finally stopping work · 7 documents · 7 voices

"Thank you! I'm 64 and hoping to retire next year at 65 and am doing initial; research and this video was such a helpful resource!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgzQc52Xkxf8FWPyD-V4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (0): "That's wonderful to hear — congratulations on getting close to retirement! I'm glad the video helped as you start planning for Medicare. Doing your research early is the best way to make sure everything goes smoothly when you turn 65."

"Wow... Great video! This has significant impact on my plans to start Roth Conversions in my 60's to move money out of my traditional 401K. I do feel a bit like I'm between a rock and a hard place though as I was "hoping" to retire early and qualify for Affordable Care Act subsidies until 65 (and then start Roth Conversions). Looks like that might not be the best strategy now."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgxyzB_zz1JEI_5PW0d4AaABAg

"I waited till 67. But am still working. Thank God. But praying God lets me retire in a few years."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgxyYfD5xIVmYqfZndF4AaABAg>

↳ @maggiemay8622 (0): "I'll be working til I die"

"i am 68 and auto enrolled in part A at 65 - i still work full time and am fully covered with a company insurance plan. When i retire i will enroll in part b - i hope i will not be subject to a medical review at that time since I did not enroll in part B when I became eligible."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugy8EnzV8F4gf8KuJ2B4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (4): "You're in good shape. Since you've had credible employer coverage while working, you won't face a penalty or medical underwriting when you retire and sign up for Part B — Medicare gives you a Special Enrollment Period for that. At that point you can also choose a Medigap plan. The key is to enroll in Part B (and your supplement if you want one) within the window after leaving your employer plan, so you don't run into delays or gaps in coverage."

↳ @Wogger1 (1): "You won't as long as the company has over 20 employees that you work for! You get a letter stating that you had coverage up to a certain date and you're covered"

"Great video with wonderful information to help me navigate retiring early. My goal is to retire in May 2027 (I will be 59.5), hubby to retire in February at age 65. Hoping your videos will help convince him that we can do this with strategic planning and enjoy life and travel while we both have the energy and health. Thank you for all your fabulous videos, I truly find them beneficial and they reiterate in more detail than I have been able to on my own to my husband."

— YouTube · ACA Premium Shock? Pay Less All Year · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8zEUYMnF5vI&lc=UgzsNVE83U9mEu84ekJ4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Hi Lisa! Thank you so much for your kind words - I really appreciate it! This comment really made my day because helping others navigate retirement and retirement planning is really the primary reason I create my videos, so it really means a lot to me that my videos are helping you and that you took the time to write this comment too. Sounds like you're doing it right, by thinking about it strategically. And absolutely, retiring why you have the energy to really enjoy life and travel is super important/critical, because that's time you won't get back. 2027 is going to be a great year for you and your husband, with him retiring in Feb and yourself in May. Retirement is such a great milestone and new chapter in one's life, and I have no doubt you'll both enjoy it and I'm sure it's very well deserved. Early congrats to both of you, here's to 2027, and thanks for watching!"

"Hi Sir, i turn 65 mid August. When i tell SS i want to retire Aug, should i work up to my birthday to get the age 65 payment or would a July 31 work exit still work? I hope that makes sense. Thank you for sharing your knowledge!"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgzlWXe438P-Hg_mucx4AaABAg

"Still confused. Should L564 and 40D forms be filled and submitted before 65 or SEP at 67 if I want to retire from my company and its health insurance at age 67?"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxjGSrqynnx5qDlqPJ4AaABAg>

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Friends, siblings and neighbors as the warning (or the proof) · 133 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"Exactly! I am 76. Have been on Original Medicare with a Supplement since turning 65. Was quite healthy at 65. Few health issues. At 63 I was remodeling a old house, doing almost all of the work myself. Tearing up old flooring. Refinishing wood floors. Tearing out old updates in the kitchen that were poor and putting in new cabinets. Did have my Son and Son-in-law help me with things I could do alone, like hanging upper kitchen cabinets, etc. At 67, my health suddenly began to fail. I have had numerous hospitalizations and surgeries since then. I have been able to go to specialist within a few days, without pre-approval. I have friends on "Advantage" plans that have had to deal with needing numerous referrals, waiting months for testing and surgeries, while I breeze through seeing specialist and getting surgeries within a few weeks. Do not expect that you will always remain healthy. Our bodies are great machines, but let's face it. As any machine ages, more and more issues evolve. Don't fall for the "Advantage" hype. It won't advantage you when you are truly in need of medical care."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 224 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugx5CVy8MAo_bxfGmzd4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (13): "Thank you for sharing your story — it's such an important reminder. Many people feel great when they first start Medicare, but as you've experienced, health can change quickly. Having a Supplement plan makes a huge difference when it comes to getting timely access to specialists and surgeries without the hurdles of referrals or pre-approvals. You make a great point: while Medicare Advantage can look attractive upfront, those restrictions can become very frustrating once serious health issues arise. Your experience really highlights why so many people value the freedom and flexibility of a Medigap plan. I'm truly sorry to hear about the health struggles you've faced, and I wish you continued strength and healing as you move forward."

↳ @franks4973 (6): "Sorry about your health but thank you for your response. HC is my big concern and even though I am healthy at 62 and like you do a lot of my own work. It was nice hearing another voice of reason regarding Medicare. Thx"

↳ @reneeblack8940 (5): "Hello which supplement plan are you using"

"As always, extremely well-done. I am now 67 and have worked in finance most of my career. So many retiring friends asked for my "advice" and I explained why I absolutely, positively chose Medicare + Medigap for myself and my husband. Every single friend ignored my advice. So, once again, my husband and I are delighted with our choice and feel so darn validated by this video. It is a true public service!. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 193 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugxk9H-8V_DSIDWGiR4AaABAg

↳ @billmulvihill8452 (8): "You can't talk sense to most people. They stubbornly don't want to hear it."

↳ @bourbontraveler (7): "Are you sure they're your "friends"?"

↳ @lauraberry6729 (5): "@TAM-bv2di I'll never ask...and I promise to 🙄 try not to gloat if it doesn't work out for my pals.😂 "

"I'm 68 and going part time at work so I'm losing my insurance. When my parents needed ivermectin their advantage plan dr said he was not allowed to prescribe it. My friend who had a supplement went to her doctor and he gave her the rx. Based on this info I'm leaning toward a supplement to allow for my independent nature. I prefer freedom. Run wild horses, run! I make my own future decisions, not a 'plan' doctor. Granted, according to this situation I would save money with an advantage plan because I'm on zero meds, no medical problems and it would be cheaper. Nope. I'll take freedom and choice. I eat food I make from scratch, exercise, walk my dog everyday, not a TV watcher, and have self discipline. We should be the captains of our own physical destiny. I've started raising chickens for healthy eggs and found a lady that provides raw milk. Ok, done with my animal references and rant. God bless all of you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugw3cwYNdOVz-04Qf-l4AaABAg>

↳ @joyschlomer6866 (2): "You just don't know, you're healthy but things change quickly at times, out of no where. Run wild an free and confident you don't have to about that tricky policy of not being able to return to that medicare supplement plan 😊 "

↳ @giancolabird (1): "@ please see my response below. I think my response went to a general answer when I was attempting to respond to you. God bless."

↳ @beckyadams4161 (0): "What if I have partial medicade and Medicare 😊 "

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"my best friend who is older than me was sold an advantage plan when she retired and didn't even know it. She thought she had "Medicare" After educating herself she was denied supplemental due to a medical condition. However, her advantage plan got canceled and she became eligible for no underwriting supplemental, she is happily on a medigap plan now."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 65 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugw5dC0g1BZMxjki_R54AaABAq

↳ @bugsy2902 (5): "These cancellations have increased lately, over a million last year. It may be the only hope for people trapped on MA plans that the greed of these insurance companies will end in them shutting down and finally patients will be free to get a medigap if they can afford it!"

↳ @herrickinman9303 (3): "Is she happily paying those huge Medigap premiums that get bigger as she gets older, on top of premiums for a Part D drug plan and a dental plan? In over 11 years on my Medicare Advantage plan, the plan premium is still \$0, my MOOP for Part A and B services is still \$1000, I have no deductibles for Part A and B services, I pay \$0 to see any doctor, \$0 for labs, and get a \$55 Part B premium discount every month. The plan includes a \$0 premium Part D drug plan and a \$0 premium Delta USA dental plan. I see specialists 4 or 5 times a year for \$0. The \$600+ lab work for each visit costs me \$0. An \$80K hospital surgery cost me \$0. A \$15K outpatient surgery cost me \$0. A \$10K ER visit cost me \$85. A \$2K CT scan cost me \$0. The only copays I've had in 11 years were \$85 for the ER visit and about \$300 for Tier 3 (preferred brand) drugs. I've never had any issue getting authorization for anything my doctor deemed necessary. I've saved over \$30,000 by not having to pay Medigap premiums."

↳ @bugsy2902 (1): "@herrickinman9303 You are in the minority! Enjoy it while it lasts. You are taking very big risks to save money because if and when they start denying care it could cost you your life! MA plans are notorious for denying expensive care and rehab. They are even using AI to do it. If your rehab is denied you can either pay out of pocket while you appeal which can take a year to hopefully win if you are still alive or go home and do without! People have died waiting for their appeal. NH rehab is around \$18K a month where I live in Milwaukee WI. Most people can't afford that. You are gambling on your health and bragging but if you lose it could be your life. Many MA plans have gone out of business. They are pushing HMO's now and less benefits. I'm curious who is the insurance company? A local or state non-profit? I'm taking the High deductible Medicare Plan G when I turn 65 so I'll be able to afford it hopefully for life since I live in a state with no anniversary or birthday rules to change even your medigap plan. God only knows what the future will be for MA plans, but I want nothing to do with them! I've had to fight with insurance companies most of my life. I can't wait till finally having Original Medicare where what my Dr says is done no questions asked, no prior authorizations or delays or denials!"

"I was the billing manager in a specialty practice for several years and I decided early on that I would go with traditional Medicare and a Medigap plan. I do not regret it. Two years ago both my husband and I had unexpected health issues, he at 66 and me at 69. We are very active and live a healthy lifestyle so this was a total surprise for both of us. In my case I had thousands of dollars worth of care. My total out of pocket costs were \$0. Several friends have come to me to ask my opinion and I just can't recommend an Advantage plan. You never know when your health may change. One other point that you didn't mention is that the private carrier can pull out of your state with short notice. I live in NH and last year we had 3-4 private carriers who stopped offering their Advantage plans in the state."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 40 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzBzcN4Eic5G8ILUrx4AaABAg>

↳ @laurennemeschansky2000 (7): "If your advantage plan pulls out then you can switch to Medicare and medigap without underwriting"

↳ @ZEROOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOOO (0): "Your total out of pocket is the substantial monthly premiums that you, and most others, overlook. A \$300 monthly premium for each of you ends of being over \$7000 yearly in premiums. That there is your out of pocket expense.....whether or not you use the plan."

↳ @bernardberger8115 (0): "@laurennemeschansky2000 Is that true in every state?"

"I remember how a former co-worker frequently extolled the virtues of her Medicare Advantage plan for its zero premium and "free" perks and derided me for wasting my money on traditional Medicare with a supplemental G plan. She since developed a severe neurological disorder and no longer talks about her Advantage plan. I can't imagine how much my wife's health care would have cost out-of-pocket during her final years if she was on Medicare Advantage. The retail cost of her medical care during her final two years including multiple rounds of both chemo and radiation, countless ER visits and lengthy hospitalizations was somewhere north of \$1.5M at which point I stopped counting."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 38 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwlzT6bcZrgxTpg0jB4AaABAg>

↳ @katie-b-1-2-3 (4): "Advantage plans all have a maximum out of pocket. But, there are other aspects of Advantage that can be problematic (pre-authorizations, out-of-state medical care is considered out-of-plan and you will pay a high percentage, the doctor you want may not be in the plan, etc.)."

↳ @kmk0799 (2): "Medicare advantage plan have a yearly max out of pocket amount. Mine is under \$6k/year"

↳ @user-gs9se8th2w (0): "Yeah, but I can guarantee that Medicare and the supplemental plan only paid \$175k of that retail price. The retail price of care is the biggest fraud of our healthcare system. People should be p#ssed, instead you think look how much I saved with my insurance. Buddy the care you received was never worth 1.5 mil."

"IF you can afford it! We have a supplement, but I can see it pricing us right out and into Advantage just because we can't afford the monthly cost! A neighbor friend was just forced into an Advantage plan because her supplement cost was over \$400 monthly!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 36 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzozvb_m6d2TPJIXMV4AaABAg

↳ @marblox9300 (9): "@badawesome Um, Plan Ns go up too. :)"

↳ @badawesome (2): "At 65 you should pick the cheapest plan N in your area and you wouldn't have that problem."

↳ @carlaford7408 (1): "@badawesome you still have a monthly premium and 20 percent of whatever hospital bill, doctor or any procedure."

"You're not kidding about approvals. My sister was sent to rehab after a quadruple bypass, and her advantage plan said no, it's not necessary. So the facility had to send her home. By herself. They finally consented to a home health aide once a week. Two weeks later she was back in the hospital, and passed away. I feel her "advantage" plan failed her. I live 400 miles away, and never felt so helpless. She asked me not to come, she wanted to move here when she got better. I'm on regular old Medicare, and it's worked for me. I will never get one of those plans."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 35 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Be_bQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugw_SPJsMWPYthw9yGl4AaABAg

↳ @patriciamcpherson4667 (6): "I've never had a problem with United healthcare. home health come every day when I had a hip replacement."

↳ @deeannpea1593 (4): "Hi John, I loved this story "My sister was sent to rehab after a quadruple bypass, and her advantage plan said no, it's not necessary". People who are going to buy Advantage need to read this part. I called Advantage plan "Dis-Advantage""

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do,before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🏠🩺🙏🕊️🕊️🕊️"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixg9Id0w9OA&lc=UqxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAq>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MA Advantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to deliver the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"My friends with Advantage plans often get hit with denials the day before scheduled surgery. Traditional Medicare never does that."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixg9Id0w9OA&lc=UgzFkuMbm12hpUDJIB4AaABAq>

↳ @LavenderBlue-q1j (1): "I'm sure they'll be thrilled whe M.A.I.D. is mandatory"

↳ @DavidDutcher-r5p (1): "What do you mean by traditional Medicare? No signing up for advantage plans? Just using the government Medicare card? My brother did that and we had about the same coverage. Would you explain this briefly? Thank you"

"My younger sister has Plan G; I have Plan N. The difference in monthly premiums is such that I would have to see a doctor four times a month to equal what she pays. So far, I have only seen one once a year."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Plan N Worth It? · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V64x-sWEALg&lc=Ugx iwmrrjoXF2bHhDMx4AaABAg>

↳ @chevelleflorida (5): "@robertp330 according to what she said she'd have to go four times a month every month. It's OK. There's no wrong answer. Someone will prefer plan in and someone will prefer plan G. Thankful that we have a choice."

↳ @robertp330 (4): "Until you get older and have to start seeing a doctor twice a month or more."

↳ @RonMac08 (3): "@chevelleflorida Just saw a dermatologist, copay was \$10.39"

"My closest friend had great supplement plan. She only told her daughter, but she dropped it, got in an Advantage plan. At 84 she would NOT listen to her daughter and did it. She had a brain aneurysm 8 months later, and two months later, still hospitalized.. She is being moved to an expensive rehab. Her daughter said the bills are astronomical. The Advantage plan rejected every single thing to make you fight for each separate coverage. Had she not been so cheap, everything would have been covered. I myself was underwritten four years ago for plan G. Yes it's expensive, I was in ICU for a month with heart failure, a \$100,000 Surgery followed by three weeks in rehab, and home rehab for three months. Cost to me??? Zero, yup, big fat zero!! Another heart surgery in Oct. cost.....zero! Think long and hard. My friend had a nice nest egg.....gone!"

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzcjY71Bi2WAeUiyGt4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (4): "WOW. Such an important story to share."

↳ @butterflygirl2285 (4): "IMO - I feel that insurance Medicare agents/brokers who push this scam on clients should be investigated. It's my understanding that the agents are compensated for at a higher rate for enrolling seniors on the Advantage Plan. At the very least customers who enrolled in the Advantage option should be allowed to change back to the traditional one at no penalty to them."

↳ @RC-vv6nr (1): "I find that hard to believe . You should get a lawyer..."

"My brother chose Medicare Advantage when it was relatively new. Years later, he needed a very specialized surgery that no hospital in his network could do. After months of fighting with insurance, they finally agreed to cover it at KU Med Center. On the 4 hr drive on the morning of his surgery, he received a call from the hospital saying that they had just dropped his Medicare Advantage company and couldn't do his surgery. He never found another way to get that surgery and he died. If this scenario happens often, Medicare Advantage saves a lot of money by not having to pay for life saving surgeries."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyQFMPprBbPsPUB1Q14AaABAg>

↳ @RipWilliam-g4c (2): "Sorry to hear this shameless act of this hospital. Whether you agree with it or not, you know better than many others, why so many people celebrate what Luigi did to the United Health Care CEO and think he is a hero by sending a signal to the Insurance Industry people that make these horrendous decisions for none other than making a couple more dollars!!!"

↳ @angiemartin7919 (2): "So sorry for your loss."

↳ @cindyk4145 (1): "They cant cancel you until the end of the year."

"Thanks for the video Erik. I've been on Plan N for almost 2 1/2 years. I like the lower monthly premium compared to Plan G (in Texas where I live it's about \$30/month less). So that's about \$360/year savings. For the copays, after the \$283 deductible, my co-pays have ranged from \$0 to the max of \$20 during those 2 1/2 years. (Most times it's in between \$0 and \$20. I had an \$11 one and a \$16 one.). I also always check that any doctor accepts Medicare assignment on the Medicare website before I see them and I've never come across one who hasn't so I've never had any excess charges. My sister in PA has Plan N as well. It's a no brainer there. I hope my comment wasn't "excess" -ive."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgwKZZvFZN0j2o0GYwh4AaABAg>

↳ @JAB-q3e (3): "When I ask a doctors office if they take Medicare assignment most do not even know what that means. Many think it means " do you take Medicare "."

↳ @tomm7505 (3): "@Theretirementnerds Thanks Erik. FYI, with my doctor appointments for 2026, I just met my deductible. I also got my first Plan N copay for the year: \$2.28."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "I always live your comments, Tom! Thank you!😊 "

"@AbtInsuranceAgency - Yes. Sadly my friend had awful experience getting treatment with his advantage plan. Too much red tape and "approval" hassles ... Regular Medicare he would very likely be fine. Thanks for your videos 🙏 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8Sji0S1o&lc=UgxVqA0ZppghheEgmBt4AaABAg.95PNrwgrN4I95PQvpoadIB>

"I spent three weeks in the hospital with nursing home offered afterwards I had another ct scan after I got home along with two MRIs. I have not been turned down for any procedures and I'm very happy with getting extra money for over the counter drugs, 48 one way transportation to and from medical appointments and hospitals, dental work, eye exams and glasses and even gym membership. My friend has Medicare w a supplement and doesn't get any of the above and pays co-pays. I also don't have co pays Needless to say, I'm very happy with Medicare Advantage Dual healthcare with United."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 21 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyTKgkxTkTMhUiMNFN4AaABAq.9xlaj0ZoZYsA4ohb9f3HXt>

"I LOVE books so much! I picked an advantage plan because I'm not rich and I couldn't afford a supplement plan. I'm happy with my choice. The plan I chose, Network Health, gets good reviews. I'm in Wisconsin. My cousin tried to convince me to get a supplement plan but when I looked at the price, I opted to keep my money. I hate going to doctors so I haven't had any problems."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwccFI0ErZH2JjwKEt4AaABAq>

↳ @J_Neighbor (8): "Yes, it's a shame that the supplement called plan G-HD is ignored by agents because it's so cheap, they make so little commission on it. Yet, you only pay the 20% after Medicare pays their 80%, and the max-out-of-pocket of \$2950 is lower than the average Medicare Advantage max-out-of-pocket. (I'm not an agent...I just watch a lot of medicare videos!) It is discussed on this channel as an excellent, low cost supplement that is a great low cost supplement option vs. Medicare Advantage."

↳ @margaretfoote2397 (3): "I hope you don't get really sick and find out what you really have. Getting cheap insurance is not the greatest health insurance. Why do you think they can give you health insurance so cheap? Your cousin was right."

↳ @patriciariddle2997 (0): "@margaretfoote2397 My cousin has twice the income I do. Everyone has to make the choice best for them. I choose to be able to buy groceries and pay my other bills. It's easy to tell someone to do it when you aren't the one paying for it."

"Matthew, I watched many the videos you have made and am very happy with the supplement plan your team helped me with when I retired earlier this year. I no longer worry about coverage and the choices I have that the plan allows. Most of my friends opted for advantage plans and they have no clue of the shortcomings that their plans have so I forward your videos so they can be educated like I am now from your complete and easy to understand videos. Thank you again! Michael"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugz0w8k5IZqJSnvw85d4AaABAq>

↳ @kellyx57 (2): "I agree completely! I'm so glad I requested a quote for my wife recently, and that you reached out to us personally and debunked some of the inaccurate info we had already received from a retiree trust that we were planning to use. I'm very happy with the supplement plan that you and your staff helped us choose, and I'm looking forward to doing it again when I turn 65 next year. Thanks Matthew!"

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "@kellyx57 Thank you."

A parent's Medicare: Advantage, denials, rehab and bills · 112 documents · 20 voices

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"I'm 68 and going part time at work so I'm losing my insurance. When my parents needed ivermectin their advantage plan dr said he was not allowed to prescribe it. My friend who had a supplement went to her doctor and he gave her the rx. Based on this info I'm leaning toward a supplement to allow for my independent nature. I prefer freedom. Run wild horses, run! I make my own future decisions, not a 'plan' doctor. Granted, according to this situation I would save money with an advantage plan because I'm on zero meds, no medical problems and it would be cheaper. Nope. I'll take freedom and choice. I eat food I make from scratch, exercise, walk my dog everyday, not a TV watcher, and have self discipline. We should be the captains of our own physical destiny. I've started raising chickens for healthy eggs and found a lady that provides raw milk. Ok, done with my animal references and rant. God bless all of you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugw3cwYNdOVz-04Qf-l4AaABAg>

↳ @joyschlomer6866 (2): "You just don't know, you're healthy but things change quickly at times, out of no where. Run wild an free and confident you don't have to about that tricky policy of not being able to return to that medicare supplement plan 😊 "

↳ @giancolabird (1): "@ please see my response below. I think my response went to a general answer when I was attempting to respond to you. God bless."

↳ @beckyadams4161 (0): "What if I have partial medicade and Medicare 😊 "

"Very well done. You did your homework. I'm 66 this year. I had to do a LOT of research to decide what was best for me. I agree about choosing for my future me. That said: I have a high deductible G plan in place (55.00 mon) in case I get very sick or have an accident but I spend a couple hundred a month(about what I'd pay for regular G premium 210.00) to take care of my metabolic health the way i want to. I use functional medicine, naturopath, no conventional drugs, acupuncture, massage therapy and supplements that are not covered by Medicare on any level. My husband died at 58 from a liver disease and a transplant. We had an HMO. I refuse to do it that way for myself. It was a chaotic, frustrating and terrifying experience for both of us. I know that if I'm hit with a chronic disease or accident I'll be set. So I chose ease of mind over just dollars. Everyone does it different. My parents have always done an advantage plan"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwDoFtNU8GrgWx3-O94AaABAg>

"@Wildflowerz57 good plan! My parents are both on med advantage and love it, same with my Medicare clients. Advantage isn't for everyone, and I have some clients on supplements because that is their preference and they can afford the premiums, but the vast majority are happily on advantage PPOs with huge networks & solid care. I have also seen older folks paying \$700 plus total monthly for part B, med supplement, and drug plan because they're stuck in an obsolete med supplement and can't qualify for another one, and are scared to move because of videos like this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtlsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABAg.9Zo-abmMTzA9aY40j57arF>

"My mother has AARP United Healthcare, Medicare advantage PPO, and so far its been great, I know someone else who has the same plan and he loves it too, I turn 65 this year so I plan on getting thd same plan three months ahead of my birthday."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyxwtlsnO3Manu9DFx4AaABAg.9Zo-abmMTzA9aVlhSSQizD>

"The information that you provided about Advantage plans was truly appreciated. After my father passed away a few years I can see the the true rhino's advantage for him. Dad had advantage. He was never sick in his life so it was a good plan for him. The disadvantage was when he did have a problem the choice of long term facilities was between two places, both of which I was not impressed with. Unfortunately, he did not come home.I blame the 'long term' facility they had a one size fits all approach. They ignored the information from the hospital. The last bills we received would have bankrupted my family. The advantage insurance company paid about 90%. Personally, I do not want to die the way he did. I would rather step in front of a train than to die the way he did. For myself I have about 7 months to decide and I can see that the Supplemental Option might be the best. I am not rich but. I do not care to have some dictating what I can and cannot have."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgylrD8QlO779A8NufB4AaABAg>

"My Father had a Medicare Advantage plan. As his ultimate caregiver it was so frustrating. He had two hip replacements, that cost so much more than it would have. He also had dementia. I tried to change his insurance and it was impossible for to his health issues. I'm 65 and didn't even want to hear the "pitch" from my insurance broker for Medicare Advantage. I have regular Medicare and pay a higher amount for Medigap plan G. I love it! I get free gym memberships wherever I travel, too! 😊 "

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugwu480zWrzAZOqcgNx4AaABAg>

"Thanks for this video. My parents for the most part in retirement have had medigap, however they had to switch over to Medicare advantage because the premiums were crushing them, across both mom and dad they were paying approximately \$8000 a year in premiums which they could not afford. However I'm not fully sold that Medicare advantage was ideal for them but only out of necessity. Dad is in his 90s and is having all sorts of medical problems. The only change after the switch was that they had to switch primary care physicians which was kind of important cause now we are starting over with a new doctor that doesn't really know us. After seeing their situation I was thinking when I turn 65 that I was automatically going with Medicare advantage but now I'm going to have something to think about now that I'm armed with the information."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugx57fRPG79VO_jgyRd4AaABAg

"Great video!! Have a known cost vs unknown. I have watched so many older family members literally blow \$100,000+ with Medicare fighting cancer with in-network and out of network drama and fighting for 4-5 years and still dying....For sure have a known cost per year with an advantage plan and a cancer policy vs unknown....It's just not worth it to have the risk of not having it.... My Mom died in 2021 and we are still getting bills-so much drama.... Hope your Mom makes a fully recovery!!!!"

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=Ugx0gk1y0sGnSUi2Fwx4AaABAg>

"@Theretirementnerds My dad had a stroke at 64, and someone got accepted to AARP/UNH's supplemental plan at some point cause he died using the plan at 82, with cancer, in intensive care. No doubt huge cost were run up, yet we never got a bill. That's when I thought, 'that's the plan for me.' But that was 18 years ago, and costs have gone way up. I know how much he was laying cause I've seen his cancelled checks, and it's much more now. But if I could know I wouldn't need surgery or chemo at the time I turned 65, or that my risks were higher for developing cancer, I'd do MA and subject myself to the risk of underwriting later. If you're not accepted, you're still limited to a max-out-of-pocket with a M.A. plan that's not that much more than what you'd pay in supplemental premiums that year anyway. Plus you'd get extra's thrown in with the M.A. plan. I'm just wondering if a drug plan that gets connected to your Medicare, such that Medicare knows you have a qualifying plan so you don't get penalized, benefits from a reduced premium due to it being a Medicare approved plan. Same for vision and dental. I've been told that if you go the M.A. route, the extra stuff can only be the plans that go with that M.A. and you can't choose the terms. But if you go supplement, you can choose, since you're paying extra. Still, I want a discount if I'm choosing from a list of 'available' plans in my area and am not allowed just anything out there in the private market. If you don't get a discount on the extra supplemental plan benefits that you must also pay each month, then I'm not benefitting from it being a Medicare approved plan that's 'available in my area.' Do you get what I'm saying?"

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgzlsHmZ_mR11mtKkBp4AaABAg.9j0yd1aL3aw9o0jy9t4uoM

"Any COLA never even covers the Medicare increase. I got raped in taxes my whole life. It will take me at my current SS payment until I am 87 (15.8 years) to breakeven with the dollars they took from me and my employer since 1970 in dollars' worth as of 2025 4 cents of a 1970's dollar. I worked in 2025 and the Medicare tax versus the COLA increase will take 15 years to get those 2025 taxes back in inflated dollars. I pay the max ERMA, so Medicare B is about \$535 this year. Add mandatory if you don't want to pay 10% more for life not just B but also a drug plan. So, drug plan which pays less than Good RX (eye drops) and I never meet the deductible, at 71 I don't see doctors. If I have to, I go to Patient First urgent care, pay the full amount for the first visit and never meet my deductible. I do see dentists, but best plan only pays 30% for things like crowns or major work. For fillings and preventative 60% first year, 70% second and 80% the third year. My parents lived like they were still in the depression of the 1930s. Their reward was when my mother got sick, they got to pay \$9K for the skilled nursing care each month and those in the bed next to her for the next 9 years who had no assets/money got the same care for free. When they ran out of money, they took the house once she passed away. The whole system sucks for the ones who work 16hr days, sacrifice and save. It rewards the stupid, and lazy. We the producers get to pay their bills. I love the earned income tax credit, don't make much and don't pay in taxes but get some of my taxes in a payment to keep the politicians in power who screwed this all up."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgxFGI-d7skN_s4t8K54AaABAg

"I've had Humana PPO (A Medicare Advantage Plan) going on five years now and I love it. It actually pays - I forget the exact amount but \$40-60 towards my mandatory Part B (I think that's the one) so I get a bit larger SocSec each month. I've had my "Yearly" grams done and x-rays and have not had to pay a penny for it. No charge to see my doctor (I know my Mother would always get a \$49 or so bill from her doctor (she had United Health) my SIL took care of that, but I don't have to pay for primary doc care. I get \$75/qtr for OTC meds like Vitamins and cold medicine, aspirin, electric toothbrush etc! eye glasses per year same as Medicare. Only downside is my old doctor left it, but being a PPO it pays a % but I've never needed to use it. Just like the Eye Doctor, Dental care is the \$750/yr as Medicare.. Never have had to pay for a Lab test either. PS: Be Aware of "hawks" in Big Box stores, acting like used cars salesmen. I told him I was happy with mine; he asked Who and laughed and said they were junk. Reminds me, I'll get my choice of \$50 gift card (Marshall's) for getting my yearly.! Now if get to where I might ever need a prolonged overnight hospital stay I may look around, but pray I'll never need that. Gonna order my Senior Multi-Vitamins on Humana's online "Pharmacy", pay with my quarterly allowance and get free shipping! God Bless in your search."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwX4Ns-sZFRZLkxzA94AaABAg>

"I have Cadillac plan G ans I live in Missouri. It's very expensive for me but my parents had terrible genetics. They had bad joints. I already had a double hip replacement. My mother had strokes. My father, grandmother, and greatgrandmother has debilitating migraines, but my G plan does nothing for those. However my migraines put me at higher risk for strokes. Two members of my family had blood cancers. Both sides of the family have Alzheimer's. Six members including both parents have died with it. I have mixed feelings about the plans. I expect to die with Alzheimer's unless I die with something else first, so I absolutely will not treat any other fatal diseases such as cancers, should I get them. If I had an Advantage plan, I could get better migraine medicine and reduce my costs, but I'm not sure how advantage plans treat preexisting conditions. I think my agent is good but she gave me a hard sell against advantage plans. How would my pre-existing conditions affect the selection of an insurance company for an advantage plan? Would I be able to determine that before I committed to the advantage plan. Can I even switch to advance plans in Missouri?"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzP4adNpdnAWjf20d54AaABAg>

"Complete BS 🙄 ! I've been on the DNC list for over 20yrs and renew it every time it's been required. I've reported all Spam calls for over 20 years to the DNC & other agencies but they still call, just from different numbers which is why Blocking does not work. In CT, we have Senate Bill 1058 making it illegal for all of these unsolicited calls with fines up \$20K and jail time. Still get these calls. I get at least 30 calls a day 7 days a week and your advice is to NOT answer these calls? If I let them go to VM, I get dead air and now they know they've got a legit number. I ignore the call, it could be someone important that I may not be able to get back in touch with right away (I'm my 89yo Mom's caregiver while I'm on Medicare myself.). My mom gets NO CALLS for Medicare Advantage, wanna know why ? Cuz she's got the advantage plan! I don't have the advantage plan and don't want it so I'm harassed 24/7/365 even on holidays! Sorry dude, but your video & advice is just lame."

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=UgxSNv7Bh3cN-w6_ScF4AaABAg

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (0): "You're not wrong about the calls. The problem is foreign call centers are calling the crap out of a seniors and they'll never get caught or face jail time."

↳ @LadyJane66 (0): "@MedicarePlanFiteven in the US, they're probably not going to face fines or jail time. Besides annoying calls for Medicare Advantage, I get daily calls regarding Auto insurance (because AAA sold my info when I asked for a quote), Solar Panels, Internet companies, etc. If I answer the call, I ask what state they're calling from and tell them about the Senate Bill and get hung up on. I've reported Spam calls for years to the DNC and FCC yet nothing works. Like most issues, I have absolutely no faith in this ever ending."

↳ @jimanderson8249 (0): "So then what do you do ? I get 70 a day and I run a business. It is ridiculous. I've lost customers over it I'm sure and then I've got an attitude from hell. to the legit callers won't even hire me after that crap..HELP???"

"I was caretaker for my mother who had an advantage plan. The limitations were frustrating to get care that she needed. Through all the headaches I vowed I would never join such a plan when I was eligible. I did not. I'm in my seventh year & I still have basic Medicare and a supplement with a separate part D prescription plan. My supplement plan is a plan "F" that pays all deductibles and co-pays for parts A & B. Believe me with 3 heart procedures & 2 different cancer surgeries I was the winner in the deal. You talked about supplement plans N & G that have approximate premiums about half my current F plan. What are the differences between F (pay everything Medicare doesn't) & the N & G plans? I'm curious about supplement plans that are more cost effective but can still meet my needs. Have you already done the comparison? Please point me to it. If not, your help is appreciated. Thanks"

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugz1FDpVGHIRbdkOrod4AaABAg>

↳ @pearlsandpowertools547 (0): "Plan F covers your Medicare Part B monthly premium \$164 for 2023, \$174 for 2024 Plan G Does not pay your Medicare Part B monthly premium \$164 for 2023, \$174 for 2024 Plan N Does not pay your Medicare Part B monthly premium \$164 for 2023, \$174 for 2024 Plan N does not pay excess Charges Source: <https://www.medicare.gov/health-drug-plans/medigap/basics/compare-plan-benefits>";

"Sunburn...great video. I've watched it twice now. So I'm turning 65 in March. Maine supposedly has a great Maine advantage plan...but after reading the comments about the denials from the insurance companies I'm rethinking that idea. My husband went on that plan last year - he's 66 now. Both of us are super healthy most of the time, no medications. I heard your caution. We may have short ambulatory stays in the future. Both my parents had cancer, and my dad had a heart attack. Have you heard about the Maine advantage plan? I'm leaning towards 'g' now, but I don't have any real income except SS. What are your thoughts? You're the best advisor I've watched yet! Thank you"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyVzxPz2Aygb7XRRReV4AaABAq>

"FYI if someone might be eligible VA medical. My dad (WWII Infantry officer Purple Heart) had full access to VA medical, it was a lifesaver, hospital bed request filled in 3 days, ramp installed, low vision equipment, hearing aides, prescriptions. Only thing he was not eligible for was in-home caregivers (other than 15 hours week); and long term care SNF (which we never needed, That required min 70% disability rating) . Also our VA affiliated with Stanford Hospital, top notch. But another surprise, when we decided to do in-home hospice for his last 4 months he was moved back to Medicare, and it was not a positive experience. I wish we had a VA visiting nurse instead"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1m3bhdj/just_a_quick_bit_of_advice_to_those_who_readpost/n3w9llh/

"I am a retired SLP who worked in nursing homes, and I saw time and time again that Medicare Advantage programs denied care, even when the patient was making good progress and regular Medicare would have let them get more therapy and stay in the facility longer. I told my parents to avoid advantage programs, but they didn't listen. 😞 My husband is going on Medicare in a couple years, and he will listen, because I insist! I've heard of lot of nursing and other allied health professionals like PT/OT say the same thing. No advantage for us! Thank you for the Medigap advice and SHIP advice--it was really useful information that I didn't know about!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxmJVoctCK2WCDJr5x4AaABAq>

"My mother in law had medigap up until the last two years of her life when we helped her switch to medicare advantage. Saved her a lot of money because even at 88, she was only going to doctor 3 times a year (\$5 a visit). The last 6 months of her life she was on hospice and it was fully paid for. Seemed like a good deal for her . I am on my husband's plan (15 months since I turned 65) and my only choice was medicare advantage. I do pay a bit more, like \$12 per visit, but I only normally go to doctor 2 times per year, so far, so good."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxyPsaAvPrFJZNeMwV4AaABAq>

"I'm lucky I'll have FEHB when I retire at 62. I need to decide if I want to use just FEHB during retirement or to pick up Medicare at 65 also. My Dad has had several hospital stays that required a few days or weeks in a skilled nursing facility. He seemed to have gotten nicer facilities because he had both Medicare and coverage as a retired City employee. 😊 I have some time to think about it. Until then, I'll just enjoy the blue skies."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugxldznotr7f8CAbbR14AaABAq>

A spouse's illness or death, and what the plan did · 90 documents · 20 voices

"For a lot of people Medicare at 65 is a blessing. We couldn't wait. My wife had been putting off hip replacement surgery for years due to high deductibles and copays with our employer's plan. On Medicare (and G Supplement) all we paid was the part B deductible of two hundred and some odd dollars! It was life changing for her."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 315 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugw5192ygARS776lv554AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (25): "Agreed! We tried to show this in the middle section. For many, Medicare is better coverage at a lower cost than what they were experiencing before 65 😊 "

↳ @pgpc6448 (12): "So glad! Your wife deserves it!"

↳ @sfstucco (0): "I'm truly sorry to hear about your situation. No one should have to experience these dilemmas & delays. I'm curious — how many, here, in these unfortunate situations vote Red (Republican)? Not to start a fight or pretend to be superior, but I hope people realize that universal coverage/socialized medicine goes a long, long way to relieving these burdens, financially speaking and logistically speaking. It would cut costs SO, so much if we had a Medicare-for-all (i.e., for all who select it) scheme, from birth to death. There are variations that can include some copayments (or not), depending on how it's structured. But expense, experience, and health outcomes are greatly superior in countries with socialized medicine, in all its forms. Democrats want that."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now

ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

"So glad we were advised to take a supplement plan when we started Medicare. A few years later my spouse was diagnosed with cancer and was able to go to a hospital that specialized in that one. We never had to worry about being in plan or getting approvals. Paying more upfront meant we had no bills through the years of treatment. I continue using my supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 61 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwhJu-QYROdQEUKL_h4AaABAg

↳ @jimarnold7561 (3): "Can't speak of other advantage plans but I couldn't be happier with my Kaiser senior advantage plan. Low cost, good doctors, modern hospitals, etc."

↳ @txladywolf01 (1): "Same here. Straight Medicare and Medigap plan N...no issues and I travel USA"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "@jimarnold7561 Dream on Jim. The data doesnt support your statement. When you need it most you will discover the mistake you made."

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/>

↳ (0): "Counterpoint: if you are a literate adult that knows how to use a plan compare tool, you don't need an agent"

↳ (0): "The medicare.gov search tool actually does give the pricing model used for each result."

↳ (0): "If you're a literal adult and can read a law book, you don't need a lawyer and can do it yourself."

"In 2013, my husband was diagnosed with a terminal, metastasized, primary liver cancer, he was gone in 4 months; and, had previously had many treatments for skin cancers, including costly surgeries. We had a supplemental. Our total out of pocket (after annual deductible) was about \$30. Those "expensive" supplemental premiums were SO worth it. Two years after he died, I was diagnosed with triple negative breast cancer and was under treatment for 15 months, including 15 months chemo, 35 radiation treatments, and surgery. My total out of pocket after annual deductible was about \$30 also (some kind of funny thing slipped through somehow). If we had not had the "expensive" supplemental, I would have lost my house. There would have been NO way for me to pay those bills. The higher premiums for a solid supplemental guarantee me that I will never face catastrophic medical bills that I can't pay. In my opinion (and I'm 79 years old with all the predictable hearing and dental problems)....I would never feel comfortable letting my supplemental go for the attraction of a low premium on an advantage plan."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 27 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=Ugyj6NHH3Clwnjnt-IN4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Sharon, so sorry about your husband and what an intense few years for you and your family. So glad you are still with us. Supplement plans are amazing, aren't they? For those who can afford them, they give great peace of mind. Thoughts and prayers 🙏 "

↳ @sharontorgerson2556 (0): "My total annual income is right at \$25,000 w/a house payment of \$671. Just to clarify in response to your kind remark: some would say I can't "afford" a supplement. It's a priority for me because I can't afford to be blindsided by bills I can't pay! Thank you for your encouragements. @Theretirementnerds"

"I chose Plan G. It's not cheap (I pay \$224 a month) but when my husband ended up in the hospital for aspiration pneumonia and... something about an infection in the sack around his right lung, Plan G covered everything except the once a year deductible of only \$240 (that was in 2024) even though all kinds of things went wrong. He died on the 22nd day in the hospital ❤️😭 but at least I didn't end up having to sell my house to pay hospital bills."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 26 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyjNvAAWfHsIX0ho5p4AaABAg.AGdx14bB8Z1AKDiwr_YwLo

"Very well done. You did your homework. I'm 66 this year. I had to do a LOT of research to decide what was best for me. I agree about choosing for my future me. That said: I have a high deductible G plan in place (55.00 mon) in case I get very sick or have an accident but I spend a couple hundred a month (about what I'd pay for regular G premium 210.00) to take care of my metabolic health the way i want to. I use functional medicine, naturopath, no conventional drugs, acupuncture, massage therapy and supplements that are not covered by Medicare on any level. My husband died at 58 from a liver disease and a transplant. We had an HMO. I refuse to do it that way for myself. It was a chaotic, frustrating and terrifying experience for both of us. I know that if I'm hit with a chronic disease or accident I'll be set. So I chose ease of mind over just dollars. Everyone does it different. My parents have always done an advantage plan"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwDoFtNU8GrgWx3-O94AaABAg>

"What you say may be true for some, but if you have a Kaiser HMO everything is different. I love Kaiser. I worked at Kaiser for years and I know it from the inside and out. When I hit 65 I opted for Kaiser's Medicare Senior Advantage. Nothing has changed for me except that I have more durable medical equipment options and things extended care and like that. My office visits cost \$5 instead of \$25. I did have to sign up for Plan B which I wouldn't have had to if I just continued Kaiser, but I could see that it could become a big cost saver down the road when I get really old. But who knows what the future will bring? That's the thing with any kind of insurance. It's a crapshoot. And let's face it, with medical care, the less you need it, the better. It's much better to pay into it not use it then not have it when you do need it. And my Kaiser Senior Advantage is always there if I need it, something that as I get older is going to become more important. A lot of people like to bash Kaiser, but it's the best HMO out there. I can tell you that if you need something, you will get it. For-profit insurance plans make money by doling expensive care. Kaiser is a not-for-profit and their goal is to keep you healthy so you don't need the expensive care down the road. But if you do, it is there. My husband needed a heart transplant. He checked into Stanford Hospital and was billed the Kaiser hospital admission co-pay of \$250. He walked out with no more charges. Zero. He had a heart transplant, something that cost anywhere from a \$half million to over \$1 million for \$250. And despite the huge cost of the immunosuppressive drugs, he has only a \$20 co-pay with no cap. Kaiser decided that there's no point in paying for a heart transplant if they won't pay for the drugs that you need to keep yourself alive. Most people can't afford a couple thousand dollars a month for medicines. So we're fans of Kaiser and I'm a fan of Senior Advantage. I kept my original benefits except that they've been expanded now."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyGOoPOpnz833X5Yo54AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (5): "Yes - glad you're happy. Unfortunately the vast majority are on plans that don't function very well."

↳ @TrishBenedict (2): "@alysewitt3729 Are we talking Senior Advantage or Kaiser here? I'll just say that anyone can have a bad experience at any hospital with any health plan. It's always the luck of the draw. Because Kaiser is a good deal. You get a lot of value for your money. They don't ration or withhold care. Mistakes can happen and things can be missed. I'm glad you got your problem taken care of."

↳ @tinas4946 (2): "My dad was on that plan and had a lot of health issues. It was the worst plan for him. His out of pocket monthly drug cost was \$500 a month. A ER visit was \$75 per visit. He had 25 ER visits in one year. His doctors had no clue how to help him and instead wasted our time in the ER. He was in assisted living and per the CA law had to call an ambulance in certain situations. It drove me crazy. My take was if you are healthy you'll be fine if not it is harder. I had no idea there was original medicare."

"My husband and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan and love it. My husband had major surgery last year and was back in the hospital multiple times due to complications. Our out-of-pocket costs were minimal, and did not have to fight with an insurance company."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 17 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugwyw6ABbDI5ZR2qr_h4AaABAq

↳ @sassy0010 (2): "@MedicareonVideo Again, if you can afford the extra premiums."

"When we signed up for Plan F, we were both healthy but we knew that a catastrophic health event might possibly come our way. My husband has had a form of cancer for which there is no known cure for more than five years. Now he's in remission, but he relies on chemo to stay that way. He's been hospitalized for as long as a month, had radiation, and his primary oncologist is out of state (not to mention out of area.) We are thankful for our supplemental insurance that has picked up all our medical bills. We don't have to be seen by our primary care doctor to see a specialist. He has had as many as seven medical appointments in a week. We don't need another layer."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgwRRilAHjf-ru22nFB4AaABAg

↳ @GodzHarleyGirlStudio (0): "@carolyncaylor4142 Love my plan F."

"We have Plan N. My wife had open-heart surgery to replace her aortic valve. Even with all the doctor and specialist visits, imaging, and cardiac angiogram, our costs for the whole year were less than the difference between Plan N and Plan G. Plan G would have cost us more for the year. No excess charges, which are extremely rare."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgwltHpEnHjU95zVKTt4AaABAg>

↳ @loral10311 (0): "exactly and they said that excess charges would be 15% if it even happens"

↳ @RonMac08 (0): "@loral10311 They're rare, not worth worrying about."

"My husband has Plan G & it works for him because he has cancer! It pays for everything! I'm turning 65 next year & I will probably go for Plan N ! Will reach out to you! Excellent information! Thank you 😊 "

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwkBDYJYAdg8GSEr4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Thank you for watching and sharing your husband's experience!"

↳ @margieleazenby804 (1): "My husband and I have plan N. It has worked well for us so far. I am healthy but he has BPH and had to have TURP surgery. We paid less than \$2K on an over \$20K bill. I just don't like the uncertainty of Medicare only. And I know a lady who went to the ER for a ruptured appendix, yet her Medicare Advantage plan denied the claim as not medically necessary! Unbelievable! Medicare "Advantage"? No thanks!"

"My wife and I chose a Medigap Plan N plan four years ago. Literally 2 months after beginning my Medicare journey I had a really bad accident that required the trauma unit, two surgeries and a blood clot issue. My total bill for all that and two weeks in hospital was \$86 after meeting the Part B deductible. I could have argued \$50 off that amount because they charged me that amount for the ambulance even though I was admitted. It wasn't worth going through the hassle. My wife is a cancer survivor so our broker strongly advised her to stay away from an Advantage plan. If you do go that route and then have medical issues and expenses get out of hand then you will have to go through medical underwriting and probably will not be able to switch to Medigap. Keep that in mind."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hwvh4AaABAg.ATSYgYfhd1hATYml_KtCEw

"My wife was diagnosed with Parkinson's at 61 and went on Medicare Disability and we started paying for part G - now ten years later we have never made a claim or received assistance with any of her meds. We noticed the cost jumped from \$60 per month to \$250 per month - what do we do now? Keep part G? No one can tell us why we are paying the premiums and what it could have been helping us with? Drug Copays are about \$80 per month as well! Very confusing"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwgXbzqmZRcY_3kYNV4AaABAg.ANkFJcLXDfBAOi13Ji-1s

"Here's my Medicare Advantage experience. My wife recently had emergency surgery and spent 8 days in ICU and 20 days in arehab facility. The final bill was \$112,460.00 . Our final out of pocket was \$2,070. There were no pre-approvals for anything. However, I do know that with managed care, a person can experience hurdles."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxujyZgMCzAVue8V2Z4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (2): "That's a great outcome, and I'm glad your wife's care was covered the way it should be. I've seen those same positive results with Medicare Advantage as well. The real concern, though, is longevity — while it can work very well in the short term, managed care may bring hurdles down the road with prior authorizations or network restrictions, especially as health needs increase over time."

↳ @RG-hf4et (1): "The hurdles are going to increase in 2026. Advantage plans will be getting new bonuses for how many claims they will DENY. Buyer beware."

↳ @dmjh932 (0): "@RG-hf4et I've had an advantage plan for 12 years. I literally many thousands of dollars in premiums. I've actually made money. But like all insurance it's based on your risk tolerance. Period. My wife has had two surgeries in two months at two different hospitals with extensive ICU stay and even had extensive rehab. We had zero issues and out of pocket with ambulance came to \$2,500. 2026 will be the same however I have noticed most plans are increasing co-pays and max out of pocket along with no dental."

"They are sending my husband medicare information he passed away almost 4 years ago."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypOamgls&lc=UgwTSZXXzRpntf3gl2V4AaABAg>

↳ @BoomerBenefits (2): "Oh no! We are so sorry to hear that."

↳ @MaryAnn-ob4qb (0): "Twenty calls a day, I can't change until October 2025"

"We have Plan N. Even after my wife had open-heart surgery and a stroke, it costs us less per year than Plan G."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan N vs Plan G - What Are The Hidden Costs? · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RcX-i3uZLj0&lc=UgwlyN7YoACd2RVGyDp4AaABAg>

↳ @avondalemama470 (0): "I'm leaning toward plan N myself. Can they drop your wife or deny coverage? 😊"

↳ @RonMac08 (0): "@avondalemama470 They can only drop you if you don't keep up with the plan payments. We have never been denied any coverage. My wife has had MRIs, CT scans, and echocardiograms; no problems."

"Sorry to hear about mom , I was just curious which one did you recommend for mom before she got sick . My wife was diagnosed with stage 3 lung cancer about a year before getting Medicare so she was on a good employer insurance. So when she went on Medicare went with plan G even though she was in remission. We both felt it was best for her because of the chance of reoccurrence the main reason was the freedom to pick her doctors . We felt comfortable with cost being higher . I can see the benefits of both plans . For us it was really a comfort thing for us."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwMGZlnO6f91E_ekBh4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "I'm sorry to hear about your wife. My mom has a supplement Plan G. The chance of reoccurring cancer influenced that decision. Another big factor was that as part of her retirement from the company she worked at for most of her adult life , they would provide an annual healthcare stipend to cover all her healthcare premiums. That made the decision pretty easy for her."

"I totally agree, G is definitely the Cadillac plan. I have it & it was a no-brainer as it saved us \$60/mo after the Medicare deductible. We're in AZ & my husband has had a F plan for years, he had a heart transplant 21 years ago so I know we will never be able to change him. It's pretty spendy but we have a good friend who has an Advantage plan & has had multiple health issues over the past two years. He has to jump thru hoops to see anyone other than their PCP & has had tremendous out of pocket due to home health visits, physical therapy visits, etc. To me it's well worth the premiums to have the freedom to go when & where we want and not have any out of pocket. Some of the very best facilities in AZ do not accept Advantage plans. Unless you absolutely cannot afford it, I would NEVER recommend anyone going on a Medicare Advantage plan. Peace of mind is well worth the money."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxCIeGhmta-6BbUjzF4AaABAg>

A younger spouse without coverage until 65 · 57 documents · 20 voices

"Thanks for this! I'm 62 and my husband is 64. I think you have saved us from possibly making the wrong choice at 65. I will share this with my friends."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 496 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCC&lc=UgzKYiHkePnOIVI9aDN4AaABAq>

↳ @zachwalton5693 (24): "Hi, as a former insurance agent make sure you still enroll in Medicare part B then get your medigap plan/Medicare supplement. THEN make sure you get a prescription drug plan. Because if you dont theres a lifetime permanent 10% fee for each year you didnt enroll this same fee applies to your Part B as well. Now this doesn't cover dental or vision so youll need you pick a plan for that. They are pretty cheap."

↳ @rapacious_rapscallion (14): "Tell them to stop getting their information from Fox "News" while you're at it."

↳ @nalou6933 (10): "Right now, regular Medicare is very expensive, but still the best plan. This administration favors big business who gives it big campaign contributions, so it will force all new Medicare enrollees to the (dis)Advantage plans, and fatally damage regular Medicare plans."

"I retired at 62 and my wife and I went on a bronze Obamacare plan. We didn't pay one penny for premiums for the three years we were on Obamacare. An advantage of the HSA plans is you can reduce the income that applies towards the subsidy calculation. You can also contribute to a traditional IRA to lower your income. I also stuffed my HSA before I retired so that I could cover an emergency."

— YouTube · The Pros and Cons of Obamacare · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VR66gt_AqA&lc=Ugwo-Gz37UHV1h4cT0l4AaABAq

"I retired at 65 but my wife is also retired and not 65 yet. So we had to get an ACA plan for her. I followed this advice early. But I followed it too well during my first year and my income was so low that the exchange bumped her down to a Medicaid plan. Which sounds great because it had \$0 premiums. But the problem with Medicaid where I live is no doctors take it. Not great insurance for someone in their 60s. Ever since then, I have been careful in taking enough taxable income so that my income threshold is high enough to not qualify for Medicaid and low enough to optimize on ACA credits."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · 43 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=Ugz7JAf8GPGbn0Ae8ld4AaABAq>

↳ @mikeb8342 (4): "@mnnew6772 I think it's not about whether providers are available, but rather will a doctor accept a lower amount for a service (usually the case with medicaid)? Maybe Colorado medicaid has higher payouts for services? If so, you might be correct. 🙄"

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "Yes that is something to think about. Good thing you caught it and readjust."

↳ @polaridoo1 (1): "No, it is very hard to find Medicaid providers in Colorado. There's usually a very long wait to get in and not many providers accept it."

"I retired at 62 and my wife and I went on Obamacare bronze plan. We didn't pay any premiums for three years. We did have a high deductible but I had almost \$40,000 in an HSA to cover the deductible. We got lucky and still had over \$30,000 in the HSA when I hit 65."

— YouTube · 6 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirees · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AGXWM9-zot4&lc=Ugz-rN7NCuc41Pz0dYx4AaABAg>

↳ @jimhandler1129 (2): "How did you not have to pay any premiums for three years? I am 61 years old with over \$70,000 in an HSA still not retired because of health insurance. All sights are asking for specific information including email and phone number. I just want to find out how much it will cost me without being harassed by a salesman."

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Wow that's amazing! Good planning! 🤔 "

↳ @jimfarmer7811 (0): "@jimhandler1129 Make sure you are going to the official website. It's easy to land on a scammer site. The. Dot gov web site won't pester you with salesperson calling. I kept our premiums at zero by choosing the high deductible bronze HSA plan and keep our annual income below the \$62,000 subsidy limit at the time. We had no debt so it wasn't a problem to live well on that income."

"I retired at 62 and my wife and I went on a obamacare bronze plan. We paid zero premiums for 3 years until we hit Medicare. Even though we are millionaires we configured our income to keep below the subsidy limit. I estimated we are \$90,000 richer because of obamacare. If you want to be rich you need to know how to work the system."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgxQKPUDWXHubWArJkZ4AaABAg

↳ @ebelen1 (2): "I'm sure you paid your fair share prior and you're following the rules. Kudos!"

↳ @Darrell_McMillan (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm planning on playing it in a similar way."

↳ @jimfarmer7811 (0): "@Darrell_McMillanDon't forget to load up your HSA. You can pay your deductible out of your HSA and it won't count towards your AGI."

"Dark Blue- Great info for someone who is turning 64 in a couple weeks and on an ACA Policy. I will be definitely signing up for medicare at 65 and keep my younger non-working wife on the ACA Policy for a couple more years."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgyCXsaO8TNSUFgFBa14AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Sounds like a good plan! 🟡 "

"Thank you for this video. For others watching, this is a very important video. I worked past 65, had large employer coverage until I retired at 67. My wife (she is 59) and I had planned on paying for our premiums to my employer ad infinitum through what we thought was an "emeritus" type program and then found out that if one is not employed, one is mandated to sign up for Part B. Therefore, when I had to come off of my employer's plan, she could no longer be covered. It was a very concerning situation that she was not covered (except now on Cobra). That only gets 18 months of coverage. Finding her individual coverage is a big challenge to make sure it is the proper and creditable insurance until she is 65. This is a huge gap in our insurance coverage system. The ACA is a terrible system that was perpetrated on the American people. People be aware of age discrepancies with your spouse. This was probably all my fault, but just to let people know, be informed and don't get caught with your pants down."

— YouTube · 7 MEDICARE ERRORS to Avoid When You Work Past Age 65 · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2RD7fyvVse8&lc=UgyqKYZL8rvQm1CM7B54AaABAg>

↳ @bettybee1852 (1): "I'm not trying to debate, but I don't see how the ACA is the problem. It's simply a marketplace that, for one thing, doesn't allow insurance companies to deny people for pre-existing conditions. You were going to face this problem whether or not the ACA existed; you were still going to have to find health insurance for your wife if she she couldn't get it through her own employer. Please elaborate if I am not understanding the issue."

↳ @dfsulliv (1): "Its not just spouses its individuals.... at the moment, ill be a few months before 65 when Cigna pulls out of CO & there would be no options to keep my doctor' prior to participating in medicare. The collapse of the marketplace (Obamacare referred to antiseptically) has most insurance companies terminating all their coverage everywhere and those that continue are insufficient to be accepted by competent medical service providers. In my case my marketplace plan is necessary as Im running my own business. Remmeber that Obamacare wasnt just meant to fail (as the GOP like to say), it was meant to punish anyone who would dare not accept complete govt HC domination. OMG, I hate this government."

↳ @dfsulliv (1): "@bettybee1852nah, you have no interest in accepting the collapse of the US HC system because you have been partially responsible for that collapse..."

"I'm currently 66 and my wife is 11 years younger than I am. We had a bunch of kids so we had no tax liability for many years. I invested solely in a Roth IRA for many years. I retired at age 61 and rolled my company retirement into a traditional IRA. I made a few Roth conversions in the first couple of years of retirement. Then my wife's company moved overseas so she retired too. Now, I'm on Medicare but my wife has about ten years before she is eligible so she is on the ACA. We take money from my traditional IRA and supplement it with money from my Roth IRA. She gets a tax credit each year that reduces her premiums to around \$50 a month. I am waiting until 70 for my Social Security. I have already looked at RMDs but we don't have millions so it's not that big of a deal. Once I'm on Social Security, I may do some Roth conversions at that time. I would like to get all of my pretax accounts by the tax man before I pass away so my wife is not caught in the widows tax trap."

— YouTube · The Surprising Truth About ACA Subsidies and Your Retirement! · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3WkluuzgD14&lc=Ugz79XRd2gGJQgd0JF14AaABAg>

↳ @davidmarshall1094 (0): "I'm five years behind you, but with a very similar situation. I've gotten advice not to do Roth conversions (from two different advisors) and also not to touch Roth until much later in retirement. I'm going to have deeper discussions on this, but I could draw down my entire Roth account during this subsidy period if necessary. The cost of ACA without a subsidy is comically high (it actually angers me how this system works)."

"Fantastic video. I retired at 60 in 2021 and we have threaded the income needle on ACA for those years. I am on Medicare now, but wife is still on ACA through this year. Became much more consequential this year to stay under the ACA cliff but I am pretty practiced at managing income now that I am retired. Lots of very tricky rules that you must be aware of to retire successfully and you do a great job explaining this one."

— YouTube · The IRS Mistake That Kills ACA Subsidies · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R_UhpUHc0Tc&lc=UgwhYHLdKOoVckX0fZ54AaABAg

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "Thank you. It's really nice to hear from people who have been through it."

"As much as I appreciate your take on this. I have been fighting this problem for years. None of these options are any good at all. The health care in the USA is completely broken. The use less government is also a joke. And completely broken. I am turning 67 and have Been working for 50 years. My wife is 61. And working. Her job does not provide decent insurance. Bottom line. All these comments have said the same thing. We need early Medicare for spouses. Period. We have earned that right. Tell the use less government to do there job. Or give us back our tax dollars. (Refund our money). Also learn about the family glitch. That will shock you. It happen to me."

— YouTube · How To Get Health Insurance If You Retire Before 65 · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I8VY8AcaLww&lc=UgxEiHIO4CIPgx1mPa14AaABAg>

↳ @DesigningRetirement (1): "Healthcare is the biggest issue for most people. There need to be better options."

"Good information. I currently have Medicare because I am also a military retiree. I noted in my medicare booklet around page 8-9 if you are a military retiree you have to sign up for Medicare then you automatically revert to Tri-care for Life. My kicker is I also still work and my employer has less than 20 employee's so Medicare is primary over my UHC provided by my work(and used for my wife who is not 65). Tri-care is only used for prescriptions. With insurance so complex it seems no one wants to solve that issue. I guess regardless of political party they have something to blame the other party for! Why would they want to simplify insurance?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=Ugw_O9yn3vxOSKxnYtp4AaABAg

↳ @ashrafikapasi (0): "political parties want to bury head in hge sand and avoid looking into providing all citizens with medical care .. they wont look into efficiency , that Use of AI technology can provide... because lots money is involved, snd they want to please the corporations, the insurance industry, etc. Also they collect public money and make it a complex puzzle to access medical care when propld will probably need it the most.. esp after retirement. This speaks to the greed of our government and our representatives, who dont care to serve the people who voted them in."

"I am 75 and my wife is 62. She is still working and I am under her employer, sponsored medical plan, but still covered under Medicare part a for certain procedures, such as my two knee replacements. I wonder if when my wife retires and I no longer have her medical insurance, would I be eligible for a Medicare supplement program without the medical underwriting?"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugx0GvgQigFlehFDTJ94AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "Yes you would likely be eligible for certain Medigap Plans “guaranteed issue” Without medical underwriting when you leave the employer plan."

"When I retired at 62 my wife and I went on obamacare bronze plan. We paid 0 premiums until we hit Medicare. Meanwhile my sister and her husband were pure MAGA and paid for a private plan. I estimate that they paid around \$75,000 for the 3 years of private insurance. Just another example of MAGA being not so smart."

— YouTube · Senate Pushes New ACA Changes 2026 — What Every Marketplace Shopper Must Know · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1RaI9g9McM4&lc=UgxuFQA_I9d1_wbzAqh4AaABAg

↳ @iHealthBrokers (1): "Many people do not understand that your eligibility for PTC is determined solely by your income (not your assets). So often times, early retirees with limited income (but assets to draw upon) are able to access plans with very low monthly premiums! Thank you for your comment!"

↳ @gazelleflix (0): "@jimfarmer7811, I am planning on doing this at 62. Do you still have it or are you on Medicare now? I'm assuming you and your wife are both healthy enough to not worry about the possible high out of pocket cost with the Bronze plan (not sure how true it is). I still need to do some research. Definitely overwhelming 😞 "

↳ @jimfarmer7811 (0): "@gazelleflix My wife and I are on Medicare. We knew the high deductible was a risk so I packed my HSA before I retired to cover the deductible. We got lucky and actually had more money in the HSA, due to investments, after we hit Medicare than before we started obamacare."

"I'm 65 .. my wife retired and is 60 .. our pensions are good she was a teacher mine is private but decent .. we have plenty other " stuff" we'd qualify for nothing .. I pay her 990 a month .I we budgeted for it."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=Ugy9bM75_-R74GPclPR4AaABAq.AZ4_8NofgyWAZB0kpMr_rM

"If one spouse provides medical insurance for the family and retires at age 66, can the other unemployed spouse apply for COBRA?"

— YouTube · Health Insurance For Early Retirement - Here Are 4 Options · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pjR3wlGOZsc&lc=UgzMlqdX76lhu-SKrLF4AaABAq>

↳ @HowToRetire (2): "Yes! The unemployed spouse in this case would be able to continue with their health insurance through COBRA. Great question! 🙌"

"Yet another reason why I won't retire until I'm 62 and my stay-at-home wife is 61. I'll have enough vacation time accrued for 5 years of half-paychecks, and of those 5 years, I can get 4 years of healthcare insurance at employee rates. Those 4 years will cover me until I'm 66, but more importantly, it'll cover my wife until she's 65 and eligible for Medicare, at which time we'll both get on Medicare without ever having to buy healthcare insurance on the exchange. That's a HUGE savings for retiring at 62 instead of 59.5. EDIT: I commented before finishing the video. Sure enough, you covered my situation (Option 2). I should've known better, since you're very thorough in your videos. 😊"

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyfmGAzNpFYrvy8ZBl4AaABAq

↳ @truepatriot-nh8zs (1): "Wow, you planned that well! Sounds like a great employer"

↳ @Po1itica11yNcorrect (1): "@truepatriot-nh8zsYes, a good career. But the accrued time was due to being severely understaffed throughout my career, thus not being able to burn much vacation time. They'd rather pay it out at the end."

"Hi I watch your youtube vedio regularly. Appreciate what you are doing for seniors. I have a quick question. I am 68.5 years old and still full time employee with my wife in my companies health plan. Company has more then 300 employees. Monthly premium for both of us including drugs, vision and dental is \$162 per week. Its a comprehensive plan. My wife is 10 years younger then me. Can i join free advantage plan while keeping the companies . How often can i change the plan from advantage to medigap or vice versa. Thanks"

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgyZeJivTOUHqna1M7F4AaABAq>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "In this situation it makes sense for you to delay Medicare altogether while you remain on this coverage. When you are ready to drop this employer plan then you can enroll in Medicare and then choose to get an Advantage Plan or a Medigap Plan!"

"Ugh. Man I feel stuck in the middle. I am 66 and am on Medicare and SS will be starting in August, and retiring end of July. But my spouse is only 61 and will need health insurance starting in November. So I need to keep my income as low as possible outside of what I will be receiving from the SSA. This year is out as I already have income through July so I am already over the 400% of FPL. Would also like to start doing Roth conversions but I guess that's not going to happen until my spouse is on Medicare."

— YouTube · Will ACA Subsidies Disappear After 2025? What You NEED to Know! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzXsJQmS9xs&lc=UgwbpG5DUXse0GWHlit4AaABAg>

↳ @EarlyRetirementRoadmap (0): "Thanks for sharing your situation and I feel your pain —it's a common dilemma for couples where one spouse reaches Medicare age before the other. The good news is that for 2025, the enhanced ACA subsidies remain in effect, so even if your household income is over 400% of the Federal Poverty Level for this year, your spouse may still qualify for premium assistance for coverage starting in November and for December of 2025 - so for the last 2 months of 2025. The 400% FPL "cliff" returns in 2026 unless Congress acts (unfortunately current signs don't look good for that happening), but for the rest of 2025, subsidy eligibility is based on your income and the cost of coverage, not a hard cutoff. It's smart to plan ahead with income and consider Roth conversions once both of you are on Medicare. You're doing everything right by thinking about these factors now. All my best to you!"

"Nothing I can do about my IRMMA. Small business owner. I'm 66 wife is 62. She will work forever. I've toned it down to about 10 hours a week. I've been paying IRMMA for a little over a year. Just got an updated one so I decided I'll let them pay it out of my Social Security Sec...I'm starting Social Security Sec in February...Just another bill to go along with property taxes, sales taxes etc etc."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: Why Your Medicare Premium Can Suddenly Explode · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R1MRB2YjYDY&lc=UgxCctDKCBTKBUjazzR4AaABAg>

"Hi Joe. My wife is 64. Her 2-year lookback period for Medicare started in 2024. Boldin is not calculating IRMAA correctly. Boldin is only calculating MAGI based on 2025 instead of the two-year lookback period that started in 2024. My wife will have to start paying IRMAA surcharges in September 2026. Boldin is showing that the surcharges will start in 2027."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: Why Your Medicare Premium Can Suddenly Explode · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R1MRB2YjYDY&lc=UgyIXQ-A2XSvySvd14R4AaABAg>

↳ @davidanddeb717 (0): "According to Boldin support - The software uses the AGI from two years prior. However, if an individual is already 65+, we use current year AGI to calculation the subsequent 2 years. IRMAA brackets and charges increase at your general inflation rate."

Helping a parent or relative choose or fix a plan · 27 documents · 20 voices

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"I'm in the process of helping my father choose his coverage and he has always had a supplemental plan. We're a bit shellshocked at the increase in premiums and the premium free advantage plans are very tempting. But Dad has several health issues and sees a lot of doctors (afib, high blood pressure, sleep apnea, wet AMD). He has several ER visits in the past few years (and one overnight hospitalization when his blood pressure spiked). He's 81 years old and I know that the odds are that he's going to have more health issues as we move forward and that he's probably better served with staying on a supplemental plan, even if it costs us more up front. So we will tighten our belts and swallow the costs now because there is something reassuring that if he does have to go to the hospital that I won't be facing a big bill afterwards. Our cats want Dad to stick around a long time."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 51 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyPVVWFFD9F_LY9wPh4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (11): "Yeah... I don't know him or the family personally, nor the financial picture, but based on that health profile, a supplement plan definitely will keep healthcare costs at bay and flexibility when it comes to providers and treatment options. Appreciate you watching and sharing. Supplement premium increases are a big deal"

↳ @emilyc.2131 (0): "I just lost my father who had a suppliment plan, which was Blue cross blue shield plan F, they don't even sell anymore becuase it covers so well. He had affib then became ill w sepsis landed in the hospital , then had to be trached because he needed more respiratory support as he recovered ove the illness. He recovered with flying colors, and shocked everyone at age 82... however it was the poor care in the rehab facilities (long term acute rehab facilities) they force you to that we believe killed him, when he should have recoved and came home just fine. He was able to survive for about a year until medicare bacially closed the book at us and denied him further treatment. What I can attest to you is it appears if he had had medicare advantage , he would have been given only 25 days in a rehab hospital they force elderly to, after they just recover from a medical illness. Whereas he was allowed up to a year with his suppliemnt plan. What we heard from doctors and other patients families is they would have forced him to go home or skilled nursing which is even worse care than the rehab. Skilled nursing , only has one visit from a nurse once per day and basically just keeps your loved one comfortable until they succumb to their illnesses... They don't work with them to get them better.... Where my father was given all green lights to have the health and the strength to get off the vent , but if was the poor care in the rehab facility , that allowed him to slip back get an infection, either from the trache, or his feeding tube, and then utlimately got a bed sore because he was left to lay in his own bowel movement, (which is 100% diarrhea all the time with a feeding tube, 24/7) ..He would get off the vent , then get pneumonia, from their lack of care then back on the vent again... we were told that over 60% of these hospitals patients are medicare patients, where they're usually under staffed, with staff that doesn't have or barely has the credentials to be caring for these more critical, patients. Who thrive just fine in ICU,, like my dad did but they force out to "make room" for younger patients. Because my dad had the suppliment plan, he was allowed to come back to ICU and get treatment. The back out again to the rehab facilities. where he would get and infection and back again. I have a nurse client who confirmed that the rehab facilities is like third world country care. So whatever you do, have him avoid getting in there...However, if you do he seemed better off with the suppliment... We learned also with my dad's affib, he wouldn't have been able to choose his caridologist either, and if someone gets cancer , advantage won't pay either... It just seems that overall the hospitals arent doing much to procatively to assist an elderly to get better and trying to waste no time coding your loved one as "not improving" when they are ... they just don't have the staff to take care of them. We found out my father was given more chances because of his supplement but if he has advantage they would have gotten rid of him long before. Where, it appears advantage just turns the light off much quicker...Sorry for writing a novel, but I hope this helps people understand how medicare and the hospitals look at everything...When you think the hospital or medicare

sees you as a human being they don't... they only see you as a cost ...and trying to figure out how they can avoid "waste" and paying too much when , it's just time they believe to let your loved one go...Also, last thing...if your father gets into a hospital.. you need to be there or other family around the clock 24/7 staying after the doctors, because it's those we hear also get to get the better care than those who don't come around or are too busy, or ones who don't have any family at all. It's very sad.. but I hope this helps."

↳ @RosemaryLackey (0): "@Theretirementnerds yeah, I'm making those decisions now, and its looking like those premium increases may well be a deal breaker for me. I see that the supplement path provides amazing coverage, but along with the increases, it looks like Id have to get dental and vision insurance also - and also for meds? Too much for me. I guess I just made up my mind. Thanks so much for your excellent presentation. I look forward to learning about social security from you too!"

"New to Medicare This Year - More Confusing Than I Thought! I had helped my mother and my mother-in-law with their Medicare in the past. I also had worked in Human Resources early in my career and learned a lot about insurance. So I thought that signing up for Medicare would be easy for me. But, not having looked at this stuff in at least 10 years, I found it a lot more confusing than I had expected! I'm turning 65 in a few months. I'm in SF Bay area of California. I already know that I want traditional Medicare and not Medicare Advantage. I started taking Social Security at the beginning of this year (2025) so I automatically got a Medicare number and automatically got enrolled into Parts A & B. Now I need to pick a Plan D for drugs and a Medigap plan, which I already know will be a Plan G. In that regard, perhaps I'm ahead of the game. But picking a Plan D and a Plan G is turning out to be much harder than I'd thought it would be. I was glad to have watched a few YouTube videos about the process for signing up for each of these things -- that helped a lot, as well as reading the Medicare website and some info from AARP, etc. I found out that some of the Part D plans I was considering have limits on how many pills can be filled in 30 days for some meds. An SSRI that I take requires 90 10mg pills each month, because I take 25 mg per day and there is no 25 mg pill (nor is there a 50 mg that can be cut in half). So the plans that limit me to 30 10mg pills per month are a non-starter. (Sure, I could probably have my doctor try to appeal and get the 90 pills per month covered, but there is no guarantee that the insurance company would agree....and then I'd be stuck! Not worth the hassle!) This information was kinda buried at the bottom of each Part D plan on the Medicare website. It would have been a "bad surprise" to learn this after the fact! Regarding Part G -- this really surprised me -- the only Part G plan for my area that shows the premium and extra perks upfront is the AARP United Healthcare plan. ALL of the others don't even have a special page (or set of pages) about their Medigap plans! How are you supposed to compare the plans if you can't even see what you're paying for? I understand that all of the plans cover the exact same things; that's not what I want to know. I want to see rate tables (because most of them are Attained Age plans. The AARP one is Community based rates, and one other that I'm considering, Transamerica, is age at issue based rate). I also want to see if there are any perks beyond the regular plan coverage (like gym membership or whatever). I don't want to have to go through an agent or get a broker involved. I've had bad experiences with them in the past. I want to do this myself and sign up directly with the insurance companies. I truly don't understand why NONE of the Medigap providers in my area have ANY information on their websites about Medicare or their Medicare plans. When you click on the "company website" link on the Medicare website, it takes you to a general home page about the insurance company. I have tried searching these websites for "Medicare" or "Medigap" or "Plan G" but the searches come up blank. Why even offer a Medigap plan if you're not going to show your benefits to your clients online???? I don't want to have to waste my time calling 3 or 4 insurance companies! Only AARP seems to be upfront with any of this stuff. It's so weird, and I truly don't understand it! Am I missing something or misunderstanding something? Are the insurance companies deliberately making it hard for people to understand exactly what they're buying??"

— r/medicare · 33 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ls9lyr/>

↳ (0): "I agree you can't find true info without contacting companies individually. I found that there are some options that might make it difficult. Smoking makes a difference, paying yearly can make a difference. Someone else in the household with the same company can make a difference. Wearables can make a difference. Like you I spent hours on YouTube (glad I did), called a few companies directly then got retirement nerds involved after I had narrowed things down. They actually placed the policy for me after helping to answer a few questions. Figuring all of this out was like a job. It worked out well for me. Good luck."

↳ (0): "Don't go with UHP. Profiteers from the pain and suffering of humans. Major lawsuits and denials. It amazes me this country still has not gone to universal healthcare. I'm on the original Medicare ABG&D. G is with Anthem BC. No perks. Simple and easy with my Drs. No issues so far in 13 months. They are profiteers as well,

but I think they are less evil than the rest. D plans are stupid. They all have their "formulary" lists and none are the same \$\$ for identical drugs. Tier 1/2/3/4 garbage. But it's better than nothing. I have Wellcare. Not great but cheap. I've heard from friends in the SF bay area that Kaiser advantage is excellent. Of course you have to use them. But they are well established there. I'm in an area where there are hardly any Kaiser facilities. The agents that "help" are paid to drive you to their plans. They make \$\$ on your payments. Agents should be eliminated. It's a parasite business."

↳ (0): "Untrue about agents that drive you to their plans. Most agents are pretty good folks doing a good job. Signed, a parasite. D plans aren't stupid. If you don't get one, you get a penalty. But go ahead and not get one... see how that works out. UHC is fine - no different than any other carrier that you are bashing. Thanks for your nice, helpful post, btw!"

"By the comments ,too many need education on Medicare. Instead of moaning, groaning,blaming, stressing, verbally attacking,call Social Security Administration directly. They answer very quickly. They have so many programs, available to Medicare recipients,no one on UTube will ever tell you about; I have a phone call appointment by a SS Medicare government official for questions,latest Medicare updates, which no one knows until released.coverage, Insurance company updates. Also, each state has programs to help Medicare recipients. In Florida it is SHINE, an agent can give you the info. SS will also help my brother apply for disability, processed 24 hours They are here to help us!!!!!"

— YouTube · 3 Medicare Changes for 2027 - and how to prepare. #medicare · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GxBa9kBx5cY&lc=UgxJpzOwTnTBpnTKkpx4AaABAg.AafQqodIE4vAaul96H2DZy>

"When my father passed. I had to help my mother make these choices because his company provided coverage ended. We went with separate part B and part D plans. Even though they are expensive. The freedom is huge. Also, when used, they pay for themselves."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzQ1x1r5qQ6nnrpxN14AaABAg>

↳ @kellynch (0): "The same thing happened to my mother - she was dropped from dad's employer retiree plan the instant he died. I called the guy who worked with my employer on insurance issues and he took care of her. It's not as good as dad's union plan, but it's better than an Advantage plan. She had 2 minor surgeries in 2024 and her only out of pocket was the deductible. Yes, she did have to pay the premiums, but that would have been cheaper than 2 hospital stays in less than 6 months on an Advantage plan. Plus, not all of her doctors take Advantage plans."

↳ @ahemphill44 (0): "@kellynch My wife's cousin had two hospital stays with surgeries within 6 months and she has an Advantage plan. She paid a total of \$140 (two \$70 copays)."

↳ @kellynch (0): "@ahemphill44 A friend of mine on Advantage had gotten all the approvals for a knee replacement. The surgery had to be rescheduled, and he needed a full set of new approvals before he could go ahead. Oh, and there's a chance he's going to lose his plan for next year because he's a Humana customer. The idea of having to research new plans every single year is just insane."

"I'm trying to assist my mother who is 89yrs old and there is NO WAY she'd understand this. Her Medicare Advantage is being cancelled and I'm just not sure what's the best route for her. We simply want the best possible medical care for an old lady who has so-so health and living on a fixed income. I feel so sorry for seniors who don't have someone around to assist them with this type of stuff."

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHS&lc=UgwYnnVejZOv1bX_zX54AaABAq

"I like the polar bear. I turn 65 next year. Trying to help my brother sign up who just turned 65 this month. He has leukemia, schiz medication and treatment for an abdominal tumor. He's also on Medi-Cal. (Believe you said Supplement Plan would not be offered to him.) Thank you. I'm still confused but learning quick. ❤️"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugz-7kRTwUHUN6mNtth4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! 🐻 Sorry to hear about your brother's health challenges 😞 "

"I just got over the phone with Social Security Administration for Medicare, as I need to go on it. Please call them directly. They do answer your call quickly. They have so many beneficial forms to help you, I was shocked. Also, each state has programs to financially help with Medicare. I am actually eligible for 6 coverage programs to and a phone appointment with Medicare Administration for the knowledge, questions, latest information on Medicare Insurance companies. They will also help my brother process his disability SS benefits. Get processed 24 hours!"

— YouTube · 3 Medicare Changes for 2027 - and how to prepare. #medicare · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GxBa9kBx5cY&lc=UgyH6ynzZIKqIC4gtQZ4AaABAq>

"What, Why, How can I help my brother, 68, not signed up yet in Texas, navigate his Medicare problem?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugyq1G78Znri_YvaLRB4AaABAq

"Great video. We are in our low 70s. We have medigap part G. The only reason I got this was I experienced what it was like to have watched my elderly parents run up hospital bills so high in the last two to three years of their lives. As a child, I never had to pay anything for their medical care (they had part f). I swore to myself that I would do this same thing. To me part g is insurance for my older age when I need real help with medical bills. If they would let you be on medical advantage and then years later go on a medigap without underwriting, I would do that. But they don't. So I pay the premium. But I also have long term health insurance too. My parents had that too and I used it. I like to manage my risk. It is as simple as that. I give up now for something in my future. And I also think about my son when he may have to manage my care. He will thank me!! I know I remember what my father did for me when I had to manage his care at the end of my parent's life. I only share this if others want to see another reason to buy the medigap policy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 239 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugy8TLuEHdMLe7BDEIN4AaABAq>

"My sister just sent me your link and I'm so glad she did. I handled all of my mother's medical affairs, though I know nothing about the world of Medicare. I know that she would get very frustrated with Medicare Advantage and being required to keep going to her PCP over and over, which meant paying him over and over. You are correct - ultimately, it ended up costing her more to be on Medicare Advantage. Now that my sister and I are about to be at the age where we need to make informed decisions, your video has helped us tremendously. Thank you for taking the time to do this."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 24 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwGibBuFspGB9GuB7J4AaABAg>

↳ @anitaking2574 (0): "Usually you don't pay anything to go to your PCP in a Medicare Advantage Plan."

"[Ask Insurance] What's the best way to find and evaluate insurance agents? (Medicare, Home, etc.) How do you find and evaluate an insurance agent and ensure they will provide good service and provide thoughtful recommendations? Are there any particular questions or resources you find helpful in separating great agents from the pack? Are reference calls useful? Do you lean towards working with independent agents or are captive agents ok? Is Profit vs. non-profit a factor when evaluating insurance providers? Sorry if this is overly broad, I'm looking for any and all good tips and lessons you've picked up. I'm in the process of helping my parents get Medicare coverage and while I've done all my homework to probably set them up with their initial coverages, but I'd rather work with a good agent long-term to make sure someone stays on top of pricing, plan changes (i.e. medigap or advantage makes more sense), part d formulary coverage, etc. Since I'm looking for a medicare agent, I figure it might be good to review all their insurance coverage and agents."

— r/Insurance · 3 upvotes · family member helping · https://www.reddit.com/r/Insurance/comments/461799/ask_insurance_whats_the_best_way_to_find_and/

↳ [deleted] (2): "I'll answer specifically to the Medicare part of your question. Medicare options are very confusing for a layman and you're definitely best advised to find an agent and work with them so they can explain all of the options, deductibles, cost sharing, enrollment requirements, etc.. Plus they'll provide ongoing customer service to help you when questions/problems arise, which they often do with Medicare plans. Your best bet is to find two or three agents and meet with each, have them pitch you their best products for your parents situation and then after you've met with all of them then make your choice as to which one you'd like to work with and who offers the best plans for your situation. Do you know how to find an agent? Finding Medicare agents can be a challenge as its not as easy as just a Google search because so many of them are just working from home and have little, if no, web presence. This is because many are older agents who have been doing this for years and rely on referrals. Since they're older they typically are not as good as using the Internet as the younger generations, and they haven't adapted. I'd be happy to find a few for you to work with if you need help with that. I used to work in that market and have hundreds of contacts. I'm not soliciting, as I do not sell Medicare products. I'm just offering to help you find a few agents in your area. If interested PM me with your state and contact info and I'll reach out to my contacts and see if I can help you locate an agent or two."

↳ [deleted] (2): "If you are employed or your parents are employed and have insurance through their company, ask HR who the broker is and contact them and ask if they provide assistance with Medicare or if they know anyone who does. Best way to find an agent is by referral honestly."

↳ WinstonWolfpack (1): "Thanks for the feedback. I've just gotten a few personal referrals that I need to check out but may take you up on the PM offer if they don't work out."

"I retired from what I read and heard, as well as what I saw. I chose Plan N cost 75 mth, drug plan 13.50 mth, the following year plan N had no significant increase but drug plan Increased to \$38.00/mth, this year I changed to Advantage, I have no significant health issues and take no Drugs, The drug plan jumped to 98.00/ mth. I have been taking care of my parents insurance 89 & 91. They were on zero dollar premium advantage plan, dental/vision/hearing/ OTC. Yes I got a little frustrated with precert, however Dad out of network over \$50,000. Cochlear implant cost approx \$200, as had to go 2 hours for adjustments Advantage plan covers at same zero dollar copay out of network where we live. Takes 5 prescriptions. All zero cost."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · 3 likes · family member helping · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlG&lc=Ugy5VG59s8BP_K17m7t4AaABAg

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (0): "Thanks for sharing all of that—that's a great real-world example 🙌 You did exactly what people should do: adjust your coverage based on your situation each year. With no medications and good health, moving to an Advantage plan can make a lot of sense—especially when Part D premiums started jumping that much. And your parents' situation highlights the other side—even with prior authorizations, those plans can still provide strong coverage, especially with things like prescriptions and major procedures. At the end of the day, there's no one "best" plan—just what fits your health, budget, and location at the time. Sounds like you've done a great job navigating that. If you ever want a second set of eyes to review options year to year, feel free to call or text us at 877-360-6565."

"I helped my Mother set up her Medicare and set up her Medicare advantage plan for her.. We largely followed my Uncles recommendation for the Medicare advantage plan and the monthly premium was very affordable. However we didn't really look into Medigap other than my Mom saying she knew it was more expensive. I wish I had looked more into Medigap for her, not that Medicare advantage was bad but she had a Cancer diagnosis and in the later stages some of the authorizations took a little time and was a bit frustrating. Excellent video and descriptions Erin, I wish I had this resource at my fingertips when I was trying to help my Mom set hers up."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 3 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugzka5Z1V5c4CnggTVx4AaABAg>

"Thanks for answering my question, this was exactly my concern as well as I have been trying to sign up my Mom with Medicare this year"

— YouTube · How Do Medicare Brokers Get Paid? · 3 likes · family member helping · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DBwUb_QfaB0&lc=UgwjBo6tZEYZosmITlx4AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "You're welcome! Please reach out to us at any time, we would be happy to assist you directly (888) 465-9728"

"So, a little update...after emailing the COBRA person at the company, stating that their deadline wasn't 60 days from the notice arriving but way before that, we inexplicably got a response in which they "opened up enrollment" for my parents today. We have enrolled them and paid for the plan, July+August+September so far. Apparently, someone can just wave a wand somewhere and fix anything they want. This is a huge relief, though I'm concerned about an interplay between the coverage and my Mom's current non-enrollment in Medicare Part B. She can't enroll/get it until January, but I don't want the COBRA coverage to refuse to pay for things because she doesn't have it but is 65+."

— r/HealthInsurance · 1 upvotes · family member helping · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wo7bfk/insurance_coverage_possibilities_for_sick_parent/pbnl3wi/

"That's why it's important to know that when you first become eligible to Medicare, you can choose a supplement and not have to go through underwriting - from what I understand, though, that's your only chance - I kind of knew what I should do from having helped take care of my parents - they had Plan F & never, ever got a bill"

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugz3yC55BWBZz1bxVFh4AaABAg.9T-k43UiJC19T8l-Glcq-u>

"Great information, thank you. I'm helping my mom, who lives in NJ, how many supplement plans do you offer in NJ. Many or just 1 or 2? Some agents only offer a few and not all eligible carriers in the state. Please advise."

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans for 2027 — What's Changed? · 1 likes · family member helping · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hAZ_geBw1Ac&lc=UgyFKDR7IVz4bg6YfKB4AaABAg

"I agree to a point. I helped my in-laws select plans when their retiree health insurance was eliminated. My father-in-law has seen his Supplement G premiums increase to over \$800 / month. My mother-in-law, whose retiree health insurance wasn't cancelled until her early 90's and again eligible for Supplement G, has premiums in the mid \$200's / month. Similar age but significant price difference. It's extremely important to analyze and select carefully how premium increases are calculated. The single best thing of a Supplement G is no pre-approvals. Decisions are between you and Doctors. Now, my choice is my retiree health insurance which is an Advantage Plan and it is based entirely on cost. I pay \$63 /month for me and my wife plus we have a maximum \$1600 out of pocket. My biggest concern is pre-approvals but I have selected Doctors and different specialists that handle all appeals and have prevailed in any issues so far. If at some point my Retiree Health Insurance is eliminated I would select a Supplement G plan for sure."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medigap at 65: The Real Costs Most People Don't Understand (Clip) · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M9hEKbgJg2w&lc=UgwKL1zZjoUiNVstP6x4AaABAg.AXD5QT0DzqdAXEGnmkiRZ0>

"Great job. Thank you so much. A couple of years ago, I asked the insurance rep signing up my dad why Medicare Advantage was less expensive and he told me that the insurance companies pitched it to the government saying that they could run insurance so much more cost effectively than the government, that it saved the gov't money. On this last enrollment I noticed that everything available in my mom's area was an HMO requiring a PCP to give referrals for everything."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugzbk55CPaVjq2mdlI4AaABAg>

Widowed: one check, the same premiums · 22 documents · 20 voices

"I turn 65 this year and I'm pretty pissed. I'm a military widow who's been covered by Tricare forever. NOW I have to pay over \$200/month for insurance!!! WTF??? When did Congress decide that my lifetime coverage is now going to cost me \$3000 a year???? (insert swear words here!!)"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 265 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugxr50UOGSXgjzKZ-lh4AaABAg>

↳ @MarieKayla00 (8): "Retirement costs are honestly scarier than market volatility sometimes. A \$600 monthly mistake at 65 can snowball into a huge problem later."

↳ @MichaelBrown00f (8): "Facts. A lot of people spend decades building savings but underestimate healthcare and tax planning completely."

↳ @AustinCole99 (5): "Working with a wealth advisor changed how I prepare for retirement. He helped me organize my withdrawal strategy, reduce unnecessary expenses, and I've added around \$87k in long-term growth while feeling much more secure."

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"I'm a 70 year-old widower, just started taking SS, but have been taking Medicare since 67. I was recently offered a short-term software consulting job (a couple of years at the most). Since my retirement accounts are comfortable, I thought it would be nice to help my two granddaughters with their college expenses, so I took the job. My IRMAA surcharge more than triples my Part B payment, and also adds onto my Part D. I'm still going to continue working as long as the contract lasts to help them minimize post graduation debt, but, learning about IRMAA was a bit of a shock. I don't get any additional coverage for that surcharge; it's just an additional tax. It's like I am being penalized for saving all those years for my retirement and then getting extra penalties because I am still able to work. Oh well. Either way, I am still happy with my choices. Just have to have some grumbles to keep the grumpy old man image intact. 😊 Than you for the great videos, Erin!"

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · 48 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgwLy3jYkTiBDE5dLcR4AaABAg>

↳ @penelope5500 (20): "Yeah, well...that's kind of the way it works isn't it? People who save & do well always seem to get dinged to subsidize the slackers. What are you gonna do?"

↳ @cedarwaxwing3509 (8): "It's not an additional tax. It's simply a factor of progressive taxation: the more you make, the more you pay. Perhaps people who make enough to cross the IRMAA threshold should be grateful that they make more money than the vast majority of other Americans."

↳ @brucestiles6477 (3): "I hope you're able to keep those pesky kids off your lawn!"

"In a blazing panic! Okay, I'm in panic mode. On 9/15/2025 I turned 65, and I did what I was supposed to do. I signed up for Medicare, online. That was easy enough. At the end of the application, before I signed, there was a space to write any questions or concerns I have, especially for the Part B premiums. I explained I have been out of work since June 2025, and I'm currently receiving unemployment benefits. Unemployment I get barely scratches my rent. I had to work for, and was approved for SNAP. So at least I won't go hungry. But that leaves nothing for power bill my car ins and my phone. I got my Medicare card, but there was no info in the letter addressing what happens if you cannot meet the Part B premium. Today I get a bill for \$740, which will cover until January 2026, and it says pay in full, not each month, (which I can't even do that), but to pay in full by 10/25/25! I'm freaking out! No job, I get \$378 week from unemployment, (the amount I was approved for was \$419. They take taxes out so it brings it to \$378). Thank goodness the management company has been and letting my rent go one extra week, with only an added \$5 late fee. My monthly rent takes every penny of the unemployment. What will I do? I can't find any concrete information to find where to get help. This is one of the most frightening things I can remember going through. If I can't find help I'm going to have no choice but to just check out. What else can I do? How ridiculous will it be to be homeless, list everything I ever worked for and all to pay Medicare part b? Which I told them in that little note they all you to write for any questions or concerns I have? I think I'm gonna be done on this earth soon. All my life I've been working hard, became a widow suddenly at 46 but I have been taking care of myself, raised a daughter, and asking nobody for help...with nothing to show for it, then to just be out in the street? Jesus, Joseph and Mary!"

— r/medicare · 26 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o1zqfs/>

↳ (0): "See if you can qualify for Medicare savings program. Info [here](<https://www.medicare.gov/basics/costs/help/medicare-savings-programs>);

↳ (0): "You may want to also apply for Medicaid through your state."

↳ (0): "I'm assuming that you are not redy to *retire* yet and start drawing from your Social Security benefits? I realize just how much of a penalty you'll have for starting at the earliest possible age, but it's better than nothing, assuming that you don't qualify for Medicaid (for some reason)."

"Exactly my situation! I was seriously considering retiring early at 60 (widow) until I realized I'd be paying that much for insurance. I'm on several prescriptions so that alone would put me closer to \$800 per month. So now I'm waiting until 65 to officially retire, but I'm doing my best to act like I'm retired right now anyway! 😂"

— YouTube · Many cannot afford to retire at age 62 because of the cost of private health insurance · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dTkOE6_xA_4&lc=Ugxwr0u89B4HeMmpNJB4AaABAq

"I am so grateful for all the Medicare insurance experts that I watched on YouTube before I turned 65. I was already a widow on Social Security widow's benefit and I needed to make the right choice the first time. And, thankfully, I chose the Supplement/Medigap option. No, I don't have vision or dental, but I know that I have a plan that cannot drop me if I should ever need major medical. Thank you!!!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwTkKJ5br_m-4bpH_d4AaABAq

↳ @lou2632-i5x (0): "Advantage plans don't pay much in dental benefits besides if you need dental procedures it's never covered and end up paying cash any ways😂"

"I have been with Supplemental N since I was eligible for Medicare. I chose this route because my husband did nothing when he was eligible and he had a heart attack, which thankfully they cleaned out the "widow maker artery," but needed a pace maker. We had to wait for open enrollment to which he got a Advantage PPO and was able to get his pace maker surgery without much cost to us, this was in 2019 Jan. I have been paying \$129 a month for my supplemental since beginning and I am thinking about changing to an Advantage PPO so I can keep my cardiologist and primary care doctor. It seems like we never have bills come in for my husband, and yet I am paying monthly payments for my supplemental and I am being charged for Quest lab work and copays. Also, I have no silver sneakers or any other "goodies." What are your thoughts on this?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Vs. Medicare Supplement - An Unbiased Comparison · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EXNLA6j2x0M&lc=UgyFW_XJxNXZFEBt_t94AaABAq

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "So much of it depends on your needs, and your doctors. We would be happy to take a look at your situation and help you determine the best Medicare Advantage PPO options as well. Please call us anytime - 888-465-9728 😊 "

"I've had to go to one meal per day. So I can afford my bills and meds. Had a widow maker in November. Already on disability and other health issues just so I can afford my doctor's and meds. Guess I'll be eating once every other day soon"

— YouTube · Trump Administration to End Medicare Drug Plan Subsidy. #medication #medicare #doctor · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BrOgYbQKs-A&lc=UgxpD3joyZMCd9unu5l4AaABAq>

↳ @CrystalLynn1988 (2): "Im so sorry. No one should have to endure this. You deserve so much better than this. Im truly so sorry. Is there anyone who can help? Food banks? A family member? Go fund me? Anything?"

↳ @Thomas-g4l2y (1): "Same here WTF Hey thanks to the POS who voted for that Been out of food for 24 hours While a criminal rules the country 😞 "

↳ @AmandaDuffy-x7r (0): "@CrystalLynn1988I go to a food bank once a month. It helps. Unfortunately a lot of the food is ultra processed or canned so I eat sparingly with my heart failure there's food restrictions. I'll get by . And I know I'm not the only one in my situation. And as time goes on there will be many many more. Seems it hts the poor the quickest. We have less to loose to feel the impacts of this administration unfortunately"

"Can changes to an advantage plan occur a few months into starting the plan? We shopped around in late 2024 for a new advantage plan for 2025 and I thought I found a perfect plan for her as she has a super fixed income and is widowed. The plan looked to cover all of the doctors and specialists she sees and the area she lived in. Then, in February of 2025, I believe, she received a letter from the advantage plan that she was no longer in a coverage area. She didn't received the letter until she received her first unexpected bill from labs or medical testing. We will be shopping again during this period, but what happened seemed so wrong, when I specifically made sure she was going to be covered, otherwise we would not have went with the plan in the first place. And if this does occasionally seem to happen, was there something we should have done so that she wouldn't have to travel for coverage or to change plans after the first of the year had already started?"

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=UgzKrJYkTgFDOXLjsPN4AaABAq>

"For God's sake we need Socialized Healthcare. The fear mongering used to be "long waits for Dr. appts." well we have those now plus where I live in Texas we are in a nursing and Dr. Crisis. I had a heart ablation and had no skilled nursing for 8 hours after my surgery. I could have died no one checking my vitals, etc. We are WAY worse than Canada, their plan performs much better than ours. Typical Captialists keep grabbing back our benefits, ever changing trying to make more and more money. Do you think they will charge me for a nurse who never showed up? OF COURSE THEY WILL."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgyGsth4x4meVaT8Hpp4AaABAq>

"My widowed MIL got a breast cancer Dx in Nebraska in a very rural town. With Original Medicare and a Plan G Supplement we were able bring her to Atlanta for treatment. The only thing we paid for was the Medicare deductible and mastectomy bras co-pay. Her brother, on Medicare Advantage, had to stay in his region and was unable to come to the "big city" for better treatment. MIL believes not getting full and proper care cost him his life."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgzUS0TjgalMUJhNeL94AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "So sorry to hear about your uncle in law. Glad to hear your MIL is okay. Thank you for sharing your experience!"

"If plan G currently is only \$248.00 a year Out of Pocket, what is the Put of Pocket for a plan N? I am a widow age 74, I went on Aetna advantage plan PPO with zero monthly payments at age 65, I live in Illinois, I have had pretty good health, I take a 10mm licinipril for high blood pressure daily. I am not diabetic, no cancer, and other than high blood pressure no other heart issues. Going forward should I try to get on an original Med Gap policy? The way I figure, with zero per month premiums for now 9 year I have saved at least \$1,500.00 per year in premiums, or around \$13-14,000.00. How long will I live? I have out lived my son and wife of 47 years, so Who knows."

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgxdfSUcS_pYBreMz494AaABAq

↳ @MedicareonVideo (0): "Plan N doesn't have a fixed out-of-pocket amount. It has the Part B deductible, office and emergency room copays, and possible excess charges. My rule of thumb is that Plan N is a great deal if it's at least \$25 cheaper than G, while GHD is excellent if it's at least \$70 cheaper than N. Given your Illinois underwriting rules and nine years in Medicare Advantage, compare carefully before switching. You can call 877-885-3484 or visit MedicareOnVideo.com for a quote."

"What about a commercial property, not a residence. My brother and i are selling a piece of commercial property which we own 50% each. We purchased it in 1993 for \$690,000 and the sale price is now \$800,000 if we get that. The capital gain would be \$110,000 divided by 2, so \$55,000 each I'm guessing? We're both over 65 and on medicare, he's divorced and I'm a widower so neither of us file jointly. The \$55,000 each would count towards our income for the year of the sale, is that correct?"

— YouTube · Will Selling a Home Raise My Medicare Premiums? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Nabja99a_eHw&lc=Ugzlcxbm_yJKUOYkjdd4AaABAq

↳ @popgems (0): "I'm not a tax professional but I think any capital gain income counts."

"I switched from G to N to help with the budget and so far I've only paid \$17.86 for my copay w my orthopedic dr. Right now my premium is \$86.70 a month but I'm expecting an increase next year since my husband died due to terminal pancreatic cancer in February 🥹 . I'm hoping it will still be less of an increase than the plan G would have been. In a normal year i don't go to the dr except for my annual visit . 9:00"

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan N Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qXRKtPCSPkI&lc=UgzR8G1ZeRpcd3mUVFI4AaABAg_ASeO7HFRaUdA_7oOdIV66Q

"I became eligible for Widow benefits and I had to go on Medicare with my age was 54 I was told I had to and was supposed to at age 50,I was not ever informed that I would have to,or did I have to Or could I had gotten Medicaid along with Medcare? I get alot of calls from Medicare thinking I am dual, and I was on Disability and I was younger than 50 when I became Widow ,in my 40s if this helps. Thank you"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙋 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzMVMIRPsOoPYM9IXB4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "Once you are drawing SSDI for 24 months, you were eligible and enrolled in Medicare. It becomes primary insurance and you have to keep it unless you're covered by active employer Group insurance from a large employer. Some people qualify for Medicare & Medicaid (based on income). You can check with your State Medicaid office about the 'Medicare Savings Program' for help with Medicare costs."

"Thank you Stephanie! You are so good at explaining the different plans . I'm 75=widow in Louisiana on a Humana Plan F which they no long sell its 100% plan although the premium is getting higher . I pay Just my med about 335 month going up 50 the first of the year. Just wondering if I went to a G plan if that would lower my monthly. I Thank you so much!"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgxkmK0r7hwapiwRHGB4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "It absolutely would. Call us for help. 888-465-9728."

"It's all about the money...What about the fact that it's getting harder to find a doctor, especially one that takes Medicare. In my area of SpaceCoast FL my town has an excellent hospital and excellent advantage plan rated good enough for me, a widow at almost 65 and not looking to live forever. It's all controlled. I did not enjoy your presentation 💎 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugxs4JXL5OiZt-VLYMN4AaABAg>

"What if you sign up for a and b medicare in 22 i still working and have my insurance thinking about retireing in april will that stop me from getting medigap my insurance pay first this last april started drawing widow social security delayed my retirement"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙋 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgwGTNsw8bL5l6Tn9Xd4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "If you kept Medicare A&B and active employer Group insurance then you should get a Guaranteed Issue into Medicare Supplement, either F or G, when you drop the employer group plan. We can advise you. If you have any questions please, feel free to give us a call at 800-864-8890 or schedule a free appointment here: <https://www.medicareschool.com/talk-to-a-guide?rc>";

"Hi Dr. Ed, I'm a widow and was late signing for Medicare. Now I have to pay penalty for life. I still work part time and try to survive. What can I do to avoid the late penalty. I'm struggling with my financial situation. PLEASE ADVISE 😞 "

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugx7UEGycVu_vEwy_b14AaABAg

↳ @GUITARTIME2024 (0): "Send a letter explaining all of that to whatever the Medicare contact mailing address is, perhaps?"

"I am looking for someone who can answer questions. I am a 79 year year old widow in Texas. How do I find someone who is independent and willing to help me make a decision? Everyone I talk to wants to sell me something."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugz0ey9ky5yfN--0jRJ4AaABAg>

A spouse on a different plan, or choosing together · 21 documents · 20 voices

"Thanks for the excellent video. I am on AARP Medicare Advantage UnitedHealthcare PPO. My wife was on the same plan, but we kept hearing bad things about Advantage and we both attempted to switch back to traditional medicare in 2023. She was accepted, I was not. I was told I could not because I had received a couple of steroid shots in my spine due to arthritis. We are both 71 and in good health for the most part. I have had cancer (16 years ago), but my wife is in excellent health and always has been. We also full time RV's. We winter in Tucson Nov-April and the rest of the year we migrate with the birds. I have just subscribed. I wish health care in America was not such a game show, but it is."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxgkqFeVTXyGsSK5nV4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching and subscribing! Check out our recent videos because we are mid-48 state road trip 😊 In A mini van though... not an RV"

"I really like the honesty of this agent. I have been studying medigap s and Medicare advantage plans plus G. And asking many questions whether to purchase G or N. No one even gives me an answer. it's always its your decision, but this agent was truthful. My husband and i are both on N because it's expensive, but it's true we never know what will happen, and we do have many friends going home to the Lord. We never go to the doctor but we dont know the future. I plan to switch next year to G"

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgxSgFnaJw69KePAqkt4AaABAg

↳ @MedicareonVideo (4): "Yes, exactly. Everyone coming into Medicare needs to understand that there are options aside from Plan G. Plan G is a fantastic plan, but it is not a one size fits all scenario. I have plenty of clients on Plan G, Plan N, and Plan GHD."

↳ @katherinebruno616 (2): "All I want to know is the monthly cost for Plan G in R.I ...What will it cost my boyfriend every month? I do know Part B comes out his check automatically so what else does he pay??"

↳ @katherinebruno616 (1): "What's the difference between reg G and a high deductible G plan???"

"Finally a video that explains a very complicated subject in a relatively easy to understand for Matt. My wife and I have two very different medical needs and two very different plans. I have an advantage plan and my wife has supplementary plan. Anyway, this is pretty easy to understand. For a very complicated subject. Thank you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzaWKyVAJJPD5L5Zmt4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much David! Appreciate you watching and sharing your experience!"

"We have UPMC Advantage and love it! A great plan with wonderful benefits. Their customer service is unsurpassed. They even give us yearly, a \$500 credit card to use for many different products and services--our choice. The prescription coverage is excellent and our monthly costs for the coverage has gone down the past couple years--each year. My wife's mom stayed with medicare and paid for the different plans (Part D etc.) available. Every year the costs went up significantly. All I can say is that we have been more than happy with our plan. Plus, since we are less than two hours from Pittsburgh, we have some of the finest specialists in the country available to us."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyRg0ssyib9zrFwr5t4AaABAg>

"Both my wife and i are currently on a plan G medigap plan. She has several chronic conditions (hypertension, diabetes, etc). I do not. Due to rising costs, im considering switching me to an advantage plan. My PCP, local hospital, dentist, optometrist, and numerous specialists are all "in network". Im a little leary but,the cost savings would help us out at the grocery store. Im thinking she'll stay on her current plan."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=UgzA0DdKnCv-VCPJKJx4AaABAg>

↳ @kciis (1): "It sounds like you're making a thoughtful decision based on your circumstances. Thank you for sharing!"

"Hi - is CA a popular state for medicare advantage? Also I am wondering what the main selling point is for a Medicare advantage plan vs a regular Medicare plan. Why would someone want to switch? The minute I heard these are managed by private health ins companies was a sucker punch. I'm a 42 old who recently has had some health issues and getting United health care to approve much needed services has been a nightmare. Also my girlfriend has had issues too. Both of us have corporate plans and we gave had to pay out of pocket for services that should be covered under our plan, like CT scans and other type tests that our drs have issued as well as appealed, and still no approvals and we had to pay out of pocket. It was an eye opening and costly experience. The reason I would like to know what the main value is to getting an advantage plan is due to me looking at getting into the business. Would hate for a senior to get an advantage plan and get need services denied by the private ins company managing the plan, same thing that happens to me. Thanks in advance. For your reply."

— YouTube · What is Medicare Advantage? Medicare Advantage Plans Explained · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eRoWOPDW8DY&lc=UgxVVsSDuRpg5Du33_p4AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "For some people and Advantage Plan can be a hood fit. It depends on your needs and your budget. In any case, it's important to understand the ins and outs of all of your Medicare plan options. A good independent broker will generally represent multiple plan types and options. Let me know if you have any other questions!"

"My plan G with BCBS here in Illinois was \$174 now it's \$207 but the wife will be on the same plan in July and we both get the 12% reduction in our premiums with the household discount."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgxaF4iEfv-bO7TSxwp4AaABAg>

↳ @policyguides (1): "That household discount definitely helps offset some of the increase. A lot of people don't realize carriers like BCBS Illinois offer spousal/household discounts that can make a meaningful difference over time. And honestly, your experience also highlights why rate stability matters just as much as the starting premium when choosing a Medigap company."

↳ @todddunn945 (1): "@ChicagoSteve69 Remember that Medicare supplements are totally different from normal commercial insurance policies. They pay what Medicare doesn't. The benefits are totally standardized. So being comfortable with a company doesn't matter much since they pay automatically. In other words, you get a medical service under Medicare and Medicare pays its part. Medicare sends the information to your supplement company which then pays the 20% coinsurance."

↳ @ChicagoSteve69 (0): "@policyguides if I can save myself a little money I'll take it. I was on BCBS PPO private insurance for YEARS and it carried over 7 yrs into retirement but turning 65 in January changed everything! So, staying with something I was familiar with was crucial and BCBS was that for us. I'll hang in there for as long as I can afford it but we will see."

"My wife and I are both on plan G, glad we made that decision, we have both had major medical issues and have only had to pay are Medicare deductible, yes, the premiums have increased each year, but we are fortunate that we can still afford the premiums. Think hard when choosing which plan you want when you reach 65 and go on Medicare, if your confused about the different plans, please talk to a health care professional and have them explain all your options so you understand them, your choice will affect you for the rest of your life."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzJfhax1LJUv3aO2_x4AaABAg

"I got my letter saying my M A premier HMO POS is being discontinued and I need to get new insurance by Dec 31, 2025. My husband has same plan as me and when I called my insurance since he got no cancellation letter, I called, they told me he is not cancelled. Red flag here! If doing away with my plan, why is my husband still being covered by this plan. He got no notice and also got no ANOC. I told them to send me proof he is covered. My second call to my insurance company, the person I spoke with said I still had coverage. I told her that is not what this letter I got on Oct 2, 2025 says. It plainly says you are cancelled, you plan is being discontinued. My other thing is in back of Medicare book, it still shows plan available in 2026. If I go back to original Medicare, I pay my \$185.00 premium that is deducted from my SS check monthly. I also will pay a monthly premium to the plan I choose, plus higher copays for hospital and specialist doctors and primary Dr. It is all about insurance companies making and keeping their profits. Makes no difference I paid into Medicare my entire life Seems someone is lying to me."

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=UgxLcRkWaIF-oiHHVgJ4AaABAg_ANmidDT4xvkANuE5XrS6-x

"Interesting video, your spreadsheet is a great tool that allows seniors to win at Medicare, Game set and match. Where can I find published the rate increases that are happening to Medicare Supplements right now? You mentioned some large percentages like 30/50%. I have been notified of a 10% increase starting next year for Plan N in Tennessee and would like to see if that's in line or not. The lifetime cost of a mEdicare supplement is eye watering. Teh planning tool I use estimates 600,000 for both my wife and I for medicare supplements *and* my overall plan has a 99% chance of success so I am well informed going in as a 65 year old. To me the extra cost of a supplement is well worth it. With commercial insurance I found myself losing sleep when I get denial notices or pre approval notices. It's going to be nice not to have to put up with them."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRlOxmSo&lc=Ugyd6LSxCR1_vLkKsiV4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching! 🍌🍌 One of my partners put out this video that show you how to track down past and present rates here: <https://youtu.be/j66oGQqz2Mc?si=zzymc4jyC3wb1Oig>";

↳ @JeanPierreWhite (0): "@Theretirementnerds That's awesome. Wish I knew that info in 2023 when I was choosing. I see 2024 rate increases are up quite a bit from previous years so that makes me feel less concerned about the increase I see announced."

"So I retired from my large company at 71. Already had Medicare part A but not B. Was waiting to what cobra might be and it was way too much. I enrolled in Medicare part B for me and my wife-(what a hassle!) and then bought a separate plan called part G. And then a separate part D for drugs. Did I over buy? All this just happened last month."

— YouTube · 7 MEDICARE ERRORS to Avoid When You Work Past Age 65 · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2RD7fyvVse8&lc=UgyE52KcitL6itFATIp4AaABAg>

"Cobalt Blue - excellent video! - I'm 65 and working for a large company. Plan to work till 70. Wife is 64 and self-employed. Both of us are on my plan with an HSA. Did not sign up, and wife not planning to till I retire when I will enroll. Excellent information. Thank you. Where are you located?"

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugy1WbdbE_CsFaYjxPh4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! 🟦 I live in Utah. Have partners scattered all over 😊 "

"I got a paper statement on the 18th of sept. for my part d. My husband has the same plan & hasn't yet received his."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Advantage Plan Cost YOU \$1,000s in 2027!? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JemKIOUrppM&lc=UgyYz-95D56lKEYEaoN4AaABAg>

↳ @MyGovExpert (2): "Each member gets their own Annual Notice of Change, and plans are supposed to send it by September 30, so his may still be coming. If it doesn't arrive, call the number on his plan card. Request my free 2027 Medicare Advantage Guide & Worksheet here: <https://24help.org/aep> — Dr. Ed"

"@concernedcitizen7697that depends on gender and state. I got Plan G through United Healthcare AARP. My wife has the same plan. I pay \$165 and she pays \$160 even though she is 5 years older. Other insurance companies may have lower rates and some and higher. Plan G rates go up every year so you can count on a -10% increase each year. I'm in NC, some states are a lot higher while others are lower. I'll always have Plan G even if need a side hustle to afford it. Supplemental plans are costly but one bad diagnosis can cost a fortune. Having good insurance is a priority for me even though I'm pretty healthy but that could change after one visit to Dr. Talk to a broker and don't hesitate to ask any questions. This young lady could be a great resource. People are healthy until they aren't. I'll never have an Advantage plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgztwikgUWWxR35VyLN4AaABAg.AZZoan4jDMSAZaFCTNdK9->

"I am on Medicare A&B with Tricare for Life as my secondary (my wife will have the same plan when she turns 65). I also use the VA on top of that. I see a lot of Advantage Plan Insurance companies that push plans "specifically for Military Retirees" trying to take away what we have so they can make a profit. Sucks having to pay the part B, but in the end it's worth it to have Medicare and Tricare rather than having to see only an Advantage Plan network and allowing an insurance company to make my medical decisions rather than my doctor."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugzlclq14ZrK5Nnt1aJx4AaABAg>

"Erin, you do a wonderful job with complicated Medicare changes. We have the fairly new Imperial Health plan of California which is an advantage plan. We are very healthy and it's worked well for us with zero costs. I estimate both of us have saved over \$30,000 in premiums versus a supplemental plan since we started 8 years ago. I have no idea how financially sound the company is so we hope they don't cancel us down the road. We weren't aware of the guaranteed right issue so that is comforting to know."

— YouTube · Up to 3.5 Million May Lose Their Medicare Advantage Plans - Don't Miss This Medigap Right · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XMKSLDipo9o&lc=UgxyvEaaZ2DtLbVHSMZ4AaABAg>

"I was told to get Advantage because it was cheaper. I was paying \$1300 a month for me and my wife for Bronze, crappy, ObamaCare. We took plan G. Yeah it cost me \$550 a month for my wife and I but, she had a tumor removed, I got pancreatic cancer. The cost was well worth it. It's all a gamble. My cost for both of us under Plan G so far has been cheaper in the long run. The big scam is the durg plan that you have to buy extra. Congress should be ashamed to sell America out for PAC money."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw8tqJwx309-PTq3-F4AaABAg>

"I use the free VA healthcare, which I like, but I also have medicare A, B, N, and part D, just in case. I've only used medicare once in 5 years just to get a civilian healthcare provider. My wife has the same plans and uses medicare quite often. She just had \$9000 worth of treatment which didn't cost us except for the initial office visit."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgxgvNDZapV_hxDLaJR4AaABAg

"I just need to know all the monthly costs on Medicare with plan G. The way I'm hearing this is I pay Medicare B premium and the cost of plan G. I will also pay on any service a deductible of up to \$226. My wife and I will get same plans so I'll just double my cost to know my max monthly payment. Am I correct???"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=UgwH4MKWfwwmdf6ZHXV4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (1): "<https://youtube.com/shorts/nRtVkCdQLV8?si=Hhtq8Cku1hlvLFtx> If you need help getting your Medicare coverage set up correctly, feel free to give us a call at 800-864-8890 or schedule a free appointment here: <https://www.medicareschool.com/talk-to-a-guide?rc>";

"We have had Medicare for 17 years. Both my wife and I are happy with traditional Medicare and our "F" supplements. We like not having deductibles, copays or coinsurance."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxtNdc_6NLAHEireXd4AaABAg

Told what to choose by family, friends or a salesperson · 11 documents · 11 voices

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want a insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

"So glad I listened to friends who told me not to get an advantage plan when I turned 65. So glad."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugwsqy61flcc1W4xCgp4AaABAg>

↳ @nealkshah (0): "yes! I tell everyone i know the same thing!"

"Thank you Erin for so well explained these healthcare confusions! I wish this video would have came out a year ago. I'm 66 and I was confused by all these last year when I needed to enroll. My broker only pushed me to enroll in Medicare Advantage and it seems to be a better choice due to the lower cause. As you said, I'm lucky that I'm still healthy now but choosing Medigap may be a better choice down the road."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwZrnBS3BHQIMpP7-x4AaABAg>

"He is very good at explaining but I am still confused. I have a supplement plan that an agent recommended when I had a special enrollment period due to job retirement and he just said I like "this company", they are great. Plan G, good rate etc, yet this supplement plan has been a nightmare, acting like an advantage plan. Refusing to cover, putting time limits on Dr ordered physical therapy etc. It says G on my card but someone told me this company was pushed on me because this company also owns a large advantage plan and the incentive to be harrassive is to make me say forget plan G I will just go to an advantage plan, and voila, here is my Plan G company right there to offer an advantage plan (their own). I feel very duped. I don't know if it was the agent pulling a fast one on me because he got some sort of commission from supp company to aggressively push me in their direction so when I get frustrated agent will push me to plan g company's advantage and he will get a kickback or something. My agent said this company a half a second after I said I wanted original Medicare and never offered me anything else. New and very green to the insurance monsters I didn't know any better even though I thought I understood it all. Now I can lateral move to a different plan g company but only with underwriting. I could probably pass underwriting. I just lost all trust in this agent and people tell me I can't change agents. Ugh! What, how and WHY?? It shouldn't be this complicated to stay on original Medicare because one agent didn't offer me an insurance company choice!!! Beware people, not all insurance reps are thinking of your best interests! (Not the man that posted this video, he is awesome and speaks clearly so you understand 😊). I truly thought original Medicare was the way to go given the nightmare stories advantage plan people post about. I wasn't in open enrollment period, so agent had lots of time to help me, it was in the middle of the year when Medicare mania wasn't in full swing."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwISnQQsx1IQjxDEhN4AaABAq_AMRqYild_gEAMS-liEeFa

"Thank you for this. I found it informative & helpful. I've been on regular Medicare plus a Supplemental (not Advantage) for the past few years. My agent has never tried to push me onto Advantage (even though he would get paid a commission for that), nor has he pushed Medicare-only (even though my expense have been thankfully minimal). I may choose the "HD" plan for next year after seeing your video... but will consider all options carefully. Thanks for shedding some SUNBURN... I mean, sunlight--- on these issues!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugwz6sk-OCmNb4s28VR4AaABAq>

"Very nice video. While I am able to have a company sponsored advantage plan, I ended up with a supplement and a part d plan. I went with plan N for many of the reasons you listed. My wife found the snake oil salesman (M) that convinced her that anything but a G would be filled with excess charges. I'll be sure to let folks turning 65 that they need to watch your videos!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugyio51XCzUrklpcWdx4AaABAq>

"My husband insisted on remaining on my work insurance after he was on part A & B. Turned out to be worth it. He got a bad cancer. I only got a few small co-pays for a specialist or two. Literally under \$1000 for a couple of MRIs, CT, specialists visits, chemo, and surgeries. Oh, and a stay in hospital after a fall, and then a week in ICU when he died."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugw6C3bUsYwEg8oblax4AaABAq>

"@ don fannin - read the comments above. There is a comment from an agent that states they make 3 times the commission to have you go with an Advantage plan. My agent "pushed me & assumed I wanted an Advantage plan" I chose a supplement - plan G. Now I know why I was pushed as I am new to Medicare. Her attitude changed when I decided on the supplement."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugz2_uF65H8Jz0jVpt4AaABA9.9Sux7M1FTTh9WR12J3iarR

"My DOG and I thank you for such an indepth yet simple explanation of the medicare jungle! I have an Advantage give back plan which I love--no major medical problems yet. My broker has been pushing me towards a plan G but I really don't want the monthly premiums. I'm still undecided... Do you all provide brokerage services?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugyl2ieaUFe2xWpzB1h4AaABA9>

"When my husband turned 65, he picked up A & B, plus insisted on staying on my work policy. Turned out to be a good idea. 4 years later he was diagnosed with both Alzheimer's and terminal cancer. I just remember paying a few specialists co-pays, but mostly I never saw a bill."

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKcNbXw-M&lc=UgwFj0AFtqInciVi1Tt4AaABA9>

"My friend told me not to get the advantage plans!!! You csnt go back to regular medicare ever !!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugy0ZiklKHauVgn7BEB4AaABA9>

Doctors who won't take their plan · 11 documents · 11 voices

"My family doctor doesn't take Medicare. I pay him up front (he charges me the allowed Medicare rate for the visit) and his staff files for me with Medicare and Medicare sends me a check that covers the visit. I have supplement G. So even if the doctor doesn't participate, the cost can be covered."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwK1gzzvwDmZ0n8K_V4AaABA9

↳ @EliseR-d1y (0): "It is so wonderful that your doctor's office does that. I am not certain many would."

↳ @MikeHammer1 (0): "@EliseR-d1y I suspect that you can submit the medical expense yourself using a copy of the actual visit paperwork with the coding for the treatment. Worth looking into. And yes, it is wonderful that they do this (not just for me), they are Christians and they also operate a free clinic to help those who lack the ability to pay. My son (an RN) worked at the clinic for several years (strictly voluntary, no compensation)."

"My local Dr here in Bartlett Tennessee doesn't take any advantage plans. I've been with him for 14 years, and he explained why he didn't take patients with these types of plans. I turned 65 several years ago, hence I was on Medicare A and B. I asked about supplemental coverage and he said in his opinion that would be the best for me. I chose a company and so far so good. It pays to have a good doctor, and his office is small, with himself and one other doctor and a FPN."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgxY9CxTqO-n8hy5cUR4AaABA9>

"I would love to go back to supplement because of my hospital stay and I had full coverage at the time and always in my life I have higher level of Medicaid and my one hospital bill was 1,000.000 and I would of been responsible for 20 %and now I'm Medicare / Medicaid qmb and it paid all. With all these changes scares me now I V did not know the difference from supplement and advantage I just made sure I had a ppo and a private insurance company and they told me I would not lose anything. And this is my second year on advantage and now after watching for my health and quality of life may change for the rules that the agents never told . I even told them if it takes anything or decisions out of my hand I don't want it. Nothing or accesentives is worthwhile than my be health care. I feel I was lied to and till this year it came out and I found out for my copays are 47\$ if I don't go to a doctor that doesn't take Medicaid. Unless you're in the hospital doctors don't take Medicaid. my yearly coverage now is \$247 in January I don't know yet this year. Even though I'm undetectable I still have to"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=UgynA8kDxKYvvlalAJd4AaABAg_AM3rbFxx_jLANEHsoyZDJy

"*!!!!IMPORTANT NOTE!!!! If you're on Medicare because you receive title two SSDI benefits and are way younger 55, NONE OF THIS APPLIES TO YOU! If you have a long term specialist and/or long term primary care physician, 9/10 they won't participate because reimbursement rates are very low. As for dental: if you can find a dentist that takes medicare (NOT medicaid - two very different programs), you'll receive one annual prophylaxis (polish and floss), and probably a discount on extractions and fillings. Of eight dentists I've visited between Cleveland, Columbus, Dayton, and Cincinnati, none take medicare. That includes Case Western, Ohio State, and community college student dental clinics. Remember when you worked full time and could choose between cheap HMO plans that covered less medical procedures, non-specialty (generic only) prescription meds, higher copays/deductibles, and that was okay cause you were healthy and just needed the basics? This is that, except much fewer providers and lower quality of care."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Plan Cuts Part B Premium To \$21.50 - Too Good To Be True? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yIhPc5AkFIY&lc=Ugz-7wAOwII8hs2Pry94AaABAg>

"Still the biggest problem all patients face is being the responsible party without upfront disclosures who's accepting your insurance vs not when you go to the hospital. Rightfully so, hospitals service patients without knowing anything about their insurance. They network with other doctors and specialists. On your behalf they create a team to meet your needs. The sticking point for the patient is they're spending your money without consent. Most of the time especially planned care there's time for the coordinator to source the insurance. Emergency, is an on call system. Hospitals is where those extra charges happen and I have G+ and still some don't get billed right and I get stuck. I haven't had anything serious that requires a doctor that doesn't take Medicare. They're out there, especially celebrity doctors."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=Ugx3YR_9UYI0c_wSFQt4AaABAg

"Have never had one problem with my Advantage plan. Yes, there is a higher annual out of pocket before everything is covered at 100%, but I have been able to go to any doctor I want, as I have yet to find one that doesn't accept my plan. I do not need referrals for specialists. I am in good health. I take no prescription medications. I only go to dr for annual blood work and check up, and I see an ophthalmologist annually, as well as a dermatologist. For people needing ongoing medical care and Rx, I can see why they would want a Medigap plan. If you are healthy and don't need ongoing medical treatment, then it can be to your advantage to be on an Advantage plan. There is a lot of misinformation going on here about advantage plans. Both Medigap and Advantage have their pros and cons."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugz7ZCg8WF1391OtQdJ4AaABAg.ACWjHW9hH_0AYh2NtRXogp

"It's been trending that way for a while. Just ran into it. I started with a new MA plan this year and was referred by my dentist to an oral surgeon for a biopsy, but after I called the referred surgeon's office they told me they no longer take Medicare, MA or supplements. So I called the BCBS to see who they have in-network. The only one they had was this office and gave me their names. BCBS rep called the OS and confirmed they are no longer accepting any flavor of Medicare. They then told me to start calling around. Instead I went to the Medicare site to see who they have listed. Not a single oral surgeon in a 200 mile radius. Closest one is nearly 300mi away."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1j9odhm/28_cut_to_medicare_payment_to_physicians_approved/mhhc5qf/

"@RG-hf4etpart of it was the deductible for Medicare your yearly one and my hip doctor you need a referral because he won't take you without it because he is highly specialized in hips . The hospital in our area has laid off multiple doctors and nurses they are hurting for money they are doing some fancy coding. Also I contacted my representative Susan Collins to check into it. If they are doing it me they are doing it to other people"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzUXCd8T0RKOWYzDF4AaABAg.AODRmnFk5oAODce6T4Pa->

"Not true you pay zero out of pocket on Plan G after the deductible. If Medicare doesn't cover chiropractors and other providers and you use these you are paying way more annually. Advantage plans are government pushed plans. My doctor won't accept them now at all. It is all corrupt."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlG&lc=UgwG7y8dYloeq6jx3oF4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (0): "Ah, that's what I said. 😂 After the Part B deductible, you pay zero for Medicare-covered services. Also, it's wise to choose your plan based on the ability to see doctors that you want to see."

👍 "

"My husband goes to a dermatologist and every time he's in the waiting room he hears someone with a MA plan being told that doctor doesn't accept that coverage. People with MA think "Medicare is Medicare" and it's accepted everywhere. NOT true."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=Uggy8EOPhkEEuNVy49h4AaABAg>

"My cat & I thank you for this information as it can be very confusing. I 78, currently on BCBS advantage. My doctor of 15 years will no longer accept my plan so I must navigate thru to find plan my dr. will take."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyqZWjW9bakPP3UnKB4AaABAg>

Not wanting to burden the kids · 9 documents · 9 voices

"I'm turning 65 in December. I am a single person and need to make sure I'm able to stay in my own home and not be a burden to family. I want a what is called "Cadillac Plan", I am considering regular Medicare plan and adding additional cover for any gaps in coverage for the rest of my life. I am not really thinking the Advantage plan works for me after hearing several Carriers are pulling out and it's harder to get approvals. I also have a Cancer Insurance and Heart Insurance I've had for years that pay a lump sum that I am keeping. I just want to be covered. I don't have much monthly income but I would rather be safe than sorry. I noticed Mutual of Omaha and Select Health offer supplements, I live in Utah. Any advise?"

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgwH3al8qtp-kRd7Hx94AaABAg>

↳ @alansach8437 (2): "G. All you pay is the Part B deductible. With the D Plans look for one that covers any drugs you may be taking. If you are going to get screwed anywhere it's with the drug plan. None of them cover everything."

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "@alansach8437 All Part D plans must cover at least two drugs from every prescription category plus substantially all medications from 6 protected categories like cancer drugs and autoimmune drugs. If they do not have a specific drug available, they will have a competitor or generic. You also have the ability to appeal and have your specific drug added to the formulary just for you."

"I'm satisfied with Plan N- I spent a long time looking at them. I can't believe that so many go for Medicare Advantage. I like having some control and I don't want my children to have to pay for me."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=Ugww3CgLvpuhi_trRZ4AaABAg

↳ @PJN61 (1): "I turn 65 in January and I chose plan N. I would never use a Medicare advantage plan."

"I'm in a battle with IRMAA because they just don't see my point. My income rose sharply in 2024 due to huge Capital Gain Distributions on a mutual fund I inherited in 2015. I have NOT sold the fund, so those CGDS effectively are NOT tangible income. In fact I plan on passing the fund to my daughter as an inheritance. This doesn't fall into any one of their SSA 44 Form categories to reduce my income. I wonder if joining the group mentioned will have some strategies to get my Social Security back where it belongs"

— YouTube · 8 Ways to Reduce Medicare IRMAA Payments · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z6yhDpaSO9A&lc=Ugxf0sbcNIT1PW6nT3d4AaABAg>

"Hey Erik, it's Kim Mary again. • Can you recommend a low(ish) premium CSH Indemnity Plan? I'd rather have that in place (in CA, must be active *before* I turn 65 this June) to avoid having to pull \$\$\$ from our home's equity = our kids' inheritance. • Does your financial partner offer Lifecycle (lose no premium) types of products? Is he *not* pushy? • John (my husband) loves elephants 🐘 ❤️ • Mel's Drive-in has a four-cheese grilled cheese sandwich 🍔 which is my favorite."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=Ugx_FkLI0ebxVd_mia14AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Hi Kim! :) My partners would be great for this. I'll send you an email."

"Erin, I turned 63 on 9/30/25 and I received a partial inheritance in 2025 and a larger one in 2026. Will IRMAA charge me higher medicare premiums for both years? Furthermore, does the higher premiums also apply to age 64? Lastly, does it reset every year?"

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgyqH88NllxXlrsDyYF4AaABAg>

"I received an inheritance from my fathers estate in 2022 and got a letter saying I had to pay more for Medicare, but that was a windfall and not representative of my normal income!"

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA 2025 Explained (Are a High Income Earner?) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ioM2gA1LLtI&lc=UgxUwQMNOlomSDBkzPF4AaABAg>

↳ @Wildflower1517 (0): "Yes just like a sale of a home after 30-50 years of living there ."

"What if something changes my financial situation like getting an inheritance. Can my mediCal be taken away and will I then be allowed to get a supplemental plan?"

— YouTube · Is Plan N the best Medicare Supplement? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M_1q1aldSw&lc=UgxBpE6p1HPBiGjY9Nh4AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (3): "@donneone in some states (not all), loss of Medicaid will trigger a “guaranteed issue right” to purchase a Medigap plan."

"I look at plan G as insurance to protect my kids inheritance."

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgxvAg9RWvQF7JGbKhN4AaABAg

"My mom had the best supplement to Medicare. Supposed to pay for everything. She had a fairly large amount of money, but she ended up on Medicaid and was moved into a semiprivate room at the nursing home because of that. Because she had dementia, they immediately took my POA away, and they took control of all of her money. I never saw a dime of inheritance, and she never received any better medical care with her fancy insurance that was supposed to pay for everything. But, she paid quite a bit out of pocket for her cataract surgery. Oliver's complaint about Advantage plans is the same that could be said about any health insurance (I used to be in the health insurance business)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 1 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCC&lc=UgzA9ydYlabYysfKTfd4AaABAg>

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

On Advantage: 'stay away' and the answers to it · 118 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"Should we just not mention Medicare Advantage plans here? Do you all see this group as solely about Medicare, only? Because if I say anything positive about Advantage plans, or heck, even mention them, I get downvoted. If Medicare Advantage plan discussions aren't welcome here, that's fine. But some clarity on this would be welcome."

— r/medicare · 82 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1mckfap/>

↳ (0): "Medicare Advantage is a part of Medicare so of course it can be discussed here. There's a vocal portion of this group that doesn't like MA and that's fine. It's a discussion forum where people discuss things."

↳ (0): "I tried very hard not to sign up for MA, but because I'm relatively healthy the maths didn't math. I had help from a SHIBA volunteer when signing up. We determined it would cost me an extra \$6000 a year to go with original Medicare. What needs to happen is for Medicare to be allowed an even playing field compared to MA. Listen to Bernie!"

↳ (0): "I think your volunteer was math challenged. Depending on your age though. What I hate is to see people say "I'm relatively healthy". Do you expect to stay that way? Do you think you can change back to a Medicare supplement whenever you want? Chances are, you cannot. You are choosing a health plan that you will be using for a very long time, possibly forever. Yes during AEP you can change from one MAPD to another, but you cannot switch to a med sup unless you are healthy. You cannot switch be declined. And right now, medical underwriting is very strict. Possibly different in your state. I know a few, very few, have open enrollment for med sup, but the vast majority do not."

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want a insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

"Absolutely. This comment spells it out the way it is. Doctors don't like to take original Medicare. In effect, you have a more limited network by staying on Medicare original, and you have to pay for both the supplement the medication premium. I strongly recommend the Medicare advantage plans with no monthly premium. They have enough providers of all types that you still have choice."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 76 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxAXzFMBaU_-X7O2GZ4AaABAg.9YRy38TRtYC9Y_UuyNITsc

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAg.AOmGYDg472zAOmUZITAtAk>

"My closest friend had great supplement plan. She only told her daughter, but she dropped it, got in an Advantage plan. At 84 she would NOT listen to her daughter and did it. She had a brain aneurysm 8 months later, and two months later, still hospitalized.. She is being moved to an expensive rehab. Her daughter said the bills are astronomical. The Advantage plan rejected every single thing to make you fight for each separate coverage. Had she not been so cheap, everything would have been covered. I myself was underwritten four years ago for plan G. Yes it's expensive, I was in ICU for a month with heart failure, a \$100,000 Surgery followed by three weeks in rehab, and home rehab for three months. Cost to me??? Zero, yup, big fat zero!! Another heart surgery in Oct. cost.....zero! Think long and hard. My friend had a nice nest egg.....gone!"

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzcjY71Bi2WAeUiyGt4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (4): "WOW. Such an important story to share."

↳ @butterflygirl2285 (4): "IMO - I feel that insurance Medicare agents/brokers who push this scam on clients should be investigated. It's my understanding that the agents are compensated for at a higher rate for enrolling seniors on the Advantage Plan. At the very least customers who enrolled in the Advantage option should be allowed to change back to the traditional one at no penalty to them."

↳ @RC-vv6nr (1): "I find that hard to believe . You should get a lawyer..."

"Anecdote ... 75 years old here. I wound up in the ER a week ago with severe abominable pain. Lots of tests and and a ERCP to clear gall stones from the gall bladder duct on the emergency day. They scheduled me for gall bladder removal surgery the next day. I called my medicare advantage and was told the surgery would need prior approval or they would NOT pay for the surgery. I told the nurse this and then the surgeon and I wound up signing an AMA (Against Medical Advice) and came home, the surgery never happened. The bills haven't arrived yet so it will be interesting to see how it all goes. I still have my gall bladder and I feel great."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugypul9EmnhP1JOBSTx4AaABAg>

↳ @davidhill7055 (13): "When you sign up for an Advantage Plan, you are giving permission of the insurance company (or software program they are running) to control the treatment decisions your doctor and you have agreed on. Advantage plans are in the business to make money, your treatment is interfering with their bottom line. It is an adversarial relationship that you signed up for. Probably tricked into it by the agent who sold you the plan. They get much higher commissions than sell Original Medicare supplement plans which require no approval."

↳ @tioswift3676 (9): "All You needed was a prior auth...the doctor handles this all. Why would you take it upon yourself to call? They would have approved this if it was necessary."

↳ @banon7853 (5): "So if you didn't have Medicare advantage and just had Medicare, would they have done the surgery?"

"I have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D drug plan. I just had my second cataract surgery and Medicare and my Plan N covered completely my Medicare approved costs except for the eye drops which Part D covered. I did have to purchase a set of various eye drops for each cataract surgery using Part D. My copay for each set was \$35. Prior to getting the surgeries, I had conversations with two different people at different times and both were seeking cataract surgery but their insurance companies denied the coverage. Those answers told me that they each had a (Dis)Advantage Plan. When I was turning 65, I chose original Medicare because I wanted to insure against the extreme costs for hospital procedures and stays while avoiding medical debt. That strategy is working well for me by providing healthcare freedom by allowing my physicians and me to determine when surgery is necessary- not an insurance company."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlG&lc=UgzZqekiWnVh-O9gfmJ4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (5): "As a follow up, I checked with a half a dozen major Medicare advantage plans and they don't even require prior authorization for cataract surgery."

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (2): "I'm glad you found what worked well for you. If you don't want to have prior authorization, your best bet is to go with the Medicare supplement for sure. With that said, we have helped over 60,000 people with their Medicare and health insurance and I've never heard of anyone being denied cataract surgery on a Medicare advantage plan."

"I wanted expert advice before I went on Medicare. So I hired a consultant. She call Medicare Advantage Medicare Disadvantage and told me to stay away from it. Why? Because it isn't real Medicare. It's private insurance that can end up making you go bankrupt. So I went with traditional Medicare with Part G supplement. I've never spent a dime out of pocket. Im glad I rejected Advantage. Rye largest hospital in my area announce last year that they were dropping out of Advantage. So have more than half of the areas physicians. This has left a lot of people without good healthcare choices. And I don't live in podunk. I live in a major metropolitan area with a population of over 6 million."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugy-HagNdaMnA1ecAZ14AaABAq>

↳ @memyself9037 (4): "@gurnblanston5000 not if you buy part G. If pays all part A and B deductables."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (2): "Still pay deductibles."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (1): "@memyself9037got it...D was cheaper here even with deductibles."

"I've been getting chemotherapy at my local hospital for a few years and when I turned 65 my mailbox started filling up with Medicare Advantage sales info. When I asked a patient navigator at the hospital about it she said do NOT sign up for an Advantage plan. A Medigap supplement plan is a much better choice for someone who needs frequent therapy and testing."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgyF9H8dZF95IVrAFHd4AaABAq>

"I advise everyone I know: DO NOT get Medicare Advantage. Instead, choose traditional Medicare along with supplemental coverage. Many seniors are lured in by lower premiums, but they often fail to realize that cheaper isn't necessarily better. Once you enter the Medicare Advantage system, it can be nearly impossible to return to traditional Medicare due to the underwriting requirements for obtaining supplemental coverage."

— YouTube · Do I Need Medigap? · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7JMcg_PV4Ns&lc=UgzNfQ_JUymwUAWMbDp4AaABAq

↳ @annefitz7346 (0): "Thx. This confirms what I've heard"

"i advise NOONE to go with advantage plans. ive worked in dr office for 23 years and can tell you "stories" where the client was not educated on what they were getting. granted , there are probably a few clients that an advantage plan in "ok". ive had plan g for 5 yrs since turning 65 ive never seen a bill for anything outside of my premium every month. it is expensive but worth it in long run. you may think you dont need it today, but you never know what is coming "down the road""

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxRkoEC_Bnkc_By0L54AaABAq

"This is so well done. I had 2 financial advisors tell me to suck it up and pay extra for Medigap G if you can afford it. They said folks with less money, ~ less than \$500k invested, should opt to save money with Advantage."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxmuzKsHgMvdeYdTRV4AaABAq>

"I switched to Medicare advantage when they lied to me on the phone and told me all the medications I was taking were covered. MULTIPLE WERE NOT! A year later I switched back to regular Medicare never looking back."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyqXuqZdiY16Hpur3J4AaABAg>

↳ @mscoyote50 (1): "You're lucky. Once you're padt a year, you really can't switch back without underwriting and most of us older people have underlying "conditions"..."

"This is definitely the best discussion I've seen regarding the cost-benefit differences of (Original Medicare + Medigap) vs Medicare Advantage I've ever seen. I wish the government would send this video out each year to new retirees since the later-years "switch-and-bait" of being denied a Medigap policy when your health fails you (intentional??) isn't that clear. Corporations are profit-scraping beasts and no way will "managed" healthcare ever be cheaper than Original Medicare in the long run. When I was 65, I told myself "Yes, it's cheaper now, but when you really need it, Medicare Advantage will take your home". I'm extremely comfortable with the knowledge today that my medical costs will not really increase much if and when my health declines. My mindset has always been to pay a little more now, to pay a lot less later and this has never failed me. EXCELLENT presentation."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz_U0ILpg-QVy8m6FR4AaABAg

"My dr told me to never get MA plan ever"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwfH5qzkkOF25XSqRt4AaABAg>

"Just a caution about switching from an Advantage Plan to A supplement. Make sure your advantage plan is explicitly cancelled or you may end up with both a supplement plan and an advantage plan and no drug plan. This happened to me. United Health automatically enrolled me after I was enrolled in a supplement. But when I tried to enroll in a drug plan, I was denied on the last day of the enrollment period. By the. It was too late to fix. A quirk of the system. Ended up having to get ugly about cancelling the MA plan in January, pay for a month of it and start my drug plan Feb 1. I even had chat records where United Healthcare's reps, 3 of them, told me my MA plan was cancelled. Even had a screenshot one of them shared with me that showed it was cancelled. But come January 1, I was welcomed to a United Healthcare MA plan. I was livid. But there were no options to undo United Healthcare's actions."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgyEXYhFKfZjy5FJf2F4AaABAg>

↳ @afrocraft1 (0): "Sorry about your experience. What did your annual notice of change (ANOC) say? That's the document that matters, not chat logs."

↳ @techadsr (0): "@afrocraft1 The ANOC was received before the enrollment period and before I started enrollment into a Supplement plan away from the Advantage Plan. Why would that matter?"

↳ @lyndayoung8761 (0): "The letter from the Carrier that states they are pulling out of MA in your area is your Golden Ticket to medigap without underwriting. Other changes are business as usual as they morph and jockey about with Extra Benefits and copay costs to get your attention PICK ME, PICK ME"

"My broker told me that with Medigap (supplemental) the doc makes the decisions...Not the insurance company Medicare Advantage...Expect delays while the insurance company figures out how to screw you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_9pWXe1A8BazF6EI4AaABAg

"Yeah u hear lot of bragging from people who have "medical" insurance for life when they retire. What 99% realize is its an Advntge style Plan that isnt worth the paper its printed on when you age and develop chronic or terminal issues. As my GP once told me "Advantage Plans kill more seniors prematurely than the government will admit..."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgxNnTwQw35v8B0SZzh4AaABAg.AWnOouAtyYFAYKCvDmrvDQ>

On supplements: what they were told and what they tell others · 111 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"One thing that stuck out big time was when he said when someone gets sick and others have to handle insurances issues Plan G takes all that away. My wife contracted Granulomatosis with Polyangiitis (GPA) a super rare autoimmune disease that killed her in 12weeks. Genetically she should have had 20 more years to live and was healthy before GPA hit her. Thankfully, we had Plan G. We didn't have to worry about all those pitfalls built into the healthcare system. So she got the best treatment and doctors available. I never saw a single bill only once in a while someone would ask about payment and when they heard Plan G there were no more questions. I never had to worry about that stuff during a horrible time when I was witnessing the disease destroy her from the inside. Medical system doesn't care what is happening to you or your spouse or family members they require payment and that's it. Her costs for that disease had to be millions of dollars and not one bill. There's so much to take care of after someone dies and not having to deal with medical bills and calls made it so much easier."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 45 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzTcf9bSKj33LRsjex4AaABAg>

↳ @randybyrnepersonal (3): "@ChrisRI1000 - very sorry for your loss. I agree with you completely regarding the benefits of Plan G for someone with serious illness(es)."

↳ @nubiareymos3161 (0): "Christ I am sorry for your loss and also need your help with information. I will be 65 years old who two months ago contracted NMOSD which is a degenerative autoimmune disease. I don't have idea of what plan to buy. I was presented Medicare Advantage as the best option for my situation. Under your experience,"

"I was a Medicare sales agent with an FMO and I almost was brainwashed against Medicare Supplements. Thanks to your videos and others that tell the truth about medicare advantage plans, the damage done by that company was reversed. Before I left that company, we were told that they would no longer be offering supplements. That disturbed me but I was still under the spell of the lies, I eventually left the company due to health reasons and now I am glad that I did. The more that I learn the less I am willing to go back to companies that enforce advantage plans and leave out information about supplements. If I could find a company that tells the whole truth about Medicare plans, I would go back into the sales field. I live in Florida and so far I have not found such a creature. So, I have to rely on you for the "truth" because I will be going on Medicare in July. I will be getting a supplement!! Thank you for your honesty. I have learned so much."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgwkxBU32hb6xclsBJR4AaABAg>

↳ @EXPLOREWITHME. (0): "If i give you my email. Could u tell me more info"

"I started on an advantage plan as a person on disability age 60. Well so much was out of network and one lab visit has a bill out of reach. The hospital it was under closed and thankfully they are canceling my plan the end of 25. I was told wrong initially that I couldn't get a plan G, but I can. I'm happier and less stressed now."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlg&lc=UgwecgdAuvPKmqHUMyV4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (2): "Sounds like you made the right choice for you! Good job."

"I'm 68 and have Mutual of Omaha Plan N. I have no complaints. The rate increases are in line with other companies' and their customer service is fantastic. My doctors are all very relieved when I tell them I have MoO Plan N - zero hassles receiving their payment."

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=UgyyacAU9Mv3KSCMkxJ4AaABAg

↳ @christinestephenson1742 (5): "I agree. I have Mutual of Omaha too and very pleased. Had them for 6 years"

↳ @policyguides (3): "Love to hear this, especially how much your doctors appreciate your Plan N!"

↳ @AndyB718 (3): "I have plan G in ny, and the cost this yr is \$1100 every 4 months. It's very good insurance, though, with all excepting it."

"So I stayed with my company plan at \$800 a month which was cheaper than ACA which was 1600 and I'm single! But I'm afraid to leave my company plan because they said if I do I can't come back and use their Medicare supplement when I turn 65. So I feel forced to stay. 😞 "

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyz5Ac7pA&lc=UgxhvxK09UxP7VuTUNR4AaABAg>

↳ @almarble1 (0): "I am in the same boat. It is the penalty of making too much money. But I am glad I can avoid ACA.....works fine for some but a nightmare for others and I worked too long and hard to deal with nightmares at this point in life. Actually, if I did things over, I can't think of anything I would change. I maxed out on non-taxable accounts I could and had no choice but to build up a significant brokerage account that--for better or worse--pays too much for me to get any freebies from the government."

"Just retiring at 72 in a couple months, and I selected Plan N because I do not really go to the dr too often and I was told that excess charges were in fact uncommon. I am going to put the numbers into your spreadsheet and see what I come up with. Thank you for valuable information. (Michigan) Just ran the numbers and it is 15000 cheaper over 20 years (assuming 5 visits a month and hitting my deductible every year - which is perhaps not going to happen because I am quite healthy and active). So could be more."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzUljK0sGCws-yaPjp4AaABAg>

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"Pre-certification on supplemental plan - I was told by several doctors that I had the medical/vision need for a Blepharoplasty process on my right eye. On both the supplemental and the Advantage plan, I had to be prequalified by Medicare. There was a particular Medicare protocol required before I could have the procedure. Worse, the protocol changed and became more strict as time passed. In the long run, I had to find a doctor who had already undergone and passed a Medicare audit of the doctor's past in that procedure before either type plan would pay. So, it's not entire true that pre-certifications are not required in the supplemental plans."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgwCo6Vg-E5MtHPiE_J4AaABAg

↳ @druannpellegrini5661 (3): "Very True. My father had a CT scan and medicare with supplement said it was not necessary. The doctor had to write a letter to medicare. A lot of phone calls and drama. I think my mom just ended up paying for it."

"I tell everyone thinking about this to gat PLAN G and enjoy life. No networks, no denials, no problems.... no worries."

— YouTube · Medicare Experts HATE Advantage Plans! Are they really THAT bad? 🤔 · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9D3l-X5q5Oc&lc=Ugzm61DeKwcoTi7DSY54AaABAq>

↳ @JulianGonzalez1974 (3): "Unfortunately not everyone can afford to pay for Part B, Plan G, DVH and Part D."

↳ @Lysander-Spooner (0): "@JulianGonzalez1974 For 2024 Part D premiums are much lower in most zip codes. Some Plans are \$0.50. While some people have financial limitations they still are paying for Part B even on MA plans. So I would ask them how much they value medical care and find a way to afford a Plan N. I would say do everything you can to avoid MA plans."

"Enjoyed this video. One thing I struggled with is deciding to take a select plan or the regular Plan G. I opted for the select plan because all large hospitals in my state are covered. I was told that if I should need to go JT of state I could change to the regular Plan G at the beginning of each month, but I would never be allowed to go back to the select option. I opted for select plan because it dropped my premium significantly, and my dentist is a "preferred" provider so my I didn't have to worry about the copay. My husband will be going on Medicare in two years. So still trying to evaluate those changes. Unfortunately, I became "disabled". Also found out I would be on Medicare, but several companies would not sell me a supplemental plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=UgyPw5FkMEOfmDbQ6mR4AaABAq>

"My broker told me that with Medigap (supplemental) the doc makes the decisions...Not the insurance company Medicare Advantage..Expect delays while the insurance company figures out how to screw you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_9pWXe1A8BazF6EI4AaABAq

"My oncologist requested a PET Scan to see how the pembrolizumab (Keytruda) and levatinib (Lenvima) medications are working on my metastatic endometrial cancer (tumors have been shrinking, no further metastasis so far, yay) When I called to schedule the scan, the hospital coordinator said, "we'll have to get authorization from insurance". I said that I had Medicare and a Plan G Supplement. She then said, 'NO AUTHORIZATION REQUIRED - we can schedule your scan' I understand the cost of a Supplement is too much for many seniors - I'm blessed to have the resources. I do know that CANCER, with all the treatments, doctor visits, medications is a COMPELLING reason to have a Supplement, if it can be afforded - I'd rather my BOARD-CERTIFIED ONCOLOGIST make decisions about my treatment than an insurance functionary"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgyRQ8qBCSunsvLKmFp4AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareSchool (1): "So glad that you have that coverage for your treatments! Thank you so much for sharing!"

"This was a very comprehensive study into advantage vs medigap and do they their best to try and confuse seniors but clearly medicare advantage is all about making money for the private insurance companies. I was told before I retired to do everything to work medigap into my budget and only go to advantage if money became an issue. I have been on medigap now for 7 years and have yet to pay anything in addition to my premiums and deductibles. Thank you for doing this video for all the seniors just starting out on this journey."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyiLdahXiJLor5uc54AaABAq>

"@12:15 "Medicare underwriting is going to apply" - I don't think that's true this year because those of us who have Advantage plans being terminated (as many are this year) we were told if we switched to to a Supplemental plan (because we're being forced to leave) the underwriting is waived. Can you please confirm or deny this? Thank you."

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans for 2027 — What's Changed? · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hAZ_geBw1Ac&lc=Ugx-fxwRIWcJfc7vXJh4AaABAq

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "You're right - some people will be given guaranteed issue rights for Medigap. I cover that in more depth here:<https://youtu.be/nXXYwC4myaw?si=q-huqyMYNLMQMlloc>";

"My first time with Medicare. I was talking to and IRS chick and got around to SSA. She told me she worked at SSA for 10 years and NOT to get Medicare advantage, go with plan N. Price same this year for Plan N. Medicare went up and took half the COLA. My broker didn't know what plan N was. I had knee replacement no overnight stay. Early surgery, going home by 2 pm. Not one bill for anything, not even the exercise bike. Paid for x-rays at docs office. Never a copay at 4 subsequent visits. If Medicare pays for 20% of a 5 day hospital surgery, plan N picks up the slack to 100%. In 2023 I had lumbar fusion on BCBSTX. I paid \$5000, still paying, but Houston Methodist sent me itemized costs. Not a bill. \$710,000.00. My surgeon had no idea what hospital charged and i sent him that itemized breakdown, wasnt a bill, just EOB and he was blown away by \$53,000 cost of a titanium rod. Now what would happen with Medicare Advantage vs Plan N? I was scared to look it up."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Plan N Worth It? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V64x-sWEALg&lc=UgzBqEPvKG5NsQ5esH94AaABAq>

"My agent of 8 years was surprised when I told him my plan was ending and I was now eligible to buy a medigap plan. He said he would send my some plans to review, but he never did, and did not return my messages. Also, I called an agent I found online and he was so very helpful and nice, but when I explained I had been on Advantage for 8 years, he said oh, in that case, agents won't work with you, they won't get paid. He said I have to call each company to purchase the plan myself. Very strange...it sounds as if the companies are being compensated to take on "Advantage Returners" with the commission normally paid to agents..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxCOhpK38o-jmdlJN4AaABAq.AOs_MoBrGwvAPdBK7fuYgn

"I worked until I was 74 and had a work plan until then. When I looked into using the original plan and a medigap plan I was told that extra plan would cost me \$500/month plus what I was paying for the Medicare insurance. That was and is just not affordable for me. I'm in good health and my drugs are few and generic. I would love to get off the Advantage plan but at this point it I do not have the income to pay that much a month for insurance."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwjoDxA_R0EDQMOTTh4AaABAg

↳ @RG-hf4et (0): "Advantage is better than no plan at all."

"Great info! My daughter is in the medical field, as I approached my 65th birthday a few months ago...I began asking her about medicare options..she said mom just remember plan C stands for "criminal"...that is how she sees Advantage C plan...criminal...that is all I needed to know as I was going with medigap anyways to have the option to go to any doctor in the country I want as I fee thus is essential as I age!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz0_VOA_xQEq_xA6054AaABAg

"What I'm concerned about is that my oncologist told me that she has seen some patients, who are under original Medicare with a Supplement, denied a claim AFTER having a procedure done. Then the patient is responsible for the whole bill! That's really scary! Has anyone experienced that?"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugy-vuLlBPswN_bzRLh4AaABAg

↳ @jonimarshall8313 (2): "Wow I was under the understanding the supplement plan would pick up the 20% that the Medicare's 80% of the bill leaving a 0 balance to patient? I don't understand that. I'm very interested finding out I'm in the middle of making big changes to my insurance plan. I'm absolutely saddened to hear these things happening it just sounds like a trap anyway you go 😞 nightmare"

↳ @luckylewy1628 (1): "If Medicare pays, the Supplement plan pays."

↳ @kirkp_nextguitar (0): "@jonimarshall8313The Medicare Supplement insurer can't deny coverage for a procedure, but CMS (the government office that administers Medicare) can if they decide the procedure wasn't necessary. In that case, the supplement insurer won't cover it either. In the past CMS has been much less aggressive about denying claims than most Medicare Advantage insurers. But that may soon change, as the Trump administration under huckster Dr. Oz have an initiative to increase denial of claims, with a pilot program in some states starting in 2026. <<https://www.cms.gov/priorities/innovation/innovation-models/wiser>>";

On doctors, drugs and networks: what the office and the plan said · 78 documents · 20 voices

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"GLP-1 Bridge Program Info As someone that works in a doctors office and submits PAs, I want to clear up some confusion about the GLP-1 bridge program. I want to start by saying I appreciate that this program will get these meds to many people that need it, but it leaves a lot of Medicare beneficiaries behind. If you have type 2 diabetes, moderate to severe obstructive sleep apnea, or MASH you do NOT qualify to use the program. You have to get a GLP-1 medication approved for those conditions through your Part D plan. Even if the Part D copay is astronomical, you still can't use the bridge program if you have any of those 3 diagnoses. It doesn't matter if the provider doesn't even use those diagnoses and only submits the PA for obesity, you still don't qualify. When we submit the PA, the provider has to attest that you do NOT have those conditions. If the provider selects that you DO have any of them, the system automatically denies it and kicks it back saying it has to go through Part D. You can't get around this if you have these conditions because that would be committing Medicare fraud. I submitted multiple of these PAs today and confirmed this is exactly how it's being processed. You do still qualify if you have mild obstructive sleep apnea and meet the other criteria, because mild OSA isn't covered under Part D, only moderate to severe. This is directly from the CMS website info for prescribers and the PA form that I've linked below. I recommend looking over these because this is exactly the guideline providers are following when submitting these PAs. <https://www.cms.gov/glp-1-bridge.pdf> <https://www.cms.gov/files/document/glp-1-prescribers-c-1.pdf> I hope this information is helpful."

— r/medicare · 74 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ulaona/>

↳ (0): "Super helpful - nice to hear from someone actually submitting the forms. People keep asking agents and that's useless :)"

↳ (0): "Great info & great explanation!"

↳ (0): "The pharmacy tech at the Walmart pharmacy i use, had no idea about the bridge program. Someone else tried to help her figure it out I sent a message to my doctor who responded the paperwork has been submitted and awaiting a response This whole thing feels like a mess. I hope it gets straightened out before the program ends Update: I just got notification from Walmart that my prescription is ready at the \$50 copay!"

"Just about to turn 65, want medicare but it seems no doc wants to take it Im facing much anxiety about this coming decision. I would prefer traditional Medicare because I travel a lot. I asked my doctor if she would accept medicare and she said because I was an existing patient of hers, yes. But not for new patients. Is this common? Makes me wonder about going with medicare"

— r/medicare · 63 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1oe2z6j/>

↳ (0): "Doctors want more money than Medicare feels is reasonable. The source of the conflict may vary by who reads it. Do Doctors want too much? Does Medicare want to pay too little?"

↳ (0): "There are automatic cuts to Medicare reimbursement built in to the law every year to reduce costs. Now because the debt ceiling was raised to pass the BBB, sequestration will result in an ADDITIONAL 4% cut to reimbursement to Medicare providers. Imagine owning a business requiring a high degree of expertise, intensive staffing needs, high overhead, and costs rising higher than inflation while your revenue decreases every year. This is not about doctors wanting "more money". It's about all Medicare providers trying to afford to stay in business."

↳ (0): "In NJ, Medicare is my best payor. Medicare Advantage? My worst..."

"I've had a Medicare plan and a Medicare supplement plan for about 8 years. And the supplement plan pays whatever Medicare doesn't. Minus whatever deductible you choose. Monthly premium has gone up over the years. In some years I may have paid more for the plan than I got in services, but there have been years when it's literally saved me thousands of dollars. So over the time frame I've had it. It's definitely paid for itself not only financially but in not having to worry about having a procedure done. And not needing a pre-authorization. If my doctor says go I go I can go to any doctor. I want anywhere in the nation. Medicare advantage plans are basically private insurance. High deductibles, high rejection of coverage. Pre-qualifications. Looks cheaper on the front end but you're going to lose on the back end. So listen to this man"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 60 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugxfb9YPgrZZhd4mdaR4AaABAg>

↳ @samuelbutterworth4303 (10): "NEVER take advice from someone that makes money from the choices they recommend, like this guy. I have a degree in Economics specializing in social insurance, and an MBA. I've had Supplemental and Advantage insurance plans. I prefer Advantage plans in my area. Zero premium, zero cost family doctor, every medical profession in my city are in network, I've never had any surgery or treatment turned down, my medications are all free except for one high cost brand and that costs me \$45 per month, free dental care, free eye exams and glasses, free hearing and discounted hearing aids. They have a national network of doctors."

↳ @patriciayohn6136 (7): "Absolutely agree with you and my Husband and I did the same thing and not sorry, we went with Supplement G plan. I had to have an emergency major surgery three years ago, spent seven days in hospital and I only had to cover about \$200.00 dollars!!!"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (3): "Don't forget the bigger concern with chronic conditions and surgical needs. Quality of care. This is overlooked by almost everyone that signs up for Advantage Plans. They love the cost vs a supp plan until they need care. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these Advantage Plans."

"This is, hands down, the best video I have ever seen about Medicare insurance plans!! Fantastic job, and thank you! And I hope you recover quickly from your sunburn! BUT... I want to introduce a dimension that I was surprised you did not mention! That is, taking care of yourself! By that, I mean taking nutrition seriously for decades, maintaining an ideal weight, and working out regularly at a gym in old age so you never neglect your body's conditioning!! Now in our mid 70s, my wife and I have been "nutritarian" for 15 years. Nutritarian is a diet developed by Dr. Joel Fuhrman based on a 100% plant-based diet, only far more emphasis on nutrient-density at every meal. No added sugar, no animal products, no dairy, no alcohol, no bread, no added oil, no added salt. Just whatever comes naturally in the fruit, vegetables, nuts, grains, mushrooms, seeds, and sprouts (microgreens) that we eat at every meal. We go to our gym for a vigorous 60 to 80 minute resistance workout every 3 days (plus a 60-minute treadmill cardio workout on some off-days). We maintain ideal weight, take no medications, and my local doctor told me that I have the blood pressure of a healthy 18-year-old. MY POINT is that your own discipline over your peak nutrition and physical conditioning will have an enormous impact over your long-term health! We have a guy at our gym at age 95 still working out!! As Dr. Fuhrman says: "Your genes load the gun. But your diet and lifestyle pull the trigger!" As part of our Advantage plan, our gym enrollment is covered. That is \$100 a month savings for both my wife and myself. We do have a local insurance agent, but if we did not I would reach out to this agent with The Retirement Nerds! What an excellent explanation of all the insurance options! So, don't eat junk! Don't sit around in an easy chair drinking beer! Make peak nutrition your most serious hobby. Grow your own sprouts and microgreens like I do. Don't eat canned beans - instead eat beans you cook yourself from dry beans. We eat 18 kinds of beans I cook weekly in a pressure cooker. I plan to make it to 100+ unless I get hit by a truck! (And if that happens, insurance won't matter.) Best wishes!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzq9b4ySEEjBX1HcUh4AaABAg>

↳ @norsemythos1438 (4): "Interesting story. I tend to agree with the concept...but in practice... eating only rabbit food and living to 100? I wonder if im better off enjoying the simple things and dying at 88."

↳ @flyshacker (3): "@norsemythos1438 Your choice! Remember, nearly all the things people call "old age" are really just neglect. Get your cremation and other final expenses paid for, and you're all set! I'll keep exercising, living longer, and I'll collect the gov't benefits you would have received. Fine with me!"

↳ @frankhodge7654 (1): "@flyshacker No matter what you eat, old age effects are very real. We were born with a guarantee of death. No one can live forever except in fantasies. We don't usually know our end date, but we all have one. Rabbit food for life is not a very enjoyable option."

"For those on low income...my primary doctor advised me on Dec 7th I saw him and he said go home call Medicare, get on Original Medicare and Medicaid...I did...only other thing I had to do was choose a prescription program...which cost nothing for me, perhaps the same for you....I was a foster care mom for decades...now retired..."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgwWguYVkcHmce3F3GB4AaABAg>

↳ @wamich4 (0): "Sign of a good Dr. My Dr said the same thing to me. Although I will not be on Medicare till April next year."

↳ @danielfeather8314 (0): "Well, get on medicaid with an advantage plan, and you will get a lot more benefits."

↳ @danielfeather8314 (0): "You would be crazy not too"

"I'm 68 and have Mutual of Omaha Plan N. I have no complaints. The rate increases are in line with other companies' and their customer service is fantastic. My doctors are all very relieved when I tell them I have MoO Plan N - zero hassles receiving their payment."

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=UgyyacAU9Mv3KSCMkxJ4AaABAg

↳ @christinestephenon1742 (5): "I agree. I have Mutual of Omaha too and very pleased. Had them for 6 years"

↳ @policyguides (3): "Love to hear this, especially how much your doctors appreciate your Plan N!"

↳ @AndyB718 (3): "I have plan G in ny, and the cost this yr is \$1100 every 4 months. It's very good insurance, though, with all excepting it."

"I'm in Florida too and in my early years I didn't have health insurance. I had to go to the hospital for surgery and the bill came to nearly 100k. When I was being discharged, they were wheeling me towards the front door and suddenly veered off and went to the business office. They were demanding some sort of payment and also wanted me to sign papers saying I would pay the entire bill. I told them that I was still medicated and under doctors orders so I couldn't legally sign anything. My wife came in , very pissed off, and took me out of there. When they called a few days later I told them that I wanted an itemized bill. They argued with me and I told them that I knew that hospital bills are works of fiction and that I wanted the same discount that the insurance companies get. They knocked the bill down to \$6,000 and I told them I would send \$100 a month. After paying for 6 months I called them back and asked what it would take to pay it off. They agreed on \$1,500 and I sent them a check and they marked it paid in full. Of course now I'm on Medicare and have a supplement plan but anyone who's younger should remember that you can always negotiate."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxiY&lc=UgypslzdYHmZ7b1sgQJ4AaABAg_A8bQ-ZobSDuA8cVBGRqKWQ

"Pre-certification on supplemental plan - I was told by several doctors that I had the medical/vision need for a Blepharoplasty process on my right eye. On both the supplemental and the Advantage plan, I had to be prequalified by Medicare. There was a particular Medicare protocol required before I could have the procedure. Worse, the protocol changed and became more strict as time passed. In the long run, I had to find a doctor who had already undergone and passed a Medicare audit of the doctor's past in that procedure before either type plan would pay, So, it's not entire true that pre-certifications are not required in the supplemental plans."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgwCo6Vg-E5MtHPiE_J4AaABAg

↳ @druannpellegrini5661 (3): "Very True. My father had a CT scan and medicare with supplement said it was not necessary. The doctor had to write a letter to medicare. A lot of phone calls and drama. I think my mom just ended up paying for it."

"Similar experience, also in California. It does vary greatly by state. As he said, the provider matters greatly too. The insurer I had for my Plan G started raising premiums way more than the average in his chart so I was able to save almost 23% by switching insurers."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgxFO8gB1kSYlvEYWex4AaABAg.9xEF30XDZ7G9xEFwsLrYle>

"Make sure to ask your insurance company that your radiology centers are in network. Even if the hospitals are in network it doesn't mean the stand alone radiology facilities could be Out of network. They will tell you yes you can go there but they FAIL to TELL you that they are out of network so your copay in my instance was almost tripled Makes no sense to say the hospitals in network but not the stand alone radiology facilities. My Insurance starts with a Hum !! I'm disabled can't drive anymore and they told me the closest place in network is a 50munte drive from my house and they only do 2 of my test. Then I'll have to get a ride in the complete opposite direct in another State which is 55 miles from my house Always get the NPI# to all your doctors,hospitals,radiology centers,etc and then ask your insurance if they're all in network If not in my situation I'll pay almost triple the copay cost. Why would the hospitals be in network with the NPI# but not the exact same NPI for all their stand alone radiology centers??? This should be illegal!!!!!! People don't know to ask if the stand alone radiology is in network. They just ask do they take my insurance. They respond yes but the FAIL to tell you they're out of network so you pay a higher co pay and it's impossible to even find a in network place at least where I live"

— YouTube · 3 Medicare Changes for 2027 - and how to prepare. #medicare · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GxBa9kBx5cY&lc=Ugwc_ITLY_2MzR4qqyN4AaABAg

"I'm eligible for medicare on 1/1/21 when I turn 65. This stuff was confusing as all get out. I almost was going to get an advantage plan until I saw your video. They told me i could see my own doctor with an advantage plan which was not entirely true. So I'm going with a medigap supplement plan because you made such a great video outlining the differences. Many thanks!!"

— YouTube ·  Medicare Advantage vs Medigap - Which to Choose? · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rS1cTsTcA8&lc=UgykldJy2e0PPAyNypp4AaABAg>

↳ @johnscott2746 (1): "Please be aware that the cost/benefit ratio for supplement plans is horrendous. The average person indecent health will never come close to justifying the cost of one of these plans. Medical bills are divided into two parts. Hospital charges, which are usually the bulk of the charges are covered under Part A with a single deductible of \$1484 (for 2021). The doctors and equipment charges are covered under Part B. And while there is no cap on your copays with Part B, Medicare typically approves about 17 cents on the dollar. So , charges of \$20,000 would be reduced to \$3400 and your copay would be \$680. Paying massive amounts up front for these policies on the off chance you might have a medical issue is folly. Most people would be better served by putting away the money they would have spent for premiums into a savings account and using it to take care of their out of pocket expenses themselves."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (0): "That's a good choice. Let me know if I can help! -Keith"

"Over here in Puerto Rico 🇵🇷 , I'm in good health, but the advantage plan, tries forcing you to visit a network doctor, I tell them I'm in good health, I'll go to a doctor, when I'm feeling sick etc"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugzg7RmeU7o68Xo63FJ4AaABAg>

"Great info! My daughter is in the medical field, as I approached my 65th birthday a few months ago...I began asking her about medicare options..she said mom just remember plan C stands for "criminal"...that is how she sees Advantage C plan...criminal...that is all I needed to know as I was going with medigap anyways to have the option to go to any doctor in the country I want as I fee thus is essential as I age!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz0_VOA_xQEg_xA6054AaABAg

"Pennsylvania I have 72 my plan G is 169.00 and my prescription plan is 44.50. I take no medications iam 100% healthy. This is all okay with me because I don't have to worry going bankruptcy. I have a piece of mind. If or when I need it I don't have to put up with no insurance company. When the doctor says I need it I get it"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans I Plan G vs Plan N vs GHD Explained! · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1zJcNnyGW_w&lc=UgwctUg8uPvrwpPnk5J4AaABAg

↳ @BarryWeaver-pv6cz (0): "great rates...Mine oiver gte border in NY are over \$100 more"

"The last 5 years I worked before actually retiring I had to provide my own health insurance the first year where I worked. I used the subsidies like you and paid approximately what you are. In my case it was 180 dollars per month since I'm single. I was earning 15 dollars an hour. I was working 2 jobs. I also had really cheap places to live. We were unionized too thank goodness. When the year was up I got the union healthcare for \$5 a week plus I was on part a of Medicare. The employer had a huge amount of employees so you can do what I'm talking about. I am a retired paralegal and nurse. In addition I have vision problems that caused me to have cataract issues. I had to have them removed from both eyes in my late 50s. I also went completely blind in both eyes for 6 weeks. Some vision came back in 1 eye. I was disqualified from disability because 1 eye functions pretty well. At any rate my vision problems are considered a medical condition. The good news is my doctor tells me my condition has stabilized and I now qualify for low vision benefits. Most of those I would have to pay for out of pocket so I just go along the best I can with what I have. I'm allowed to drive and restrict myself to daytime driving. I go to discount eyeglass providers and pay about 50% less than I would if I went to my doctor for eyeglasses. When I retired I went from health insurance plus pt A Medicare to Medicare and a high deductible medigap plan. I was able to keep health insurance plus pt A Medicare until 67 because my store had a huge amount of employees and had somewhat decent health insurance thru the union. Because of this loophole I was entitled to keep my \$5 dollar a week health insurance until I retired at 67. I am now 73. My retirement age was 66. I eventually added dental insurance I figure if I need implants I can be a dental tourist and get them done abroad if I need to. So far my blood pressure has come down into the normal range now that I'm not working as well. And I've not had to take any medication for my blood pressure. Yay! I'm just taking care of myself. Now mind you this is also because I'm exceptionally frugal. I live on 21k and save 5k a year. Furthermore at the age of 72 I came into a nestegg of 325k from 2 individuals in my life and my own savings. My family left me the 325k. I've not had to touch a nickel of it. And since the 21k is technically my only source of income I owe zero dollars in taxes. Bonus for me 😊😊 . I pay 825 dollars a month in rent and have a small 20 pound dog. My best friend bought my house outright and rents it to me. It is 850 sq ft of heaven. I live in a home built in 1950 that is constantly undergoing renovations. And I live a very simple modest lifestyle. My neighborhood is a working class neighborhood in a downtown area. I live in a wealthy county outside a large metropolitan city. My city has a population of 100k approximately. It is peaceful and quiet. Yes when you are pricing out your healthcare check out both federal and state laws."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugz860t4k73bl5uGt_x4AaABAg_AazTRSBtvmuAazs91Tvqjh

"Unknowingly Had Other Health Insurance For One Month I feel like I'm in a bit of a pickle. Full story here, tl;dr at end: Last year I aged out of my parents' insurance (TRICARE) and began to pay out of pocket for a separate "Young Adult" plan they offer. I have been using this insurance regularly to help diagnose and treat a few different issues, and up until now there hasn't been much issue. A few weeks ago one of my providers urgently reached out to me because TRICARE began denying claims and trying to recoup payments with the belief that I had an undeclared OHI. After some conflicting phone calls, I found out they thought I had Aetna - which my Father (same name and address) has under his employer, but which I am NOT covered under - so I asked TRICARE to remove it and they said "sure thing, everything should be cleaned up after ten business days" (paraphrasing of course). The bad coverage showed up in the portal, but it was lacking an expiration date while saying it was expired, *and* some of the phone agents couldn't see it, so it looked like a bug or an erroneous record they'd need to clean up. Problem solved. In the meantime, my various providers kept receiving letters about recoupment and thus kept reaching out to me, and I'd tell them it was taken care of already and that I just needed to wait those ten days. Well... one of those providers dug deeper and reached out to Aetna directly, who told them that I had coverage from January to end of June (!). I discovered that my Dad had accidentally enrolled the family in Aetna in January when he had meant to enroll one family member in a dental plan; when he got billed for it in February, he realized his mistake and canceled the plan. I seem to have been automatically included in that plan because I am under 26, and Aetna seemingly didn't officially end my coverage until end of June. So now I have no idea how to navigate this. I don't know the terms of the Aetna coverage, who I would talk to on their end, or if they'll accept the claims, *or* if they'll try to bill my Dad for March-June if I DO try to file with them. And now that I do know I technically had Aetna, I don't know if TRICARE will honor the claims from that period, which is particularly frustrating to potentially have to pay for a mistake that I did not make and did not know about until a few weeks ago (if the roles were reversed, TRICARE almost assuredly would not refund me for the months I paid them). If neither plan pays, then by my estimate I might owe one provider almost \$2600 for service from March-June. If Aetna is able to correct their date to match end of coverage with my Dad terminating the plan it would be *very* convenient, but I have no idea if this is possible or who I would talk to. Any ideas? Am I overthinking it? tl;dr Dad accidentally enrolled me in one month of his work insurance, which did not officially end for six months, and now my primary insurance wants to recoup as many claims as possible"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wm5b4u/unknowingly_had_other_health_insurance_for_one/

↳ The-Big-Play (4): "It sounds like these claims need to get billed to Aetna asap. Ask your provider to submit each claim to Aetna as your primary insurance. After Aetna finalizes the claims, the Aetna EOBs will need to be forwarded to TRICARE. Even if Aetna denies their claims, the EOBs will need to be sent to TRICARE. Then TRICARE can reprocess their claims."

↳ aldousfoxly (2): "Thank you! Will get on it"

↳ aldousfoxly (2): "Mess is a good way to put it. Still worried there's going to be an unexpected bill but if the solution is to get them all on the same page, hopefully it turns out alright. Getting confirmation from Aetna sounds like a good idea too. Thank you for your reply, I appreciate it"

"I enrolled on Medicare part B at 70 due to I had HSA account and company had a 1,700 employees . Prior that I and my company stopped contribution to my HSA 1 Year so that I don't have to face with the penalty ! I wanted to be Medicare supplement and Medicare part D as needed while United healthcare associates tokd me very high deductible rather Medicare advantage with free doctor visit and drugs! Now I am the first time gi to family doctor in network, they said he was out of network and given to me a list doctor in network, additional i have to pay deductible drug up to \$2000 per year before the plan pays me ! Hell nó! They told me one way then do other at the beginning enrolling ! Now I was upset about it ! That's why a United healthcare CEO got killed past years in New York (i remember)! Ervin do you have any idea ? And Can I switch to Medicare supplement in 2027 . I just retired at April 2026! Thanks"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugw7uVI2hc5qZkKoSBx4AaABAg.AU3ooa-Gm8NAZJt1HChqMd>

"I wanted an advantage plan but they lock you into one doctor ,I like freedom to tell your doc to kick rocks if they're no good."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Vs. Medicare Supplement - An Unbiased Comparison · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EXNLA6j2x0M&lc=Ugz42Uz3kQKW272nslx4AaABAg.94-Bine9Ypp9AN0X-9-UJm>

"@rickarmstrong9660 i'm glad you think you found the plan that would work best for you, but it doesn't sound like you had a very good advantage plan if it was going to cost you thousands of dollars. When I had my bypass I was in the hospital for 13 days and I only had to pay \$1,500 out of 13 days and hundreds of blood tests, the surgery, doctors, and all preparations for my surgery. This was way back in 2014 under a Humana plan. However, when I went through breast cancer I did have to pay quite a bit more because of my out of pocket cap was quite high. Then I switched to a better advantage plan with a much lower out-of-pocket max just for that reason. This is why you've got to do your research on all of these advantage plans and talk directly to that company - not a sales rep like they advertise on tv. I was in the hospital for one day this past year and only had to pay \$80 for several heart screening tests, labs, ER and this included the overnight stay. I pay no monthly premiums on hospital, doctor care or my part D drugs. All of my drugs so far are 100% covered for heart and cancer that I have to take. I have 100% coverage on antibiotics such as tetracycline (try finding a plan that covers that expensive drug!). My cap is \$2,900 at most for any out of pocket expense including if I were to get a new cancer and need treatment. As I said before, the only disadvantage to these advantage plans would be if you should have major hospitalization outside of your network. So if you are a person that travels or lives elsewhere outside of your hometown like a snowbird does, it may not be a very good plan for you especially if you're a sickly person. The advantage to an advantage plan is you don't pay a supplemental or Medigap fee that you may not use all year or even for years. So you might think you're covered, but if nothing happens, it's money wasted each month. To me it's like having a premium for medicare. It's kinda like these so called car insurance deals that you pay each month in case your car breaks down. How often does a car break down? (Unless you don't take care of it) It's better to have your money saved for these things. I make sure my hospital cap limit is saved, so I feel totally reassured and covered with my advantage plan."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BeBQ04cKzJc&lc=UgyCB7xZ-Cm83SApCAt4AaABAg.9T0QVvqoXZa9USot7KatjL>

'Do your own homework, read the fine print' · 52 documents · 20 voices

"LEAVE advantage plan OR RISK YOUR LIFE. WARNING: Medicare Advantage Plans Can Delay Care With No Consequences Please read this carefully—your health and your life could depend on it. I just found this out on Friday after speaking with an attorney. If you have a Medicare Advantage plan, you are NOT protected if your insurance company delays your care in bad faith—and right now, you have no legal recourse. I found this out the hard way. UnitedHealthcare's algorithm delayed my cancer treatment for five months. When I first found a lump in my neck, my cancer was stage one. By the time I was finally able to get treatment, it had progressed to stage three. Five months lost. Five months where the cancer spread. Now, I am left with irreversible side effects and a permanently diminished quality of life. These are facts. It's public knowledge if you do the research. I recently spoke with an attorney who confirmed my worst fear: Because of a 2023 Supreme Court upheld with the ruling listed bellow. You CANNOT sue a Medicare Advantage provider for delaying your care for BAD FAITH. The law was made in 2023. (The California Supreme Court's decision in Quishenberry v. UnitedHealthcare) -2022 Read that again. They can delay your treatment for as long as they want. They can deny and restrict access to life-saving care. And you have NO legal way to hold them accountable. If I had traditional Medicare or a standard insurance plan, I may have been protected. But under Medicare Advantage, patients have no rights when insurance companies prioritize profits over their lives. And if you think this is an accident, think again. These companies are making billions from Medicare Advantage while rationing care and exploiting legal loopholes that shield them from responsibility. Look up how much they've profited—while patients like me suffer the consequences. It's public record. You have until March 31st to switch back to straight Medicare if you are currently enrolled in an Advantage plan. Do your research before it's too late. I am looking into a class-action lawsuit, and I will be writing to my state senator—because this is criminal. No one should be forced to endure what I have. Please—share this information. Protect yourself. Protect your loved ones. The system is rigged, and right now, patients are paying the price!!!"

— r/medicare · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jcgwz2/>

↳ (0): "I have Stage IV cancer with Original Medicare and Medigap. Everything has been covered with no issues since my diagnosis. Your experience is a nightmare and echos what I've heard from other cancer patients. Some patients have no issue with Medicare Advantage but some experiences have put people's lives in jeopardy and I applaud you for telling your story."

↳ (0): "Are your bills higher? New to Medicare and need brain surgery. Soon. I was going to pick an advantage plan due to medical bills, seeming like they would be lower with advantage versus medigap. But now I'm thinking, after this post and your comment,for my current situation medigap would be smarter. This is all so confusing to me. Any advice I'd appreciate. Thank you."

↳ (0): "With our medigap G we only pay the \$257 deductible per year. Our monthly medigap plan cost my husband \$160 per month. He has lymphoma and gets ct scans 2x per year, pt scans, mri, specialists, all at no extra charge and no hassle. Unless you are healthy and don't need more than a physical once per year, I would recommend traditional Medicare and the medigap G."

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

↳ (0): "You need to consider the monthly insurance premium for the Medicare supplement, too. One reason many people sign up for MA is that they cannot afford the supplement premiums. Everyone pays the monthly Part B premiums, then on top of that, they may pay a monthly supplement premium, if they sign up for a supplement, and they will have drug insurance (Part D) premium, which they should sign up for even if they do not take medications now, to avoid paying a penalty later. If they sign up for MA, rather than a supplement, some MA plans, but not all, have a monthly premium. Drugs are included with MA plans."

↳ (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm making a file and adding new info as I go along. It's overwhelming!"

↳ (0): "5. The amount of commission an agent gets varies extremely from plan to plan, company to company, etc. Not set in stone at all like the numbers you have listed"

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want an insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

"What Needs to be said in these videos is yes all plan G's have to cover the same things that is true, what is missing is you need to be careful about which plan G you are looking at and by that I mean if a plan G is cheaper than the rest look at why, you will find they likely have a vary small percentage of the market which also means if they get hit with a lot of claims they could drop out leaving you without coverage. Are you going to have to go through a medical review to pick a new Plan G and if you have medical issues will you be denied? Don't shop on price, paying a little more for your Plan G with a company that has a larger market share and has stability to spread the costs of claims might be your best choice."

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans - What's Changed for 2026 · 20 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qQtzKellvypk&lc=UgwnRtaUM_9aYtlQaAB4AaABAq

↳ @bobjender863 (0): "A couple nuances....if you have an HSA you cannot use those funds for any supplement plan premiums. You can use HSA funds to pay for out of pocket expenses. If you have 5-10 times today's max out of pocket in your HSA for the HDG, it would be perfectly reasonable to save the money on the premiums and go with the HDG. I think you'll also find the premiums for the HDG will have significantly lower plan increases. Lower % increases from a significantly lower starting point."

"I have an excellent MA plan. Never take anyone's advice until you do the research for yourself. Different plans are available in different zip codes. I have max out of pocket \$5,000 which I have never met, even when I had cancer surgery and chemo with multiple CT and MRI'S in 2021. No premium. Best cancer treatment center in my state. Have had the insurance for 8 years. Never had any procedure denied. Do your own research."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyX3i-SNVhtfygRmJl4AaABAq

↳ @777z ecol (5): "I have to agree with you. I have a MA plan and have never paid anything for it for the past 6 years. Have not encountered any deductible or copay issues. I receive dental benefits and vision benefits worth thousands of dollars and I receive a quarterly \$60 benefit to cover non-prescription related medical expenses such as OTC meds, bandages, etc. I also received a silver sneakers gym membership at no cost."

↳ @user-jb6cd1kn3t (2): "Which MA plan do you have and in which county and state if you don't mind sharing 😊 "

↳ @AriesRising4444 (0): "@user-jb6cd1kn3t New Mexico. Presbyterian Senior Care. HMO plan with rx."

"First, I'd suggest that those complaining about their Medicare Advantage plans ask for the plan's explanation of benefits and explanation of coverage before they sign up. A lot of what's being stated here is not true, and I've been on Advantage plans for more than 12 years. Also, this site is largely for Californians. Medicare Advantage plan coverage can change dramatically by state. In short, do your homework and don't ever use a broker. They receive compensation from a provider and may recommend a plan that only benefits the broker. Lastly, understand the Medicare Supplement rules. Once you leave a Supplement plan, preexisting conditions are not covered. With Advantage plans, they are."

— YouTube · 6 BIGGEST Medicare Changes in 2027!! IMPORTANT 📢 · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1a0lVireAKg&lc=UgzVS2h2Np-DpkSvixB4AaABAg>

↳ @guzzi95 (1): "No difference because if you go out of your Network, you are going to have an out of pocket Expense. It could be up to \$9,000 dollars this year. Last year it was \$8,850 dollars. I went from United Health to Blue Cross with no worries about my Pre-Condition Illness. I guess it depends on who you talk to."

↳ @CalHealth-Insurance (1): "Thanks Alan! You make some excellent points. Medicare Advantage plans can vary significantly by state, county, carrier, and provider network. Here in California, they can work very well for many people, particularly in larger metropolitan areas with strong provider networks. Choosing between Medicare Advantage and Medigap really comes down to the individual's healthcare needs, preferred doctors and hospitals, prescription coverage, travel needs, budget, and comfort with out-of-pocket costs. Both can be excellent options for the right person. You're also absolutely right that people should look beyond the monthly premium and carefully review things like the maximum out-of-pocket limit, deductibles, copays, drug coverage, provider networks, and prior-authorization requirements before enrolling. At CalHealth, our goal is to help each person understand their options and choose the coverage that fits them best. It's also important to work with a broker who presents the available options objectively rather than steering someone toward a particular type of plan based on compensation. What state are you in?! Thank you so much for the comment and support!!! We appreciate it!!!"

↳ @Susie-f7s8n (0): "U right this man is lieing"

"I have Medicare part A, B, D and supplemental part F. I have no copay or deductible. I'm covered 100%. No matter what state, or what facility I go to. Supplemental coverage is standardized. Many Advantage plans charge the same or more than what I pay for my Supplemental, yet cover a lot less. Be smart and do your research. It won't be easy, but it must be done. Good thing is, if you like your plan you don't have to change it every year."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Vs. Medicare Supplement - An Unbiased Comparison · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EXNLA6j2x0M&lc=Ugw46wZTcOhJWhKqagJ4AaABAg>

↳ @jamesebola1250 (4): "@jungleno. Right...they also don't pay much in time of need. Why do you think Medicare pushed these plans off to 3rd parties? Like the saying goes "You get what you pay for". Good luck!"

↳ @jungleno. (2): "Many Medicare Advantage plans do not charge any premium at all!"

↳ @gw3598 (0): "You are/were very smart."

"Just some clarification on medicare parts A & B. If you begin drawing social security even if you continue working you will automatically be enrolled in part A. You don't pay for part A so no big deal. I started drawing SS when I reached FRA (full retirement age) at 66 1/2 and I continued working full time. Because I have credible health insurance coverage through my employer with benefits and a premium that's competitive with and in most instances much better than either Medigap or Medicare Advantage plans available under Part B, I opted to defer enrollment into part B of medicare. Furthermore my insurance through my employer is primary over Medicare B coverage anyway and covers everything I need so no sense paying for extra insurance I would never use or need as long as I have credible coverage. You just need to do your research and decide what's best for your circumstance."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwPvGltRq28reGxZNZ4AaABAg>

↳ @akontilis1792 (1): "I was wondering about that automatic enrollment into Medicare Part A. Why is that? And, why was it assigned an effective of 6 months earlier than the first Social Security check?"

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"I am on both regular Medicare and Medicaid. Blue Cross has been pushing me to join their "combined" plan but the fine print says they get control over what either pays. I have said no twice and they keep calling and sending me their packets. Not signing away my rights."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugz1mVBnskyMjmfSryF4AaABAg>

"Most of these stories are made up by those selling those supplement plans. The MA plans MUST cover EVERYTHING that original Medicare does BY LAW! In more than 15 years on a MA plan we have NEVER been turned down for ANY care covered by Medicare or the .A plan! There are rules these plans MUST go by. Several times my MA plan has even gone out of network for me and paid the ENTIRE cost even though I would have had a copay in network. If you can't read your plan, please have someone else read and explain it to you. I call CMS first if I expect a problem. If my MA plan doesn't have a supplier within a reasonable distance, they have gone out of network. At one point Walmart optical refused to sell me the transition lens for the plans agreed upon price so I purchased the glasses anyway but complained vigorously and they sent me out of network to purchase another complete glasses both frames and lenses and paid the entire 420 dollars!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwEXrTu6t2HMPv_to14AaABAg_9uY6DRxXShU9wBQpmFLuNW

"Got a flier in the mail last week from a well known insurance provider touting their Advantage plan covered dentures and hearing aids but as I looked closer I saw that required participation in the plan for 3-5 years first. Also there was an asterisk by the plan name and in very fine print at the bottom of the flier was the statement that the the policy's availability was based on the insurance provider renewing its contract with Medicare. Which I took to mean the the policy could be canceled by the insurance company simply by the insurance company not renewing its annual contract with Medicare."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgwZlvIUQ0P-r-oh0DI4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (3): "Always read the fine print :-)"

↳ @commonsense6967 (2): "@1m2rich If you're healthy and generally on no meds, it makes no sense to NOT choose a 4 or 5 star MA. I'm pretty happy with mine. So far for 5 years now."

↳ @1m2rich (1): "Advantage plan profitable for private insurance corp. You pay a lot for rehab, etc when needed. Advantage insurance is private insurance not Medicare. They call it Medicare but it isn't. If you have Advantage and want to leave you can't have pre existing conditions, etc. They are trying to get American seniors off Medicare for insurance corporation profits. Lie? Yes. More and more seniors think advantage is good when it is not. They spend a lot of money advertising on TV. That should be a clue."

"I've read the following will prevent you from switching back to a medigap plan: ALS (Lou Gehrig disease), asthma, cancer, COPD, end stage renal, diabetes, stroke, congestive heart failure, among others. People choose advantage plans to save money, but if you get seriously ill, you have lots more financial exposure than on the medigap plans, and probably can't afford the much much higher MOOP. (max out of pocket) Me, I just turned 64, love to travel, am really healthy "right now", have a corporate funded advantage plan option, not sure what I'll do yet, leaning to plan 'n' with a plan 'd' (Maybe a plan 'g' with 'hd' depending upon rates in my state. (unless my corporate plan 'c' PPO is better than expected.) Hope to figure out which option is right for me over the next 9-12 months. Lots to learn!!! Good luck all."

— YouTube · Unhappy with Medicare Advantage? How to Leave Your Advantage Plan for Original Medicare · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5h5ErGtBYLQ&lc=UgxPzPQ6dHnng653FJx4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Great insight. Thanks for watching and commenting! Please call us anytime for assistance (888-465-9728) 😊 "

"Honestly I had UHC and it was the best insurance I've had. I had a PPO plan with choice plus network and never had to fight for a PA approval. Never had issues with in network vs out of network. I've had Aetna and BCBS before as well. Those two though I didn't use nearly as much as my UHC. UHC had 5 surgeries on and extensive imaging and medications with 2 hospital stays. 0 problems. The one thing I can suggest though is READ your plan forwards and backwards side to side up and down diagonal. lol you get the idea. Everything you're curious about is in all that boring paperwork."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wmcm76/company_is_switching_from_blue_cross_to_united/pb9clj4/

"Agreed!! I did medical billing before retirement and I'm a firm believer regular Medicare with a supplemental backup is the way to go. I could never understand people's fascination with the very inappropriately named "Medicare Advantage " Plans!! Only Medicare should use that name!! Too confusing for us seniors!! Beware and read fine print. Medicare Advantage IS NOT Medicare!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwD08-TMWD3-KfvSI54AaABAg_AMXqZTH3orDAMaQg3qSUJP

"@rickarmstrong9660 i'm glad you think you found the plan that would work best for you, but it doesn't sound like you had a very good advantage plan if it was going to cost you thousands of dollars. When I had my bypass I was in the hospital for 13 days and I only had to pay \$1,500 out of 13 days and hundreds of blood tests, the surgery, doctors, and all preparations for my surgery. This was way back in 2014 under a Humana plan. However, when I went through breast cancer I did have to pay quite a bit more because of my out of pocket cap was quite high. Then I switched to a better advantage plan with a much lower out-of-pocket max just for that reason. This is why you've got to do your research on all of these advantage plans and talk directly to that company - not a sales rep like they advertise on tv. I was in the hospital for one day this past year and only had to pay \$80 for several heart screening tests, labs, ER and this included the overnight stay. I pay no monthly premiums on hospital, doctor care or my part D drugs. All of my drugs so far are 100% covered for heart and cancer that I have to take. I have 100% coverage on antibiotics such as tetracycline (try finding a plan that covers that expensive drug!). My cap is \$2,900 at most for any out of pocket expense including if I were to get a new cancer and need treatment. As I said before, the only disadvantage to these advantage plans would be if you should have major hospitalization outside of your network. So if you are a person that travels or lives elsewhere outside of your hometown like a snowbird does, it may not be a very good plan for you especially if you're a sickly person. The advantage to an advantage plan is you don't pay a supplemental or Medigap fee that you may not use all year or even for years. So you might think you're covered, but if nothing happens, it's money wasted each month. To me it's like having a premium for medicare. It's kinda like these so called car insurance deals that you pay each month in case your car breaks down. How often does a car break down? (Unless you don't take care of it) It's better to have your money saved for these things. I make sure my hospital cap limit is saved, so I feel totally reassured and covered with my advantage plan."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgyCB7xZ-Cm83SApCA4AaABAg_9T0QVvqoXZa9USot7KatjL

"As I see it,the main risk of a Medicare Advantage plan vs traditional Medicare,is for Medicare Advantage, the incentive the private insurance company has to limit care for you and it's costs.In other words,they are prepaid and make the most money if you never use,receive any care and if they can figure out a way to limit the care you receive.On the other hand,with traditional govt Medicare,the providers get paid when you actually seek care.So,the more care they provide,the more money they make.The opposite of Medicare Advantage.So,I believe you must read the Evidence of Coverage for whatever Medicare Advantage plan you are checking and the govt's star rating.Finally,Medicare Advantage probably works best for those beginning Medicare and not needing much care.Later,when you're older,needing more care,move to traditional Medicare and supplement."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=Ugz8wYuHQ3nkK8y5Ezd4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "Very good points. It's also important to keep in mind that for those who may want to move to traditional Medicare plus a Medigap plan when they are older, they will likely need to pass through medical underwriting in order to qualify for the Medigap/Medicare Supplement Plan. Thanks so much for watching!"

"I was able to keep my Union group plan when I retired. I have Medicare part A. My premium for my private insurance is about the same as Part B but then I would need to get a gap plan and drug plan making it a lot more expensive. The main reason I stayed with the private co is they cover a lot of things Medicare does not and those happen to be things that I need. If you have any private insurance which meets your needs and you can keep it, do your homework, but you will most likely be better off with private co. In the last 32 yrs my insurance has paid out over \$400,000 in benefits for me, my co pays have been about \$30,000."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyqTX5E7sfVkvq3NER4AaABAg>

"After getting a Medicare supplement plan I added a dental plan. I was paying monthly premiums of about 120\$ for my wife and I. That plan said they would pay for dental expenses anywhere in the world. They did not say the dental office in that other country had to fill out paper work. Well I had an excellent dentist in Mexico who told me they do not fill out any paper work. So I cancelled that dental plan and saved 1300\$. A portion of which pays for annual cleaning and checkup of 100\$ for each of us. I get to pocket 1100\$ and use it towards a nice vacation in Mexico. Do your research people and always re-evaluate every year."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgzopCvHJF1ts3UUENJ4AaABAg>

"It's a puzzle alright. Thank you for being willing to help us thread the maze. Part D was never an issue for me in the past because I didn't need medication except on rare occasions.... Now, it is different when there are meds one needs to live. It is shameful that OUR government makes it so damned complicated....especially for seniors or those who don't have easy access to the internet. Your honest help is so very much appreciated in these difficult times. Thank you!! ."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Drug Plans: Two Things You NEED to Know · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANgeD3oOJ40&lc=Ugw699m5rMTxVobMLqV4AaABAg>

What the agent or broker told them · 34 documents · 20 voices

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want a insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

"Anyone else not having fun anymore? I work at/partially own a smaller independent agency here in the Midwest with my dad and brother. I've been doing this for 14 years now and boy, the past 12 months has sucked. We only have 4 agents but I think the last time I checked our total written premium we were at \$9m so we're doing alright. We're pretty evenly split between personal and commercial and are really lucky to have a big selection of companies. * Travelers, Progressive, Nat Gen, Safeco, Hartford AARP, Auto Owners, Cincinnati, Philly, Nationwide, Openly, Stillwater, and probably a dozen specialty and mutual companies. I'm sure I'm forgetting a couple. I'm fully aware we got it better than most. Even still, this isn't really fun anymore. Especially on the personal side of things. I know we're not FL or TX but my god is it getting tough to shop people around. That's kinda our whole thing. We've always prided ourselves on being honest, upfront, actually answering the phones when folks call in, and trying to do what's best for the customer even if that means less commission. Us agents do all our own quoting and 90% of the servicing. I know we do it differently than most agencies. By doing that we've done pretty well for ourselves and really don't need to advertise or worry about finding leads. We run solely off referrals and call ins and are too busy to keep up. That's the good thing about right now. 10 years ago, we were desperate for business and would have to take anyone who walked in the door. Nowadays, I bet we have to turn away 30% of new customers for misc reasons. Oh your roof is 11 years old, tough. Your house is \$212k and 100 years old, sorry. A single water claim in the last 5 years, nope. You bought both of your daughters Kias?? I can't tell you how many call ins I've sent to Farm Bureau. 2-3 a week at least. We just had a big regional meeting with our parent company last week and boy it was grim. It was the most depressing company round up I've ever been to. Record losses, more companies tightening guidelines, don't expect profit payouts again anytime soon. I was sitting with some of our peer agency (comparable # of employees and companies) and man, they sure seemed like they were struggling. A couple of them said they were closing 3-4 customers a week and he seemed proud of it. Like for the whole agency. I didn't tell him that I myself did 6 that week. I'm not complaining about the money. I made \$25k more this past year than the year before it. I'll probably match that again this year given what renewals are rolling in at. I'm just getting real tired of quoting a perfectly normal 2,700 sqft 2 story with a perfectly fine 12 year old roof and not being able to do anything. I quote 9 different companies and only one offers me a price and it's \$1200 more than what they paid last year. There's a good chance I'll get that sale but the customer already doesn't like me. I'm tired of having to justify the 79% rate increase I saw this morning on a Nationwide home (no claim). I'm tired of every single elderly person telling me "I'm on a fixed income" whenever their policy goes up \$27. I'm tired of roofing companies rolling our customer's wind/hail deductible into the amount they're billing the insurance company to win over their business. And then I'm tired when that same customer bitches to me next Summer when their home goes up \$1800 on renewal. I'm tired of not being able to talk to an underwriter anymore without first going through India and having them pretend to know what's going on only to transfer me to a misc underwriter 10 minutes later. I'm not saying this job was all sunshine and daisy's but it's crazy how much less stressful it was just 2-3 years ago. My dad's been an agent for 40 years (25 with Farmers) and he said this is the worst market he's ever seen. He predominantly does commercial and habitational and that's become a nightmare as well. He's had to turn away \$250k premium accounts recently because there's literally not a single other market for it. Please tell me we're not alone. Please tell me this is temporary and it won't suck to come into work in 2 years. We've never ever listened to a single buyout offer but man, I get why some folks do it these days."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 51 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cswcw9/anyone_else_not_having_fun_anymore/

↳ LifeVictor (26): "This may be the best post I have seen in a long time. I think it sums up what 90% of us are all dealing with in this unprecedented market. I'm captive and can you imagine all of the above with no other options to offer. It sucks! Hang in there. Be strong! 🍊 "

↳ PromiseAdvanced1870 (9): "Here in KS and MO it's the same thing...I can't tell you how many times this month I've turned away new customers AND CURRENT cuz their roofs are over 10 years old. Just about 70% of our Nationwide book is calling in cussing us out for the MASSIVE rate hikes NW is taking. "Sorry Mr. Customer, NW is trying to figure things out just like the rest of the industry. Good thing is you're not the only customer to call in and we do have other options! Real quick, how old is the roof on your house? Oh it's the original from 1998??.....![gif](emotelfree_emotes_pack|facepalm)"

↳ Samwill226 (6): "I'm in Georgia....it hasn't been fun in two years. Had a 40% loss ration for oh I don't know....20 years? Had a 200% due to storms for a 6 month period and now its back to 50%. Travelers came in and shut down my ability to write new homeowners. I was also just notified that if I don't write enough policies I may drop a tier on commission.....but also wanted to let me know if we continue we'll get a loss ratio check. What F**KING world am I in right now?? No it hasn't been fun. I always just dreamed that I'd like to build my commercial to about a million or two then sell off my personal lines and sit at home.....then I had three businesses call me to let me know they were going out of business. Totaling about \$70k I'll be missing by end of the year. It's very frustrating for me and our clients. No one is happy!"

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do,before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎🙏🙏🙏🕊️🕊️🕊️"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAg>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to delivery the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAq>

"I always mess with those medicare scammers. I already have my medicare set up the way I want it. They stopped calling after I told them to talk to my insurance agent. They seem to hate that LOL"

— YouTube · Messing with Medicare Scammers to See How They Operate · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JPvSJab6kzM&lc=Ugx9kQ9QMCgQE4shPS14AaABAq>

"My broker told me that with Medigap (supplemental) the doc makes the decisions...Not the insurance company Medicare Advantage..Expect delays while the insurance company figures out how to screw you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugy_9pWXe1A8BazF6EI4AaABAq

"A broker in Nashua, NH, told me several years ago that an Advantage plan is good unless you need it. The Advantage scheme is a scam. Its purpose is to move the country off Medicare and privatize all health insurance."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz-kN-jQS9K-v2zAoJ4AaABAq>

↳ @billjones4986 (0): "Yep I have one it's fine if your healthy need it for something major another story."

"My agent of 8 years was surprised when I told him my plan was ending and I was now eligible to buy a medigap plan. He said he would send me some plans to review, but he never did, and did not return my messages. Also, I called an agent I found online and he was so very helpful and nice, but when I explained I had been on Advantage for 8 years, he said oh, in that case, agents won't work with you, they won't get paid. He said I have to call each company to purchase the plan myself. Very strange...it sounds as if the companies are being compensated to take on "Advantage Returners" with the commission normally paid to agents..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxCOhpK38o-jmdIJN4AaABAq.AOs_MoBrGwvAPdBK7fuYgn

"Love & Other Ways of Dying. Excellent video Erik! Now I understand why, in Texas, my hubby got a guaranteed issue supplement without an Agent! My agent calls me every year, I asked if she can be hubby's agent and she said no!? Is that something you and/or your staff can help me with, to help hubby with best choices in lower premium supplement plans when necessary? Also, is it easy to change agents bc I understand agents receive monthly compensations, do agents receive those compensations indefinitely? Thank you 🙏 (Hubby's 73, I'm 68)"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwmACHxBrtYedrg7Dd4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "@Theretirementnerds Thank you Erik! 🙏 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching! To change the Agent of Record, your husband would have to change insurance companies. Commissions are different depending on the insurance company. Most have commissions drop over time."

"Forced as in regular Medicare ceases to exist? I'd guess not, but I have no qualifications to make you think I know anything. Forced, as in unable to afford a supplement? That doesn't seem so unusual. Find out the basis on which the cost of any supplement you are considering will raise its prices (it is a matter of how much, no a matter of whether). I know our agent told me she had a customer with a lot of issues who loved her supplement-- but it had gotten to be unaffordable, and of course by this time she has quite a bit wrong with her. The Advantage plan really was the only affordable option"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzPZB6VC5KBhdUGM5B4AaABAg.9YTcATdNCDS9Yh6VK6ddL5>

"Purple. Thank you for your guidance. I want to make sure others know that there are medications and therapies that Medicare won't cover or only cover for certain persons who meet criteria, but commercial insurance may cover them. For instance, parenteral nutrition coverage by Medicare has strict criteria. Persons who take meds, have chronic health conditions or are planning to have surgery should make sure Medicare will cover care. Not all agents know the criteria so I advise everyone to check with their doctors or pharmacies for their knowledge of Medicare coverage."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgxkxcAh3AmWYuUJsa14AaABAg>

"Your videos are very helpful...the cadillac of Youtube insurance advice presenters! I am in Brooklyn, NY and realized I need to move to a high D plan G. Do I have to call the broker that signed me up and tell them to cancel me? I realize, you probably DID say yes to this, but if this comment gets thru I'd love to know for sure if I am correct. I didn't realize I had given up my autonomy in this was! Thanks for all the great info."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzMHCms7OHEkTzFnod4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! You don't have to call the broker that signed you up to cancel you. Once you move to a new plan, it will cancel the old plan. As a broker, I think your broker would appreciate it if you reached out to him or her and asked them to make that switch for you :)"

"I'll chime in! Massage therapist here with lots of ortho, medical rehab experience. I have elderly clients and they almost universally love their G or N, or hate their Advantage but cannot switch to original w/supplemental because of poor health hx. A broker I know told me, "Advantage is NOT Medicare. Period." And I agree. I had hoped you'd discuss HD G."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugwhv-WrDaXqfUllnr54AaABAg>

"It's agent that got me in such a mess 😞😞😞😞 I switch from original to advantage 😞 huge mistake cause it's all not what I was told my doctor don't except the plan 😞 now I'm having hard time trying get that insurance company to dis enroll me for four days they continue to not tell the truth 😞 I want my original back"

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=Ugwk0NoNVjOm0Ft9fc94AaABAg>

"He is very good at explaining but I am still confused. I have a supplement plan that an agent recommended when I had a special enrollment period due to job retirement and he just said I like "this company", they are great. Plan G, good rate etc, yet this supplement plan has been a nightmare, acting like an advantage plan. Refusing to cover, putting time limits on Dr ordered physical therapy etc. It says G on my card but someone told me this company was pushed on me because this company also owns a large advantage plan and the incentive to be harrasive is to make me say forget plan G I will just go to an advantage plan, and voila, here is my Plan G company right there to offer an advantage plan (their own). I feel very duped. I don't know if it was the agent pulling a fast one on me because he got some sort of commission from supp company to aggressively push me in their direction so when I get frustrated agent will push me to plan g company's advantage and he will get a kickback or something. My agent said this company a half a second after I said I wanted original Medicare and never offered me anything else. New and very green to the insurance monsters I didn't know any better even though I thought I understood it all. Now I can lateral move to a different plan g company but only with underwriting. I could probably pass underwriting. I just lost all trust in this agent and people tell me I can't change agents. Ugh! What, how and WHY?? It shouldn't be this complicated to stay on original Medicare because one agent didn't offer me an insurance company choice!!! Beware people, not all insurance reps are thinking of your best interests! (Not the man that posted this video, he is awesome and speaks clearly so you understand 😊). I truly thought original Medicare was the way to go given the nightmare stories advantage plan people post about. I wasn't in open enrollment period, so agent had lots of time to help me, it was in the middle of the year when Medicare mania wasn't in full swing."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwISnQQsx1IQjxDEhN4AaABAg.AMRqYild_gEAMS-liEeFa

"@IwasRetired Just an fyi & question....I picked Plan G with AARP when I started out 2 years ago. It has been great. Just pay your Plan B & Plan G. You don't have to think about anything. It truly gives you peace of mind. I picked AARP bc it was the biggest insurer but that does not mean their prices are the cheapest. After doing TONS of research mostly listening to every YouTube Medicare video out there, Plan N has become the best cost saver for the long run. Every year your plan will go up. Plan G gets higher % increases than Plan N. I go to the md's a lot. Even paying \$20 a visit, the overall cost in a year & over my lifetime will be less on Plan N. I called AARP to inquire about switching to Plan N from G. They told me there is no underwriting going from G to N under AARP. Perhaps if I went to another company wanting Plan N, there might be underwriting. I don't know. Does anyone know? I called AARP twice & both agents said I could switch anytime to Plan N from G with no underwriting. Also, I was concerned about the deductible that I already met on G. If I switch to N, does my deductible start all over again? Both agents told me no, which I was happy to hear bc I already paid my Plan G yearly deductible for the year. The only thing I don't know is if it is ez to switch from G to N because it is the same AARP company.....I also thought I will just go to N within the same company bc it seems to be no hassle. I wonder if I go from AARP Plan N to Aetna/Cigna/someone new, how hard would it be going from AARP N to a new less expensive company N? Any thoughts on this?.....Another tidbit: When I spoke to the AARP agent & said I have a few questions bc I am thinking of switching from Plan G to Plan N....the agent said, " Ohhhh, you want to downgrade your plan?"....lolol....I laughed to myself. Most people don't realize it, but agents get a bigger commission each month on G over N. Actually, it's an upgrade bc you will save more money in the long run with N....."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgyIM5AreXhzxJF8V4Z4AaABAg_A9VxG9avBGyAA7SGkm_N4k

"I know the first time I ever had a UTI and pull anything I want to go to the jazz festival down in Houston that afternoon when I first became a nurse and I knew this medical student he was going to school to be a dentist and he put it he told me a pull my name up I want to be out for a weekend he told me I need my full wisdom tooth so he pulled them off all went down there today and I have a knack with you but now I said now OK and the universe is yours that I called his people they tell me insurance for the agents to Shema started to say 123 pool OK now but I have I will get Medicare thing and she told me theylt's nice that they told me they give me \$500 OK name and I'll go for the x-rays so yeah the 400 wouldn't want to eat she won't tell me what I did he wanted something he doesn't know kind of programs out there I got all the phone number babe relieve me a call around then as soon as I am afraid is calling that Medicaid they call it a boom boom boom boom boom they get everything they won't know they got my money or if I want my money from the time I was 55 on American you tell him you're my baby enough to pay the dentist do you think I need to get a lawyer that will leave you alone it was amazing that we are the same batch as governor they told me the governor's fault but now that my money roll over and I'll kind of stuff I had to put my foot down baby what is your name Stephanie know that I want to call me to clean with clean Mathis a possibility kind of stuff I told Medicare I'm at La Quinta marina Tato next week I don't know what I want to get real time ago that's why 3NNJEJ OK God bless you she's not sure she tried to go to"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg_9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7qE4D49X

"I would love to go back to supplement because of my hospital stay and I had full coverage at the time and always in my life I have higher level of Medicaid and my one hospital bill was 1,000.000 and I would of been responsible for 20 %and now I'm Medicare / Medicaid qmb and it paid all. With all these changes scares me now I V did not know the difference from supplement and advantage I just made sure I had a ppo and a private insurance company and they told me I would not lose anything. And this is my second year on advantage and now after watching for my health and quality of life may change for the rules that the agents never told . I even told them if it takes anything or decisions out of my hand I don't want it. Nothing or accesentives is worthwhile than my be health care. I feel I was lied to and till this year it came out and I found out for my copays are 47\$ if I don't go to a doctor that doesn't take Medicaid. Unless you're in the hospital doctors don't take Medicaid. my yearly coverage now is \$247 in January I don't know yet this year. Even though I'm undetectable I still have to"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=UgynA8kDxKYvvlalAJd4AaABAg_AM3rbFxx_jLANEHsoyZDJy

"That's all a lied I live in brockton Massachusetts and I spoke to Medicare a year ago and they said I couldn't get the allowance card to buy groceries pay bills well today it's october 23 spoke to 4 people and they transfer me to an agent I told each one all I want to know if where I live gives out allowance card the last one said they have it but it's only 35 dollars so I git mad and told him why waste my time again just hear that I don't qualify for 350 dollars allowance card I cursed them out because the 4 person I spoke to I told him all I want to know is about the allowance card he said let me look into this and what happened I can't get allowance I told him I wasted my time I knew it you all liars waste peoples time I said please put in the computer that in brockton Massachusetts they don't get allowance card and I hanged I feel bad for people that are 70 80s and they call im so pist off right now it was ridiculous and he kept saying let me see what I can do all that for nothing why do Medicare agents waste people's time im 59 yrs old"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzN9aXOwEERuMQimIB4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (3): "That's one heck of a run on sentence"

"I was diagnosed with Luekemia just before going on Medicare advantage at 65. I was told (by humana agent for a switchback to supplemental plan) I would not qualify for original medicare because of this. So, medicare advantage was my only option. They said only after being cancer free for 3 years would I even be considered. Im not sure but I they said it be at a higher rate. IDK, but it seems to me that if you have a major illness, most cannot afford tradtional medicare, asssuming that you will pay more when it happens. Yes, ma can be death of 1000 cuts due to copays and the fact that drugs dont count to your max out of pocket. My teor 4 and 5 drugs cost 3600.00 a month. Finally, I will say it can be confusing. Sometimes you think youre going with medicare but somehow get directed to ma. The 174.00 for most ma plans can lead you astray. Also, the bombardment of calls dont help."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgxF-en6FZD62rOqwKd4AaABAg>

↳ @pearlsandpowertools547 (0): "Your agent misled you. Right out the gate you could have gone on original Medicare and a supplement/Medigap at age 65 Guaranteed Acceptance. But he wanted his commission so he steered you to MA and now you can go back to original Medicare buy you cannot get a supplement. Source <https://www.medicare.gov/basics/get-started-with-medicare/get-more-coverage/buying-a-medigap-policy>";

'You get what you pay for' · 23 documents · 20 voices

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixg9Id0w9OA&lc=UgxdgBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAg>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to deliver the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"anyone that is 65 and over must pay for medicare cost that is paid from social security, about \$175 a month. the 20% supplement can cost \$150 a month , plan G and goes up each year with United Health Care. So annually, one pays \$1800 plus the annual deductible of \$240, or \$2000 a year for health insurance. no co-pays and no other expenses to see the doctor or ER visits after the annual deductible is paid, \$240. the original medicare pays up to 60 days in the hospital. 60 days is a long time. In most cases, one will be discharged within 60 days. From age 65 to 75, most seniors would not be staying in the hospital for long periods of time. the goal is to make appointments to see the doctor and do preventive care. take advantage of the plans. the part that I have a problem with is, medicare advantage can change its policy and they are for profit. the medicare advantage tangle carrots like free stuff , some dental work, glasses, and partial payment for hearing aids. plus gym membership which are available on some supplements. some medicare advantage plans do not pay if you leave the network. when the original medicare, I can go to any ER and do not need to worry about a co-pay. with advantage plans, there are doctor visit co-pay and ER co-pays and drugs cost money, with kaiser advantage plans. if one starts with the original medicare, you are guaranteed , no need to qualify. if you start with an advantage medicare plan with zero to little monthly fee with some free stuff, if you wish to go back to the original medicare plan, you have to be screened and qualify. the questions, do you wish to pay \$2,000 a year that gradually increases with the annual \$240 deductible , then unlimited doctor visits and ER visits? or be nickled and dime with office visit cost, ER cost , and subject to having the advantage plan approving your bill with possible surprises? I have to make a choice soon, nothing is free in life. All I know, I am currently paying \$1000 a month with kaiser and it cost me \$\$\$ for office visit, lab work and if I need to go to the ER. if I have to have a test performed, I have to still pay. So the \$200 a month supplement is reasonable with the original medicare. Again, Nothing in life is FREE, especially when our congress is swayed by private insurance companies trying to get a larger piece of the business. I hear many horror stories with private advantage medicare plans. they surprise Americans with large bills since the coverage does not pay for certain treatments. IMO"

— YouTube · Original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage: What's the Difference? · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=weO1WkquA3s&lc=Ugzaix7JeWu8Hgkw-fB4AaABAg>

↳ @ESMEE_4EVERR (0): "Jvgknftiokfpmgibdhcujjgbjjg"

↳ @AIH-p2u (0): "I'm surprised you think it's okay to pay 2400\$ a year plus dental plus vision plus medication and think it's everyone's best option. Many ppl are healthy and can save 2400\$ etc for 5-10 yrs then go into a chronic plan with little max out of pocket saying you thousands but if you're ill and have my doctors then supp is the way to go UHC offers both mapd pdp and supp I am contracted with them"

↳ @bozomonster (0): "The math doesn't workout in your if your paying \$1,000 per month to Kaiser. The max out of pocket with a Medicare Advantage Plan is \$5,000."

"There's some good info here. One thing that wasn't mentioned, that I think is potentially vital, is that if you're hospitalized under a HMO Advantage plan, there are 3rd party services you could experience that are NOT covered under your HMO. One area I can think of is anesthesia. Many anesthesia groups are contracted by the hospital. Other areas might be OT/PT, labs and even radiology. ER physicians are often under contract. Just be aware. There are PPO Advantage plans. I'm not sure how contractors are handled in a hospital setting under a PPO plan. I'm pretty healthy, but the potential financial impact of having to personally cover all these other costs persuaded me to go with a plan G supplement. I just feel more secure. It's kinda like you get what you pay for. Pay me now or pay me later."

— YouTube · Avoiding Costly Medicare Mistakes · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M_lw87U6Moo&lc=UgzJT8N-Bc0xXJiqiut4AaABAg

↳ @Wonderland41 (1): "PPO's will pay out-of-network, but it is usually (not always) more, ex. around 40%."

↳ @steveshannon7904 (1): "I'm in a HMO advantage plan with no premium and I get what you pay for."

"You get what you pay for. I signed up for a supplemental because I've heard about the disadvantages. I had heard stories about people not getting approvals for procedures their doctor thought they needed."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugx0XJcHhRSHIWQPe7Z4AaABAg.9ChuVh7y3MN9Ge5M2Eb6uk>

"@missionelpaso3766 Thanks for that info. It's possible that Meet Jamie doesn't know the answer, so we may not get a reply from him. The exception seems way too good to be true. However, since you read it on a medicare webpage, I think it might be a good idea if we consult with a couple of insurance reps anonymously. If this "move out of area" exception is real, it could be life changing. If I confirm this with reps, I'll remember to come back here to post another reply."

— YouTube · Can I Switch From a Medicare Advantage Plan Back to Original Medicare · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gaorZ0NfaOA&lc=Ugx9bhE4DeNCmVRmift4AaABAg.9deFZ67OFqs9p483cw1A1->

"The reason why I didn't choose MA plan was because it reminded so much the HMO and PPO plans that were options when I was working. The fact that you need to ask for approval on virtually everything looked annoying. In Oklahoma your limited to the counties you live in. There were no 'National' plan coverages. So if you don't like to travel, in my state, this may work for you. Secondly, when I was working full-time, the 80/20 plan Major Medical deductibles gradually increased over time. That's why I wouldn't take a MA for anything. I am have very happy with my traditional medicare plan. Also traditional medicare saved me alot of money compared to the retiree plan my past employer offered. It was a "community" plan where everyone that joined had the same monthly premium minus vision, dental, and life insurance....double the premium I am curretlly paying. It was worth it to ask alot of questions and do research. Like they say, there's no free lunch. Stephanie your the BEST!!"

— YouTube · What is Medicare Advantage? Medicare Advantage Plans Explained · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eRoWOPDW8DY&lc=Ugy_IXNeToB5xdMZJtF4AaABAg

"I just cancelled a give back plan after signing up a few weeks ago. I don't trust any of them, if it's too good to be true it is. I received a letter after initially signing up, and it stated I would continue paying part B, I was like huh? I'm 72, in good health, take two inexpensive meds, and pay for them. I could have used the vision and dental though small, but, oh well. I'm single, alone, no family or kids, pretty scary, probably the reason for being extremely careful."
— YouTube · Medicare Part B Give Back Benefit - What's The Catch? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dMy1JJvQwTs&lc=Ugz8uFITc15-pj_BwJJ4AaABAg

"I am staying with original Medicare to avoid all the confusion with the advantage plans. My sanity makes it worth while. I listened to the pros & cons of the advantage plans and they have back end billing practices which means you'll be charged for separate medical tests etc. so you end up paying more than you would have on the 20% on original Medicare. Nothing is free and simple is better."
— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzONtoIzImlo_4M9LV4AaABAg

↳ @davidharris678 (3): "Darlene, All the co-pays for Medicare Advantage are spelled out clearly in the plan. If anything is confusing it would be Original Medicare's billing. I know I look at hospital bills all the time."

↳ @TK-cl1jm (1): "If you can't swing a med supp, DEFINITELY get a med advantage plan."

↳ @darlenemeek2201 (0): "Plus if you get a hefty 20% bill you can usually make arrangements to pay monthly."

"My advice is to keep your straight Medicare, NO insurance "plans", and pay the part D out of pocket and shop for part D that contracts with your favorite pharmacy and covers your medications. If you're low enough income you may qualify for QMB or other state assistance also known as extra help. You will get better care with less wait time, because there's no insurance company acting like an oil slick over clear water, dictating YOUR medical protocol. Keep your choices of doctor in your OWN hands not a network. Find doctors that use the EPIC portal, you can share your test results inter office and coordinate your own care. Every doctor accepts Medicare, but not every insurance company contracts with every doctor or Hospital network. There may be doctors in the hospital network that don't contract with a certain insurance company, and you will wait longer for a doctor that does. In the long run, you get what you pay for. What "Advantage" is long wait times and unnecessary procedures, pointless tests and wrong diagnosis and over prescription of drugs with contraindications. Never will they put you in that 3D MRI and get you the physical therapy and clean lifestyle changes you need. They WILL pay for risky surgery, drugs and a wheel chair, and make you wait for it too."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugzdds22a7Ly22IO9_94AaABAg

"@jessicaeversole300 nope, Medicaid is a drain on taxpayers. The people on it do NOT PAY INTO IT. I paid into my Medicare for 48 years. I'm not sponging off the system and most likely will never use half of what I paid in. Keep in mind the morons who want Medicare for all....that would be a drain on tax payers because many more freeloaders would drain it who never paid into it. I hope that clears things up for you. No such thing as a free lunch."

— YouTube · TRUTH about the Affordable Care Act · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J0WBbhOzSCY&lc=Ugw_2eLH4eN9ay6gsmF4AaABAg.APOpG70rdSQAUEh-mVM_fe

"Thank you for this. I have traditional A & B and always felt a sense of "disbelief" about the advantage plans. I've read all the literature but those are always just the hooks and I sensed that these were too good to be true. Well, you know what they say about things too good to be true! I did not know about the fine print you presented. Very interesting. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Experts HATE Advantage Plans! Are they really THAT bad? 🤔 · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9D3l-X5q5Oc&lc=UgzTpVBTMfzoCO4gwXp4AaABAg>

"For some reason Med Adv never appealed to me, sounded too good to be true or something. I just double checked my Medicare Card, I don't have Adv Plan. Thx for the information, it's not like we can count on being informed in a timely manner, they'd rather create a crisis."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugze0QtahAetCNO5iR54AaABAg>

"@LeeCountySpeedShop This is exactly what I did. I strongly oppose Medicare Advantage. You get what you pay for. It's cheap for a reason. They can deny care, tests, procedures and they have doctor networks. I can go wherever I want, without pre-approval, and see any doctor I want. I also ended up suddenly in the hospital last year and got diagnosed with an autoimmune disease out of the blue. I was a week in the hospital and paid nothing. I got weekly in home nurse and PT visits for 2months after I was home. Without part D I estimate my drug costs would have been >20,000 last year. Instead my costs were capped at 2000 and everything free after that. I had no clue this was going to happen to me. I have been in doctors offices when people came in with their Medicare advantage cards only to be told that office doesn't accept that plan. People think it's the same as traditional Medicare. It is NOT."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1lpLq6moM&lc=Ugygro_vH19Oogf8kHN4AaABAg.ASPiXZR9M9GAWks_vZXDUq

"Just for fun, during open season I called the Advantage provider to ask two questions: 1) What is the preapproval process for your plan? 2) What is the process for dropping the plan and switching back to my current supplemental insurance. After a half hour wait, she finally picked up the phone. There was a vague & uncertain answer to the first question; a noncommittal & uninformed answer to the second. She asked me for my birthdate, name, address before she would answer the second question--probably signing me up for the Advantage plan even though I hadn't requested it. If their service was so poor during the sign-up phase, what would it be like when I actually filed a claim? IMO Advantage plans are too good to be true. I'm sticking with the Supplemental plan that I've already got. No free gym membership and monthly premiums with what I've got, but no problems with preauthorizations or denied service."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤯 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzvyhYUTEteyM0RDXB4AaABAg>

"I appreciate what I learned from this video. I particularly find value in your emphasis on "Don't make your decision solely on the fact that you are healthy today because as we age that most likely will change.".....and can change in the blink of an eye !!! I find Original Medicare very important & perhaps is being thrown away all too often & too easily.....as with anything if it sounds too good to be true most likely it is too good to be true !!! Don't be pound wise and penny foolish ! A sound health care plan is as important as Good Health !!!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwcsItL-qIKx7R_S994AaABAg

"Well first of all, nothing is free. Second, there are MA plans that have \$0 premium but as agents we are told to never say free and there's one reason. It isn't free. It's just your part of the premium. The government pays the other part. (I think, correct me if I'm wrong.) Also...Medicare Advantage is NEVER zero cost because you pay as you go. Also, the MOOP is much higher than Medicare Supps. With the Supps, you may not like the monthly premium you are paying, but unless I'm missing something, you know what your costs are."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwPA1P1Slezp3jZeJl4AaABAg.AQcjbM4h_cAS0hZAnCisr

"Theres a reason you only see advertising for Medicare "Advantage" - it's only advantageous to the insurance companies. I have a family member who had plan G and has had 3 different operations in the last 3 years with very little out of pocket expense. Unless you're the epitome of good health avoid these "advantage" plans like the plague. In life you get what you pay for, and nowhere is it more true than with Medicare."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1qe8s33/watching_my_uncle_struggle_actually_made_me/nzxc31i/

"Nobody warned ME! Common sense told me when something sounds too good to be true ... It IS. Nobody warned me not to take the COVID shot(s) .. Common sense told me if something is EXPERIMENTAL .. it's not what I want in MY body. I don't go on vacations or get a new car every 5 years, etc etc ... I wanted a good medigap insurance and I accepted that it wasn't going to be cheap! It's all about where your priorities are .."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxxi6snmCvpHtHoLXp4AaABAg.AZ_ohB230CiAZjdYMPo-39

"The simplicity of a gap plan was the main reason my wife and I chose gap plans. More expensive up front, and may even be more expensive in total, but none of this in and out of network crap and so on. I understand that some people have modest finances and the advantage plans may be all they can afford. But a gap plan is simple a better product. You get what you pay for."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medigap at 65: The Real Costs Most People Don't Understand (Clip) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M9hEKbgJg2w&lc=UgzIFVrFmBu_IeHDkp4AaABAg.AXDxePCpa8JAXFPQ5U-LS2T

'I love my Advantage plan' · 20 documents · 20 voices

"I love my medicare advantage, especially because I can be treated at Mount Sinai Medical Center and my copayment is 0"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 17 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pg6H7UZBbU&lc=UgznrQ3AeIMxI7_LZt4AaABAg.AMa0mE2CuSIAMcZKnj4rwD

"I love my advantage plan, i have not had anything denied, I've had two knee replacements, 3 back surgeries, trigger finger fixed all fingers on both hands and i have a monthly infusion that is 20,000 every 4 weeks. Absolutely nothing has been denied. MA for the win. Also i use the hell out of dental and vision i also love the 70.00 A month spending card."

— YouTube · MORE Medicare Advantage Plans CUT: Millions Will Face Forced Dis-enrollment ❌ · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPLaLyfDZxY&lc=UgwRfwxGoyyoZ6A7iHJ4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (3): "That's fantastic to hear, especially with a treatment history like that — a plan that's handled everything from major surgeries to a \$20,000 monthly infusion without denials is genuinely a strong track record, not something everyone experiences. And getting real use out of the dental, vision, and spending card on top of that is exactly how those extra perks are supposed to work. MAPD plans tend to work especially well for people who also have Medicaid or other government benefits layered on top, since that combination often minimizes the cost side of the equation. It's worth noting MAPD plans are still required to cover everything Original Medicare covers — the prior authorization process some people run into is real and does trip some people up, but clearly hasn't been the case for you. Thanks for sharing your experience — it's a good reminder there are real success stories alongside the more difficult ones people sometimes hear about."

↳ @ikestevens (2): "I'm curious, if you wouldn't mind, to know what plan you're on.. ? Thx :)"

↳ @matthewtaylor6564 (0): "What kind of plan are you on in Massachusetts?"

"I love my Medicare Advantage plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgzhmKFiqCpry0qwWM94AaABAg>

↳ @mmb9775 (2): "As a cancer survivor I love my Medicare Supplement plan."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "That's great! Many people do."

"I love my medicare advantage plan. I have no worries. I have additional dental, eye, hearing, prescription, in home aid help, that I wouldn't receive under regular medicare. I'm able to go out of network for a small co-pay. My state of Ohio pays \$149 of my advantage plan. This guy is full of it."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwAstxstJ5RtNB4fT94AaABAg>

↳ @Paulohlsson7 (0): "Hi Deborah, how's your day going with you?"

↳ @deborahasher176 (0): "@Paulohlsson7 Do I know you?"

↳ @Paulohlsson7 (0): "@deborahasher176 I'm Paul. From Moultrie Georgia. I stumbled upon you comment while trying to add mine and decided to say 'Hi'"

"I chose a Medical Advantage PPO plan when I first enrolled in medicare. The biggest issue was the poor performance of the insurance company staff. Most of my first Advantage Plan companies were staff with very incompetent personnel. I did find a company after all of that pain and aggravation and they have done quite well for me. I will be staying with them, as long as they stay in the MA business. That same company, a big, stable company has pulled many of its plans for 2026, but not mine. So, I love my Medicare Advantage Plan company almost as much as I love my dogs."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxgQCE8uukbLQPdWIZ4AaABAq>

"I love my advantage plan. It paid for my teeth to be pulled AND my dentures."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgzFPpBOR8UbxFUSxUt4AaABAq.AM92ivn8YDAAM9EFZGbhGw

"I love my advantage plan"

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugz-fVdYi89CeC7pScJ4AaABAq>

"Mind your own business! I like my Medicare Advantage Plan."

— YouTube · Everyone's Sick of Medigap Rate Increases...Here's What to Do! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NQHG_o1vxVU&lc=UgxPqj9Y5lOTZo-qWqt4AaABAq.AWMujRLAWPiAWUyww6EnP6

"Our thoughts and prayers go out to you and your wife!! My husband and I love our medicare advantage plan. My husband is suffering both from prostate and lung cancer. NEVER has he been denied or had to wait for authorizations for CT scans, MRI, treatment plans, inpatient admissions, home health services and the copays are nominal. Flex cards are amazing. Flex cards are part of our plan and can be used to pay copayments. It's like anything else.... YOU MUST SHOP AROUND. Good luck."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgxQMpsk7w77W5CNR_54AaABAq

"I love my Medicare Advantage Plan. \$0 monthly payment, low co pays on major surgeries (knee replacement, heart stent) all my prescriptions are free (6) except my Brilinta and ED Rx. They cost \$118 (insurance pays \$1200) and \$16 every 90 days. All the hand wringing about Advantage plans is unwarranted in my opinion. It has its issues but I trust the private sector with minimal government oversight wayyyy more than the 100% federal government department to manage our healthcare."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgxNQQjGln8eKueEwrp4AaABAq.AMZe27i5m-MAMZqSyK2HA7>

"My friend is 68. Hes diabetic. He has a daughter with special needs. He needs to fix his home to bring her out of a nursing home .she is slightly brain damaged. This girl is a living miracle. I give him these links for questions. We are both on Advantage plan. We pay nothing. We see specialist. We have no copay We love our Advantage plan. What should he do?? Continue working till 70?"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙋 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxOGkM2ic2ivFWOkNp4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (1): "That will vary by each of your scenarios. We would be more than happy to review plans that fit both your needs. Just give us a call at 1-800-864-8890. We're here to help any way we can!"

"Im sorry thats been bad for you. I love my advantage plan, it works very well for me. I pay nothing for 6 prescriptions, my 7th, Lyrica, I pay \$5.00 for. I pay \$99.00 per CAT scan, no limits. I pay \$250.00 per MRI. PT? No charge. My part of the bill for two cataract surgeries? \$200.00."

— YouTube · Trump Administration to End Medicare Drug Plan Subsidy. #medication #medicare #doctor · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BrOgvbQKs-A&lc=UgxW0Qw3TCkA4Jk6DHd4AaABAg.AZp6HaO9jl-AZpDs9ff5u1>

"I like my advantage plan. I needed the dental and eye plan. Regular Medicare doesn't offer that. Plus I pay 0 for my medication! I'm happy with what I have"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypOamgls&lc=UgyRw963rFTGUed2UP14AaABAg>

↳ @BoomerBenefits (0): "We love to hear that - we have many clients who are happy with MA plans as well :)"

"I like my MA plan, and don't want to waste money paying for a Supplement. My HMO has been here since 1952. None of its MA plans are going anywhere."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgxEj3fMCTx8DrCzTbh4AaABAg.A_Q_j4dRixPA_QvKsRCYc1

"@julieday2786my wife and I love our Kaiser Medicare advantage plan. Excellent doctors and facilities with everything you need in one place."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxnrhYSzJzaflqfOSV4AaABAg.ATShWZ6W99TATU2-yYvAYT>

"I love dogs. I like my Medicare Advantage plan. But since I can't go through underwriting at this time, I will need to stay on Advantage."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgyG-syF07DVzDGKR754AaABAg>

"I love my MA plan. I love that I have several to chose from and I can switch plans if my needs change from year to year."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwLdnGVweg2XoSYd8p4AaABAg.A_Qx50Rcs56AaHCGFdvun

—

"I like my Medicare advantage plan..mine is not thru an insurance company..."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw5dva41Mo5gKOGT8h4AaABAg>

"I love my Humana advantage plan , it's great."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugy0CRz3F-dB-So5NMN4AaABAg>

"Good for you I like my MA plan"

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgylYjtXy7l6rid092t4AaABAg.AXEIEmkd0ctA_hiU00yo1N

'They told me it was covered' · 18 documents · 18 voices

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAg>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAg.AOmGYDg472zAOmUZITAtAk>

"I switched to Medicare advantage when they lied to me on the phone and told me all the medications I was taking were covered. MULTIPLE WERE NOT! A year later I switched back to regular Medicare never looking back."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyqXuqZdiY16Hpur3J4AaABAg>

↳ @mscoyote50 (1): "You're lucky. Once you're padt a year, you really can't switch back without underwriting and most of us older people have underlying "conditions"..."

"Make sure to ask your insurance company that your radiology centers are in network. Even if the hospitals are in network it doesn't mean the stand alone radiology facilities could be Out of network. They will tell you yes you can go there but they FAIL to TELL you that they are out of network so your copay in my instance was almost tripled Makes no sense to say the hospitals in network but not the stand alone radiology facilities. My Insurance starts with a Hum !! I'm disabled can't drive anymore and they told me the closest place in network is a 50muinte drive from my house and they only do 2 of my test. Then I'll have to get a ride in the complete opposite direct in another State which is 55 miles from my house Always get the NPI# to all your doctors,hospitals,radiology centers,etc and then ask your insurance if they're all in network If not in my situation I'll pay almost triple the copay cost. Why would the hospitals be in network with the NPI# but not the exact same NPI for all their stand alone radiology centers??? This should be illegal!!!!!! People don't know to ask if the stand alone radiology is in network. They just ask do they take my insurance. They respond yes but the FAIL to tell you they're out of network so you pay a higher co pay and it's impossible to even find a in network place at least where I live"

— YouTube · 3 Medicare Changes for 2027 - and how to prepare. #medicare · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GxBa9kBx5cY&lc=Ugwc ITLY 2MzR4qqyN4AaABAg>

"I enrolled on Medicare part B at 70 due to I had HSA account and company had a 1,700 employees . Prior that I and my company stopped contribution to my HSA 1 Year so that I don't have to face with the penalty ! I wanted to be Medicare supplement and Medicare part D as needed while United healthcare associates tokd me very high deductible rather Medicare advantage with free doctor visit and drugs! Now I am the first time gi to family doctor in network, they said he was out of network and given to me a list doctor in network, additional i have to pay deductible drug up to \$2000 per year before the plan pays me ! Hell nó! They told me one way then do other at the beginning enrolling ! Now I was upset about it ! That's why a United healthcare CEO got killed past years in New York (i remember)! Ervin do you have any idea ? And Can I switch to Medicare supplement in 2027 . I just retired at April 2026! Thanks"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugw7uVI2hc5qZkKoSBx4AaABAg.AU3ooa-Gm8NAZJt1HChqMd>

"Having recently become eligible for Medicare I scheduled an annual wellness appointment w/ my provider. During the appt the Dr. suggested I get vaccinated against shingles and I was told the vaccine would be covered by insurance, so I completed the series of two shots several weeks apart. Medicare denied payment and upon investigating why found out the vaccine is not covered under Part B. However, the cost is covered under my Part D and if I'd had received the shots at my local pharmacy instead of the doctors office the claim would have been processed no problem. When I called the Atrium Health billing to request they bill CVS Caremark I was told they will not bill Part D insurance. So now I'm left to navigate the paperwork nightmare of asking Caremark to reimburse me for the \$1k I'm out of pocket."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Claims Issues (and how to avoid them) · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QWGAaZw0d6o&lc=Ugy6AjSxBER0_yljAep4AaABAq

↳ @emc6511 (0): "Email from Medicare this week QUOTE ... Medicare Part D now covers these vaccines and more at NO cost to you: Shingles RSV Tetanus/diphtheria (Td) Tetanus, diphtheria, and pertussis (whooping cough) (Tdap) Hepatitis A Hepatitis B, if you're at low risk for the virus Also, Medicare still covers flu shots, COVID-19 vaccines, and pneumococcal shots."

"I got my letter saying my M A premier HMO POS is being discontinued and I need to get new insurance by Dec 31, 2025. My husband has same plan as me and when I called my insurance since he got no cancellation letter, I called, they told me he is not cancelled. Red flag here! If doing away with my plan, why is my husband still being covered by this plan. He got no notice and also got no ANOC. I told them to send me proof he is covered. My second call to my insurance company, the person I spoke with said I still had coverage. I told her that is not what this letter I got on Oct 2, 2025 says. It plainly says you are cancelled, you plan is being discontinued. My other thing is in back of Medicare book, it still shows plan available in 2026. If I go back to original Medicare, I pay my \$185.00 premium that is deducted from my SS check monthly. I also will pay a monthly premium to the plan I choose, plus higher copays for hospital and specialist doctors and primary Dr. It is all about insurance companies making and keeping their profits. Makes no difference I paid into Medicare my entire life Seems someone is lying to me."

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=UgxLcRkWaIF-oiHHVgJ4AaABAq.ANmidDT4xvkANuE5XrS6-x>

"My local hospitals have Medicare Advantage Plans. When I asked, I was told that if I travel out of state, the hospitals would have to accept them in an emergency. If a hospital has stopped accepting Medicare Advantage plans, does that mean they have to "save your life" and then force you to transfer to an accepting hospital irregardless of location as soon as a bed becomes available?"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyvH7eH2-6Lo34Cr3Z4AaABAq>

"As with everything, what plan you should choose depends on your own circumstances. Many people are happy with their advantage plans, as all their doctors accept it and all their medications are covered, and they are usually cheaper than a medigap plan. But, there is always risks regardless of what you choose. My personal doctors told me they don't accept any advantage plan, and none of them available in my state covers all my meds. But it's always possible to get a separate part d. The risk of standard Medicare and medigap is that premiums increase to much. Technically that can happen with advantage as well, but it's more likely with medigap. The risks of advantage are many. Fewer supported doctors (this is just fact), and you hear stories all the time about doctors dropping ma plans. No ability for most people to go back to original Medicare without incurring that 20% and no max out of pocket (ie they won't pass underwriting). If you live in a guaranteed issue state, you have much less risk. And can easily choose the plan that fits your current state of healthcare. But if you don't it's a choose wisely situation because you can't go back for most people after a year. So you have to ask yourself, are you feeling lucky?"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ep6jo4/why_do_people_say_never_get_an_advantage_plan/hin754/

"Medicare Advantage is great for healthy people. Medicare Supplements are great for sick people. My wife recently racked up 200 grand in medical bills, multiple hospitals and specialists. Multiple ambulance trips between hospitals. Then nursing care and back into acute care, then rehab and months of in home PT, durable medical equipment etc. We have original Medicare and G supplement. Our total cost (after the Part B deductible of 200.00 bucks) ZERO, NADA, NOTHING! There was one piece of equipment that wasn't covered, but Medicare told us that since the provider didn't tell us that it wouldn't be covered, because they didn't take Medicare assignment, we didn't have to pay for it! And they contacted us and told us before we ever knew it wasn't covered!! Our case manager kept telling us how fortunate we were to have original Medicare and a supplement. She said people with Advantage Plans are constantly on the phone fighting for coverage, arguing with insurance. We were never on the phone arguing with anyone once. All we had to worry about was my wife getting better. The doctors ordered it, Medicare paid for it. Period."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyYD0Su0JT2-8sO63d4AaABA9.9VelwLFh7JA9e9hFhr1dEM>

"I switched to Medicare advantage on January 1st. I switched back to a supplemental plan after watching this episode of John Oliver. I found a similar situation that John had described with my new Medicare advantage insurance plan. I had my primary doctor schedule (referral) a sleep study for me. The sleep center contacted me and told me they did not accept my insurance. I explained that the sleep center was listed on the insurance website as being in network, however, that was not correct. The sleep study center explained that they were not contracted with my insurance. As I found, the Medicare advantage insurance plan has a limited number of available doctors and facilities. Even though the financial incentives are very attractive, I don't want to sacrifice my health. The incentives for the advantage plan includes refunding my monthly Medicare premium, waived the deductible, and included dental and vision. At least now I can see any doctor I want without a referral."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyVG9Ymah-dmbtFjRB4AaABA9>

"@robnunurbiznezz7618 == I've learned to be a little careful. Medicare doesn't cover everything either. You can't get a 2nd colonoscopy within 10 years unless you meet certain conditions. Same for dermatology. They treat some things and not others -- unless you pay. I had a bone density scan and they paid the hospital but not the doctor who interpreted the official results. I didn't make waves lest they decide to take back the hospital payment too. There are very specific conditions where you can get a bone density scan, not just if the doctor thinks it's a good idea. So I'm starting to ask all the time if every thing the doctor says is covered or not. Having said that, my Medigap plan has surely saved me 1000s since I've had a couple surgeries etc where with an Advantage plan I would have paid a few more \$1000s out of pocket"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyE_Alm8EugoAtW-Ax4AaABAq.ATShF4cKkiNAX-wGqjm2wf

"I hate my Medicare advantage plan. Can't wait to cancel it. I had trigger finger and went to a specialist that helped me before. I told him I had Medicare and went in. They saw that I actually had Medicare advantage and they said they could not accept it. It turns out this doctor was not in my network so I could not see him. Then they assign me to a PCP that was 20 mi away from my house. I had to wait for the following month to cancel that PCP and go with the doctor close by to my house. I'm also on an HMO so it's the worst of the two plans. What a mistake. Plus I had to wait 3 weeks to go see the in Network doctor for my trigger finger. If I had been on straight Medicare I could have gotten it taken care of right away."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugx08R_5OP0h0kZogVx4AaABAq

"I'm 68 years old and I don't understand a lot of this. I just got my insurance information in the mail and they're raising Price on everything Co pays. I've been with United Healthcare forever and I was on Medicaid during Covid. After Covid they took me off of Medicaid because I had made too much money, they said it was a program that the government put in place during Covid for People which since then has expired. I have part A B D Medicare I don't know how the D works I don't understand it I filed for it they said I was accepted and then that's all I know and that was a while back. I don't understand any of it Then it makes me feel stupid. Does it cost me anything to call you and get help?"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=Ugw4KvC77mZIMMFGdJd4AaABAq>

"You're welcome. This happened to me one time with some labs my doctor ordered when I first went on Medicare. I asked them if the PA I was seeing if he was sure Medicare would pay for them and he told me Medicare would pay. When they drew the labs, the lab technician asked me to sign an ABN for some of the labs that stated I would be responsible if Medicare did not pay. I signed the form stating I would pay if Medicare denied the labs and, sure enough, Medicare denied the labs and I had to pay for the labs. I learned my lesson. Now I never sign an ABN agreeing to be responsible if Medicare denies them. It was an expensive lesson for me to learn!"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1l9toie/you_didnt_know_this_service_isnt_covered_so_you/mxfwmgb/

"I changed from Kaiser Medicare Advantage. I signed up with AARP UCH medigap with plan g. No Hospital close to me in Folsom Ca. would accept me. They said we are not accepting anymore patients. I called back 2 hours later and said I have UCH Advantage and all of a sudden yes they have an opening for me. WTH! UCH medigap D-G, D \$80 a month, G \$125 a month. Advantage \$0 for both. So confusing. I am still signed up for original medicare with D&G but getting a doctor or hospital to accept my coverage is really hard."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzducfmvkPMbq21U0R4AaABAg>

"I'm currently on Medicaid and I was told that part of the Medicare would be covered. I'm still confused. Do I still have to choose things or how do I find out what part is covered through Medicaid? Could not get any answer from the Medicaid department. I turned 65 in June"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211lpLq6moM&lc=Ugyv2TFcZoKI0JUBw-N4AaABAg>

"How do you know if the hospitals and clinics your doctors use, are covered by an advantage plan? An advisor said Humana giveback was a good one for me - when I called Humana, they said my doctors are covered, but NOT the hospitals and clinics. WTH?????"

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSML&lc=Ugzehrod1va7br6SvQ14AaABAg>

↳ @ace-c7j (1): "Great answer - thanks very much"

'Don't answer, don't give them your number' · 18 documents · 18 voices

"I always say " here in the United States Medicare does not call people on the phone they just hang up."

— YouTube · Medicare Scam Call AGAIN! This is how I handle them. · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hIDJ4XfKHJE&lc=UgzZ0Mq8BzLgQQ3bJPI4AaABAg>

↳ @michaelquigley7927 (1): "Good Advice Brian!!!"

"@71suns that is all I have. Plan A and plan B which I pay for plan B. Plan A is regular Medicare that covers hospital stays. I get bombarded with phone calls and text from insurance companies wanting me to get an advantage plan. I block them because I do not trust them. I am 75 years old and I am scared of the medical system. I don't trust hospitals or doctors. They're only there for the money these days."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxrrFVha096OaNtoNd4AaABAg_AMUWC5cfeMZAMXWPB_jarG

"Lmaoo I'm in health insurance (Medicare) as well so I have a ton of people asking me find in network providers. Yesterday I had 70 year old (non dementia/no POA) tell me that her bank isn't answering the phone and for me to give her her routing and account number or call her bank. She had never given me her bank information prior as that is not needed for Medicare applications, I told her that her best bet would be to "keep calling the bank"😂"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1txwn8g/insureds_are_grown_adults/oq0hj8m/

"As a Medicare insured and a Medigap insured, I want to say: BE VERY WARY OF MEDICARE SALES REPS! THEY GET MORE AND BETTER COMMISSIONS AND VACATIONS AND EVEN CARS AS THEIR COMMISSION. BEFORE you start a conversation, ASK what their commission is if you sign up for MEDICARE or a MEDICARE ADVANTAGE PLAN. If they will not answer, hang up or walk out. The reps are a dime a dozen."
— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyhNmQtn1f74jveoIN4AaABAg>

"This is unbelievably upsetting for several reasons. From my point of view especially, because this is my actual job. Not scamming the elderly, but doing telephone enrollments for Medicare Advantage plans. Most of these people truly would benefit from these plans but they are so afraid, understandably, to give any information because of these people. We have folks in this country that have to choose between food and prescriptions and I talk to them everyday. The plans could assist with several different benefits. Some of these sound very similar to what a real call sounds like. BTW, open enrollment is from Jan 1st-March 31st, lol. But, we certainly don't hang up on people if they ask questions or ask for any info other than MBI and bday. Also, the girl could've been legit when he was telling her she had a sexy voice. I've been asked to say all kinds of bizarre, nasty things when I'm really just trying to get people the best health coverage possible. Just giving my input as an actual person who is contracted with Medicare. Screw with the scammers all you want but remember that there are some honest agents out there who are just doing their jobs. ♥"
— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4lY&lc=UgyfAhK7yeJyHtAcVm94AaABAg>

↳ @MisfitCornerComics (0): "I've said that before... There are honest licensed agents out there that do help people with their Medicare and health/life insurance but these despicable scammers take advantage of that and pose as people just trying to help. It is disgusting but there are good people out there... There's also a whole lot of the other types."

"This happened today!! Asking me if I'm 65 years old if I said no or why the question I would get hung up on. I called back thinking I felt with a rude unprofessional person but I also had some questions. I kept getting hung up and I found odd all calls had the same accent and realized it was a scam !! Next time I will hang up and call my own provider to verify!!"
— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4lY&lc=UgxkdfqXp0yY7DvTkbt4AaABAg>

"The scammer say that my doctor, they say my doctors name asked them to call in her behalf asking me about a new program. They always leave their name because I never answer the phone. They leave a message to call, I do not call."
— YouTube · Messing with Medicare Scammers to See How They Operate · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JPvSJab6kzM&lc=UgywjK4YnpgOTjNUN1Z4AaABAg>

"The Medicare scam attempts to get me too and I'm not even old enough to qualify for Medicare I troll them though. I make them hang up on me :-)"
— YouTube · Messing with Medicare Scammers to See How They Operate · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JPvSJab6kzM&lc=UgyjVyYOIHUC8kctseV4AaABAg>

"My number is on the do not call list and it doesn't stop the calls. This is not from my Advantage plan."

— YouTube · How to Stop Unsolicited Medicare Calls! · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ijs8JUzUlwQ&lc=UgzR49iOnPMDgV6QEfZ4AaABAg>

"I've often received the Medicare scam call. Once I wade through the robocall preliminary and get to a real person, they always ask, "You currently have Medicare parts A and B, correct?" That is when I try to sound confused and respond, "Well, I seem to have Medicare Parts F and U. Do you understand?" This is always followed by either a hang up or lots of cussing. The longer I keep them on the line before I give them the "F&U" response, the more likely it is that they'll cuss. It's very entertaining."

— YouTube · Medicare Scam Call AGAIN! This is how I handle them. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hlDJ4XfKHJE&lc=UgxFLU10541Ulfmadnd4AaABAg>

"i cant count the number of medicare spam calls i get everyday i get so many im sick of my phone constantly ringing. i dont answer the phone to numbers i dont recognize anymore. i dont have an answering machine either. i signed up with the national do not call registry but it doesnt seem to be working."

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4lY&lc=UgzS6_W5Zi17RfBOflJ4AaABAg

"Good one! I've been getting alot of these calls from Medicare scammers. Most are robocalls and they hang up either just after I say hello or after they ask whether I have Part A and Part B. Usually these days I don't get a live person."

— YouTube · Messing with Medicare Scammers to See How They Operate · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JPvSJab6kzM&lc=UgyCz4MCrtpAFQDsJ6h4AaABAg>

↳ @IAMGiftbearer (2): "@CorasAtHerCorner Automated calls. When you hang up they call right back and it may or may not be the same AI voice. I've also been getting pure hang-up calls in which they don't say anything and you say "Hello, Hello", and then it hangs up. It seems like they do that just to harass people they know they can't fool."

↳ @CorasAtHerCorner (0): "Thank you! I wonder if they are trying to go more recorded lines now."

"Yesterday I got 48 calls from medicare scammers. I answer, hang up and block. I've ignored them and let it ring. I just switched carriers and caller ID shows the majority of the calls come from towns in Oklahoma (where I live) or from a Senator, government offices that have no reason to contact me, like the federal farm bureau. I know these are all spoofed numbers... but DAMN! I'm leary of changing my number since there's no way to tell if it'll be just as bad or worse. I'm disabled and I've got enough going on. lol When you tell them, " I appreciate the call, but I'm already receiving all of the benefits I qualify for. Please, take me off your call list... Some hang up on me, some say okay, but they all lie. I'm going insane."

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=UgysvRadke3cEkOgAkx4AaABAg>

"I'm 70 , I work 24 to 34 hours a week to supplement my SS. I am a prolific Gardner\canner, I'm on no meds my blood pressure is fine, my sugar is fine, get 10k steps in a day minimum. I have a 91 year old Mom who just got her drivers license renewed. That said; UHC Advantage calls all the time wanting to setup an in home visit? This disrupts my work day, dinners etc. I don't want a in home visit, I don't need my blood pressure checked as I check my own (TY UHC for the 3 blood pressure kits you sent me). I try to block every UHC Advantage phone number they must have hundreds. If I'm sick I'll go to the doctor stop disrupting my day and night!"

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=UgyaMXHCARBbuETLv8N4AaABAq>

"My elderly father was pressured by unscrupulous salesmen on the phone to sign up for Medicare Advantage. I overheard one call & told him to hang up. I could hear the woman say that she would call back when he was alone. Sure enough, weeks later he was in a bad wreck which killed his beloved dog. His hospital had a renowned rehab program with a dog of the same breed. The doctors asked me to write a letter to the Advantage plan to request an appeal of their denial. It didn't work. He had to go to a facility far from relatives with substandard care."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxJCAYkJ5wl_zCDBap4AaABAq

"False, I am on the Do Not Call List and still get at least 12 calls a day for Medicare, car insurance, burial insurance, home repair, and such. They steal phone number from business and individuals. I have gotten calls listed as Lowes companies, Delhaize, US Army, Rocket Mortgage, and Merk for a few examples. These callers are located outside the USA and don't care about US law."

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=UgxSA-H6EcCEjluOZLR4AaABAq>

"@Capitan-America-no.1 The Today Show recently did a segment on this. The said that many tactics don't work and the BEST way to combat this is: DON'T ANSWER THE PHONE. Let everything go to VM; if you never pick up, they will stop calling. My husband did this after his enrollment info Medicare; he just didn't answer calls; they stopped. It worked!"

— YouTube · How to Stop Unsolicited Medicare Calls! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ijs8JUzUlwQ&lc=Ugxb3wyUzsdAD8wO6sl4AaABAq.AOYa7bn3klyAOdJNVTWxFk>

"@winnie2379 Wow - you have way more patience than I do! I have heard of people harrassing the callers for fun. I just choose to ignore the calls; it worked for my husband when he turned 65. We don't answer any unknown callers and guess what...the calls stopped!!!! Yep we never answer unknown calls and they don't call any longer. It works!"

— YouTube · How to Stop Unsolicited Medicare Calls! · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ijs8JUzUlwQ&lc=UgzPWRr5SpsOBm3ZW5x4AaABAq.ARKDdl7AFJ1ARUNRI75U_n

What they were told about penalties and signing up · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Soda Family! Nice video, since about 4 or so years ago when a family member who was disable needed a medicare plan I have been watching. At the time it was plan F through United healthcare (they claimed we could not get G), there is a penalty (complicated) received and the premium just went to \$520 per month. In the beginning I thought you were peddling advantage plans with all the comments on what supplements doesn't give you, thought it was an angle to upsell advantage plans, glad I watched. I have heard many advantage plans can and have dropped perks after a few years, put shiny object out there for people to bite then once you are unable to go on a supplemental no need to offer any longer. I'll take a look the SS, interesting. Note I know others that call themselves to insurance companies and are given incomplete (rather than lied too) and make bad choices as well, if you don't already probably not a bad video to put together. Thanks,"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugz2eIDZLXipkrpHigF4AaABAg>

"I never signed up for Part D when I first signed up for SS and Medicare 17 years ago. I looked into adding it this year, and was told I would have to pay a penalty for 17 years, plus a penalty for each year going forward because I didn't sign up originally! That is crazy! Can you explain why? Luckily I'm 82 with only one prescription needed for high blood pressure. But I'm appalled."

— YouTube · Medicare 2027 WARNING: What's Changing With Part D Costs · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VL9ka29qz8Y&lc=Ugzj1GZF7J6Y-TgcgG14AaABAg>

"Yes true. Now I told my wife she will need to wait until she is 65 in 2025 before she retires now that I know this penalty. But I wouldn't mind the higher premiums if I could make 2022 income every year 😊 Thanks for making the video and explaining. It was a helpful video!"

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA (Everything You Need To Know) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WUaV8Eh6pKQ&lc=Ugx3XyFTARSz6OFj-Yt4AaABAg.9yLmxMxinME9yMKwfaSNz6>

"I was told by Social Security when I turned 65 in 2024, that I HAD to sign up for Part A. I refused part B. They said if I didn't sign up for Part A when I turned 65 there would be a penalty. Was that untrue?"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgwdlCslJmi3TBp1vTJ4AaABAg>

↳ @tayfan2 (0): "Medicare sign up is 65. For SS you can wait up til age 70+. Go to their website for FAQ or Google it in any AI powered browser search bar. There may be other videos on this channel to cover that topic."

"Im turning 65 in Feb 2024, I was told that if I didn't enroll in medicate at least part A, then when I did decide to enroll, there would be a penalty, so I enrolled in part A only. Im covered by my employers health plan, an I have an HSA. This is the first time I have heard that you cannot have an HSA , how would they know, and what are the penalties?"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgwAX97t8_MOgHexCdZ4AaABAg

"I was told when I received social security I was told that if I didn't sign up for Medicare I would have to s penalty."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugzw9Jvgw0fJ9I0BRUp4AaABAg>

↳ @Rembrandt1981 (0): "It is about \$40 more per month for life. Even if you are on it and it lapses. Penalty premium for life."

Tab 5 — Frustrations

Prior authorization and insurers second-guessing doctors · 481 documents · 20 voices

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

↳ @ChrisRI1000 (135): "Plan G was a life saver. My wife contracted a rare autoimmune disease. The disease affected almost every single organ in her body requiring uncountable numbers of specialists. She has numerous expensive treatments and procedures, was intubated in a ICU for 12 weeks, etc. The hospital bill was way past the million dollar mark. I saw not one single bill from all that. When she died it threw me into this awful whirlwind having to deal with the loss, making arrangements, contacting numerous businesses, and all the fallout of her death. I can't imagine what it would have been like adding in every single bill to deal with, refuting charges, calling the insurance company due to denials (and the sick games they play), etc."

↳ @2BeeMe (66): "I had an advantage plan for 8 years. It worked great for the first 6 years until 2 of my doctors quit taking my insurance. My premiums were \$0 and I had gym and vision benefits. Things got tricky when I had an emergency and the closest hospital didn't take my insurance. I was in ICU for 5 days. Follow up visits with specialists and physical therapy were now a regular thing. Lots of copays. The next year I was diagnosed with cancer. I needed an oncologist for my type of cancer. I didn't get a choice of doctors. I went to the only one in my network. Again, lots of scans and copays. Last fall my insurance company notified me they weren't staying in business for 2025. It was a blessing! I was now guaranteed acceptance to get original Medicare with supplemental plan F (because of the date of part B start) without underwriting. Getting medical care this year is so much easier without networks, prior approvals and copays. You can go where you want to whatever doctor. If you can afford the premiums I recommend it. I've had both and there is no hassle anymore."

↳ @jenniferperry-pk5zt (32): "@ChrisRI1000sorry for your loss 🥹 "

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAq>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"I spent the last half of my career working in the billing office for a medical specialist group. I dealt with everything from private insurance, worker's compensation, medicare, medicaid, etc. By a large margin, the problems I encountered with payment denials came from Medicare Advantage plans. And most of those happened because people did not understand the rules of their plans. Thanks for the informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 232 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwMop0zRDK1CKkLhJ14AaABAq>

↳ @pacmanc8103 (7): "Although, it would seem as though a lot of the issue is with provider groups not confirming Advantage plan coverage prior to treatment. It seems like pre-auths are needed - I'm not sure how most patients would even know how to communicate with insurance carrier or have the relevant information. Stuff only the provider could know."

↳ @Melanie-ix4nq (2): "I'm seeing the payment denials because of in proper billing to the insurance company (using the wrong code) I'm showing that on one of my claims in my portal."

↳ @SipLeila (1): "@Melanie-ix4nq That is common but it is often the nurse's fault."

"Exactly! I am 76. Have been on Original Medicare with a Supplement since turning 65. Was quite healthy at 65. Few health issues. At 63 I was remodeling a old house, doing almost all of the work myself. Tearing up old flooring. Refinishing wood floors. Tearing out old updates in the kitchen that were poor and putting in new cabinets. Did have my Son and Son-in-law help me with things I could do alone, like hanging upper kitchen cabinets, etc. At 67, my health suddenly began to fail. I have had numerous hospitalizations and surgeries since then. I have been able to go to specialist within a few days, without pre-approval. I have friends on "Advantage" plans that have had to deal with needing numerous referrals, waiting months for testing and surgeries, while I breeze through seeing specialist and getting surgeries within a few weeks. Do not expect that you will always remain healthy. Our bodies are great machines, but let's face it. As any machine ages, more and more issues evolve. Don't fall for the "Advantage" hype. It won't advantage you when you are truly in need of medical care."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 224 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugx5CVy8MAo_bxfGmzd4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (13): "Thank you for sharing your story — it's such an important reminder. Many people feel great when they first start Medicare, but as you've experienced, health can change quickly. Having a Supplement plan makes a huge difference when it comes to getting timely access to specialists and surgeries without the hurdles of referrals or pre-approvals. You make a great point: while Medicare Advantage can look attractive upfront, those restrictions can become very frustrating once serious health issues arise. Your experience really highlights why so many people value the freedom and flexibility of a Medigap plan. I'm truly sorry to hear about the health struggles you've faced, and I wish you continued strength and healing as you move forward."

↳ @franks4973 (6): "Sorry about your health but thank you for your response. HC is my big concern and even though I am healthy at 62 and like you do a lot of my own work. It was nice hearing another voice of reason regarding Medicare. Thx"

↳ @reneeblack8940 (5): "Hello which supplement plan are you using"

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAq>

↳ @RonMac08 (18): "@nealjones84 She's doing well, recovering quickly."

↳ @nealjones84 (13): "Congratulations 🎉 how is she doing now after major surgery"

↳ @ckstaff (13): "Sooner or later you get to realize and feel how smart you were in choosing right. If you did have advantage, she may have died waiting or you would now be bankrupt paying a huge out of pocket. I witnessed first hand a friends husband die in bed with Leukemia when he was sent home after 1 day in hospital because the advantage company had their loophole as to why they would not pay. He spent the next 3 weeks fighting denials and appeals in his soon to be deathbed. He died before he ever got approved."

"I live in Ohio . I am on plan N with the wife . I pay \$91 a month at 69. I had stage 3 cancer last year and paid very little out of my pocket .Very happy as I could pick my doctors and hospitals I wanted ! Every bill was paid fast !! No denying services too !! Original medicare works like a charm !!!! Dont fall into the Medicare Advange trap !!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 194 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwvfURn5XXCLWCAGlp4AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (16): "Thank you for sharing your experience — I'm really glad to hear you're doing well and that Plan N worked so smoothly for you. Having the freedom to choose your doctors and hospitals is a huge benefit of Original Medicare with a Medigap plan. Your story is a great reminder of why so many people value that flexibility and peace of mind."

↳ @rvmadnessrvmadness9406 (12): "I'd like to see his recommendation living on the salary of SS. \$200 a month can make a difference on whether you eat or not. I recently had a heart attack and the bill was over \$300,000. I paid \$700 out of pocket on an advantage plan."

↳ @mammothenterprises2921 (3): "As I stated above I live in Florida it's \$230 a month."

"This is the ONLY unbiased YouTube on both options. This gentleman is an agent and that's very rare. I can name two, no three agencies that do nothing but flood this site with constant negative videos about Medicare Advantage Plans. The one guy always has a thumbnail with his eyes wide open and his hand over his mouth. Scare tactic, nothing more. Supplements are great, but millions of Americans have advantage plans that do what they are designed to do without issue. I personally have experience using both for more than a decade. Original Medicare should be requiring more pre-authorizations and in the coming years this will happen. The government has been getting ripped off for decades. Oh, we like cats!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 171 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgxT0a_1CgP1_SKsFld4AaABAg

↳ @douglasjensen8986 (2): "You are absolutely correct. In my humble opinion, the "Never Advantage" agents/brokers are committing professional malpractice. (I love dogs and cats, and assorted other critters, too.)"

"As an Oncology provider for over 40 years I will tell you that there are other issues to consider which in my opinion make a G plan even more helpful. One of these issues is that G plans allow you to seek expert care outside of an Advantage plan PPO list of providers and institutions. I practice in a rural community and often send my patient to larger Comprehensive Cancer Centers around the country where they can get the best care for their unique situation. As I understand it, some Advantage plans may not pay as well in these situations. The other issue is prior approvals. If I order a diagnostic study such as a PET scan or MRI, or an IV chemotherapy medication agent, with a G plan there is no authorization process and these items will be paid for (assuming I am practicing within accepted guidelines). An Advantage plan may require a prior authorization before the test or medication can be ordered. These prior authorizations are a huge burden to providers and staff. Indeed, at many large institutions they will not spend any time on these and that means a less than ideal test or drug may need to be substituted."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 164 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCl8m0OI18&lc=Ugyjp1bQqNodSTf4TMd4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (7): "Thank you for watching and sharing your insights!"

↳ @nevermind7253 (6): "Thank you so much for this information! I've had cancer I'm going on Medicare very soon I'm terrified to be honest with you! I was on Medicaid and everything thankfully was covered. But with these changes I'm scared and don't know what to do"

↳ @techserviceondemand9409 (6): "@Theretirementnerds This video is really good, I also live in a rural area but less than 6 hours (driving) from Mayo Clinic, so a Plan G is a no brainer. On top of that, if you do not have cancer, you can run up that \$5000 (or \$3000) max out of pocket in a hurry."

"LEAVE advantage plan OR RISK YOUR LIFE. WARNING: Medicare Advantage Plans Can Delay Care With No Consequences Please read this carefully—your health and your life could depend on it. I just found this out on Friday after speaking with an attorney. If you have a Medicare Advantage plan, you are NOT protected if your insurance company delays your care in bad faith—and right now, you have no legal recourse. I found this out the hard way. UnitedHealthcare's algorithm delayed my cancer treatment for five months. When I first found a lump in my neck, my cancer was stage one. By the time I was finally able to get treatment, it had progressed to stage three. Five months lost. Five months where the cancer spread. Now, I am left with irreversible side effects and a permanently diminished quality of life. These are facts. It's public knowledge if you do the research. I recently spoke with an attorney who confirmed my worst fear: Because of a 2023 Supreme Court upheld with the ruling listed bellow. You CANNOT sue a Medicare Advantage provider for delaying your care for BAD FAITH. The law was made in 2023. (The California Supreme Court's decision in Quishenberry v. UnitedHealthcare) -2022 Read that again. They can delay your treatment for as long as they want. They can deny and restrict access to life-saving care. And you have NO legal way to hold them accountable. If I had traditional Medicare or a standard insurance plan, I may have been protected. But under Medicare Advantage, patients have no rights when insurance companies prioritize profits over their lives. And if you think this is an accident, think again. These companies are making billions from Medicare Advantage while rationing care and exploiting legal loopholes that shield them from responsibility. Look up how much they've profited—while patients like me suffer the consequences. It's public record. You have until March 31st to switch back to straight Medicare if you are currently enrolled in an Advantage plan. Do your research before it's too late. I am looking into a class-action lawsuit, and I will be writing to my state senator—because this is criminal. No one should be forced to endure what I have. Please—share this information. Protect yourself. Protect your loved ones. The system is rigged, and right now, patients are paying the price!!!"

— r/medicare · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jcgwz2/>

↳ (0): "I have Stage IV cancer with Original Medicare and Medigap. Everything has been covered with no issues since my diagnosis. Your experience is a nightmare and echos what I've heard from other cancer patients. Some patients have no issue with Medicare Advantage but some experiences have put people's lives in jeopardy and I applaud you for telling your story."

↳ (0): "Are your bills higher? New to Medicare and need brain surgery. Soon. I was going to pick an advantage plan due to medical bills, seeming like they would be lower with advantage versus medigap. But now I'm thinking, after this post and your comment,for my current situation medigap would be smarter. This is all so confusing to me. Any advice I'd appreciate. Thank you."

↳ (0): "With our medigap G we only pay the \$257 deductible per year. Our monthly medigap plan cost my husband \$160 per month. He has lymphoma and gets ct scans 2x per year, pt scans, mri, specialists, all at no extra charge and no hassle. Unless you are healthy and don't need more than a physical once per year, I would recommend traditional Medicare and the medigap G."

"I have plan G-----I had a heart valve replaced and then a series of health problems, plan G made sense to me. My old workplace health plan was a PPO and I got tired of having to wait for pre authorization, and sometimes got turned down. If I need a cat scan or Mri, there is no pre-authorization. So far, plan G has been good for me"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 134 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgZr0UmEPHaqKRmCcjl4AaABAg>

↳ @JBerger1983 (8): "@jackfrost-fu7hz Surprised your former PPO needed authorizations. Usually that's HMO. I have PPO with my employer...no authorizations needed. Actually why I chose PPO instead of HMO."

↳ @gindie1 (7): "@JBerger1983 Might you be confusing pre-authorization of procedures with needing a referral to see a specialist?"

↳ @RonMac08 (6): "We have Plan N. My wife had an open heart surgery to replace her aortic valve. Even with all the doctor visits and procedures, it cost us less than a Plan G with the larger monthly payments. My sister is younger than my wife, and her Plan G is over \$50 a month more than our Plan N."

"What decisions as you near retirement are "time-sensitive"? As you near retirement (say, 65) what decisions are "time-sensitive"? We had a close call with almost being unable to get a Medicare supplement (Medigap). Was not aware you get a *one-time* 6 month window when you first get Medicare that insurance/supplement companies are *required* to allow you to enroll and cannot deny you (or charge a higher rate). Individual here was pressured to take Medicare Advantage and lost their guaranteed issue timeframe and had to go through medical unwriting and was initially denied and had to appeal to get approved. This makes me wonder, what other decisions regarding retirement are "time-sensitive" or something individuals may not think about and/or realize before it's too late?"

— r/retirement · 121 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1n0pjc2/>

↳ (0): "If you intend to purchase long term care insurance, the sooner the better."

↳ (0): "Your health. My husband got sick and I retired. It helped that I was offered a decent buyout. And I don't regret"

↳ (0): "I found a great consultant who helped me find the best plans for me. Find an expert to help you with the Medicare / insurance stuff"

"I think it is called Advantage plan is because it advantages the insurance companies as they often deny care."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 119 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugys1pC3NFzodwwwYlh4AaABAg>

↳ @jn1ty (5): "You are going with the wrong provider. My wife and I have never been denied anything."

↳ @pattyann2108 (4): "Do not, I repeat NOT use United Health Care on the Advantage plan. UHC is a sunburn of a nightmare - a mess and my hospital dropped them. I signed up with the Advantage plan at the hospital. All went smooth until they sent a letter that said Advantage is going away in Oregon? :("

↳ @ourhouseofg (1): "Sunburn, do you talk about Medicare and TRICARE?"

"This video was so informative. My late husband was blessed to have a Supplement Plan G. Prior to beginning Medicare he began having neurological problems and was diagnosed with ALS. Thankfully we were able to receive the treatments he needed without the stress of co-pays, referrals, or pre authorizations. Instead of the healthcare process being a bear to deal with, it seemed more like leading a lamb."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 98 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxnPLA_JdSH8Od-IRF4AaABAq

↳ @debbbycoffey4788 (7): "You never mentioned underwriting, questions about your health, in order to switch from a MA to Original Medicare if you aren't happy with the Advantage plan you chose. I understand it can be very hard to switch if you have an underlying condition. What are some questions they might ask to deny you from switching?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "So sorry to hear about your husband. Yes, the ease of use is quite different between the two plans. I like your animal analogy 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "@debbbycoffey4788 we have a video that goes over switching. And, we just finished filming an update to this video where we go through the medical questions in more detail that we hope to release next week. Hopefully you are subscribed and can see that when it comes out. Here is the existing video: <https://youtu.be/djuGel829M4>";

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— r/medicare · 88 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1op2r5b/>

↳ (0): "Bad insurance is great when you don't use it. Medicare Advantage plans work great when they aren't used."

↳ (0): "Exactly this. What happens when (not if) significant chronic conditions coupled with acute conditions accumulate? None of us is getting any younger. Once you're locked into MA, it can be *very* hard to get out, and once they start denying needed care, you will need to start fighting them for your life."

↳ (0): "Nope. Wife and I both have Advantage plans. Her's is used a lot. No problems. I wish people like you would stop making general statements you really know nothing about. It works well for half the Medicare recipients."

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

↳ (0): "You need to consider the monthly insurance premium for the Medicare supplement, too. One reason many people sign up for MA is that they cannot afford the supplement premiums. Everyone pays the monthly Part B premiums, then on top of that, they may pay a monthly supplement premium, if they sign up for a supplement, and they will have drug insurance (Part D) premium, which they should sign up for even if they do not take medications now, to avoid paying a penalty later. If they sign up for MA, rather than a supplement, some MA plans, but not all, have a monthly premium. Drugs are included with MA plans."

↳ (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm making a file and adding new info as I go along. It's overwhelming!"

↳ (0): "5. The amount of commission an agent gets varies extremely from plan to plan, company to company, etc. Not set in stone at all like the numbers you have listed"

"Prior authorization for Medicare Beginning in January 2026 people on traditional Medicare (not Medicare Advantage) in 6 states-Arizona, New Jersey, Oklahoma, Ohio, Washington state and Texas-will have to prior authorizations for spine surgery and some other types of care. This is a 6 year pilot program. They will use an AI algorithm. This seems dangerous to me when you consider the disruption in healthcare by insurance companies who already use AI algorithms to ration healthcare. There is a lot of incentive for AI companies to deny care. The AI companies will share in "savings" they create."

— r/medicare · 80 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1n5f4zw/>

↳ (0): "It's a step forward in making Medicare like the advantage programs and then removing all advantage programs because they are redundant. I said this once before and everyone gets in a hissy fit. One day Medicare as we know it will be going away. The money is needed to pay down the deficit while the war machine asks for and gets more than what it needs. Medicare was instituted at a time when our government sort of still worked for the people. It doesn't matter any more who you vote for because the needs of everyday Americans are cared for just enough to shut us up."

↳ (0): "Having to say this all the time, but "Actually Medicare Advantage is bad for everyone except the insurance companies." No. Have had great service for many years and yes have had out of state care and other medical issues. I just wish people would stop with this in this group."

↳ (0): "Rick Scott, wealthiest Senator, Republican Senator of FLA & the one who presented the end of SS to Heritage Foundation (Project 2025 aka Koch Network): <https://www.britannica.com/biography/Rick-Scott>";

"Matthew: I have a Medigap Plan N with you and Original Medicare. I am so thankful I followed your advise and made this decision. About 4 months after being enrolled, I was diagnosed with Colorectal Cancer. Treatments included a surgery (3 days in the hospital) and 12 Chemo treatments with my Oncologist over 8 months. I am currently in surveillance, with CT scans and annual Colonoscopies. If I had no insurance, I estimate the cost of treatment at over \$250,000. To date, my out-of-pocket expense has been about \$750 plus the cost of premiums. At NO time has anything my doctors have prescribed been evaluated or denied by someone else. And I didn't have to wait on any treatments. I am alive today (and hope to be for years in the future) because of the Medicare coverage I have been given. Thank you, thank you for all your efforts."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 78 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugzcg6gBrwkdkxQiGx54AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (5): "Thank you for your comment Bob. It's always good to have a story with a happy ending. It's stories like these that motivate us every day!"

↳ @wynetteabc (1): "May God continually bless your health. Were any of your out of pocket expenses for excess charges? I'm trying to decide between the High deductible G plan and the N plan. Thank you. :)"

↳ @metaphysicalministries6863 (0): "This video is very informative and he hits it on the head with the differences between Medicare Advantage and Medicare Supplement plans. It's also about having the client in mind and their specific needs and determining what's the best coverage for their medical needs and budget as well. Both plans have their Advantages and Disadvantages; it just depends on what works best for the client and their present health. Some clients maybe more healthy and a Medicare Advantage plan maybe best for them and don't need to use it as much or some clients may not be as healthy and go to the doctor more frequently and a Medicare Supplement plan maybe better because it covers more with less out of the pocket expenses. I'm licensed in NY, TX and 32 other states and anyone needing help choosing the right plan or has any questions about Medicare Supplement and Medicare Advantage plans can call me directly at 929-352-6044. I can send you brochures, documents, forms and other materials and go over all the information with you and there's no cost. Also if clients can't afford Medicare premiums maybe eligible take advantage of the Medicare Savings Program that helps cover the Part B premium 100%. Clients also maybe eligible to save up \$2,041.20 or more in Medicare cost. The eligibility requirements are: (2022 monthly income limit for a single person is \$1,549, married (living together) is \$2,080 and the 2022 Total Resource Limit for single person is \$8,400 and married (living together) is \$12,600). Anyone interested in learning more and would like to know if they're eligible can give me a call. I'm here to help."

"I have a Medigap plan N and would not consider an Advantage plan unless I could not afford one financially. My main reasons are because I do not want to hand over my medical decisions to a for profit insurance company (Advantage plan) which will dictate what medical care I will be able to receive and where I will receive it. These plans can, and routinely do, deny care. I want any medical decisions on my care to be made by me and my doctor, not an insurance company who is beholden to shareholders and is only concerned about their own profits. If a specific treatment or procedure is determined by my doctor to be medically necessary, Medicare will cover it and my Medigap plan will pay, no questions asked. However, that is not the case with an Advantage plan, who can refuse to pay, forcing treatment delays or an outright denial for the patient receiving the care they need. The patient is then left in the unfortunate situation of having to go through the appeals process in an effort to get the care they need, or paying for their treatment out of their own pocket."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 71 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugw5RQFbE3SDniC5Hb14AaABAq>

↳ @kciis (9): "You make some excellent points about the importance of having control over your own healthcare decisions. Medigap plans certainly provide a level of security and peace of mind for many people. Kai & Ann Chung"

↳ @buggy5 (3): "You appear to be somewhat confused. The companies that offer Medigap coverage are also in business to make a profit for their shareholders - they are not non-profit. According to a study by CMS - the advantage plans are costing the taxpayer much more than Medigap plans. This is because the government pays the advantage plans a certain amount of money every month - regardless of whether the policy holder receives any medical care or not. The advantage plans are currently making many billions of dollars in profits every year. They have essentially zero incentive to pay out on a claim - unlike Medigap plans, whom must pay if Medicare pays."

↳ @MaryBethMcCoy (2): "@alfonso1781 You are welcome, and I am so sorry you are having to deal with a denial. My advice to you in this situation is to make the extra effort and appeal the decision, since I think that over 70% of the time, you can win if you stay persistent, assuming you and your doctor are in agreement that your procedure is medically necessary and covered by Medicare."

"After working in healthcare (I'm a psychologist) through the heyday of managed care, and knowing how important it is to me to be able to choose my own doctor (they aren't all the same!), I went straight to Traditional Medicare. I know that there are some great Medicare Advantage plans that people really like. But people often love their plan until they get very sick. Then the claims start getting denied. My best friend and I were seeing the same physical therapist. I could get as many sessions as my doctor would recommend. She had to beg for more sessions, haggle for a reasonable cost due to confusing payments from her Medicare Advantage plan, and end PT before she was better. It was appalling! You may believe you are saving money with a MA plan. But if you have to pay for physical therapy or some other service that isn't covered, you'll send up spending more. And God forbid you need prior authorization for something before getting much-needed treatment! There are horror stories of people who have died waiting for that prior authorization. Ever notice how many ads there are for MA plans? Guess where they get that money? It comes out of the premiums they collect. That's money that won't go to healthcare. This is just wrong."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 70 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwEXrTu6t2HMOVp_to14AaABAg

↳ @GAderly-fn5ly (8): "Most of these stories are made up by those selling those supplement plans. The MA plans MUST cover EVERYTHING that original Medicare does BY LAW! In more than 15 years on a MA plan we have NEVER been turned down for ANY care covered by Medicare or the .A plan! There are rules these plans MUST go by. Several times my MA plan has even gone out of network for me and paid the ENTIRE cost even though I would have had a copay in network. If you can't read your plan, please have someone else read a d explain it to you. I call CMS first if I expect a problem. If my MA plan doesn't have a supplier within a reasonable distance, they have gone out of network. At one point Walmart optical refused to sell me the transition lens for the plans agreed upon price so I purchased the glasses anyway but complained vigorously and they sent me out of network to purchase another complete glasses both frames and lenses and paid the entire 420 dollars!"

↳ @trumpetingangel (5): "@Rnjeepshoelver Right. They are making money off of those plans, and that's money that just doesn't go to healthcare. Plain and simple."

↳ @glw5166 (4): "@GAderly-fn5ly Nobody should have to complain that much to get what they need. Very glad that it worked out for you but it may be denied for another."

"What a great and thorough explanation. Thank you, most sincerely. I, and a friend, are both seniors. She with and Advantage Plan and I chose Supplemental. We both have the exact same diagnosis. Routine testing is required. Her coverage is approved for 1 time per year and has been denied for more frequent testing. My testing is approved for every time my doctor wants to do it (every 3 months). I will be pointing many to your video. Just to make the point: I have another friend, also a senior, that is older than me but very healthy. She's very happy with her no cost Advantage Plan. Thanks so much. Like an elephant, I'll never forget (God willing ☺)"
— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugwuu0qLpz1SPRsjnFd4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much!! 🐘 so glad it was helpful and thank you for sharing your experiences!"

↳ @logicalblueberry (0): "That's what makes choosing so very difficult. My husband and I are healthy and in our early sixties. We would hate to waste money on an expensive health plan that we will hopefully never use. However, two of his siblings have died from cancer so???"

↳ @judysouzaw2293 (0): "Before I retired 8 years ago, my employer paid most of my UnitedHealthcare supplemental plan F after I turned 65. Now I'm 79 and still in good health, thanks to the love and joy I receive from my cats Denny and Donny!! Every year I call UHC to see if there is a cheaper plan and why my plan has no perks at all. I hesitate to switch to an advantage plan and be under covered if I encounter a costly medical event. I pay separately for Plan D and also dental coverage. I can afford all the premiums, but it doesn't seem fair. I know I'm grandfathered into plan F, but should I at least think about switching to plan G? Thank you very much."

Too confusing to compare · 456 documents · 20 voices

"I like the elephant. :) I had no idea how complicated and layered the system is. I've checked books out at my library on Medicare, researched online, talked to friends, and I recently discovered your channel. Your presentations are concise and logically structured. I was dumbfounded when I first started researching Medicare, I'm turning 65 in May, This is a great channel and comments are informative too."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 240 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgzZx9D3ilHuxXtdoPR4AaABAg>

↳ @michaelparadis5483 (1): "Nothing was mentioned about high deductible plans for G and N. Also are there additional plans? L , M , others?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Glad you found me! Thank you so much for watching and your kind words! 🐘 "

↳ @hoosier_daddy65 (0): "So Beth, what did you go with?"

"Erin, this is your best video ever! I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed. Thank you, thank you, thank you 🙏 "

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 234 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRlqEu63hwvh4AaABAq>

↳ @BirdandDiz1957 (13): "My wife and I chose a Medigap Plan N plan four years ago. Literally 2 months after beginning my Medicare journey I had a really bad accident that required the trauma unit, two surgeries and a blood clot issue. My total bill for all that and two weeks in hospital was \$86 after meeting the Part B deductible. I could have argued \$50 off that amount because they charged me that amount for the ambulance even though I was admitted. It wasn't worth going through the hassle. My wife is a cancer survivor so our broker strongly advised her to stay away from an Advantage plan. If you do go that route and then have medical issues and expenses get out of hand then you will have to go through medical underwriting and probably will not be able to switch to Medigap. Keep that in mind."

↳ @geraldarcuri9307 (11): "So, you're NOT going to sign up for an Advantage plan, right? A waste of money, and no choice of physicians or hospitals."

↳ @trackguy4038 (9): "I agree!!! Best video ever!!!"

"As someone turning 65 next month this type of information is very helpful. The way they have set everything up could not be more confusing and inefficient."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 129 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwddBLZOMhdw-fYFsl4AaABAq>

↳ @kimdagnillo8246 (9): "They do that on purpose, that's how they use their excuses on how you get penalized later on."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (6): "Agreed! Glad this was helpful."

↳ @irenegriego2446 (5): "That's cause there forcing people on this cause they want your money"

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

↳ (0): "You need to consider the monthly insurance premium for the Medicare supplement, too. One reason many people sign up for MA is that they cannot afford the supplement premiums. Everyone pays the monthly Part B premiums, then on top of that, they may pay a monthly supplement premium, if they sign up for a supplement, and they will have drug insurance (Part D) premium, which they should sign up for even if they do not take medications now, to avoid paying a penalty later. If they sign up for MA, rather than a supplement, some MA plans, but not all, have a monthly premium. Drugs are included with MA plans."

↳ (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm making a file and adding new info as I go along. It's overwhelming!"

↳ (0): "5. The amount of commission an agent gets varies extremely from plan to plan, company to company, etc. Not set in stone at all like the numbers you have listed"

"My wife has been working with Brian for over a year now. He and his team are dedicated to helping folks not only during the initial Medicare set up process but long term. We are very happy to be able have his and his team's expertise to navigate this complicated process. I will have to go on medicare myself in the next year and a half and I'm grateful to know I will get the best plan for my circumstances just like my wife did. BTW, He did not ask me to endorse him. I just want folks to know Brian and his team are the real deal. They know what they are talking about. 🙌🙌 Shout out to Mike B ❤️"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 78 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxTEu8VeCwPtWAf_zp4AaABAg

↳ @medicare365 (6): "Thank you sir. I will be sure to tell Myke B."

↳ @nighthawk_predator1877 (2): "@medicare365 My bad Brian. We have his name 2 ways and I picked the wrong one to reference. He is indeed Myke. Oh and plez let Myke know Carolyn and Ann said hello and we'll be in touch soon! You wouldn't know by my avatar but I am in fact not a "sir". 😊 ❤️❤️"

↳ @saketashol6728 (0): "I second that. Brian and his team are straight shooters and take all the fog out of understanding Medicare plans."

"Good info! I'm on Plan G. I do see a doctor more that 2 times a month. Medicare is so darn confusing & frustrating!"

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 76 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgyIBq27pyMHhCEeUp14AaABAg>

↳ @skorky2 (17): "hey ...y'all like me....i'm watching all these vids also.....so da*n confusing....hard to trust anyone, any company, or any agent !!"

↳ @afanofdieselengines675 (4): "It cant be easier! On Plan G you go to the doctor, hand the billing person your medicare card and the card from your Plan G carrier. They photocopy them and you walk out the front door of your healtgcare provider and thats it. No co-pays. Ever! The only thing you have to pay for are the very reasonable monthly premiums. Ours are \$145 for her and \$156 for me. We are both 68 y.o. Very thankful we signed up for plan G as soon as we went on medicare. Ultimate peace of mind."

↳ @lizzy-wx4rx (0): "@skorky2 Please look for a SHIP counselor in your area. SHIP = Senior Health Insurance Program. It's a FREE service offered in every state. I'm training to be one right now. Most SHIP counselors are volunteers (that go through extensive training) and have NO financial incentive to recommend any plan. They just explain how it all works. (They can also help you choose or switch your Part D drug plan every fall, based on the prescription drugs you're currently taking.)"

"After working in healthcare (I'm a psychologist) through the heyday of managed care, and knowing how important it is to me to be able to choose my own doctor (they aren't all the same!), I went straight to Traditional Medicare. I know that there are some great Medicare Advantage plans that people really like. But people often love their plan until they get very sick. Then the claims start getting denied. My best friend and I were seeing the same physical therapist. I could get as many sessions as my doctor would recommend. She had to beg for more sessions, haggle for a reasonable cost due to confusing payments from her Medicare Advantage plan, and end PT before she was better. It was appalling! You may believe you are saving money with a MA plan. But if you have to pay for physical therapy or some other service that isn't covered, you'll send up spending more. And God forbid you need prior authorization for something before getting much-needed treatment! There are horror stories of people who have died waiting for that prior authorization. Ever notice how many ads there are for MA plans? Guess where they get that money? It comes out of the premiums they collect. That's money that won't go to healthcare. This is just wrong."

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↳ @glw5166 (4): "@GAderly-fn5ly Nobody should have to complain that much to get what they need. Very glad that it worked out for you but it may be denied for another."

"I am a former Computer Programmer and think very logically. I agree, the entire American Medical Industry is 100% criminal along with medical insurance companies. After I was eligible for Medicare I thought my med insurance problems were over. I found out EVERYTHING is so confusing and unnecessarily complicated it is a complete nightmare. It started with the governments little rule about if you are born on the 1st of the month your initial enrollment period is different. Then it went to you have 12 months to avoid part B (in some specific instances LOL) and not get the lifetime penalty. It is very strange and not by accident that you have to pay the government for medical insurance and THEN need go out to buy more medical insurance."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxVVOM4Fb2X-xO5SGJ4AaABAg>

↳ @TomSpeaks-vw1zp (19): "Thank you marblox9300. I'm just a 12th grade educated everyday citizen. I came to that same conclusion years ago. Now at age 84 all this double talk & different plans for this & maybe not for that makes my mind shut down. It's typical lawyer & government BS. If we considered all the spending waste in this country, healthcare could be 100% free & still have money left over."

↳ @evelynmitchell2888 (2): "I found out about the first of the month rule too, the hard way. They should put this in the information when they give you your Medicare instructions, which is a joke too. I am having the same issues."

↳ @MarlizeClarke (2): "this is excellent thank you"

"Turning 65 next year and Medicare enrollment is way more confusing than I expected assumed I'd just sign up and be done. then found out about Parts A, B, C, D, Medigap, and enrollment windows with actual penalties if you miss them biggest surprise: the enrollment window isn't just your birthday month, it's seven months — and missing it can mean a permanent premium penalty. a free broker consultation helped untangle Advantage vs Supplement plans more than searching on my own."

— r/medicare · 62 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1wksnot/>

↳ (0): "I suggest that everyone start researching 2 years before signing up. You will think you understand it, then you find out something new that changes everything for you. Then repeat and repeat."

↳ (0): "Contact your State's SHIP staff. They provide FREE, UNBIAS information so you can navigate the Medicare maze and make an informed decision. Find your's here: [shiphelp.org](<http://shiphelp.org>);

↳ (0): "Besides the deadlines, biggest decision is whether to go with traditional Medicare plus supplement or go with Medicare Advantage."

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/>

↳ (0): "Counterpoint: if you are a literate adult that knows how to use a plan compare tool, you don't need an agent"

↳ (0): "The medicare.gov search tool actually does give the pricing model used for each result."

↳ (0): "If you're a literal adult and can read a law book, you don't need a lawyer and can do it yourself."

"My wife turned 65 a few years ago and I thought I was a wise man with the ability to think and understand things. NOT WITH MEDICARE. It is so confusing to the average American"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 55 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211lpLq6moM&lc=UgwxSooBO1Y9mfd2BV94AaABAg>

↳ @anacolon1142 (3): "Indeed it is. There is so much information that gets thrown at you all at once before you turn 65. I'm still confused."

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAg

↳ @peterfrank1572 (6): "I'm in my 60's, retired, and I'm literally planing to leave the country before I reach 65. This is complete madness. And when you add the manufactured wars and immigration crisis, I've concluded that the American government only intent is to hurt as many people as they can !"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (4): "They don't make it easy :("

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>;
— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/>

↳ (0): "In terms of coverage, traditional Medicare and a supplement is going to offer more choices and flexibility than a Medicare Advantage plan. Whether or not it's affordable for everyone is another story. The unfortunate truth is that more and more of our senior population is living on poverty wages and simply can't afford a Medicare supplement. Also, most retirees have been covered by managed care plans for a good portion of their working careers, so dealing with provider networks and utilization management is not a novel concept. With annual max of pocket costs under \$4000 for PPOs in my area, many of these individuals are choosing a zero premium MAPD option and paying for the care they use as they use it. Are MAPDs right for everyone? Of course not. But, the market has spoken on Medicare Advantage plans. More than half of the 65 million Americans on Medicare are currently enrolled in Medicare Advantage plans. They aren't going anywhere. It's important to discuss the potential risks of MAPDs, but it's not inherently the wrong choice. **Edited for auto cor-wrecks"

↳ (0): "I get several calls a day from foreign call centers regarding Medicare. They are frequently aggressive and sometimes vulgar. My latest weapon - your insurance license number... I ask: if you sell Medicare related products in my state you must be licensed, what is your number? The next sound is a click."

↳ (0): "This is correct!!! OP is very uneducated in Medicare... clearly!!!! and can be proven by going to Medicare.gov!!!! I hope this post was satire. But please y'all do not listen this this is not correct."

"As a 72 yo American (my husband is 74), I appreciate your attempts to enlighten the American public. It is a convoluted world we live in, but I appreciate laughing along while you point out the absurdities. Thank you!!! P.S. I LOVE Megan and Nick!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 45 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=Ugwk5KjV0Ejg3qhxoF4AaABAq>

"What are the most common Medicare mistakes people make when turning 65? I work with people who are turning 65, and I've noticed some recurring Medicare pitfalls — like enrolling late, overpaying for the wrong plan, or thinking Medigap and Advantage are the same. I've been pulling together a checklist of the most common questions and confusion points people have when starting Medicare. Just wondering what others here think are the most common or costly mistakes you've seen? Would love to hear from other agents, advisors, or anyone who's helped a parent or client through it."

— r/medicare · 44 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jujn7m/>

↳ (0): "Choosing an Advantage plan based on premium price alone, and not paying attention to factors that will affect quality and accessibility of care. Co-pays vs co-insurance, star ratings and other quality metrics, network, prior authorization restrictions, etc. Failing to understand limits on guaranteed issue for Medigap. Failing to understand special enrollment periods, especially for people coming off employer plans. Failing to understand the interplay between Medicare and COBRA."

↳ (0): "The best advice is to consult a broker. It's free and helps take the confusion out of your decisions; we found it invaluable."

↳ (0): "Or better, start with a SHIP counselor who has no toe in insurance money."

"All I can say is wow! I'm 66 and past the age of choosing. I went with good old Medicare and medigap, thank goodness. But the research required to make good decisions was overwhelming. I'm happy that moving forward people will have access to your complete and well explained tutorial on this most important decision as we approach retirement. You have provided an incredible service, Erin, and I'm sure your dad is very proud of his daughter."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 38 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugzrq2ND9UayBnM6cKx4AaABAg>

"Thank you SOOOO much. You have answered questions for me that I have been asking for years! You made the information about choice of doctors and coverage area simple to understand without double talk that confused me. After listening to you I now understand the difference and I will always stay with Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 38 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxUgNQdZ9jlmq_CnhR4AaABAg

"NPR: Older Americans say they feel trapped in Medicare Advantage plans JANUARY 7, 2024 8:10 AM ET HEARD ON WEEKEND EDITION SUNDAY By Sarah Jane Tribble - Kaiser Health News 3-Minute Listen (Story first aired on All Things Considered on January 3, 2023.) UNIDENTIFIED NARRATOR: Right now is the Medicare annual enrollment period. 2024 Medicare Advantage plans are now available, so everyone on Medicare can call to see if a Medicare Advantage plan may be better for you. RASCOE: The plans are private insurance that Americans 65 and older can sign up for instead of traditional Medicare. And lots of Americans are signing up in this open enrollment period through March. Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News reports that some regret signing up and then have trouble getting out. SARAH JANE TRIBBLE: Back in 2016, when Richard Timmins first signed up for Medicare, he went to a free informational seminar with an insurance agent. RICHARD TIMMINS: Basically, he really promoted Medicare Advantage. He just said, well, look, it's less expensive. It's broader in coverage. TRIBBLE: For Timmins, it made economic sense to sign up for Medicare Advantage instead of traditional Medicare, and that worked out great - for a while. Then, he found a small bump on the back of his right ear. TIMMINS: I have a family history of melanoma, so I was kind of tuned into that and thinking about that. TRIBBLE: But it took him a long time to see the right specialist in his Medicare Advantage network, and getting the paperwork in order was confusing. TIMMINS: It was starting to - it started to grow and started to become rather painful. TRIBBLE: By the time Timmins finally saw an oncologist, the lesion had grown to the size of a dime. His right earlobe needed to be removed. He thinks getting care using traditional Medicare would have been faster and easier, and David Meyers at Brown University School of Public Health says he's probably right. DAVID MEYERS: You can see any provider you want. There are many less sort of restrictions on care. You get a lot more freedom with traditional Medicare. TRIBBLE: Timmins wishes he could switch, but there's a catch. TIMMINS: Would I go back to traditional Medicare if it was not cost prohibitive? Absolutely. TRIBBLE: Traditional Medicare premiums average about \$170 a month. And while enrollees on Medicare Advantage plans still pay that premium, the monthly cost can be more affordable. That's because plan enrollees often don't have to pay for extra prescription coverage. They also don't have to buy supplemental insurance, usually called Medigap. That supplemental insurance is needed because, unlike Medicare Advantage plans, traditional Medicare doesn't cap out-of-pocket cost. The thing is, Timmins might not be able to get a Medigap policy anymore. Here's David Lipschutz, associate director of the Center for Medicare Advocacy. DAVID LIPSCHUTZ: Medigap is one of the few types of insurance that can exclude you based upon preexisting conditions unless you enroll during certain designated times. TRIBBLE: That designated time is primarily when you first sign up for Medicare. But since Timmins enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan instead of traditional Medicare and he has a preexisting condition, he could be denied Medigap or charged a lot more for it. While federal law generally prohibits insurers from denying people coverage because of preexisting conditions, Medigap is an exception. Lipschutz again. LIPSCHUTZ: It's a lot easier to get and stay in a Medicare Advantage plan, but a lot harder to get out and pick up a Medigap plan, depending upon where you are. TRIBBLE: Only four states require Medigap insurers to cover applicants regardless of age or health. But Timmins lives in Washington state, which isn't one of them. He wants people to know. TIMMINS: You can get screwed if you're on Medicare Advantage. The advantage kind of disappears once you need them. TRIBBLE: In the meantime, Timmins worries. There's a chance that his cancer could come back, and he'll be trapped on Medicare Advantage if it does. So he's focusing on what he can control. TIMMINS: You know, I'm a vegetarian. I don't drink. I don't smoke. I try to get exercise as much as possible. TRIBBLE: But he knows it might not be enough. RASCOE: That was Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News. Copyright © 2024 NPR. All rights reserved. Visit our website terms of use and permissions pages at www.npr.org for further information."

— r/medicare · 35 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/192eueh/>

↳ (0): "I am so grateful that I happened to get an agent who explained that Medicare with a supplement was better in the long run than Advantage. I knew nothing at the time. I was really lucky."

↳ (0): "My husband became disabled. He worked for a fortune 100 company and had gold plated everything insurance including healthcare through CIGNA. Two years later when he went on Medicare, we picked an advantage plan by CIGNA. They were fantastic. It was seamless. Granted we are in a major city with amazing medical Everything. All his doctors, including an entire transplant team, and every specialist you can think of, Plus Oncology eventually, were available and we did not have any long waits for anything at all. I qualify this year for Medicare and hope there is a CIGNA advantage plan available."

↳ (0): "I think the rub is that you don't know what you'll need further down the line. Common illnesses are one thing. But there's a slew of less common ones and if you get one of those, there's a huge chance you'll be cut off from the doctors that treat them. I wish we had healthcare that was the same for everyone. The way it is now is inefficient and confusing for most."

"New to Medicare This Year - More Confusing Than I Thought! I had helped my mother and my mother-in-law with their Medicare in the past. I also had worked in Human Resources early in my career and learned a lot about insurance. So I thought that signing up for Medicare would be easy for me. But, not having looked at this stuff in at least 10 years, I found it a lot more confusing than I had expected! I'm turning 65 in a few months. I'm in SF Bay area of California. I already know that I want traditional Medicare and not Medicare Advantage. I started taking Social Security at the beginning of this year (2025) so I automatically got a Medicare number and automatically got enrolled into Parts A & B. Now I need to pick a Plan D for drugs and a Medigap plan, which I already know will be a Plan G. In that regard, perhaps I'm ahead of the game. But picking a Plan D and a Plan G is turning out to be much harder than I'd thought it would be. I was glad to have watched a few YouTube videos about the process for signing up for each of these things -- that helped a lot, as well as reading the Medicare website and some info from AARP, etc. I found out that some of the Part D plans I was considering have limits on how many pills can be filled in 30 days for some meds. An SSRI that I take requires 90 10mg pills each month, because I take 25 mg per day and there is no 25 mg pill (nor is there a 50 mg that can be cut in half). So the plans that limit me to 30 10mg pills per month are a non-starter. (Sure, I could probably have my doctor try to appeal and get the 90 pills per month covered, but there is no guarantee that the insurance company would agree....and then I'd be stuck! Not worth the hassle!) This information was kinda buried at the bottom of each Part D plan on the Medicare website. It would have been a "bad surprise" to learn this after the fact! Regarding Part G -- this really surprised me -- the only Part G plan for my area that shows the premium and extra perks upfront is the AARP United Healthcare plan. ALL of the others don't even have a special page (or set of pages) about their Medigap plans! How are you supposed to compare the plans if you can't even see what you're paying for? I understand that all of the plans cover the exact same things; that's not what I want to know. I want to see rate tables (because most of them are Attained Age plans. The AARP one is Community based rates, and one other that I'm considering, Transamerica, is age at issue based rate). I also want to see if there are any perks beyond the regular plan coverage (like gym membership or whatever). I don't want to have to go through an agent or get a broker involved. I've had bad experiences with them in the past. I want to do this myself and sign up directly with the insurance companies. I truly don't understand why NONE of the Medigap providers in my area have ANY information on their websites about Medicare or their Medicare plans. When you click on the "company website" link on the Medicare website, it takes you to a general home page about the insurance company. I have tried searching these websites for "Medicare" or "Medigap" or "Plan G" but the searches come up blank. Why even offer a Medigap plan if you're not going to show your benefits to your clients online???? I don't want to have to waste my time calling 3 or 4 insurance companies! Only AARP seems to be upfront with any of this stuff. It's so weird, and I truly don't understand it! Am I missing something or misunderstanding something? Are the insurance companies deliberately making it hard for people to understand exactly what they're buying??"

— r/medicare · 33 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ls9lyr/>

↳ (0): "I agree you can't find true info without contacting companies individually. I found that there are some options that might make it difficult. Smoking makes a difference, paying yearly can make a difference. Someone else in the household with the same company can make a difference. Wearables can make a difference. Like you I spent hours on YouTube (glad I did), called a few companies directly then got retirement nerds involved after I had narrowed things down. They actually placed the policy for me after helping to answer a few questions. Figuring all of this out was like a job. It worked out well for me. Good luck."

↳ (0): "Don't go with UHP. Profiteers from the pain and suffering of humans. Major lawsuits and denials. It amazes me this country still has not gone to universal healthcare. I'm on the original Medicare ABG&D. G is with Anthem BC. No perks. Simple and easy with my Drs. No issues so far in 13 months. They are profiteers as well,

but I think they are less evil than the rest. D plans are stupid. They all have their "formulary" lists and none are the same \$\$ for identical drugs. Tier 1/2/3/4 garbage. But it's better than nothing. I have Wellcare. Not great but cheap. I've heard from friends in the SF bay area that Kaiser advantage is excellent. Of course you have to use them. But they are well established there. I'm in an area where there are hardly any Kaiser facilities. The agents that "help" are paid to drive you to their plans. They make \$\$ on your payments. Agents should be eliminated. It's a parasite business."

↳ (0): "Untrue about agents that drive you to their plans. Most agents are pretty good folks doing a good job. Signed, a parasite. D plans aren't stupid. If you don't get one, you get a penalty. But go ahead and not get one... see how that works out. UHC is fine - no different than any other carrier that you are bashing. Thanks for your nice, helpful post, btw!"

"Thanks for the thorough explanation. I've been asking Medicare questions well before the requirement age of 65. And now 6 years later. I am just as confused. To top it off, I worked at an agency that did not pay into social security. Which means I have to pay a larger Medicare premium. Nobody has given an explanation like this about the differences in this Overwhelmingly confusing process. I subscribed."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxY7Fsdm7cNK0RMdXx4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (4): "Thanks Connie! Sorry you'll have to pay more than you should."

↳ @Kim7-77 (2): "Its so uneccesarily difficult to understand. I still don't know what to do!! I live in Manhattan, NY , just got approved for disability and I feel there are no options that I can afford ."

↳ @rmhalili (1): "There are some employers (read school districts) that don't contribute to Social Security, however, there is a separate line item for Medicare. I would check you paystub. If there is a medicare line with a dollar amount, and it has been paid for 40 quarters or more then you will get no premium Part A. Part B cost \$170.10/month for most middle class"

Premiums that keep going up · 162 documents · 20 voices

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAg

↳ @Is-aka-Pari (2): "What do you do if you really can't afford any extra payment, say if your SSI is very low?"

↳ @cristianbaluta1232 (1): "The government is composed of a bunch of careless irresponsible incompetent people who are there for one goal only - to get all the money from those outside the government. To expect these people to do their "job" is naive bordering stupidity."

↳ @rachelisnosy (1): "@Is-aka-Pari Definitely apply for Medicaid. Some people only get their part B premium paid for, but that's still \$200 that you don't have to spend each month. Regardless of what type of plan you have, you can apply for a social security program called Extra Help. It will cap your drug copays at \$12.65, even if the drug costs \$2000 normally. I would recommend anyone without Medicaid, to apply for it. Don't talk to any of those people who cold call you. I would ask your doctor's office who they work with, they'll know which companies work with them the best."

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tbdbvh/>

↳ (0): "Unless you live in a birthday rule state that allows you to switch plans, or you can pass medical underwriting (which is unlikely given your health issues), you're stuck with your current Plan G. If you're stuck, see if your current Plan G insurer will allow you to switch to HD Plan G (high deductible) without medical underwriting. Premiums would be dramatically less. Another option is to move to a Medicare Advantage Plan. Even that may not guarantee any savings because while the premiums are likely to be \$0, there are copays and coinsurance and an out of pocket maximum of \$9250. Given that your current premiums for Plan G are \$5500/year, and that is likely your only out of pocket expense, it might not make sense to move to a \$0/month Medicare Advantage Plan if you end up spending the max out of pocket of \$9250. Even with copays and coinsurance, you'd likely not hit \$9250 (the max out of pocket), but the real question is how likely you are to hit \$5500 (the cost of Plan G premiums). You'd have to look closely at what the out of pocket costs would be for whatever Medicare Advantage Plans you were considering. If you think the cost of copays and coinsurance would be less for Medicare Advantage than the premiums for Plan G, then switch. Of course, if you are low income, then you should also investigate Medicaid options, but just know the income thresholds are pretty low."

↳ (0): "If you really want to go Med Adv, and duplicate the original Medicare as best as possible, gotta go PPO for out-of-network support, and the OOP for that is \$13,900. In 2027 it will be in the neighborhood of \$14,800. Otherwise, one is stuck on networks with HMO. For most stuff that is fine. But, if it's the big C? I had enough money to afford PPO to expand choice closer to original Medicare. It's not really Medigap or Med Adv. It's Medigap, or PPO, or HMO. But, PPO only makes sense if one can operate the plan fully, and that does require a spare \$13,900, although there are cheaper combined OOPs for PPOs. I saw a \$7400 ppo last fall."

↳ (0): "I'm not a Medicare Advantage nay-sayer, but it's worth pointing out that even with a PPO you can't necessarily go to any provider you want to. Some places don't take PPOs."

"The more my Plan N increases annually, the more I'm inclined (against my better judgement) to start looking at a Part C Advantage Plan instead. I went with Plan N because I believed in the idea of "Pay me now or pay me later", where I protected myself against high deductibles and annual outlays by paying a (reasonable) monthly premium. Sadly, "Pay me now" is becoming "Pay me a LOT more now, and every year until you die." Also, we need better oversight of these insurers. Offering low costs for a year and then inflating prices once you have attracted a bunch of subscribers should be illegal. Or at least a Medicare plan cost should be guaranteed for a reasonable amount of time. I would be much happier paying more when I sign up, knowing that my premium won't increase to shocking levels for years."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 57 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxVyp4MBD-dEhPeZlh4AaABAg>

↳ @chevelleflorida (8): "To me, if one can afford a medigap/supplemental plan, that is the best option. The biggest issue with Advantage plans is the level of care that you will receive. For example, I know someone who had a heart attack and stroke last year and was referred to a SNF/rehab center. The MA plan was calling within 3 days talking about discharging the patient even though they were not ready to go back home. With traditional Medicare, that person likely would have received 100 days. Fortunately, moving to a SNF, creates a qualifying event to change insurance and we were able to move he patient back to traditional Medicare with a supplemental plan that they already had (Tricare for life.) In truth, the broker who signed them up for a MA plan did them a huge disservice. No one with a Supplemental plan should move to a MA plan."

↳ @Farrodee (5): "In two years my plan G went from 1500 to over 1800 per year. I don't even take any meds and rarely see dr!"

↳ @vanguy9780 (0): "@jaygrenham education is a wonderful thing. You should try it"

"I understand your point about averages. I chose HD-G when I turned 65 and started on original Medicare. Out of pocket expenses have been manageable and in line with my expectations. I'm 70 now. My biggest challenge is the annual premium increases. You showed 2-4% as an average for HD-G. My premium increases the past 3 years were 14%, 20%, and 21%. Combined, the increase was 59% higher than the premium from 3 years ago. I can still pass underwriting and switched companies, which helped some. My overall worry is these type of increases aren't "sustainable" over 15-20 years..."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 54 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzxVpDFzqjIW527Aop4AaABAg>

↳ @dennisdavis4792 (6): "@MrA@MrAndyinbethesda On HDG since the very beginning. Initial premium was \$60.40/mo. I understand it varies widely depending on where you live. Increases the last 3 years are: \$66.54 to \$75.86, then to \$91.15, and now the 2026 increase is to \$105.73. That's ~ 59% over 3 years. Switching companies so won't be paying the \$105.73."

↳ @Geronimo2Fly (2): "@dennisdavis4792 Wow those are SIGNIFICANTLY higher increases than I thought would happen with the HD plan. That's very disappointing. I assume you switched to another HDG?"

↳ @MrAndyinbethesda (1): "Assume you started with a Plan G and not HDG at 65 or your increases would not have been that level?"

"I started Medicare in 2018 at age 65. Every single year I have had rate increases that far exceeded 5-8%. I left United plan G in 2024 as their rate increase jumped drastically and sent my premium well above \$200 a month. I switched to plan N through, you guessed it, Ace. The rate started at \$113 a month and in 2025 increased to \$126 and for 2026 just went up this month to \$154. These high percentage rate increases are wearing thin. Texas resident."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 52 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgyL5MEueBzKhmgghgJ94AaABAg>

↳ @Merzui-kg8ds (17): "The US is a FOR PROFIT medical care nation. As long as we treat healthcare as a for profit industry, costs will be manipulated to increase profits."

↳ @myvenusheeler (12): "@Merzui-kg8ds Well, the flip side to that is socialized medicine has plenty of issues too."

↳ @bobbo11357 (12): "@m@myvenusheeler Socialized Medicine aka the rest of the world. Germany, Sweden, Japan, Argentina. Every country has problems but do those countries health systems bankrupt their citizens?"

"After hearing about 50%+ increases for supplement plans, I'm not going to complain about the 12-13% hike in my Plan N."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugwp0mGewFXxJSrJY3t4AaABAg>

↳ @miessy9633 (3): "Same, as long as it doesn't keep doing this year after year"

"anyone that is 65 and over must pay for medicare cost that is paid from social security, about \$175 a month. the 20% supplement can cost \$150 a month , plan G and goes up each year with United Health Care. So annually, one pays \$1800 plus the annual deductible of \$240, or \$2000 a year for health insurance. no co-pays and no other expenses to see the doctor or ER visits after the annual deductible is paid, \$240. the original medicare pays up to 60 days in the hospital. 60 days is a long time. In most cases, one will be discharged within 60 days. From age 65 to 75, most seniors would not be staying in the hospital for long periods of time. the goal is to make appointments to see the doctor and do preventive care. take advantage of the plans. the part that I have a problem with is, medicare advantage can change its policy and they are for profit. the medicare advantage tangle carrots like free stuff , some dental work, glasses, and partial payment for hearing aids. plus gym membership which are available on some supplements. some medicare advantage plans do not pay if you leave the network. when the original medicare, I can go to any ER and do not need to worry about a co-pay. with advantage plans, there are doctor visit co-pay and ER co-pays and drugs cost money, with kaiser advantage plans. if one starts with the original medicare, you are guaranteed , no need to qualify. if you start with an advantage medicare plan with zero to little monthly fee with some free stuff, if you wish to go back to the original medicare plan, you have to be screened and qualify. the questions, do you wish to pay \$2,000 a year that gradually increases with the annual \$240 deductible , then unlimited doctor visits and ER visits? or be nickled and dime with office visit cost, ER cost , and subject to having the advantage plan approving your bill with possible surprises? I have to make a choice soon, nothing is free in life. All I know, I am currently paying \$1000 a month with kaiser and it cost me \$\$\$ for office visit, lab work and if I need to go to the ER. if I have to have a test performed, I have to still pay. So the \$200 a month supplement is reasonable with the original medicare. Again, Nothing in life is FREE, especially when our congress is swayed by private insurance companies trying to get a larger piece of the business. I hear many horror stories with private advantage medicare plans. they surprise Americans with large bills since the coverage does not pay for certain treatments. IMO"

— YouTube · Original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage: What's the Difference? · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=weO1WkquA3s&lc=Ugzaix7JeWu8Hgkw-fB4AaABAg>

↳ @ESMEE_4EVERR (0): "Jvgknftiokfpmgibdhcujjgbjjg"

↳ @AIH-p2u (0): "I'm surprised you think it's okay to pay 2400\$ a year plus dental plus vision plus medication and think it's everyone's best option. Many ppl are healthy and can save 2400\$ etc for 5-10 yrs then go into a chronic plan with little max out of pocket saying you thousands but if you're ill and have my doctors then supp is the way to go UHC offers both mapd pdp and supp I am contracted with them"

↳ @bozomonster (0): "The math doesn't workout in your if your paying \$1,000 per month to Kaiser. The max out of pocket with a Medicare Advantage Plan is \$5,000."

"My 2027 S.S. may increase \$105 /month . Then minus \$7 /month increase Federal Tax , Minus \$ 7 month increase Medicare pt B , Minus \$161 / month increase Medigap plan (confirmed) and minus \$15 month increase Prescription plan leaves me \$85 / month net less than 2026 with . S.S. yearly adjustments are NOT keeping up with inflation and things like food prices , gasoline and energy costs & health insurance should be considered when adjusting yearly S.S. benefits."

— YouTube · 2027 Social Security & Medicare ALERT: What You'll Actually Keep · 28 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RIP9Ickspiw&lc=UgwbPDVT1v0P_OtZGyh4AaABAg

↳ @MichaelD-md4fh (6): "Your SS benefit of \$2900/month is well above average. Consider those average folks trying to get by on 2/3 of that."

↳ @kjFL1 (4): "@MichaelD-md4fh why should he have to consider that. He's just expressing what actually pertains to him. It's horrible for everyone, but we can't be responsible for that."

↳ @kevin9742-o9g (1): "@ronb493 I didn't have to pay \$800 / month for health insurance , included as part of the benefit package . Although your right some year's raises were small...."

"Mutual of Omaha Plan N in AZ raised my premium 25% this year. Still competitive in market and the service is great."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgwB6RPpKWm-6iD-mMp4AaABAg>

↳ @policyguides (4): "That was a big increase, but unfortunately, we're seeing it across many carriers right now because claims costs have gone up industry-wide. The good news is Plan N in Arizona is still very competitive overall, and Mutual of Omaha has a strong reputation for service and stability. This is also why it's important to look beyond just the lowest starting premium when choosing a Medigap company."

↳ @Pamela_Marie (0): "@policyguidesI just started Medigap with Mutual of Omaha plan N. 103.00 a month for the rest of this year. I am in Ohio. Just turned 65. I have till the end of October if I want to change without underwriting so I'll be revisiting again to see if this is still the best plan. At the time I chose this their rate of increase was less than 25% I believe last year. In my ZIP code it was the lowest rate of increase plan. Who knows what it's going to be like next year. I just met my deductible and so far they seem to be okay. I need to be in this type of plan because I have to travel outside of my area for care at the Cleveland Clinic. Can't qualify for the discount because my husband has been on Medicare Advantage UHC for over 10 years or close to it when it first started. He just entered home hospice."

"I live in Michigan. My plan G supplement increased over \$100 a month this year. I now pay \$329 a month. I called to find out why. They said it is based on the amount of services that are used in the area that you live. By the way, I will never use an Advantage plan as long as I can manage to pay for a my supplement."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=Ugypl6HFOjBsasr7DgN4AaABAg>

↳ @mk4kate (1): "I pay over \$200 and live next to a big hospital, go figure?"

↳ @jmas2312 (0): "You are right to do so."

"Game, set, & match for the govt. We pay into medicare all our lives, then after 65..... we have to pay to supplement what we've been paying for all our lives, and it increases every year."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgwVSuJ83pQwxlCGolJ4AaABAg

"I joined my AARP UHC Medigap plan in March (Southern California) and less than 10 days later was informed that next March my rate will be increased by 14% ! Welcome to retirement 😞 "

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgytflNfgzCPshFvyjl4AaABAg>

↳ @paulstein916 (4): "You are still within your 6 month initial enrollment, so you can change your carrier or your plan if you want. And CA has a birthday rule too, so you have some options to change down the road if desired."

↳ @steves3688 (3): "Mutual of Omaha did the same...stopped a discount I was getting for having another over 60 person in the household and then upped the premiums...25% total increase for Plan N....."

↳ @KurtRothwell (1): "Keep voting Democrat. See how it works out for you."

"I HATE doctors. I HATE insurance and I avoid both at all costs. This all makes me cringe. Unfortunately I have to make a decision in a few months and I honestly don't know what to do. I want to choose Traditional Medicare, but with my rent jumping up every year, I'm going to be homeless next summer on Traditional Medicare. There is no way I can afford double digit increases on supplements. I don't like the Advantage plans at all either. What's a Senior supposed to do? Take what I can afford and just die when Advantage denies a procedure is what it's looking like. Great options 🙄 after working our whole lives. It's ALL a racket."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugwcgxlchxqa2pLRBYx4AaABAg

↳ @adoptacat2877 (3): "I'm in the same boat. I hate our healthcare system. As always you only survive if you have a high paying government job or a wealthy person the rest of us lose everything if we get sick and even if you don't get sick right away the copays on these advantage plans are not affordable. We are screwed and that's why so many millions of people die needlessly in our country."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "A lot of moving parts for sure! Appreciate you watching and sharing. Highly recommend working with an agent familiar with your area. Takes a lot of the guesswork and fear out of the equation for you :) Thank you for making it to the end ;)"

↳ @eduardooramaeddie4006 (1): "You could say i agree with this gentleman"

"I have Humana part D and pay \$9.90/month. For the two prescriptions I filled since I joined Medicare a while ago, I paid \$3 each. I was surprised how inexpensive part D was compared to anything else. My part G supplement increased \$40 between the time I signed up and the time the plan took effect. I built added inflation and premium increases into future budget since everything is always going up. Thanks for your unbiased information."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgxQeLHWlxNE6h3TPTx4AaABAg

↳ @kirkbixler2335 (0): "I agree. I found my Humana part D plan right off medicare.gov and mine is \$0 a month and (lucky for me) my generic drugs are free"

"Your discussion while very informative, ignores the very real IRMAA adjustment to the Medicare Part B premium. I found out the hard way. While the 2026 Part B premium increases to \$202 per month, my Part B premium will increase by an additional \$324.60 per month for a total Part B premium of \$527.50 due to IRMAA (this is in addition to the premium I pay for my Medigap plan). This increase in my Part B premium is due to the fact that I withdrew monies from my 401(k) plan to maintain a fairly standard middle class lifestyle as I live in San Diego, which is a very high cost of living area. Moreover, the IRMAA adjustment must be paid regardless of whether one enrolls in a Medigap or an Advantage Plan. Many seniors are not aware of this time bomb when withdrawing from their 401(k)s. Perhaps a video focusing on IRMAA would benefit and alert seniors about this seemingly "hidden" Part B premium increase that is lying in wait."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxB-sft1CicsFwsf3B4AaABAg>

"Thank you for this clear explanation, I do think however if rate increases continue at around 25% for plan N and G, high deductible G is going to see some big changes as well, where I live blue cross does not even offer it, also after coming off of a very high deductible insurance plan, dealing with all the bills coming in from all different providers is exhausting, sometimes there are problems and discrepancies to be worked out, when you're young and relatively healthy no problem, but if you are older with a serious illness that's the last thing I'd want to deal with or would I even be able to, esp. for seniors with no family."

— YouTube · Everyone's Sick of Medigap Rate Increases...Here's What to Do! · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NQHG_o1vxVU&lc=UgztjTX92OfeNuuDrhx4AaABAg

↳ @sandiegohome03 (2): "This was the only reason I skipped HDG "dealing with all the bills coming in from all different providers is exhausting, sometimes there are problems and discrepancies to be worked out""

↳ @sfree322 (1): "That's where I am in the decision making process, quickly approaching age 65 and deciding between G and HDG. The mental load seems like it would be so much heavier with the HDG even with the savings in premiums. I live alone and some days the brain fog is quite thick, my friend! 😊 Honestly, though, this is one of the toughest decisions I've had to make in a long while."

↳ @usaman7358 (0): "Please, please, please. Can anyone tell me WHY the "mental load" is any different on high deduct vs G??? I don't get it. The only diff would be the number you owe, not the process along the way. Am I wrong?"

"Thank you Stephanie. That was very good information. I hope the listeners will stay to the end of your video. Because the most important cost information is at the end. Case in point, my supplemental premium jumped up 50% from one year to the next. Talk about sticker shock. Fortunately I was healthy enough to pass underwriting and switched to a better company. I think this is not the case for many subscribers. Bottom line: don't get tricked by the "lowest" first year cost! It may turn into the highest cost within a few years."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=Ugy5eASDtgdM4Solg5l4AaABAg>

"Thank you! I appreciate all the work you put into this. I would make a small correction to your presentation: Some of us (not many, comparatively speaking) live in states where we can switch plans around our birthday and not have to go through medical underwriting. Living in California, I am one of those blessed ones and I plan to switch when my next birthday rolls around because my horrible medigap provider (AARP, United Healthcare) raised my premiums by 11% this month!"

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgxYnqYRwy-DZsr2tEB4AaABAg>

↳ @hopespringseternal2624 (8): "@MikeD_ I was on MA at first. But then I started researching and I would NEVER choose MA now. Fortunately I was in my 6 month window where I could switch back to original Medicare. Please be careful. With MA you DO have to go through medical underwriting and have to get pre-authorization for many services. They often do not cover for cancer treatments, etc. You may save in the beginning, but that savings could cost you your life. When I wrote the above I was only writing about switching Medicare plans, not MA. Medicare Advantage plans are not Medicare. They have nothing to do with the government. Please let me know if you have any questions."

↳ @MikeD_ (4): "I believe that's the same in NY. I'm not eligible for Medicare until later this year so I'm currently in research mode, but I believe there are four states that allow customers to move between MA and Medigap plans without going through an underwriter. On the flip side, I suspect we pay significantly higher premiums for that capability."

↳ @TC-yi3ue (0): "@hopespringseternal2624 wow good to know! I am 65 and just getting ready to enroll in UHC through AARP!"

"This was very interesting. I was all ready to switch over to Plan N this year, but then I saw that Plan N with Aetna rate increased just as much percentage wise as Plan G, according to our state insurance dept. website. So now I'm wondering if the insurers are looking to make up for lost time with big Plan N increases too."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgyHGtoV4VaJ6SJQOKI4AaABAg>

↳ @myvenusheeler (1): "You know there are other companies carrying Plan N than Aetna."

↳ @steves3688 (1): "YEP...I just got hit with 25% increase from Mutual of Omaha....they took my discount away (person over 60 in household with discount - now that person has to be insured by them as well) and upped the premiums....PLAN N! I just switched to another insurer but still got hit with a 10% increase from what I was paying...."

↳ @threeftr3349 (0): "What state and zip code are you in?"

"I would like to thank you Stephany and Carter (my agent) to help find new supplemental insurance for my 72 years old husband. His supplemental insurance MOO raised price double in 2026. Thank you ABT agency they found insurance with good price. Because of their help process got easy and without any problems. Suggesting other seniors to ask ABT agency for help if price going up."

— YouTube · Medicare Parts A B C D Explained - Everything you need to know! · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wci4BBmjXfo&lc=UgyZ7KePa0Lo3DKSaIR4AaABAq>

Part D: drugs dropped from the formulary, prices that jump · 70 documents · 20 voices

"People on Medicare advantage plans, what is your experience? So, I am planning for retirement and by FAR the largest line item in our future budget is healthcare, especially after Medicare kicks in. So I am just wondering...is medicare advantage adequate for you? Is there a lot of services/medications not covered at all that you need? Did you keep some of your same doctors or lose a lot of them? I have a pacemaker and a replaced heart valve (mechanical). I am on warfarin, atorvastatin (cholesterol med), and metoprolol satrite (blood pressure meds)....any one have issues with those on medicare advantage? Also, take sertraline (generic zoloft). Just weighing my options. Last questions....if you had to work an extra year or two in your early 60's to be able to afford medigap insurance (plan G)would you...or would you retire earlier? Why / why not? Thanks for your time and considerations. , "

— r/retirement · 95 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1jddz0q/>

↳ (0): "Hey folks do note that we are conversational, not confrontational, here. Also - In order for us to read your comment- you need to be a member , Hit the JOiN button. These guidelines for our supportive and respectful community , can be see in the rules. Unfortunately, you have to dig a little for them via the landing page of our subreddit. Thanks and have a good day, MAM"

↳ (0): "I worked in Medicare insurance for years and still do so take my opinion with a grain of salt. There are benefits to both medigap and Medicare advantage, but overall medigap (also called Medicare supplement plans) have more benefits for most people. The biggest benefit of advantage plans being that a lot have a \$0 premium and include some dental and vision benefits and other benefits so I've seen very healthy people just turning 65 start with an advantage plan for the first few years and "roll the dice" so to speak on their health while paying \$0 monthly premium. The only issue is we don't know when our health will turn and like some comments, to switch to a supplement plan later, there is health underwriting that could disqualify you at that time. Advantage plans also have yearly out of pocket maximums that range anywhere from \$3000-\$8000 for anything not routine. Hence the "rolling the dice" comment. When first starting Medicare, you have an open enrollment period where you can qualify for any supplement plan with any company regardless of health, and a plan G for example will cover 100% of your medical costs after the Medicare part B deductible. (\$257 in 2025 but typically increases a bit each year) the monthly premium varies by state but for someone starting Medicare at 65 years old, you're probably looking at \$90-\$120/month. Also no networks, accepted in all 50 states the same."

↳ (0): "Don't go with an Advantage plan. Use straight Medicare and get a Medigap supplemental. Work as long as you can."

"Part D 2027 Increases Mine is going up 72%. Just a little bit more?? Are we winning yet? I have a semi-rare disease that requires specialty medications and already pay more than the average boomer."

— r/medicare · 87 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1wkq5nz/>

↳ (0): "Thank you Mr. TV Doctor Sir! May I have some more please?????"

↳ (0): "My Wellcare Value Plan is going down to \$5.27/month, down from \$6.00."

↳ (0): "My wife is on that but it won't cover my specialty meds."

"The thing that gets me is after you chose a Part D plan and start using it the following January, the insurer mails you a report of what you have been buying and spending. The report mentions they can drop the drugs you are taking at any time. Which leaves the patient at the mercy of a Part D insurance plan dropping your drugs from their formulary any time they want. So what is the point of picking a plan based on their formulary when they can change it during the year?"

— YouTube · The \$9.8 Billion Medicare Subsidy Just Ended — Here's What Really Happens to Part D · 35 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pfLylplem30&lc=UgzhuPCRU98hddyASlx4AaABAg>

↳ @ggjr61 (10): "Unfortunately all insurance companies do this. I don't understand why this is allowed. I totally understand being able to change the formulary before open enrollment but I don't think they should be able to change it mid stream."

↳ @alansach8437 (4): "Yeah. You are stuck for a year. They are not."

↳ @youngtimer964 (0): "While this is technically true, it has never happened to us in 7 years of having Part D plans."

"I didn't know that Part D gets increased as a penalty for not getting it right away ...I didn't get it. Oh well. Have had Part A for 5 years and Part B for 4 years (got it just before turning 66 so no penalty) and never used either one of them so far. I think we're getting a really crummy deal though."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugzkn6c2pKk0nxWoi1V4AaABAg>

↳ @user-TM59 (2): "Part D does carry a small penalty monthly, Part A and B doesn't cover prescription drugs nor dental. You have to purchase a standalone plan for dental. You'll need part D for your prescription drugs"

"Me also. I listened to my doctor at the time that warned me against the 'advantage' plans. It hurts when I have to pay full price for any prescriptions, but at least I'm not getting denied coverage. Which has happened to friends of mine. I admit, I was close to signing up once until I mentioned that to my doctor. He was adamant about running away from those plans."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 17 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwLHliq9v5_Sx1UGW14AaABAg.AZufjqX7PNbA_5IJRy-YC

"Thanks again Erin! Yes, for my husband who has all kinds of chronic medical conditions, we missed the window for Medigap after he turned to 65. So we got Medicare advantage for him, and it has worked out. Then when I turned 65 a year ago, I hopped right on Medigap. I have no medical conditions, fairly healthy, and I am on one prescribed medication. I actually ended up paying far more than he did throughout the year and Medigap and part D were about to increase significantly. So I changed to Advantage and to save over \$3000 this year."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxkRafGiwGdwZhaAGt4AaABAg>

↳ @bozomonster (3): "Your experience is very common."

"Part of the problem is that the Base Medicare payout for doctor visits, tests, imaging , procedures, surgeries, and other related costs, is not keeping pace with inflation, and so the medi-gap policies are footing a larger and larger chunk of the costs. I'm 67, just about to turn 68, and in almost three years, iv'e seen my Blue Shield of California premiums go up over 30%, and my bare bones Part D from Humana double, and that's before these new increases. It's unsustainable for all but the richest individuals. Who can pay \$1000 a month for " Supplemental" insurance, Medicare is collecting HUGE amounts of premiums from workers and employers, where is all the money going ???"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgxrnrelyKu5u4lTlud4AaABAg>

↳ @bugsy2902 (0): "They only pay 20% of what the medicare bill is so no that isn't true! It is greed! The Part D is due to the fact that they don't allow medicare to negotiate drug prices with big pharma and have lowered the donut hole to around \$2K a year, but that is also linked to inflation and will grow. But Congress lied when they said the donut hole would close in 2020!"

"As a licensed agent, I absolutely agree. I understand why mapds exist, because not everyone can afford a supplement, let alone part b premium. I will also like to point out however, that sometimes, especially in areas of Florida, there are great mapd plans out there. The fact of the matter is, most people don't venture out seeking multiple doctors, and rarely seek routine service out of their service area. Heck, most people wouldn't even know what to do if they are diagnosed with chronic condition. I am slowly warming up to mapds because those who live in hardships, and have health conditions have no other choice. Original Medicare needs to be increased because besides that part d and part b premium, never mind the ancillary "not covered" services like vision, hearing or dental (what a joke)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwIBspUINt_ZTfu8bN4AaABAg

↳ @akita96th (0): "You haven't had to shell out the \$7500 out of pocket expenses yet.... That will wake you up."

↳ @stuntmasta305 (0): "@akita96th this is pretty much the norm for most private healthcare coverage under 65. Not including Aca, or Medicaid. For those on OM, it goes on forever, unless you have a supplement that you pay anywhere between 100-300 a month, plus a separate part D with no dental, vision or hearing in consideration. There are plans with considerable less MOOPs, not uncommon in populated areas to have moops as low as 800. The ugly side of mapds isn't always the cost, but the utilization management."

↳ @akita96th (0): "Like I said its all fun and games until you really get sick then they put the screw on you. All I am saying is those who say they can't afford a supplement will realize when they get sick that maybe they could have afforded it after all once those out of pocket bills start piling up. It is a shame seniors have to live like that in this rich country thanks to the republican party. Any senior citizen on a fixed income who votes republican deserves all the misery old age can muster. MAGA does not love you back."

"Just a caution about switching from an Advantage Plan to A supplement. Make sure your advantage plan is explicitly cancelled or you may end up with both a supplement plan and an advantage plan and no drug plan. This happened to me. United Health automatically enrolled me after I was enrolled in a supplement. But when I tried to enroll in a drug plan, I was denied on the last day of the enrollment period. By the. It was too late to fix. A quirk of the system. Ended up having to get ugly about cancelling the MA plan in January, pay for a month of it and start my drug plan Feb 1. I even had chat records where United Healthcare's reps, 3 of them, told me my MA plan was cancelled. Even had a screenshot one of them shared with me that showed it was cancelled. But come January 1, I was welcomed to a United Healthcare MA plan. I was livid. But there were no options to undo United Healthcare's actions."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgyEXYhFKfZjy5FJf2F4AaABAg>

↳ @afrocraft1 (0): "Sorry about your experience. What did your annual notice of change (ANOC) say? That's the document that matters, not chat logs."

↳ @techadsr (0): "@afrocraft1 The ANOC was received before the enrollment period and before I started enrollment into a Supplement plan away from the Advantage Plan. Why would that matter?"

↳ @lyndayoung8761 (0): "The letter from the Carrier that states they are pulling out of MA in your area is your Golden Ticket to medigap without underwriting. Other changes are business as usual as they morph and jockey about with Extra Benefits and copay costs to get your attention PICK ME, PICK ME"

"Received 2027 ANOC for my husband's Part D plan and his monthly premium increased 66%!! Increasing from \$113.90/mo to \$189.10/mo in 2027. In addition they increased the annual deductible to \$300 and increased his payment of 21% of the cost of his tier 3 drugs. And the max OOP raised to \$2400. The 66% increase in part D drug plan, along with a 20.5% increase on supplement plan N and the increase in the part B premium will result in a negative loss. The SS COLA will be a joke compared to these increases for 2027."

— YouTube · Another HUGE INCREASE: Medicare Part D Drug Cap Has JUMPED 20% in 2 Years !! · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C_kBm_imXLg&lc=Ugzmb_hb6OF18-uuaJx4AaABAg

"Thank you for this video. My cats are learning as much about Medicare coverage as I am. They are probably thinking "just make the change, already!" Yes, I'm making the change to Advantage due to the costs. My plan G and plan D prescriptions are just too expensive for my very limited budget."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugxzb_eaL814QxXio754AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Thank you so much for watching and I'm glad to have some cats following our content as well :)"

"My part D went up \$10. My husband's up \$5. Of course we do not know about each of our personal drug prices yet but we're happy with the raise in price. Could be a LOT worse! Going to wait to figure out that part once we can just go to Medicare and plug in the meds. Happiness level may change once that is done."

— YouTube · Shocking Medicare Plan Changes Coming for 2027 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HJ98mctbEC8&lc=UgzQf44704c0Oniz7bp4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Glad the costs aren't bad! Thank you for watching and sharing!"

"Retirement is very expensive if you need medical care, devices, etc. on a regular basis. We pay \$150 (approx.) for basic Medicare, and another \$145 for the advantage part. Plus, we have co-pays on everything. And, many prescription drugs are either not covered at all, or so expensive we can't get them."

— YouTube · Medicare Part B Give Back Benefit - What's The Catch? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dMy1JJvQwTs&lc=UgyN2vgwCvqPQB30P4B4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (2): "\$145 sounds pretty expensive for an Advantage Plan. We would be happy to help you review your options if you'd like. Please contact us at 88-465-9728."

"The Part D of my advantage plan just skyrocketed. I might have to puzzle out a whole new way of getting drug coverage. As always, thanks for the video."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Drug Plans: Two Things You NEED to Know · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANgeD3oOJ40&lc=UgydlymRrgKZYh46Fr94AaABAg>

↳ @laxnative4622 (0): "Don't Advantage plans (i.e. Part C plans) already include drug coverage?"

↳ @gindie1 (0): "@laxnative4622 Yes, but that coverage is considered to be a Part D plan, nonetheless."

"My Medicare advantage prescription plan D was cancelled and even denied me to reenroll w/no explanation yet. Listening for clues here."

— YouTube · Will Your Medicare Drug Costs Soar in 2027? What to Do Now · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5qjYsfpQuVw&lc=Ugx2l3oZ78tWFI0f41p4AaABAg>

↳ @lisat9802 (1): "Wow what the heck? Did you get an answer as to why yet?"

"Yes... it makes no sense to compare one year of cost as most comparisons do! Since it may be impossible to switch from one plan to the other at a later date (say, after getting cancer), one MUST compare the expected lifetime cost. That is, assuming current year premiums are constant (even though we know they will likely increase), what is the expected cost of an average medigap plan vs advantage plan over the average life expectancy (age 65 through ~85) assuming typical senior medical issues. It's important to factor in that there is a high probability that seniors will get seriously ill at some point after age 65. We know that statistics predict that a majority of seniors will succumb to one or more of the following expensive diseases: cancer, diabetes, obesity, heart disease, etc. The critical factor is whether your selected plan will cover any given procedure your doctor recommends at some indeterminate point in the future. If there was some law that prevented medicare advantage insurers from denying coverage (or, better yet, reserving that decision to government CMS authority so all plans have the same exact authorization process) it seems to be a no brainier to choose advantage plan as one single year costs are certainly going to be less. However, unlike traditional medicare, these plans are driven by a profit motive. They certainly WILL restrict coverage. That is how they make their money. Therefore it is highly likely that going that path will restrict your medical care at some point in your life. What is certain is traditional medicare will always pay from what is now essentially a limitless bucket of money with no regard to profit (or how big the multi-million dollar executive bonuses are in a given year). That said, most traditional medigap plans suffer greatly by not having an out of pocket maximum (only K & L have this). In my estimation this is a huge disadvantage of going the traditional medicare route. My wife has cancer, and for the last several years she has hit the out of pocket maximum which thankfully has limited our costs (we turn 65 next year). Under Medicare, we would have lost that certainly with, say, plan G. On the other hand, the medications/infusions that saved her life would certainly have been denied by any of the medicare advantage programs."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugz63C1KHwyf67er4LJ4AaABAg>

"Thank you for this important information! I now understand why the premium for my Part D will increase. Yes the can has been kicked down the road. I would also add that the huge problem of fraud has also impacted the financial situation for Medicare. As a senior, my own Medicare Original account was used fraudulently with thousands of dollars charged for services I did not receive."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgwOYhNIH0Z4Ry9ogv14AaABAg

"I have received my Wellcare Part D ANOC (today) and the premium went down like 30 cents but the benefits changed considerably. Tier 1 copay went up 33% (from \$15 to \$20). Tier 2 SWITCH from copay of \$20 to a COINSURANCE of I pay 25% of the total cost. Tier 3 went from I pay 25% of cost to I pay 48% of cost."

— YouTube · Shocking Medicare Plan Changes Coming for 2027 · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HJ98mctbEC8&lc=UgyZZPxCWzJeF3ofet14AaABAg>

"Puzzle. thanks for this info. My drug plan has increased in price and this information helped me. Who thought it was a good idea to take away enrollment help from the people who may need the most enrollment help as we age."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Drug Plans: Two Things You NEED to Know · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANgeD3oOJ40&lc=UgztD_5nVEp9Hzzf_jd4AaABAg

↳ @user-to1xl5zl7o (0): "Gee who could that have been. Huh...😬"

"I just got my part D premium change. It literally doubled each month and my main prescription each month over doubled."

— YouTube · Medicare 2027 WARNING: What's Changing With Part D Costs · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VL9ka29qz8Y&lc=Ugws7_jOj5fiomVzkqt4AaABAg

↳ @MyGovExpert (0): "A cheaper premium and a costlier year can happen together, and untangling that is more than a reply can do. Before you decide anything, the worksheet is in my Drug plan costs guide. Request my free guide here: <https://24help.org/drug-costs>. For help comparing plans, I'd reach out to my partners at Chapter Medicare at 352-841-0632."

↳ @BeKind-q1p (0): "@MyGovExpert thank you so very much for all you do."

Doctors and hospitals dropping Advantage plans · 45 documents · 20 voices

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

↳ @sct4040 (24): "I too, am on AARP UHC and will be paying \$333/month in 2027. That is so much money."

↳ @nealkshah (18): "Sounds like that "blessing in disguise" really did work out. Thanks for sharing the whole story."

↳ @edwinrodeo (15): "@sct4040... me 2 🙄 . I'm in CT though.. open enrollment yr round. No underwriting required. Only 4 states has it."

"Another negative for Advantage plans is that hospitals in my area are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans. So if you have a doctor you like and he works out of a certain hospital you could find yourself looking for another doctor and hospital. I was on an Advantage plan but was able to get on Plan G because the hospital I use stopped accepting the Advantage plan I was on. I didn't have to get approved or pass any medical tests to go on Plan G since it wasn't my fault that my Advantage plan was no longer valid. Best thing that could have happened to me."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx4MOWZuO_w_2-SLoV4AaABAg

↳ @tracyjohnson5023 (1): "Same here. The hospital still accepts advantage, but many doctors do not"

"The only hospital within 100 miles of me has stopped accepting Humana advantage plans as in-network due to claim denials and long waits for pre-approvals. Switching to plan N while I can pass underwriting."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxNqF0wOHim1a8HT3J4AaABAg>

↳ @christinedaley5580 (5): "@JohnJohn-wr1jol ve never heard high deductible G \$800 a month. Never. Anywhere."

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (2): ""pass underwriting" is insurance speak for how much we can overcharge you for a policy. Friends were advised to stay away from any Advantage Plan but couldn't resist the premiums. All was fine until the wife developed breast cancer and was treated with old protocols and denied tests and latest drugs and treatments. Every step was delayed for months and she eventually passed. Husband was so disillusioned with the process he applied for Medicare and a Supplement so had to go through the underwriting process. No health issues 68 years old. The best he could do with a high deductible G was \$800 bucks a month. Drug plan was almost \$200 a month. He stayed with the Advantage Plan due to cost and was recently diagnosed with cancer. Hes ready to go the "Kavorkian" route and doesnt want to fight it out with yhe Advantage Carrier"

"My brother chose Medicare Advantage when it was relatively new. Years later, he needed a very specialized surgery that no hospital in his network could do. After months of fighting with insurance, they finally agreed to cover it at KU Med Center. On the 4 hr drive on the morning of his surgery, he received a call from the hospital saying that they had just dropped his Medicare Advantage company and couldn't do his surgery. He never found another way to get that surgery and he died. If this scenario happens often, Medicare Advantage saves a lot of money by not having to pay for life saving surgeries."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyQFMPprBbPsPUB1Q14AaABAg>

↳ @RipWilliam-g4c (2): "Sorry to hear this shameless act of this hospital. Whether you agree with it or not, you know better than many others, why so many people celebrate what Luigi did to the United Health Care CEO and think he is a hero by sending a signal to the Insurance Industry people that make these horrendous decisions for none other than making a couple more dollars!!!"

↳ @angiemartin7919 (2): "So sorry for your loss."

↳ @cindyk4145 (1): "They cant cancel you until the end of the year."

"I was warned by everyone not to take Medicare Advantage-so glad I listened. It's next to impossible to switch back-I would encourage anyone just about to enter-don't do it. The premiums are very attractive to rope you in but like they say-lots of exceptions, some doctors won't accept the plan etc"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxxi6snmCvpHtHoLXp4AaABAg>

↳ @Ingrid-h7x (0): "Nobody warned ME! Common sense told me when something sounds too good to be true ... It IS. Nobody warned me not to take the COVID shot(s) .. Common sense told me if something is EXPERIMENTAL .. it's not what I want in MY body. I don't go on vacations or get a new car every 5 years, etc etc ... I wanted a good medigap insurance and I accepted that it wasn't going to be cheap! It's all about where your priorities are .."

↳ @wisember (0): ""It's next to impossible to switch back" The same is true for the other direction. MA isn't guaranteed issue after your trial period. You may or may not qualify for one later."

↳ @marieberberich4445 (0): "Not only that, there are many hospitals in the south that have gone belly up because they can't get paid by Advantage. A lot of hospitals, hearing this, won't take Advantage plans."

"I wanted expert advice before I went on Medicare. So I hired a consultant. She call Medicare Advantage Medicare Disadvantage and told me to stay away from it. Why? Because it isn't real Medicare. It's private insurance that can end up making you go bankrupt. So I went with traditional Medicare with Part G supplement. I've never spent a dime out of pocket. Im glad I rejected Advantage. Rye largest hospital in my area announce last year that they were dropping out of Advantage. So have more than half of the areas physicians. This has left a lot of people without good healthcare choices. And I don't live in podunk. I live in a major metropolitan area with a population of over 6 million."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugy-HagNdaMnA1ecAZ14AaABAg>

↳ @memyself9037 (4): "@gurnblanston5000 not if you buy part G. If pays all part A and B deductables."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (2): "Still pay deductibles."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (1): "@memyself9037got it...D was cheaper here even with deductibles."

"The brokers make a lot more commission to put you on Advantage Plan FYI. I went with Original Medicare Plan N With Supplement from Humana. So far, very few copay, no copay for PT, Chiro, or appts for a problem. Only "office visit " for follow up. My spouse saw neurosurgeon with only \$15 copay 🎉 Advantage Plans sound good BUT can control which Dr you can go to, decline procedures, and can change every single year!! Too risky for me. Many Drs and hospitals don't accept Med Adv plans. I feel that America can do better ... seniors shouldn't have to deal with how complex all this is - they should not have to appeal three times to get procedures from advantage plans! Especially when they're sick and going through health problems."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1lpLq6moM&lc=UgwWBdVQ1TJw1FBtEep4AaABAg.ASI_W_LBHuvAUIE4ho-s1Z

"Sunburn. Great job on this video. I love your chart, as well. I am 71, and have had \$0.00 Premium Advantage Plans so far. I had to change to a different company a couple years ago because my Primary Doctor dropped my plan, because he was tired of arguing with them on proper care for his patients. Both of my Advantage Plan companies have worked out well for me so far. However, I am now leaning towards switching to a Supplement Plan after I saw how wonderful they worked for both of my parents, who each had a lot of issues through their lives, and they never had to pay for anything, other than their monthly premiums. As I get older, I think it might give me a bit more peace of mind to have a Supplement that has more complete coverage and I will have more control over which doctors I see. Your video was very helpful as I do my research to make my decision for 2026. Thanks again!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzJ0S3dtITngj28Ghl4AaABAg>

↳ @KGH-ew8mw (0): "From what I understand, switching to a Supplement Plan from an Advantage plan is not that easy to do. I am under the impression that if you want to switch from a current plan to another, you have to be accepted by the plan after passing their medical underwriting approval. That could be difficult if you have any medical conditions that the company does not want to cover."

"You mention that some Advantage plans have dropped some doctor and hospital groups. What I have personally seen more often is that Dr.'s and hospital groups are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans because the Dr and hospitals say they are not being reimbursed enough from these Advantage plans. Most of the Baby Boomer generation is now on Medicare. A large portion of these folks have chosen Advantage plans. Since the Dr's say they are not being paid enough from Advantage plans and insurance companies are not making the profits they want, that is why Advantage plans are changing rapidly. It's all about the money. That's why a lot of the so called "Freebies" like glasses and dental will soon be going away or else your premiums will rise rapidly because the insurance industry will not absorb these costs, they will be passed onto you."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwZ6C0z6Q1hyolb2PJ4AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (1): "You make some excellent points. Many doctors and hospitals are pushing back on Advantage contracts because of lower reimbursements, and that's one reason we're seeing rapid changes in networks and benefits. You're right - it really does come down to money, both for providers and insurers. That's why people need to keep a close eye on their Advantage plan each year, because the 'extras' can shift quickly. For those who value stability and access, a Supplement can often feel like a safer long-term choice."

"A Medicare Advantage plan + Cancer policy might be the *least expensive* total cost, but I am seeing in other videos that many hospitals are no longer accepting Advantage plans coverage due to their burdensome pre-authorization processes and higher incidences of fraud. So that might not be the *best* option. An Original Medicare plan is accepted everywhere, and bundled with a good Supplement plan, appears to be a close second in terms of cheapest overall cost."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgyCX_t3mhh0eD7T-7V4AaABAq

↳ @the_original_skytiger (1): "Not all doctors take Medicare."

"if you have a generic pre existing condition, if you go with advantage you might not to get to see you specialist you might need. Also Mayo clinics no longer accept advantage plans. I have and will skesys gave original medicare. If you are healthy and garentee you will never have any mefucal conditions then advantage might work. But if you have cancer or other catastrophic events you best have Original Mefucare and a supplemental insurance"

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlg&lc=UgyNVVw8bhXx45TEgRB4AaABAq>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (1): "Yes, good points. The Mayo Clinic traditionally did not accept Medicare advantage but they have for maybe four or five years now. But, starting on January 1, 2026, they are no longer going to take any Medicare advantage. This has historically been the case. It's only the last 3 to 5 years that they have accepted Medicare advantage plans. That's why I tell people if you want access to premier clinics, you have to pay for the premier insurance."

"Do not, I repeat NOT use United Health Care on the Advantage plan. UHC is a sunburn of a nightmare - a mess and my hospital dropped them. I signed up with the Advantage plan at the hospital. All went smooth until they sent a letter that said Advantage is going away in Oregon? :("

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugys1pC3NFzodwwwYlh4AaABAg.AKdMkH291hCANZVXQWelul>

"If you've been a Medicare agent in 17 states for over a decade, you would know exactly what I'm talking about. You are well aware of the changes our industry is facing, so please do not call this an unfair, fear-based claim. And you're right—I forgot to provide proof and evidence—so here they are. Feel free to look up any of these news outlets to see exactly what I'm referring to if you're not aware of that. Medicare Advantage – The Hidden Risks (2024 Sources) Insurers Dropping Members Millions at risk as carriers pull back—over 1 million patients had to shop for new health plans as insurers and hospitals dropped MA coverage (Stateline, Oct 2024). Hospitals Dropping Contracts 15 health systems ended MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., Aultman, Scripps, WellSpan, etc.) due to denials and slow payments (TheStreet, 2024). 32 health systems dropped or declined to renew MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., CommonSpirit, Vanderbilt Health, Avera Health, etc.) (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). 17 health systems across multiple states did the same—citing administrative burdens—in a Becker's list updated August 2024 (Strategic Healthcare, 2024). HealthPartners left UnitedHealthcare MA network, citing denial rates up to 10x higher than with other insurers (Center for Medicare Advocacy, 2024). Hospitals are dropping MA plans "left and right"—Scripps Health terminated MA contracts affecting 30k seniors; many more followed suit across the country (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). JustCare lists 2024 cancellations (e.g., ECU Health, Comanche Regional, Genesis, Brookings, Memorial Hermann, etc.) (JustCare USA, 2024)."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyfN02DFY0-5fva9L94AaABAg.AMAJEJokT6yAMAm2VxdHH8

"My advantage plan is not being cancelled. The hospital in my area and all of the Drs. affiliated with the hospital are no longer accepting the advantage plan as of 1/1/27"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgxVT8fo198rfdBbnF4AaABAg>

↳ @ptm7809 (0): "That's odd. What state/county?"

"I will keep my g plan if you need special care such as the Mayo clinic they don't take most advantage plans"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement 2026: Full Comparison · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5Qc8YvLjGE&lc=UgwRqEntkMz3edWyaoV4AaABAg>

"Insurance Question After a CT scan this week my doctor believes I have cancer. Biopsy is scheduled for Friday. I have a United Healthcare family plan through work that's pretty good. My wife has the option to take a family healthcare plan with Blue Cross Blue Shield. Her healthcare currently pays us \$3600 annually to not take it. It would cost us \$4200 annually for family coverage, so it's a \$7800 swing. The problem is her open enrollment ends tomorrow. My worry is we don't take her insurance and end up with a diagnosis that takes us to a specialist that is out of network for UHC. I know most major hospitals take it but have also read Hopkins doesn't for example. Also my out of pocket max is about 7k Any insight would be appreciated. Thank you!"

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wicqeo/insurance_question/

↳ Budget-Schedule-3040 (9): "I'd recommend not trusting the hospitals websites for what they take. You really should check the insurance companies website and filter by which specific UHC and BCBS plans you're talking about. Each company has tens of different plans and they'll potentially utilize different networks. Knowing the specific plan name is the place to start"

↳ EmZee2022 (5): "That's a hell of a tough situation :-(UHC and Blue Cross both have decent networks in general. I'm a bit shocked that Hopkins does not take UHC - do they take Blue Cross? We did run into a local radiology practice being dropped from the UHC network, last year, which was annoying (fortunately we have a lot of alternatives locally). Is Hopkins "local" to you? If not, are there other big name hospitals that are? Mayo, Sloan Kettering, Cleveland Clinic and so on?"

↳ NBL2210 (2): "I live in a very remote area in upstate NY so I'll have to travel for any care. Hopkins is close to family so that was one of the options. They do take BCBS but no UHC according to their website"

"My husband who suffers from primary progressive MS can only have an advantage plan because he is not yet 65. This year he lost his neurologist because the group is associated with a hospital that stopped accepting UHC's Advantage plan. We looked forever for a doctor who wouldn't just tell my husband he had to live with his worsening MS and actually helped him. I am so disgusted. Some of us are trapped in advantage plans due to disability before 65."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugxv6KpkNPiprYXfBnh4AaABAg>

"In Maine, and I'm sure in other states too, hospitals have been dropping Medicare Advantage programs because of payment problems from those companies."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medigap at 65: The Real Costs Most People Don't Understand (Clip) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M9hEKbgJg2w&lc=UgzNgRpMsr-cScn3M6Z4AaABAg>

"Sunburn! Something I avoid due to skin cancer I've already had. Thanks for your detailed analysis. I will pass on a link to your video to a friend of mine. My sister went with Advantage plan because she was OK with dealing with prior auth and limited service providers. I warned her that someday she may find that she gets denied necessary care, because that's what those plans do in order to stay profitable. I personally despise HMO type plans and the limited providers and pre-auth/referral games. PPO isn't much better. And Advantage plans tend to limit care to only providers either local to your area or in your state, which if I wanted to be a snowbird would not work for me. Many providers in my area are refusing Advantage plans due to payment hassles and bad reimbursement rates. So I went with Traditional + Plan N. I did consider a high-deductible G and when I move I might switch to that. Currently very healthy and come from healthy family tree that doesn't tend to need much care until the last 5-10 years of life."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugy2GFPS4r1DbUkqpl4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for taking the time to watch and share :) ☀️"

Under 65 and disabled: no Medigap, or an unaffordable one · 43 documents · 20 voices

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

↳ (0): "You need to consider the monthly insurance premium for the Medicare supplement, too. One reason many people sign up for MA is that they cannot afford the supplement premiums. Everyone pays the monthly Part B premiums, then on top of that, they may pay a monthly supplement premium, if they sign up for a supplement, and they will have drug insurance (Part D) premium, which they should sign up for even if they do not take medications now, to avoid paying a penalty later. If they sign up for MA, rather than a supplement, some MA plans, but not all, have a monthly premium. Drugs are included with MA plans."

↳ (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm making a file and adding new info as I go along. It's overwhelming!"

↳ (0): "5. The amount of commission an agent gets varies extremely from plan to plan, company to company, etc. Not set in stone at all like the numbers you have listed"

"I was on Medicare advantage for 15 years because I'm disabled and I was too young to get a supplement plan. I turned 65 last year and switched to original Medicare with a Humana plan G supplement plan. I'm thrilled with this. I did have to buy a separate dental plan. But I know I can travel anywhere in the United States and I have the same coverage. And I don't get nickel and dimed to death. And I don't have to get approval for tests and surgeries. And I'm not going to be dumped. FYI, it doesn't matter what insurance company you choose for your supplement plan. They pay exactly the same. So don't spend a lot of money getting a Blue Cross plan when you can get a Humana plan that pays exactly the same and is a lot less expensive. But I do recommend plan G."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 60 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyaUtMfHKYB03d_PGZ4AaABAg

↳ @pursuehealth940 (15): "@georgebronson9486 they can't cancel plan G. They can stop accepting all insurance from one company, or all Advantage plans from all companies, but they can't stop accepting Medicare insurance or supplements. It's federally mandated."

↳ @georgebronson9486 (4): "How do you know hospitals won't start cancelling plan G? And then what?"

↳ @sarahdee374 (3): "could you share appr what your supp plan monthly premiums are? I've been on an Advantage plan for years, and happy with it, and pretty healthy too. But now I'm scared, but also don't want a high premium to pay ongoing. Thank you for sharing your experience."

"Something you may wish to address is that in many states (including mine), if you're under 65 and qualify for Medicare through being on SSDI, you *can't* sign up for a Medigap plan. I was fully convinced Medigap was the right thing for me--until I found out that only plan A is available in my state if you're under 65, and its premium would be nearly \$1000/month. It's hard not to panic when your only option is the one that's being taken away."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzD2U3nrXQh12oLeV94AaABAg>

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (1): "That is high, like 4x more."

↳ @Dbb27 (1): "I'm paying \$1,200 a month for a family member that has medicare. He could get on Medicaid but none of his doctors take it. He does qualify for a Medigap but we are afraid to switch as his insurance has been very good. It's becoming unaffordable."

↳ @gurnblanston5000 (1): "@Dbb27Is that a Medicare C plan, as you mention switching?"

"I'm under 62, on SSDI, & have a Medicare supplement plan that I'm stuck with until I turn 65 & can't change without underwriting. Feel like i am penalized because of a chronic, permanent disability i suffered from in 2012 that resulted in going on SSDI. The cost of it has doubled over the last several years & my only choice is to change to a Medicare advantage plan until then. I have been through the worst of our health care system through my experiences. I should have gotten dual citizenship in another country years ago when I had the opportunity where I could have gotten the medical care I needed without it financially ruining me."

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=UgwqNyHLjygxlduP51Z4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Sadly, there is no federal law mandating the availability of Medicare supplement plans to people under 65. Most states do not offer any Medigap plans until a person reaches 65. Other states price under 65 supplement so high, they are not a reasonable solution. It's just the way it is."

↳ @jdenino6022 (2): "@MedigapSeminarsBlame Congress. 😞 "

↳ @ctwilk1 (0): "Check with BCBS. They have a Medicare Supplement Plan for ppl that are under 65 and disabled. Good luck!"

"I am under 65 and had to go with an Advantage plan my state does not offer a supplemental plan. I cannot bear the financial responsibility of traditional Medicare. I feel a blessing is that I've had to learn about Medicare very fast and unexpectedly, but I can see what will be coming for Me in about 11 years and hopefully I'll be able to plan so that I can go with the supplement plan when I reach 65."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgxNd2dlnwxUWEDXrCF4AaABAq>

↳ @barreloffun10 (0): "Remember that when you do turn 65 you can get a medigap plan at that time."

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "Yes, once you reach 65 you will be able to switch to a supplement plan with no underwriting!"

"I'm registered nurse and I have CRPS or what used to be called RSD or reflex sympathetic dystrophy. I had a work injury that caused that illness and I can say it is a devastating pain syndrome. If you don't get it treated within fairly short time maybe a month or two at the most it is very difficult to get it under control and it can spread throughout your entire body. I was covered by workman's comp at the time and so I didn't have any out-of-pocket payments and was very thankful because I was in a pain clinic getting a procedure 3 days a week for about 3 months in addition to physical therapy and many other doctors appointments.. and even with that good care another minor injury to my opposite foot cause it to spread to the second foot. My husband was a cancer patient and we had a very good insurance coverage. Even with that, it was very stressful because there were some things that they didn't want to cover initially until I sent a letter to the president of the company and they finally straightened out the problem. I was much younger then, and it was a huge burden and as we get older having to deal with an insurance company is not something that I would recommend. 😞 . My last comment is that I am currently on disability in part because of the CRPS and I had to go on Medicare Advantage because at a certain point I couldn't afford any other coverage. The supplements in my area for being on disability would cause me approximately \$600 a month and I wasn't a Christian HealthCare sharing plan, but that cost also went up during covid. Next year I will be 65 and I'm hoping that a supplement plan will be affordable, at least for the short-term and hopefully for the long-term!"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgyOPv1Xe-jSMRQsg6B4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (1): "Good thing is when you turn 65, you can switch to a supplement plan without medical underwriting. So you will have another option when your turn 65 to make a change."

"I'm on disability Medicare. Cadillac Plan G is necessary but also I'm young to be on Medicare and the rising cost every year when I'm on SSDI so my income doesn't increase to cover the plan G increase and won't for much longer than your average Medicare user. We will see what the future holds. Plan options are also different for disability versus age. But I just had major surgery and I have major out of pocket drug costs and a lot of that doesn't apply to the OOP max because they have to be compounded and are very expensive. Just had surgery and none of the pain meds I can actually take post op are covered by insurance at all so none of that is going towards OOP. But there's a reason that I'm on disability and it's expensive all around. EDIT I have been having problems with places not getting paid by my plan G and billing me and not doing the billing correctly to refill. It's incredibly frustrating and billing is incredibly more and more difficult to deal with in healthcare. The fact that my plan G EOB listings are clear as mud is also not helpful."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgyVhXD1riYhr9wn4R94AaABAg>

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (0): "Go with high deductible g! I am paying only \$52.60 per month at 65"

"I love mine it pays well Update: I'm 62 on disability this has the giveback so only \$39 per month for my part. The MA plan is Cigna Preferred Savings Plan HMO and the Dental added benefit will be a PPO with \$1500 annual allowance (2024 plan). Even at the max co-pay at \$625 for prosthetics like dentures and partial plates that great here in Texas. Free YMCA membership with their Silver & Fit plan. I love it outdoors hiking trail so many amenities. I had a total knee replacement and was in the hospital for 4 days. My part was \$85 for hospital and \$45 for the doctor. 3 weeks of home health \$0 but outpatient therapy now is \$40 a session with unlimited sessions. I chose UT Health and they are awesome!! When I turn 65 I'll get the Medicare and supp plan with no hassle as it will reset from disability to retirement."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzZcWOShtTZ-jZhDox4AaABAg>

"I'm on Plan N because as a person on SSDI the plan G was unaffordable and/or they wouldn't take me. Plan N has \$20 copays. so far so good . I can go anywhere as you say"

— YouTube · Should You Switch from Medicare Plan G to Plan N? Here's the Real Tradeoff · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xsEZJVMwY8E&lc=Ugz4a5kmyEeah8Pmf854AaABAg>

"@pattyeverett2826 Individuals who qualify for Medicare based on a disability (under 65) can be enrolled in the traditional/original Medicare plan. It depends on which state they live in, if there is a supplemental plan offered to this type of Medicare enrollee. If there is a supplemental plan for individuals who are disabled, it maybe more costly for this group of Medicare beneficiaries, than those who purchase supplemental plans at age 65, or when they are first enrolled in Medicare Part A and B (after age 65). Other options are, If they have a spouse or family member they can be covered under a large employer group health plan (100 or more employees). If they qualify for state assistance; Medicaid/Medical and the Medicare Savings Programs. Otherwise; their choices are original/traditional Medicare (without a supplemental plan for most) or a Medicare Advantage Plan. Not to forget the Part D plans—they would be included. This is just a snapshot of information in trying to answer your question. Every state has a program to help people of all ages on Medicare called, State Health Insurance Benefit Advisers (SHIBA) who help people navigate through insurance issues. They usually work under the State Office of the Insurance Commissioner. Many of the people who make up this awesome group of individuals are volunteers."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwIRuG_RCUcWibSbSJ4AaABAg.9ZEKzt_9V_D9ZQNEtPPaAi

"Depending on what your budget is, you may be better off with a Medicare Advantage plan until you turn 65. When you turn 65 you have a reset with your Medicare and you can apply for any Supplement Plan without underwriting. At least where I live in michigan, being on disability causes supplement plans to be terribly expensive, so I had to go with a Medicare Advantage plan, and I've actually been very happy with it. It's a local Michigan Plan though so they tend not to cause a lot of problems for the doctors because they would back out and ruin the company LOL the negative thing about Medicare Advantage is that there are co-pays for almost everything, but there is a maximum out of pocket that makes it more manageable. I really wish you the best. Being on disability really sucks sometimes!"

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgwKIEUD4hb3PBEnpxN4AaABAg.AA-6d6OzdNSAAtNHwT9UpI

"I'm disabled and under 65 so I was told I can't get a supplement because I'm under age. So I'm on advantage ppo. It's ridiculous too that I have to pay 40.00 for each time I see my counselor..mental health needs should be free"

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgwlyrjAePNZ3DtlwGh4AaABAg>

"I have plan g on disability and pay almost \$600 a month. Can't afford it and can't afford not to. Almost 62. Hopefully at 65 it will reduce"

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=Ugw-xr-rm61mf2drwy54AaABAg>

"I wish I could buy a Medigap plan. I have Medicare, I'm 49 disabled with a spinal disease, and I can't even get a Medigap plan."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugwkagft2E0ioaUjlud4AaABAg>

↳ @b0borden437 (0): "I thought there are no pre-existing illnesses?"

"Glad it seems to be working good for you. Hopefully it continues! Had a question about you saying your Leukemia was diagnosed at age 64. I'm assuming that since you wasn't 65 yet, did this then qualify you to be able to sign up for disability medicare and if so were you then able to go on Medicare w/medigap instead of being forced to go on advantage plan? I never heard anyone that was on disability say they had a choice of original medicare or advantage so i was surprised with what you said. My brother went on disability i think the same age as you and i could tell his wife did all the paperwork because he didn't know what he had for sure but he said he didn't use his medicare card. So I just assumed then it was Advantage and he had no choice since he could afford Supplemental Coverage. His is wife is a nurse and i thought she would know better! Don't mean to pry but i trying to write notes about all this stuff to tell my family about since they will eventually handling this for themselves and making decisions on its use for me later. The information regarding all this comes piece by piece and sometimes not in time when you need to know or what you should know! Thank you!"

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCl8m0OI18&lc=UgyWndxq316Pp8dkzYJ4AaABAg.9vhucxHXnG_9wTCYX4DkrN

"Unfortunately, for those of us on disability we can't afford the \$1,000 - \$1,500 monthly premiums we were quoted when we were first eligible for Medicare (and that was when I was first eligible - no telling what the cost is now). In my case, that would take the majority of my monthly benefit. You run into a problem of not being able to pay the bills necessary to survive and buy groceries if you sign up for one of these supplemental plans. So, for us it's either take original Medicare only (with possibly a drug plan) or sign up for an advantage plan and take the risk of having some major medical expense that the plan won't cover. It's really a lose - lose scenario for us. My plan is ending at the end of this year, so I may check into prices again as they said I qualified for a guarantee issue period - but if it's still that expensive, it's just not going to work for me financially. You've got to be able to pay your bills and eat to survive."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgxYJ1I99gk8jMuy1u54AaABAg>

↳ @saketashol6728 (1): "No supplement plan charges \$1000 to \$1500 per month unless your 150 years old give or take. You must be trolling or an MA agent."

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "We would be happy to help you review once you reach 65, it should be better cost for you at that time. If you need any assistance. Give us a call at 1-800-864-8890."

"You said it yourself in a previous video that you can't switch to a supplement plan from an advantage plan. Also, what if someone has is younger with disability social security medicare with state medicaid, I believe you can't get a supplement plan but can get an advantage plan 🙄 "

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgzDbymb31VdaftkPvR4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "There are a few ways to switch. Not always straightforward, but there are ways. When talking about disability and Medicare pre-65, this varies a lot by state. There are some states that allow and offer Supplement plans to those with a disability. These states are the exception, not the rule. Most states have some form of Advantage plan only and those with a disability must get an Advantage plan. All depends on where you live. Thank you for watching and great question!"

↳ @jdenino6022 (0): "@Theretirementnerds the U.S. is ass backwards with health insurance. 🙄 "

"Thank you so much for this information! First time viewer. As a person on SSDI, under 65, and moved to AZ with a supplemental plan that was just raised to over \$600 a month, this will more than likely hurt. I may be forced to go with an Advantage plan for 2 yrs 🙄 ."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSlfc&lc=UgzNogOcHVvooo9EXYJ4AaABAg>

"I am 63 years old and on SSDI and Have Traditional Medicare and my Supplement Plan F. When I turn 65 do I qualify for another Open Enrollment Period without Medical Underwriting to qualify for a plan or carrier change?"

— YouTube · Top 5 Medicare Mistakes that will COST you. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o9PfeE1GFM4&lc=UgxHNeIR1pmFccnpS514AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "Yes! It's usually in your best interest to take advantage of that."

"I'm only 47 but disabled so I'm on a medicare advantage plan since I'm too young to get supplemental insurance in my state. Am I wrong in thinking this is the best bet for me?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgwUhfW14EgMDYZLgwb4AaABAq>

Agents and callers who push or mislead · 31 documents · 20 voices

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAq>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want a insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

"One of the better explanations of the difference. I noticed several agents here push Plan G very heavily. My wife and I see a doctor twice a year, so co-pays don't bother us. We would have to have three doctor appointments a month to make up the difference in plan prices. Good job."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgwpXUF5t2zyH94bLlx4AaABAg>

↳ @gianmatt1930 (10): "Don't the brokers make more money on the more expensive plans? Of course they do. That is why they are all pushing plan G. This nice person on the video is honest. It's appreciated."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (4): "Thank you! And yes, some brokers right here on YouTube won't even sell or discuss other options besides Plan G."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (3): "@gianmatt1930 thank you! 😊 "

"IMO - I feel that insurance Medicare agents/brokers who push this scam on clients should be investigated. It's my understanding that the agents are compensated for at a higher rate for enrolling seniors on the Advantage Plan. At the very least customers who enrolled in the Advantage option should be allowed to change back to the traditional one at no penalty to them."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzCjY71Bi2WAeUiyGt4AaABAg.A7yD_2SFDkoA8AiNVaa-oS

"I live in Texas and I help these people all the time get their bills covered until they can get to another, more legitimate health insurance option. How they do is click bait, advertisements, and just typing into their search engine health insurance and accepting what they find. What I also see all the time is brokers who commonly say lies. They lie about network coverage. A good example is one lady causes everybody to be afraid of Healthcare Marketplace and only accept her off marketplace plans, because she misinforms them about insurance coverage for their children's care. She lies and says the hospital does not accept any, when they do accept one (I get it - not a wide variety...) but the one further away takes four, and etc. It makes parents panic into the cheap plans, and then the worst happens; no spending caps, exceptions, exemptions, etc. Then we also get a lot of, "We just retired before 65, so we aren't Medicare, but we don't have the money to spend on a health insurance plan from the Healthcare Marketplace; what is available?" or "We just moved from another state that had their own exchange website (many do), but I guess Texas doesn't?" and it's always the cheap plans with spending caps, exemptions, exclusions, and it's so unfortunate that the buzzards go for these people. In great summary, it's commonly fear mongering and word of mouth that get people to take other plans. "Oh, Janet, you pay \$1,000 a month?! I pay \$100 a month. I know a guy.""

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1whfg16/how_do_people_usually_get_health_insurance/pa2jzsu/

"@RickeyReynolds Yes----I called several companies before signing up and they all sounded like used car salesmen with high pressure, then I got sucked into Medicare School and spoke to a low key guy and he told me how great Ace was-----I think he pushed Ace because they were paying a higher bonus. After Ace closed their books I called to get information buy was told I would have to make an appointment about a week out to speak to someone-----I finally spoke to someone and they had no information and had to ask other people there. With a closed book of business, you would think the cost would be spread out to all the states-----go on line and find the map that shows which states are in Ace and the other half INA. I interpret that the closed book of business for Ace is in, WA, MT, ID, CA, UT, NM, NE, MN, MO, IL, IN, KY, PA VT, PA NJ, DE, MD ,VA,AL, FL, AK-----all the other states are listed as INA"

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=Ugzl1NfBfQeBIZOMdbB4AaABAg.AWhpZS1r1SkAWi_7MQnsfQ

"I've been on disability w/Medicare A&B since Jan 2001. Living in Texas, I have the unusually Texas unique situation I'm a partial dual eligible (QI-1). I've tried advantage plans briefly only to find it's not for me. Fortunately Medicare Part D and the fact I'm a QI-1 I can switch anytime (upto3 times a year). I've been on A, B and D until this past September when I turned 65 last Sept. Though I was born in 1957 and due to my having had PART B since Jan 2001, I was able to get a plan F. Using the SPEND DOWN of the monthly premium, I'm able to recover \$128 p/m of that premium via section 8 housing voucher. Others might recover some or all via SNAP. Realizing that Spend Down with other programs may make the higher premium plans more affordable than Plan N. Love your videos education is important. Wish I'd found you earlier. I had to use my past experience as a PART D and medication assistance program activist/advocate. When I was discussing with an agent he was pushing Plan G over Plan F. I educated him on what and how Spend Down regarding other assistance programs worked. I realize my situation is rather unique, but then again everyone's situation is unique."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=Ugxj8rtCZvjiduLzFv54AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (1): "Thank you for the feedback and comment."

"Thank you Erin for so well explained these healthcare confusions! I wish this video would have came out a year ago. I'm 66 and I was confused by all these last year when I needed to enroll. My broker only pushed me to enroll in Medicare Advantage and it seems to be a better choice due to the lower cause. As you said, I'm lucky that I'm still healthy now but choosing Medigap may be a better choice down the road."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwZrnBS3BHQIMpP7-x4AaABAg>

"I have UHC plan N, my premium is going up to \$172 in next month and then \$180 in December. In 2 years it's gone from \$117 to \$172, I called my broker and applied with Cigna, hopefully I'll get approved. I get why Luigi whacked the CEO of UHC now....."

— YouTube · Can You Change Your Medicare Supplement Anytime? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p2hlpMKoQZU&lc=Ugyxx0cmV7Ks-y0VAup4AaABAg.AEv-SCQghNfAIF-ms_g3jp

"I wonder why SSA Rep never told me about plan N? 🤔"

— YouTube · Is Medicare Plan N Worth It? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V64x-sWEALg&lc=Ugyv sCNeb9VhoDPGnLJ4AaABAq>

↳ @TheLewkowskiGroup (0): "SSA only handles Social Security. Plan N is a Medicare Supplement and Medicare Agents can help find and enroll you in these plans, not SSA."

"He is very good at explaining but I am still confused. I have a supplement plan that an agent recommended when I had a special enrollment period due to job retirement and he just said I like "this company", they are great. Plan G, good rate etc, yet this supplement plan has been a nightmare, acting like an advantage plan. Refusing to cover, putting time limits on Dr ordered physical therapy etc. It says G on my card but someone told me this company was pushed on me because this company also owns a large advantage plan and the incentive to be harrassive is to make me say forget plan G I will just go to an advantage plan, and voila, here is my Plan G company right there to offer an advantage plan (their own). I feel very duped. I don't know if it was the agent pulling a fast one on me because he got some sort of commission from supp company to aggressively push me in their direction so when I get frustrated agent will push me to plan g company's advantage and he will get a kickback or something. My agent said this company a half a second after I said I wanted original Medicare and never offered me anything else. New and very green to the insurance monsters I didn't know any better even though I thought I understood it all. Now I can lateral move to a different plan g company but only with underwriting. I could probably pass underwriting. I just lost all trust in this agent and people tell me I can't change agents. Ugh! What, how and WHY?? It shouldn't be this complicated to stay on original Medicare because one agent didn't offer me an insurance company choice!!! Beware people, not all insurance reps are thinking of your best interests! (Not the man that posted this video, he is awesome and speaks clearly so you understand 😊). I truly thought original Medicare was the way to go given the nightmare stories advantage plan people post about. I wasn't in open enrollment period, so agent had lots of time to help me, it was in the middle of the year when Medicare mania wasn't in full swing."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwlSnQQsx1IQjxDehN4AaABAq.AMRqYild_gEAMS-liEeFa

"Be careful how you use a broker if you want a Medigap policy. Sure, they can help explain the differences between the various lettered plans, and that's very valuable, but brokers don't necessarily represent all of the possible insurers you can buy a plan from. In my opinion, once you know what type of Medigap plan you want, i.e., G, N, etc. , go on Medicare.gov and see which insurance companies are available in your area for that plan. That site will also give you the approximate premiums. You can then narrow it down by price a little, if you want, but some insurers might be better than others. That's when your state's SHIP office might be able to give you some insight. You can also research insurers on your own When you eventually contact a broker, ask them which of the insurance companies on your list they represent. I suggest that you do that upfront because they probably don't represent all of the insurers on your list that you are interested in. If they don't, then they may push you toward an insurer they represent, which might not be in your best interest. When I went through this last year, that was one of the initial questions I asked the first broker I spoke to. When I ultimately narrowed it down to an insurer that broker did not represent, I contacted a different broker which represented that company, because that company only sold through agents. YMMV"

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1wksnot/turning_65_next_year_and_medicare_enrollment_is/patxmyj/

"I would love to go back to supplement because of my hospital stay and I had full coverage at the time and always in my life I have higher level of Medicaid and my one hospital bill was 1,000.000 and I would of been responsible for 20 %and now I'm Medicare / Medicaid qmb and it paid all. With all these changes scares me now I V did not know the difference from supplement and advantage I just made sure I had a ppo and a private insurance company and they told me I would not lose anything. And this is my second year on advantage and now after watching for my health and quality of life may change for the rules that the agents never told . I even told them if it takes anything or decisions out of my hand I don't want it. Nothing or accesentives is worthwhile than my be health care. I feel I was lied to and till this year it came out and I found out for my copays are 47\$ if I don't go to a doctor that doesn't take Medicaid. Unless you're in the hospital doctors don't take Medicaid. my yearly coverage now is \$247 in January I don't know yet this year. Even though I'm undetectable I still have to"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=UgynA8kDxKYvvlalAJd4AaABAg_AM3rbFxx_jLANEHsoyZDJy

"As agents push people to Plan N who would normally choose Plan G, the premiums for Plan N will become more like Plan G because the utilization between the two groups will become more similar. As that happens, the 'natural G plan' patients will pay higher premiums than expected at sign-up AND the differential Plan N costs. From the consumer side, a person who anticipates low utilization will want a plan that does not include high utilization participants since there is intra-group subsidy going on. The high deductible plan (HDG) has the highest barrier to entry. This can be seen in the plan's relatively low COL increases over time, which I expect to continue to be true. Who are natural HDG participants ? Not those in 'average' health at age 65. Only those in excellent health, and who specifically do not have lifestyle risk factors. This is a small group, but it is nice for them that a plan exists that matches their cost to the plan to the premium."

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=Ugz_F-TlgLCKBleeaL14AaABAg

↳ @GiardiniMedicare (1): "It's great to anticipate "low utilization," but in reality, our health can change in an instant despite our expectations. HDG is a great option for some people, but it's not as straightforward as saying healthy = HDG. Either way, thanks for watching and for adding your perspective to the mix!"

"Thank you so much for your expert advice. I have Medicare agent from the Texas. I am 73 years old in Colorado first year 7/01/ 2024 with All State Health Solution medigap G \$1477.12 with 10% discount paid one time, second year \$1717.40 and 2026 7/01/2026 😞 . This year I tried switch with other insurance down grade to medigapN but denied. Not always guaranteed with agent I had difficult time to found agent willing to help me for medigap plan. The agent wanted push for advanced plan. I found out All State Health Solution is dead pool now. When deal pool mean next year my premium will go same rate? What do I have to do or switch to advanced plan? Please let me know what your advice will be 🙏 "

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yb_zNHT67jnc&lc=UgwwwRYSVHDYWz7KWGN4AaABAg

"Karen, I'm an independent insurance adviser. Any time I hear that someone has TRICARE For Life (TFL), I give them a high-five and say that they have the "Cadillac of Health Insurance." You are correct - you do NOT need additional Medicare supplement coverage. Also, some ignorant / less than-ethical agents might try to enroll you in a "Medicare Advantage" plan by pushing " free dental, vision, and hearing" benefits, or a "free gym membership." People with TFL should NOT get on "Advantage" plans. They will greatly complicate your coverage situation. Hope this helps."

— YouTube · Avoiding Costly Medicare Mistakes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M_lw87U6Moo&lc=UgxehnzAxp-hYI3e1Dd4AaABAq.904LpIZhFlq91eH0Sgk9c6

"Thank you for this. I found it informative & helpful. I've been on regular Medicare plus a Supplemental (not Advantage) for the past few years. My agent has never tried to push me onto Advantage (even though he would get paid a commission for that), nor has he pushed Medicare-only (even though my expense have been thankfully minimal). I may choose the "HD" plan for next year after seeing your video... but will consider all options carefully. Thanks for shedding some SUNBURN... I mean, sunlight--- on these issues!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugwz6sk-OCmNb4s28VR4AaABAq>

"@AbtInsuranceAgency The payout to agents is almost triple from what I researched. I was not correct that agents aren't paid every year for Medigap plans, they are but it's generally 10% of the premium. The Medicare Advantage plans pay \$600-750 the first year with a much higher yearly payout. It's in the salesperson's best interest to sell an MA policy. I think that's something you should be exposing; there's a financial incentive for agents to push an MA policy. Source: The Commonwealth Fund"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgyMntrSGH2A9tiPQUh4AaABAq.A_I2YT78_TjA_J8E3hEv8a

"They told me I was talking to Medicare. They told me I was talking to Medicare. They took my Medicare information they took all my prescription information. They made me feel terrible. I've never felt so violated in my whole life. I woke up at 4 o'clock in the morning knowing that the things they told me just were not right dental coverage vision coverage at \$4000 spending card then the next man told me there was a \$6000 spending card, why is anything like this to happen?"

— TrustPilot · GoHealth · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/679d2387f2836d35b70f3595>

"I quickly found that Medicare "Advantage" is really Medicare Disadvantage, because Insurance Companies love to delay, deny, and ignore critical treatments when it gets costly. Unfortunately there are a lot of Medicare Advantage Sales people who will lie and pressure you to sign up for it, so they get the big commission check, and you get screwed. Regular Medicare works very well and most Doctors accept it."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzWZsffAGpZwbyEIX94AaABAq>

"I worked in healthcare industry for 35 years at large group of hospitals and I don't even try to pick mine without my Medicare agent. and I know in's and out of most hmo in all of Oregon and I still use Medicare agent not from ins co a Medicare agent that is numeral not from an Aetna Medicare agent from plan cause of course they will push their insurance you need a neutral Medicare advisor"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugz0TNeo1qpbtfi-Kft4AaABAg>

Calls, mail and TV ads that never stop · 23 documents · 20 voices

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— r/medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

↳ (0): "You need to consider the monthly insurance premium for the Medicare supplement, too. One reason many people sign up for MA is that they cannot afford the supplement premiums. Everyone pays the monthly Part B premiums, then on top of that, they may pay a monthly supplement premium, if they sign up for a supplement, and they will have drug insurance (Part D) premium, which they should sign up for even if they do not take medications now, to avoid paying a penalty later. If they sign up for MA, rather than a supplement, some MA plans, but not all, have a monthly premium. Drugs are included with MA plans."

↳ (0): "Thanks for the info. I'm making a file and adding new info as I go along. It's overwhelming!"

↳ (0): "5. The amount of commission an agent gets varies extremely from plan to plan, company to company, etc. Not set in stone at all like the numbers you have listed"

"I see the Medicare advantage commercials on TV everyday and how they are misrepresented. They only point out the pros and never explain the cons. Being a past Chartered Life Underwriter, I am surprised the Insurance commissioner lets this slide."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 27 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxYsyXZ2F7QRC7SUXB4AaABAg.9ZDCYdipbst9ZH9zAtTFD2>

"I won't ever enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan just for those annoying commercials they bombard us with every year"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · 27 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypOamgls&lc=UgwdnumgTKxINNtbPp14AaABAg>

↳ @stephenlan5450 (2): "And people from India call too"

↳ @BoomerBenefits (2): "Those commercials can be frustrating!"

↳ @ahbeemarie7451 (1): "Commercials??? I turned 65 april1st. I HAD to pick a plan. I did. I STILL receive unsolicited phone calls from insurance companies....at LEAST 25 a day. I have to keep my ringer off at all times and every day block and delete these calls."

"@71suns that is all I have. Plan A and plan B which I pay for plan B. Plan A is regular Medicare that covers hospital stays. I get bombarded with phone calls and text from insurance companies wanting me to get an advantage plan. I block them because I do not trust them. I am 75 years old and I am scared of the medical system. I don't trust hospitals or doctors. They're only there for the money these days."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxrrFVha096OaNtoNd4AaABAg.AMUWC5cfeMZAMXWPB_jarG

"I doubt the celebrity hawkers for Medicare Advantage plans really have one themselves. I bet Joe Namath, William Shatner, and the dynamite guy all have supplemental plans. The only reason not to is if you can't afford the premiums and these guys can."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugxi-BJ7WpxJLsFGVvV4AaABAg.9UkMxX2Jeqw9UnBarC97uj>

"Dreaded having to learn about Medicare as I turn 65 in September. Those commercials during open enrollment are confusing and annoying. I turned to YT to begin learning the easiest way I know. Stephanie made this madness so simple! Suddenly I felt like an expert and that I could see the way to making decisions. Stephanie is just up the road from where we live, and I felt that Texas connection. I called her office and was helped by Abbie, who is as informative and pleasant as Stephanie! I also learned that Abbie will serve as my agent from here on. I had no idea of the ongoing customer service. I am so very pleased!"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement coverage denied? Why insurance companies deny you (and what to do about) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iHQdxXXdiQo&lc=UgyUbPXSR0zQGDCBO3p4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "We are so pleased that you decided to give us a call, neighbor!"

"I'm 86 and have never regretted buying a supplement. I had a few moments this past year by being bombarded with ads from Advantage policies and all the perks. It's getting too expensive and I need dental and eye care however their amounts of help aren't that high. I like being able to pick my own Doctor, especially if I know how good their competency is. I did the pros and cons when I had to decide which one I wanted. Just hope I can keep up with the cost since I am a low income senior."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyzznWAwFso860PP_h4AaABAg.9x6UkfaJ6G39zkzFa8nBiV

"That's funny because I watch MeTV all day and I think it's produced by Medicare because that's really the only commercial they show.....Joe Namath; George Forman; Jimmy "JJ" Walker; James T. Kirk (lol) another football player I can't think of his name and a number of different women so I hear it everyday. I have Medicare but I also have military insurance that covers anything left over. cheers :)"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgxhR8P6yv5aiENqPRV4AaABAg.9To7SfJdfYb9TrnyvclPp>

"@nancybryant4325 Thank you again for your response. I had been told by someone I trusted that I should be on Medicare. I do not have lots of expenses now but I can see that investing before I need it, which most of us definitely will, will give me more security if something major were to happen. I also find most of the so-called benefits of the advantage plan actually not that valuable when I try to use them. And no I don't use referrals because often when I have asked for a specific referral I have either been denied or the payment to the caregiver is denied even though a legitimate referral and I paid a copay. Here I am talking about physical therapy which now I pay out-of-pocket and don't even bother trying to get the referral. I negotiate for a cash price. Many won't take my plan anymore anyhow because of the endless denials, etc. Someone is paying for all those slick commercials bombarding us."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtIF4AaABAg.9TDdw-WtTCC9Tta6FO3qEN>

"Wow! A great video! I turn 65 at the end of 2026 and I have begun researching the different parts in Medicare. I will certainly pass on the flood of TV commercials and look for an independent broker!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1pLq6moM&lc=UgwH6vjoEVspWL0q-DR4AaABAg>

"I'm 66 and get harassed by phone calls & mailings daily trying to get me to enroll into more than the Part A & B! Abuse of Power-Penalties should be called Medicare Pushers, that's Blackmail!"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgxaAftiutka2B4aVcB4AaABAq>

"An extremely informative and well put together video! I appreciate the non-partisan presentation because that is really hurting all of us in this country. That's especially true for seniors who will again be bombarded with those Medicare Advantage ads all day everyday during the Medicare open enrollment. It's true, as you clearly stated, it's either raise taxes or reduce coverage or benefits or other programs, or, one we should all be getting on board with, eliminating the horrible abusive fraud that is in the system. There are apparently billions upon billions of dollars in Medicare fraud of course alone. We need to stop the horrible partisanship, at least in this instance, and demand that our states persist the feds in auditing Medicare beneficiaries and more important, providers since the provider and seems to be where most of the fraud is. But every day I see dates refusing assistance in this area claiming they're already doing it, but that just doesn't make sense, if you can get help, take it! All that aside, I truly appreciate what an amazing job you did on this, I am in original Medicare with a supplement and Medicare part d, so not exactly looking forward to this fall but, hey, could be worse! Kick the Can😂😂"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSl_fc&lc=UgzVZjooYulDgzYZYF54AaABAq

"I get bombarded in the mail and online everyday to switch to an Advantage plan. I am smart enough to realize there is a reason they want want me to switch and it is not to my advantage. I will also say my agent actually does a medicare seminar and he informs everyone about both plans the good and the bad. He did not push the advantage plan on me at all."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgwX027oX-hXzDseMO14AaABAq>

"i cant count the number of medicare spam calls i get everyday i get so many im sick of my phone constantly ringing. i dont answer the phone to numbers i dont recognize anymore. i dont have an answering machine either. i signed up with the national do not call registry but it doesnt seem to be working."

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=Ugzs6_W5Zi17RfBOflJ4AaABAq

"I'm on plan G and holding on to it for dear life. Hope things never get bad enough to accept an Advantage plan. Believe me Joe Namath is on original Medicare "I guarantee it " 😂😂😂"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzH_VEtTDJ8Ye_FI54AaABAq

"Great analysis with humor. 5 years ago I selected an advantage plan. I was fortunate enough to have it cover everything I needed as I was diagnosed with cancer and had a stroke in the same year. However, I initially selected it because it promised all this wonderful dental Care. However they neglected to tell me that no damn dentist in my area took the plan. They told me to call around and find a dentist they didn't even have a list of providers that participated, it was up to me to find one. Funny thing is the only ones I could find that participated we're 2 hours away in Detroit. That is the only time I have had advantage. And they don't mind bugging you multiple times a day to the point of harassment by making phone calls over and over. I decided a long time ago that this was a scam. In my situation I could switch plans once during the year which is what I did, however with the first plan I was paying extra for dental (that I could not use for lack of providers in my area) which is one reason I switched. And when I switched the first plan tried to Bill me for the money they lost in my extra payment and I pretty much told them to get f* I wasn't going to pay them a dime. I would never never never never never have advantage again"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=Ugy1FOwz2cpjpYKC7hd4AaABAg>

"OK I am on the federal do not call list, our state does not have one. I get 20 to 30 scam calls every day. I am in the service industry so have to answer the calls. Every thing from Alpha lab telling me that medicare will pay for 8 covid tests (I dont have medicare) to my free medic alert system or will pay off all my credit card dept (dont have a credit card). Oh yes I have won a free paypal reward (dont use paypal) abusively no card. You are cute but the info is worthless, sorry I have reported the calls (with phone numbers) (spoofed ofcourse) to the FCC for the last 6 weeks this has not helped ether. Surely in this day and time the technology exists to keep this from happening and who would develop it or is it already here? The government has there hands tied, so we need to look to private enterprise, Phone company's maybe? If one of them did that would be a great selling point"

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=Ugz1xSpdalWCICEjV1x4AaABAg>

↳ @TheMedicareFamily (0): "We hate those robo- and scam-calls just like you, Eric! Too many folks get taken, and it makes it seem like honest agents in my industry are part of the problem."

"I was diagnosed with Luekemia just before going on Medicare advantage at 65. I was told (by humana agent for a switchback to supplemental plan) I would not qualify for original medicare because of this. So, medicare advantage was my only option. They said only after being cancer free for 3 years would I even be considered. Im not sure but I they said it be at a higher rate. IDK, but it seems to me that if you have a major illness, most cannot afford tradtional medicare, asssuming that you will pay more when it happens. Yes, ma can be death of 1000 cuts due to copays and the fact that drugs dont count to your max out of pocket. My teor 4 and 5 drugs cost 3600.00 a month. Finally, I will say it can be confusing. Sometimes you think youre going with medicare but somehow get directed to ma. The 174.00 for most ma plans can lead you astray. Also, the bombardment of calls dont help."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgxF-en6FZD62rOqwKd4AaABAg>

↳ @pearlsandpowertools547 (0): "Your agent misled you. Right out the gate you could have gone on original Medicare and a supplement/Medigap at age 65 Guaranteed Acceptance. But he wanted his commission so he steered you to MA and now you can go back to original Medicare buy you cannot get a supplement. Source <https://www.medicare.gov/basics/get-started-with-medicare/get-more-coverage/buying-a-medigap-policy>";

"All true. And having to defend a book of business from Joe Namath every year. I think that most of the problems and issues around using Medicare Advantage arise from the misleading advertising by national call centers that the Center for Medicare and Medicaid allows. People buying insurance via 800 number because whatever celebrity said that they were owed more benefits. Buying a medical policy based on dental or over the counter money. When you enroll via call center you will never speak to the same person again and it's all about making a sale. Imo CMS is definitely not the champion of the people they proclaim themselves to be."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/192eueh/npr_older_americans_say_they_feel_trapped_in/kh2ksdh/

"They made it real clear that if I wanted to be guaranteed acceptance for a supplement, also known as a medigap plan, I needed to sign up for one when I signed up for Medicare. I recommend people go to one of the many consultants when they get ready to go on Medicare, you will be inundated with mail and offers, some are legitimate, others, not so much.. The people that assist you don't charge anything and act as your agent if something goes wrong. They usually know how to pull the right strings if necessary.."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxeDWZcQcMmztzS7vN4AaABAg>

Dental, vision and hearing 'coverage' that pays little · 19 documents · 19 voices

"One more thing, folks.... yes, Medicare is supposed to cover dental now, I think. But if they see the prefix "perio" on anything, you are NOT covered. As our gums deteriorate over the years, treatment for them in any way is not covered by anyone. I don't think there is such a thing as dental insurance anymore, and if there is, it is a pure ripoff because it will be capped at around \$2,000. Anything after that is all yours and it will be a lot. What they do have now are "dental discount plans." But no coverage for any periodontal work. If a dentist even LOOKS at your gums, be ready to cough up some major bucks. And even with a dental plan you will pay big, big bucks if you need any kind of major work, like a bridge or an extraction "by a specialist." You bet I'm angry. After working since 1971 full time in IT (information technology) and made good money, and maxed out my 401k contributions - guess what, after the big recession, what is left is not enough to live on. I am very surprised that our president, with all the tariffs, and everything else, has not done much for the everyday people. Along with huge rent and utility payments, with electricity and water going sky high for AI data centers, more people than ever will never be able to afford a good Medicare plan."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugy4dImjy8eYocHABU14AaABAg

↳ @bellaclyde (2): "Trump has trumped us all"

↳ @namllenum00 (1): "@bellaclyde better than Biden, just care to put money in his pocket and cover for his family. leave politic out please"

↳ @raulhodge3314 (0): "Quit watching the 6:00 news propaganda"

"My Blue Cross Blue Shield, Medicare advantage plan that had good coverage and dental was good too for 2025 now it's gonna cost more for crappy coverage in 2026. It upsets me"

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHS&lc=UgzXkzmRgEgwGWnMznI4AaABAg>

↳ @toecutter7683 (0): "PPO in 2025 was good. HMO in 2026 not as good"

"As a licensed agent, I absolutely agree. I understand why mapds exist, because not everyone can afford a supplement, let alone part b premium. I will also like to point out however, that sometimes, especially in areas of Florida, there are great mapd plans out there. The fact of the matter is, most people don't venture out seeking multiple doctors, and rarely seek routine service out of their service area. Heck, most people wouldn't even know what to do if they are diagnosed with chronic condition. I am slowly warming up to mapds because those who live in hardships, and have health conditions have no other choice. Original Medicare needs to be increased because besides that part d and part b premium, never mind the ancillary "not covered" services like vision, hearing or dental (what a joke)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwIBspUINt_ZTfu8bN4AaABAg

↳ @akita96th (0): "You haven't had to shell out the \$7500 out of pocket expenses yet.... That will wake you up."

↳ @stuntmasta305 (0): "@akita96th this is pretty much the norm for most private healthcare coverage under 65. Not including Aca, or Medicaid. For those on OM, it goes on forever, unless you have a supplement that you pay anywhere between 100-300 a month, plus a separate part D with no dental, vision or hearing in consideration. There are plans with considerable less MOOPs, not uncommon in populated areas to have moops as low as 800. The ugly side of mapds isn't always the cost, but the utilization management."

↳ @akita96th (0): "Like I said its all fun and games until you really get sick then they put the screw on you. All I am saying is those who say they can't afford a supplement will realize when they get sick that maybe they could have afforded it after all once those out of pocket bills start piling up. It is a shame seniors have to live like that in this rich country thanks to the republican party. Any senior citizen on a fixed income who votes republican deserves all the misery old age can muster. MAGA does not love you back."

"Good basic coverage of Medicare and supplement plans. Not too tough to understand when I went on the Medicare website 3 years ago and also watched a few of your and other independent insurance broker's videos. When looking at the Advantage plans I noticed the variations in costs based on covered services, and by the time I found a few plans with the coverage I was comfortable with they were as expensive as regular Medicare with a supplement plan and a Part D plan. Since retirement is kind of a 'spend your accumulated savings/wealth on what benefits you' I decided to spend a bit extra on regular Medicare plan, a supplement, and Part D, and I'm happy with it. I also have a separate dental & vision plan (the Advantage dental and vision is a joke!). Cheers."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgyJgBRgrCnwTLEcTRV4AaABAg>

"The problem with this video is you only get one shot at picking your plan(s) at 65 with no health questions, after that if you are on Advantage and suddenly you get really sick and think open enrollment you can pick what you want, you can but they can then charge you whatever they want a far cry from 165.00 plan G supplement. And the vision, dental crapp is just that it's fluff you get really sick your screwed if you have an Advantage plan. The Feds need to stop funding these profit making insurance companies. And speaking of Plan G or N United health gives you a super good gym membership for free called Renew Llife NOT silver sneakers. My gym membership is 100.00 a month my Plan G premium is 135.00!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwjEpp6OLVm5hPM1hZ4AaABAq>

"I guess I am lucky. I have Medicare, Medicaid (due to the Covid crisis, despite our republpuke governor saying it's over) and a supplimental plan. I am also on "Silver Scripts" and "Extra Help" so my scripts are never more than \$1.30. AND I qualify for a state program that pays my Medicare premium directly. The only down side is not having dental (or very limited dental with Medicaid) and vision only covers every other year.) So I am happy that I am covered and don't have any MAJOR health issues (knock on wood)"

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugy-wNirMFDuiXZZs3t4AaABAq>

"If I dont go with Advantage plan, what are my options for Dental and Vision if they are not covered by plan A and plan B?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8Sji0S1o&lc=UgyJzkOOUoGBImFnwzl4AaABAq>

↳ @AlexSmith-tr9hc (3): "Outside Dental insurance carriers like Physicians Mutual are a good alternative for Dental coverage. However, any major restorative work requires a 1 year waiting period, while preventive can be covered more quickly. I do not have any advice on outside Vision coverage, but your eye doctor may offer a plan or know of a plan to minimize your expenses."

"@sealevel14.7 I have a Plan N Medigap and am very pleased with that. If you are not constantly seeing a doctor, Plan N is usually the better deal than Plan G, as you will save on the monthly premium. Plan N does have \$20 co-pays when you see a doctor, but the premium difference (between Plan N and G) more than compensates. Sadly, not everyone can afford both a Medicare and a Medigap premium. Dental is not covered by Medicare+Medigap, so I pay \$50 per month for a separate plan with Delta Dental, which has good/comprehensive dental coverage. Medicare Advantage plans are deceiving ... and designed that way, on purpose with lots of cheap "trinkets" in lieu of solid/comprehensive coverage! There is an illusion of coverage in all areas, but it's somewhat for basic stuff only. With Medigap, you do pay up front/every month, but then most medical procedures, including major/chronic stuff (excluding dental, vision) are covered at 100% ... 80% by Medicare and 20% by Medigap. With Advantage, there is an initial low cost, but there are expensive co-pays, networks, denials of coverage, etc. As seniors age and start to have more chronic health problems, they often try to switch back to traditional Medicare+Medigap to cut costs, but they cannot pass underwriting ... so are now trapped in an Advantage plan for the rest of their life. Many healthcare providers have stopped taking Advantage, due to problems with being reimbursed by insurers. If you can guarantee you will never have any serious/chronic health problems for the rest of your life, then Advantage is a good deal. With Advantage, the insurance company controls your health care, but with Medicare+Medigap, your doctors control your healthcare"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugzc_CkfUiS7A8RGWs14AaABAg.AOIHGUuVOyHAPaO2DPNnLn

"Medical is good but Vision plan pays nothing. I have Medicare Advantage plan with Humana. The max out of pocket expense is high but I seldom even get close to the max. The deductibles and co-pays are very reasonable. The only issue I have is with the Humana Vision Plan. It is not really a Vision Plan when it comes to eyewear. You only have a limited number of places in network and then when you get glasses and apply insurance, they jack up the price and double the price of eyewear. Eye glasses with Humana plan will cost you more with insurance than buying through another company and paying cash. The Humana Vision plans does not actually cover any cost of your eyewear. All the plan does is allow the merchant to jack up the price and then apply a discount--the \$400 in benefits is not what insurance pays, it is a discount that places like glasses.com apply after inflating the price. I priced a pair of budget frames with progressive lens, transition lens, standard lens. The price without applying insurance was \$269.40. I then clicked the apply insurance benefits and the cost was \$505 and \$105 was my cost. I priced a better frame with progressives, premium thin lens, transition, scratch resistant, anti-glare lens, smudge resistance for \$160 at another online merchant."

— TrustPilot · Humana · 3★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/68e463f740b44c019107645d>

"HealthMarkets was better than the last.... HealthMarkets was better than the last company I used to obtain the "best rates and insurance" company. However upon checking on dentists my dentist which I took on last year is not in the new plan(Aetna) By going into Medicare I had to change dentists. The Humana plan, which I have now has no Endodontists within the plan within 60 miles of me. Every Dental plan I have seen only pays 30-33% on Dental work and I have been lied to by both of the brokers my first two years. I have to get a Root Canal and because there are no Endodontics in the area I will have to spend over 1,000 on dental work. I had a better plan with Delta Dental/Blue Cross Blue shield b4 Medicare The plan I had last year (Humana was worthless) (all they did was fight every claim I had) so I switched to Aetna for 2021 but I will have to switch dentists again because my regular dentist is not in Aetna's plan. Medicare has made my life more miserable, than under my Previous plan. At least I am getting experience with calling all the dentists and endodontics in the area."

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 3★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5fbc97675e693f08f0084541>

"Kick Can... I am on Medicare Part A & B, Medicare Part D, and Medicare Part G. And I have a separate dental plan that cost \$32/mo, and basically doesn't cover anything (a recent cleaning left me holding the bag for \$50). The Medicare plans and the deductibles total up to \$8,532 per year, or 25% of my annual Social Security benefits (before taxes). In addition to Social Security, I have a small annuity that pays about \$900/mo. I'm determined to hang on to the Medicare Part D and Part G for as long as possible, but I feel like the day is coming when I'm going to be forced to decide whether to buy food, or to continue paying for the Medicare plans. In the meantime, the National Debt continues to explode—and Trump alone is responsible for 27% of that debt. And Elon Musk is a trillionaire. At what point does our society simply decide that the government bears no responsibility for the healthcare of its citizens at all?"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgxUUZEIVIVHPWRCWaB4AaABAg

"Check out Cigna, I really like it, Cigna advantage plan.. 3.000 a year dental, nothing is not covered, like a blank check! Broke my back in several places a year ago this October, no exaggeration, Ive had every diagnostic procedure there is plus any doctor, any hospital therapy, Chiropractor, braces medicine, never a copay yet, much more.. I'm sorry I didnt check this out years ago.. I've had Viva (can't be trusted), used my ss plan when I first started ss which is zero helpful! 🤔"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzgM7tL9bIQNKyO7ix4AaABAg.9r4E09uERgGA-e6OUu7tRG>

"You are spot on. I literally get pennies-on-the-dollar reimbursements for my dental bills. Demanded my insurance company provide a list of reputable dentists who don't work in a back alley and who actually charge the absurdly low 'usual and customary' bs prices insurer requires and they just laugh. Worse, most good dentists have dropped out, especially biological dentists, which are the best. Dental is a joke and a ripoff. Of course, like everything else, today."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Plan Cuts Part B Premium To \$21.50 - Too Good To Be True? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yIhPc5AkFIY&lc=Ugwe73oKMNTUFN-3Z7V4AaABAg.APDb5MyRze0APVoT35dKZr>

"@jeffs3627None. Supplement plans all cover the same things based on letter. None cover vision and dental because Medicare doesn't cover those things. However, a few Supplement plans offer discounts at select dentists and optometrists. It's not considered "coverage" because it's just a small discount. I have that with my Plan G, but I would have to drive 100 miles out of my way to save 10%. Not worth it."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugxok-KsWXvobskLJtt4AaABAg.AWldaoZvoPUA_z-eMZIASu

"Everything on The Aetna Advantage plan is going up next year, higher co-pays, higher deductibles, less coverage for dental, and they still don't cover transportation to the Doctor,etc, I have to appeal almost every claim i file with Aetna to get them to pay the claim, Aetna is basically a discount card and not actually insurance"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgwToQmV8Upns5xdI-B4AaABAg>

"@Malteser00 Dental insurance (in my opinion) is the scam. Because of the dentists. I have dental as part of Medicare Advantage (up to \$1,500). I purchased by myself Delta Dental . That is nearly \$80 a month for Delta Dental. And still I pay for the dental services."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgxzaZRDLhsBRTomhbh4AaABAq.AZUOwn1CHSvAaTeAiFucRK>

"I believe you can use your HSA funds to pay your Part B premiums. I did for three years, had enough to get me to when I filed for SS benefits at 69 1/2. Also used it for my co-pays and dental not covered by my Plan N supplement. Dogs are my favorite!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxyGTzzXveN7msXbt54AaABAq>

↳ @Chris.Brisson (0): "But, you were not able to pay your Plan N premiums from your HSA."

↳ @richkuban2027 (0): "@Chris.BrissonCorrect."

"For plan G or N I'm confused on the vision and dental part is it not covered or is there a monthly premium within the plan?"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgyZwcv6ZQi2t3n9aj94AaABAq>

"Do you go to my call me back I tried to talk to them daughter and I don't want it all American people call me tell me a zero down and I'll let up cause either way go you're still gonna have to pay that is that is not her fault for the most weirdo I don't know when you made the state it would've run 48 some meals OK God bless you 148 God bless you now the enemy want to do route canals and crowns and stuff yeah Denist wanted without everything put in place they got a game I don't want to give me your plan is managers would he say I read it wrong I got a good TV I need to tell him the truth to those they do a filling on it OK the feeling don't last so long didn't want to do the crown to pay all the money for a crack baby you know how to dress like it was before I know that you get it it is my day is it no I have not told about the dress like it I'd rather play with no I had to dress like that does all my God where do you mature know when I go get my T4 my dad didn't account but when I go get my T4 I'll take my headphones are used to make my doctor here for me to put all my emails and tell me that he iPhone but I'm not I take my medication I take my headphones The main TV was broke right now all the TVs in there I can't believe it has a yard to pay your bill how do I say what are you doing what did we watch TV and pay the bill in the waiting room no television no magazines no nothing is it all my God help me Jesus that's all I can say I'm gonna take them to magazine I got a treat everybody equally OK God bless you guys lady I'm glad you're teasing I was going on and tell him to about it while green they can order from Walmart every 66663 month when my phone is it me the catalog does my insurance lady know if you are from my telephone I told Medicare I don't play with the phone so they don't need to send me to Walmart catalog on my telephone just send me a catalog and order every order no I got me I got the message or vitamins last time 200 I got vitamin is 200 what I need to help I got a come a cosmetic and tell them we need to get the yeast rice and refried rice diet supplement I have to take them that want me to take them while greenhouse Walmart has them OK God bless you guys presentation I'm proud of you but now I know to dinner Saturday bring over us and being nice as it burns when I sober and I guess I'm doing Tele dentistry"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku8LpblWhz>

'Free' benefits that are a rip-off · 14 documents · 14 voices

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

↳ @johnphillips4342 (10): "All the celebrity promotional advertising is very misleading. These people, although they are over 65, probably are not on an MA plan. The money to promote the MA plans on TV and provide the higher compensation to agents to steer people to those plans comes out of the funds that Medicare pays the carrier to provide medical care. Thus, the networks, prior authorizations, referrals, and denials of care to compensate for the costs to promote the programs. Yes, it's a scam and one our wonderful Congress cooked up and keeps giving support for."

↳ @gordonallen9095 (6): "Agreed. Medicare Advantage = Death Panels."

↳ @ClintFletcher-eu8tn (4): "Medicare is no paradise either. My Mom fell at age 95 and needed physical therapy. The hospital discharged her because they did not want deal with the low Medicare payments. My mother was unable to walk, but they discharged her anyway. I had to carry her about the house until she was able to start walking some by herself."

"anyone that is 65 and over must pay for medicare cost that is paid from social security, about \$175 a month. the 20% supplement can cost \$150 a month , plan G and goes up each year with United Health Care. So annually, one pays \$1800 plus the annual deductible of \$240, or \$2000 a year for health insurance. no co-pays and no other expenses to see the doctor or ER visits after the annual deductible is paid, \$240. the original medicare pays up to 60 days in the hospital. 60 days is a long time. In most cases, one will be discharged within 60 days. From age 65 to 75, most seniors would not be staying in the hospital for long periods of time. the goal is to make appointments to see the doctor and do preventive care. take advantage of the plans. the part that I have a problem with is, medicare advantage can change its policy and they are for profit. the medicare advantage tangle carrots like free stuff , some dental work, glasses, and partial payment for hearing aids. plus gym membership which are available on some supplements. some medicare advantage plans do not pay if you leave the network. when the original medicare, I can go to any ER and do not need to worry about a co-pay. with advantage plans, there are doctor visit co-pay and ER co-pays and drugs cost money, with kaiser advantage plans. if one starts with the original medicare, you are guaranteed , no need to qualify. if you start with an advantage medicare plan with zero to little monthly fee with some free stuff, if you wish to go back to the original medicare plan, you have to be screened and qualify. the questions, do you wish to pay \$2,000 a year that gradually increases with the annual \$240 deductible , then unlimited doctor visits and ER visits? or be nickled and dime with office visit cost, ER cost , and subject to having the advantage plan approving your bill with possible surprises? I have to make a choice soon, nothing is free in life. All I know, I am currently paying \$1000 a month with kaiser and it cost me \$\$\$ for office visit, lab work and if I need to go to the ER. if I have to have a test performed, I have to still pay. So the \$200 a month supplement is reasonable with the original medicare. Again, Nothing in life is FREE, especially when our congress is swayed by private insurance companies trying to get a larger piece of the business. I hear many horror stories with private advantage medicare plans. they surprise Americans with large bills since the coverage does not pay for certain treatments. IMO"

— YouTube · Original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage: What's the Difference? · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=weO1WkquA3s&lc=Ugzaix7JeWu8Hgkw-fB4AaABAg>

↳ @ESMEE_4EVERR (0): "Jvgknftiokfpmgibdhcujjgbjjg"

↳ @AIH-p2u (0): "I'm surprised you think it's okay to pay 2400\$ a year plus dental plus vision plus medication and think it's everyone's best option. Many ppl are healthy and can save 2400\$ etc for 5-10 yrs then go into a chronic plan with little max out of pocket saying you thousands but if you're ill and have my doctors then supp is the way to go UHC offers both mapd pdp and supp I am contracted with them"

↳ @bozomonster (0): "The math doesn't workout in your if your paying \$1,000 per month to Kaiser. The max out of pocket with a Medicare Advantage Plan is \$5,000."

"Great explanation of the two options. I wanted to add my experience. I started with original Medicare. I was then attracted by the extra benefits of the Advantage plans like dental and vision, so I switched. About 11 months in, my cardiologist wanted to perform a diagnostic procedure, but the pre-authorization was denied. I decided to switch back to original Medicare, and in my state, I was fortunate that my original Medigap insurer would accept me back without medical underwriting. As soon as I was covered by my Medigap plan, I had the diagnostic procedure done. It revealed that two heart arteries were 100% blocked, and a third was 80% blocked! The cardiologist and heart surgeon both said I was lucky I did not have a heart attack. Those extra benefits in the Advantage Plans are not worth my life. I never would have imagined an insurance company denying a cardiologist's request. I am curious how many patients have suffered and/or gone broke under an Advantage plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medigap at 65: The Real Costs Most People Don't Understand (Clip) · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M9hEKbgJg2w&lc=UgzatdULLbThq980Ddl4AaABAg>

↳ @stargazer-c5v (0): "Nope you wont go broke with an advantage but you will with the medigap. I guess you had the money to pay an extra \$500 plus copays. Well bully for you. What we need is government medicare for all not a for profit medical system. Imagine if firemen came to your looked at your fire insurance and said oh your policy doesnt cover your house just the property so we have to let it burn. You Americans are so blinded by greed and me bot attitude that ypu let the rich eat you"

↳ @gerryglauser2394 (0): "Alternately, I've had an Advantage plan for well over a decade. Before choosing a plan, however, I looked into their record. A year ago my cardiologist wanted multiple heart diagnostic procedures, which were done. In addition to AAA scans and others, I never had anything denied."

"I seriously question how scammers are getting away with the Medicare Free Food cards ad's that they have been pushing hardcore on youtube videos. They state anywhere from 1,500.00-3,500.00 cards available for food to people with Medicare. Gotta love the way that she avoids your question as to "Who are you looking for to talk to" These scammers suck!"

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=Ugw7Zp26mwU5jQY6hqp4AaABAg>

"I am staying with original Medicare to avoid all the confusion with the advantage plans. My sanity makes it worth while. I listened to the pros & cons of the advantage plans and they have back end billing practices which means you'll be charged for separate medical tests etc. so you end up paying more than you would have on the 20% on original Medicare. Nothing is free and simple is better."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzONtoIzImlo_4M9LV4AaABAg

↳ @davidharris678 (3): "Darlene, All the co-pays for Medicare Advantage are spelled out clearly in the plan. If anything is confusing it would be Original Medicare's billing. I know i look at hospital bills all the time."

↳ @TK-cl1jm (1): "If you can't swing a med supp, DEFINITELY get a med advantage plan."

↳ @darlenemeek2201 (0): "Plus if you get a hefty 20% bill you can usually make arrangements to pay monthly."

"You are so WRONG about EVERYTHING you say! MA plans are required to cover EVERYTHING that original Medicare does and they do so much more....like dental, vision, hearing health clubs, healthy groceries, over the counter supplies, transportation, utility payments, now even certain paper products! They ALSO provide phone doctor advise at no charge 24 hour. If you want to listen to these sales people who sell supplements and make huge profits , you are welcome. I like the MANAGED CARE as they protect me from doctors taking advantage of me. Doctors pay each other for referrals etc keeping you going to doctors unnecessarily just for profit. I have NEVER paid for a prescription drug in 17 years! I also haven't paid for OTC supplies for 17 years. Please keep your expensive Medicare plan so you can keep paying for my great MA plan. My MA plan pays for my Medicare premium...your Medicare plan takes your MO ey from your SS CHECK. My MA plan puts it back. Thanks"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwpJ9tT2yIndb6B0sV4AaABAg.9hp4BMpwwmN9y8MwIEgOhK>

"I was scammed by Humana into enrolling based on the "giveback" that was SUPPOSED to lower my Medicare monthly premium till i found out that it was Only a "one-off" payment of \$102 to Social Security not a monthly reduction of the Medicare premium, as i had earlier been given to believe. Now i am thinking of cancelling my Medicare part B because of this deceitful misinformation and cancelling my Humana enrollment."

— YouTube · Medicare Part B Give Back Benefit - What's The Catch? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dMy1JJvQwTs&lc=Ugw0zeeu5s5pfs9ZjC94AaABAg>

"Advantage plans bait and switch on you they give you money for glasses and false teeth cleaning your teeth I give you food card but when you need surgery you're real sick in the hospital they deny you surgery now can you imagine our government allow an advantage plan to deny you surgery when you need surgery it's a joke don't take advantage plan they deny you what Medicare would normally allow you to have they keep the Bonnie they bait and switch you they'll give you a pair of glasses or fix your teeth or give you a little card or give you a little money back every month but then when you really need all that money they won't give it to you because they keep it and they want you to die they won't let you have surgeries you need in our government allows them to do this to old people a lie through their teeth to get your money every month from our government run for your life don't take advantage plans stick with Medicare and take a secondary insurance to cover what Medicare doesn't the 20% Medicare doesn't"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgzuydJEAfUDWV7viGd4AaABAg>

"@g0989 At the time I didn't know anything about anything. I just knew that I was mad as hell because it was just a bait and switch. After what the lady at the doctor's office told me I switched her back to medicare. Her meds were not very expensive so we just paid for them. The PA did put her on a \$300 once a day insulin that did not control her diabetes. We started using Walmart insulin in two doses and it controlled her diabetes. In Georgia you can get insulin over the counter and Walmart sells their own brand. It's made by the same company as the name brand. It was \$25 back then. It worked great for her and is probably a lifesaver for many others. I would never get a Medicare Disadvantage plan. I am totally against the privatization of medicare. They're trying to do it to institutions that have served us very well. Look at the Postal Service. It won't stop unless we stop it. I lost my sister to covid in January of 21 while a crooked coward secretly got the vaccine."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugx4L8LUGpEt1CSGoBx4AaABAg.9yUchLrsiyx9yb2fnNH-fu>

"Well first of all, nothing is free. Second, there are MA plans that have \$0 premium but as agents we are told to never say free and there's one reason. It isn't free. It's just your part of the premium. The government pays the other part. (I think, correct me if I'm wrong.) Also...Medicare Advantage is NEVER zero cost because you pay as you go. Also, the MOOP is much higher than Medicare Supps. With the Supps, you may not like the monthly premium you are paying, but unless I'm missing something, you know what your costs are."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwPA1P1Slezp3jZeJl4AaABAg.AQcjbM4h_cAS0hZAnCisr

"I have Medicare A and B and Tricare for life. Period! You see those commercials? Change the channel, do NOT buy into these commercials. You know the commercial that says call us you get a grocery card! Yeah remember this, nothing is free!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycFtJYZcyGDSiSejN4AaABAg>

"I totally agree about the greed. I do not support Medicare for all or universal healthcare. There will still be a tax we will have to pay. It will be much worse than now. Nothing is free, someone has to pay for it."

— YouTube · UPDATE: Medicare Part D Subsidy Program ENDS - What Happens Next? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7l_bhhxH9w&lc=UgzDVZZDa8wn7aZh2kx4AaABAg.AZwugovu_WSAZxEOJxDEIT

"medicare• advantage is the biggest rip off scam they offer all free dental free membership to a gym \$1000 for groceries people that fall for that stupid shit I'm sorry"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxjmxUc5vbabp8-Gh4AaABAg>

"Do not leave the original Medicare for any advantage replacement policy With Medicare open enrollment upon us. I don't know who needs to hear this, but if you're out searching for Medicare plans for yourself or your parents and it's getting confusing as it does for everybody. I want to provide you with a cautionary word of advise from our failed experience. First off never leave the original Medicare. Just don't. When my mom became Medicare age, we did not know which plan to put her on and we blindly trusted a very close family friend who sold insurance to pick that plan for her, not knowing any different. I didn't find out until later that my mom was put on a Medicare "replacement" plan through United, which is not actually Medicare. If you're helping someone pick a Medicare plan, just add a "supplement" to their plan. Do not make any changes to their original Medicare plan and never ever switch over to any of the advantage plans where they try to lure you into their insurance plans by giving you extra cash / groceries / gym memberships / benefits because it's not the real original Medicare. Does replacements work, yes, and they are great until they aren't. The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. That's when the real issues can rise up to the top. I personally call it a scam bc I think few are told what is actually occurring when you sign up for a advantage replacement. If you already left the original Medicare, you have 1 year to go back to it otherwise you have to take a medical examination to be approved. If you have real health issues, your rates will likely skyrocket and make it impossible to return. Keep the original bc the cost stays the same for the most part and it's protected far more than any other insurance policy out there. Disclosure: I can only speak from our personal experience. On a side note: insurance agents make more money on the replacement plans than they do on a supplement plan. So take it for what it's worth. **The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. I am ultimately making this post to help, but also to see if anyone else has any ideas on how I could get my mom back on the original Medicare, it looks hopeless but I thought its worth pushing it out to Reddit and pray someone has had a way of reversing this mess Thank you."

— r/medicare · 89 upvotes · family member helping · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1gs3yfb/>

↳ (0): "I think you have a lot of misleading "information" here. While I agree that original Medicare with medigap is typically better, it's also much more expensive. So what's misleading? * Medicare advantage IS Medicare. It's Medicare part C. It's not "original" Medicare, but it is Medicare. It's an "original" Medicare replacement, but it's NOT Medicare replacement. These terms are important. * original Medicare without a medigap plan is VERY risky, as there is no out of pocket max, and you are responsible for 20%. This adds up quickly. Advantage plans have a max out of pocket, even if it's high, it's still better than no oop max. * you can return to original Medicare without any kind of underwriting. Medigap plans may require the underwriting (unless in a GI state). This is not typically an "exam", but rather a set of questions. If they find out you were dishonest on them, your coverage may be invalid for the medigap plan (not the original Medicare part, that is always going to be valid). * while the cost of original Medicare itself does not increase much year to year, medigap plans often do. They can increase dramatically, especially after they have been sunsetted and members start dropping off. Again, if you are on original Medicare only this will open you to a lot of liability. Again, I'm not anti original Medicare. If you can afford it and a medigap plan, it's the best choice. But a Medicare advantage plan is often better than original Medicare only because of the extra liability and risk."

↳ (0): "The liability and risk still exists. MA plans have been proven to deny services even when all the necessary requirements have been met. While the numbers on a page might suggest an MA plan is cheaper, if the plan denies coverage the person will either have to file an appeal (costing time) or pay for the service (costing money). Original Medicare is by far the safest choice. MA plans are for people who wanna gamble."

↳ (0): "You're comparing the cost of healthcare with the cost of the insurance. They are two different things. The cost of healthcare varies based on the benefits of your insurance. The cost of your insurance is only the cost of

your insurance. While there are logical reasons to include both in your planning, it doesn't help if you don't have the money to pay for the insurance. I literally said go with og Medicare if you can afford it."

The government's part in it: rules, cuts and mandates · 14 documents · 14 voices

"Don't just verify your doctors are in network. Check with each doctor to make sure they will accept your new advantage insurance. Two dentists in my network refused to accept my new insurance when I turned 65 and switched from AARP dental insurance to Medicare advantage. Turns out they don't have to take your insurance, even though they're "in network". Also, if you get a part d after turning 65 you'll get hit with a penalty premium based on age that never ends. What the government is doing to Medicare is horrible. The people who have worked all their adult lives and now need it the most are the ones suffering."

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 573 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=UgyHNddHO9eG9zZ5XTh4AaABAg>

"LEAVE advantage plan OR RISK YOUR LIFE. WARNING: Medicare Advantage Plans Can Delay Care With No Consequences Please read this carefully—your health and your life could depend on it. I just found this out on Friday after speaking with an attorney. If you have a Medicare Advantage plan, you are NOT protected if your insurance company delays your care in bad faith—and right now, you have no legal recourse. I found this out the hard way. UnitedHealthcare's algorithm delayed my cancer treatment for five months. When I first found a lump in my neck, my cancer was stage one. By the time I was finally able to get treatment, it had progressed to stage three. Five months lost. Five months where the cancer spread. Now, I am left with irreversible side effects and a permanently diminished quality of life. These are facts. It's public knowledge if you do the research. I recently spoke with an attorney who confirmed my worst fear: Because of a 2023 Supreme Court upheld with the ruling listed bellow. You CANNOT sue a Medicare Advantage provider for delaying your care for BAD FAITH. The law was made in 2023. (The California Supreme Court's decision in Quishenberry v. UnitedHealthcare) -2022 Read that again. They can delay your treatment for as long as they want. They can deny and restrict access to life-saving care. And you have NO legal way to hold them accountable. If I had traditional Medicare or a standard insurance plan, I may have been protected. But under Medicare Advantage, patients have no rights when insurance companies prioritize profits over their lives. And if you think this is an accident, think again. These companies are making billions from Medicare Advantage while rationing care and exploiting legal loopholes that shield them from responsibility. Look up how much they've profited—while patients like me suffer the consequences. It's public record. You have until March 31st to switch back to straight Medicare if you are currently enrolled in an Advantage plan. Do your research before it's too late. I am looking into a class-action lawsuit, and I will be writing to my state senator—because this is criminal. No one should be forced to endure what I have. Please—share this information. Protect yourself. Protect your loved ones. The system is rigged, and right now, patients are paying the price!!!"

— r/medicare · 152 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jcgwz2/>

↳ (0): "I have Stage IV cancer with Original Medicare and Medigap. Everything has been covered with no issues since my diagnosis. Your experience is a nightmare and echos what I've heard from other cancer patients. Some patients have no issue with Medicare Advantage but some experiences have put people's lives in jeopardy and I applaud you for telling your story."

↳ (0): "Are your bills higher? New to Medicare and need brain surgery. Soon. I was going to pick an advantage plan due to medical bills, seeming like they would be lower with advantage versus medigap. But now I'm thinking, after this post and your comment, for my current situation medigap would be smarter. This is all so confusing to me. Any advice I'd appreciate. Thank you."

↳ (0): "With our medigap G we only pay the \$257 deductible per year. Our monthly medigap plan cost my husband \$160 per month. He has lymphoma and gets ct scans 2x per year, pt scans, mri, specialists, all at no extra charge and no hassle. Unless you are healthy and don't need more than a physical once per year, I would recommend traditional Medicare and the medigap G."

"Nope. I'm not willing to pay 50 or 60 % in taxes, plus if you think the government can run the Healthcare system completely without terrible consequences it is delusional. Medicare is bad enough no need to destroy what we have with communism."

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgynxtJNTyb5jbGSrtl4AaABAg.AaWwDvQmagg7AaX3q99wjlu>

"I've been waffling between the Cadillac plan and the others, but I think I may not be able to afford Plan G in the future. I'm now considering Plan G-HD or Plan N (less likely). It's very annoying to have to go through this considering that the government could plug the Medica charges and just let people get on with the important things in life."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgzlTQzLwuu1zsnkRPP4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "It can be a heavy decision for sure. I wish it was easier!"

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (0): "HDG It's the way to go. Plan G long-term is unaffordable for the average person with the rate increases (10% and up each year)"

"I got a letter and because I dropped part b for Va community care they said part d would be canceled and I wrote back and told them that that was not a requirement when I signed up on part d and why they were discriminating against a 70 year old man drawing retirement, I said before that Medicare was nothing but a scam and fraud perpetrated on the people, we pay all our lives and get screwed again and again by Medicare and all the government, if there going to cancel my part d I am asking for a life long refund of every penny I paid these crooked asses"

— YouTube · Will Your Medicare Drug Costs Soar in 2027? What to Do Now · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5qjYsfpQuVw&lc=Ugz8ep2jb84jXBkHfAp4AaABAq>

↳ @MyGovExpert (0): "Good that you wrote back. Check your plan's letter and your ANOC carefully before the deadline. Our plan guide walks you through your options: 24help.org/aep. You can also call our Chapter at 352-841-0632 for help. - Dr. Ed"

↳ @LarryDerryberry-j3b (0): "@MyGovExpertthank you , I filled out a new application and sent it in with my letter, see what the fake AI says about that then I will go from there. I saved your reply so I can hopefully get it took care of"

"I am ("involuntarily") enrolled in Medicare Part D, a zero dollar premium plan. I DON'T use it. Instead, I just order my prescription drugs from Amazon Pharmacy. MUCH cheaper than my Part D plan, free home delivery. Part D is a TOTAL scam, but if you drop it, the government penalizes you SEVERELY if you decide later to re-enroll. You're damned if you do enroll, damned if you don't. The whole convoluted thing is a shell game designed by insurance company actuaries. The average person can't hope to understand it."

— YouTube · Medicare Part D Is Changing in 2027 — Don't Make This Mistake · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7X5kZQsy56Y&lc=Ugw1eOUIKHCcvT1IEjF4AaABAq>

"Well it was the GOVERNMENT that required everyone belong to a part D program to begin with...why do i need to pay for a plan that barely pays for my drugs to begin with; medicare advantage plans are a joke anyway!"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSl_fc&lc=UgxaSbrDtZvtlUi2bKp4AaABAq

"The problem I find with Medicare is customer support. I have Humana and get very good customer support; I can call, chat, etc. And the government doesn't do those things without a lot of frustration."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxnXHk5uYUo6jAYvOZ4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (1): "Absolutely true. The government doesn't welcome you onto Medicare and show you the steps you have to take.. You have to make an appointment at the local SS office and have them explain it. I guess that is the reason someone like me has work! 🙄 "

"@robertprince1900 as a caregiver to aging family members, I had to deal with the billing snafus of doctors, hospitals and rehabilitation facilities in a Plan G situation. The burden of sorting out what had been paid or not paid by both the government run medicare buffoons and the inept supplemental insurance agents was a NIGHTMARE and stressful beyond belief. I had boxes of correspondence, bills, EOBs to keep track of and sort out. I do NOT want this administrative burden to be thrust upon my lived ones. I've found personally the advantage plans insurance companies have been far easier to deal with. That said, I've not had lots of denials to deal with and frankly, doctor, it's your services that deal with the denials first. So no wonder you hate them as it stops your cash flow. My experience in the few cases of MA denial was that the billing departments didn't code a bill correctly or they double billed or billed for some service they FAILED to get preauthorization for and knew they were required to get. The whole system is a nightmare. We can do better."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugyx2vSFo0pDKeUHZFZ4AaABAg.AKZosH5eIVcAMaxJufQmHS>

"John, I want to thank you for this segment. My husband (who is under 65, but permanently disabled) was on Medicare Advantage for several years. After he was injured, the process of getting all his disability benefits in place was frustrating and time-consuming, and after FINALLY getting approved, we foolishly thought that Advantage would simplify things going forward. Yet I was constantly baffled by how many more headaches and expenses we had with it than I'd anticipated. I watched this segment back in October and after getting over being angry at the government (and my past self's ignorance), I immediately looked into what he needed to do to switch back to regular Medicare. We're not even 2 months into 2026 and we've already had fewer frustrations and lower expenses. Of all the things I've learned from this crazy show over the years, this might have been the most personally impactful for me and my family. 💜 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=Ugy8jfEi53nztNpHkfZ4AaABAg>

"All medical auto home owners insurances are a BIG SCAM.... We are being scammed by the CEOs of all the insurance companies as well the government has their hands in all of this without doubt.. I refuse to pay for any other additional Medicare SCAM only will continue with part A & B that's it, one thing is for certain we are not here on this earth for long time tomorrow isn't promised to anyone & I could care less about any other coverages I won't become a gullible fool to waste anymore money then what I am paying now for part A & B PERIOD."

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgwV2FkNEPdiQgfXled4AaABAg>

↳ @calguy3838 (1): "If you don't get a Medigap plan to supplement your Part B, you are on the hook for 20% of the cost for everything, which can get very, very expensive."

"But the corporations can't seem to understand WHY people are so angry at them and the government. A high percentage of people won't know about this and their insurance company nor the government will tell them about this. 🤔 This is why this country needs to get a socialized healthcare system instead of the 700+ billionaires getting more tax breaks or even having tax breaks that the average American can get. I never even heard of plan N. What is that?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxV49EfNMJ0KGJhIcN4AaABAg>

"Almost impossible to do anything with money involved without encountering some type of scam. This is exactly what I have lived 69 years to have every human vulture on the planet picking at my bones before I am even cold. The way we treat our elderly is intolerable. Fined for life! Even criminals can pay off their fines. F the government, corporations, small businesses and all you other thieves. (I did not get fined)"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgzzZiup4bL_mQgzQRZ4AaABAg

↳ @sabineprice2055 (0): "As a small comparison, Germans pay a higher premium than we do for Medicare. Unfortunately, everything changes. Many years ago the Medicare deductible for Part B was \$100.00. Now it is higher."

"Damn. I was planning to sign up for Part D this Fall. :(I hate this administration."

— YouTube · Trump Administration to End Medicare Drug Plan Subsidy. #medication #medicare #doctor · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BrOgvbQKs-A&lc=UgxyqqQVKkoZH-9Cu2p4AaABAg>

IRMAA and the Part B premium · 11 documents · 11 voices

"As a licensed agent, I absolutely agree. I understand why mapds exist, because not everyone can afford a supplement, let alone part b premium. I will also like to point out however, that sometimes, especially in areas of Florida, there are great mapd plans out there. The fact of the matter is, most people don't venture out seeking multiple doctors, and rarely seek routine service out of their service area. Heck, most people wouldn't even know what to do if they are diagnosed with a chronic condition. I am slowly warming up to mapds because those who live in hardships, and have health conditions have no other choice. Original Medicare needs to be increased because besides that part d and part b premium, never mind the ancillary "not covered" services like vision, hearing or dental (what a joke)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwIBspUINt_ZTfu8bN4AaABAg

↳ @akita96th (0): "You haven't had to shell out the \$7500 out of pocket expenses yet.... That will wake you up."

↳ @stuntmasta305 (0): "@akita96th this is pretty much the norm for most private healthcare coverage under 65. Not including Aca, or Medicaid. For those on OM, it goes on forever, unless you have a supplement that you pay anywhere between 100-300 a month, plus a separate part D with no dental, vision or hearing in consideration. There are plans with considerably less MOOPs, not uncommon in populated areas to have moops as low as 800. The ugly side of mapds isn't always the cost, but the utilization management."

↳ @akita96th (0): "Like I said it's all fun and games until you really get sick then they put the screw on you. All I am saying is those who say they can't afford a supplement will realize when they get sick that maybe they could have afforded it after all once those out of pocket bills start piling up. It is a shame seniors have to live like that in this rich country thanks to the republican party. Any senior citizen on a fixed income who votes republican deserves all the misery old age can muster. MAGA does not love you back."

"CLIFF. I know someone who has been paying IRMAA from day one, he is far from being angry. His Medicare premium is still MUCH CHEAPER than his individual health premium before 65. As far as he's concerned he's laughing all the way to the bank."

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA: What Most Retirees Get Wrong About Their Premiums · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w1PM7D2XD84&lc=UgxD49_MZE_85aUXK_F4AaABAg

"My wife will turn 65 in November of this year (2024), she just received (today 10/10/24) the letter from Social Security telling her that she will be getting charged for Part B next month in Nov. and if she wants to appeal it she has 60 days from the date on the letter to do so. In the meantime they will be deducting approximately \$174 which she will not get back after she cancels, how can they get away with that when she never consented to be covered by Part B, THIS IS SO INFURIATING. And to top it off the letter says she has to contact them by writing a letter, I can curse but I will refrain from doing so. Oh yeah, did I mention that she is on Social Security Disability, how does that work."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgxVLeGAKK5z5D3r5x14AaABAg>

"Back in the day showing your SS number wasn't a big deal and nothing to worry about. But since credit agencies started using them to ID people, then identity theft was an issue and we had to protect our SS numbers. I have a Medicare Advantage plan, that's all my State employer retirement system offers, there are 5 advantage plans for my area. I'm confused as to why I have to pay the plan's monthly amount plus the Part B amount (plus I pay the Part B IRMAA). The State does reimburse me for the Advantage plan and Part B, and Part B IRMAA, but not Part D. I have to wonder if I would have been better off not in an Advantage plan and just with straight Medicare paying only for Part B and Part B IRMAA. I've been with Medicare over a year now and it's still just as confusing as it was when I first got in it. What I really hate is that if I sell my house or started collecting a 401K, get SS or even took profits from stocks, then two years from now I could be in the top Part B IRMAA and Part D IRMAA brackets and stuck there for an entire year paying huge monthly amounts. Seems like my health insurance cost me way less before I retired. And yet all through my work years I kept hearing how great Medicare was. Apparently it is if you didn't make a decent salary. And it's scary knowing that coverage costs vary depending on where you live. Now moving to a different State, even area within a State can end up costing a lot more for medical coverage. Kramer"

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKcNbXw-M&lc=UgzIPynuZI3xj98YC714AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you for watching and sharing your thoughts. I have a video on if Original Medicare only is wise. Hoping to release this week."

"What I laugh at is people who won't pay ANY IRMAA surcharge (which may only amount to a few thousand per year more for one or a few years of increased Medicare prems), because of some crazy principle in their head that paying more than is necessary is somehow bad, HOWEVER, they then later in retirement end up pay many tens of thousands ore in income tax over time. It's the old saw of bird in the hand in their minds, but unless you do the calculations, you won't know that it could be less expensive to pay a few year of higher IRMAA prems in conjunction with doing Roth conversions to reduce your income taxation later in retirement."

— YouTube · 8 Ways to Reduce Medicare IRMAA Payments · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z6yhDpaSO9A&lc=UgwSFFJ-CAAF01mnVbl4AaABAg>

"Switching to an Advantage Plan is often done to reduce health care costs. Every year Medicare Part B goes up about the same amount your Social Security COLA goes up. Add your Part B to any supplement plan and you're paying about \$4K a year. I switched to GEHA Advantage Plan, which pays \$75 a month on Part B, but unfortunately has United Healthcare as its provider. I still pay a monthly Advantage plan premium, so I don't think I saved that much in the end. We'll see how it turns out when I get sick because I'm now an Advantage Plan hostage. BTW the Medicare 'promise' is a joke when you have a ridiculous Part B cost you can't escape"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugw7f7xJ94ECsW1FDOql4AaABAg>

"I'm in Massachusetts , they don't use tge G / N designations, the cheapest Medicare Medigap supplement is \$268 ,in Boston it goes up from there , combine that with the \$202 part B premium (that just went up in 2026) that's \$470 month not including dental , eye , ear or prescriptions , that's insane !! Average working people can't afford it , that's why so many have signed up with Medicare Advantage even though that has its downsides also, , healthcare shouldn't be harder for boomer seniors that have worked their whole lives , it should be relatively easy , system is broken driven by a lust for money/ GREED !"

— YouTube · Everyone's Sick of Medigap Rate Increases...Here's What to Do! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NQHG_o1vxVU&lc=Ugy9e1mYeBPNkkuc22F4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (1): "Have you compared high deductible plan g to Medicare Advantage? You'd be surprised."

↳ @JRugg-tt5kw (0): "@policyguidesYes. HDG is so much better!"

"@KathleenMcNe I too worked had. Married at 30 years old and only \$5k in the bank. No college education, do not come from money. For several years had 2 full time jobs (clerical work). For the last 20 years worked for several Fortune 25 companies at director level. Well I was extremely lucky in investments. Stock portfolios (No ETFs) is over \$20 million. What troubles me is RMD tax and IRMAA. Instead of driving me crazy (Tax/IRMAA), the solution is to make more money."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: Why Your Medicare Premium Can Suddenly Explode · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R1MRB2YjYDY&lc=UgxTXm0YjrsiVO1knfF4AaABAg.AR1nAzRk5KRAR_7LezBcxc

"I understand the reason for IRMAA what I find annoying is that IRMAA is charged on W2 income that is already taxed for Medicare. The IRMAA taxes should only be charged on excess income not subject to Medicare taxes."

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA: What Most Retirees Get Wrong About Their Premiums · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w1PM7D2XD84&lc=UgyDbjccCFPJfVqzovN4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching, Paul. I have a video coming out on this - specifically how IRMAA is often presented as a tax or penalty (including by me) but the reality of it is that it is a reduction in a subsidy."

"I will most likely be affected by IRMAA, only 56 and retired last year, but I don't think I will be able to reduce my 401k's enough with Roth conversions without triggering IRMAA. So it is a pick your poison choice, outrageous RMD taxes or more moderate IRMAA taxes. Hopefully I will just be in the 2nd tier of IRMAA, although if we get a couple more years of returns like the last two I may end up with both IRMAA and RMD's."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgyvIb0rDIKNwOsK5694AaABAg>

"I retired from government job. Kept my medical insurance, got Medicare A & B when eligible. 7 months later I just dropped part B. It was too expensive to have. Part B was costing me over \$500 per month due to my past income. So I was paying about \$700 per month and not using any of it. I am in good health thank God, only visit dr once a yr. IRMAA charges are crazy. Thank you for educating us."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugzv43Zh1ZJnPOiQDY54AaABAg>

Insurers' profits, CEOs and Advantage overpayments · 7 documents · 7 voices

"Thank you for this video. I worked for a medical billing company as a surgery medical coder, assigning procedure and diagnosis "codes" for insurance claims. Patients would tell us their stories as they tried to maneuver through the paperwork to try and get their insurance to authorize the surgeries their doctors said they needed to have. My own PCP had worked for an insurance company reviewing claims for medical necessity. When she was hired, they told her she literally had to deny a certain percentage of claims to keep her job. She said she couldn't do it, the claims all met their medical necessity guidelines so she quit in disgust. When it was time for me to go on Medicare I went with a Plan G. Does it cost me more in premiums than an Advantage Plan? Yes, but it is worth it. I know it is the best choice in the long run and I never need to stress over the shameful process of pre-authorization, knowing if the insurance company had a choice between their profit and my life, they'd let me die without so much as a thought. I've even heard of cases where the patient was told to wait until the next "quarter" of the year to ask for authorization and of one patient whose pre-authorization was put off until the following calendar year. It all affects the profit they show to investors, after all, health insurance is BIG business. Personally, I will find a part time job if money to pay the premiums (currently \$129 month not including the \$\$ withheld from my SS check) for my Plan G ever becomes an issue. Piece of mind is priceless."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgxIzKqLKsUUTpu94IR4AaABAg>

↳ @threeftr3349 (6): "An amazing story, thank you for sharing that. I am not of age yet for Medicare. When I worked for an imaging company, I briefly sat by the authorization dept. I was shocked of some of the conversation my co-workers had with elderly patients. The shocker, a person trying to explain, why their insurance company denied their Pet scan, and they had a history of cancer. That test was medically necessary, to determine continue course of treatment for their cancer. Doctors don't have the staff or time to fight these lengthy denials, so it's left for the patient to fight. Unfortunately it's a steep almost impossible hill to conquer"

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "So thrilled to hear that we can be so helpful. Thank you for sharing this we appreciate it so much! Happy to hear that you are getting the coverage and treatment you deserve!"

↳ @Itsgettingcrazy. (0): "@MedicareSchoolWould you recommend a person who is retired and turning 65 stay on their private insurance or get on Medicare part A and B? One person told me if I wasn't working, I had to go on Medicare? I'm happy with my plan. My husband passed 18 years ago and I was able to stay on his insurance."

"Healthcare for profit is a joke. The majority of people that go bankrupt from medical bills have insurance - so it's a worthless joke. The ACA are taxpayer funds funneled to wall-street. Tying health insurance to work is a joke. McDonalds doesn't provide insurance and tax payers have to subsidize these monopolies. Let GOP policies play out and run on healthcare for all 2028. I haven't had health insurance through work since the early 1990s. Paid in for almost 1/4 century and went to the doctors once. Should have gone without. I was paying over \$1,000 per month a decade ago for worthless insurance. So I went the last 10 years without any health insurance, saved over \$120,000 and retired early (58). I'm 66, have Medicare, went to the docs and all is fine."

— YouTube · Expiration of ACA subsidies will have 'ripple effects' in health care and economy · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xOrWISxntkQ&lc=UgkxkDNx8Almb_D8Novh4AaABAg

↳ @bobbear4437 (0): "The insurance you talk about isn't the ACA, it was bankruptcy care that is where we're headed again, you get sick, you go bankrupt, you'll never have anything to leave to your children!"

"Plan G is costing me over 440\$ + drug coverage separate another 125\$ + Medicare monthly fee - ridiculous - half of my ss is going to greedy insurance companies that have record profits, while the undocumented illegal aliens that never worked a day in their life in USA get this for free from our overtaxed system - what i also find ridiculous is that plan g changes rates depending on your zipcode - if you live in a more colorful community the rates are significant lower verses a white one - many years i've been hearing about white privilege and systemic racism -but never imagined i'd be a victim of racist system with no special civil rights to protect my whiteness."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=UgwwpYDKOJoJuIBDSbB4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (2): "I'm not sure how to respond to this comment, but Medicare supplements can get expensive."

↳ @janc8199 (0): "It sucks, I'm praying this administration means what it says getting cost down, but we wont see it until 2027. Crossing fingers, because it's so damn expensive and confusing."

"Back in the day showing your SS number wasn't a big deal and nothing to worry about. But since credit agencies started using them to ID people, then identity theft was an issue and we had to protect our SS numbers. I have a Medicare Advantage plan, that's all my State employer retirement system offers, there are 5 advantage plans for my area. I'm confused as to why I have to pay the plan's monthly amount plus the Part B amount (plus I pay the Part B IRMAA). The State does reimburse me for the Advantage plan and Part B, and Part B IRMAA, but not Part D. I have to wonder if I would have been better off not in an Advantage plan and just with straight Medicare paying only for Part B and Part B IRMAA. I've been with Medicare over a year now and it's still just as confusing as it was when I first got in it. What I really hate is that if I sell my house or started collecting a 401K, get SS or even took profits from stocks, then two years from now I could be in the top Part B IRMAA and Part D IRMAA brackets and stuck there for an entire year paying huge monthly amounts. Seems like my health insurance cost me way less before I retired. And yet all through my work years I kept hearing how great Medicare was. Apparently it is if you didn't make a decent salary. And it's scary knowing that coverage costs vary depending on where you live. Now moving to a different State, even area within a State can end up costing a lot more for medical coverage. Kramer"

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKCnbXw-M&lc=UgzlPynuZI3xj98YC714AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you for watching and sharing your thoughts. I have a video on if Original Medicare only is wise. Hoping to release this week."

"All medical auto home owners insurances are a BIG SCAM.... We are being scammed by the CEOs of all the insurance companies as well the government has their hands in all of this without doubt.. I refuse to pay for any other additional Medicare SCAM only will continue with part A & B that's it, one thing is for certain we are not here on this earth for long time tomorrow isn't promised to anyone & I could care less about any other coverages I won't become a gullible fool to waste anymore money then what I am paying now for part A & B PERIOD."

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgwV2FkNEPdiQgfXled4AaABAg>

↳ @calguy3838 (1): "If you don't get a Medigap plan to supplement your Part B, you are on the hook for 20% of the cost for everything, which can get very, very expensive."

"Healthcare providers will pushback on anyone who tries to limit their greed and absurd charges. Routine bloodwork at our local hospital is \$1800 vs \$120 at a private lab. Take it with a grain of salt when one greedy business pushes back on another. The person in the article represents "for profit" hospitals. Profit being the key word here."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/189nk8b/hospitals_and_doctors_are_fed_up_with_medicare/kbtdn47/

"I love my Plan G but damn, those fees are getting outrageous so I wonder what the CEO of Wellabe makes and how many yachts, fancy cars and homes he owns? It is sickening how rich these CEOs are, robbing their customers blind."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plan Reviews ★ (from real people) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nw14VxxHrmM&lc=UgwrJ8GBPioU7Odp_5p4AaABAg.9kl-m-9KZ2YA0qMii9Kvo

On hold, transferred, given wrong answers · 6 documents · 6 voices

"They not only change tears of the medication they also change the price of the medication at their whim. One month you could pay \$9.00 and next month it cost you \$30.00 for the medication. When you call for explanation you don't get any answers from customer service or they provide you with phone number that is not in the service any longer. They are all thieves, liars and crooks. They will bleed us every year more and more. They are in business for only their own profits. \$600.00 out of my SS goes to cover all the mandatory Medicare programs to be just covered not including copays and cost of the medications. I am managing three different autoimmune diseases, SLE Lupus, Sjogren's syndrome and Thyroid disease."

— YouTube · UPDATE: Medicare Part D Subsidy Program ENDS - What Happens Next? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7I_bhhxH9w&lc=Ugza8BzMqSbV0DL-SUp4AaABAg

"I started doing research on Medicare during my first week and knew them and there I was a scammer I only worked for 3 days and pulled off one scam which I didn't know at the time what I was doing fully and I seek forgiveness everyday because of the guilt but you know what at least now I work at a restaurant I make an honest living even if it ain't much. They paid people ~500 Egyptian pounds per scam which is like \$10 now but it's still heavy money over here and basically they just hire you to get social security numbers so that the people who are running the call centres and take all your money it's disgusting yet so common"

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=UgwcfDKR976zRjaE-IR4AaABAg.AB6DntD4cXuABoHmVwgGd9>

"But the thing is they're old people on the phone who simply can't understand what's happening because of how ridiculously complicated Medicare is to begin with. I started training with them stupidly thinking we were customer service for Medicare since I haven't been to america and didn't know Medicare isn't a private company then I actually started working there still not understanding 100% if this is a scam but then being on the floor there with everyone working it just felt really really odd"

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=UgwcfDKR976zRjaE-IR4AaABAg.AB6DntD4cXuABoHObw-bM6>

"Anecdote: I had decided to go for a Plan F when I went on Medicare, but was hoodwinked into an Advantage plan. I felt like I was wearing a straitjacket. Getting information on anything was an awful experience where one customer service person would say one thing and another would say something completely different. I hated always having to get a referral. After 2 years, I was able to go back on regular medicare and get on a high deductible Plan F supplemental, which suits me fine."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugxa2yCHeaQeABKJoBZ4AaABAq>

"Welcome to the wild world of ACA, brotha! I have no idea how those commercials are running on Youtube. As another Redditor in the thread stated, I once looked at working for an ACA shop full time to retain control over my Medicare contracts, but I ran into the same scammy practices with ACA call centers. There seems to be a lot of stuff that's against the rules but CMS, state DOI's, etc. just haven't had time to enforce the rules yet."

— r/InsuranceAgent · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1lwzydf/is_this_fraud/n33j8b0/

"How are you supposed to compare these plans? The coverage is standardized, but the premiums are all over the map. My current Plan G is now over \$200 a month. I'm worried a cheaper company will have terrible customer service when I actually need to file a claim."

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=Ugylgv9mfYAkiaCwhGF4AaABAq.A1GYh2vjgt1AOlhDacwV9r>

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Chose an Advantage plan · 1,180 documents · 20 voices

"Thank you. I turned 65 this summer and I was inundated with Medicare Advantage paperwork. Intuitively after doing more research I decided to stick with regular Medicare and I'm so glad you covered this. I was led to believe I had to enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan and I'm soooo glad I didn't. The program is designed to deceive you into signing up with zero understanding of what the risks are especially since I'm disabled with a rare spinal cord disease. I feel like I dodged a bullet and I'm going to share this information everywhere. I believe you saved people's lives with this piece."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 895 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgzhQ6cK4tHUxOcEFjt4AaABAq>

↳ @sunflower9611 (31): "I got tricked and switched to a Medicare advantage when they told me over the phone that all my medication's were covered they lied. Multiple weren't a year later. I switched back to regular Medicare. Good job that you didn't try it out."

↳ @ammaleeslie509 (31): "THANK YOU JOHN OLIVER! Medicare Advantage is a scam. Stick to traditional Medicare (with an extra Medigap program) if you can! At this time of year, watching "old people TV", every other commercial is about switching to Medicare Advantage, and some of these commercials are two minutes long, which seems like an eternity."

↳ @edg3048 (24): "Stay out of the Advantage stuff. BCBS has always been good as a supplement. Insurance in this country sucks."

"I came off a supplement to an advantage plan about 5 years ago for two reasons affordability and our good health. We enrolled into a HMO-POS plan for 2026. Of course before the switch we verified all of our providers were still in the plan. Zero premium and \$4800.00 MOP. Which is thousands less than the previous plan. I've saved in premiums over the 5 years over 18K. And wer still healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 888 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgyH9WWhAjCLI7lrkMt4AaABAg>

↳ @Johnsonadam_6652 (1): "Exactly.It's a calculated risk. I did the same, but a major health event last year showed me the holes in my "cheap" plan. The out-of-pocket max became a real number fast. That \$18k in savings vanished in medical bills."

↳ @AmirKazan-n2l (1): "What professional looks at healthcare and investments together?Most treat them separately."

↳ @ReeceCook-r7o (0): "Smart move saving on premiums.That \$18k can compound. The risk is the plan's network stability. A provider leaving or a new diagnosis can change the math overnight. You're betting on continued health."

"I am 64 and received my medicare card. As a senior citizen trying to go through the maze of medicare plans is enough stress to kill anyone. One must ask themselves why is medicare so hard to navigate that private insurers send out their so called medicare advisors to steal our money? I have decided to decline Part B and I will definitely not sign up for the Advantage Plan that I know all too well it will kill you in the end. I will cancel my Federal blue Cross Blue Shield insurance that is almost \$400 a month now that I have only used on four occasions in 21 years. I'd rather die than give one more cent to a broken health care system. When property insurance, health care insurance and auto insurance takes over 50% of a retired citizen income, I call that a crime. The only reason we are the wealthiest country in the world is due to the fact that private companies have been stealing money from the hard working middle class folks and became richer with the money they stole from us because the law makers got their kick back money and we got kicked in the back."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 811 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwoFkaXMEaOiRM1oYh4AaABAg>

↳ @mlyt3153 (24): "I agree that it's incredibly confusing to understand all of the implications when choosing a plan."

↳ @christinereich6050 (16): "Don't give up the Fed blue cross and blue shield! Just don't take Medicare Part B"

↳ @fnhc2023 (16): "Well said, doctors over order and duplicate tests ALL the time.....private advantage tries to prevent waste cuz they have money but not unlimited like the government. Make sure u know when buying Gap how much they increase each year. God help us all"

"My wife and I signed up for Medicare plus the G supplement plus Medicare D. At First it was fine, but after 3- 4 years it was costing us 700 dollars a MONTH. We kept it when we were traveling. It did pay claims, but we did have to pay some stuff. It just became too expensive to keep. So, we changed to the Advantage type after moving to a higher population area. Referrals are not a problem most of the time. Now our max out-of-pocket is 700 dollars a YEAR. My drug copays were 25 bucks for the YEAR, no deductible. True, we have to stay within the provider groups, but we have quite a few to pick from. Original Medicare is great, if you're rich or can go to wherever you have the money to afford to seek out expensive care. Not so much if you live in a backward state or a medical wasteland. Either way you go, you're screwed. Insurance companies, PBMs, hospitals, medical groups, drug companies, crooks who cheat Medicare at every turn are what we Americans are stuck with at this point. The ruling rich overlords will never change it. Congress and the courts have been bought, and YOU AND I have been stuck with the bill."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 722 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxAXzFMBaU-X7O2GZ4AaABAg>

↳ @GPSinger (76): "Absolutely. This comment spells it out the way it is. Doctors don't like to take original Medicare. In effect, you have a more limited network by staying on Medicare original, and you have to pay for both the supplement the medication premium. I strongly recommend the Medicare advantage plans with no monthly premium. They have enough providers of all types that you still have choice."

↳ @savannahsmiles1797 (39): "@JohnDavis-yz9nq John I am licensed agent and EITHER way can bleed ya...it is the hope of Medicare that NO ONE uses it."

↳ @tdtommy89 (32): "@MedicareonVideo Wouldn't that be hoping that the client could also pass through underwriting?"

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

↳ @TheCheryl57 (34): "Again, you have to consider your situation and many older people don't travel so this would not be a problem. There are many things to consider on a personal level, it's not one size fits all."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (31): "Sure wish everyone could read your comment!"

↳ @lindahidalgo1804 (15): "@TheCheryl57 I heard Advantage plans are more costly in the long run especially if you need a lot of medical care. Also, that those plans are more costly for the government, because those Advantage plans charge more for services because the middlemen/women and the in those companies need to make a profit."

"Medicare Advantage is a Scam: My experience almost a decade in the Healthcare industry I was inspired to go into some detail after an AskReddit post about dirty insider truth that most people won't know. I replied that, as a person who's worked in the medical field for a little over 9 years, saying that Medicare is leagues better than Medicare Advantage and Medicare Advantage is a scam. I've worked in a Home Health Agency, an inpatient rehab (SNF), a doctor's office, and am currently an RN working inpatient rehab. Hopefully, people will find this interesting or helpful \- Admissions for SNF: First medical jobs was admissions primarily to fill short term rehab beds. I had a website of all the people discharging from local hospitals who needed inpatient therapy, I would reach out to the hospitals, say we had a bed available, they would confirm with me, I would get the paperwork, get insurance authorization if needed, and greet the patient once they arrived and sign papers Medicare patients: I was told to try and get as many traditional Medicare patients as possible. I asked my boss why and she said that they pay the most and they always pay. I never once had to get insurance authorizations for traditional Medicare. The people could just come in! It covered the most therapy per day vs any other insurance(an hour a day vs. 30 minutes a day usually), including every Medicare Advantage. It automatically covered the first 20 days, then the next 80 days after that, I think it was like 60%. But if they had a secondary insurance, it would cover 100 days at 100%. Medicare Advantage: First off, once you get a Medicare Advantage plan, it's not traditional Medicare anymore, it's the insurance company now. Of you want to come to our facility, you don't get the grace of just walking in. I'm sure they've streamlined everything now, but we had to call a number, present the diagnosis in certain code numbers, wait for an authorization number, and then we could let you in. From there, you'd maybe get 20 days at 100% with half the daily rehab, then after 20 days, they were done. it covered nothing. Patient was 100% responsible for all costs. \- Home Health Scheduler My 2nd job was scheduling a team of Therapists and Nurses to different homes in my city who needed home health. I'd get a stack of referral papers every morning and was told to get them scheduled. For example, a referral would say "Medicare A: Needs RN and PT services", and then I'd contact my staff and arrange a schedule. I would also work with my staff and the patients that needed anything rescheduled. I was essentially the Guy in the Chair Medicare: Let's say that of my 3 referrals I had that morning 1 was traditional Medicare A, once was a UHC Medicare Advantage, and the other a Humana Medicare Advantage. Once again, I was told, "Staff the Medicare patients first!" And once again, I asked why and was told that Medicare always pays, and it always pays the most. I wasn't working directly with insurance at that job, so I can't comment on authorizations or cost. But Medicare patients generally had more RN and PT visits per week than any Medicare Advantage. Usually 3 days per week for each with Medicare, and 2 days a week for any Medicare Advantage. Also, there are longer sessions with Medicare. usually an hour vs 30 minutes Medicare Advantage: Just less care. Less staffing days and shorter sessions. \- Doctor's office: Next job I had before my RN was in a primary care physicians office. I only worked the front desk, but I worked right next to the referral coordinator, so I knew everything that was happening about that Medicare: From a cashiers perspective, Medicare never had a copay while many Medicare Advantage plan did. From a referral perspective, Medicare was so much easier. I don't think I ever saw Medicare rejected a referral claim. It was always quick, and as long as we filled the paperwork out properly, it was approved. Also, most specialists took Medicare, so usually patients could go where they wanted. Medicare Advantage: There was always an authorization process. it often involved scanning and sending documents, then waiting for approval. Generally it was a longer process that resulted in much more rejections than traditional Medicare. Also, one again, because Medicare Advantage isn't Medicare anymore, it's whatever insurance company has it now, the patients were stuck with whatever doctors they had plans with, and it was always a much smaller list than Tradition Medicare. I've been an RN for about 4 years now, so I am very separated from the insurance side, thank God! DISCLAIMER: Some Medicare Advantage plans are competitive with the benefits of traditional Medicare, but they are often very expensive. Some people are very happy with their Medicare Advantage plans, but I wanted to share my perspective, and my experience. But, this is also why I am greatly in support of expanding Medicare to cover all People in the US. We have the means to give the people proper

Healthcare, we just need to do it"

— r/HealthInsurance · 472 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sl2x0z/>

↳ (0): "Reminder to get a supplemental plan with your traditional Medicare. A medigap plan. Also reminder to get your part D plan. Everything you said is spot on but leaves out those couple things that are very important. Everyone I know turning 65 I tell them get your traditional Medicare A and B and then get your D and Medigap. But that sounds really confusing to people which seems to be why they think it'd be 'easier' to just get a Medicare advantage plan to 'do it all'."

↳ (0): "I did research for 2 month on my spare time when I chose my mom's plan last year. And this sub was so beneficial because of so many people sharing their experiences. I chose her A,B,D an G Extra. I feel really bad they make it sooo complicated. I can't imagine being 65 and having to deal with this nonsense."

↳ (0): "The current administration is pushing MA plans; they want to get out of the Medicare business and just pay the \$\$ to the private insurers instead. I think more people need to be aware of this & put a stop to it. As an elderly person, you don't want a for-profit company making care decisions for you."

"I'm so glad that when I first signed up for Medicare, I didn't go with the Advantage Plan."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 328 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwLHliq9v5_Sx1UGW14AaABAg

↳ @christinekoenig5669 (17): "Yes i WAS WARNED & took heed.. do you have to have discernment from God and not be looking for free discounts, great deals from the government etcetera .Be not Decieved!!!"

↳ @davidclaycomb5496 (17): "Me also. I listened to my doctor at the time that warned me against the 'advantage' plans. It hurts when I have to pay full price for any prescriptions, but at least I'm not getting denied coverage. Which has happened to friends of mine. I admit, I was close to signing up once until I mentioned that to my doctor. He was adamant about running away from those plans."

↳ @ahb3296 (13): "I didn't either. Then BCBS sent something with an automatic sign up if you didn't respond. I was out of country. I'm getting ready to try and drop it. Some kind of advantage plan through BCBS. They are scammers!!!"

"You explain the options very well in this video. I'm glad I picked the supplemental plan instead of advantage. I'm 69 and not a spring chicken anymore. Your priority has to be medical benefits as you get older. Go to the doctors and hospitals that you want. No referrals. Pay the supplemental premium, skip the new car payments and hang on to that older car."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 290 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugw1n1YjSCR0VLIkwUd4AaABAg

↳ @FollowScripture (0): "He was very informative...I agree with what you say here"

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_I4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🙏 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌👏"

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"Exactly! I am 76. Have been on Original Medicare with a Supplement since turning 65. Was quite healthy at 65. Few health issues. At 63 I was remodeling a old house, doing almost all of the work myself. Tearing up old flooring. Refinishing wood floors. Tearing out old updates in the kitchen that were poor and putting in new cabinets. Did have my Son and Son-in-law help me with things I could do alone, like hanging upper kitchen cabinets, etc. At 67, my health suddenly began to fail. I have had numerous hospitalizations and surgeries since then. I have been able to go to specialist within a few days, without pre-approval. I have friends on "Advantage" plans that have had to deal with needing numerous referrals, waiting months for testing and surgeries, while I breeze through seeing specialist and getting surgeries within a few weeks. Do not expect that you will always remain healthy. Our bodies are great machines, but let's face it. As any machine ages, more and more issues evolve. Don't fall for the "Advantage" hype. It won't advantage you when you are truly in need of medical care."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 224 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugx5CVy8MAo_bxfGmzd4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (13): "Thank you for sharing your story — it's such an important reminder. Many people feel great when they first start Medicare, but as you've experienced, health can change quickly. Having a Supplement plan makes a huge difference when it comes to getting timely access to specialists and surgeries without the hurdles of referrals or pre-approvals. You make a great point: while Medicare Advantage can look attractive upfront, those restrictions can become very frustrating once serious health issues arise. Your experience really highlights why so many people value the freedom and flexibility of a Medigap plan. I'm truly sorry to hear about the health struggles you've faced, and I wish you continued strength and healing as you move forward."

↳ @franks4973 (6): "Sorry about your health but thank you for your response. HC is my big concern and ven though I am healthy at 62 and like you do a lot of my own work. It was nice hearing another voice of reason regarding Medicare. Thx"

↳ @reneeblack8940 (5): "Hello which supplement plan are you using"

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzvXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAq>

↳ @RonMac08 (18): "@nealjones84 She's doing well, recovering quickly."

↳ @nealjones84 (13): "Congratulations 🎉 how is she doing now after major surgery"

↳ @ckstaff (13): "Sooner or later you get to realize and feel how smart you were in choosing right. If you did have advantage, she may have died waiting or you would now be bankrupt paying a huge out of pocket. I witnessed first hand a friends husband die in bed with Leukemia when he was sent home after 1 day in hospital because the advantage company had their loophole as to why they would not pay. He spent the next 3 weeks fighting denials and appeals in his soon to be deathbed. He died before he ever got approved."

"Well. Thankfully, I saw this before I moved to an Advantage plan. Thank you, John Oliver!!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 211 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugyq5YtMME0u1GngbYB4AaABAq>

↳ @shawshifter2510 (3): "Glad you're able to afford a supplement plan AND a pdp, MOST cannot afford both. Over \$200+ for a plan G or N(\$350+)for most people, then depending on the PDP, it's around 90-155\$ depending on your area. AND THATS MONTHLY."

↳ @jennifervang606 (2): "Are you on a supplement with a drug plan? Don't forget to get a drug plan or you will end up with a lifetime penalty when you do need to get it."

↳ @thainsworth67 (0): "Check out Boomer Benefits."

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

↳ @sct4040 (24): "I too, am on AARP UHC and will be paying \$333/month in 2027. That is so much money."

↳ @nealkshah (18): "Sounds like that "blessing in disguise" really did work out. Thanks for sharing the whole story."

↳ @edwinrodeo (15): "@sct4040... me 2 🙄 . I'm in CT though.. open enrollment yr round. No underwriting required. Only 4 states has it."

"Just went through this with my 96 year old mother. Advantage plan fought with doctors recommend care and we had to go to arbitration. It worked out but if we were not available to help her , she would not have understood what was going on. Easy way to understand difference. Regular Medicare , doctors control your health care. Medicare advantage , underwriting controls your health care."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 193 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgztAt-OUHVW8yJkjot4AaABAg>

↳ @riadanabtawi5880 (32): "I am 76 and my phone has been ringing all day since last Thanksgiving with different people from different states trying to sell me Medicare Advantage. I am happy to hear what you've said."

↳ @richardmcombs617 (16): "@MedicareonVideo thanks yes she is at 96 still very alert and on the mend."

↳ @MedicareonVideo (15): "Hi Richard, Unfortunately I've heard that story too many times. Happy that it worked out for her but many times it does not. Hope she is doing better."

"I've had an ins agent from the beginning of going on Medicare 6 years ago, at no cost to me. She's very informed and has been extremely helpful, especially when I had to change my Advantage plan last year. I don't think I could navigate Medicare without her assistance. I live in Texas."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 192 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw4lalh6RbSRBaUEo54AaABAg>

↳ @ryan-c-U (16): "@kathrynludrick4821 Same here. I'm a Texas new retiree and I'm so grateful my wealth management team takes care of all this at no cost to me. Otherwise I'd be totally lost, despite my executive management background. The complexity and needless micro details of these plans is mind boggling."

↳ @danielstadden1149 (15): "If you were on traditional Medicare you wouldn't even have to worry about that"

↳ @Jd2211-ytm (8): "Just watched, in Tx also and getting close to Medicare age, saw your comment and find this all very confusing. Anyway you know of where I could find the agent or an agent to help me figure this out. I'd probable have them help me with my Dads medical to make sure he's on the right plan. Thank you in advance."

"I've had a Medicare advantage plan for about ten years, and never had a problem even though I had a stroke, rheumatoid arthritis, and pneumonia. I take nine Rx a month and this past month, February, I paid out 37.00. thanks for your input I've had the same doctors for many years."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 181 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxDaTzel73QcRBL0DF4AaABAg>

↳ @cynthiamurphy3669 (15): "Joy, that's great to know. I stayed on the original Medicare for a few years but finally switched to Medicare Advantage and am very pleased with it thus far. Seems much easier to me all the way around. I like my docs and the network."

↳ @MrN75nokia (13): "Get em Joy you don't need the supplement plans my Mom paid \$179.00 a month for G and never used it \$6000.00 down the drain"

↳ @marciasloan534 (4): "Agree. Me2 ZERO PROBLEMS ❤️ KELSEY-SEBOLD HOUSTON TX"

"I retired from health insurance processing about 50% because of this scam. I did not have a single person who had a "Medicare Advantage", who had any advantage. The only ones getting an advantage here is the insurance companies, and the feds."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 177 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=Ugz5qyDIIBnU7-nFzc14AaABAg>

↳ @davidlang1125 (5): "Actually the government is getting ripped off too."

↳ @catserver8577 (4): "@davidlang1125 Oh yeah, poor government. So ripped off they throw good money after bad."

↳ @davidlang1125 (3): "@catserver8577so under your reply was an option to translate into English. Yep, that's appropriate."

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now

ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

Chose Plan G or Plan N · 704 documents · 20 voices

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

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— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAq>

↳ @RonMac08 (18): "@nealjones84 She's doing well, recovering quickly."

↳ @nealjones84 (13): "Congratulations 🎉 how is she doing now after major surgery"

↳ @ckstaff (13): "Sooner or later you get to realize and feel how smart you were in choosing right. If you did have advantage, she may have died waiting or you would now be bankrupt paying a huge out of pocket. I witnessed first hand a friends husband die in bed with Leukemia when he was sent home after 1 day in hospital because the advantage company had their loophole as to why they would not pay. He spent the next 3 weeks fighting denials and appeals in his soon to be deathbed. He died before he ever got approved."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorqh/>

↳ (0): "Plan N offers the same coverage as plan G except excess charges (which aren't allowed in my state anyway) and there is a \$20 co-pay for an office visit and \$50 co-pay for an emergency room visit. The savings with N will cover over 20 co-pays per year based on the rates I was quoted. It is also expected that premium

increases with N will be less than G since plan G is the guaranteed issue plan."

↳ (0): "Good point. Even with all of my appointments, I don't think I ever went over 20 in a single year. If I did, it wasn't by much. Plan N is a good option for those just starting Medicare. Unfortunately, I'm in Massachusetts and this plan is not available."

↳ (0): "Agree whole heartedly on the Medicare supplement plan. My husband is currently undergoing cancer treatment at MD Anderson. He has tonsil cancer, which is an uncommon type of cancer. We came to Houston from Oregon because MD Anderson is an NCI cancer center that treats thousands more cases of tonsil cancer than the one NCI hospital we have in Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

"I have plan G-----I had a heart valve replaced and then a series of health problems, plan G made sense to me. My old workplace health plan was a PPO and I got tired of having to wait for pre authorization, and sometimes got turned down. If I need a cat scan or Mri, there is no pre-authorization. So far, plan G has been good for me"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 134 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=Ugzr0umEPhaqKRmCcjl4AaABAq>

↳ @JBerger1983 (8): "@jackfrost-fu7hz Surprised your former PPO needed authorizations. Usually that's HMO. I have PPO with my employer...no authorizations needed. Actually why I chose PPO instead of HMO."

↳ @gindie1 (7): "@JBerger1983 Might you be confusing pre-authorization of procedures with needing a referral to see a specialist?"

↳ @RonMac08 (6): "We have Plan N. My wife had an open heart surgery to replace her aortic valve. Even with all the doctor visits and procedures, it cost us less than a Plan G with the larger monthly payments. My sister is younger than my wife, and her Plan G is over \$50 a month more than our Plan N."

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (19): "Thanks for sharing your experience. You're not alone — I've seen a lot of people face those same big increases on Plan G. Plan N usually ends up being the smarter long-term choice because of the lower premiums, and for most people the extra cost-sharing is pretty minimal compared to what they save each year. With how fast rates are climbing, especially going into 2026, your switch makes a lot of sense."

↳ @christinestephenson1742 (11): "I have Mutual of Omaha supplement since 2019. It's maybe 130 a month and has just gone up a bit each year."

↳ @jayes8191 (6): "@policyguides Could Plan N's extra cost sharing increase significantly if Medicare reimbursements decrease in 2026?"

"I had Plan G for 12 years. Then I relocated and went to advantage. Big mistake. My annual outlay was MORE with advantage. Fortunately, my advantage carrier threw in the towel and I'm in Plan G for 2026."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 112 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugy-3JbsELjwXA6g_214AaABAg

↳ @owggarage723 (16): "@chevellefloridawhen a Medicare Advantage plan stops offering your plan, you are allowed a "special enrollment period". At that time you may switch to a Medicare supplement or another Medicare Advantage plan with no underwriting."

↳ @chevelleflorida (3): "So you were able to move back to Plan G with out underwriting? Or you "passed" underwriting?"

↳ @toma4750 (0): "do you mind giving details why your outlay was more? Did you have a number of hospitalizations? or an ongoing illness?"

"I can't believe how much more I will have to pay going on Medicare. I was on an Obamacare plan paying \$175 a month with no drug copays and occasional \$20 doctor visit copays. So maybe \$2,200 a year. On Medicare I will pay \$202 a month for the basic coverage, around \$150 for a plan N supplement, around \$100 for plan D drug coverage and \$100 for the few current drugs I'm taking now. So about \$6,600 a year. That is triple the cost. Is this normal? Isn't part D just a discount plan?"

— r/medicare · 95 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1q0gcln/>

↳ (0): "Your ACA plan was subsidized. Look how much ACA would cost you for 2026"

↳ (0): "And if you voted for Trump you voted to unsubsidize them."

↳ (0): "Right but on the bright side we'll have the world's most expensive ballroom."

"Maybe a better title for this video would be "When I Wouldn't Chose Medigap Plan G verses Plan N". I have Plan G and it was \$25 more in premium than Plan N, but I knew with my upcoming health issues I would be seeing many specialists and more often. I went with peace of mind decision."

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 81 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgyZe4YXRtM8AXD_Al4AaABAg

↳ @MedicareonVideo (9): "If you are going to meet that difference in premium paying copayments, it is a great option to go Plan G"

↳ @Cynster777 (2): "Keith I need your help. Who has the best price for Medigap N at this time. My husband has had it for 8 years and they just raised it again \$35.00 more per month. Please let me know where to go to to get a lower premium for Medigap N."

↳ @Cynster777 (0): "@B@BarryWeaver-pv6cz. I did. They are all expensive."

"I have Plan G and I do not have any headaches or problems with hospitals and doctors. It is a piece of mind"

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 79 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgzxEj-4OX2zMa1URx4AaABAg

↳ @MedicareonVideo (5): "Peace of mind is a priority for a lot of people! I just always like to present alternatives to save on premium"

↳ @-myal-8691 (5): "I have Plan G because I can afford it. I can't afford to not afford it. I cannot afford frequent doctor visits with multiple doctors, multiple surgeries, hospitalizations, MRI scans, CTs, PET scans, and cancer treatments costing \$50,000.00, \$100,000.00, \$500,000.00+ over several years. Plan G covers my needs better than any other plan."

↳ @0007tad (1): "@SantaDaddy1 maybe he meant A ""piece "" of his mind 🤔 "

"Matthew: I have a Medigap Plan N with you and Original Medicare. I am so thankful I followed your advise and made this decision. About 4 months after being enrolled, I was diagnosed with Colorectal Cancer. Treatments included a surgery (3 days in the hospital) and 12 Chemo treatments with my Oncologist over 8 months. I am currently in surveillance, with CT scans and annual Colonoscopies. If I had no insurance, I estimate the cost of treatment at over \$250,000. To date, my out-of-pocket expense has been about \$750 plus the cost of premiums. At NO time has anything my doctors have prescribed been evaluated or denied by someone else. And I didn't have to wait on any treatments. I am alive today (and hope to be for years in the future) because of the Medicare coverage I have been given. Thank you, thank you for all your efforts."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 78 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugzcg6gBrwkdkxQiGx54AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (5): "Thank you for your comment Bob. It's always good to have a story with a happy ending. It's stories like these that motivate us every day!"

↳ @wynetteabc (1): "May God continually bless your health. Were any of your out of pocket expenses for excess charges? I'm trying to decide between the High deductible G plan and the N plan. Thank you. :)"

↳ @metaphysicalministries6863 (0): "This video is very informative and he hits it on the head with the differences between Medicare Advantage and Medicare Supplement plans. It's also about having the client in mind and their specific needs and determining what's the best coverage for their medical needs and budget as well. Both plans have their Advantages and Disadvantages; it just depends on what works best for the client and their present health. Some clients maybe more healthy and a Medicare Advantage plan maybe best for them and don't need to use it as much or some clients may not be as healthy and go to the doctor more frequently and a Medicare Supplement plan maybe better because it covers more with less out of the pocket expenses. I'm licensed in NY, TX and 32 other states and anyone needing help choosing the right plan or has any questions about Medicare Supplement and Medicare Advantage plans can call me directly at 929-352-6044. I can send you brochures, documents, forms and other materials and go over all the information with you and there's no cost. Also if clients can't afford Medicare premiums maybe eligible take advantage of the Medicare Savings Program that helps cover the Part B premium 100%. Clients also maybe eligible to save up \$2,041.20 or more in Medicare cost. The eligibility requirements are: (2022 monthly income limit for a single person is \$1,549, married (living together) is \$2,080 and the 2022 Total Resource Limit for single person is \$8,400 and married (living together) is \$12,600). Anyone interested in learning more and would like to know if they're eligible can give me a call. I'm here to help."

"My husband bought plan N this Feb. he did knee replacement. We pay \$250 medicare deductible for xray and visiting surgeon consultation. We pay \$20 cardiologist and \$20 primary for clearance before surgery. We pay 0 for surgery and 0 for physical therapy for 2 month (3 times a week). It is also \$0 for numerous follow up appointments with surgeon and his nurses. I am very please how plan N work for us"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 72 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgzLql0tefyhBzM6rPp4AaABAq>

↳ @lisaveta8565 (15): "@RC-vv6nr I know about it. We are in Midwest and N cost him \$92 for first year. My husband and me are not wealthy but we make decision our med coverage is second priority after housing"

↳ @RC-vv6nr (9): "In NY plan N 2025 will be \$282. premium per month.. Not affordable"

↳ @mercedescalderon6268 (6): "@RC-vv6nr think long term not monthly. Sacrifice something else in order to pay for Plan N or G. It is what my dad used to call pennywise dollar foolish. I researched for a year to make sure I understood fully what I should choose and prepare for. Tough business at a time when we are most vulnerable to sales people. Beware and good luck."

"I have a Medigap plan N and would not consider an Advantage plan unless I could not afford one financially. My main reasons are because I do not want to hand over my medical decisions to a for profit insurance company (Advantage plan) which will dictate what medical care I will be able to receive and where I will receive it. These plans can, and routinely do, deny care. I want any medical decisions on my care to be made by me and my doctor, not an insurance company who is beholden to shareholders and is only concerned about their own profits. If a specific treatment or procedure is determined by my doctor to be medically necessary, Medicare will cover it and my Medigap plan will pay, no questions asked. However, that is not the case with an Advantage plan, who can refuse to pay, forcing treatment delays or an outright denial for the patient receiving the care they need. The patient is then left in the unfortunate situation of having to go through the appeals process in an effort to get the care they need, or paying for their treatment out of their own pocket."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 71 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugw5RQFbE3SDniC5Hb14AaABAq>

↳ @kciis (9): "You make some excellent points about the importance of having control over your own healthcare decisions. Medigap plans certainly provide a level of security and peace of mind for many people. Kai & Ann Chung"

↳ @bugsy5 (3): "You appear to be somewhat confused. The companies that offer Medigap coverage are also in business to make a profit for their shareholders - they are not non-profit. According to a study by CMS - the advantage plans are costing the taxpayer much more than Medigap plans. This is because the government pays the advantage plans a certain amount of money every month - regardless of whether the policy holder receives any medical care or not. The advantage plans are currently making many billions of dollars in profits every year. They have essentially zero incentive to pay out on a claim - unlike Medigap plans, whom must pay if Medicare pays."

↳ @MaryBethMcCoy (2): "@alfonso1781 You are welcome, and I am so sorry you are having to deal with a denial. My advice to you in this situation is to make the extra effort and appeal the decision, since I think that over 70% of the time, you can win if you stay persistent, assuming you and your doctor are in agreement that your procedure is medically necessary and covered by Medicare."

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAq>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"I have plan G. Had a hip replacement earlier this year. Had a small complication when they tried to do surgery the first time so had a few additional dr visits before they could reschedule the surgery a second time. In total start to finish cost was just over \$100,000. Everything was covered 100% except for my Medicare deductible cost. No issue getting appointments or getting them paid for. Everything went smoothly between Medicare and m6 supplemental plan. Can't recommend plan G enough!"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PlzY4A7HxHg&lc=UgwmYSkdOxcvZwNvYB4AaABAq>

↳ @g0989 (7): "\$100K for a hip replacement would have to be the provider's retail list price. The Medicare allowable charge would be much, much lower than that. And if the provider accepts Medicare assignment, they can't accept more than what Medicare allows."

↳ @leonawilcox4821 (0): "@g0989 let me elaborate a bit. During the start of my first surgery I had an a fib incident which stopped surgery and landed me a night in the hospital. We got all that under control which then gave me the ability to finally have the surgery 6 weeks later. I checked my EOBs and here are the exact numbers: amount billed = \$140,074.73 Medicare paid = \$112,316.44 Plan G paid = \$4285.53 So well over \$100,000 was paid between traditional Medicare and plan G. Very glad I don't have an advantage plan. Oh and I still need to have the other side done in a few months"

↳ @DobeMom (0): "@g0989 \$100,000 covered the cost of 2 hip replacement surgeries. I have Plan G...it is the BEST."

"I have plan G. I was diagnosed with cancer while living in a small community. I had some of my care locally for convenience. Then I opted to drive 2 hours for a special targeted radiation. In every case my insurance paid it all. I paid my annual deductible, and everything thing else was covered by plan G. I have real security knowing I have excellent coverage, and can go whenever I think care is most appropriate."

— YouTube · Don't Buy Medigap Plan G Before Watching This ! · 63 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tughWPQP08&lc=Ugwr8t6QJL-dV67U3PR4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (4): "@rebeccam6128 thank you for sharing this with us. The peace of mind knowing everything is paid for and that when you need it, you can drive two hours or two days away to find the healthcare you need, priceless."

↳ @PoppaPicky (0): "I wish you strength and a positive outcome..."

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tbdvvh/>

↳ (0): "Unless you live in a birthday rule state that allows you to switch plans, or you can pass medical underwriting (which is unlikely given your health issues), you're stuck with your current Plan G. If you're stuck, see if your current Plan G insurer will allow you to switch to HD Plan G (high deductible) without medical underwriting. Premiums would be dramatically less. Another option is to move to a Medicare Advantage Plan. Even that may not guarantee any savings because while the premiums are likely to be \$0, there are copays and coinsurance and an out of pocket maximum of \$9250. Given that your current premiums for Plan G are \$5500/year, and that is likely your only out of pocket expense, it might not make sense to move to a \$0/month Medicare Advantage Plan if you end up spending the max out of pocket of \$9250. Even with copays and coinsurance, you'd likely not hit \$9250 (the max out of pocket), but the real question is how likely you are to hit \$5500 (the cost of Plan G premiums). You'd have to look closely at what the out of pocket costs would be for whatever Medicare Advantage Plans you were considering. If you think the cost of copays and coinsurance would be less for Medicare Advantage than the premiums for Plan G, then switch. Of course, if you are low income, then you should also investigate Medicaid options, but just know the income thresholds are pretty low."

↳ (0): "If you really want to go Med Adv, and duplicate the original Medicare as best as possible, gotta go PPO for out-of-network support, and the OOP for that is \$13,900. In 2027 it will be in the neighborhood of \$14,800. Otherwise, one is stuck on networks with HMO. For most stuff that is fine. But, if it's the big C? I had enough money to afford PPO to expand choice closer to original Medicare. It's not really Medigap or Med Adv. It's Medigap, or PPO, or HMO. But, PPO only makes sense if one can operate the plan fully, and that does require a spare \$13,900, although there are cheaper combined OOPs for are PPOs. I saw a \$7400 ppo last fall."

↳ (0): "I'm not a Medicare Advantage nay-sayer, but it's worth pointing out that even with a PPO you can't necessarily go to any provider you want to. Some places don't take PPOs."

"I survived stage four cancer ten years ago. When I turned sixty five last year I got supplement N plan. I would never let my life depend on an HMO again. Dealing with the HMO was worse than the cancer."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 60 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCl8m0OI18&lc=UgwEMYbm6ygPZV68PeV4AaABAg>

↳ @happycook6737 (10): "HMO is an abbreviation that means give as little care as possible to make the most profit for the HMO"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "I'm so glad to hear you survived and are here. Thank you for watching and sharing."

↳ @sct4040 (0): "Thanks for your personal input into Medicare Advantage plan. They are horrible, and I will not be using one."

"My union changed the retirement supplement to an Advantage plan. I declined and got my own BC/BS plan N. Best decision I made."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 59 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgyhTz0t36_WnBfkBht4AaABAg

↳ @patneander7436 (2): "I have heard of this happening more and more. Insane."

↳ @patneander7436 (2): "Thank you for covering this important issue. So many people have been duped into these "advantage" plans many unknowingly. My mother was one of them."

↳ @larkc7677 (1): "My former employer was also considering dropping our retiree medigap plan and switching us to an Advantage Plan. They have now decided, at least for 2025, to stay with the supplemental plan. It's very stressful because I would not want an Advantage Plan."

"The more my Plan N increases annually, the more I'm inclined (against my better judgement) to start looking at a Part C Advantage Plan instead. I went with Plan N because I believed in the idea of "Pay me now or pay me later", where I protected myself against high deductibles and annual outlays by paying a (reasonable) monthly premium. Sadly, "Pay me now" is becoming "Pay me a LOT more now, and every year until you die." Also, we need better oversight of these insurers. Offering low costs for a year and then inflating prices once you have attracted a bunch of subscribers should be illegal. Or at least a Medicare plan cost should be guaranteed for a reasonable amount of time. I would be much happier paying more when I sign up, knowing that my premium won't increase to shocking levels for years."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 57 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxVyp4MBD-dEhPeZIh4AaABAg>

↳ @chevelleflorida (8): "To me, if one can afford a medigap/supplemental plan, that is the best option. The biggest issue with Advantage plans is the level of care that you will receive. For example, I know someone who had a heart attack and stroke last year and was referred to a SNF/rehab center. The MA plan was calling within 3 days talking about discharging the patient even though they were not ready to go back home. With traditional Medicare, that person likely would have received 100 days. Fortunately, moving to a SNF, creates a qualifying event to change insurance and we were able to move he patient back to traditional Medicare with a supplemental plan that they already had (Tricare for life.) In truth, the broker who signed them up for a MA plan did them a huge disservice. No one with a Supplemental plan should move to a MA plan."

↳ @Farrodee (5): "In two years my plan G went from 1500 to over 1800 per year. I don't even take any meds and rarely see dr!"

↳ @vanguy9780 (0): "@jaygrenham education is a wonderful thing. You should try it"

Part D plans, GoodRx, Cost Plus and Canada · 279 documents · 20 voices

"What pisses me off is... I did not sign up for prescription drug plan when I signed up for Medicare at age 65 because I wasn't taking any drugs. Later I was convinced to take the part D coverage. Then I find out I will have to pay a monthly penalty amount of \$18.00 for the rest of my life to the drug companies because I did not enroll in part D when I signed up for Medicare. (I am now 82 years old, in good health, and still do not take prescription drugs). It's a rip-off."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 312 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwYnNkAm7dPfm_ViEZ4AaABAg

↳ @OLDGUY7301 (25): "People go talk to a medicare agent. ITS FREE."

↳ @flufwix (21): "I agree, the penalty is a rip off"

↳ @jimroscovius (13): "Why didn't you know that? You've got to research and find out those things. That was in the first mailing I got about Medicare. Also, if you're in good health, you should take Medicare Advantage, which includes a drug plan."

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAq>

↳ @RonMac08 (18): "@nealjones84 She's doing well, recovering quickly."

↳ @nealjones84 (13): "Congratulations 🎉 how is she doing now after major surgery"

↳ @ckstaff (13): "Sooner or later you get to realize and feel how smart you were in choosing right. If you did have advantage, she may have died waiting or you would now be bankrupt paying a huge out of pocket. I witnessed first hand a friends husband die in bed with Leukemia when he was sent home after 1 day in hospital because the advantage company had their loophole as to why they would not pay. He spent the next 3 weeks fighting denials and appeals in his soon to be deathbed. He died before he ever got approved."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorqh/>

↳ (0): "Plan N offers the same coverage as plan G except excess charges (which aren't allowed in my state anyway) and there is a \$20 co-pay for an office visit and \$50 co-pay for an emergency room visit. The savings with N will cover over 20 co-pays per year based on the rates I was quoted. It is also expected that premium

increases with N will be less than G since plan G is the guaranteed issue plan."

↳ (0): "Good point. Even with all of my appointments, I don't think I ever went over 20 in a single year. If I did, it wasn't by much. Plan N is a good option for those just starting Medicare. Unfortunately, I'm in Massachusetts and this plan is not available."

↳ (0): "Agree whole heartedly on the Medicare supplement plan. My husband is currently undergoing cancer treatment at MD Anderson. He has tonsil cancer, which is an uncommon type of cancer. We came to Houston from Oregon because MD Anderson is an NCI cancer center that treats thousands more cases of tonsil cancer than the one NCI hospital we have in Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

"I have the AARP UHC Supplemental Plan plus a Prescription Plan. I pay just over \$100 a month for my prescription plan. Purely by accident I discovered I pay double for my prescriptions using my insurance vs being uninsured. My CVS charge for my 90 day prescriptions was about \$45 but using a Good Rx card which I pay just over \$20 for the same prescription."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 120 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgwIJVVWWtbq6IZbBBJ4AaABAq>

↳ @juanestopinan3250 (16): "I live in a State where you can switch annually with a different carrier for your plan as long as it's the same letter, without underwriting..but because of this the premium is higher"

↳ @gdpope52 (10): "I just shopped plans on the government website. Put in your current meds and review plans that take those medicines. I pay \$17.50 and have very small out of pocket expenses. Also i do not have any major health problems."

↳ @ssa8479 (5): "Then the time comes to sign up I'll have to look for the cheapest Part D plan. For now my one generic prescription costs \$10 for a 90-day supply. The good thing would be that one can pick a different plan every year."

"I did not take part D when I first signed up due to my ss being so small. Well, I didn't know that you either take it or they will take it from you as a penalty!!!! Now at 70 I have to get a FT job to make up for the extra. What a joke this medicare system is."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 85 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgzxlrNwUjOHiyM0X8V4AaABAq>

↳ @danagaar (5): "We were considering this also partly because we try not to take medicines but if anything big happens we may have to. Can you explain that better? If you don't mind. How much do they take and why do they take it?"

↳ @ArabellaPottery (3): "DO NOT ENROLL IN PART B!!! We are paying over \$8,000 for Part B rip off. We just found out we do not have to enroll in part B and can still keep part A."

↳ @carolanderson7655 (2): "@ArabellaPottery Well they sock you with penalties just like if you don't carry part C. Check with your state first. Most parts are not optional. You can't just opt out of anything."

"Thank you for posting this. It took me a significant amount of research before I decided to go with traditional Medicare and add a drug plan and gap policy for my aging parents. It's an utter shame that the government even shares Medicare Advantage plans on their official Medicare website. Kind of a tangent, but I'm finishing up medical school and we barely touch on Medicare besides knowing what Parts A and B cover or billing and insurance in general. Also, if anyone from the production team is reading this, please make an episode on the cost and quality of medical school education and how residency programs use residents to work themselves to death while criminally underpaying them."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 73 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyRUv7o2aYh4Hu_9IV4AaABAg

↳ @kgrider6325 (8): "I've worked with many new doctors as they have started their practices and there is one thing I recommend to all of them: take a few business courses while you're establishing yourself. Business is not taught in medical school, but it is an important part of your future success. Learn it now, so you have a good foundation. That will allow you to focus on what likely led you to medical school in the first place: the patients."

"COST PLUS DRUGS (Mark Cuban's) I have insurance that I pay \$350. a month for and only one of my drugs is covered, the other three are relatively inexpensive and I pay 100% of the cost. For the other drug it costs me \$2000 a year, and then my insurance pays 100%. Now I signed up for Mark Cuban's Cost Plus drugs. I get the same 4 prescriptions for \$424. a year. I would like to cancel my drug plan, but I guess I have to wait until open enrollment."

— r/medicare · 58 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1qw7vli/>

↳ (0): "You don't want to cancel your Part D unless you are absolutely, totally sure you can use Mark Cuban OR afford to pay all your drug costs out of pocket for the rest of your life OR re-enroll later & pay a penalty for the rest of your life You can voluntarily disenroll or not enroll in a Part D plan during the Annual Enrollment Period (typically Oct 15 – Dec 7) or certain other enrollment periods. Can you try & find a zero or low cost plan next open enrollment? If you can, keep your D even if not actively using it and if you are off for 63 days and ever have to go back on it, then you will be charged a penalty which is: 1% of the national base beneficiary premium for each full month you went without creditable coverage.(\$38.99 in 2026) That amount is rounded to the nearest \$0.10. The penalty is added to your monthly Part D premium — so you pay it every month for as long as you have Part D coverage (even if you switch plans). The longer you go without coverage, the bigger the penalty. This is all up to you, but please think through the implications"

↳ (0): "I'm not sure if you have a Part D drug plan or not, but I have never seen one that costs hundreds of dollars per month. You do have to wait until the enrollment period later in the year to sign up for a different one. My opinion is that it's a good idea to buy the cheapest Part D plan if you are buying generic drugs "off plan" from places like Cost Plus. You can often get a plan for a very small amount. I have never paid more than \$1.40 a month for mine. It just serves as a backstop if I'm prescribed a more expensive drug later."

↳ (0): "Please get some expert advice. No drug Plan costs this much. Get an appointment with SHIP. It's free unbiased expert advice. If you do have a drug Plan and it's costly, if you drop it you'll have a penalty forever. I had a Wellcare drug Plan that had 0 premium and protected me against penalties. This year the premium is \$3.25 a month. Next year I might get a better more expensive plan. Maybe."

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1iten4m/>

↳ (0): "I have also found the Medicare experience like a breath of fresh air. It is so nice not having to worry about it."

↳ (0): "I feel the same way. I am a somewhat insecure person (lol), and probably some of my fears of not having health insurance go back to growing up and watching my father lose his job at 58 years old. He worked for his company for over 35 years and they cut him loose when his health began deteriorating. (He was a commercial artist and his hand wore out from repetitive stress injury. I remember his fear that he would lose the house and everything else.) Plus, a few surgeries that I had and the astronomical bills didn't help to put my mind to rest regarding the loss of insurance. Plus, my employer was not hesitant in eliminating people/departments at a moments notice. In short, Medicare has given me great peace of mind. It's not perfect and I know others may have completely opposite opinions, but I am so grateful to have it, I've seen what happens when you don't. Take care. :)"

↳ (0): "Thanks, OP. My spouse is turning 65 in April, and we really need to get on this. You mentioned YouTube videos. Do you have any particular channel that you found most helpful?"

"Thanks, think I've completed everything and will be on medicare on wednesday I signed up for trad Medicare A + B . I signed up AARP/UHC for part D because all my drugs are covered in their formulary. I signed up State Farm for Medigap because I didn't need a fitness pass. I cancelled my marketplace insurance effective Sept 30 with all the above plans going into effect Oct 1. I spoke to my pharmacist and picked up enough refills to last through the next month in case of any hiccup. I confirmed all my doctors will take Medicare and electronically upload my Medicare card into their patient portals. I will need to sign up for part D plan (or stay with AARP/UHC) for Jan 2026. I am in CA and can switch part G providers without underwriting on my birthday month next year. This has all been a huge amount of anxiety, hope I did everything right, and sincerely have no idea how I would have done without all your advice."

— r/medicare · 47 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1nrj552/>

↳ (0): "Sounds like you covered all the bases. Good job."

↳ (0): "Nice work, congrats."

↳ (0): "Huge congrats This is a rock solid setup and you handled it beautifully **Here is a quick double check list** • Part A and Part B active on October 1 • Medigap Plan G with State Farm confirmed and premium autopay set • Part D with AARP UHC active on October 1 and pharmacy preferred in network • Marketplace plan ends September 30 so no overlap billed • Doctors confirmed they accept Medicare and have your Medicare number on file • Online accounts created for Medicare MyMedicare AARP UHC and State Farm • Part B premium payment method set or Social Security deduction confirmed • Keep your receipts and Explanation of Benefits for the first couple months in case of hiccups **Smart moves you already made** • Picked up refills to bridge the switch • Checked each doctor for Medicare participation • Matched Part D to your current formulary **Dates to keep in mind for next choices** • Part D and drug plan changes for 2026 can be made during October 15 to December 7 • California birthday rule lets you switch Medigap to equal or lesser benefits without underwriting starting on your birthday for at least 60 days **If anything looks off during October** • Show your pharmacist both cards Medicare red white and blue plus Part D • Call the plan's member services to reprocess any rejected claim the first week is when small glitches happen • Use paper claims only if needed then keep copies You did everything right Take a breath and enjoy the peace of mind You have got this"

"I guess Part D is a good thing for people on costly drugs. Before I was 65, I could get my generic prescriptions for \$10 for an 90 day supply with a GoodRx coupon. On Part D, 2 have a zero copay, one has a \$9 co-pay. I laugh every time I get that notice about how Medicare is "saving" me \$57...because I used to pay only \$10. Now I get to pay the part D premium which is 10 times what I used to pay for all my drugs combined."

— YouTube · The \$9.8 Billion Medicare Subsidy Just Ended — Here's What Really Happens to Part D · 47 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pfLylplem30&lc=UgzR-4WgnmzhcrDR4mV4AaABAg>

↳ @jasonjames4254 (20): "The true crime being committed in all of this is that everybody pays a different price for the same damn thing!"

↳ @jamesallen8107 (6): "@duanehorton4680 I like proper spelling and grammar as much as anyone, but commenting about a missing hyphen is important because ... and it adds value to the comments, due to ... the readers will not understand what was communicated without the hyphen? Should have been "a" rather than "an" as well, correct?"

↳ @duanehorton4680 (0): "90-day should be hyphenated."

"I was diagnosed with cancer in 2022 at age 64, 1 year before qualifying for Medicare at age 65. Made the decision to purchase a Part G supplemental plan in 2023 (at which time cancer in remission) easy. Max. coverage and can see any doctor that accepts Medicare. Premiums are affordable, though they'll increase yearly both with inflation and age adjustments. But I already have a chart of the age adjustments, so that helps in planning. I did also have to buy a Part D drug plan, but wasn't a big deal. I'm paying less than \$20/mo. I pay more for pet food."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 37 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwcXvMjV0iLH5MErUd4AaABAg.A1KdKhnuifTtA3OzAu_SgQ

"New to Medicare This Year - More Confusing Than I Thought! I had helped my mother and my mother-in-law with their Medicare in the past. I also had worked in Human Resources early in my career and learned a lot about insurance. So I thought that signing up for Medicare would be easy for me. But, not having looked at this stuff in at least 10 years, I found it a lot more confusing than I had expected! I'm turning 65 in a few months. I'm in SF Bay area of California. I already know that I want traditional Medicare and not Medicare Advantage. I started taking Social Security at the beginning of this year (2025) so I automatically got a Medicare number and automatically got enrolled into Parts A & B. Now I need to pick a Plan D for drugs and a Medigap plan, which I already know will be a Plan G. In that regard, perhaps I'm ahead of the game. But picking a Plan D and a Plan G is turning out to be much harder than I'd thought it would be. I was glad to have watched a few YouTube videos about the process for signing up for each of these things -- that helped a lot, as well as reading the Medicare website and some info from AARP, etc. I found out that some of the Part D plans I was considering have limits on how many pills can be filled in 30 days for some meds. An SSRI that I take requires 90 10mg pills each month, because I take 25 mg per day and there is no 25 mg pill (nor is there a 50 mg that can be cut in half). So the plans that limit me to 30 10mg pills per month are a non-starter. (Sure, I could probably have my doctor try to appeal and get the 90 pills per month covered, but there is no guarantee that the insurance company would agree....and then I'd be stuck! Not worth the hassle!) This information was kinda buried at the bottom of each Part D plan on the Medicare website. It would have been a "bad surprise" to learn this after the fact! Regarding Part G -- this really surprised me -- the only Part G plan for my area that shows the premium and extra perks upfront is the AARP United Healthcare plan. ALL of the others don't even have a special page (or set of pages) about their Medigap plans! How are you supposed to compare the plans if you can't even see what you're paying for? I understand that all of the plans cover the exact same things; that's not what I want to know. I want to see rate tables (because most of them are Attained Age plans. The AARP one is Community based rates, and one other that I'm considering, Transamerica, is age at issue based rate). I also want to see if there are any perks beyond the regular plan coverage (like gym membership or whatever). I don't want to have to go through an agent or get a broker involved. I've had bad experiences with them in the past. I want to do this myself and sign up directly with the insurance companies. I truly don't understand why NONE of the Medigap providers in my area have ANY information on their websites about Medicare or their Medicare plans. When you click on the "company website" link on the Medicare website, it takes you to a general home page about the insurance company. I have tried searching these websites for "Medicare" or "Medigap" or "Plan G" but the searches come up blank. Why even offer a Medigap plan if you're not going to show your benefits to your clients online???? I don't want to have to waste my time calling 3 or 4 insurance companies! Only AARP seems to be upfront with any of this stuff. It's so weird, and I truly don't understand it! Am I missing something or misunderstanding something? Are the insurance companies deliberately making it hard for people to understand exactly what they're buying??"

— r/medicare · 33 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ls9lyr/>

↳ (0): "I agree you can't find true info without contacting companies individually. I found that there are some options that might make it difficult. Smoking makes a difference, paying yearly can make a difference. Someone else in the household with the same company can make a difference. Wearables can make a difference. Like you I spent hours on YouTube (glad I did), called a few companies directly then got retirement nerds involved after I had narrowed things down. They actually placed the policy for me after helping to answer a few questions. Figuring all of this out was like a job. It worked out well for me. Good luck."

↳ (0): "Don't go with UHP. Profiteers from the pain and suffering of humans. Major lawsuits and denials. It amazes me this country still has not gone to universal healthcare. I'm on the original Medicare ABG&D. G is with Anthem BC. No perks. Simple and easy with my Drs. No issues so far in 13 months. They are profiteers as well,

but I think they are less evil than the rest. D plans are stupid. They all have their "formulary" lists and none are the same \$\$ for identical drugs. Tier 1/2/3/4 garbage. But it's better than nothing. I have Wellcare. Not great but cheap. I've heard from friends in the SF bay area that Kaiser advantage is excellent. Of course you have to use them. But they are well established there. I'm in an area where there are hardly any Kaiser facilities. The agents that "help" are paid to drive you to their plans. They make \$\$ on your payments. Agents should be eliminated. It's a parasite business."

↳ (0): "Untrue about agents that drive you to their plans. Most agents are pretty good folks doing a good job. Signed, a parasite. D plans aren't stupid. If you don't get one, you get a penalty. But go ahead and not get one... see how that works out. UHC is fine - no different than any other carrier that you are bashing. Thanks for your nice, helpful post, btw!"

"So far I haven't paid any excess charges on my plan N. The broker I used for me a \$0 drug plan so I'm happy with this plan."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=Ugx6leloy6y4iqccDFJ4AaABAg>

↳ @pinkfreud62 (2): "Ohio forbids excess charges. Some other states do, too."

↳ @Reed-2big (0): "Tricare at one time had the excess rule too. Even with the 15% some doctors still getting what they really wanted to accept."

"Puzzle. How are seniors supposed to get by without any help from family or an agent? My 92 yr old Dad lost part D coverage from Anthem Blue Cross for 2026 & he just received his ANOC from Aetna stating that he will not have part D coverage for 2027. He lives in a senior facility as an independent resident, but we use their preferred pharmacy (Omnicare in NorCal) for convenience & this limits his options greatly for part D coverage. Clearly, the people running Medicare now just don't care about seniors, their health, & the economy. It seems like they & the insurance companies lining their pockets only care about themselves 🤔. Thanks for another informative video."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Drug Plans: Two Things You NEED to Know · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANgeD3oOJ40&lc=UgyhXhJhSKZ509Ygeoh4AaABAg>

↳ @bassinsquatch8503 (9): "I retired this year in May and ever since I have signed up for Medicare and Social Security it has been nothing but a big headache they don't care about the seniors they make you feel like you are done we don't need you around any longer they don't understand what contributions we've given to the workforce or dependent upon our careers what we've done for the nation they just throw us out like we're crap other countries treat their seniors like they matter their families treat them like they matter here in United States they say get out of the way you've had your time now move on."

↳ @asterixky (5): "Treating people like this doesn't exist in countries with Single Payer systems. It's cheaper, as there is only one National plan, it doesn't change or stop years after years. It guaranty you insurance from birth to death, even if you are unemployed."

↳ @lindajohnson. (3): "It's all about the \$\$\$\$. Same with our government, how can you go to Washington work in Congress for a few terms and leave with millions of \$\$\$\$. We don't have a chance to get ahead ..."

"We chose Medigap. Retired last year and had intended on keeping work plan at greatly increased cost, still slightly less than Medigap (for now). Our financial planner recommended Medigap for stability in cost, our want to travel domestically, and because our overall plan would support the cost long term. Our only variable is prescription coverage. We are happy we made this choice as AFIB has appeared in our lives, so we have a broader availability of service providers and specialists. I have a \$0 cost Part D, Mrs. \$90. I am thankful we can carry these costs, but still think we need to go to single payer system to reduce everyone's costs. Erin, Great explanation! Thank You ."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgytXybRULzOjbJqI194AaABAg>

↳ @TAM-bv2di (1): "Congratulations, good for you. I chose Medicare Advantage and I also have cost certainty. \$0, and \$0 to see my PCP, whom I chose, even though new Medicare patients aren't accepted."

"I have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D drug plan. I just had my second cataract surgery and Medicare and my Plan N covered completely my Medicare approved costs except for the eye drops which Part D covered. I did have to purchase a set of various eye drops for each cataract surgery using Part D. My copay for each set was \$35. Prior to getting the surgeries, I had conversations with two different people at different times and both were seeking cataract surgery but their insurance companies denied the coverage. Those answers told me that they each had a (Dis)Advantage Plan. When I was turning 65, I chose original Medicare because I wanted to insure against the extreme costs for hospital procedures and stays while avoiding medical debt. That strategy is working well for me by providing healthcare freedom by allowing my physicians and me to determine when surgery is necessary- not an insurance company."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlg&lc=UgzZqekiWnVh-O9gfmJ4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (5): "As a follow up, I checked with a half a dozen major Medicare advantage plans and they don't even require prior authorization for cataract surgery."

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (2): "I'm glad you found what worked well for you. If you don't want to have prior authorization, your best bet is to go with the Medicare supplement for sure. With that said, we have helped over 60,000 people with their Medicare and health insurance and I've never heard of anyone being denied cataract surgery on a Medicare advantage plan."

"I am still paying a penalty of over 65 dollars for not taking part d when I first took social security at 62. I am now 87. I did not take a prescription medication until last year. I am healthy. Dirty deal"

— YouTube · The \$9.8 Billion Medicare Subsidy Just Ended — Here's What Really Happens to Part D · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pfLylplem30&lc=Ugx1xFxk-EqjsWa7ptN4AaABAg>

↳ @kitsiewr (2): "Just another sure-fire giveaway to Big Pharma. Even if you refuse their product, you still pay."

↳ @missmarymary6506 (1): "How did you get Medicare at 62? I retired early at 62 but I going feg Medicare until 65"

↳ @Simsane (1): "@missmarymary6506 same here. Maybe it was different when he was 62 or maybe they just are not remembering that they had to wait until they were 65."

"Thanks again Erin! Yes, for my husband who has all kinds of chronic medical conditions, we missed the window for Medigap after he turned to 65. So we got Medicare advantage for him, and it has worked out. Then when I turned 65 a year ago, I hopped right on Medigap. I have no medical conditions, fairly healthy, and I am on one prescribed medication. I actually ended up paying far more than he did throughout the year and Medigap and part D were about to increase significantly. So I changed to Advantage and to save over \$3000 this year."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxkRafGiwGdwZhaAGt4AaABAg>

↳ @bozomonster (3): "Your experience is very common."

"I'm 73, had plan g since the beginning, been healthy, disappointed that my premium went up to 268 a month, thinking of switching to advantage plan. And I'm disappointed that my agent didn't help me understand about Medicare part D, which I did not sign up for, and now I have to pay penalties from now on. I am in Texas, and I hope I have a memory like an ELEPHANT for all that you have explained."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugx1SAL00qKcb-uYy2t4AaABAg>

"I'm with Kai's mom. My advantage plan is not unlike my group plan when I worked. Although I have a few chronic conditions, my meds have no copay, and my doctor visits are just twice a year. For me, no additional premium, bundled coverage, and all my caregivers -- primary care, teeth, eyes in network -- were the determining factors. I could have easily afforded the medigap premiums, but when you factor in annual increases, a separate prescription plan, dentist, eye exams and glasses -- it didn't make sense to pay year after year for a "what-if" scenario. My M-I-L has a medigap policy, like Ann's mom, and she's happy with her choice, because she is a "what-if" person. Health insurance companies are in the business of making money, so either way, they will make money. I could have stuck with original Medicare, but I'd still be paying copays, deductibles, the dentist, the eye doctor, and a drug plan with copays, so why not get more bang by choosing the right Medicare Advantage plan. And yes, it all hinged on having the right in-network providers and taking generic drugs. Not everybody has that option. It would have changed my choices for sure."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap | Your TRUE Cost · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugw2aEzSgWeOa1nxIj4AaABAg>

↳ @kciis (2): "Thank you for sharing your experience with our viewers. Definitely sounds like you made the right choice for yourself. 😊 "

↳ @shall5867 (1): "Original medicare with a Medigap Plan G has no copays or deductibles, other than the Part B \$240 per year deductible which everyone pays. It is true that it does not cover dental or vision and most Advantage plans offer minimal dental and vision in my area. 20% may not be much to pay until you run into a very large bill which can bankrupt you - so that's the gamble."

↳ @4378200 (0): "You said it perfectly. I would have giving a company thousands for medigap fees that I could handle. It's a crap shoot as insurance has always been."

Stayed on an employer, union or retiree plan past 65 · 217 documents · 20 voices

"For a lot of people Medicare at 65 is a blessing. We couldn't wait. My wife had been putting off hip replacement surgery for years due to high deductibles and copays with our employer's plan. On Medicare (and G Supplement) all we paid was the part B deductible of two hundred and some odd dollars! It was life changing for her."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 315 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugw5192ygARS776lv554AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (25): "Agreed! We tried to show this in the middle section. For many, Medicare is better coverage at a lower cost than what they were experiencing before 65 😊 "

↳ @pgpc6448 (12): "So glad! Your wife deserves it!"

↳ @sfstucco (0): "I'm truly sorry to hear about your situation. No one should have to experience these dilemmas & delays. I'm curious — how many, here, in these unfortunate situations vote Red (Republican)? Not to start a fight or pretend to be superior, but I hope people realize that universal coverage/socialized medicine goes a long, long way to relieving these burdens, financially speaking and logistically speaking. It would cut costs SO, so much if we had a Medicare-for-all (i.e., for all who select it) scheme, from birth to death. There are variations that can include some copayments (or not), depending on how it's structured. But expense, experience, and health outcomes are greatly superior in countries with socialized medicine, in all its forms. Democrats want that."

"Being able to enroll in traditional Medicare (A,B,D,G) and to start collecting Social Security allowed me to walk away at age 65 from my shitty employer and company health insurance to change focus from an unfulfilling career to pickup the creative arts I had to put on a back burner to make a living has been truly liberating."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 155 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgxhLZ_kuIW53Z9_7ZN4AaABAg

↳ @Pelican5077 (10): "Great post. Knowing we had SS and Medicare on the horizon allowed us to quit working full time at age 55, sell our house (at a loss), take the wife's pension early (at a discount), and move onto our gracefully aging 35 ft sailboat with a 5 year plan to see the world. 13 years later we are still in the boat. We supplemented our small income stream along the way by doing all sorts of different jobs which was a fantastic experience. We don't do that anymore but (until the inflation debacle) we were able to save about 25k per year over those 13 years. It's been a blast and although we are approaching 70, our goal now is to continue our nomad lifestyle for another decade if we can. I get not taking Medicare if you are still working and have employer coverage. Or if you're a 1%er. Otherwise it's a no brainer IMO."

↳ @dgc590 (2): "So you worked for a shitty employer? That's your own fault. You chose to stay."

↳ @NuggetMaven (1): "Hope this new chapter in your life is transformative! 🎉 🎉 🎉 "

"OK. Now I am just turning 65 and I have some things to add. My wife was 71 when I had to retire to take care of her. When I did so, I lost my health insurance. I enrolled in COBRA and it was damned expensive. Had I known then what I know now, I may have chose differently. Both insurances together were 1600 a month, which is a horrible price to pay, but it was an approved plan so she slid onto part B with no problem. Here's the thing. She went to the hospital and the finance people were telling me that BCBS was the primary and Medicare was the secondary, this is just information. COBRA through your former employer is the secondary payer and Medicare is primary payer. Hope this helps when choosing what to do. It doesn't matter now. RIP Linda B. 07/16/23 I miss ya baby. Thanks for 45 years. It was worth everything we went through. (I made a couple of edits because I made some mistakes on the post. Thanks to youtube for allowing me to edit. 🙏 "

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙏 · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzLz7ljSVYL8z78XYJ4AaABAg>

↳ @zebragiraffe1 (10): "You must have been a great husband. Sorry for your loss."

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "My team would be happy to assist you. Give us a call at 800-864-8890 or schedule an appointment at www.medicareschool.com"

↳ @djmydlack (1): "Hi. Thanks so much for posting. Could you say what you'd done differently? My wife is dying of ALS and I may be forced to retire to care for her. Thank you."

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

↳ (0): "It should automatically go down in January, if your income goes back down. We won appeal in 2024 and again in 2026 based on retirement events."

↳ (0): "I just asked Google this question "can you go off medicare to avoid irmaa" You should do the same and read the full reply. (It basically says don't do it and gives options to reduce IRMAA which I am including below.) # Here is what it says about dropping Medicare: **No**, dropping your Medicare coverage to avoid IRMAA (Income-Related Monthly Adjustment Amount) is rarely a good idea. \[1](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenrolling_later_on/)\] If you voluntarily disenroll from Part B and Part D, your IRMAA surcharges may temporarily stop, but you will face severe consequences: \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>)\] **Gaps in Coverage:** You will be left without coverage for basic outpatient care, doctor visits, or prescription drugs. **Permanent Late Enrollment Penalties:** When you try to re-enroll in Medicare later, you will face hefty, permanent late enrollment penalties. **Lack of Guarantee:** You may not be able to simply re-enroll whenever you want; you will have to wait for the General Enrollment Period (January 1–March 31) with coverage beginning the following July. \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [2](<http://www.investmentnews.com/retirement-planning/what-happens-to-medicare-when-you-suspend-social-security-bennies/48121>), [3](<https://thebig65.com/medigap-plans-guide/>), [4](<https://boomerbenefits.com/medicare-enrollment-period/>), [5](<https://www.leonardfinancialsolutions.com/transition-from-employer-insurance-to-medicare/>)\] # These are the ways it suggests for reducing IRMAA: **Better Ways to Reduce or Avoid IRMAA** Instead of dropping your Medicare coverage, consider these legally recognized strategies to lower your MAGI or appeal the surcharge: \[1](<https://www.schwab.com/learn/story/how-higher-income-can-affect-medicare-premiums>), [2](<https://www.medicareresources.org/blog/four-ways-to-avoid-income-related-medicare-surcharges/>), [3](<https://decimawealth.com/planning/avoid-irmaa-surcharges/>)\] **File an Appeal for Life-Changing Events:** If your income dropped due to a qualifying life event (like retirement, work reduction, divorce, or the death of a spouse), you can appeal to the Social Security Administration using [Form SSA-44](<https://www.ssa.gov/forms/ssa-44.pdf>). **Reduce Taxable Income Pre-Retirement:** Maximize pre-tax contributions to employer-sponsored retirement plans (like a 401(k) or 403(b)) before you hit age 65. **Make Qualified Charitable Distributions (QCDs):** If you are 70½ or older, you can donate up to \(\\$111,000\) per year directly from your IRA to a charity. This money is not counted as taxable income, thereby lowering your MAGI. **Roth Conversions Early On:** Strategically converting traditional retirement accounts to Roth IRAs *before* you reach Medicare age can reduce your future taxable RMDs (Required Minimum Distributions).\[1](<https://youstaywealthy.com/how-to-avoid-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [3](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/medicare/avoid-the-irmaa-with-a-roth-conversion>), [4](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenrolling_later_on/), [5](<https://medicareagentshub.com/questions/how-can-i-avoid-or-reduce-irmaa-charges-on-my-medicare-premiums/>)\] — Hope this helps. I do Roth conversions which increase my income. IRMAA is triggered. (There is a 2 year look back so the impact of this years conversions cause IRMA 2 years later). If I stopped conversions, iRMAA would stop 2 years later. But I could use some the money I converted to pay the IRMAA if I had to. I don't fully understand your issue, but hopefully this helps you with some options. 🙏 "

↳ (0): "I dropped my part b due to an Irmaa spike and stayed on my wife's insurance for three years, as long as you have creditable coverage it's not issue, you just have to reapply."

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1iten4m/>

↳ (0): "I have also found the Medicare experience like a breath of fresh air. It is so nice not having to worry about it."

↳ (0): "I feel the same way. I am a somewhat insecure person (lol), and probably some of my fears of not having health insurance go back to growing up and watching my father lose his job at 58 years old. He worked for his company for over 35 years and they cut him loose when his health began deteriorating. (He was a commercial artist and his hand wore out from repetitive stress injury. I remember his fear that he would lose the house and everything else.) Plus, a few surgeries that I had and the astronomical bills didn't help to put my mind to rest regarding the loss of insurance. Plus, my employer was not hesitant in eliminating people/departments at a moments notice. In short, Medicare has given me great peace of mind. It's not perfect and I know others may have completely opposite opinions, but I am so grateful to have it, I've seen what happens when you don't. Take care. :)"

↳ (0): "Thanks, OP. My spouse is turning 65 in April, and we really need to get on this. You mentioned YouTube videos. Do you have any particular channel that you found most helpful?"

"Anecdote: I switched from my employer insurance plan to medicare advantage plan from the same insurer when I turned 65 15 years ago. My bills have been small until this year. My primary detected that I had a heart murmur. The results is an echo to verify the murmur, and angiogram to tell if I could have a TAVR. Followed by a TAVR procedure. I was in the 30% of patients that needed a pacemaker. 2 more echos and 2 CT scans. 9 days in the hospital, 5 for the TAVR mostly because my platelets "crashed". After release, my pulse rate dropped so it was to the ER with what turned out to be a Heart Block necessitating the pacemaker. 4 more days in the hospital with an accompanying ambulance from the ER to the Cardiac unit. I still have 11 days of zero cost in the hospital this year. After 20 days, it will be \$100 / day for an additional 80 days. I have zero copays for doctors and specialists. Also zero for labs and x-rays. I just got my August statement for the year. The hospital billed approx \$300,000 and the insurer agreed to a little more than \$100,000. My costs were \$30 copay for the 2 CT scans. I did have to pay for parking for my wife. My meds accounting will come in a few days but most of my meds are zero copay with a few \$5 copays. In addition to the medicare premium, I pay zero premium for the advantage plan. I guess my non-profit HMO is a bargain. I must emphasize that it's a NON-PROFIT."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 25 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugwxwqe13wFaaz_XOged4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Thank you so much for sharing this! Would love to do a similar video on your experience if you're willing"

↳ @FM-kl3iu (1): "Key words are NON PROFOT HMO otherwise it would be a different experience"

↳ @anonemouse3768 (0): "@FM-kl3iu That's why I emphasized NON PROFIT."

"I had United Health a decade ago...not for medicare but through my employer. I don't even know why they are legal they were so bad. They use incompetence as a means to increase profits. If you can't reach them, you will never be able to effectively use your coverage...chaCHING for them."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=Ugzg2A74V6Ph1FdE-ZZ4AaABAg>

↳ @PuiChan-uf9ne (3): "Possibly true for the entire corrupted health insurance industry. How is it the cost from health providers are charging like 5 to 10 times the insurance are willing to pay (they call it insurance discounted price), forcing everyone must purchase insurance."

↳ @JoanDoris1 (1): "That's the way I feel about my Humana Part D Rx plan."

↳ @annawarner1078 (0): "Didn't their CEO was killed by this guy in New York? Because they did not approve some procedure. So it had to be other insurance not Medicare Supplement."

"It's not one size fits all. I've been on Medicare Advantage for many years and am very satisfied. The max out of pocket is not much above what I had with employer health care. I hit that a couple of times over the last 10 years. I live in a large metro area. I've never had a problem with doctors or hospitals being out of network. Prior approvals have been effectively immediate. I have one single plan that covers everything and my healthcare providers have one number to call for insurance. I've never had to show my Medicare card. My monthly cost in years where I've not had major health issues has been well below the monthly cost for a supplement. I'd recommend a supplement plan if you have or expect to have a chronic condition that requires regular medical treatment that is expensive. I'd also recommend it if you live in a small and remote community where staying in-network might be more of a challenge."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugy9jndtEutPx0Q5ZzR4AaABAg>

↳ @richardreiman8202 (0): "No one said it was one size fits all. But the Supplement path is the best if you can afford it, full stop. No one can predict if they will need chronic care. Past performance on Medicare Advantage is no predictor of future need. If you can afford a Supplement, you should go with it. The whole purpose of insurance is financial security. Plus if you do not choose a Supplement at 65 and then get sick later, which most people do, you usually can't switch to a Supplement without medical underwriting!"

↳ @markrosenthal9108 (0): "@richardreiman8202 You didn't address why in a large metro area a supplement is any better than Medicare Advantage. Medicare supplements and Advantage do not cover long-term care. Long-term care insurance agents try to scare people into buying their product when most don't need it."

"So I stayed with my company plan at \$800 a month which was cheaper than ACA which was 1600 and I'm single! But I'm afraid to leave my company plan because they said if I do I can't come back and use their Medicare supplement when I turn 65. So I feel forced to stay. 😞 "

— YouTube · How to Get Affordable Health Insurance Before Medicare · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dVyz5Ac7pA&lc=UgxhxvK09UxP7VuTUNR4AaABAg>

↳ @almarble1 (0): "I am in the same boat. It is the penalty of making too much money. But I am glad I can avoid ACA.....works fine for some but a nightmare for others and I worked too long and hard to deal with nightmares at this point in life. Actually, if I did things over, I can't think of anything I would change. I maxed out on non-taxable accounts I could and had no choice but to build up a significant brokerage account that--for better or worse--pays too much for me to get any freebies from the government."

"Which is exactly why I chose original Medicare and kept my FEHB plan as my supplement."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxeeXBBjCcQMnx7jGp4AaABAg_AMSJ6njcv7zAMTQzdDpoD6

"Just some clarification on medicare parts A & B. If you begin drawing social security even if you continue working you will automatically be enrolled in part A. You don't pay for part A so no big deal. I started drawing SS when I reached FRA (full retirement age) at 66 1/2 and I continued working full time. Because I have credible health insurance coverage through my employer with benefits and a premium that's competitive with and in most instances much better than either Medigap or Medicare Advantage plans available under Part B, I opted to defer enrollment into part B of medicare. Furthermore my insurance through my employer is primary over Medicare B coverage anyway and covers everything I need so no sense paying for extra insurance I would never use or need as long as I have credible coverage. You just need to do your research and decide what's best for your circumstance."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwPvGltRq28reGxZNZ4AaABAg>

↳ @akontilis1792 (1): "I was wondering about that automatic enrollment into Medicare Part A. Why is that? And, why was it assigned an effective of 6 months earlier than the first Social Security check??"

"I totally lucked out. My buyout (it was a really good one, especially considering I had an upcoming termination date) included affordable (not wicked cheap but nowhere near COBRA prices) health insurance until I turned 65 (7 years worth)."

— r/obamacare · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1woyyo6/for_people_retiring_before_65_how_are_you/pbr9us0/

"Happy with my Medicare advantage. Better than the insurance I got from my past employer."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypOamgls&lc=UgxOhl7cfQzkV8LnPRZ4AaABAg>

↳ @g0989 (4): "Yes, despite the criticism Advantage plans receive, they are often better than non-Medicare employer group insurance plans."

↳ @sondrasmith2691 (0): "@g0989 What you say is now true. It became true after Obama Care was passed. We watched our great Group Health Ins be "gutted of benefits," our deductibles and co-pays increased each year. What had once been great Group Health Ins was then terrible once Obama said all companies with x amount of employees HAD to provide Health insurance. So, the companies said "Okay, you got it, but since our costs are now increasing, employees who had good coverage now won't have that same coverage. We'll buy cheaper plans to save ourselves money. ""

"I have an Advantage plan, specifically designed for my previous employer, Texas Retirement System for Teachers. It has NO donut hole & I use very expensive meds. My husband is not eligible for my plan, so currently has an Advantage Plan with 0 premium, but a medium size deductible on his drug plan, plus he pays Medicare B premium. He is 82, so the cost of a Supplement plan is quite high. Your video was the most informative I have seen or read about. The comparison between Advantage & Supplement was great & answered a lot of my questions. Medicare, in general, can be the elephant in the room, when you are with a large group of seniors. Thank you for the great video!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxHKCBN2E2_Gq7XU7R4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching and sharing the arrangement you have currently. Appreciate you! 🐘 "

"Ditto! Many, if not most, employer's plans nowadays are bare minimum plans with huge deductibles! Medicare was so much better! Medicare (with Supplement) is the best health insurance we have had in twenty years, despite full time employment and employer's coverage during that time. Other coworkers who have turned 65 have done the same! Putting off Medicare may have been good advice years ago when employer plans were worth a damn, but not anymore."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugz5U0NbhmpvnoEB4Bl4AaABAg.A2dSZGiXINy.A2eO8YpsZgE>

"Excellent. short and to the point. This video validated my concerns as to how I should fill out the form. Summary: I retired 11/3/23 so I made enough income last year to bump up the Part B cost. I just received my letter from SS validating this. They used 2022 income. I filled out the form using an ESTIMATED 2024 income as this is the tax year my income drops AND the tax year I am tasked to start the Part B premiums. You do not need to reference an already filed tax return. Added notes: I did call our local SS office. She stated NOT to make an appointment as they are a month out but my office, as with others welcomes walk-ins. I just left there. 30 minutes tops. **Of great value was that I had an official letter from my prior employer (large company) that I was terminated on 11/3/23 by reason of retirement. SS took a copy of this. All my info got input in their systems and will update tonight!! Words to the wise - if you know you'll get hit with this added charge, sign up for Medicare the 1st day possible so that you can get your letter and file this form BEFORE the first bill shows up. Good day today!"

— YouTube · How to Lower Your Medicare Part B Premium I SSA 44 IRMAA Form · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8esTBooWlQY&lc=UgzK2qrLra0cguAoHR4AaABAg>

↳ @farroaj1813 (0): "Thank you for sharing this information, Maggie-D924. Did SS happen to mention how close in the ballpark you need to be for the estimate? I will begin Part B mid-2025, the same time I quit working. So, for Step 2, I will use my YTD 2025 earnings to calculate an estimated MAGI for line 11 of a tax return not yet filled until 2026. Since I would only be working 1/2 the year, my GROSS earnings for 2025 will already be significantly less than \$103,000. The way I'm seeing this, I don't see where an accurate estimate is that important unless you're MAGI is super close to the \$103,000 threshold."

"Thank you for this video. For others watching, this is a very important video. I worked past 65, had large employer coverage until I retired at 67. My wife(she is 59) and I had planned on paying for our premiums to my employer ad infinitum through what we thought was an "emeritus" type program and then found out that if one is not employed, one is mandated to sign up for Part B. Therefore, when I had to come off of my employer's plan, she could no longer be covered. It was a very concerning situation that she was not covered (except now on Cobra). That only gets 18 months of coverage. Finding her individual coverage is a big challenge to make sure it is the proper and creditable insurance until she is 65. This is a huge gap in our insurance coverage system. The ACA is a terrible system that was perpetrated on the American people. People be aware of age discrepancies with your spouse. This was probably all my fault, but just to let people know, be informed and don't get caught with your pants down."

— YouTube · 7 MEDICARE ERRORS to Avoid When You Work Past Age 65 · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2RD7fyvVse8&lc=UgyqKYZL8rvQm1CM7B54AaABAg>

↳ @bettybee1852 (1): "I'm not trying to debate, but I don't see how the ACA is the problem. It's simply a marketplace that, for one thing, doesn't allow insurance companies to deny people for pre-existing conditions. You were going to face this problem whether or not the ACA existed; you were still going to have to find health insurance for your wife if she she couldn't get it through her own employer. Please elaborate if I am not understanding the issue."

↳ @dfsulliv (1): "Its not just spouses its individuals.... at the moment, ill be a few months before 65 when Cigna pulls out of CO & there would be no options to keep my doctor' prior to participating in medicare. The collapse of the marketplace (Obamacare referred to antiseptically) has most insurance companies terminating all their coverage everywhere and those that continue are insufficient to be accepted by competent medical service providers. In my case my marketplace plan is necessary as Im running my own business. Remmeber that Obamacare wasnt just meant to fail (as the GOP like to say), it was meant to punish anyone who would dare not accept complete govt HC domination. OMG, I hate this government."

↳ @dfsulliv (1): "@bettybee1852nah, you have no interest in accepting the collapse of the US HC system because you have been partially responsible for that collapse..."

"What, Why & How - Thank you for a very informative video. I have had a Medicare Advantage plan for 3 years and have learned a lot from your video. After having health insurance through an employer my whole life, I found Medicare and everything surrounding it to be overwhelming due to the different scenarios to choose from. I did work with a broker that was very good, but I always worried if I was making the right choice - we don't have crystal balls. I am very satisfied with my Medicare Advantage plan, and I am concerned about changes that may occur in 2026. Thank you again for a very informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwltgkKJea68YVkyWN4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch! Remember, this applies to about 3% of folks on Advantage that we can see so far and, if your plan does change or exit, you do have options."

"I wish I had educated myself when I turned 65. I chose to stay with my employers retiree health plan which we pay ourselves. This year the price has jumped dramatically and I am looking at marketplace. It looks like I missed out on medigap because I know I would now be turned down if underwritten. I could stay with my employers plan and if they discontinued it I could get medigap, but leaving voluntarily my only option is advantage. I will save 4000 a year by choosing advantage but fear the authorizations/denial process."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyNq-I5E9DgaRdfDEN4AaABAq>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (2): "As someone told me when I was turning 65. You can pay it now (traditional and supp) or pay it later (advantage) as far as costs. As far as quality of care there is no comparison. Advantage Plans kill seniors prematurely by the hundreds every day in the US. And thats a fact"

↳ @ahemphill44 (0): "@JohnJohn-wr1jo That's the most ignorant statement (of many) that I have read on this old post."

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAq>

↳ @CD-ek3iq (4): "I work with both MA and Supplements. While what you say is mostly accurate the sad fact is many seniors simply cannot afford the high premiums of Supplements AND and a PDP. Add in the monthly cost of dental, vision and hearing, which supps won't cover, and it's easy to be priced out completely. There's nothing wrong with MA. I work with people every day who LOVE their MA plans and wouldn't trade em for the world, lol. (It's my job to try!) Many also have much lower Max Out Of Pockets than mentioned that can end up being as much as the yearly premium you pay with Supps whether you use it or not. 🙌 If you travel, simply get a PPO. Easy. Everybody has different needs and means. Luckily there are multiple options to try and help people with their Heath Care."

AARP / UnitedHealthcare · 176 documents · 20 voices

"Medicare Advantage is a Scam: My experience almost a decade in the Healthcare industry I was inspired to go into some detail after an AskReddit post about dirty insider truth that most people won't know. I replied that, as a person who who's worked in the medical field for a little over 9 years, saying that Medicare is leagues better than Medicare Advantage and Medicare Advantage is a scam. I've worked in a Home Health Agency, an inpatient rehab (SNF), a doctor's office, and am currently an RN working inpatient rehab. Hopefully, people will find this interesting or helpful \- Admissions for SNF: First medical jobs was admissions primarily to fill short term rehab beds. I had a website of all the people discharging from local hospitals who needed inpatient therapy, I would reach out to the hospitals, say we had a bed available, they would confirm with me, I would get the paperwork , get insurance authorization if needed, and greet the patient once they arrived and sign papers Medicare patients: I was told to try and get as many traditional Medicare patients as possible. I asked my boss why and she said that they pay the most and they always pay. I never once had to get insurance authorizations for traditional Medicare. The people could just come in! It covered the most therapy per day vs any other insurance(an hour a day vs. 30 minutes a day usually), including every Medicare Advantage. It automatically covered the first 20 days, then the next 80 days after that, I think it was like 60%. But if they had a secondary insurance, it would cover 100 days at 100%. Medicare Advantage: First off, once you get a Medicare Advantage plan, its not traditional medicare anymore, it's the insurance company now. Of you want to come to our facility, you don't get the grace of just walking in. I'm sure they've streamlined everything now, but we had to call a number, present the diagnosis in certain code numbers, wait for an authorization number, and then we could let you in. From there, you'd maybe get 20 days at 100% with half the daily rehab, then after 20 days, they were done. it covered nothing. Patient was 100% responsible for all costs. \- Home Health Scheduler My 2nd job was scheduling a team of Therapists and Nurses to different homes in my city who needed home health. I'd get a stack of referral papers every morning and was told to get them scheduled. For example, a referral would say "Medicare A: Needs RN and PT services", and then I'd contact my staff and arrange a schedule. I would also work with my staff and the patients that needed anything rescheduled. I was essentially the Guy in the Chair Medicare: Let's say that of my 3 referrals I had that morning 1 was traditional Medicare A, once was a UHC Medicare Advantage, and the other a Humana Medicare Advantage. Once again, I was told, "Staff the Medicare patients first!" And once again, I asked why and was told that Medicare always pays, and it always pays the most. I wasn't working directly with insurance at that job, so I can't comment on authorizations or cost. But Medicare patients generally had more RN and PT visits per week then any Medicare Advantage. Usually 3 days per week for each with Medicare, and 2 days a week for any Medicare Advantage. Also, there are longer sessions with Medicare. usually an hour vs 30 minutes Medicare Advantage: Just less care. Less staffing days and shorter sessions. \- Doctor's office: Next job I had before my RN was in a primary care physicians office. I only worked the front desk, but I worked right next to the referral coordinator, so I knew everything that was happening about that Medicare: From a cashiers perspective, Medicare never had a copay while many Medicare Advantage plan did. From a referral perspective, Medicare was so much easier. I don't think I ever saw Medicare rejected a referral claim. It was always quick, and as long as we filled the paperwork out properly, it was approved. Also, most specialists took Medicare, so usually patients could go where they wanted. Medicare Advantage: There was always an authorization process. it often involved scanning and sending documents, then waiting for approval. Generally it was a longer process that resulted in much more rejections than traditional Medicare. Also, one again, becuae Medicare Advantage isn't Medicare anymore, it's whatever insurance company has it now, the patients were stuck with whatever doctors they had plans with, and it was always a much smaller list than Tradition Medicare. I've been an RN for about 4 years now, so I am very separated from the insurance side, thank God! DISCLAIMER: Some Medicare Advantage plans are competitive with the benefits of traditional Medicare, but they are often very expensive. Some people are very happy with their Medicare Advantage plans, but I wanted to share my perspective, and my experience. But, this is also why I am greatly in support of expanding Medicare to cover all People in the US. We have the means to give the people proper

Healthcare, we just need to do it"

— r/HealthInsurance · 472 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sl2x0z/>

↳ (0): "Reminder to get a supplemental plan with your traditional Medicare. A medigap plan. Also reminder to get your part D plan. Everything you said is spot on but leaves out those couple things that are very important. Everyone I know turning 65 I tell them get your traditional Medicare A and B and then get your D and Medigap. But that sounds really confusing to people which seems to be why they think it'd be 'easier' to just get a Medicare advantage plan to 'do it all'."

↳ (0): "I did research for 2 month on my spare time when I chose my mom's plan last year. And this sub was so beneficial because of so many people sharing their experiences. I chose her A,B,D an G Extra. I feel really bad they make it sooo complicated. I can't imagine being 65 and having to deal with this nonsense."

↳ (0): "The current administration is pushing MA plans; they want to get out of the Medicare business and just pay the \$\$ to the private insurers instead. I think more people need to be aware of this & put a stop to it. As an elderly person, you don't want a for-profit company making care decisions for you."

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

↳ @sct4040 (24): "I too, am on AARP UHC and will be paying \$333/month in 2027. That is so much money."

↳ @nealkshah (18): "Sounds like that "blessing in disguise" really did work out. Thanks for sharing the whole story."

↳ @edwinrodeo (15): "@sct4040... me 2 🤔 . I'm in CT though.. open enrollment yr round. No underwriting required. Only 4 states has it."

"I have the AARP UHC Supplemental Plan plus a Prescription Plan. I pay just over \$100 a month for my prescription plan. Purely by accident I discovered I pay double for my prescriptions using my insurance vs being uninsured. My CVS charge for my 90 day prescriptions was about \$45 but using a Good Rx card which I pay just over \$20 for the same prescription."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 120 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgwIJVVWWtbq6lZbBBJ4AaABAq>

↳ @juanestopinan3250 (16): "I live in a State where you can switch annually with a different carrier for your plan as long as it's the same letter, without underwriting..but because of this the premium is higher"

↳ @gdpope52 (10): "I just shopped plans on the government website. Put in your current meds and review plans that take those medicines. I pay \$17.50 and have very small out of pocket expenses. Also i do not have any major health problems."

↳ @ssa8479 (5): "Then the time comes to sign up I'll have to look for the cheapest Part D plan. For now my one generic prescription costs \$10 for a 90-day supply. The good thing would be that one can pick a different plan every year."

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (19): "Thanks for sharing your experience. You're not alone — I've seen a lot of people face those same big increases on Plan G. Plan N usually ends up being the smarter long-term choice because of the lower premiums, and for most people the extra cost-sharing is pretty minimal compared to what they save each year. With how fast rates are climbing, especially going into 2026, your switch makes a lot of sense."

↳ @christinestephenson1742 (11): "I have Mutual of Omaha supplement since 2019. It's maybe 130 a month and has just gone up a bit each year."

↳ @jays8191 (6): "@policyguides Could Plan N's extra cost sharing increase significantly if Medicare reimbursements decrease in 2026?"

"Last July, I spent one week in the hospital which included two ambulance rides, specialists, many tests, etc. The bill was \$30,000 and going up. I paid ZERO dollars because I have a good plan. If you buy cheap, you will end up paying for it. I have original Medicare A & B with an AARP United Health Care supplement plan for \$410 a month. Just one trip to the hospital is worth the cost. I'm 80 and just getting by financially by the grace of God."
— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 102 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzhW03ErdB2Dq8ZcXI4AaABAg>

↳ @Its_Mooch (12): "wow, amazing but still unaffordable for so many. they need to get the monthly cost down for our seniors."

↳ @astralartist4 (9): "I know from my parents who always had medicare with blue cross medigap - they never paid a cent after leaving the hospital after surgeries and being an inpatient for a few days to 3 weeks - only the tv was not covered."

↳ @ValMarie707 (6): "Not sure where you are but I got a letter that my Medicare Advantage - AARP thru UHC is not going to be available next year so good luck. I had to switch to a regular supplement plan costing 5x as much for not as much coverage plus I still have to buy Rx, Dental & Vision."

"My husband and I were paying over \$700 a month for premiums alone with Medicare and a Supplement plan, so we changed to Medicare advantage plan Preferred Care with UHC and here in Miami it works fairly well. We never had any issues to go to specialists. Even though my husband takes a lot of medications, at the end of the year we end up saving money."
— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 67 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwRHs4R8-hbL8liv_R4AaABAg

↳ @domerbuz3813 (13): "Thank you. These dummies never consider \$700 per month or \$8400 a year for supplement insurance. Have had Advantage plan so have saved nearly \$90000."

↳ @lantanaleah (9): "@danielhurley2894 I have an Advantage plan. I'm raising a red flag but doubt that our representatives in Congress will. They receive massive donations from the healthcare and pharmaceutical industry who also spend massive amounts on lobbyists. My doctor and physical therapist recommended further treatment, but after the initial 90 days (which included only ~16 visits because my copay was \$35), request for authorization was sent to a contractor for Aetna who did not respond to phone calls, voicemails, or emails—so no further treatment. I filed a grievance w Aetna; their response 2 months later was that I had treatment and they had no further request for authorization. Phone calls to Aetna— rep said there was no request w Aetna, didn't know anything about the contractor but admitted they do use outside contractors. I had a previous experience with an insurer who also contracted with outside companies whose job it is to deny claims. My neurosurgeon received a payment of \$150 months following my 6 hour surgery. There is no good health insurance company or plan in this country."

↳ @danielhurley2894 (5): "@domerbuz3813 I agree with you. For me a Medicare Advantage Plan works great."

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1iten4m/>

↳ (0): "I have also found the Medicare experience like a breath of fresh air. It is so nice not having to worry about it."

↳ (0): "I feel the same way. I am a somewhat insecure person (lol), and probably some of my fears of not having health insurance go back to growing up and watching my father lose his job at 58 years old. He worked for his company for over 35 years and they cut him loose when his health began deteriorating. (He was a commercial artist and his hand wore out from repetitive stress injury. I remember his fear that he would lose the house and everything else.) Plus, a few surgeries that I had and the astronomical bills didn't help to put my mind to rest regarding the loss of insurance. Plus, my employer was not hesitant in eliminating people/departments at a moments notice. In short, Medicare has given me great peace of mind. It's not perfect and I know others may have completely opposite opinions, but I am so grateful to have it, I've seen what happens when you don't. Take care. :)"

↳ (0): "Thanks, OP. My spouse is turning 65 in April, and we really need to get on this. You mentioned YouTube videos. Do you have any particular channel that you found most helpful?"

"Thanks, think I've completed everything and will be on medicare on wednesday I signed up for trad Medicare A + B . I signed up AARP/UHC for part D because all my drugs are covered in their formulary. I signed up State Farm for Medigap because I didn't need a fitness pass. I cancelled my marketplace insurance effective Sept 30 with all the above plans going into effect Oct 1. I spoke to my pharmacist and picked up enough refills to last through the next month in case of any hiccup. I confirmed all my doctors will take Medicare and electronically upload my Medicare card into their patient portals. I will need to sign up for part D plan (or stay with AARP/UHC) for Jan 2026. I am in CA and can switch part G providers without underwriting on my birthday month next year. This has all been a huge amount of anxiety, hope I did everything right, and sincerely have no idea how I would have done without all your advice."

— r/medicare · 47 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1nrj552/>

↳ (0): "Sounds like you covered all the bases. Good job."

↳ (0): "Nice work, congrats."

↳ (0): "Huge congrats This is a rock solid setup and you handled it beautifully **Here is a quick double check list** • Part A and Part B active on October 1 • Medigap Plan G with State Farm confirmed and premium autopay set • Part D with AARP UHC active on October 1 and pharmacy preferred in network • Marketplace plan ends September 30 so no overlap billed • Doctors confirmed they accept Medicare and have your Medicare number on file • Online accounts created for Medicare MyMedicare AARP UHC and State Farm • Part B premium payment method set or Social Security deduction confirmed • Keep your receipts and Explanation of Benefits for the first couple months in case of hiccups **Smart moves you already made** • Picked up refills to bridge the switch • Checked each doctor for Medicare participation • Matched Part D to your current formulary **Dates to keep in mind for next choices** • Part D and drug plan changes for 2026 can be made during October 15 to December 7 • California birthday rule lets you switch Medigap to equal or lesser benefits without underwriting starting on your birthday for at least 60 days **If anything looks off during October** • Show your pharmacist both cards Medicare red white and blue plus Part D • Call the plan's member services to reprocess any rejected claim the first week is when small glitches happen • Use paper claims only if needed then keep copies You did everything right Take a breath and enjoy the peace of mind You have got this"

"I have had TWO increases in my Supplement Plan N AARP United Healthcare. It is not fun but as long as I can manage,I will stay with it and be grateful I have it."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 34 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugw7SOOIloZtern4oQh4AaABAg>

↳ @MikeD_ (7): "Two increases in the past year, or since you joined the plan? What state are you in?"

↳ @mixville2 (6): "I'm with you. It's not cheap, especially here in New England, but my Plan N AARP/UHC with Medicare is by far the best insurance I've ever had - and I've had some big operations."

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (4): "Mine and wife's go up every single year..mine has tripled the cost in 3 years"

"I'm Swedish, where we have UHC, but we pay insane taxes and our health-care system is dependent on the government, so in a financial crisis the quality goes down."

— YouTube · I'm Young & Healthy, Can I Skip Health Insurance? · 34 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WTtjmdyTCRM&lc=UgwPWRAKdB9tABSDmIF4AaABAg.8vnf3cjZz2l8vnlBxVd0Zd>

"I had United Health a decade ago...not for Medicare but through my employer. I don't even know why they are legal they were so bad. They use incompetence as a means to increase profits. If you can't reach them, you will never be able to effectively use your coverage...changing for them."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=Ugzg2A74V6Ph1FdE-ZZ4AaABAg>

↳ @PuiChan-uf9ne (3): "Possibly true for the entire corrupted health insurance industry. How is it the cost from health providers are charging like 5 to 10 times the insurance are willing to pay (they call it insurance discounted price), forcing everyone must purchase insurance."

↳ @JoanDoris1 (1): "That's the way I feel about my Humana Part D Rx plan."

↳ @annawarner1078 (0): "Didn't their CEO was killed by this guy in New York? Because they did not approve some procedure. So it had to be other insurance not Medicare Supplement."

"I have been on a UHC Advantage HMO plan for 7 years. It has paid for all of my big treatments including a detached retina and a knee replacement. They both cost me about \$250. I pay 0 premium. I have saved over 26K in premiums. I exercise everyday. I have never smoked and don't have any chronic problems yet. I think I'm kind of stuck with it as I will pay a hefty price for a Supplement plan at my current age."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugyk3is4VtZ_KBbfd94AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for sharing your experience!"

"I joined my AARP UHC Medigap plan in March (Southern California) and less than 10 days later was informed that next March my rate will be increased by 14% ! Welcome to retirement 😞 "

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgytflnfgzCPshFvyjl4AaABAg>

↳ @paulstein916 (4): "You are still within your 6 month initial enrollment, so you can change your carrier or your plan if you want. And CA has a birthday rule too, so you have some options to change down the road if desired."

↳ @steves3688 (3): "Mutual of Omaha did the same...stopped a discount I was getting for having another over 60 person in the household and then upped the premiums...25% total increase for Plan N...."

↳ @KurtRothwell (1): "Keep voting Democrat. See how it works out for you."

"Happened to me last year. I joined Medicare, was a member of AARP, had United for gap insurance & a part D drug plan. Since then any diagnostic screening cost me \$0. MRI's, CT's, etc. Check what an Advantage Plan'll cost for the same diagnostic IF they approve it.."

— YouTube · MORE Medicare Advantage Plans CUT: Millions Will Face Forced Dis-enrollment ❌ · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPLaLyfDZxY&lc=UgxB-0NAW2Hx47o6a5h4AaABAg>

↳ @lazycat7409 (5): "I'm not complaining about the insurance we had while I was working but the years of "ifs" was enough for me to choose the gap plan G."

↳ @peterkiviat9969 (3): "A 30 minute video describing a problem that can be solved in 20 minutes. Plan terminated? Call your doctor 's office, speak to the business manager, ask which plans they accept, and which is easiest with approvals. Problem solved."

↳ @RolandoSoto-l4r (1): "How expensive was it?"

"We went with original Medicare + Medigap Plan "N" + Part "D" Prescription + AARP Delta Dental PPO. No regrets, whatsoever.... Thank you Stephanie & your team!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1lpLq6moM&lc=UgxRN81uNI8NB_BZ0f14AaABAg

↳ @juliava605 (3): "Right. And how much does that cost you per month? More than MANY of us can afford is my guess."

"I have AARP United Health Care Plan F supplement. Recently, I had an expensive out patient procedure done. It was costly and the supplement paid all of what medicare didn't pay. I've heard about nightmares about the Advantage plan and definitely don't want it. Don't plan on dropping my Plan F since it's no longer offered."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=Ugyhipv0pyvC8y4fPoJ4AaABAg>

↳ @fredwiley3731 (2): "Plan F also. Wife and I have had many procedures, doctor visits and we have paid zero. The out of pocket would way exceed what I pay for Blue Cross premiums. It is confusing."

↳ @RudyDoody-z3q (2): "I have Plan N. Pretty much same as Plan F, except I have a \$203 deductible. Once that's paid, everything is 100%! The cost is much lower than Plan F."

"When we signed up for medigap insurance UHC through AARP was the winner in premium cost, but the devil is in the details! UHC had a big discount that diminished the longer you're with them. Add in the year by year increase and we were seeing double digit increases each year. Fortunately we were able to switch to another plan from a well rated company and pass medical review. So we're now saving about 1500 this year. The new company has a track record of manageable yearly increases. Time will tell..."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxMVz0BI22UXcj0L6x4AaABAg>

↳ @jfrog2658 (1): "@KathyRackowBankers Fidelity"

↳ @KathyRackow (0): "Could you please share what company you switched to? My Insurance Raised my premium from \$232 to \$550."

↳ @KathyRackow (0): "@jfrog2658Thank You Very Much For Responding to me. Have A Great Day. 😊 "

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMp4AaABAg>

↳ @paulaberstler4449 (4): "I also have Original and AARP medigap plan. More than a year of cancer treatments and NO charges other than Medicare B deductible (\$283). I never considered an Advantage plan. (I am in remission.)"

↳ @anthonykobiec8569 (1): "My doctor had the broker come in, and ALL he tried to sell me was Advantage plans. He tried telling me that it what people were interested in. It is what they make the MOST money on because the Insurance companies PUSH you towards a profit driven model."

↳ @sweetds1 (1): "How much do you have to pay monthly?"

"I am so very happy I went with AARP UHC Advantage Plan. Most of my drugs are completely free, zero cost to see my PCP, free Y membership, vision and dental coverage. Going with a supplement Plan or straight Medicare would cost my wife and I so much more than \$19 a month."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyW90LDk8lyNz2tgB14AaABAg>

↳ @notthereyet4872 (1): "Same! 👍 Husband and I pay a bit more per month with our AARP MAP PPO, but we probably entered later than you? Anyway, so far - no regrets whatsoever. Have only been in the plan a couple of years and it has already more than paid what we put into it. Fact."

↳ @spunkyspice4777 (0): "Agree. Rich people can afford 170 each month. I certainly can not. Almost out of food at the end of the month a few times. Part B should NOT be mandatory. Part B is there so that Social Security doesn't pay out the full amount owed to peeps. That is why Social Security is hard to live on for many peeps. Part B is a scam. Make Part B a voluntary option. Like now I have 4.73 in the bank."

"I just got off a UHC Advantage Plan and went to Medicare Original. I've been on an advantage plan since I turned 65. UHC this past year has been horrific to deal with. They are extremely slow. Approved upon submission? That has not been my experience. First dental work takes forever to get paid. I broke my shoulder really bad. They denied some of my Physical Therapy and limited how long, on the next phase of PT they took several weeks to approve (and again only some of the request was approved) I had to wait for treatment until they approval so I missed several weeks. CT scan for lung nodules, were only paid for the initial scan none of the follow up scans. I've yet to find out why except the rep claims they paid something but actually they just reduced my share by their negotiated price they didn't pay a dime! I'm in the process of filing appeals but who needs this especially when they are sick and in pain? No more arbitrary advantage plans for me!"

— YouTube · The Truth About United Healthcare's Claim Denials and Dr. Oz's Plan to Force Medicare Adva · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LhIMMntQaY0&lc=UgzFc3HTg_57ldnt16R4AaABAg

↳ @virginiamoss7045 (1): "Have you been able to get a Medicare supplemental policy? You may not can afford it, but if you can, they will require underwriting and may not accept you for a policy no matter how expensive due to your pre-existing conditions. If you get Medicare original to begin with there will be no concern about pre-existing conditions by supplemental policies within the first 6 months or whatever the number is. If you leave original Medicare for an Advantage policy, you can go back to original Medicare, but a supplemental policy will be hard to get. And Medicare alone is only hospitalization; with plan B (\$184 monthly) you get some coverage for doctor visits, etc. You still need more coverage in a supplemental plan; as you age you will have increasing need for medical care."

Agents and brokers (and the commission question) · 166 documents · 20 voices

"I have been a Medicare insurance agent for over 40 years I am 68 and now on Medicare... I chose a Medicare Supplement"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 290 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyTKgkxtkTMhUiMNFN4AaABAg>

↳ @lindadavidson7328 (60): "@mont5584because the advantage plan is shit unless you're healthy till death"

↳ @lindadavidson7328 (44): "Me too , I was an agent too and I pick the supplement plan"

↳ @constancerobinson1377 (21): "I spent three weeks in the hospital with nursing home offered afterwards I had another ct scan after I got home along with two MRIs. I have not been turned down for any procedures and I'm very happy with getting extra money for over the counter drugs, 48 one way transportation to and from medical appointments and hospitals, dental work, eye exams and glasses and even gym membership. My friend has Medicare w a supplement and doesn't get any of the above and pays co-pays. I also don't have co pays Needless to say, I'm very happy with Medicare Advantage Dual healthcare with United."

"As a 79 years old person, I have worked with my Medicare Broker 10 years. I cherish and trust him as much as my Tax accountant, Investment Broker, Insurance agent, Veterinarian, Physician, car repairman, Apple Help line. How could I survive if not for their guidance? Yes, they make money off of me, but the mistakes I have made in the past were disasters. No more stressful nights nearly in tears because I did not understand the ins and outs of this complex world."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 120 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw3E0Y7_DI2bpu859V4AaABAg

↳ @incorrigiblycuriousD61 (10): "@sandrashort1221 How did you find a trustworthy Medicare broker? I have no idea."

↳ @Floridabruce1960 (6): "@sandrashort1221 Where do you find a medicare broker?"

↳ @brucewilson6694 (5): "@sandrashort1221 I'd like to know too! This is the first time I've heard of a Medicare Broker."

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (9): "I recently started original Medicare with a supplement plan N. If the day were to come I could no longer afford supplement premiums, I could move over to a Disadvantage plan during open enrollment without being concerned about medical underwriting. I would probably take out a reverse mortgage on my home to continue affording supplement premiums before I would do that though. I would buy a HDG supplement plan before a Disadvantage plan. I do not want a insurance company having that much control of my healthcare decisions. I don't buy my health insurance for the shiny distracting objects of vision, dental, gym memberships and such either. @johnyracercat"

↳ @johnyracercat (8): "I'm an agent. I explain the options and yes, 95% choose an Advantage Plan because they cannot afford or do not want to pay the Supplement costs and PDP, plus dental, RX, etc. Most Supplement clients will need to reprice to a better rate sooner than 7 years anyways. Supplements will continue to raise their rates as well. It sounds real good at \$125mo. How will you feel when you're Supplement is \$500mo and your drugs are \$400mo higher on the PDP? Suddenly, the Advantage Plan you hate will start looking very tempting. Plus it will cover your dentures? What? Sign me up. Unless you are wealthy, you will get priced out when you really need it."

↳ @mhlovelady (0): "I can understand perhaps 50% choosing the Advantage plan, but NOT 95% unless they are being steered to that. My experience with agents that just sell price is that they are not doing their customers a favor. I once heard a wise agent say that a doctor that makes a mistake may kill you quickly, but an agent that sells you the wrong coverage is like slow death financially. @johnyracercat"

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/>

↳ (0): "Counterpoint: if you are a literate adult that knows how to use a plan compare tool, you don't need an agent"

↳ (0): "The medicare.gov search tool actually does give the pricing model used for each result."

↳ (0): "If you're a literal adult and can read a law book, you don't need a lawyer and can do it yourself."

"Anyone else not having fun anymore? I work at/partially own a smaller independent agency here in the Midwest with my dad and brother. I've been doing this for 14 years now and boy, the past 12 months has sucked. We only have 4 agents but I think the last time I checked our total written premium we were at \$9m so we're doing alright. We're pretty evenly split between personal and commercial and are really lucky to have a big selection of companies. * Travelers, Progressive, Nat Gen, Safeco, Hartford AARP, Auto Owners, Cincinnati, Philly, Nationwide, Openly, Stillwater, and probably a dozen specialty and mutual companies. I'm sure I'm forgetting a couple. I'm fully aware we got it better than most. Even still, this isn't really fun anymore. Especially on the personal side of things. I know we're not FL or TX but my god is it getting tough to shop people around. That's kinda our whole thing. We've always prided ourselves on being honest, upfront, actually answering the phones when folks call in, and trying to do what's best for the customer even if that means less commission. Us agents do all our own quoting and 90% of the servicing. I know we do it differently than most agencies. By doing that we've done pretty well for ourselves and really don't need to advertise or worry about finding leads. We run solely off referrals and call ins and are too busy to keep up. That's the good thing about right now. 10 years ago, we were desperate for business and would have to take anyone who walked in the door. Nowadays, I bet we have to turn away 30% of new customers for misc reasons. Oh your roof is 11 years old, tough. Your house is \$212k and 100 years old, sorry. A single water claim in the last 5 years, nope. You bought both of your daughters Kias?? I can't tell you how many call ins I've sent to Farm Bureau. 2-3 a week at least. We just had a big regional meeting with our parent company last week and boy it was grim. It was the most depressing company round up I've ever been to. Record losses, more companies tightening guidelines, don't expect profit payouts again anytime soon. I was sitting with some of our peer agency (comparable # of employees and companies) and man, they sure seemed like they were struggling. A couple of them said they were closing 3-4 customers a week and he seemed proud of it. Like for the whole agency. I didn't tell him that I myself did 6 that week. I'm not complaining about the money. I made \$25k more this past year than the year before it. I'll probably match that again this year given what renewals are rolling in at. I'm just getting real tired of quoting a perfectly normal 2,700 sqft 2 story with a perfectly fine 12 year old roof and not being able to do anything. I quote 9 different companies and only one offers me a price and it's \$1200 more than what they paid last year. There's a good chance I'll get that sale but the customer already doesn't like me. I'm tired of having to justify the 79% rate increase I saw this morning on a Nationwide home (no claim). I'm tired of every single elderly person telling me "I'm on a fixed income" whenever their policy goes up \$27. I'm tired of roofing companies rolling our customer's wind/hail deductible into the amount they're billing the insurance company to win over their business. And then I'm tired when that same customer bitches to me next Summer when their home goes up \$1800 on renewal. I'm tired of not being able to talk to an underwriter anymore without first going through India and having them pretend to know what's going on only to transfer me to a misc underwriter 10 minutes later. I'm not saying this job was all sunshine and daisy's but it's crazy how much less stressful it was just 2-3 years ago. My dad's been an agent for 40 years (25 with Farmers) and he said this is the worst market he's ever seen. He predominantly does commercial and habitational and that's become a nightmare as well. He's had to turn away \$250k premium accounts recently because there's literally not a single other market for it. Please tell me we're not alone. Please tell me this is temporary and it won't suck to come into work in 2 years. We've never ever listened to a single buyout offer but man, I get why some folks do it these days."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 51 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cswcw9/anyone_else_not_having_fun_anymore/

↳ LifeVictor (26): "This may be the best post I have seen in a long time. I think it sums up what 90% of us are all dealing with in this unprecedented market. I'm captive and can you imagine all of the above with no other options to offer. It sucks! Hang in there. Be strong! 🍊 "

↳ PromiseAdvanced1870 (9): "Here in KS and MO it's the same thing...I can't tell you how many times this month I've turned away new customers AND CURRENT cuz their roofs are over 10 years old. Just about 70% of our Nationwide book is calling in cussing us out for the MASSIVE rate hikes NW is taking. "Sorry Mr. Customer, NW is trying to figure things out just like the rest of the industry. Good thing is you're not the only customer to call in and we do have other options! Real quick, how old is the roof on your house? Oh it's the original from 1998??.....![gif](emotelfree_emotes_pack|facepalm)"

↳ Samwill226 (6): "I'm in Georgia....it hasn't been fun in two years. Had a 40% loss ration for oh I don't know....20 years? Had a 200% due to storms for a 6 month period and now its back to 50%. Travelers came in and shut down my ability to write new homeowners. I was also just notified that if I don't write enough policies I may drop a tier on commission.....but also wanted to let me know if we continue we'll get a loss ratio check. What F**KING world am I in right now?? No it hasn't been fun. I always just dreamed that I'd like to build my commercial to about a million or two then sell off my personal lines and sit at home.....then I had three businesses call me to let me know they were going out of business. Totaling about \$70k I'll be missing by end of the year. It's very frustrating for me and our clients. No one is happy!"

"When I first picked a supplement plan a few years ago and was deciding between Plan G and Plan N, the difference in premiums would pay for about 20 doctor visit copays per year. I usually see a doctor 2-3 times per year maximum. I live in Ohio which doesn't allow excess charges so I chose Plan N with the help of an experienced broker."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 50 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=Ugz5OJseywWR-Ps1bVV4AaABAg>

↳ @patrick39432 (3): "@ranman1959 Good to know that, as I live in Ohio 😊 "

↳ @KittyRayas (0): "@ranman1959 excess!!"

↳ @KarlG-z9d (0): "You NEED to focus on when the BIG charges(WILL) happen. NOT when you barely use any medical services at all!!!"

"Chartreuse. 67 and looking to retire that end of next year if they don't put me out to pasture before then. Been on part A since 65, with company health plans that change every year. The agent at my local SS office went above and beyond to explain everything to me when I signed up. He was extremely helpful."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzNY_JjDH7DleQpHbp4AaABAq

↳ @texaszag8748 (9): "I'm glad to hear that you had a positive experience with the people at SSA. I was also fortunate in that I had an agent who was as helpful as I could have hoped for. Government agencies get a bad rap and all too often it is people parroting the same refrains from the Reagan era (i.e., "...government IS the problem"). I have an older brother who has been on Social Security disability since the 1980's. They've NEVER failed him. He's not paid a dime for rent or health care since becoming disabled, yet he insists that the government can do NOTHING right! Amazing!"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "This is great! Glad they were helpful! 🟢🟡 Combine those two colors for yours 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "@poolbump1234 do you have an HSA with your company plan? Part A doesn't cover the 20%. Part A is hospital coverage, has a deductible and daily copays for certain hospital and facility stays. Part B is the 80% coverage."

"I'm 7 months away from turning 65. I have an appointment with a broker in a few weeks. Very grateful to come across this video. Thank you."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 40 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1IpLq6moM&lc=UgwWBdVQ1TJw1FBtEep4AaABAq>

↳ @MarcBanish-yg3lq (7): "The brokers make a lot more commission to put you on Advantage Plan FYI. I went with Original Medicare Plan N With Supplement from Humana. So far, very few copay, no copay for PT, Chiro, or appts for a problem. Only "office visit " for follow up. My spouse saw neurosurgeon with only \$15 copay 🎉 Advantage Plans sound good BUT can control which Dr you can go to, decline procedures, and can change every single year!! Too risky for me. Many Drs and hospitals don't accept Med Adv plans. I feel that America can do better ... seniors shouldn't have to deal with how complex all this is - they should not have to appeal three times to get procedures from advantage plans! Especially when they're sick and going through health problems."

↳ @freespeech3 (6): "Medicare does pretty good all by itself just pick up a drug plan"

↳ @Katrina.3032 (4): "I've heard that when you make the choice initially is the Only time you can get the supplemental plan without a medical examination and they can't turn you down. If you go to advantage plans first and later try to switch back, you may not be able to."

"This is, hands down, the best video I have ever seen about Medicare insurance plans!! Fantastic job, and thank you! And I hope you recover quickly from your sunburn! BUT... I want to introduce a dimension that I was surprised you did not mention! That is, taking care of yourself! By that, I mean taking nutrition seriously for decades, maintaining an ideal weight, and working out regularly at a gym in old age so you never neglect your body's conditioning!! Now in our mid 70s, my wife and I have been "nutritarian" for 15 years. Nutritarian is a diet developed by Dr. Joel Fuhrman based on a 100% plant-based diet, only far more emphasis on nutrient-density at every meal. No added sugar, no animal products, no dairy, no alcohol, no bread, no added oil, no added salt. Just whatever comes naturally in the fruit, vegetables, nuts, grains, mushrooms, seeds, and sprouts (microgreens) that we eat at every meal. We go to our gym for a vigorous 60 to 80 minute resistance workout every 3 days (plus a 60-minute treadmill cardio workout on some off-days). We maintain ideal weight, take no medications, and my local doctor told me that I have the blood pressure of a healthy 18-year-old. MY POINT is that your own discipline over your peak nutrition and physical conditioning will have an enormous impact over your long-term health! We have a guy at our gym at age 95 still working out!! As Dr. Fuhrman says: "Your genes load the gun. But your diet and lifestyle pull the trigger!" As part of our Advantage plan, our gym enrollment is covered. That is \$100 a month savings for both my wife and myself. We do have a local insurance agent, but if we did not I would reach out to this agent with The Retirement Nerds! What an excellent explanation of all the insurance options! So, don't eat junk! Don't sit around in an easy chair drinking beer! Make peak nutrition your most serious hobby. Grow your own sprouts and microgreens like I do. Don't eat canned beans - instead eat beans you cook yourself from dry beans. We eat 18 kinds of beans I cook weekly in a pressure cooker. I plan to make it to 100+ unless I get hit by a truck! (And if that happens, insurance won't matter.) Best wishes!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzq9b4ySEEjBX1HcUh4AaABAg>

↳ @norsemythos1438 (4): "Interesting story. I tend to agree with the concept...but in practice... eating only rabbit food and living to 100? I wonder if im better off enjoying the simple things and dying at 88."

↳ @flyshacker (3): "@norsemythos1438 Your choice! Remember, nearly all the things people call "old age" are really just neglect. Get your cremation and other final expenses paid for, and you're all set! I'll keep exercising, living longer, and I'll collect the gov't benefits you would have received. Fine with me!"

↳ @frankhodge7654 (1): "@flyshacker No matter what you eat, old age effects are very real. We were born with a guarantee of death. No one can live forever except in fantasies. We don't usually know our end date, but we all have one. Rabbit food for life is not a very enjoyable option."

"Thank you soooo much! I'll be 72 in less than 2 months. When approaching 65, I met with an insurance agent that had over 30 years of experience with Medicare. Listened to him and choose regular Medicare, plan G. Have medigap policy with anthem. And it's paid for every medical issue, hospital stays, tests, etc. Is it difficult for me to pay the premiums? Yes because I'm another person who didn't save enough for retirement. I'm managing to make it work. However, a good friend and my step sister have been after me to switch to M Advantage for last few years to save money. And it probably works for some people. But I've had several health issues. I know they mean well, but I'm tired of hearing it! And you just proved my point! My mama raised me on: If it sounds too good to be true, it probably is!!!! Thank God for my incredible parents. My agent told me at 64 exactly what you said. It's difficult to go back to regular Medicare after being on Advantage because of the health exam, pre existing conditions and then the provider doesn't want to sign you up and you're screwed. I hope a lot of people who are in their early 60's sees your video or has a good agent like I do, before they choose their Medicare plan. Bravo! Thank you! And God bless you! 🙌🙌🙌🙌❤️❤️❤️😎😎😎👤👤👤🙏🙏🙏"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgxdqBtHEeLV2ikHP-N4AaABAg>

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MAdvantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to delivery the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @martagarland1783 (3): "The G supplement pays the hospital bills!"

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"I went with the HDG plan, my agent who is a friend wasn't offering it but agreed it was the best fit for my wife and I and he contacted the insurer and handled it for us. We are 3 years in without any health issues and have saved about 6K in G premiums so moving forward we could have several years with large medical expenses and still be ahead of the game."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=Ugzs_Ta08W530jcH1VI4AaABAg

↳ @billjones4986 (5): "As a senior your in good health until your not,things could change quickly."

↳ @bugsy2902 (1): "@billjones4986 Looking at the increase of premiums of G or N over the years and being trapped by medical underwriting this seems the only solution for many seniors on a fixed income. I know that I can't pay hundreds of dollars a month for a medigap plan plus another couple hundred for Medicare plus potentially 2K plus Part D drugs on a fixed income. And I don't want to be in a Disadvantage plan with MOOP of \$9K while they delay and deny care! I was so looking forward to Medicare and not having to fight for care till I saw how outrageously expensive it is. How many times I've had to fight calling the state Ins Commissioner and Dept of Labor to get my bills paid even HR! And I know many others don't bother and just pay what they shouldn't have to or let it go to collections because of the corrupt insurance mafia in America! I'm on Obamacare and had my first preventative colonoscopy 100% free but Anthem tried to stick me with \$6K from the hospital! After a month of fighting to finally get a resolution billing rep in US she finally fixes the hospital bill but tries to leave me to pay \$2k out of network anesthesia bill! She only fixed it when I threatened to file a complaint with Senator Tammy Baldwin and also the No Surprises Website! I never expected to have to fight like that for what is federal mandated as FREE!"

↳ @paulmarc-aurele5508 (0): "@billjones4986I you are certainly right but with HDG your maximum deductible would be \$2400 more than a G plan other than that the same.. in our first 3 trouble free years we have save about 7K in premiums."

"So far I haven't paid any excess charges on my plan N. The broker I used for me a \$0 drug plan so I'm happy with this plan."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=Ugx6leloy6y4iqccDFJ4AaABAg>

↳ @pinkfreud62 (2): "Ohio forbids excess charges. Some other states do, too."

↳ @Reed-2big (0): "Tricare at one time had the excess rule too. Even with the 15% some doctors still getting what they really wanted to accept."

"I have just signed up for Medicare and went with the advantage plan. My agent went through everything with me including the fact that I rarely go to doctors. He suggested that the advantage plan seemed to be the best fit for me. He also warned me that if I change my mind next year and want a supplement plan instead then it may have to go through underwriting before I am approved for it. If I had unlimited funds, I would have gone with a supplement but unfortunately when you go on social security, your income goes down not up. I did also take an extra cancer plan that would cover any out-of-pocket expenses for the current year that I use it. I think the agent I had did a great job explaining everything to me. He even read and explained every line of the plan I was signing up for before I signed anything. I think the best thing and most important thing you can do is to have a good agent to help you. Btw, I think your videos are the best I've ever seen! Here's the animal, I watched everything! 🦒 "

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCOrHIJenu2qzwdXZ4AaABAg>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (11): "Flo, unfortunately your agent was looking out for his best interests since there is no "advantage" to the agent when you sign up for Medicare. Advantage Plans are back end loaded. U save initially because let's face it, why would anyone pay the same for an inferior product. The advantage plans costs will catch up with you later in life when you can least afford it. Even more alarming will be the quality of care provided later in life with the Advantage plans. Managed Healthcare is ignoring elderly seniors needs and literally allowing thousands to die every year in the US. I've witnessed it first hand with elderly family members and friends who can't get appointments with specialists and necessary tests and care in a timely manner. Stay healthy and you will be fine and save money. Very few of us are able to do it. The odds aren't in our favor."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "@kimdiedrich9712 correct. Premiums for supplement plan carriers are in addition to Medicare Part B premiums, and with a Plan G, you still have the Medicare Part B deductible (\$240 in 2024). However, with a supplement plan G, you don't need to pay the Part A deductible. The supplement plan takes care of that."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (4): "Sounds like your agent did a great job, which makes us so happy! Thank you for sharing your experience and watching (especially to the end) 😊 "

"Fired from my medicare advantage job After getting my 215 license I started working at an agency that sells mapd, supplement, and hospital indemnity plans. Things were going great compared to fast food jobs I started making 1k+ a week and I wasn't even closing yet. Things started going down hill when I started closing my own deals after the agency bought me a few states. Aep was over and during oep I noticed the callers became increasingly hard to deal with. Most of them were only calling about a flex card, some of them didn't want to switch providers, while others stayed on the line just to curse me out and ask to be under the do not call list. I tried my best to close more deals and had no idea how other agents were even managing 5 deals a day compared to the calls I was receiving. Eventually I got called in the office and they decided to let me go. My question is where should I go from here? This is the first job I got fired from and I still have my license so I should be able to find a new job but now my confidence is at an all time low. What if I get fired again? Idk"

— r/InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srg5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/

↳ ThatWideLife (28): "Main reason I got out of Medicare. I had nightmares about those garbage food/flex cards. I would have people literally cussing me out to get a \$10 increase in their welfare, I give them what they ask and then they say "Its not worth it for such a little increase." I had a soft spot for elderly people, not anymore, they are some major A-holes."

↳ afrojoee824 (7): "5 deals a day is high unless they're doing shady things and selecting SEP's that are not valid. In other words, they're not compliant. I'm an independent agent and do inbound calls too and having 2-3 sales in a day is an awesome day for me. so two scenarios is what I'm gathering here; your co-workers were burning through calls and hanging up on people they couldn't service. and those who they could service, they're non compliantly selecting SEPS"

↳ Extra_Necessary9512 (5): "How did you start sales for a law firm? It's a niche I'm trying to break into"

"I'm 73, had plan g since the beginning, been healthy, disappointed that my premium went up to 268 a month, thinking of switching to advantage plan. And I'm disappointed that my agent didn't help me understand about Medicare part D, which I did not sign up for, and now I have to pay penalties from now on. I am in Texas, and I hope I have a memory like an ELEPHANT for all that you have explained."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=Ugx1SAL00qKcb-uYy2t4AaABAg>

"Thank you. I just met with a Medicare broker yesterday. He tried to tell me original Medicare with a supplement required pre authorizations just like advantage plans and he didn't know of any of his clients who had delayed or denied procedures. I said I had to review the plans before making a decision. But what I did is make an appointment with a different Medicare agent"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugw4aqKwlwxaQTzZ4nd4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Of course, you could call us. That is what we do for a living. I can assure you, I have more experience and knowledge than any local broker you can find. <https://medigapseminars.org/contact-us/> 800-847-9680 Even more, my team is trained to help you after the sale when you may have issues with billing or whatever can come up between your doctor and Medicare."

↳ @californiaslastgasp6847 (1): "Wow, what a liar. Did you confront him?"

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMp4AaABAg>

↳ @paulaberstler4449 (4): "I also have Original and AARP medigap plan. More than a year of cancer treatments and NO charges other than Medicare B deductible (\$283). I never considered an Advantage plan. (I am in remission.)"

↳ @anthonykobiec8569 (1): "My doctor had the broker come in, and ALL he tried to sell me was Advantage plans. He tried telling me that it what people were interested in. It is what they make the MOST money on because the Insurance companies PUSH you towards a profit driven model."

↳ @sweetds1 (1): "How much do you have to pay monthly?"

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"Our role as agents is to give correct and accurate information, there are some people who just can't afford a Medicare Supplement, I have seen people whose income is under \$1000 a month and they are so thankful to have Medicare Advantage special needs plan. I believe once an agent explain both options (the pros and the cons) allowing the customer to choose what best fits their situation; the job has been completed."

— YouTube · Medicare Experts HATE Advantage Plans! Are they really THAT bad? 😬 · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9D3l-X5q5Oc&lc=Ugze8Qr04SUXHn6mqjp4AaABAg>

↳ @wendyjohns4667 (1): "If their income is that low then they would qualify for extra help. That's why it is important to go to a qualified agent who looks at each individual's situation. Why we listen to these videos from experts like Medicare school! 😊 "

↳ @Jody-kt9ev (1): "Just read that Medicare Advantage plans cost CMS \$321 more per person than regular Medicare. If Medicare Advantage was terminated, possible the savings could be used to assist lower income families in paying for a supplement plan. Regular Medicare with supplement is far better coverage than any Medicare Advantage plan."

↳ @janetrogers4738 (1): "Yes but they need to explain agents get more of a commission if they sell the advantage plans"

"When we first got on medicare we got a part G for 150 for me and 175 (and it went up every year after 3 years was paying over 225) for my husband a month plus RX another 50 for both and app \$5 per RX (another 20 a month plus and one time). Yearly just under \$6000 even if we never see a doctor. We are now on an advantage plan 0 per month RX 0. Last year my husband started bleeding internally...was taken to the hospital by ambulance spent 15 hours in ER given 5 liters of blood 5 days in hospital and given more test than I can count...total cost 225!!! Out of pocket for the 2 of us last year was right around 1100. Our plan does cover dr all over the US. We pay 0 for our RX and 0 to see our pc doctor and 20 to see a specialist. And we get over the counter ...cold , pain reliver ect... of 50 a month. Our doctors are great and I really do feel we have much better coverage than when I was working and paying insurance. We had part G for almost 5 years because we didn't know better and our agent use the same scare tactic on us. Been on Kelsey Advantage for 3 years and it is great. AND NO WAITING IN DOCTORS OFFICES!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxDmm3wFeiHTEwsAYZ4AaABAg>

↳ @virginiamoss7045 (0): "No waiting? I do not believe that. Wait times even for appointments is weeks to months. I've never seen a doctor without waiting up front or, worse, in an exam room. Never."

↳ @pamelaconaty6878 (0): "@craigharris702 great...thank you!"

↳ @pamelaconaty6878 (0): "@virginiamoss7045 We are still on KCA and still love it. It could take weeks to get an appointment for routine appointments but emergency right away. They even have Home visits for just \$25 (not the once a year wellness exam that most plans do) if you feel to sick to go in that usually takes 24-48 to see, video anointment within 2hours and only 20 to go to urgent care. We do a lot of traveling and have used it in most part of the country (to be honest most parts are Oh NJ and FL are the only states we had to use it) with no problems. I'm sure my plan is NOT the only one out there. When looking start with 5star plans in your state."

YouTube channels, seminars and their own research · 158 documents · 20 voices

"I won't be 65 until June 2024, but have been doing a lot of research about this topic. I have watched several videos by others that explained the difference between the 2 ways to go, but had yet to find one that I felt comfortable passing on to my other 64 year old friends. My search has ended. Yours is the most even-handed, non-emotional one out there. You aren't just parroting the biased views of others."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 485 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAg>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (51): ""Better than nothing" until you develop a serious medical issue and start racking up denial of service for treatments that your doctor orders. A lot of health groups are no longer taking "Disadvantage Plans" for this reason. Their liabilities increase exponentially due to the sub par treatment they are limited by MA plans. It's becoming a huge issue in many areas. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these plans. Medicare Advantage isn't medicare.... It's privatized insurance that the companies are making double the profits vs Medigap plans. It's by far the biggest scam of all. The government is paying between \$1200 to \$1800 monthly per person on these plans. Guess whos supplementing this waste. Those of us on regular Medicare."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (22): "This means a lot! Thank you so much for taking the time to watch and share! 🐦 "

↳ @robertporter6659 (6): "Spike has given you 2 barks out of 3 , for your good work. 🐕 "

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/>

↳ (0): "Counterpoint: if you are a literate adult that knows how to use a plan compare tool, you don't need an agent"

↳ (0): "The medicare.gov search tool actually does give the pricing model used for each result."

↳ (0): "If you're a literal adult and can read a law book, you don't need a lawyer and can do it yourself."

"Outstanding video! I have participated in several Medicare seminars, and I will tell you that no one compared Plans G and N like you just did. Very helpful!"

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · 35 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=UgyY1VZUNOmbsPWsrud4AaABAg>

↳ @GiardiniMedicare (2): "Thanks for watching and thank you for the feedback!"

↳ @tioswift3676 (0): "Probably because no one has 30 minutes to waste at Medicare seminar to just go over plan g and n alone. They usually cover Medicare broadly"

↳ @clifforddavis5483 (0): "@tioswift3676 , Have a good day!"

"Turquoise!!! Your vids are awesome. I just turned 65; my role as a fed contractor is ending May 31 (role being eliminated). Surprise! I was planning on retiring end of this year, but things happen. So although I went on Part A this March, I just signed up for Part B and an N plan effective June 1. I could NOT have done this confidently without your channel/content. Even if my company offers me a new FT role on a different contract (highly likely), I think I am going to turn them down and see if they have any PT or contract gigs I can do that will keep me below the SS max income levels. I am blessed to have healthy SS income and can live off that and short-term savings for the rest of this year - probably even longer - and not touch a dime of my retirement yet. NO worries - I will like and stay subscribed forever - the algorithm is with you!"

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 24 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgyfTu5GD_kHcqEsZ3p4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "Appreciate you so much 🙏 So glad to know we have been helpful and thank you for sharing your experience! 💎 - closest to turquoise I could find 😊 "

"OMG! Thank YOU! SO MUCH! I am turning 65 in 3 weeks - I had thought to myself UGH! I am never going on Medicare (I own a highly profitable company, without any plans of retiring, I just love too much what I do) I was resigned to, was happy to, can easily afford to, continue paying \$900+ (in NY) a month for my insurance - IF you hadn't told me that after 1 year I would have to undergo underwriting (not that I have any medical issues - Today, that is....) Your Video, I think it's fair to say - you've saved the rest of my Healthcare Medicare Life! (LOL!) Truly, I am SO very grateful to you for this invaluable info!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 24 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzlcot7XJbOiGBGEZN4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (9): "Thank you so much for reaching out! I'm really glad the information was helpful to you. One important caveat with medical underwriting is that in New York, Connecticut, Maine, and Massachusetts, underwriting doesn't apply at all — but in most other states it does. In the video, I wanted to keep the focus on the bigger picture rather than breaking down each state individually, since that would have taken quite a while. I hope this clears things up and makes sense!"

↳ @mkneely4539 (6): "If you don't sign up you will have to pay a penalty."

↳ @harleygirl795able (0): "@mkneely4539unless you are still working! Once you retire, you have a limited amount of time to sign up before the penalty kicks in."

"My sister will be turning 65 later this year and I have been suggesting that she watch your videos to learn the lingo of Medicare and her options for enrollment. You do a really great job."

— YouTube · What is Medicare Advantage? Medicare Advantage Plans Explained · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eRoWOPDW8DY&lc=UgxKrOrlf_X6Ox3tYaN4AaABAg

↳ @youngtimer964 (7): "Totally agree with you. I have watched a lot of different videos and Stephanie's simple/logical approach is second to none."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (3): "@youngtimer964 Thank you!!"

↳ @eddyvideostar (1): "To Red Oscar: Good looking out for your sister and I bid you and her the best. Keep binge-watching these videos to perspectively retain every insurance nuances and parlance possible. -----¶----
--- There is also a timeline aspect of life where the "Medicare young" are ready to roll, but need to consider possible -- and inevitable rocky outcomes down the road. She may not want to over-insure now -- when she may need to "premium splurge" later."

"Matthew, I watched many the videos you have made and am very happy with the supplement plan your team helped me with when I retired earlier this year. I no longer worry about coverage and the choices I have that the plan allows. Most of my friends opted for advantage plans and they have no clue of the shortcomings that their plans have so I forward your videos so they can be educated like I am now from your complete and easy to understand videos. Thank you again! Michael"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugz0w8k5IZqJSnvw85d4AaABAg>

↳ @kellyx57 (2): "I agree completely! I'm so glad I requested a quote for my wife recently, and that you reached out to us personally and debunked some of the inaccurate info we had already received from a retiree trust that we were planning to use. I'm very happy with the supplement plan that you and your staff helped us choose, and I'm looking forward to doing it again when I turn 65 next year. Thanks Matthew!"

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "@kellyx57 Thank you."

"Who, What, Where Thank you for clarifying Medicare vs advantage plans. I'm 88 and have had an Advantage plan for quite a few years. I wasn't aware that United Healthcare was dropping some of their plans. I haven't received a notice from them that they are dropping mine, but I will check to be sure. With SSA my only source of income, reasonable cost and maximum coverage is very important. My cat and I watched the whole video, although he slept through most of it. He wasn't interested anyway because Medicare doesn't cover veterinarians."

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKCnbXw-M&lc=UgzH9JdhblOqeKilnot4AaABAg>

"I've been on original Medicare since 2021. After watching your video, I understand more now than ever before about Supplement Plans. (I also watched the video on Advantage Plans.) So glad you popped up on my YouTube feed. Great informational videos! Thank you. 🙌"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgxZTFHxAMEN6y_mzlt4AaABAg

"Thank you for explaining this. When I get mailings soliciting my participation in a medical insurance plan, it's ALWAYS for an advantage plan. Until I watched your video, I didn't know why there are so many advantage plans looking to hook me up. They talk about free gym membership, vision and hearing test coverage...all kinds of tempting offerings. But I suspected, and your video confirmed this, there is big money to be made by companies offering advantage plans. Money for them, not medical coverage for me. I just toss these mailings. I have a Medicare Supplement plan, and I'm keeping it!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyZjY-LBhqJi3DjwOF4AaABAg>

↳ @EXPLOREWITHME. (1): "Do we get prescription and dental with original Medicare?"

↳ @janetbetts5159 (0): "@EXPLOREWITHME.NO.....Medicare does not pay for prescriptions or provide dental."

↳ @Jkaye13 (0): "@EXPLOREWITHME. No, part D needs to be added on for your drug coverage"

"I have been following and watching your YouTube videos for several months now and I have learned a great deal doing so. Your presentations are very clear, extremely informative and I feel your honesty every time, whether you're talking about Advantage or Supplemental plans. Your honesty inspires trust and I truly appreciate that, thank you! I still have many questions regarding my own situation before I begin walking through the Medicare maze, so I'll be sure to contact your team for further guidance. Also, thank you for addressing the white elephant in the room!.."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwF19SiDGJg0eUgtWI4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Thank you so much! Your comment really means a lot as you stated exactly what we're hoping to be. And the elephant appreciates the attention 🐘 We'd be honored to help when the time comes."

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMp4AaABAg>

↳ @paulaberstler4449 (4): "I also have Original and AARP medigap plan. More than a year of cancer treatments and NO charges other than Medicare B deductible (\$283). I never considered an Advantage plan. (I am in remission.)"

↳ @anthonykobiec8569 (1): "My doctor had the broker come in, and ALL he tried to sell me was Advantage plans. He tried telling me that it was what people were interested in. It is what they make the MOST money on because the Insurance companies PUSH you towards a profit driven model."

↳ @sweetds1 (1): "How much do you have to pay monthly?"

"Very good, informative video on this horribly complicated subject of deciding on a Medicare Plan. I have watched a few Medicare videos and really liked your unbiased explanations! Now, I can go back to my cat nap after all this thinking!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugyn_GEAgMY12VJu2kl4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching Barb! So glad it was helpful, and I could use a nap as well :) 🐱 "

"I have watched your channel Medicare Specialist and the Medicare School channel! It is ridiculous how complex it is. I have learned from watching you guys all about the timelines and various choices!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1IpLq6moM&lc=UgwDqiET2xQUpfEJBxV4AaABAq>

↳ @LeeCountySpeedShop (0): "It is not complicated at all. I did this myself, I chose to go with original medicare and Plan G and picked a Plan D drug plan. What you need to look at is the fact as we all age the majority of us will need more medical care with that aging. To many people think because they feel good when they first sign up for medicare that they can pick an advantage plan if when they get sick they will just switch over to original medicare and a Plan G and a Pan D drug plan, but that is not how it works, first you will have to under go a medical underwriting and because you are now sick you will more than likely be denied for original medicare with a Plan G. Choose smarty from the start, yes original Medicare and Plan G along with Plan D Drug will cost you more than an Advantage plan but the truth is Original Medicare with a Plan G is far better medical coverage in the end with the smallest out of pocket expense. Mine this year is \$283 dollars out of pocket."

"I am so grateful for all the Medicare insurance experts that I watched on YouTube before I turned 65. I was already a widow on Social Security widow's benefit and I needed to make the right choice the first time. And, thankfully, I chose the Supplement/Medigap option. No, I don't have vision or dental, but I know that I have a plan that cannot drop me if I should ever need major medical. Thank you!!!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwTkKJ5br_m-4bpH_d4AaABAq

↳ @lou2632-i5x (0): "Advantage plans don't pay much in dental benefits besides if you need dental procedures it's never covered and end up paying cash any ways😂 "

"I was in a unique situation because I got Medicare at age 64 due to disability. I chose a Medicare Advantage plan (Anthem). I had 2 surgeries, another procedure at the hospital that required general anesthesia and a lot of hospital based tests plus I am on several RX's. I paid nothing up front but by the end of the year, I had paid over \$5000 in co-pays etc not counting RX copays. Plus it was a pain to followup on bills they disallowed. Thank goodness I found out I could change back to regular Medicare with a supplement at age 65 with no underwriter requirement or extra costs. This year has been a breeze compared to last year! I have had one surgery that required numerous trips to a wound care doctor specialist, an ER visit, starting PT and stopping PT several times, lots of expensive RX's, etc. I am going to have another major surgery next month too and know I will need one or 2 more next year. My uncovered medical costs out of pocket have been \$150 for this year for a specialized medical device that Medicare will not cover. My RX cost have been a lot less too. The nice thing is I can go to any doctor that accepts Medicare!!! My first surgery this year was done in a Bon Secour hospital and the next surgery will be in a Riverside hospital. All covered!!!! I can research and find the best doctors in my area and not be restricted to one group. I also travel so no worried about being out of network. Last year while out of state, I ended up with a simple eye infection and it cost me over \$250 for the doctor visit and RX that was not covered out of network. Yes, I pay extra but at \$190.29 a month (supplement policy, a drug plan and a dental plan) I am still way ahead of last year. I need to say I got a high end drug plan because it equals less out of pocket for my drugs over the year. I also chose to do a dental plan with the dentist I have used for over 30 years at \$29 a month. The Anthem plan only had dentist an hour away from me. I get my glasses at Costco or Sams so the cost is reasonable so no insurance needed. So $\$190.29 \times 12 = \2283.48 for the year.....a lot less than the over \$5000 from last year. Even if I add the \$150 that none of the insurances would cover I am less than the \$5000! I am a retired math teacher so the numbers are my thing and I researched a lot of plans before I chose the right supplement plan for me. After months of searching I picked Mutual of Omaha for me. Then when I was almost confident in my research I stumbled on a EXCELLENT group that does it all for you and even helps you if problems come up. BOOMER BENEFITS. They were wonderful even months later when there was an issue with my drug plan. I was always informed during the process. I even did not have to run the figures to find the best drug plan, I just sent them a list of my regular RX's. Save yourself a lot of work and money and call them. No, I am not a rep or am I paid to say this. Just someone who put a lot of time and effort to get the best cost plan for myself only to find a free phone call could have saved me A LOT of time and work. And yes they do advise you on the Advantage plans if that is what you want. They take the time to find THE best plan for their clients and it is all FREE!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgzB3E8lInNx0KYQAzh4AaABAq>

↳ @keilana6 (1): "Great if you have the income to afford the supplement. But why have Medicare coverage for only those who have been able to save thousands of \$ for premiums? System needs to work for all income levels."

↳ @jdenino6022 (0): "If you live in NY State the rules for going onto a supplemental plan after an Advantage plan are different than most other states."

"Friends told my wife and I about IRMAA two nights ago at a dinner party as we discussed our upcoming retirements. I had no idea what this was so I did not include this expense in my retirement budget. While I don't relish the idea of having to pay this Medicare fee, at least I know enough now to plan for this as we get ready to retire. Thank you for explaining this subject in such a clear way, I really appreciate you taking the time to create this content. If only the rest of the stuff put on the Internet was so helpful... I have liked this video and subscribed to your channel and I look forward to learning much more about managing our finances with your help.

Sincerely, Matt W."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=Ugxzh_R-lbro0n07ylh4AaABAg

↳ @timtorkelson7201 (0): "She and here channel are very good! Easy listen/learn too! 🙌🙌🙌"

"Everyone turning 65 soon and facing this decision should watch this video. It is the best explanation I have seen, and I watched a LOT of videos! I reached Medicare eligibility 2 years ago, and the obvious choice for me was a Medigap plan. I budget for the \$200 monthly premiums, and I feel that health care services are an "all-you-can-eat buffet" The hassles and delays I see my friends dealing with are impacting their health! If you are in a fight for your life with cancer or major heart episode, you are NOT going to want to wade through the mud to get the care you need. Thanks for your great work."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxcBzA_IMdJVACVxRZ4AaABAg

"Excellent video! I have watched several videos on YouTube explaining Medicare and supplemental plans. This is by far the best and clearest video I have watched! Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=UgxyLv3Y1sK3JZ_ZHRt4AaABAg

VA, TRICARE and federal retiree coverage · 156 documents · 20 voices

"Great video! I retired from the civilian sector at 62. We have Tricare from when I retired from the military at age 42, this covers my family as well, so I never had to have any other health insurance while I worked. I also have VA disability, so I use a combination of both. I turned 65 this year so I have Medicare and Tricare for Life now, but my wife is younger than me and is still on Tricare Prime."

— YouTube · 8 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirement - All You Need To Know · 221 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiX777fTzzU&lc=Ugy_GwUf1EpCVF7geHF4AaABAg

↳ @TheUnRetired (0): "That's great! thanks for sharing"

"I'm retired military. In order to keep my Tricare insurance, I have to get Medicare at 65."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugypk4LJ0FVOrAlkurl4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (16): "Correct! Don't let anyone talk you into dropping Tricare. It is amazing."

↳ @saraw8503 (13): "Same. I pay for Medicare, but Tricare for life is free. Hooray!"

↳ @clwest3538 (5): "Tricare told my dad that as long as he was working and covered by insurance he didn't need to sign up for Medicare at 65 - he worked until 70. Then when he signed up for Medicare, Medicare penalized him for not getting it early - even though he had full company insurance (large company). Left hand doesn't know what the right hand is doing or what is the law/regulations which cause 'normal' people to have to overpay."

"I turn 65 in January 2026 and I chose plan N and I live in a very expensive area (Northern Va.) and will only pay \$87 and the Part B so about total \$294 a month so I'm pretty happy. And I also purchased a zero payment part D premium. I don't go to the doctor much so not worried about \$20 copay visit."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg.AODI8bYlzmOAOE-L9QNWYq>

"As a retired Fed, I kept my Federal Employee Health Care plan to supplement Medicare for my wife and me. We are in our early 70s and we spend about \$1000.00 a month for Medicare, health, prescriptions and dental coverage which is pricey. However, we see the best doctors we can find and make our own health care decisions. We have had 3 major back surgeries, a shoulder replacement surgery, a hip replacement surgery, 2 Carpal tunnel surgeries, cataract surgery, and a heart attack scare all with zero additional out of pocket expenses. I will pay whatever it takes to not be in "managed" care."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwpYf9xGADzU9o1T654AaABAg>

↳ @martygraw9708 (2): "I'm also on FEHB and another big advantage is not having to worry about IRMAA"

↳ @TAM-bv2di (0): "@martygraw9708 Good for you both, and you're welcome! As a regular payer of IRMAA, I'm glad you're enjoying the benefit of that rip-off that regular payees into the system - not the special endowments that you and politicians receive, have to go endure. I don't begrudge you your self-congratulations, since I'm certain I've achieved much greater wealth than you working for actual value-added enterprises during my life!"

↳ @BrendaKennedy-l5q (0): "@martygraw9708 why is that? Curious because i am older, but I may be getting a fed job and would give up my state employment insurance (which would turn into an advantage plan at 65)."

"Which is exactly why I chose original Medicare and kept my FEHB plan as my supplement."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pg6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxeeXBBjCcQMNX7jGp4AaABAg.AMSJ6njcv7zAMTQzdDpoD6>

"Same. I pay for Medicare, but Tricare for life is free. Hooray!"

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgyPk4LJ0FVOrAlkurl4AaABAg.A2uxfjqcMDMA38YLjJsvTG>

"I called CHAPTER Approximately a month ago spoke to a representative. Told the representative that I'm retired military with Tricare for life that I use in conjunction with Medicare part A, and part B. I asked the representative Is there anything better, and without hesitation, he told me there wasn't and to stick with what I have. Can't go wrong with that."

— YouTube · IT KEEPS HAPPENING I ANOTHER Medicare Advantage Company Cancels ALL Plans · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j2ENvE0j1gc&lc=UgxSlc_tUbP0YBpAK614AaABAg

"When I turn 65 I have to get Medicare part A & B so I get Tricare for Life."

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=211IpLq6moM&lc=Ugzfl22y5xABIP43vax4AaABAg>

"I was on the F plan but gave it up because I went to an advantage plan because I gained \$600 per month.that's every month! I also have 100% VA coverage. Unfortunately I think our medical in this country is pathetic. I believe that because of what COVID exposed of our so called healthcare system. Big fail in my view. I have also had some bad experiences with being able to find a good doctor. I had a knee replacement that turned out to be much more complicated than it should have been. I got cellulitis from the surgery and seemed to me like Drs were more focused on my not having gotten it from anything they did than taking care of my needs! When asked I gave the hospital and dr a bad review. After that I stopped being contacted.! Great patient care don't you think!"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans for 2027 — What's Changed? · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hAZ_geBw1Ac&lc=UgwkHKiAkqnu9hYOrEt4AaABAg

"i am glad i went with Medicare part a part b plan N and VA health care and a tiny part d"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=Ugz7aAfpnSHwj3_Ga3Z4AaABAg

"Sunburn - I am a 70 year old Medicare Insurance Broker. This really helps me in my presentation, and my own personal plan. As a Retired Veteran, I use Tricare for Life or the VA for my medication (not on any yet), and this allows me to use a Medicare Advantage giveback plan, where I save another \$120 or more off on my Part B."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugy1g6TYsutm3W1LlxN4AaABAg>

↳ @Wogger1 (1): "Does the VA ever deny care like advantage plan administration people do?? I bet not."

"You say the same things I have been telling people for years. I have worked for doctors for 30 years before I retired. I told everyone that would listen that I stayed with original Medicare because I could do what I wanted to when I wanted to and see who I wanted to see. I have Medicare and Tricare for Life. When I worked with doctors I did the back office. Referrals, authorization and posted checks. I saw what Medicare advantage plans I did not want. One advantage plan would pay right away but then come back and take part of the money back. What a mess for our books. I learned early not to switch to a Advantage plan. These advantage plans also promise a lot of things but when most of the people switch over from original Medicare they will not offer you anything as a deal to switch. Patients also do not seem to understand everything has to be approved by these plans before surgery is done. They also do not understand that the 20% that Medicare makes you pay is a lot less than the \$30 or \$50 copays. Patients never wanted to pay the copays to the heart surgeon I worked for. Thanks for validation."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugz3kz-clhcicSwjHxV4AaABAq>

↳ @rcastle8993 (1): "Gloria O ,thanku for ur insight. It's very helpful to me as u back this gentleman's explanation. I was fortunate To come across this verrrry informative video after 20yrs of muddling through it all almost never getting nearly as much clarity as this video gave! Thank God i have always felt this way towards the whole mystery of it all and kept with org.medicare even with my dads persuasion to go with a plan. Thnx again"

↳ @mariebrooks7341 (1): "They say that you get money back in your social security check. Yeah, that the 30 and 50 dollar copays when you go to the doctor. There's no free money coming back to you in that social security check. I didn't feel comfortable with that medicare advantage and had it for one night, switched back the next morning before it was in the system."

"Yep me too. Retired at 61 and because our MAGI is low I get generous subsidies. My husband has free care through the VA any we have enough after tax cash to supplement social security until I'm eligible for Medicare."

— r/obamacare · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1woyyo6/for_people_retiring_before_65_how_are_you/pbu62oc/

"because you have the other options that many don't. We have Tricare and it will work with Medicare and no costs except. Part B, but others don't have this. Blessed."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugy1yIMa9_gSV6PJJaY14AaABAq.ANOnRfp-7vsAO9KdrhFkym

"I got va community care 2 years ago and dropped my part B and have only got part A and don't have to pay the \$ 202.00 a month, I am 70 years old and"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugx67djChB5lK_UjwEB4AaABAg

↳ @karlnordinger5968 (0): "For care outside of VA system without prior authorization keep Medicare part B . VA is funded annually by Congress and depending on priority group there is no guarantee everyone enrolled in VA healthcare will get care . VA strongly encourages veterans to keep Medicare parts A & B. I have a 100% P/T disability rating and am in Tier 1 which includes all medical , dental , prescriptions and long term care at no cost to me but still pay for Medicare part B because " you don't know what you don't know . ""

↳ @LarryDerryberry-j3b (0): "@karlnordinger5968depends on what you are getting your care under, I have community care which lets my primary doctor in my home town make all my medical decisions not va doctors"

"Hi Erik, I turn 65 in August of this year. I currently get the majority of my medical from the VA. I had my wife get original Medicare with a plan G supplement last year since she's a little older than me. Her supplement for my zip is currently around \$96.00 a month. If I got the same one, mine would be \$101.00. With that being said, I was thinking of getting original medicare plus the supplement in case I want to go outside the VA or they change the way they cover veterans in the future. I have heard and talked with some that says a MA plan would work better for me because I could get a reduction of my part B premium since the VA drug plan is considered a covered plan, although as far as I know it only would cover prescriptions that the VA prescribed. I get all the cost savings of the MA plans, but if I can afford original MC, would it be the best option in the long term even though I can, and do go to the VA. I have past heart issues, and I wonder just how long the VA will continue covering veterans with ratings under 30%. I'm service connected for my back but only at 10%, and 10% for tennitius. With my past heart issues I would also hate to get on a cheaper MA plan, only to possibly need more in the future. Thanks, enjoyed your video."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCl8m0OI18&lc=Ugww1g7o9cFBj1kGj3R4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "Hi Tim, appreciate you watching! It's an interesting conversation and the details around your VA coverage are important. Happy to help in any way we can. My email is erik@90daysfromretirement.com. your zip code will make a difference. Yes, most with VA coverage go to the VA as much as possible and grab an MA plan for cost reasons, but we can look into options. Appreciate you!"

"Great video, a lot of good information. As for me, I will be turning 65 this month and I will be taking Medicare parts A&B. I'm retired military so I will transition into Tricare for Life and also the Tricare Plus Program, so I will continue to see my Military Primary Care Provider at the Military Clinic. I have VA disability so I use a combination of the VA and Tricare. I get all my medications mailed to me free by the VA and I use the VA eye clinic, they do 2 exams a year and I get new glasses once a year, full dental care, and I also get my CPAP machine and supplies. We chose to retire in an area that has a large Army Hospital, and the VA Hospital Medical Center is just down the road from the Base Hospital. Also, for me it's very convenient that, here in town, the Military Clinic and VA Clinic are actually in the same building."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHAvJauGRrYhXRaG94AaABAg

"Two years ago I was looking at the Advantage plans (fell for the commercials), but when I called and mentioned that I am retired Marine, they informed me that they are prohibited from selling me a program and that I should go to Tricare for Life. Kind of felt like an idiot for not looking into that first. I thought dealing with them would be a hassle, but it has turned out to work quite well for me. I do still have some expenses for drugs, but not massive."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxS1zKTvHLIksV6jcN4AaABAg>

↳ @bellesouth3052 (0): "My husband and I are on Tricare for Life and original Medicare. We still have copays and deductibles but are very satisfied."

"Thank you; solid info! I chose an advantage plan to save \$70/mth. I have free VA, so didn't even want to go on Medicare and pay a premium. I had Tri-Care Prime as a back up to VA, but when I turned 65 they cancelled that, and once I signed up for Part B, I got Tri-Care for Life. I think I'll CanX the Advantage plan while I'm still healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugy7g2x0dwPoQbMH7il4AaABAg>

"I have Medicare part a & b with a supplement plan Which is free Tri-Care-for-Life from being retired military. As a backup I have a 10% VA rating. I HAVE HAD a quad bypass, A TUMOR ON MY pituitary gland, Bladder and Kidney Stone operations and almost no out of pocket expenses. Plus not required to have a In-network doctor or hospital."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgwVzjnYcXoOBF4rPV14AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Tricare For Life is a wonderful benefit to have! Thank you for watching! I hope your health is great!"

High-deductible Plan G · 102 documents · 20 voices

"For a lot of people Medicare at 65 is a blessing. We couldn't wait. My wife had been putting off hip replacement surgery for years due to high deductibles and copays with our employer's plan. On Medicare (and G Supplement) all we paid was the part B deductible of two hundred and some odd dollars! It was life changing for her."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 315 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=Ugw5192ygARS776lv554AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (25): "Agreed! We tried to show this in the middle section. For many, Medicare is better coverage at a lower cost than what they were experiencing before 65 😊 "

↳ @pgpc6448 (12): "So glad! Your wife deserves it!"

↳ @sfstucco (0): "I'm truly sorry to hear about your situation. No one should have to experience these dilemmas & delays. I'm curious — how many, here, in these unfortunate situations vote Red (Republican)? Not to start a fight or pretend to be superior, but I hope people realize that universal coverage/socialized medicine goes a long, long way to relieving these burdens, financially speaking and logistically speaking. It would cut costs SO, so much if we had a Medicare-for-all (i.e., for all who select it) scheme, from birth to death. There are variations that can include some copayments (or not), depending on how it's structured. But expense, experience, and health outcomes are greatly superior in countries with socialized medicine, in all its forms. Democrats want that."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"My Medigap High-Deductible Plan G Analysis *[Edit: The official 2026 HD deductible is* **\$2,950. That's a 2.8% annual increase, which seems pretty much in line with inflation.**]* In case this is useful to others... I ran the numbers on switching to Medigap High-Deductible G (HD-G) for 2026, assuming the HD-G deductible will increase to \$3,000. The numbers would vary by age and ZIP code, but here's a way to run the math: 1. Premiums for my available Plans * **Plan G: \$250/month * HD-G: \$50/month** 2. Maximum Savings (Best Case Scenario) **If I have a healthy year and don't need care beyond what Medicare Part B already covers at no cost: * Plan G annual premium: $250 \times 12 = \$3,000$ * HD-G annual premium: $50 \times 12 = \$600$ * Savings = \$2,400/year** This is my "very healthy year" scenario. 3. Maximum Extra Cost (Worst Case Scenario) **If I have a major medical year and hit the full HD-G deductible: * Out-of-pocket under HD-G = \$3,000 * Minus the \$2,400 in premium savings * Net worst-case cost = \$600 more than if I'd had Plan G** So the most I can lose relative to Plan G is \$600/year. 4. Net Risk This is what makes HD-G attractive to me: *** One healthy year (+\$2,400) * Pays for up to four worst-case years (-\$600 each)** I obviously can't predict my future medical needs, but on average my net cost will fall somewhere between +\$2,400 and -\$600. With two people in our household: *** Max savings: \$4,800/year * Max risk: \$1,200/year** The odds of both of us consistently having worst-case years feels pretty low, so that's a very asymmetric risk profile where the upside heavily outweighs the downside. 5. How HD-G actually works **Many people misunderstand how the HD-G deductible actually works: * After you meet the Part B deductible, Medicare starts paying 80%, just like it normally does. * Because you're only paying 20%, you don't actually hit the HD deductible until and unless you require roughly \$13,000 in total Medicare-approved charges for your annual medical care. One way to look at it: * The HD-G "deductible" is actually a maximum out-of-pocket (MOOP) for Part A + B services. Another way to look at it: * HD-G = You have Original Medicare (A + B) and your premium buys you a \$3,000 MOOP * Plan G = Same coverage but your higher premium buys you a lower MOOP, equal to the Part B deductible (There is no official MOOP for Plan N because you can't accurately predict copays, but it's probably not a big issue for most.)** 6. Bottom Line** For me — with a \$200/month premium difference — HD-G is a no-brainer." — r/medicare · 87 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1owx5kn/>

↳ (0): "Yeah, this is an excellent analysis. I came to the same conclusion but didn't go through as much mathematics. The bit of cash saved monthly could also possibly be invested. Anyway you slice it, GHD is also better than any employer plan I've had"

↳ (0): "Because you're only paying 20%, you don't actually hit the HD deductible until and unless you require roughly \$13,000 in total Medicare-approved charges for your annual medical care."* The other thing to emphasize here is that \$13k is *Medicare approved* charges. I had a procedure recently that was billed at \$1124. But the Medicare approved amount was \$43. Some eye tests by a specialist? Billed at \$763 but Medicare rate? \$197. The point is that \$13,000 in Medicare approved charges is a LOT of care"

↳ (0): "Plus when you pay for services (doctors etc) as part of your deductible, you can pay with your HSA account if you have one. The G plan with no deductible at \$250 per month cant be paid with an HSA. Only medical services, not insurance premiums."

"The more my Plan N increases annually, the more I'm inclined (against my better judgement) to start looking at a Part C Advantage Plan instead. I went with Plan N because I believed in the idea of "Pay me now or pay me later", where I protected myself against high deductibles and annual outlays by paying a (reasonable) monthly premium. Sadly, "Pay me now" is becoming "Pay me a LOT more now, and every year until you die." Also, we need better oversight of these insurers. Offering low costs for a year and then inflating prices once you have attracted a bunch of subscribers should be illegal. Or at least a Medicare plan cost should be guaranteed for a reasonable amount of time. I would be much happier paying more when I sign up, knowing that my premium won't increase to shocking levels for years."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 57 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxVyp4MBD-dEhPeZlh4AaABAg>

↳ @chevelleflorida (8): "To me, if one can afford a medigap/supplemental plan, that is the best option. The biggest issue with Advantage plans is the level of care that you will receive. For example, I know someone who had a heart attack and stroke last year and was referred to a SNF/rehab center. The MA plan was calling within 3 days talking about discharging the patient even though they were not ready to go back home. With traditional Medicare, that person likely would have received 100 days. Fortunately, moving to a SNF, creates a qualifying event to change insurance and we were able to move he patient back to traditional Medicare with a supplemental plan that they already had (Tricare for life.) In truth, the broker who signed them up for a MA plan did them a huge disservice. No one with a Supplemental plan should move to a MA plan."

↳ @Farrodee (5): "In two years my plan G went from 1500 to over 1800 per year. I don't even take any meds and rarely see dr!"

↳ @vanguy9780 (0): "@jaygrenham education is a wonderful thing. You should try it"

"I understand your point about averages. I chose HD-G when I turned 65 and started on original Medicare. Out of pocket expenses have been manageable and in line with my expectations. I'm 70 now. My biggest challenge is the annual premium increases. You showed 2-4% as an average for HD-G. My premium increases the past 3 years were 14%, 20%, and 21%. Combined, the increase was 59% higher than the premium from 3 years ago. I can still pass underwriting and switched companies, which helped some. My overall worry is these type of increases aren't "sustainable" over 15-20 years..."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 54 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzxVpDFzqjIW527Aop4AaABAg>

↳ @dennisdavis4792 (6): "@MrA@MrAndyinbethesda On HDG since the very beginning. Initial premium was \$60.40/mo. I understand it varies widely depending on where you live. Increases the last 3 years are: \$66.54 to \$75.86, then to \$91.15, and now the 2026 increase is to \$105.73. That's ~ 59% over 3 years. Switching companies so won't be paying the \$105.73."

↳ @Geronimo2Fly (2): "@dennisdavis4792 Wow those are SIGNIFICANTLY higher increases than I thought would happen with the HD plan. That's very disappointing. I assume you switched to another HDG?"

↳ @MrAndyinbethesda (1): "Assume you started with a Plan G and not HDG at 65 or your increases would not have been that level?"

"I went with the HDG plan, my agent who is a friend wasn't offering it but agreed it was the best fit for my wife and I and he contacted the insurer and handled it for us. We are 3 years in without any health issues and have saved about 6K in G premiums so moving forward we could have several years with large medical expenses and still be ahead of the game."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=Ugzs_Ta08W530jcH1VI4AaABAg

↳ @billjones4986 (5): "As a senior your in good health until your not,things could change quickly."

↳ @bugsy2902 (1): "@billjones4986 Looking at the increase of premiums of G or N over the years and being trapped by medical underwriting this seems the only solution for many seniors on a fixed income. I know that I can't pay hundreds of dollars a month for a medigap plan plus another couple hundred for Medicare plus potentially 2K plus Part D drugs on a fixed income. And I don't want to be in a Disadvantage plan with MOOP of \$9K while they delay and deny care! I was so looking forward to Medicare and not having to fight for care till I saw how outrageously expensive it is. How many times I've had to fight calling the state Ins Commissioner and Dept of Labor to get my bills paid even HR! And I know many others don't bother and just pay what they shouldn't have to or let it go to collections because of the corrupt insurance mafia in America! I'm on Obamacare and had my first preventative colonoscopy 100% free but Anthem tried to stick me with \$6K from the hospital! After a month of fighting to finally get a resolution billing rep in US she finally fixes the hospital bill but tries to leave me to pay \$2k out of network anesthesia bill! She only fixed it when I threatened to file a complaint with Senator Tammy Baldwin and also the No Surprises Website! I never expected to have to fight like that for what is federal mandated as FREE!"

↳ @paulmarc-aurele5508 (0): "@billjones4986I you are certainly right but with HDG your maximum deductible would be \$2400 more than a G plan other than that the same.. in our first 3 trouble free years we have save about 7K in premiums."

"Very well done. You did your homework. I'm 66 this year. I had to do a LOT of research to decide what was best for me. I agree about choosing for my future me. That said: I have a high deductible G plan in place (55.00 mon) in case I get very sick or have an accident but I spend a couple hundred a month(about what I'd pay for regular G premium 210.00) to take care of my metabolic health the way i want to. I use functional medicine, naturopath, no conventional drugs, acupuncture, massage therapy and supplements that are not covered by Medicare on any level. My husband died at 58 from a liver disease and a transplant. We had an HMO. I refuse to do it that way for myself. It was a chaotic, frustrating and terrifying experience for both of us. I know that if I'm hit with a chronic disease or accident I'll be set. So I chose ease of mind over just dollars. Everyone does it different. My parents have always done an advantage plan"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwDoFtNU8GrgWx3-O94AaABAg>

"Thanks for another great video! I recently switched to a High Deductible Medigap plan. Monthly premium is currently \$67 with an almost \$3,000 out-of-pocket maximum. I'm hoping that it provides the flexibility and predictably that I want with a lower premiums throughout my life. Not too many people choose the High Deductible Medigap plans, but it seems like a good compromise among all the available options."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugx Ct-3YOkOpHjJyLt94AaABAg>

↳ @shirl5953 (6): "YES!!! You found the BONANZA of HDG! Erin did not talk to this but I am hoping she does in her follow up videos!!"

↳ @stevevenn1 (0): "Thx I'm a fan of this kind of choice. A form of mini self insuring just the HD portion. I like that trade off for lower premium."

↳ @scottpearson5871 (0): "If a person has a decently sized (50-100k) HSA this seems to be the best option."

"I retired at 62 and my wife and I went on Obamacare bronze plan. We didn't pay any premiums for three years. We did have a high deductible but I had almost \$40,000 in an HSA to cover the deductible. We got lucky and still had over \$30,000 in the HSA when I hit 65."

— YouTube · 6 Health Insurance Options For Early Retirees · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AGX WM9-zot4&lc=Ugz-rN7NCuc41Pz0dYx4AaABAg>

↳ @jimhandler1129 (2): "How did you not have to pay any premiums for three years? I am 61 years old with over \$70,000 in an HSA still not retired because of health insurance. All sights are asking for specific information including email and phone number. I just want to find out how much it will cost me without being harassed by a salesman."

↳ @HappyonMonday (1): "Wow that's amazing! Good planning! 😊 "

↳ @jimfarmer7811 (0): "@jimhandler1129 Make sure you are going to the official website. It's easy to land on a scammer site. The. Dot gov web site won't pester you with salesperson calling. I kept our premiums at zero by choosing the high deductible bronze HSA plan and keep our annual income below the \$62,000 subsidy limit at the time. We had no debt so it wasn't a problem to live well on that income."

"I enjoyed your presentation and it is very accurate. I worked for Health insurance companies for a couple of decades back when HMO's started. The Advantage plans remind me a lot of how the HMO plans work and if your provider is within their network, you are good, but you must check every year to verify your provider is still in that network. I have been on Medicare for a couple of years and have Plan G with the High Deductible. I have my HSA since I am healthy at 70, except for my accident. Glad you are presenting options since many seniors may not understand the consequences of their decisions."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxiY&lc=UgxjXtWmbEVSU3jhKfB4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching and sharing what you are on!"

"He is selling supplemental so take that with a grain of salt. Supplemental is going to cost you hundreds—maybe a few hundred, maybe many hundreds—a month extra. I have ACA Marketplace insurance with Kaiser Permanente (an excellent healthcare system) which has generally served me well except for the high deductible. About to turn 65 and I can choose a Kaiser Advantage plan that COSTS NOTHING EXTRA, and continue with the same coverage as I had before. No brainer? Pretty much."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwGTCcYJclKFIDKljt4AaABAq>

↳ @maryg1338 (0): "Fortunately you never had to get an authorization for a treatment that your doctor prescribed. I have worked in medical offices and would need to get these authorization. So here I am talking to some kid that was selling bicycles last week, trying to explain why it's necessary. Finally, the doctor would ask for a peer to peer. After waiting sometimes a week to be able speak with the company's doctor and convince him/her, that it is necessary.. (wait time) and often they would make you try different treatments that were less expensive before granting the authorization. Advantage plans do work for some... but, sadly not all"

↳ @kitcatmeowpurr745 (0): "He is telling the truth about Medicare DIS-Advantage ! The proof is that the very BEST (Ivy League) physicians and state of the art, cutting edge hospitals are no longer accepting Medicare DIS-Advantage Plans. UNLESS that Medicare DIS-Advantage Plans are issued from a EMPLOYER'S GROUP Plans (patient's former employer provided medical coverage). Medicare DIS-Advantage Plans have become a NIGHTMARE and ENDLESS approvals, and increasing patient co-payments, and splitting up single visit lab tests into separate charges to force the patient to pay for co-payments for EACH lab test during a single visit ! Also, they are REDUCING the lifetime limit of hospital visits to force patients to go back to straight Medicare. Manage Care plans offer to drive you to doctor's visits, pay your gym membership, and fluff your pillows, BUT HIDE THE FACT THAT THEY ARE REDUCING COVERAGE ON THE MOST EXPENSIVE MEDICAL COSTS, LIKE SURGERIES, HOSPITAL VISITS & REHAB STAYS ! They even offer plans that pay your Medicare Premium, but HIDE the fact that these very plans that return your Medicare Premium, pay for LESS MEDICAL SERVICES ! The ones that claim to pay for your prescriptions will only do so for GENERIC drugs, but refuse to pay for drugs that have no generic option ! Then if your physician prescribes a drug that has no generic, these plans will only pay a "PORTION" of the drug price. But you can get that same non generic expensive prescription FROM CANADA FOR LESS than what the Medicare Advantage Plan is paying ! If you talk to a Medicare Advantage "agent" who helps you to find a plan during open enrollment, give him/her THE ZIP CODE of WHERE you WANT TO RECEIVE MEDICAL TREATMENT. You will find that the BEST PHYSICIANS & HOSPITALS IN THE MOST EXCLUSIVE NEIGHBORHOODS DO NOT ACCEPT MEDICARE ADVANTAGE PLANS !!! UNLESS that Medicare Advantage Plan is issued by the patient's EMPLOYER GROUP POLICY! Then if you give them a zip code from a WORKING CLASS OR POOR NEIGHBORHOOD, YOU WILL FIND LOTS OF PHYSICIANS that WILL accept Medicare Advantage, and also WEEKS TO MONTHS TO GET AN APPT !!! EVEN LONG WAIT TIMES FOR EXISTING PATIENTS !!! Btw, IVY LEAGUE DOCTORS DO NOT WORK FOR KAISER !!! ALSO, RICH PEOPLE NEVER GO TO KAISER, FOR A REASON ! Kaiser IS NOT & NEVER HAS OFFERED, "CADILLAC MEDICAL CARE !" KAISER HAS ENOUGH HORROR STORIES, TO FILL A HALLOWEEN MOVIE THEATER FOR THE NEXT CENTURY ! Rich people, go to Johns-Hopkins, Mayo Clinic, UCLA, Cleveland Clinic, St John's Providence (Santa Monica CA), etc."

↳ @GNick1234 (0): "@kitcatmeowpurr745 I have had Kaiser Permanente for three years. Kaiser is one of the best health organizations in the US. Although my ACA coverage had a fairly high yearly deductible (\$6,000) that's not unusual anymore. Next month I switch to Kaiser's Medicare Advantage plan. The coverage and cost is nearly identical."

"That's amazing. i have high deductible plan G. i wonder if something like that happened to me, whether my plan G would cover everything. I think they would require me to pay the full deductible each year...but, still...that would be a heck of a lot less than 4 million dollars. I hope that your wife is all recovered 🙏 now."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgyYr0IBMVt4x-T6Cil4AaABAg.AXz9ixxBP-gAZRzEnJWvIJ>

"Everything I have read indicates that the Medicare Part B deductible counts toward the Plan G High Deductible out-of-pocket spending requirement before benefits "kick in." Your chart seems to indicate the opposite, though. Can you please clarify?"

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=UgxsaHS4ieZED2UgjB14AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (11): "Yes. That is an error on our end. The Part B deductible DOES count towards the deductible of the High Deductible Plan G."

↳ @slomo4672 (0): "@MedicarePlanFit Another channel says there's an exception: if you paid the entire HDG deductible toward part A before you paid a penny towards part B, then you still have to pay the part B deductible."

"After a year of researching my Medicare options, I chose original Medicare with Plan N. Living in SW Florida, it was a close call between Plans N & High Deductible G, but because of underwriting requirements here, I had to pick the plan that would be best for the long-term. Initially, my HD-G's total costs would be cheaper (if I remain healthy). But after about 10 years, it's likely that my N's total costs would be cheaper as I need more medical services and HD-G's max out-of-pocket would keep getting higher. In the end my decision came down to my concern about HD-G's deductible increasing each year at an unpredictable rate of inflation versus the much more predictable & budgetable N monthly premiums."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyYhExgJdVDH1dnNpp4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (4): "You made a good choice. Pre- 2020 I would have chosen a G-HD myself. But now that inflation is back, it's not a risk I want to take."

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (3): "@robannmateja5000 HDG deductible has gone up 27 percent over 5 years. Having said that most people will not reach that deductible. Remember your paying only 20 percent of Medicare approved charges. Unless you have cancer you simply will not hit that deductible. NY you can switch back and forth so you can play that game. Of course that's why the regular G rates are so high."

↳ @ChrisSadowski10372 (0): "@MedigapSeminarschoose Plan N to avoid high rate increases of plan G, avoid HDG for inflation and EOB issues, avoid advantage plans and pay dental and vision with an HSA to avoid networks and denials."

"In Minnesota plan G is a minimum of \$300/month. I pay under \$60.00 for high deductible planG Minnesota rates are not age dependent. It is the same monthly premium if you are 65 or 90 years old. In addition to this I get \$100 12:46 to 200 back each year. I have blue cross blue shield. Premiums for G plan for an entire year is 12 months• \$300/month = \$3600/year minimum. I pay less than \$600 per year for high deductible G. Therefore I save more than the total high deductible which is about \$2900./ year. When I go to the doctor it is usually less than the N plan to my surprise. I pay about \$15 to 25 for an office visit. This is paid for by my plan B. Blue cross blue shield has the best high deductible for me because it includes gym membership. One of the few that do include gym membership."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=UgyDztX1qJyuyFclyst4AaABAg>

↳ @madisonbullock2337 (3): "How are you getting 100 to 200 dollars back each year? Im also in Minny and I am more than likely going with HDG, my only contemplation is between the N plan \$196 a month BCBS and HDG BCBS at \$56 a month. being on a fixed income Im worried taking a higher tier plan than HDG that in 5 to 10 years you are screwed if the premiums go up at the rate they are now and you cant afford it and then the only option for health insurance without underwriting is MA plan."

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (2): "It's one of the best kept secrets in Medicare!"

"Trust this lady. I have Plan G HD. Last July the wife suffered a TIA and the cost of vascular surgery, etc etc came close to \$190,000.00 dollars. Deductible is \$2,900 with Plan G w United and that is my out of pocket. Lets not even talk about a surgery/ hospital costs of \$191K. Regular Plan G not HD is costly for 2 people..over \$ 500/month + \$412 for Medicare. Right now I pay \$ 412 + about 180 for Plan G HD. Over time we are relatively healthy couple."

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans for 2027 — What's Changed? · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hAZ_geBw1Ac&lc=UgzQX0tuBBJRzZzpO-h4AaABAg

"My husband and I read similar advice to yours when we were researching Medicare options for him last year. We went with a Part G high deductible Medicare supplement plan, and picked a prescription drug coverage plan which had the lowest cost for premiums + prescriptions for the 1 prescription medication he takes, and which also would be accepted by our local CVS. I'll be doing similar research for myself this fall, as I will be on Medicare as of next January."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw1n-j6SsHXRDj1OVZ4AaABAg>

↳ @mutantplants1 (4): "@DOSBoxMom Well, if that's your only choice.... I originally got my Rx's filled at CVS. They made me wait, often till the next day, they were rude, and sometimes gave me the wrong prescription. I heard Walgreen's was just as bad. In fact there is a sign on the wall of one of my doctor's offices which reads: "Walgreen's and CVS rarely carry dermatology related brand prescription medications. If you bring your prescription to Walgreen's or CVS and you have a problem, I will not be able to help you get your medication. These two pharmacies create much unnecessary work even if they dispensed your medication. Please fill your prescriptions at Publix, Target, Walmart, Pill Box, Budget Drugs, Locatel, etc.""

↳ @mutantplants1 (2): "Why would anyone deal with CVS for prescriptions?"

↳ @DOSBoxMom (1): "@mutantplants1 Because they're the only pharmacy in my hometown. I know the office manager at my workplace complains about CVS, because her health insurance used to cover prescriptions via a different pharmacy chain, and she thinks the customer service at the local CVS is inferior."

"My UHC plan N increase 35%. Waiting to be approved for the HDG plan I applied for last week. I can comfortably afford the \$2,950 MOOP if necessary. Future premium rate increases will be much more stable."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgzEYkKNYHYjCOR0th14AaABAg>

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (6): "@McDevitt228 You are wise to avoid a Disadvantage plan. The HDG is a great alternative to Disadvantage plans. View the HDG plan as a MOOP plan (max out of pocket). It protects from a huge financial hit because it caps cost annually. Yes that scenario of end of year healthcare situation rolling into the next year is a possibility. How much ? I dunno. If you drop the supplement keep in mind your MOOP is 20% of all costs with no cap. I personally would not risk the unlimited 20%."

↳ @yeahright532 (3): "That's smart. My plan GHD only increased \$4 in five years. It's now a whopping \$48 a month."

↳ @McDevitt228 (2): "I'm precisely in your position regarding Plan N and also looking hard at HDG, but here's my problem. I can also take the \$2900 hit....ONCE. But if a medical event happens towards the end of the coverage year and rolls into the new coverage year, now we're talking about close to 6K in basically one extended event. It would take me a few years to rebuild my savings and blessings from the good Lord to stay healthy for that long. I'm thinking of dropping the supplement plan altogether and putting the money into a stand alone savings account and role the dice. As little respect as I have for Advantage plans I am not even considering one."

"I have a high deductible supplement, which helps keep costs down in case of some giant unexpected expense, (for which I have set aside a chunk of money in a savings account, just in case.)"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgzsmP--HUMo8ybkKwt4AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (2): "That's a really smart strategy! High deductible supplements can be a great way to keep premiums lower while still protecting yourself from those big, unexpected bills. Having that savings set aside gives you peace of mind and makes the plan work even better for you."

"I ended up with HDG because I live in Florida and couldn't afford the plan N or G yet I have enough tucked away if I have multiple bad years to pay the deductible. I know it is costing me more than the people near me with an Advantage plan that gives back the total part B premium, but I love choosing my doctors and not having to play "mother may I" with an insurance company. Not sure how long I'll be able to afford this route but I'll keep it as long as I can. Having multiple skin cancer surgeries I protect myself from sunburns."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxW5GWmdGQldg9Kf4l4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Very popular choice there in Florida. Thank you so much for watching and sharing your thought process! ☀️"

Kaiser and staying inside one health system · 102 documents · 20 voices

"I came off a supplement to an advantage plan about 5 years ago for two reasons affordability and our good health. We enrolled into a HMO-POS plan for 2026. Of course before the switch we verified all of our providers were still in the plan. Zero premium and \$4800.00 MOP. Which is thousands less than the previous plan. I've saved in premiums over the 5 years over 18K. And wer still healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 888 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgyH9WhhAjCLi7lrkMt4AaABAq>

↳ @Johnsonadam_6652 (1): "Exactly.It's a calculated risk. I did the same, but a major health event last year showed me the holes in my "cheap" plan. The out-of-pocket max became a real number fast. That \$18k in savings vanished in medical bills."

↳ @AmirKazan-n2l (1): "What professional looks at healthcare and investments together?Most treat them separately."

↳ @ReeceCook-r7o (0): "Smart move saving on premiums.That \$18k can compound. The risk is the plan's network stability. A provider leaving or a new diagnosis can change the math overnight. You're betting on continued health."

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"Anyone else receive their 2025 Annual Notice of Change from Aetna today? I have the HMO plan, and the biggest shock is the maximum out of pocket will go from \$4800 in 2024 to \$9350 in 2025. All the 'extra benefits' are getting reduced as well."

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1f93bec/>

↳ (0): "It's a regressive year for sure.. the 2k cap for pdp is a big reason for it."

↳ (0): "I have united healthcare advantage dual plan, my plan decreased in 2025, dental, vision, OTC, looks like my going have to visit dental regardless once a year, on my vision, hell where to go to get yearly vision testing, and new glasses that's not going to go over 350, that's going to be impossible, the OTC amount from 187, to160 for food, hope snap program increases , but I doubt it, that's government, well what can u do, can't fight the government"

↳ (0): "Some big factors for these changes are the Medicare reimbursement rates are lowering slightly, the \$2000 cap on Part D medications and insurance companies being more responsible for the costs versus the big pharma companies, and since COVID, insurance utilization has been at record highs. You're going to see every part of Medicare affected. Med Supp rates are already going up like crazy, premiums for Part D plans will be much higher, with higher copays on meds and Medicare Advantage plans will have less "extra benefits" like dental, vision, hearing, and for more you will probably need to pay an added premium. All in all it's adjustment. In my opinion, insurance companies were giving way too much on those MAPD plans and weren't making enough on the back in due to utilization being so high, it was bound to break somewhere"

"Very well done. You did your homework. I'm 66 this year. I had to do a LOT of research to decide what was best for me. I agree about choosing for my future me. That said: I have a high deductible G plan in place (55.00 mon) in case I get very sick or have an accident but I spend a couple hundred a month (about what I'd pay for regular G premium 210.00) to take care of my metabolic health the way i want to. I use functional medicine, naturopath, no conventional drugs, acupuncture, massage therapy and supplements that are not covered by Medicare on any level. My husband died at 58 from a liver disease and a transplant. We had an HMO. I refuse to do it that way for myself. It was a chaotic, frustrating and terrifying experience for both of us. I know that if I'm hit with a chronic disease or accident I'll be set. So I chose ease of mind over just dollars. Everyone does it different. My parents have always done an advantage plan"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwDoFtNU8GrgWx3-O94AaABAq>

"My husband and I have had an advantage plan for 5 years. We love it! It is not an HMO and we receive many benefits that we would not have with medicare. Example: Dental, Vision, Spa Membership, no monthly premium, over the counter allowance for medical supplies etc. etc. All our doctors and hospitals are covered, and it also has out of town coverage. The regular medicare plans are very expensive. For us the advantage plan PPO is the way to go."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyzPUNJ3cvxD TI3ZZ4AaABAq>

↳ @alysewitt3729 (5): "I agree that it's okay unless you get something serious. Then you better be very choosy about your surgeon or doctor that they assign to you."

↳ @tyrone-tydavis5858 (4): "@Alyse Witt That's how you know this guy posting the video has no idea what hes talking about. There are medicare advantage plans that you choose your doctor. Everyone from your primary care physician to a specialist should you need one. I just injured my shoulder and needed an MRI and surgery. I picked the imaging center and I picked the orthopedic surgeon."

↳ @alysewitt3729 (2): "@tyrone-tydavis5858 when I had to have lung surgery they sent me to one surgeon. I later found out he was a general surgeon who was training to be a lung surgeon. I didn't know any better at the time. When I changed insurance I got the very best at Cedar-Sinai. The surgeon there said they took so long and surgery correcting the mistakes the first well-meaning surgeon made. As long as I can afford it I will keep my medicare with a gap plan. The advantage plans are okay unless you get something serious. You don't get more serious than lung removal usually."

"What you say may be true for some, but if you have a Kaiser HMO everything is different. I love Kaiser. I worked at Kaiser for years and I know it from the inside and out. When I hit 65 I opted for Kaiser's Medicare Senior Advantage. Nothing has changed for me except that I have more durable medical equipment options and things extended care and like that. My office visits cost \$5 instead of \$25. I did have to sign up for Plan B which I wouldn't have had to if I just continued Kaiser, but I could see that it could become a big cost saver down the road when I get really old. But who knows what the future will bring? That's the thing with any kind of insurance. It's a crapshoot. And let's face it, with medical care, the less you need it, the better. It's much better to pay into it not use it then not have it when you do need it. And my Kaiser Senior Advantage is always there if I need it, something that as I get older is going to become more important. A lot of people like to bash Kaiser, but it's the best HMO out there. I can tell you that if you need something, you will get it. For-profit insurance plans make money by doling expensive care. Kaiser is a not-for-profit and their goal is to keep you healthy so you don't need the expensive care down the road. But if you do, it is there. My husband needed a heart transplant. He checked into Stanford Hospital and was billed the Kaiser hospital admission co-pay of \$250. He walked out with no more charges. Zero. He had a heart transplant, something that cost anywhere from a \$half million to over \$1 million for \$250. And despite the huge cost of the immunosuppressive drugs, he has only a \$20 co-pay with no cap. Kaiser decided that there's no point in paying for a heart transplant if they won't pay for the drugs that you need to keep yourself alive. Most people can't afford a couple thousand dollars a month for medicines. So we're fans of Kaiser and I'm a fan of Senior Advantage. I kept my original benefits except that they've been expanded now."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyGOoPOpnz833X5Yo54AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (5): "Yes - glad you're happy. Unfortunately the vast majority are on plans that don't function very well."

↳ @TrishBenedict (2): "@alysewitt3729 Are we talking Senior Advantage or Kaiser here? I'll just say that anyone can have a bad experience at any hospital with any health plan. It's always the luck of the draw. Because Kaiser is a good deal. You get a lot of value for your money. They don't ration or withhold care. Mistakes can happen and things can be missed. I'm glad you got your problem taken care of."

↳ @tinas4946 (2): "My dad was on that plan and had a lot of health issues. It was the worst plan for him. His out of pocket monthly drug cost was \$500 a month. A ER visit was \$75 per visit. He had 25 ER visits in one year. His doctors had no clue how to help him and instead wasted our time in the ER. He was in assisted living and per the CA law had to call an ambulance in certain situations. It drove me crazy. My take was if you are healthy you'll be fine if not it is harder. I had no idea there was original medicare."

"We have Kaiser Medicare Advantage through California Public Employees retirement system. After the county contribution of \$158, we pay \$550 a month for the Advantage for the two of us, and the first of the year the price is going up. Kind of blown away hearing Advantage basically is free, especially when I think of what it has added up to over the years. I am looking into reg medicare because we get denied seeing specialty doctors all the time. Thank you for explaining in the video."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgyurrVddTqKVsd0_cp4AaABAg

↳ @fscooper3 (1): "I've had a UHC MA plan with a \$0 monthly premium for 7 years I've been on Medicare since 2017. I think the first 2 years were \$39/month."

↳ @karen-r1e4w (1): "kaiser is a big no no in our area. i work in our local ED and any admissions of kaiser must be authorized by them and i can tell you it is usually a big hassel. UHC is no longer accepted at JOHN HOPKINS>"

↳ @tommyluu7395 (0): "It's because you both have Kaiser HMO 🙄"

"For me, being able to see the doctor of my choice is priceless. I had a bad experience when I was young and had an HMO that used a specialist that said I could not be sick anymore after two weeks of antibiotics and that any continuing problem was in my head. I had to pay \$800 a visit to go to a real (out of network) specialist that treated me until I was well. So choosing Medigap was an easy choice for me when I turned 65."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyLkPPrqjwHLUM7ZRd4AaABAg>

↳ @TAM-bv2di (1): "Whateer you choose, never, ever go with an HMO."

"I have been on medical insurance HMO from my job for 24 years, and have seen maybe three or four pc doctors and two specialists during that time. I have had three stent placements, two hip replacements plus a knee surgery among other smaller health issues. So yes, I am used to getting referrals and prior authorizations mostly for specialists and hospital visits. And I can happily say that the care and services that I have received have been great. Therefore, I will continue this process, and join an Advantage plan with one of the big providers like Cigna, Humana or UnitedHealthcare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plan Reviews ⭐ (from real people) · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nw14VxxHrmM&lc=UgyxfZNTpemPHZHQmuN4AaABAg>

↳ @MarshaMarsha998 (0): "@EightyDeuce-x1d Humana advantage can no longer be provider at some hospitals be aware of that fact when a plan drops you"

"I have been on a UHC Advantage HMO plan for 7 years. It has paid for all of my big treatments including a detached retina and a knee replacement. They both cost me about \$250. I pay 0 premium. I have saved over 26K in premiums. I exercise everyday. I have never smoked and don't have any chronic problems yet. I think I'm kind of stuck with it as I will pay a hefty price for a Supplement plan at my current age."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugyk3is4VtZ_KBbfd94AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for sharing your experience!"

"I have had Kaiser for 30+ years before Medicare eligibility. Now I have Kaiser advantage. I have never been denied service that I needed!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyJxKikQmDD8l7BQc54AaABAg>

↳ @johncyr181 (7): "Wish you luck with MA coverage. When you really are in need of medical help, you may wish you had original Medicare but it may be too late...."

↳ @aliannarodriguez1581 (4): "I'm guessing there are different flavors of Kaiser Advantage plans out there and would be interested in hearing about which one you have. Kaiser is pretty good, and they have a lot of top rated doctors apparently, though they still only give you the 10 minutes per patient that so many doctors offices have implemented. (You really have to be in charge of your own health these days.)"

↳ @briancaine9130 (2): "My mother had Kaiser Advantage for many years. They were excellent on coverage and all other aspects."

"He is selling supplemental so take that with a grain of salt. Supplemental is going to cost you hundreds—maybe a few hundred, maybe many hundreds—a month extra. I have ACA Marketplace insurance with Kaiser Permanente (an excellent healthcare system) which has generally served me well except for the high deductible. About to turn 65 and I can choose a Kaiser Advantage plan that COSTS NOTHING EXTRA, and continue with the same coverage as I had before. No brainer? Pretty much."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwGTCcYJclKFIDKljt4AaABAq>

↳ @maryg1338 (0): "Fortunately you never had to get an authorization for a treatment that your doctor prescribed. I have worked in medical offices and would need to get these authorization. So here I am talking to some kid that was selling bicycles last week, trying to explain why it's necessary. Finally, the doctor would ask for a peer to peer. After waiting sometimes a week to be able speak with the company's doctor and convince him/her, that it is necessary.. (wait time) and often they would make you try different treatments that were less expensive before granting the authorization. Advantage plans do work for some... but, sadly not all"

↳ @kitcatmeowpurr745 (0): "He is telling the truth about Medicare DIS-Advantage ! The proof is that the very BEST (Ivy League) physicians and state of the art, cutting edge hospitals are no longer accepting Medicare DIS-Advantage Plans. UNLESS that Medicare DIS-Advantage Plans are issued from a EMPLOYER'S GROUP Plans (patient's former employer provided medical coverage). Medicare DIS-Advantage Plans have become a NIGHTMARE and ENDLESS approvals, and increasing patient co-payments, and splitting up single visit lab tests into separate charges to force the patient to pay for co-payments for EACH lab test during a single visit ! Also, they are REDUCING the lifetime limit of hospital visits to force patients to go back to straight Medicare. Manage Care plans offer to drive you to doctor's visits, pay your gym membership, and fluff your pillows, BUT HIDE THE FACT THAT THEY ARE REDUCING COVERAGE ON THE MOST EXPENSIVE MEDICAL COSTS, LIKE SURGERIES, HOSPITAL VISITS & REHAB STAYS ! They even offer plans that pay your Medicare Premium, but HIDE the fact that these very plans that return your Medicare Premium, pay for LESS MEDICAL SERVICES ! The ones that claim to pay for your prescriptions will only do so for GENERIC drugs, but refuse to pay for drugs that have no generic option ! Then if your physician prescribes a drug that has no generic, these plans will only pay a "PORTION" of the drug price. But you can get that same non generic expensive prescription FROM CANADA FOR LESS than what the Medicare Advantage Plan is paying ! If you talk to a Medicare Advantage "agent" who helps you to find a plan during open enrollment, give him/her THE ZIP CODE of WHERE you WANT TO RECEIVE MEDICAL TREATMENT. You will find that the BEST PHYSICIANS & HOSPITALS IN THE MOST EXCLUSIVE NEIGHBORHOODS DO NOT ACCEPT MEDICARE ADVANTAGE PLANS !!! UNLESS that Medicare Advantage Plan is issued by the patient's EMPLOYER GROUP POLICY! Then if you give them a zip code from a WORKING CLASS OR POOR NEIGHBORHOOD, YOU WILL FIND LOTS OF PHYSICIANS that WILL accept Medicare Advantage, and also WEEKS TO MONTHS TO GET AN APPT !!! EVEN LONG WAIT TIMES FOR EXISTING PATIENTS !!! Btw, IVY LEAGUE DOCTORS DO NOT WORK FOR KAISER !!! ALSO, RICH PEOPLE NEVER GO TO KAISER, FOR A REASON ! Kaiser IS NOT & NEVER HAS OFFERED, "CADILLAC MEDICAL CARE !" KAISER HAS ENOUGH HORROR STORIES, TO FILL A HALLOWEEN MOVIE THEATER FOR THE NEXT CENTURY ! Rich people, go to Johns-Hopkins, Mayo Clinic, UCLA, Cleveland Clinic, St John's Providence (Santa Monica CA), etc."

↳ @GNick1234 (0): "@kitcatmeowpurr745 I have had Kaiser Permanente for three years. Kaiser is one of the best health organizations in the US. Although my ACA coverage had a fairly high yearly deductible (\$6,000) that's not unusual anymore. Next month I switch to Kaiser's Medicare Advantage plan. The coverage and cost is nearly identical."

"When my husband turned 65 we were clueless on this process but our longtime HMO offers an advantage plan so we went with that. I still have a few years to go and I will probably do the same (my primary, specialty, etc are already well established with them). That said I really appreciate the information you provide and I feel like for me this decision will be much more informed. And for that I thank you. PS Watch out for those sunburns!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugz5IHhLGLD16_uvLNB4AaABAg

"I would never change my 4.5 star-rated MA plan, which I've had for 8 years now, and is with the same HMO I had prior to retiring. I'm pretty healthy, but have never been denied a service or test that my primary care doctor recommended. But the truth is, with health insurance as in all of life, one size does not fit all. Kai's mom for the win!"

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap | Your TRUE Cost · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugz5C9WW4q7WNELeV-N4AaABAg>

↳ @kciis (2): "It's great to hear that you've found a plan that works so well for you! You're absolutely right – health insurance needs can vary so much from person to person."

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAg>

↳ @CD-ek3iq (4): "I work with both MA and Supplements. While what you say is mostly accurate the sad fact is many seniors simply cannot afford the high premiums of Supplements AND a PDP. Add in the monthly cost of dental, vision and hearing, which supps won't cover, and it's easy to be priced out completely. There's nothing wrong with MA. I work with people every day who LOVE their MA plans and wouldn't trade em for the world, lol. (It's my job to try!) Many also have much lower Max Out Of Pockets than mentioned that can end up being as much as the yearly premium you pay with Supps whether you use it or not. 🙌 If you travel, simply get a PPO. Easy. Everybody has different needs and means. Luckily there are multiple options to try and help people with their Health Care."

"Went through the whole video. I just retired this month and will make a decision as to what option I will choose I am a cancer survivor and gearing towards supplement plan G. It was actually the first time I am aware of that plan. I am actually signed up with Kaiser through my retirement health plan so I have to get more information on this. Thank you for all the information. You said send an elephant or hippo? I didn't know how to do that."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think | Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwcXvMjV0iLH5MErUd4AaABAg_A1KdKhnuifT6Yz0Vurot2

"My wife retired two years ago from a public school system. We have been covered on her HMO group plan for many years. I turn 65 in 2 months. The HMO required me to sign up for part A and B plus fill out an application for their "advantage" plan by a month before I turn 65 or they would drop me."

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxY51KAn0KjUwfoxA54AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "You have a 6 month Open Enrollment opportunity without any Health questions asked for Medicare Supplement Insurance to consider."

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "If you have any other questions, or need help getting your Medicare coverage set up correctly, give us a call to schedule an appointment: 800-864-8890 or schedule a free appointment here: <https://www.medicareschool.com/talk-to-a-guide?rc>";

"I pay 0 for my advantage plan, it's not hmo. I can go to any specialist if it's on the covered list without a trip to pcp. Same with dentist. I just find one that takes it, and most do. 0 charge pcp, specialist is 25., no charge mammogram"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzlqliHk3WjxbMpKUB4AaABAg.AZs-HW-cTZGAZsIMP4I_W1

"I have had no problems getting care during ten + years in a Medicare Advantage HMO. However, I live in a large city, and I might reconsider my choices if I move to an area without all the resources my present HMO offers."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugx8_KPe7uTsi-X2V5d4AaABAg

"Let's get our facts straight: If I decide that after a time that I want to change from a Medicare Advantage plan to something else, I have two choices: I can return to original Medicare Parts A & B or I can, given insurability, apply for a Medicare Supplemental plan. I have not "signed away my rights to original Medicare" by choosing a Medicare Advantage plan. Apparently, you haven't seen many of "90 Days from Retirement" videos where they take actual hospital stay cases and compare the coverages of private insurance, original Medicare, Medicare Advantage, and Medicare Supplemental plans. It's surprising how different scenarios give different results depending on the plan you have. There is no clear "winner". During my entire business career, I have been covered by some type of HMO health insurance by the various companies I've worked for. I've been very well-versed in how to get referrals and work within a network. And it's been quite affordable. I'm still working and have chosen a Medicare Advantage plan for my health care coverage. I could easily afford a Medicare Supplemental plan but choose, instead, to save a ton of money for my coverage. There is no "this is better, this is worse" when it comes to choosing. You pick the type of plan that meets your goals. If you want the privilege of choosing your doctor and want to pay for that privilege, then by all means go Supplemental. If you're comfortable with getting referrals and working within a network, then choose Advantage. For me living in Florida, I choose a Medicare Advantage plan. I paid a total out of pocket of less than \$200 for my medical coverage in 2022 and for 2023. Yes, I had some co-pays and the like, but it amounted to significantly less than what I would have paid if I'd had a Medicare Supplemental plan. Essentially, for my Medicare Advantage plan here in Florida, I have a "give back" on my premium that covers all but \$10/month of the Part B premium. I have no deductible, \$0 copay for seeing my primary care physician, and a \$10 copay for specialists. I have a \$60 copay for outpatient surgery and a \$75/night for days 1-5 if I have a hospital stay. \$0 copay for nights after the 1st 5 nights. I have prescription, dental, and vision coverage as well. There are perks such as 48 trips per year to/from doctor appts, a meal plan for two weeks after a hospital stay, and many, many more. I believe many people choose these advantage plans not for as you say, "these are for people with low monthly retirement incomes", but they choose them for using their money wisely."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwTsL3DpxecL9X-mph4AaABAg.9wePF3EAQZI9xjrZGMO-x>

Medicaid, Extra Help and Medicare Savings Programs · 89 documents · 20 voices

"There's no way I could describe how the cost of Medicare infuriates me... I worked from age 15 (part time/went to school) until I retired at 66..51 years!!! I had a stellar job and outstanding benefits.. when I retired, the amount I pay, the co pays, the deductibles are infuriating... people who receive Medicaid get almost better care and FREE for never working... make it make sense to someone who has common sense...can you ???"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgykUrRns1xbaJTY2S54AaABAg>

↳ @coachop94 (3): "@Jaded57your attitude toward others is why we can't have nice things like Universal Health care"

↳ @Shars43 (3): "Madicaid get better care. after 75 on medicare, all you get is a wellness check. but we're still paying for full medicare."

↳ @Lifeworthliving425 (1): "Those on Medicare with Medicare worked all of their lives they just were paid lower wages."

"I retired at 65 but my wife is also retired and not 65 yet. So we had to get an ACA plan for her. I followed this advice early. But I followed it too well during my first year and my income was so low that the exchange bumped her down to a Medicaid plan. Which sounds great because it had \$0 premiums. But the problem with Medicaid where I live is no doctors take it. Not great insurance for someone in their 60s. Ever since then, I have been careful in taking enough taxable income so that my income threshold is high enough to not qualify for Medicaid and low enough to optimize on ACA credits."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65: The ACA Reality Nobody Tells You · 43 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Qz8CyPjA5s&lc=Ugz7JAf8GPGbn0Ae8Id4AaABAg>

↳ @mikeb8342 (4): "@mnnew6772 I think it's not about whether providers are available, but rather will a doctor accept a lower amount for a service (usually the case with medicaid)? Maybe Colorado medicaid has higher payouts for services? If so, you might be correct. 🙏"

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "Yes that is something to think about. Good thing you caught it and readjust."

↳ @polaridoo1 (1): "No, it is very hard to find Medicaid providers in Colorado. There's usually a very long wait to get in and not many providers accept it."

"Worked in the healthcare industry my entire career. I found that most people do not have any knowledge of the Medicare and/or Medicaid even with a "pocket computer" today. Very good presentation! I hope people will see it and learn. 🧐 🙌 🍷"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🧐 · 39 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=Ugy4l3pgsk6qRHMD0t4AaABAg>

"For those on low income...my primary doctor advised me on Dec 7th I saw him and he said go home call Medicare, get on Original Medicare and Medicaid...I did...only other thing I had to do was choose a prescription program...which cost nothing for me, perhaps the same for you....I was a foster care mom for decades...now retired..."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🧐 · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgwWguYVkcHmce3F3GB4AaABAg>

↳ @wamich4 (0): "Sign of a good Dr. My Dr said the same thing to me. Although I will not be on Medicare till April next year."

↳ @danielfeather8314 (0): "Well, get on medicaid with an advantage plan, and you will get a lot more benefits."

↳ @danielfeather8314 (0): "You would be crazy not too"

"I have continued feeling a great deal of relief that I wormed my way out of a mistaken choice to get an Advantage plan. I was hooked by the offer of a vision plan. But then I learned all the shady stuff various Advantage plans can do, and because I am in NC and on Medicaid, I had a 6 month period to change my mind,. I switched back to original Medicare the minute I got my new pair of glasses. And I learned about how messed up Advantage plans can be thanks to YouTube. Thank you for making this video!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwiVOAo3PYIG4-Wj54AaABAg>

↳ @ragtop326 (0): "My vision plan only covered \$100 towards glasses, and I had to pay for my own exam \$89. In Viet Nam, RX glasses only cost \$14. What's wrong with our country. They're money hungry, that's all."

"I want the advantages offered by having regular Medicare over my \$0 upfront and nightmare back end Advantage plan. However, the choice I was given was Medicare plus supplement, drug, dental, optical = nearly \$600/mo for me. No. And that's this year, with no premium caps for any coming year. This, during an administration that is shifting the government costs to citizens. Who knows the monthly costs or sudden share of cost later on? As of now, underwriting is required to change from one to another. If you can afford Medicare, you are blessed financially. I have so many other ways that I am blessed, and I'm grateful. May there come a day that I can rest assured that I will have the same access to the USA Healthcare system as the well off enough to get good health insurance and the poor with Medicaid (for now?)"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzlqliHk3WjxbMpKUB4AaABAg>

↳ @Jamm607 (5): "@SuBee71 This was how my previous plan was, rarely an issue. I moved from one state to another, requiring a change as there aren't many doctors here that take the original. My current plan has been challenging with most interactions, too. I've been making great use of Dr YouTube. There's one high note positive from it all though. Better choices are underway to create a healthier body that doesn't need any of the insurance at all anyway! 👍 😊 "

↳ @SuBee71 (4): "I pay 0 for my advantage plan, it's not hmo. I can go to any specialist if it's on the covered list without a trip to pcp. Same with dentist. I just find one that takes it, and most do. 0 charge pcp, specialist is 25., no charge mammogram"

"Turning 65 in December and there's no way I can afford any form of Medicare. I've been on medicaid for years and I do not have housing, so I made my decision that I'm going to not take part b. Or any of it because I cannot afford premiums or deductible or the 20% copay. So you ask what will you do? I decided that I will never see a doctor again for the rest of my life. You might think that's crazy. But when you're completely alone, and it no longer matters than why go see a doctor? Yes, I might die earlier because of it, but I don't care. If I have to pay for all the medicare expenses, I will not be able to buy food and die anyway. Trying to answer your question now. Could you say what about food stamps? No I don't qualify fruit stamps because there's this thing about, you know, falling through the cracks."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgzGhqKOanMEcqGSrh4AaABAg>

↳ @VegasHobo (4): "@Bobcat1950 nope, the Medicaid requirements change the day I turn 65 and that puts me in what they call the cracks to the no longer qualify and I don't have the money to pay. Nor can I get other assistance because my savings is just a little over the maximum allowed. That is why I referring back to my original statement that I'm going to only going to take part a and never ever see a doctor again for the rest of my life."

↳ @Bobcat1950 (3): "Your State or Medicaid will probably pay your premiums. As long as you qualify for Medicaid, they will continue to assist you. Very little should change for you. Every State administers Medicaid a little differently. You don't want to miss any deadlines. Current Administrations will cut you off with little to no chance recovery."

↳ @mariavazquez-s9k3p (3): "I hear you loud and clear. I think I am going to drop out of the M'care system. Won't be able to pay rent. At least I can die with a roof over my head"

"I have lived in the UK, The Netherlands, Belgium, Italy, and Australia, while in school and working in healthcare. My children were born in Europe, and I have been a patient in a few of these countries as well. I have also worked at hospitals in S. America and Asia on a range of research projects, and in hospitals across the US over a 40-year career. I would put the best level of care from the best socialized healthcare systems in Europe (Germany, Scandinavia, and Switzerland) at the level Medicare patients receive in the US. In Spain, Portugal, Italy, France, it is well below. Wait times for treatment can be months, treatments significantly constrained by costs, and the quality of facilities inferior. And here is what the armchair critics of the US system should understand: it is not free. I paid 41% income tax, along with a slew of other taxes in the UK, for a level of care way below the standard an insured American receives, and equal to what Medicaid provides. Living in Australia and the UK, I carried private insurance as well, to protect my familys well being. You think Medicine is expensive? Everything is expensive. The costs of R&D, the costs of FDA and regulatory approval, the costs added by the practice of defensive medicine due to a broken legal system. The reason the system works better here than anywhere I've been is that it is run as a business. You want to see a poorly run healthcare system, take a look at any that are run by the government."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgyHH-2jD66KrEcohmF4AaABAgAQdV-BlagQA_TwfYFyt8R

"I receive my ANOC for my Advantage plan yesterday & some things are going down. But I have dual care coverage, Medicare & Medicaid, so I'm still in good shape."

— YouTube · 3 Medicare Changes for 2027 - and how to prepare. #medicare · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GxBa9kBX5cY&lc=UgxY_TW23GC7nbNZ_dl4AaABAg

↳ @susie8255 (0): "Why do you have dual coverage, how does that work?"

↳ @stevec3872 (0): "@susie8255: Due to my income I qualify for Medicaid here in Wisconsin. I was on it before I retired."

↳ @stevec3872 (0): "@susie8255 Dual care coverage in Wisconsin explained: https://www.google.com/search?q=what+is+dual+care+medicaid%2Fmedicare+coverage+in+wisconsin&rlz=1CASLSU_enUS1171US1171&oeq=what+is+dual+care+medicaid%2Fmedicare+coverage+in+wisconsin&gs_lcrp=EgZjaHJvbWUyBggAEEUYOTIHCAEQIRigATIHCAIQIRigATIHCAQIRigATIHCAUQIRigAdIBCjl5MTU4ajBqMTWoAgiwAgHxBXweNJC0IKT_8QV8HjSQtJSk_w&sourceid=chrome&source=chrome.rb&ie=UTF-8";

"I get my medicare premium paid by the State of Arizona because I have their Medicaid plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Part B Give Back Benefit - What's The Catch? · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dMy1JJvQwTs&lc=UgwAltK9C6mGOEVwjz4AaABAg>

↳ @pilarq7886 (1): "where, who do I call for help in AZ thank you please respond if you will"

"I'm under 62, on SSDI, & have a Medicare supplement plan that I'm stuck with until I turn 65 & can't change without underwriting. Feel like i am penalized because of a chronic, permanent disability i suffered from in 2012 that resulted in going on SSDI. The cost of it has doubled over the last several years & my only choice is to change to a Medicare advantage plan until then. I have been through the worst of our health care system through my experiences. I should have gotten dual citizenship in another country years ago when I had the opportunity where I could have gotten the medical care I needed without it financially ruining me."

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=UgwqNyHLjygxlduP51Z4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Sadly, there is no federal law mandating the availability of Medicare supplement plans to people under 65. Most states do not offer any Medigap plans until a person reaches 65. Other states price under 65 supplement so high, they are not a reasonable solution. It's just the way it is."

↳ @jdenino6022 (2): "@MedigapSeminarsBlame Congress. 🙄 "

↳ @ctwilk1 (0): "Check with BCBS. They have a Medicare Supplement Plan for ppl that are under 65 and disabled. Good luck!"

"It's crazy now that I am a senior my hard earn money is going to feed the insurance companies no matter which one I choose wether is advantage or original I have to pay the only way is been poor and getting both Medicare and Medicaid now This is am devastated"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyYQnPn5sTQV5KgsTp4AaABAg.9yNQjvqH58j9znnHjdBdOM>

"I'm on Medicare due to permanent disability. I also have Medicaid as a secondary. I like this channel because in time, if I no longer qualify for the Medicaid secondary, I want to know what is out there for me. Unfortunately, I have to wait until I'm 65 (5 more years!) before I can even get a supplemental plan to my Medicare. My biggest concern about an Advantage plan is the limited physicians in the group. I'm in a small town, so it's even worse for me because I have to travel a long distance for specialists. The last thing I need is the insurance company telling me I have to travel to a specialist included in their group that's 3-4 hours away. I prefer to have more power than the insurance company and also, not have to always have a referral for a specialist. Some specialists require them, even on Medicare, like neurologists and doctors like that. I'm definitely team #Ann'smom! :)"

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugz2IUNXNxT99E_hf_54AaABAg

↳ @kciis (1): "Thank you for sharing your experience! Navigating Medicare and Medicaid can be challenging, especially with the limitations in your area. It's great to have a community where we can learn and support each other!"

"We were on COBRA when George turned 65 and he had to sign up at 65, a few months after he got a permanent job. I didn't sign up when I turned 65, when I found out I could be penalized for not signing up at 65, I called the SSA told the the SS worker why I didn't sign up for Medicare, she told me what form I needed and to have George's HR Department fill out their part. I liked having dual medical coverage, no co-pay for prescriptions and Dr.' the most we paid while on medical from work and Medicare was 8 cents for a prescription to get ready for a test."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgyqlQkmWCg0hfEdEiV4AaABAg>

↳ @curiouspenguin6887 (1): "More companies are now denying healthcare coverage if you or your spouse qualify for other healthcare coverage - aka Medicare. You got lucky."

↳ @tayfan2 (0): "@curiouspenguin6887 My husband's medical retirement plan states in the contract that he had to enroll in Medicare at age 65. His work health plan is the secondary plan & it will continue to cover his/ our dental, vision, and prescriptions. We are fortunate not to need Advantage plans. I am not yet 65 but I'm researching now."

"I don't choose an advantage plan. lost Medicaid and here in California a medigap plan is unaffordable, so I am forced into it, sure it will be fine until I use it for a serious and expensive health care event. yes I get a free gym membership that's not important."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugy_tfbQ7ARfRG_9yh4AaABAg

↳ @miked5106 (0): "I've been on MA for 2 years. It's great! Went to the ER my copay was \$115 that's it! No charge for labs, docs, cat scan, meds. Same with Urgent Care, Flat \$40. N/C to see my primary."

"This is informative but really just touches on some of what you need help with. You never mentioned talking to an independent agent. SHIP is a decent starting point but they usually have volunteers that have very minimal training and have seen many times where they have hurt people. I have been doing Medicare for 17 years and was a "captive" agent in the beginning and saw the need for being not tied to an individual company. Medicare supplements can be good but you never mentioned some of the benefits that Medicare Advantage company have, such as dental, hearing aids, vision coverage, health club membership, and even OTC benefits. Another thing is you can have a Medicare Advantage plan with a Hospital Indemnity plan that can cover major costs such as cancer and hospital stays and have premiums at less than half of a Medicare supplement and you can have the extra benefits of the MA plan and lower out of pocket costs. Another thing is that if you live in an area that has zero plan premiums for Medicare Advantage your prescription cost 95% of the time will be lower than if you have a stand-alone RX plan. Bottom line you can spend hours and hours going through all the plans and learning about options and be overwhelmed and still not know what to do. Again the SHIP department can help but they do not go through the extensive training an independent agent has to do every year and they don't have the experience or even the responsibility if they steer you the wrong way. I can sit with a client for a couple of hours and truly walk someone through their options and narrow down what would be in their best interest now and the future. 2 or 3 hours of your time is nothing to spend on something that over a 10 year period may save you literally thousands. It's your choice but if you think talking with your doctors' office or SHIP office is going to be the best resource you will regret it. Talk to an INDEPENDENT agent with 5 years or more and you will be able to make a MUCH better-informed decision. I (WE) do this at no cost to you and do get paid by the company you sign up for and it makes no difference which company you sign up with....Medicare made it so there is no incentive to steer you to a company that pays more so we truly give you an unbiased opinion of what's best for you! Sorry for going on but I really felt this needed to be covered. You need to know to use a local agent. I am in NW Arkansas, NE OK, and SW MO and know the plans in this area extensively but if you asked me about what to do in Florida, Wisconsin or any other area I would not be able to help other than tell you to find a Local agent. Good luck :)"

— YouTube · Avoiding Costly Medicare Mistakes · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M_lw87U6Moo&lc=Ugyq0OC917TwMii_n9x4AaABAq

↳ @scottfreedom2012 (1): "@lisad2701 Absolutely. I have clients down to Hot Springs and Mena. I am located in Bentonville. I have a website that you can contact me through when the time comes. nwamedicareplans dot com I also have a facebook page that I post good info year-round. If you are on facebook at all use @nwamedicareplans to find me."

↳ @lisad2701 (0): "Scott Widen...I'm south of you in Polk County - could I still contact you when my "Medicare" time comes?"

"[CA] Dual enrollment causing issues for upcoming surgery Bay Area, California. On SSI & SSDI, so I have Medicare & Medi-Cal. Surgery is scheduled for Nov 18 Long story short, I was told that legally, the surgeon cannot take payment from me because I have both Medicare (not accepted) and Medi-Cal (accepted ONLY if it's my sole/primary, which it's not). Even if I wanted to, I could not do cash-pay through Care Credit. They're not allowed to accept **anything**. Surgery has not yet been cancelled, since the office is also trying to see what hidden options/legal loopholes/etc. might be available, so I'm also trying to do research to see what I might be able to do. I'm trying to avoid having it rescheduled/fully canceled, especially since I already have stuff sorted out with my community college classes and home support (parent & close friend already approved for time off). I considered seeing if I could cancel Medi-Cal since I don't use it much beyond medication coverage, but was told that if I wanted to get back on it, it would be likely be very difficult. Paraphrasing her, but she has a point; "they'd question why you canceled in the first place if you tried to get it back, and they'd also see that you had surgery in that time as well, so that would probably cause issues." Basically, I'm trying to see what legal options I have that will let me keep this date and not screw myself over in the long run as well."

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wk34b0/ca_dual_enrollment_causing_issues_for_upcoming/

↳ msp_ryno (12): "That is correct. If the provider is not participating with Medicare, they cannot see you because if medicare doesn't pay, then medicaid won't either."

↳ babybambam (6): "Your Medi-Cal is used more often than you think, especially for surgeries and minor procedures. If you "cancel" it you're on the hook for the 20% Medicare coinsurance. They are correct that you aren't able to be cash-pay. Medi-Cal (Medicaid) is an entitlement program. You've demonstrated that you're financially incapable of paying out of pocket for your healthcare. In order to be cash pay you would need to file MC 215. You would be able to reapply for it in the future. However, so long as you remain eligible for Medi-Cal, you will not be eligible for Covered California. Your best option is to find a provider that accepts Medicare. It is incredibly rare to find a provider that will take Medi-Cal (Medicaid) but not Medicare. Typically patients that have both struggle to find a provider because they don't want the Medi-Cal component. When a claim processes, Medi-Cal will only pay for each service up to its own allowable; it doesn't simply just pick up the medicare coinsurance. That means that a lot of professional services are paid at 80% of Medicare rates for these patients. Surgical specialists often accept both as 1. 80% of Medicare for the office visit and testing is often much higher than the Medi-Cal rates. 2. Surgical codes often have a higher allowable than Medicare, so they're usually guaranteed to get 100% of Medicare rates."

↳ GroinFlutter (5): "Okay, you have a Medicare Advantage plan. Do you have a Medicare Dual SNP plan? Or just plain Medicare Advantage? To confirm, the provider is not in network with HumanaChoice PPO. But is in network with CCHP? How were you seeing this provider before? Like how were you able to get scheduled to see them for the initial consult? Is the Medicare new? They are correct that they cannot charge you (a Medi-Cal patient) out of pocket for Medi-Cal covered services, it's illegal. The tricky part is the only way I can see this going forward is if this is NOT a Medicare covered service. Then the CCHP should pay. But it depends on what the surgery is. I can see why they are hesitant... a surgery is significant financial risk that may not get paid."

"Speaking as another sunburn victim, I'd like to say that your content style is exceptional. Thank you for your work. I'm turning 64 and dreading going into medicare after being a low income Medi-Cal patient in California under the Affordable Care Act. I have some basic assets that will probably put Medi-Cal out of reach now. I'm old enough to know that our health care system in the USA has become a licensed organized crime syndicate. Now our president and his party have seemingly dismantled the Affordable Care Act. I'm afraid. But your content gave me some tools and confidence that I didn't have before. Thank you."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxRTnn-P-VtTYTkhRF4AaABAg>

↳ @wellsorted (1): "Here is my good deed for the day (unfortunately it won't help my transition from CoveredCA Medi-Cal to Medicare 😞) : "In California, Medi-Cal no longer counts assets when determining eligibility for most programs, including those for long-term care. This change, effective January 1, 2024, means that applicants' financial eligibility is now based solely on income, not on the value of their assets." So keep your assets and live long and prosper 🙌"

↳ @xf6657 (1): "@wellsorted , Thanks for that. I've been reading some info which suggests that Newsom may need to deploy "work requirements" and asset checks due to Trump's medicaid cuts. I appreciate the input. Peace."

"Once I am on Medicare, I'll get a good plan; I wasn't aware of the premium there being affected by assets (in any case, ALL of my assets are either in my own Roth or an Irrevocable Trust (with HEMS terms, defined as Complex, and with me being the sole Trustee/Beneficiary). I would have no problem buying a Medicaid plan (or Public Option plan), but this is not possible with there being so many politicians that win the votes of folks that vote against their interest. I think I will just stay with an ACA plan until the Dems are in control of the House and are able to have BBB repeal language as part of any appropriation. I have never been about cutting other folks' health-care. My position is for there to be a Public Option open to all, priced at the actuarial cost of a healthy 26 y.o. man, and subsidized by the general fund, and such that if folks want that cost to be applied to an ACA plan, or even an HSA (i.e., that ensures that the subscriber can't offload risk to Uncle Sam), they're more than welcome. I would be for Medicare-For-All, but I realize that there are too many yoyos that think that somehow they beat this system, and thus it will be unpopular; my plan is basically Medicare-For-All-Except-Those-Too-Stupid-To-Understand-It's-Their-Best-Option."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1uxy258/has_anyone_heard_of_a_court_case_where_someone/o9oi0u2/

"I used my work insurance until it ran out. My doctor had my sister immediately sign me up for Medicaid. This was during peak Covid so they were waiving the income limits at that time. I actually got approved for SSDI because of the condition and kept my medicaid. Eventually the Medicaid income waiver period ended and my SSDI income was over the medicaid limit and I got kicked off. Around the same time that happened I was about to be auto-enrolled in Medicare because I had been on SSDI for 24 months. There was a 3 month period in between that transition where I to pay out of pocket for an ACA plan though. Once I fully transitioned over to Medicare I got myself on to a Medicare Advantage plan which I currently still have. I started transitioning back to work in January of this year and my employer provides medical coverage. I still pay for my MA plan too so I have dual coverage for the time being."

— r/HealthInsurance · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wh6ko8/is_it_worth_it_for_me_to_get_health_insurance/pa49en5/

Changed Medigap carriers to escape a rate increase · 51 documents · 20 voices

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (19): "Thanks for sharing your experience. You're not alone — I've seen a lot of people face those same big increases on Plan G. Plan N usually ends up being the smarter long-term choice because of the lower premiums, and for most people the extra cost-sharing is pretty minimal compared to what they save each year. With how fast rates are climbing, especially going into 2026, your switch makes a lot of sense."

↳ @christinestephenson1742 (11): "I have Mutual of Omaha supplement since 2019. It's maybe 130 a month and has just gone up a bit each year."

↳ @jayes8191 (6): "@policyguides Could Plan N's extra cost sharing increase significantly if Medicare reimbursements decrease in 2026?"

"I turned 65 while employed, and my company switched me to the "Medicare Version" of the standard employee plan. I then retired with an early retirement package covering my medical insurance at employee rates for three years. Guess what. I had been put on an Advantage version plan. Ugh. I decided to jump to a Medigap plan as soon as the employee rate ended and was fortunately able to still pass underwriting. Two years later, I got diagnosed with a chronic heart condition. I am so grateful to have been able to move to a Medigap plan when I did!!!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz3XghK1-XGwM55ivZ4AaABAq>

↳ @grenloopy2969 (2): "Lucky you were able to afford the supplement plan because they're very expensive in many areas versus Medicare Advantage."

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (1): "Your decision likely saved your life and a whole lot of money. Advantage Plans likely kill thousands of seniors prematurely every week in this country."

"I started Medicare in 2018 at age 65. Every single year I have had rate increases that far exceeded 5-8%. I left United plan G in 2024 as their rate increase jumped drastically and sent my premium well above \$200 a month. I switched to plan N through, you guessed it, Ace. The rate started at \$113 a month and in 2025 increased to \$126 and for 2026 just went up this month to \$154. These high percentage rate increases are wearing thin. Texas resident."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 52 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgyL5MEueBzKhmgghgJ94AaABAg>

↳ @Merzui-kg8ds (17): "The US is a FOR PROFIT medical care nation. As long as we treat healthcare as a for profit industry, costs will be manipulated to increase profits."

↳ @myvenusheeler (12): "@Merzui-kg8ds Well, the flip side to that is socialized medicine has plenty of issues too."

↳ @bobbo11357 (12): "@m@myvenusheeler Socialized Medicine aka the rest of the world. Germany, Sweden, Japan, Argentina. Every country has problems but do those countries health systems bankrupt their citizens?"

"I always laugh/cringe when I see young people wanting Medicare for All. Apparently they have never actually talked to anybody who is on Medicare. When I turned 65 I was informed that I had to move off "my" company's healthcare plan and on to Medicare. So I was paying for all my employee's healthcare, but couldn't be on the plan myself. By the time I paid for all the Medicare coverage I could get, it cost almost as much as my company's plan without nearly the coverage. Congress is the reason Medicare costs are so high...over the years they have added more and more people to the Medicare roles who haven't contributed or fully contributed to the pool without funding these additions. Oh and this video was content absent."

— YouTube · Avoiding Costly Medicare Mistakes · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M_lw87U6Moo&lc=UgyCbpe_GfOQGpGheYR4AaABAg

↳ @SandfordSmythe (0): "Medicare for all is only an illustration of how a single payer system works. Medicare would be different."

"Started Medicare at age 65 in 2018 and went with plan G. It was \$126 a month. Since then, I have changed G plan companies twice from the original company due to high-rate increases. This year my AARP/United Health plan ballooned from \$179 a month to \$211. I was done with plan G and at age 71 went on plan N where I am paying \$113 a month. Fortunately, I am healthy and every time I have gone through underwriting I passed easily. My friends are not so fortunate and are now stuck. One has even contemplated an Advantage plan and upon asking what I thought about that, and I replied I personally would rather crawl a mile over broken glass before entering the managed care route."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=Ugwe7zoMYTq671ntRkR4AaABAg>

↳ @Colt-ii4qn (0): "Still working for few more years, hoping to hang on to my plan G 🙄"

"I have Aetna medigap. If I wanted to switch companies would I have to go through underwriting"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Companies Review · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DXrpiO_sGSc&lc=UgwgMJ2pCbaNwkCAk6p4AaABAg

↳ @policyguides (0): "Howdy! If you don't have any special election periods and you've been on a Medigap plan for over 12 months, then yes, there's a high likelihood that you would have to go through medical underwriting. If you call us directly, we can go over the health questions to determine which company may work if you have existing health concerns. 888-414-4547. Please let us know if we can help further. Thanks!"

↳ @DonEricWeber (0): "Yes, outside of a guaranteed issue period have to go through underwriting to switch."

"Similar experience, also in California. It does vary greatly by state. As he said, the provider matters greatly too. The insurer I had for my Plan G started raising premiums way more than the average in his chart so I was able to save almost 23% by switching insurers."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgxFO8gB1kSYlvEYWex4AaABAg.9xEF30XDZ7G9xEFwsLrYle>

"I chose the G plan because I didn't want to deal with co-pays and excess charges. I take 1 prescription so my drug plan is \$6.30 right now. I just switched over to my husbands carrier so we could each get a 10% family discount. Every little bit helps 😊 12:14"

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgywttgocD9ehKtbLPt4AaABAg.A27TZ7RDuQNA3qmfFQeuJ

"Sunburn. Great job on this video. I love your chart, as well. I am 71, and have had \$0.00 Premium Advantage Plans so far. I had to change to a different company a couple years ago because my Primary Doctor dropped my plan, because he was tired of arguing with them on proper care for his patients. Both of my Advantage Plan companies have worked out well for me so far. However, I am now leaning towards switching to a Supplement Plan after I saw how wonderful they worked for both of my parents, who each had a lot of issues through their lives, and they never had to pay for anything, other than their monthly premiums. As I get older, I think it might give me a bit more peace of mind to have a Supplement that has more complete coverage and I will have more control over which doctors I see. Your video was very helpful as I do my research to make my decision for 2026. Thanks again!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzJ0S3dtITngj28Ghl4AaABAg>

↳ @KGH-ew8mw (0): "From what I understand, switching to a Supplement Plan from an Advantage plan is not that easy to do. I am under the impression that if you want to switch from a current plan to another, you have to be accepted by the plan after passing their medical underwriting approval. That could be difficult if you have any medical conditions that the company does not want to cover."

"Stephanie, I retired in June and I just started my Medicare coverage in July. I have part A, part B, and a supplemental plan G along with my stand alone plan D for prescriptions. Do I have to keep the same insurance company I have now for next July or can I switch to Abt insurance company? I really appreciate how you explain everything and I would trust you to be honest with me and in getting the best insurance at the cheapest rate."

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans for 2027 — What's Changed? · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hAZ_geBw1Ac&lc=UgwKDOY6pos7u6Ui2Z54AaABAg

↳ @dbeck2571 (1): "She is an insurance agent not an insurance company. She seems very knowledgeable."

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAg>

↳ @CD-ek3iq (4): "I work with both MA and Supplements. While what you say is mostly accurate the sad fact is many seniors simply cannot afford the high premiums of Supplements AND a PDP. Add in the monthly cost of dental, vision and hearing, which supps won't cover, and it's easy to be priced out completely. There's nothing wrong with MA. I work with people every day who LOVE their MA plans and wouldn't trade em for the world, lol. (It's my job to try!) Many also have much lower Max Out Of Pockets than mentioned that can end up being as much as the yearly premium you pay with Supps whether you use it or not. 🙌 If you travel, simply get a PPO. Easy. Everybody has different needs and means. Luckily there are multiple options to try and help people with their Health Care."

"I've always said, Having to pay the max IMRAA monthly Medicare premium is a nice problem to have! Ok, zeroing out the CEO's bonus is a good start on premiums! Me personally, I had one stent put in my heart. Hospital bill was \$205,000. Medicare paid \$50k. thats still a crazy number! I stayed on original Medicare with plan G. I had already paid my deductible, so my cost zero. I just have to keep paying all my monthly premiums and yearly premium increases with increasing deductibles. I do live in a birthday state. We changed Supp company this year saving us \$54 a month in Plan G premium's. Our independent agent did this for us. Oh, nesting dolls for sure!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Math Nobody Shows You · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LJ3P5gL1JFw&lc=UgycDpWXdz56b_JH91F4AaABAg

"I went thru Boomer Benefits and was given similar misleading information about rate increases. Based on what they told me, I selected Mutual of Omaha. What a mistake! Boomer Benefits talked about a 3-4% annual rate increase. What I got was a rate increase average of 15.9% per year. The problem is that Mutual of Omaha "closed the book" on my plan. This is one of the dirty little secrets of the Medigap business."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgyQiwAUlIfLGcYLJJl4AaABAg.A20cpKxef1fA4JxR6qqW2P>

"I wanted to switch my wife from a HDG plan to a G plan and keep my HDG plan. We both went through medical underwriting at age 67 without issue and changed companies and plans. Neither of us had chronic conditions so it wasn't very difficult. I found the underwriting for a LTC policy far more difficult and comprehensive. Travel"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgxUYtL0BPPSazrA4HJ4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you for sharing your experience Paul! 🍷"

"Stephanie you are the Best! This year I was on Plan F and it was high I changed companies stayed with F and they saved me 150 dollars a month. Of course they did ask a few questions but thankfully my health not to bad . So you are So right Thank you"

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgyQZh9ShT3Rte4O4-N4AaABAg>

"Hi Richard! It's hard to say. Rate increases could level off and drop back to closer to what they used to be (like 5-9%/year we used to see...) versus 10-15 +% annually. If they keep at this high of a rate I'm sure it will push more people into Medicare Advantage Plans or Plan G-HD. It's important to understand your options!"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans for 2027 — What's Changed? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hAZ_geBw1Ac&lc=Ugy9PA8tK6l35PbN8s94AaABAg.AbBFnLu3dBUAbBOVcCBWfq

"My wife and I switched from F supplement to N from a different carrier. We did it for the same reasons as you mentioned. We switched 7-ish years ago and even with the ensuing rate increases still less then our last year on F."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan N vs Plan G - What Are The Hidden Costs? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RcX-i3uZLj0&lc=UgwpcdP5z3PtXJSK2t4AaABAg.A_BQxorzP4jA_B_D3eky2S

"Travel and watch you regularly. I'm in NY state with a high-deductible plan G. Two questions: 1) Any way to anticipate the risk of "dead pooling" when choosing a plan? 2) Are there any brokers than can help with high-deductible plans? The broker I spoke with said I would have to do that on my own, that "brokers can't help clients enrol in high deductible plans." Thank you for this clear explanation that has altered my understanding of supplement plans and underwriting — I had understood from a different YouTube channel that buying any supplemental plan at the outset (when enrolling in Part B) guaranteed the ability to change companies with no underwriting. Undoubtedly my own error."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugz73SydkGL8NK4FKIh4AaABAg>

↳ @TenaB-j2l (0): "That's a lie from the broker, Chapter Medicare can do that."

"My wife and I had been on Plan F but several years ago we switched to Plan N with a different carrier resulting in significantly lower premiums. Switching normally involves medical underwriting but if you do not currently have an expensive condition it should not be hard to qualify. But this does underscore the need to pick a supplement plan for the long term. I'm glad you spoke about excess charges, I think often the risk is grossly overstated. We are both pretty healthy for geezers so don't go to the doctor very often. So even if our health deteriorates we are betting our lifetime supplement cost will be lower with Plan N, but YMMV."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=Ugz2q-iaaj1QqQtkpMd4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Absolutely! Thanks for commenting 😊 "

↳ @Slo-ryde (1): "@tomschmidt381 I was referring to high deductible plan F (which is no longer available to new enrollees)... the whole selling point of F (both types) is that the premiums were lower than N, and if you are someone who does not utilize the healthcare system much, then it would make more sense to have taken F, as the savings are realized by the lower premiums (as is my understanding). But now plan F has been supplanted by plan G (high deductible version)."

↳ @Slo-ryde (0): "How could plan F, a high deductible plan.... Be more expensive than plan N?"

"Retired early 61 my Bronze \$6500 deductable \$7500 out of pocket \$489 a month premium the next year 62 it went up to \$1283. A 63 it's \$1289. Next year at 64 it's estimated at \$1500. This is the same plan and the cheapest the plan. 2028 I'll be 65 and Medicare with gap and all coverage will be around \$600. We need a Medicare for universal healthcare. Remove the insurance companies and have the federal government guarantee the funds and we pay through are taxes."

— YouTube · Managing Income for ACA Subsidies in Early Retirement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EcmjePg8f1M&lc=UgyCMWUEJJRteWuVpBB4AaABAg>

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "Totally agree. We need Congress to act."

↳ @mike-e4e4e (1): "We're mid 50s. Our 2 person plan is \$1800/mo with a \$6500 out of pocket max. Meaning we will pay \$28k for insurance annually. This was the best we could find as we don't qualify for any subsidies. It will only go up from here."

↳ @RetireEarlyWithMelanieAndKeith (1): "@mike-e4e4eI think we are all looking for a better healthcare option."

Medicare.gov, SHIP counselors and Social Security · 32 documents · 20 voices

"That's just what things cost..." Usually, I get my EOB (explanation of benefits), do a quick review that I actually received the service and thank Medicare and my Part G for saving me the bill. However, yesterday I got an EOB that really ticked me off. After hip surgery, I was prescribed "cryo therapy" (for the uninitiated, it's known as an ice pack.) What arrived at my door in April was a piece of padded fabric with some Velcro attachments - 1) to fit the wrap to my waist and hip and 2) to attach a frozen gel pack. In my wildest imagination, I couldn't see this thing being worth more than \$100. And here's where the insanity begins. The vendor charged Medicare **\$3417.96** 🤔 Of that amount, Medicare paid **\$1095.74**. Nearly \$1100 for padded fabric and an ice pack. Nice work if you can get it. Some of you may say, "That's the system" and that's basically what 2 Medicare reps told me when I called to tell them they were ripped off. "Nothing we can do, that's just what things cost." And we wonder why healthcare is in its current state. Apparently, the same people who value screwdrivers at \$1500 for the defense dept. are doing double duty. I know I shouldn't be amazed but color me gobsmacked. Now if you'll excuse me, I'm off to find a glass and some scotch aka "aroma therapy."

— r/medicare · 109 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1v3wccf/>

↳ (0): "Can you return it? If not can you report it to Medicare's Senior Medicare Patrol or ask SHIP for a resource. When you get a prescription it is out of your hands. You HAVE to take it?! Can you show it to your prescribing physician or the PT company you used? That is utterly ridiculous. Send it to your US Congress person and ask what should /could be done to recover these funds. There must have been an error coding that tag instead of a cryo machine. Can you look at MSN and get the code to see what they billed for? Now I'm needing some aroma therapy just reading about it."

↳ (0): "It was coded as a miscellaneous brace which clearly it was not. The vendor was chosen for me so... The attitude at Medicare of "Ho hum, oh well, stuff happens" was beyond frustrating. My doctor will probably throw up his hands and try to sympathize. I guess I can always escalate with a tersely worded missive to Dr. Oz..."

↳ (0): "I invite you to write a letter to your 2 Senators and your 2 Representatives in Congress. When the debate over single payer healthcare begins again, and it surely will, they will remember your \$1,000 ice pack. "If you see something, say something." To members of Congress. Do not imagine they know the details of \$1,000 ice packs. They do not."

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1iten4m/>

↳ (0): "I have also found the Medicare experience like a breath of fresh air. It is so nice not having to worry about it."

↳ (0): "I feel the same way. I am a somewhat insecure person (lol), and probably some of my fears of not having health insurance go back to growing up and watching my father lose his job at 58 years old. He worked for his company for over 35 years and they cut him loose when his health began deteriorating. (He was a commercial artist and his hand wore out from repetitive stress injury. I remember his fear that he would lose the house and everything else.) Plus, a few surgeries that I had and the astronomical bills didn't help to put my mind to rest regarding the loss of insurance. Plus, my employer was not hesitant in eliminating people/departments at a moments notice. In short, Medicare has given me great peace of mind. It's not perfect and I know others may have completely opposite opinions, but I am so grateful to have it, I've seen what happens when you don't. Take care. :)"

↳ (0): "Thanks, OP. My spouse is turning 65 in April, and we really need to get on this. You mentioned YouTube videos. Do you have any particular channel that you found most helpful?"

"Thanks Erin. This is a much-needed video for millions. I did my homework for a full 6 months before joining Medicare and learned what I needed to learn. I had to go to many resources in addition to Medicare site itself. I wish I had this video to simplify my life but I am going to forward to those reaching 65 soon. You, undoubtedly, did an outstanding job for the entire senior/Medicare community. On behalf of millions, thank you."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzrY6wrecXKKs-U6oF4AaABAg>

"I have been a volunteer Medicare counselor for 12 years. Part of the State Health Insurance Assistance Program (SHIP) I have help almost 2000 seniors enroll in Medicare and see many of them annually for a Medicare check-up. I assist people in enrolling in both Advantage and Medigap plans. In my 12 years I have had many scores of people come to me to switch from their Medigap plan to an Advantage plan. Primarily because their Medigap plan has become unaffordable due to age based increases. In all those years I have had only 1 person inquire about switching from their Advantage Plan back to original Medicare."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzDR9MTPothxM3jWTF4AaABAg>

↳ @LeftRoaster (1): "With Medigap you do risk getting Deadpooled. Your pool gets closed to new signups. The insurance company dumps all the fit 65 year olds in a new pool and you are stuck in the closed pool with all the sick older folks. They go to the insurance commissioner and ask for a hike. New players can offer teaser rates and grab market share and then ask for a rate adjustment double digits. The 2026 Premium Surge: According to data compiled by Telos Actuarial, early 2026 state insurance filings revealed that major national carriers (including Aetna, Cigna, and Mutual of Omaha) requested massive rate corrections. Plan G policies—the most popular type—saw first-quarter premium jumps ranging from 12% to over 26%."

↳ @johndaly8060 (0): "I really appreciate the SHIP program. Thank you nd your comrades around the country."

↳ @michelleyang2310 (0): "The premium of Medigap plan is age based and increases every year?"

"I want to thank you for your honesty. I am 67 & I went through a Medicare rep that my best friend had. The rep kept steering me towards an Advantage plan. I asked her how much money she made signing me up. She said \$25.00 per person. I signed up for Medicare & a Medigap plan G from the get go. Unfortunately my best friend signed up for an Advantage plan."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgyJAhN00Ri7418jYY94AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (4): "We are here to provide help and clear information. We like to ensure everyone is in the best plan for them, not for our pockets. We're pleased that any information we provide is helpful!"

↳ @palady1486 (1): "this is what happened to me and my husband. I ask a lot of questions and he didn't have answers so I dug even deeper into this mess. We picked Medicare A and B and supp G plan and a stand alone RX plan. He was not happy."

↳ @threeftr3349 (1): "@palady1486 Of course he was not happy. Sounds like he was more concerned about his loss of a big commission, than your healthcare needs."

"I went to the social security office to sign up for medicare when I turned 65 and I was told if I was still working and had health insurance I didn't need do anything!! When I did sign up later I would need to have some forms signed to prove I had insurance! FYI!"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙌 · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgyUwwuGl6Z6y7n9IP94AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "Correct, you can delay if covered by a large employer's Group insurance."

↳ @sterlingmarshel6299 (0): "that's what he explained"

↳ @verbalwidget0919 (0): "@sterlingmarshel6299thank you Mr know it all"

"I took Medicare Part A when I turned 65 but not Part B because still working for employer with more than 20 employees. I am planning on retiring this year so the timing of presenting to the Social security office proof that I have been on continuous coverage since 65 is useful. I agree how complicated they've made it. Unfortunately our American health care system is profit driven."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=Ugy0ftj8wwg9Fqv6e1V4AaABAg.9zyADkU6_pgA07m7aCqzbg

"I 'traveled' here from your video on Advantage plans. I tried to go to your channel page to find this video but it didn't show up there. So I had to replay the end of the last video and click on the link to this one. Hope this makes sense, and I hope it not showing up on your channel will resolve itself! Very discouraging to hear of the large price increases but can't say I'm surprised. I have always just researched my options on the Medicare website but this year I will be contacting an agent to get some help with my choices. Thank you for the excellent info you always provide."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugy93ORLHCIXOhpz4Lx4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Thank you so much for watching! Yes, this video is currently "unlisted" so the only way to get to it is through the end of the Advantage video. This one will go live likely Sunday or Monday :) I appreciate you!"

"Wow! Your first Medicare issue just happened to me. I left my employer insurance for Original Medicare (I'm still working). I thought all was well. But every time I went to my Medicare account I'd see 2 insurances: Original Medicare and my company's health plan (which I had left). I checked for a couple of weeks thinking my employer plan would eventually be deleted, but it wasn't. So I had an online chat (I wanted it in writing--no phone call) with the Medicare rep to explain that I no longer had company insurance. Then she asked: So you want original Medicare to be your primary insurance? Duh! Of course I said yes. Now my employer insurance is off the site and only Original Medicare and my Plan D Rx plan are there. Whew! I managed to dodge a bullet. I haven't used the insurance yet, so I don't see my Medigap Plan there. My Supplement plan (United Healthcare) said once a doctor sends a claim, then Medicare will know I have a supplement. *I hope that is correct.* Always check your account to make sure things are in order!"

— YouTube · Top Medicare Claims Issues (and how to avoid them) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QWGAaZw0d6o&lc=UgyTbmD4yKfdlg2BE3x4AaABAg>

↳ @ragu_cr7 (2): "Hi, I'm a Medical biller from India who is working for the providers. So I understand what you're talking about. You don't have to worry about getting billed. Once Medicare approves the claim, the claim will be automatically forwarded to your medigap plan electronically.."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "This happens so often! It can often take a while for your supplement plan to show on your mymedicare.gov account but as long as your plan is active and premiums are paid, it should pay after Medicare approves a claim."

↳ @kathys53 (0): "@ragu_cr7 Thank you!"

"I did a appeal I sold my house but also retired... I got a IRMA Lettering warning me my premium will be going up...I went to the local Social Security office and spoke to the Type 2 clerk who took the added Premium amount off while sitting there I thanked her and paid the standard premium amount from then on.. If you can...DO NOT MAIL IN THE APPEAL...BRING ALL EVIDENCE AND PROOF OF YOUR LIFE CHANGING EVENT...YOU DO NEED PROOF...They can right there while you are sitting there remove THE IRMA letter and the extra premium charge."

— YouTube · Will Selling a Home Raise My Medicare Premiums? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Nabja99aeHw&lc=UgyH1oqojUAPh4vi_q94AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "This is exactly what I tell my clients! However, in many parts of the country it can be so hard to get a face to face appointment at the social security office. But in person is always best if you can!"

"@AbtInsuranceAgency thank you for such an easy to understand video of the difference. I called SHIP and was still so confused until I watched this. Is it true I have to get supplemental through a private carrier such as Aetna or Humana?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Vs. Medicare Supplement - An Unbiased Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EXNLA6j2x0M&lc=UgwicP9BcYgC0OAwdUh4AaABAg.92TeakBOy1O92i9Qcbw8D>

"I went to the medicare site today but I was looking for my plan g since the email from them talked about at least seeing what's available. But all they showed were the plans and this year's cost. Gee, thanks Medicare. That was a waste of time. I did get my ANOC on Sat 9/26. And yes I have the wellcare value script PDP. My premium here in New York State is 42.40 for 2026 and after all the histrionics in recent weeks about how the prices (well, premiums) could go up by 75%, I am now puzzled as to why it went down to \$37.30. I think the clue to solving said puzzle is that tier 1 standard is \$20 copay instead of \$15. And tier 2 standard is no longer \$20 copay but 25% of total cost for a 1-month supply and for preferred at tier 2 it goes from \$3 copay for 1-month to the same 25% of the total cost. Another puzzle for me is what is meant by 'total cost?' The MSRP of the drug? Does each pharmacy have a total cost for a given drug? Or is the total cost a price the insurer sets? Well good news, thanks to you indicating that the 2027 drug plan options are at least visible now (yes, can't select one). So this year 6 out of the 7 scripts I have are \$0 copay at the preferred pharmacy I go to. The other script is about \$50 and I pick it up twice a year, so \$100 for the year. I was ok with that. But now I see that even that script is \$0 at the 1st pharmacy. Once I confirm things after the 15th, I leave well enough alone but when it comes time to renew next year, I will tell my PA-C to send it to the supermarket pharmacy and not her hospital's pharmacy. So this all means that my total drug cost for 2027 will be \$447.60 (12 months x \$37.30/month). Thanks for the heads-up about the Plan D info."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Drug Plans: Two Things You NEED to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANgeD3oOJ40&lc=UgzfVbn9ALdNbJJjnod4AaABAg>

"Yes, I am aware of that, thank you. And thank you for your videos. My state allows me to switch to any other plan except Plan A (no longer sold?) and Plan F (don't qualify for that one due to my age) , so I can switch to a Plan N later, if that makes more sense. Right now, this is the path that works best for me. I have done extensive research and also discussed and got assistance from my SHIP representative. I had to get some Medigap plan within the bounds of my SEP (because, although my state - not NY btw- has better guaranteed issue rights than many others, I am still bound by the SEP timing or I lose guaranteed issue. HD-G premiums in my state are lower than Plan N, I am healthy right now (thank God!) and have few doctor's visits, so this seemed like a good choice for me. Am I taking advantage of the system, well, just doing what is right for me. I wish everyone the best. This is much more convoluted than it should be, and as I mentioned, your videos are very helpful in finding the way through the maze."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyYhExgJdVDH1dnNpp4AaABAg.9yNfosgcxRg9zWuaSDKqCd>

"I assume I'm like most people in most ways. I signed up for Medicare in the 7 month window around my 65th birthday (three months before, the month I turned 65, and three months after). I delayed starting the coverage and provided evidence of insurance since I was still working so I didn't get a penalty when I started it. I don't remember the exact process but it was very straightforward with some form that my employer had to provide. But I could have just done the Part B stuff at the same time if I were retiring then. When I formally retired 18 months later, I signed up for social security benefits, and indicated that I wanted Medicare part B to start, set up my automatic payment, etc. The only thing I found confusing is that I couldn't initiate the Part B coverage at the Medicare website, I had to do that at the Social Security website. But it was all very straightforward, everything was done online except some employer forms, and I had zero issues."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugx3qmlvwLN6NGDfhU94AaABAg>

"Hello mam..im a new subscriber as of today (nov 13 2021)..and I have a question that maby you can do a video on for U.S VETERAN'S ABOUT THESE MEDICARE PLANES..AND WHICH PLANES WOULD BE BEST AND INCLUDE THAT GIVE BACK TO OUR Social Security..of which they never told me when I put in For my social security..that Money would be taken out for Medicare. In fact. I knew nothing about Medicare .they never explained that to me at the social security office when I applied at age 66..so can you can you help us VETERAN'S OUT HERE.. BECAUSE NO ONE ELSE SEEMS TO CARE..AND YES I DO HAVE MY V.A HOSPITAL benefits..but since this covid-19..things Have gone crazy..THANK YOU MAM..AND WILL BE WAITING FOR YOUR RESPONSE..SIGNED U.S.M.C RETIRED..👍👍👍 "

— YouTube · Medicare Part B Give Back Benefit - What's The Catch? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dMy1JJvQwTs&lc=UgwmDfbDtby9JtEFK-J4AaABAg>

"I have medicare/ share of cost medicaid. I was told I can still switch to a supplement. Im am 70. I have medicare/ full medicaid. But when my x died and I received his ss my income increase. Im not sure if I should switch to a supplement. I have only B.P and high cholesterol. Nothing else. I spoke to a person from SHIP. They said I can get a supplement for about 100\$ month. My share of cost is my whole ss check and it is a monthly deductible. Im not sure what's best for me. I recently went in ER and my 14,000 bill i had to pay only 400\$. If you can give me any guidance please help. And I also wonder in I can get a supplement can I switch back to share of cost medicaid"

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugw_Y7vr57pPEQItN0R4AaABAg

"It's been trending that way for a while. Just ran into it. I started with a new MA plan this year and was referred by my dentist to an oral surgeon for a biopsy, but after I called the referred surgeon's office they told me they no longer take Medicare, MA or supplements. So I called the BCBS to see who they have in-network. The only one they had was this office and gave me their names. BCBS rep called the OS and confirmed they are no longer accepting any flavor of Medicare. They then told me to start calling around. Instead I went to the Medicare site to see who they have listed. Not a single oral surgeon in a 200 mile radius. Closest one is nearly 300mi away."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1j9odhm/28_cut_to_medicare_payment_to_physicians_approved/mhhc5qf/

"I contacted my Ship Counselor supposedly head lady I explain that my 2025 PPO plan merged with a different new PPO plan in 2026 but the coverage is totally different. So I couldn't get that guarantee issue right letter even though my plan ended. The head guy from advantage went line by line in the annual notice change and he agreed the plans pay completely different. Then he said we merged them in case someone didn't make a switch then they would have no coverage. WTH. Ship lady says nothing she could do since they're merged. I said so you're going to allow this behavior. She said nothing she can do about it. WTH"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=Ugx7ya7JPIAvkVSAMO14AaABAg.A_Ryk3k9t9UA_S5apGlFzO

"FINALLY a clear, concise and FREE explanation of this very confusing topic. I am 66 and still working, with credible insurance coverage, plus I have an HSA! I believed I had the right NOT to enroll in Medicare at all when I turned 65, based on wading through the Medicare website, but one of my doctors insisted that was wrong. You have confirmed I was correct. I would add one more caveat about the HSA. You need to STOP all contributions to your HSA at least six months prior to your retirement because Medicare goes back up to six months in determining your eligibility regarding the HSA. THANK YOU!!!"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=Ugy-YJishPmrikDPuyd4AaABAg>

Appealed a denial or filed a complaint · 32 documents · 20 voices

"My late mother who died just less than a year ago had UHC-MA as her insurance and she needed physical therapy to help make her well enough for ovarian cancer treatment. After a few weeks she received NOMNC (notice of Medicare non-coverage) notices, which I appealed and won for her ten times over the span of just over a month (basically had to appeal 2-3 times a week). She lost a second level appeal, and with the assistance of a law school clinic, she won her ALJ (administrative law judge) appeal. Unfortunately, the win was two months after she died from the cancer. The system was designed to slow down her progress and see her die before they really had to pay out (the actual chemotherapy and additional services). I'm not a violent person, but what happened to the CEO of UHC did not have me shedding any tears."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 4,193 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyLL0RuYD8EU19OYq14AaABAg>

↳ @randyhowey7414 (264): "The UHC guys death didn't bother me either, sorry about your mom, fortunately? my mom was able to die at home like she wanted, I took care of her best I could but she wouldn't go to the Dr. She made it to 91 yrs old."

↳ @StrikeWarlock (160): "In this house, Mangione is a hero."

↳ @P.M.B99 (80): "@randyhowey7414Yessa rest her soul I know she had great memories and a wonderful life and she obviously left a wonderful legacy(you).¹⁰⁰ "

"I was hospitalized with a heart issue. I spent a week in hospital I had an advantage plan. I live 1 1/2 blocks from a hospital but they didn't participate in my plan (1) I went to a hospital 1/2 hour away that did. I was sent to a rehab facility after the week in the hospital. 2 days after arrival I was informed I contracted COVID. I was isolated for 2 more weeks total of three weeks on my back in bed. When rehab began I couldn't even stand. After 1 week of intense pain and effort I was able to stand. I then received a call stating that my insurance had ended coverage and that I would be sent home I would require home care at my expense. I appealed and was granted a few more days. It was long enough to switch to plan g just in time. My cat was my inspiration. Everything is fine, I am walking and able to function at home now."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 83 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxtFiT9QsmW9PgyxKN4AaABAg>

↳ @donmoore7785 (2): "It is surprising that you were able to switch from MA to Plan G, especially since you had an existing condition."

↳ @Joecrow-waytogo (1): "Thank God and thank you for sharing this valuable information."

↳ @loriar1027 (1): "That plan G must have been expensive, though. It usually is if you go from MA to regular M with a supplement."

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

↳ (0): "It should automatically go down in January, if your income goes back down. We won appeal in 2024 and again in 2026 based on retirement events."

↳ (0): "I just asked Google this question "can you go off medicare to avoid irmaa" You should do the same and read the full reply. (It basically says don't do it and gives options to reduce IRMAA which I am including below.) # Here is what it says about dropping Medicare: **No**, dropping your Medicare coverage to avoid IRMAA (Income-Related Monthly Adjustment Amount) is rarely a good idea. \[1](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenrolling_later_on/)\] If you voluntarily disenroll from Part B and Part D, your IRMAA surcharges may temporarily stop, but you will face severe consequences: \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>)\] **Gaps in Coverage:** You will be left without coverage for basic outpatient care, doctor visits, or prescription drugs. **Permanent Late Enrollment Penalties:** When you try to re-enroll in Medicare later, you will face hefty, permanent late enrollment penalties. **Lack of Guarantee:** You may not be able to simply re-enroll whenever you want; you will have to wait for the General Enrollment Period (January 1–March 31) with coverage beginning the following July. \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [2](<http://www.investmentnews.com/retirement-planning/what-happens-to-medicare-when-you-suspend-social-security-bennies/48121>), [3](<https://thebig65.com/medigap-plans-guide/>), [4](<https://boomerbenefits.com/medicare-enrollment-period/>), [5](<https://www.leonardfinancialsolutions.com/transition-from-employer-insurance-to-medicare/>)\] # These are the ways it suggests for reducing IRMAA: **Better Ways to Reduce or Avoid IRMAA** Instead of dropping your Medicare coverage, consider these legally recognized strategies to lower your MAGI or appeal the surcharge: \[1](<https://www.schwab.com/learn/story/how-higher-income-can-affect-medicare-premiums>), [2](<https://www.medicareresources.org/blog/four-ways-to-avoid-income-related-medicare-surcharges/>), [3](<https://decimawealth.com/planning/avoid-irmaa-surcharges/>)\] **File an Appeal for Life-Changing Events:** If your income dropped due to a qualifying life event (like retirement, work reduction, divorce, or the death of a spouse), you can appeal to the Social Security Administration using [Form SSA-44](<https://www.ssa.gov/forms/ssa-44.pdf>). **Reduce Taxable Income Pre-Retirement:** Maximize pre-tax contributions to employer-sponsored retirement plans (like a 401(k) or 403(b)) before you hit age 65. **Make Qualified Charitable Distributions (QCDs):** If you are 70½ or older, you can donate up to \(\$111,000\) per year directly from your IRA to a charity. This money is not counted as taxable income, thereby lowering your MAGI. **Roth Conversions Early On:** Strategically converting traditional retirement accounts to Roth IRAs *before* you reach Medicare age can reduce your future taxable RMDs (Required Minimum Distributions).\[1](<https://youstaywealthy.com/how-to-avoid-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [3](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/medicare/avoid-the-irmaa-with-a-roth-conversion>), [4](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenrolling_later_on/), [5](<https://medicareagentshub.com/questions/how-can-i-avoid-or-reduce-irmaa-charges-on-my-medicare-premiums/>)\] — Hope this helps. I do Roth conversions which increase my income. IRMAA is triggered. (There is a 2 year look back so the impact of this years conversions cause IRMA 2 years later). If I stopped conversions, iRMAA would stop 2 years later. But I could use some the money I converted to pay the IRMAA if I had to. I don't fully understand your issue, but hopefully this helps you with some options. 🙏 "

↳ (0): "I dropped my part b due to an Irmaa spike and stayed on my wife's insurance for three years, as long as you have creditable coverage it's not issue, you just have to reapply."

"New to Medicare This Year - More Confusing Than I Thought! I had helped my mother and my mother-in-law with their Medicare in the past. I also had worked in Human Resources early in my career and learned a lot about insurance. So I thought that signing up for Medicare would be easy for me. But, not having looked at this stuff in at least 10 years, I found it a lot more confusing than I had expected! I'm turning 65 in a few months. I'm in SF Bay area of California. I already know that I want traditional Medicare and not Medicare Advantage. I started taking Social Security at the beginning of this year (2025) so I automatically got a Medicare number and automatically got enrolled into Parts A & B. Now I need to pick a Plan D for drugs and a Medigap plan, which I already know will be a Plan G. In that regard, perhaps I'm ahead of the game. But picking a Plan D and a Plan G is turning out to be much harder than I'd thought it would be. I was glad to have watched a few YouTube videos about the process for signing up for each of these things -- that helped a lot, as well as reading the Medicare website and some info from AARP, etc. I found out that some of the Part D plans I was considering have limits on how many pills can be filled in 30 days for some meds. An SSRI that I take requires 90 10mg pills each month, because I take 25 mg per day and there is no 25 mg pill (nor is there a 50 mg that can be cut in half). So the plans that limit me to 30 10mg pills per month are a non-starter. (Sure, I could probably have my doctor try to appeal and get the 90 pills per month covered, but there is no guarantee that the insurance company would agree....and then I'd be stuck! Not worth the hassle!) This information was kinda buried at the bottom of each Part D plan on the Medicare website. It would have been a "bad surprise" to learn this after the fact! Regarding Part G -- this really surprised me -- the only Part G plan for my area that shows the premium and extra perks upfront is the AARP United Healthcare plan. ALL of the others don't even have a special page (or set of pages) about their Medigap plans! How are you supposed to compare the plans if you can't even see what you're paying for? I understand that all of the plans cover the exact same things; that's not what I want to know. I want to see rate tables (because most of them are Attained Age plans. The AARP one is Community based rates, and one other that I'm considering, Transamerica, is age at issue based rate). I also want to see if there are any perks beyond the regular plan coverage (like gym membership or whatever). I don't want to have to go through an agent or get a broker involved. I've had bad experiences with them in the past. I want to do this myself and sign up directly with the insurance companies. I truly don't understand why NONE of the Medigap providers in my area have ANY information on their websites about Medicare or their Medicare plans. When you click on the "company website" link on the Medicare website, it takes you to a general home page about the insurance company. I have tried searching these websites for "Medicare" or "Medigap" or "Plan G" but the searches come up blank. Why even offer a Medigap plan if you're not going to show your benefits to your clients online???? I don't want to have to waste my time calling 3 or 4 insurance companies! Only AARP seems to be upfront with any of this stuff. It's so weird, and I truly don't understand it! Am I missing something or misunderstanding something? Are the insurance companies deliberately making it hard for people to understand exactly what they're buying??"

— r/medicare · 33 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ls9lyr/>

↳ (0): "I agree you can't find true info without contacting companies individually. I found that there are some options that might make it difficult. Smoking makes a difference, paying yearly can make a difference. Someone else in the household with the same company can make a difference. Wearables can make a difference. Like you I spent hours on YouTube (glad I did), called a few companies directly then got retirement nerds involved after I had narrowed things down. They actually placed the policy for me after helping to answer a few questions. Figuring all of this out was like a job. It worked out well for me. Good luck."

↳ (0): "Don't go with UHP. Profiteers from the pain and suffering of humans. Major lawsuits and denials. It amazes me this country still has not gone to universal healthcare. I'm on the original Medicare ABG&D. G is with Anthem BC. No perks. Simple and easy with my Drs. No issues so far in 13 months. They are profiteers as well,

but I think they are less evil than the rest. D plans are stupid. They all have their "formulary" lists and none are the same \$\$ for identical drugs. Tier 1/2/3/4 garbage. But it's better than nothing. I have Wellcare. Not great but cheap. I've heard from friends in the SF bay area that Kaiser advantage is excellent. Of course you have to use them. But they are well established there. I'm in an area where there are hardly any Kaiser facilities. The agents that "help" are paid to drive you to their plans. They make \$\$ on your payments. Agents should be eliminated. It's a parasite business."

↳ (0): "Untrue about agents that drive you to their plans. Most agents are pretty good folks doing a good job. Signed, a parasite. D plans aren't stupid. If you don't get one, you get a penalty. But go ahead and not get one... see how that works out. UHC is fine - no different than any other carrier that you are bashing. Thanks for your nice, helpful post, btw!"

"I lost my job at 63 years old. When I became Medicare eligible 2 years later I successfully appealed the IRMAA determination to zero as I no longer had the income from employment 2 years prior."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=UgwF0l5oazOpolqFKXl4AaABAg>

"@danielhurley2894 I have an Advantage plan. I'm raising a red flag but doubt that our representatives in Congress will. They receive massive donations from the healthcare and pharmaceutical industry who also spend massive amounts on lobbyists. My doctor and physical therapist recommended further treatment, but after the initial 90 days (which included only ~16 visits because my copay was \$35), request for authorization was sent to a contractor for Aetna who did not respond to phone calls, voicemails, or emails—so no further treatment. I filed a grievance w Aetna; their response 2 months later was that I had treatment and they had no further request for authorization. Phone calls to Aetna— rep said there was no request w Aetna, didn't know anything about the contractor but admitted they do use outside contractors. I had a previous experience with an insurer who also contracted with outside companies whose job it is to deny claims. My neurosurgeon received a payment of \$150 months following my 6 hour surgery. There is no good health insurance company or plan in this country."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwRHs4R8-hbL8liv_R4AaABAg.9d4MiFJuUr99hx-Y8XZxIE

"Regarding pre-approvals. I believe that insurance companies are over using the pre approval process, simply because they know so few people will appeal. Yes you can ask your doctor to appeal, I have been in situations where the doctor's office didn't want to appeal and offered something else, my take was that they did not want to do a peer-peer review with insurance and simply palmed me off. Other than a second opinion there isn't much as a patient you can do in these situations. These issues and concerns are why I was motivated to take original medicare at retirement, I simply don't want to have to deal with pre-approvals. I am happy to pay more so I don't toss and turn in bed at night wondering how to handle an appeal. Unfortunately pre approvals are still there for Part D claims, not much that can be done about that."

— YouTube · The Truth About United Healthcare's Claim Denials and Dr. Oz's Plan to Force Medicare Adva · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LhIMMntQaY0&lc=UgzS8flwDYfBlpxcHdB4AaABAg>

"I just appealed my IRMAA surcharges for the upcoming year and got it approved. Saving me over \$400 a month."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: Why Your Medicare Premium Can Suddenly Explode · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R1MRB2YjYDY&lc=Ugyl7k8uV4VYGyaf6w94AaABAg.AQfaaQlrcdYAQgZHxUuXED>

"Hi - is CA a popular state for medicare advantage? Also I am wondering what the main selling point is for a Medicare advantage plan vs a regular Medicare plan. Why would someone want to switch? The minute I heard these are managed by private health ins companies was a sucker punch. I'm a 42 old who recently has had some health issues and getting United health care to approve much needed services has been a nightmare. Also my girlfriend has had issues too. Both of us have corporate plans and we gave had to pay out of pocket for services that should be covered under our plan, like CT scans and other type tests that our drs have issued as well as appealed, and still no approvals and we had to pay out of pocket. It was an eye opening and costly experience. The reason I would like to know what the main value is to getting an advantage plan is due to me looking at getting into the business. Would hate for a senior to get an advantage plan and get need services denied by the private ins company managing the plan, same thing that happens to me. Thanks in advance. For your reply."

— YouTube · What is Medicare Advantage? Medicare Advantage Plans Explained · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eRoWOPDW8DY&lc=UgxVVsSDuRpg5Du33_p4AaABAq

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "For some people and Advantage Plan can be a hood fit. It depends on your needs and your budget. In any case, it's important to understand the ins and outs of all of your Medicare plan options. A good independent broker will generally represent multiple plan types and options. Let me know if you have any other questions!"

"Retired at 63. Got a big six-figure leave payout, took social security (I should had waited), and the pension kicked in. All this put me in a higher tax bracket that year. Wont be making nearly as much the next year (just pension, and social security). Sounds like at 65 I guess I will have to file that appeal (if I get the letter) . . . Great video thanks for the info. 👍 "

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA 2025 Explained (Are a High Income Earner?) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ioM2gA1LLtI&lc=Ugz4VFGQc45GVKKaANt4AaABAq>

↳ @tonymanero5544 (0): "Medicare for IRMAA looks back 2 years. So in 2026 calculation, they look at your AGI in 2024."

"I had a kinda-sorta similar IRMAA appeal, and it appears to have succeeded. I say, "appears to have," because afterward, you have to send them your 2025 (in this case) tax return to confirm to them that you calculated the income drop correctly. In my particular case, I was not able to find all of the relevant information when I filed the appeal. In particular, dividends and capital gains on investments can change on the last day of the year, outside of your control. In my particular case, my calculation on my original IRMAA appeal was in fact off a bit. It was _still way below_ the IRMAA threshold, but did require amendment. Best I interpret the letters I've received from them, yes, I appear to have avoided the cliff this time!"

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA: What Most Retirees Get Wrong About Their Premiums · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w1PM7D2XD84&lc=UgxOg_VhTv5e8Dd_aw54AaABAq.Aa_UWeYysXXAa_iR1-cpls

"I had a transplant after years of dialysis every few months need hemoglobin or while cell boosters at 5-15,000 a shot getting pre approval with appeals etc could take weeks I'd have been dead by then win win for the advantage plan Also weeks of delta for fistula grams so no dialysis and probable death There is special Medicare coverage for kidney problem use it NOT advantage"

— YouTube · MORE Medicare Advantage Plans CUT: Millions Will Face Forced Dis-enrollment ❌ · 2 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPLaLyfDZxY&lc=Ugw0b1JL3ct8E9k5X2J4AaABAq>

"Doctors can perform procedures without Medicare approval and YOU pay the full amount (the amount the MD wants to charge) . I know because I have had to pay thousands out of pocket for tests that Medicare and procedures that Medicare did not approve and was denied after all appeals have run out (all 5 levels). I currently am on the hook for \$13,000 for heart related tests/procedures Medicare will not cover. You MD DOES NOT check with Medicare first to see if you're covered. I would give anything thing to go back to private insurance. No one tells you that Medicare DOES NOT COVER a multitude of things from simple vaccinations, blood tests and thousands of procedures. You're on you own AT FULL COST."

— YouTube · Medicare Explained in Plain English — Every Part, Every Cost, Every Decision · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ooZKCbXw-M&lc=UgwL2twEFZCdPX7BOMh4AaABAg>

"Go Packers! Love Federer! Looking at Plan GHD starting in 2026. Wondering how I can appeal the IRMAA due to the 2 year look back even though I will have retired in June '25."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRlOxmSo&lc=UgxIdPgyp6CrFdv13N4AaABAg

↳ @alankurtz2393 (1): "@Theretirementnerds Thank you so much for the info! Hopefully they will grant my appeal when the time comes."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching! 🟢 Here is a video on how to appeal: <https://youtu.be/8esTBooWIQY?si=zL97ZNZCHIE9ksya> A little older, but still applicable 😊 "

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "@alankurtz2393 i hope so too!"

"I signed up for Humana dental for 2026.... I signed up for Humana dental for 2026 and have regretted it ever since. When signing up in marketplace it seemed like it was the best option. They had my current dentist in-network(with no locations listed). First dentist appointment was in February, the submitted a claim and I then received a bill for almost the full amount minus \$19 and change, for an out-of-network dentist. I went to Humana's website and Dr.Lockney is still listed as in network. They have him listed in 4 locations, 3 being in network and 1 being out. Fact: Dr.Lockney only works at ONE family owned practice, he does NOT work or has ever worked at any other practice or location . I called Humana with my findings.They informed me that my information is correct and his location is out of network, no solution. As I explained again my situation they informed me they actually do not have any in network dentists in my city. They said I should file an appeal which I had already done and was denied. Customer service said they would contact Dr.Lockney to see if he would like to join their network, I ask if they would back date my claims if he did, she said "I don't know". I explained again that this is not user error and they are at fault and my claims should be paid. She again stated I should file an appeal and they will fix the misinformation on their website. By this time (August 2026) I have seen Dr.Lockney twice and my daughter once with a cost of \$840.80. I have paid Humana \$566.37 with an outstanding bill of \$161.82 = \$728.19 total YTD. So basically I will have paid \$1,568.99 for dental YTD. Humana is a total scam. They basically make up the "in network" doctors list. And never pay any of your claims with the excuse of "location". The outcome I would like to see is a full refund for all the money I have given them to be insured, pay for the dentist for my troubles and cancel. I'd like to mention I have proof of all of this. Lockney Dental (704) 324-8521 Kelley Burren 7047013087 Concord, NC Claim# 202602116380321"

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a873579330d94cb96c65de3>

"UHC double billed me for my Part D.... UHC double billed me for my Part D Medicare Advantage Plan. It was paid by me and also through Social Security deductions. I informed them and they asked me to give them proof. I sent all the receipts and other verification twice and both times I was told they never received anything. The third time I sent registered mail with return receipt. I got the return receipt showing they have received it but I got the same song and dance from them. We never received it. You can't argue or fight with someone or an organization that is in complete denial. I needed physical therapy last winter but there wasn't an in network PT center in my area. They said I would have to travel 75 miles over snowy mountain roads for an half hour session at an in network center. I appealed twice. The second appeal was granted for 3 months of PT at the center in my area. I was informed of it 9 days before the 3 months was up. I was told it was my fault for not checking up on it. I checked every week but was told they had never received the appeal. I did get 3 PT sessions in those 9 days which they later denied saying it was never approved. I sent them their written approval twice but guess what , they said they never received it. I believe that their modus operandi is to win by attrition."

— TrustPilot · UnitedHealthcare · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aaaae1fa5d5f2677bf28156a>

"I switched to plan G from plan F, which I had been on for 10 years. In fact I was on what was called F plus and didn't even know it but when I realized I was paying the insurance company, the supplement provider, the Medigap company about \$900 a year so they would have the privilege of paying my part B deductible. That's the benefit I got from paying the extra premium. I paid over \$600 in free money to them for nothing. I've been on plain G ever since. It's not cheap and I have to say my wife's Medicare advantage plan with a zero premium and almost no copayments except small copayments for her medication's and every once in a while an additional copayment for a procedure is very appealing. She gets excellent coverage and excellent service and has never had any delays or denials. On the flipside she does sometimes have to wait months to see a specialist who is very popular and so has a full schedule."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=Ugy6-MafSrRIGxiZ2FZ4AaABAg>

"I went to a dentist for a bridge. He confirmed allowance first with united healthcare. Told me it would take all of my allowance for the year. Scheduled and went to appointments, scheduled the last appointment and his receptionist phoned me. She asked if my insurance allowance was lowered. I told her no and asked why. She replied that the billing was sent and the dentist wasn't paid the full amount. She then told me that the dentist is canceling the last appointment. If I pay the remaining balance, the work will be completed. I filed a grievance against dentist. Didn't hear anything, phoned UHC and was told they couldn't find it, I had to file at least 4 grievances and never got a response..... have continued to try to contact UHC to no avail. They send my call to the Phillipines or to another department... what can I do?"

— YouTube · The Truth About United Healthcare's Claim Denials and Dr. Oz's Plan to Force Medicare Adva · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LhIMMntQaY0&lc=UgzqRdeK8PeaJCMmM9x4AaABAg>

"I'm 70 and am on Medicare, work part-time, made less than \$50,000 in 2024. My husband is much younger, is not on Medicare, and is in construction (self-employed, S-corporation). In 2024 he made over the \$400,001 threshold, and I got hit with IRMAA. The year before, he had a loss in the business of (- \$100,000). This occurred just based on how and when income and expenses are booked from year to year, when self-employed. First, I know they include joint income (even though my husband is not on Medicare), but really unfair to me. Secondly, we did not even see the money, it never hit our personal funds but stayed in the business, and used for the following year's 2025 expenses. Now in 2025, his income is below the thresholds. Do you think I have a chance at an Appeal? Cliff"

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA: What Most Retirees Get Wrong About Their Premiums · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w1PM7D2XD84&lc=UgwnjEyXVTLQX0dLfst4AaABAg>

"Demand to See the Ultra Fine Print. I have a Humana Medicare Advantage plan. The plan I was sold specifically states that an annual dental allowance of \$1000 is included. This year, I needed a crown. Denied. When I asked why, they directed me to a website that had hundreds of pages of fine print. Somewhere on this site, it stated that everything else in Dental was included, EXCEPT CROWNS. I appealed, asking what the difference was and why a measly \$1000 could not be used on any preventative dental care. They took four months to 'process my appeal', then sent an email that said nothing more than Appeal Denied. No explanation and no way to contact anyone who was part of the process. Do not trust this company."

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aa2ccb091801eedb07a8e07>

Switched from Advantage back to Original Medicare + Medigap · 24 documents · 20 voices

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_l4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🙏 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌👏"

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"Thanks for the excellent video. I am on AARP Medicare Advantage UnitedHealthcare PPO. My wife was on the same plan, but we kept hearing bad things about Advantage and we both attempted to switch back to traditional medicare in 2023. She was accepted, I was not. I was told I could not because I had received a couple of steroid shots in my spine due to arthritis. We are both 71 and in good health for the most part. I have had cancer (16 years ago), but my wife is in excellent health and always has been. We also full time RV's. We winter in Tucson Nov-April and the rest of the year we migrate with the birds. I have just subscribed. I wish health care in America was not such a game show, but it is."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 25 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxgkqFeVTXyGsSK5nV4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching and subscribing! Check out our recent videos because we are mid-48 state road trip 😊 In A mini van though... not an RV"

"I have continued feeling a great deal of relief that I wormed my way out of a mistaken choice to get an Advantage plan. I was hooked by the offer of a vision plan. But then I learned all the shady stuff various Advantage plans can do, and because I am in NC and on Medicaid, I had a 6 month period to change my mind,. I switched back to original Medicare the minute I got my new pair of glasses. And I learned about how messed up Advantage plans can be thanks to YouTube. Thank you for making this video!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwiVOAo3PYIG4-Wj54AaABAq>

↳ @ragtop326 (0): "My vision plan only covered \$100 towards glasses, and I had to pay for my own exam \$89. In Viet Nam, RX glasses only cost \$14. What's wrong with our country. They're money hungry, that's all."

"I have been a volunteer Medicare counselor for 12 years. Part of the State Health Insurance Assistance Program (SHIP) I have help almost 2000 seniors enroll in Medicare and see many of them annually for a Medicare check-up. I assist people in enrolling in both Advantage and Medigap plans. In my 12 years I have had many scores of people come to me to switch from their Medigap plan to an Advantage plan. Primarily because their Medigap plan has become unaffordable due to age based increases. In all those years I have had only 1 person inquire about switching from their Advantage Plan back to original Medicare."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzDR9MTPothxM3jWTF4AaABAq>

↳ @LeftRoaster (1): "With Medigap you do risk getting Deadpooled. Your pool gets closed to new signups. The insurance company dumps all the fit 65 year olds in a new pool and you are stuck in the closed pool with all the sick older folks. They go to the insurance commissioner and ask for a hike. New players can offer teaser rates and grab market share and then ask for a rate adjustment double digits. The 2026 Premium Surge: According to data compiled by Telos Actuarial, early 2026 state insurance filings revealed that major national carriers (including Aetna, Cigna, and Mutual of Omaha) requested massive rate corrections. Plan G policies—the most popular type—saw first-quarter premium jumps ranging from 12% to over 26%."

↳ @johndaly8060 (0): "I really appreciate the SHIP program. Thank you nd your comrades around the country."

↳ @michelleyang2310 (0): "The premium of Medigap plan is age based and increases every year?"

"I dropped United Healthcare Advantage plan last year and went back to original Medicare and Humana supplement plan, I'll never go back, I can go to any doctor or hospital I want to go to it's great, it cost \$120.50 a month here in Oklahoma for Humana plan G, I went to eye doctor yesterday and set it up a cataract surgery, it will be done 7-06-26 no referral and with who I want..."

— YouTube · IT KEEPS HAPPENING | ANOTHER Medicare Advantage Company Cancels ALL Plans · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j2ENvE0j1gc&lc=UgxwrOhvpmwtbvAo0TI4AaABAq>

↳ @ReginaCline-u8i (1): "Thank you for the info, i to plan on keeping A and B. But needed a part D drug program, and had always worked with Etna they are great. With ma as a back up, ma isn't doing it any more. They notified the doctors be for me, and then they started firing volleys at each other then me. That's why i said i needed help. Thanks"

↳ @commonsense6967 (1): "Where I am, ALL the cataract surgeons accept my MA HMO and have since MA plans began."

↳ @pgrut8880 (0): "Yup. Might pay more after adding supplemental plan. But you have much less head aches."

"Great explanation of the two options. I wanted to add my experience. I started with original Medicare. I was then attracted by the extra benefits of the Advantage plans like dental and vision, so I switched. About 11 months in, my cardiologist wanted to perform a diagnostic procedure, but the pre-authorization was denied. I decided to switch back to original Medicare, and in my state, I was fortunate that my original Medigap insurer would accept be back without medical underwriting. As soon as I was covered by my Medigap plan, I had the diagnostic procedure done. It revealed that two heart arteries were 100% blocked, and a third was 80% blocked! The cardiologist and heart surgeon both said I was lucky I did not have a heart attack. Those extra benefits in the Advantage Plans are not worth my life. I never would have imagined an insurance company denying a cardiologist's request. I am curious how many patients have suffered and/or gone broke under an Advantage plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medigap at 65: The Real Costs Most People Don't Understand (Clip) · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M9hEKbgJg2w&lc=UgzatdULLbThq980Ddl4AaABAq>

↳ @stargazer-c5v (0): "Nope you wont go broke with an advantage but you will with the medigap. I guess you had the money to pay an extra \$500 plus copays. Well bully for you. What we need is government medicare for all not a for profit medical system. Imagine if firemen came to your looked at your fire insurance and said oh your policy doesnt cover your house just the property so we have to let it burn. You Americans are so blinded by greed and me bot attitude that ypu let the rich eat you"

↳ @gerryglauser2394 (0): "Alternately, I've had an Advantage plan for well over a decade. Before choosing a plan, however, I looked into their record. A year ago my cardiologist wanted multiple heart diagnostic procedures, which were done. In addition to AAA scans and others, I never had anything denied."

"I switched from Advantage to the supplement plan at age 72. It was not an issue. I also got the Medigap."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxlp1NR8QlwYKq:pH94AaABAq>

"The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq.AXFFtsLMytJAZXHpuUtXFuU>

"ANECDOTE ... I just switched from a Advantage Plan during Open Enrollment to a G Plan with the same Insurance co. They accepted the change without Underwriting... Fast and Easy. I would like to continue to review my options. Thank You."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgwYqbSkpcHnJJG5JBI4AaABAq>

"I am 77 years old and currently in a Medicare advantage nightmare. At first I had original Medicare with a supplement. I was looking for a way to cut my costs but still have decent health insurance. So a friend of mine said there was a lady who worked at Walmart that you could walk in and talk to and she was a good broker. Taking my friends advice, I did that, got into a Medicare advantage plan, which I've had for two years. I am really feeling stupid for not doing more research but Medicare and capitalism have made this process so complicated, that one must do extensive due diligence before deciding on a plan. I was diagnosed with rheumatoid arthritis about five or six years ago. As my symptoms are advancing, my RA doctor recommended some better but higher price drugs. I started looking into it and found that Medicare advantage will not pay for these drugs. Out-of-pocket cost run at least around \$5000 per year. Also, since I have RA, it is almost impossible for me to get back to original Medicare. I am devastated and not sure what I'm going to do. I have been talking to your Medicare seminar agents and am seeing if there are any possibilities left. It does not look promising."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgxSutev5rw74ep6rTx4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "All Part D plans, including those bundled with an Advantage Plan, must cover at least two prescriptions from every category of prescription. In addition, there are six categories of drugs that the insurance company must cover substantially all drugs available. Autimmune disease is one of those categories. If you can't get a drug it is for a reason other than "not available"."

"I got my letter saying my M A premier HMO POS is being discontinued and I need to get new insurance by Dec 31, 2025. My husband has same plan as me and when I called my insurance since he got no cancellation letter, I called, they told me he is not cancelled. Red flag here! If doing away with my plan, why is my husband still being covered by this plan. He got no notice and also got no ANOC. I told them to send me proof he is covered. My second call to my insurance company, the person I spoke with said I still had coverage. I told her that is not what this letter I got on Oct 2, 2025 says. It plainly says you are cancelled, you plan is being discontinued. My other thing is in back of Medicare book, it still shows plan available in 2026. If I go back to original Medicare, I pay my \$185.00 premium that is deducted from my SS check monthly. I also will pay a monthly premium to the plan I choose, plus higher copays for hospital and specialist doctors and primary Dr. It is all about insurance companies making and keeping their profits. Makes no difference I paid into Medicare my entire life Seems someone is lying to me."

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=UgxLcRkWaIF-oiHHVgJ4AaABAq.ANmidDT4xvkANuE5XrS6-x>

"We switched from Advantage to Plan N just this year--didn't need underwriting because our Advantage plan was cancelled by the provider, Humana. Figured this was a good time to try Original Medicare with supplement. I'm going to be interested to see, at the end of the year, where we stand with the change. I really liked Advantage with Humana, but do understand that it may not always be the best thing to have. I'm happy that I've never had to go to the doctor for a SUNBURN, though I've had plenty in my youth (there was no such thing as sunblock)."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugwt3Ce84ztixeqt5Dh4AaABAg>

"Great video as always. I switched from an advantage plan back to Plan G last year. The allure of the Advantage Plans got me to switch. Now after getting a bad case of sunburn, I'm glad I went back to plan G. I will be sharing this with family and friends. Thanks again!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugz6p8rPz-f1q9Wrkph4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching and sharing! 🌞"

"I have tried to shift back to Medigap and it is easier said than done. Also, if Oz gets his hands on Medicare, all this may be mute."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=UgwugsqP1ouBuPFV6eh4AaABAg>

"Live in Mass. can you help us switch from Advantage plan we have to a G plan?"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugzzoc7zygS7yOxtcdx4AaABAg>

↳ @medicare365 (0): "Mass doesn't have plan G. They have something that is similar."

"Erin, Great video as usual! I wanted to add a couple of other points. I signed up for Medicare Part A when I turned 65 even though I was still working full time and had healthcare coverage through my employer. Side note, I was led to believe that you must sign up at 65 or there would be a penalty! Not necessarily true! In my case was NOT because I had "creditable coverage" Perhaps you could cover that topic in a F/U video. Fast forward 3 months after enrollment in Medicare Part A (during annual enrollment for my employer) I decided to switch over from my employer health coverage to a Medicare Advantage Plan (which started my Medicare Part B in January) even though I had not yet retired. (I did retire at the end of February) Mid year I had second thoughts about Medicare Advantage but found out that since my Medicare Part A & B enrollment dates were not the same, that rather than having a year to change from Medicare Advantage to Medigap, I only had 6 months from when I enrolled in Medicare Part B (which now had passed) Having said all that I am still happy with my Medicare Advantage plan, which also pays for all but \$30 of my Medicare Part B monthly premium. That offset as well as NO monthly Medigap premium more than makes up for my 1 annual specialist co pay. My PCP MD (which I see twice a year) is a \$0 co pay. Last year I had several procedures (heart cath, ecocardiogram, and a pacemaker implant) and my entire out of pocket expenses (including prescription drugs) were less than 12 months of Medigap premiums. Things certainly may change in the future but the one thing for certain is no one has a "crystal ball" and if one puts away money saved from no monthly Medigap premiums that is a source to pay when times may be worse, and you have the max out of pocket annual amount! Thanks again for your indepth coverage of a VERY complex and confusing process!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugyhe_tnCPyyMzPulaZ4AaABAq

"I switched to Medicare advantage on January 1st. I switched back to a supplemental plan after watching this episode of John Oliver. I found a similar situation that John had described with my new Medicare advantage insurance plan. I had my primary doctor schedule (referral) a sleep study for me. The sleep center contacted me and told me they did not accept my insurance. I explained that the sleep center was listed on the insurance website as being in network, however, that was not correct. The sleep study center explained that they were not contracted with my insurance. As I found, the Medicare advantage insurance plan has a limited number of available doctors and facilities. Even though the financial incentives are very attractive, I don't want to sacrifice my health. The incentives for the advantage plan includes refunding my monthly Medicare premium, waived the deductible, and included dental and vision. At least now I can see any doctor I want without a referral."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyVG9Ymah-dmbtFjRB4AaABAq>

"I love the gray elephant. I would like to say that the most important to me is the problem in being about to go from Advantage to Supplement after I had it for more than a year. I think the supplement plan really covers people that may need a lot of health care, but if I had an accident and then needed lots of medical care, you are not able to switch to a supplement plan."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwVbvNdHuigLkJM7et4AaABAq>

"My spouse was already dealing with bladder cancer when signing up for Medicare, and our advisor made it clear traditional with supplement would be better for us, bc, in the future, if he ever wanted to go from Advantage to traditional, they would vet him, and things could then be declared pre-existing and not be covered... I chose the same for myself when I signed up..."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxvAeaRKfIGvy0hz-N4AaABAg>

"I went to change from an Advantage plan to a Plan G supplement. May I have an approximate price quote? I am 88 yrs young and never smoked..I live in zip code 17543..in Lancaster County, PA. Have been in Medicare A&B since Aug.1999. Thank you"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgzswIFXCsO4n288qEx4AaABAg>

↳ @jeannewitwer5072 (0): "My question was meant to be a comment. Sorry!"

Called a number from TV, the mail or a cold call · 22 documents · 20 voices

"I'm in Florida too and in my early years I didn't have health insurance. I had to go to the hospital for surgery and the bill came to nearly 100k. When I was being discharged, they were wheeling me towards the front door and suddenly veered off and went to the business office. They were demanding some sort of payment and also wanted me to sign papers saying I would pay the entire bill. I told them that I was still medicated and under doctors orders so I couldn't legally sign anything. My wife came in , very pissed off, and took me out of there. When they called a few days later I told them that I wanted an itemized bill. They argued with me and I told them that I knew that hospital bills are works of fiction and that I wanted the same discount that the insurance companies get. They knocked the bill down to \$6,000 and I told them I would send \$100 a month. After paying for 6 months I called them back and asked what it would take to pay it off. They agreed on \$1,500 and I sent them a check and they marked it paid in full. Of course now I'm on Medicare and have a supplement plan but anyone who's younger should remember that you can always negotiate."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgypslzdYHmZ7b1sgQJ4AaABAg.A8bQ-ZobSDuA8cVBGRqKWQ>

"My husband and I are only on social security have the same bills as everyone else we choose to pay for supplement husband had prostate cancer and broken leg had physical therapy I had two total knee replacement and other very expensive test throughout the 5 years on g husband 1800 a month and I make 1500 a month"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugy_Z4G4woonmXVcBW54AaABAg.AM45Z_Lbz2bAMXKXjGn5pl

"Since all or almost all of the TV commercials about Medicare promote the advantage plans, not the supplement plans, I've come to the conclusion that the insurance companies make more money from the advantage plans in the long run. In fact, I have never heard a Medicare TV commercial explicitly promote supplement plans. The fact that you have to be underwritten to be able to buy a new supplement plan (unless you're new to Medicare), but NOT so with new advantage plans AT ANY TIME, is further proof that insurance companies make more money with advantage plans, even if it means being less profitable in the short run, while seniors are younger and healthier. This is so that as they become older and sicker, they will not be able to go to a supplement plan that will cover them better, because they flunked the underwriting process, and therefore could not get supplementary insurance."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage I Pros, Cons and Myths · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANL8Sji0S1o&lc=UgwdXSuTBra6oArUP8x4AaABAg>

"I don't know what number you called because I called and made a reservation for a call back to register and when they called me back they never even mentioned advantage plans. They just verified that I was eligible and signed me up for Part A and B and I got them to set up automatic billing. It sounds like you didn't call the actual Medicare number."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwspuuSLr0lwSAb2np4AaABAg.AOTq8utKNuzAQfxw-oc20k

"I called United Healthcare and they didn't have a price for 2026 for my Supplement G plan. The cost increase was 7.43% from 2024 to 2025."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgycxgAKS3b7YPfrfA94AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Their supplement plan renewal is typically in June, so they won't have 2026 until closer to June"

"@IwasRetiredyou are correct. I called AARP and they said I could switch to plan N for 1900 dollars since my wife is under 65. The rate goes down when she reaches 65. I could never get plan F again if I switched so I decided to stay with F for two more years."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgzcwkhmPHNR8gGARQJ4AaABAg.AMr0NFwOybpAMr91gFGGFF>

"I wrote to you earlier tonight when i worked the hmo yes i remember. I have to try to keep this short but it will be tough.. I worked most of my life with a disability since a child.. it go in and out of readmission, and then alot thru the years hit other parts of body ..back in the day they told my parents by prom time i be in a wheel chair... NOT.. i went thru the episodes pain and kept going, older it was getting worse rheumo neuro and pcp wanted me to stop work way before i was ready too and lets put it this way alot went on , lots of health issues , then from joints, neck , gait, falls, to find out from the spine lots of damage, now it was muscle and nerve endings..i tried hard in early 50s to fight back.. but not working..at 55 it was over.i knew deep down.. but had that hopeful miracle happen...Since you know all with medicare and all.. due when i could not work my doctors of years would not take me , i had no insurance, people back then... not today but back then, if you worked all your life as i did, i got accepted which is unusual but so many medical records on all i had.. and testing..and specialists..attorney said probaly my state could be a year or two...for ssdi...which is the money i earned all my life working.. what is unfair... they go back 5 years average all your work...pay , the last year i had so many days out due specialisist said no you cannot go in. do had alot even a wound ankle., and mri cts and etc were bad...but all dropped me when i had no medical..i got a call 3 months after doctors my new ones i got one thru clinic and i am with her till today and she is also private..she got all on board to help..then from physically then to emotional i was more than down.. a private phychrist/counselor i despised to go to.. but of today i admire her as a mom, sister , friend and great doc that helped save me emotionally.. with all else going on...do you remember sir back in the day if you worked all your life or etc and went on disability... had to wait 2 years for medicare.. after accepted to medicare. but if i did not work, i could of got medical asap.....what a system.....made me feel like a failue..everything..so i got my ssdi..and 2 years later was medicare. out of my check 130.00 come out monthly for it... my medicine my pcp could get thru clinic. certain ones.....i had to pay.. that did it for my credit cards.. i had co pays that were horrific.. accept my pcp...Finally advocates for our state reached out to me.... and they will do all they can... never knew how theyy knew to contact me..they brought me they call them SHIP workers, to go all over my medical and they are proffessionals with all policies and they cannot pick one out. but then ripin workers came with me to meet up due was first thing they wanted fixed due alot i was going to need...The woman did so many companies and policies and excellent.. If i said i would think this one due to...my rep would say.. to the ship worker....okay the ship lady big machine.. put my docs my meds my everything thru say. so you will know these test you need or meds are not covered with this so do you want it i say no.. then she said i can finish this your case.. i said why.. she said elderly affairs has to look at this..... asap... i looked at my rep said i did nothing... only what i was told...i said what do i do now medicare is not taking care of my needs.. and the plan i had with it... i was taking out of check 130 out of ssdi and 180 for my blue chip... . the lady said the woman from elderly affairs is in next room....when she walked in sir....she was older but standing tall , and looks at me and said will you tell me how did this ever happen she said HOW... i will continue. next reply so you can hear with medicare an my plan now of last three years."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxtKzW1VKKKbDSp6cB4AaABAq>

"I signed up for Humana dental for 2026.... I signed up for Humana dental for 2026 and have regretted it ever since. When signing up in marketplace it seemed like it was the best option. They had my current dentist in-network(with no locations listed). First dentist appointment was in February, the submitted a claim and I then received a bill for almost the full amount minus \$19 and change, for an out-of-network dentist. I went to Humana's website and Dr.Lockney is still listed as in network. They have him listed in 4 locations, 3 being in network and 1 being out. Fact: Dr.Lockney only works at ONE family owned practice, he does NOT work or has ever worked at any other practice or location . I called Humana with my findings.They informed me that my information is correct and his location is out of network, no solution. As I explained again my situation they informed me they actually do not have any in network dentists in my city. They said I should file an appeal which I had already done and was denied. Customer service said they would contact Dr.Lockney to see if he would like to join their network, I ask if they would back date my claims if he did, she said "I don't know". I explained again that this is not user error and they are at fault and my claims should be paid. She again stated I should file an appeal and they will fix the misinformation on their website. By this time (August 2026) I have seen Dr.Lockney twice and my daughter once with a cost of \$840.80. I have paid Humana \$566.37 with an outstanding bill of \$161.82 = \$728.19 total YTD. So basically I will have paid \$1,568.99 for dental YTD. Humana is a total scam. They basically make up the "in network" doctors list. And never pay any of your claims with the excuse of "location". The outcome I would like to see is a full refund for all the money I have given them to be insured, pay for the dentist for my troubles and cancel. I'd like to mention I have proof of all of this. Lockney Dental (704) 324-8521 Kelley Burren 7047013087 Concord, NC Claim# 202602116380321"

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a873579330d94cb96c65de3>

"@IwasRetired Just an fyi & question....I picked Plan G with AARP when I started out 2 years ago. It has been great. Just pay your Plan B & Plan G. You don't have to think about anything. It truly gives you peace of mind. I picked AARP bc it was the biggest insurer but that does not mean their prices are the cheapest. After doing TONS of research mostly listening to every YouTube Medicare video out there, Plan N has become the best cost saver for the long run. Every year your plan will go up. Plan G gets higher % increases than Plan N. I go to the md's a lot. Even paying \$20 a visit, the overall cost in a year & over my lifetime will be less on Plan N. I called AARP to inquire about switching to Plan N from G. They told me there is no underwriting going from G to N under AARP. Perhaps if I went to another company wanting Plan N, there might be underwriting. I don't know. Does anyone know? I called AARP twice & both agents said I could switch anytime to Plan N from G with no underwriting. Also, I was concerned about the deductible that I already met on G. If I switch to N, does my deductible start all over again? Both agents told me no, which I was happy to hear bc I already paid my Plan G yearly deductible for the year. The only thing I don't know is if it is ez to switch from G to N because it is the same AARP company.....I also thought I will just go to N within the same company bc it seems to be no hassle. I wonder if I go from AARP Plan N to Aetna/Cigna/someone new, how hard would it be going from AARP N to a new less expensive company N? Any thoughts on this?.....Another tidbit: When I spoke to the AARP agent & said I have a few questions bc I am thinking of switching from Plan G to Plan N....the agent said, " Ohhhh, you want to downgrade your plan?"....lolol....I laughed to myself. Most people don't realize it, but agents get a bigger commission each month on G over N. Actually, it's an upgrade bc you will save more money in the long run with N....."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgyIM5AreXhzxJF8V4Z4AaABA9VxG9avBGyAA7SGkm_N4k

"I currently have United Healthcare. For years I have used 2 medications that I was told didn't have generic. They are very expensive. I just got on a program with Indiana University Healthcare that will cover prescription costs on medications that United Healthcare have copays. Upon starting the program Indiana University found there were actually generics for my two very expensive drugs. United Healthcare doesn't cover the generic they said in letters I was sent. I called United Healthcare and nope they won't cover generic. It's a scam!!! They won't accept a generic drug to save money??? I also can look at it as maybe United Healthcare doesn't want to pay it at all since Indiana University Healthcare is helping me they will just let IU pay it all. Worst of all the lady I was talking to at United Healthcare bursts out "that's the big beautiful bill for you." I spoke my mind back. I was supposed to get a survey after the call which I wanted and the rep wouldn't disconnect the line. She didn't want me to get that survey. She should have NEVER brought politics into it. I guess I'll be moving my insurance coverage from United Healthcare."

— YouTube · The Truth About United Healthcare's Claim Denials and Dr. Oz's Plan to Force Medicare Advan · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LhIMMntQaY0&lc=Ugy2Mq0sGEHgOnpiFCp4AaABAq>

"I disagree with your point starting @9:30. When you say, "nobody can tell you what is best for you," I would argue that a Medicare Advantage plan is never the best choice for anyone. It is even worse than a Ponzi scheme for America. The ads say these plans have a "zero premium," but that is far from the truth! Enrollees allow insurance companies to draw large sums — often \$1,000.00 to more than \$1,800.00 per month (in the enrollee's name) — from the MEDICARE FUND that we all paid into. If those plans continue draining the fund, what will happen when it runs out? Medicare as we know it will disappear. How can a plan that pulls premiums, benefits, commissions, gym memberships, reimbursements, etc. from the same Medicare fund possibly keep that fund sustainable? Therefore these plans are bad for everyone."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgxrNIG8YYh3bPLsDvN4AaABAq>

"What, When How. Thanks for all the straightforward information. I just got the letter. My Advantage PPO plan was eliminated by BCBS in a state that doesn't pay brokers. I have 3 questions: Does the insurance company lose money under an Advantage Plan if you don't go to the doctor for routine visits and basically don't use that \$ amount minus the \$1,800. ? Is there a niche in the system for seniors who actually educate themselves on self care, know how to stay healthy (which costs money) and consult doctors only rarely, when necessary? I actually like the benefit cards and those gym benefits. What I don't like is those calls pushing services on me. So thanks for the clue about why. Do you have any hunches about Advantage plans in the future? I will keep watching so no worries about a direct answer."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgzrnqcqLgeNdy-0XRZ4AaABAq>

"I have United Health Care Advantage plan. They have not paid for providers saying they are out of network when the clinic said they were before they made the appointment. Also I need a Psychiatrist after calling United and asking for a list of Psychiatrist in my area. After exhausting list after list they gave me even out of my area.. I called United I said you find me a Psychiatrist to go to anywhere in Austin, Tx.. After 3 weeks they called with two names.. I called one said they did not take United. And the other said they did not accept new patients.. After United said that I had been accepted.. Needless to say. I am off of any Psychiatrist drugs.. Hopefully I will not commit suicide. I have tried before 3 times.. Don't get on a Advantage plan."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgwEkJd25Ga0kseISWB4AaABAq>

"I also had trouble finding a dentist to accept my MA plan. Then I called Aetna and asked them to find a dentist in my area that would accept my plan, and they called the dentist to explain how it works. My benefit was for a fixed amount of money, around \$2000 per year. The first year, I had to pay cash to the dentist, then file a claim. Aetna always paid it. But after that the dentist billed directly. Paid all for exams, cleanings, even deep cleanings and fillings. But then I discovered there was a tier system, so for more complicated work like crowns they would only pay a percentage of the cost, even though I had money left in my benefit amount."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwPZFcv6WpB3KEM1cl4AaABAq.AOXzQff4AvqAPd9eo0qQ5P>

"I am 65 years old and I'm kind of surprised i am still alive. I am going to change my Part D as they won't cover certain medications but I am happy with my Medicare and Plan G. I have three dogs and a pet centipede. He loves spiders 🕷️ he thinks they're delicious 😊 I was in the process of moving from Michigan to West Virginia. I got a "cold call" from an agent whilst I was heavily involved in the hassle of moving and packing. I attempted to blow her off but she gave me great advice. Unfortunately I didn't accurately get her name and number, but I am happy."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugw_sXiwcLunmlpNfLd4AaABAq

"I was shocked to see my Plan F go to \$5k Ann. I called United & was told they will call back & do an application for plan G. If it's going to be the same after copay I might have to go to Humana. will be 85 (F)2/25. Aside from knee pain I don't go to the Dr. HIP replacement @ this age is not an option for me. I tried calling your # no avail. 😞 "

— YouTube · Don't Buy Medigap Plan G Before Watching This ! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tughWPQP008&lc=Ugzd7C61NqVgnCXEzBF4AaABAq>

"I'm 44 I'm about to turn 45. I got a call from one of them and they all have the same accents and I can tell that they are calling from a board from India. I can automatically sense fraud. I told them I still got another 20 more years to qualify for Medicare. If it's still around in the next 20 years the way how the world is going right now."

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=UgygNusL5IBwknSdGtN4AaABAq>

"So true. When my wife had a burst appendix followed by breast cancer, even with insurance the sheer number of copays and deductibles had me cash in my 401k. When I was too broken to work and filed for SSDI I was on Medicare I just had both knees replaced my total cost was about \$1800. What a difference."

— r/HealthInsurance · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1ofm197/is_the_american_healthcare_system_that_bad_and/nlcb7ok/

"How do you know if the hospitals and clinics your doctors use, are covered by an advantage plan? An advisor said Humana giveback was a good one for me - when I called Humana, they said my doctors are covered, but NOT the hospitals and clinics. WTH?????"

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=Ugzehrod1va7br6SvQ14AaABAq>

↳ @ace-c7j (1): "Great answer - thanks very much"

"This is ridiculous! I pay \$1800 a year for Part D and I never even use it because it is less expensive to fill my prescriptions via discount programs. This Administration preys on the most vulnerable members of society."

— YouTube · Trump Administration to End Medicare Drug Plan Subsidy. #medication #medicare #doctor · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BrOgybQKs-A&lc=UgzvtCqzlrKqZW2hkst4AaABAg>

Self-insured: Original Medicare with no supplement · 17 documents · 17 voices

"We choose MA over Medigap. May not work out well, but for the first years we have been keeping a lot of dollars in our self-insurance fund that would have been going out to pay Medigap premiums. The old equation of Pay Now (A Growing Cost each year) and Pay Less (Maybe) vs. Don't pay now and Pay More Later. Which to choose? Personal decision."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugx5Wu3cl7paCtPKNVZ4AaABAg>

↳ @tomm.8892 (1): "@douglashughes2331 I've not had a problem with a lack of choice. I'm in an urban area. I think that is more of an issue in rural America ... but then healthcare in rural America is just plainly more of a problem."

↳ @douglashughes2331 (0): "But you ignore the lack of choice and the ability of your MA plan to deny coverage or delay it so long as to ruin your health."

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "MA is a 'cakewalk' and perceived money saver until you develop chronic issues or worse a catastrophic illness. Sister in law found out 5 years into her Advantage Plan. No doubt it killed her prematurely and financially wiped out most of her estate. Delays and denials were an everyday occurrence."

"I am taking the risk. I self insure the 20%. As I see it: the potential, high cost illness is variable. It may happen, it may not. The Plan G Monthly Premium is fixed. It will rise over time. I may use it, I may not. But I will pay for it. Here is a much better idea: At age 65, rather than Plan G supplement, budget \$150 per month for Medical Risk, assume that number rises 6% per year. Put that money into a personal investment account, a safe one but growing too. I will use those funds as protection against the 20% self insurance risk. If I stay healthy, the incentive is a load of money that I own v. the insurance company."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRlOxmSo&lc=Ugxt5VAFWFpm7mvH00B4AaABAg

↳ @aa-dz6cr (1): "Self funding is ridiculous if you have assets."

↳ @fl3609 (0): "I think it's a good idea if you are healthy now and can pass underwriting if you need it later."

↳ @jenniferpark2706 (0): "I pay less than \$40 per month for HDG to avoid that risk. I can afford this premium, but I cannot afford the risk for unknown MOOP."

"I lived in 8 different countries, aall had universal healthcare, and I was 100% satisfied with my medical care overseas I do not use the USA medical system if I can help it I have Medicare A and B only and feel like a pauper when I'm in the United states We are a failed country"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugzvmlw0X3ThDvC44yp4AaABAg>

↳ @ScottsdaleSushi (1): "Not in my opinion. If my twin granddaughters had lived in a different country they would not be alive today. My daughter was flown to another state to have the number one doctor in the world operate on them in utero & save their lives. My daughter's insurance paid for that. Would not have been possible - at least unless she wanted to pay the almost 4 million dollars it all cost out of pocket. Universal healthcare isn't going to allow that but my daughter & son-in-law's health insurance did."

↳ @dianah.9718 (0): "What insurance do they have? How much of the 4 mil did they have to pay?"

"No mention is made of traditional Medicare with no supplement. I have used Medicare for 12 years with no supplement. I think that a whole video would be well advised for people, especially those who are in good health, favoring traditional Medicare."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgyJeqH7eRMcZ2cKQnl4AaABAg>

↳ @grandfatherrecords (1): "You can still do that however do expect a 20% charge from hospitals and doctors if you choose to stay with OG Medicare. Supplements, Advantage plans.. all used to cover that 20% A and B does not cover. So fantastic that you are health and never needed a part C. But truth be told we are not immortal"

"The worst part about all of this is I have an advantage plan. Because I need that benefit card for my food and my cellphone. And my medicaid pays for the premium. If I have straight Medicare, just regular Medicare, because I am just turning 60, and I'm on disability. Yes, my premium is paid for but I have no supplement money coming in to pay for food and my cell phone. I don't make enough money to live without getting that paid for and I can't afford to pay that monthly premium without medicaid. So how do you make this work with regular Medicare? And what do you do Il just, I'm stuck between a rock and a hard spot. I don't know what to do. And I can't afford to pay chapter to talk to me."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Advantage Plan Cost YOU \$1,000s in 2027!? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JemKIOUrpM&lc=UgzoSfiEjM23DDoktDJ4AaABAg>

"We have an advantage plan, zero premium. Since the company is aligned with the largest hospital in the region we have no problem going to the doctors we want. Last year my wife got cancer. The docs, etc. billed almost \$200K, our out of pocket was the \$6700 stated in the presentaiton plus another \$600 for stuff that was not included. If we had just Medicare alone our savings would be gone."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyC0XHT4Ga99GPNM_B4AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "So glad you have found a plan that works well for you!"

"I have full healthcare for free for life through the VA as a 100% disabled (SVC related) permanent & total veteran. While everyone everywhere keeps advising that when I turn 65 (6 yrs away) that I should definitely pay the 202.00/ month for the peace of mind in the case of travel injury or sickness as well as for community care I may need if the VA cannot provide what I may need. I've yet to see examples of care needed that VA does not provide. I know 200/ mo isn't a lot but I'd rather use it myself. Can any reader of this convince me that the extra 200.00/ month I pay is worth it?"

— YouTube · Medicare Parts A B C D Explained - Everything you need to know! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wci4BBmjXfo&lc=Ugy2UY9KLAllos2OoAx4AaABAg>

↳ @mysighkee (0): "Maybe I can help. Your situation with the VA is good. There's no reason to break something that isn't broken. There are plans designed to cater to veterans, but they do require you have part B. Because these plans don't offer a Rx plan, they throw you extra "benefits." Meaning, depending on where you live, you could get monthly money back that goes towards your part B premium, along with some additional benefits like Dental allowance, gym access, etc. So basically you'd pay to pick up the part B premium, while getting some "benefits" in return. I wouldn't break what isn't broken. Thank you for your service."

"Hi Stephanie, I retired few months ago and tried digesting all the Medicare rules and regulations. Your presentation is awesome and clarifies a lot of issues. This is my question: I have Medicare part A and B only, but Carefirst as my secondary insurance plus dental and drugs coverage as well through my former employer; so, would be any benefit to enroll in Medicare advantage plans that promise to be free of charges in this scenario? Thanks."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyiMiUAjDPBYnRRREh4AaABAg>

"I am 82 years old .last year i had jhon Hopkins advantages plan .but it was hacked. Now i have only medicare .i am taking only 3 medication ,and i have no medication insurance . When i had supplements plan three years ago .they did not covered all tests .I am completely Confused about different kinds of Plans.i need help for choose a plan for 2024. I willl appreciated if you help me"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N Vs Plan G? Which Should YOU Choose? 🤔 · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H8IVf79gAV8&lc=UgwPCFm0sJVTaEn08_x4AaABAg

"I have a good chunk of money in my HSA, and plan on using this asset for medicare premiums and deductibles, plus a source of self-insurance for Long Term Care expenses. Now I would add planned IRMAA (as a function of Roth conversion) as a way to utilize my HSA."

— YouTube · 8 Ways to Reduce Medicare IRMAA Payments · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z6yhDpaSO9A&lc=UgwHsjKKuNZxyIXzfFJ4AaABAg.AL0CDrnKyTiAL0VWXm-SMY>

"I have been self insured for years and have paid thru the NOSE for insurance, insurance with a high deductible for years. I cannot wait to turn 65 next year and get on Medicare. I know you are not referring to my situation but still.."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgwB6XxP07dXimW-Cwd4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Yes, there are many put there who will have a better experience on Medicare, for sure. Just not everyone."

"Very clear explanation. I'm still on original Medicare with no plans to leave it. I'm a TFL member also with VA benefits. Is there anyway you could explain any of these relationships? I realize that it could a complex subject but your dissertation on Med Adv plans was very concise and verified my reluctance to switch. I have considered a supplement plan but as it stands my current situation doesn't seem to need me doing so. I've had several VA surgical procedures(appendectomy(along with abdominal abscess)and an inguinal hernia surgery with no out of pocket expenses. But I don't really have a handle on how it fits together in medical coverage. Oh, I also had a left hip replacement surgery with only Medicare and TFL coverage with no out of pocket expenses. I know I'm asking a lot so if it is ours of your realm of knowledge or expertise and you'd prefer not to respond, I'd understand with no problem. Again thanks for this presentation as I feel vindicated that I did not switch a few years back when everybody seemed to want to get on the band wagon of MA plans."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxaaYPNxT-5RYs8XYx4AaABAg>

"Or you can only do Medicare without a supplement, which is what I do my out-of-pocket expenses don't add up to the \$157 a month I pay only pay 20% of what Medicare has to pay, which is a much smaller amount than you would pay just going to doctor. something not covered completely. It's always a small amount 20 - 80- dollars - maybe three times a year for a procedure."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgyjOet4GGdy750qvsF4AaABAg>

"@GiardiniMedicare I have only original medicare. No Advantage. No medigap. I recently had a \$101,000 hospital bill. Medicare covered 80% and the hospital forgave and wrote off the entire remaining balance because I'm retired on social security. I was told that if I had either Advantage or medigap I would have paid at least 4K out of my own pocket."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplements (Which is Better?) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=T3GhVv480m8&lc=UgwhejbBNeflztmPWPn4AaABAg.AFqwYUW4Z3PAHotp8h7q7Y>

"I had to switch to the original Medicare without a supplement because of many denied claims, tests and prior authorizations. The health care facility where I get most of my care offered financial assistance to cover what Medicare doesn't. Advantage plans are bad news for people who are sick."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jcgwz2/leave_advantage_plan_or_risk_your_life/mi29d1q/

"I recenle got a Lab bill for 'uncovered' charges. Letter said 'all insurances were billed' so went to customer service... no Supplement listed, but when I tried to add it the acreen flipped, rechecking there was no balance due."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyDvj2sCNuPi_2wz9J4AaABAg

"thank you i have just medicare and was thinking about a advantage plan but im staying where im at gonna check out a g plan"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugyh7H9bRpMcsxwMFFx4AaABAg>

Switched from a supplement to Advantage (usually for the premium) · 9 documents · 9 voices

"My situation exactly. I switched from a medigap plan to an advantage plan. I was spending \$4,500 for the medigap plan and prescription drug plan plus a \$480 deductible on the drug plan. My advantage plan capped my max out-of-pocket at \$5,100. I got prescription drugs and \$1,000 dental in the MA plan at no extra cost. MA has been perfect for me."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=Ugz57a5HtSvqlR5fU8l4AaABAg_9SjvKJxeBpO9UKMbF_TFcO

"I love this type of video and you did a great job as usual. As an anecdote, this year (2024) I switched from a supplemental plan F to a MA plan and I couldn't be happier. I retired in 2015. Now, gone is my \$240 per month premium for supplement plan F, gone is my \$110 per month part d plan where the drugs also cost twice as much and present is my \$0 premium health plan, \$0 premium drug plan, and I still see the same doctors and hospitals that I was anyway. I now save enough in one year, that if I ever reach my maximum out of pocket (\$4100) I am still way ahead financially. Love my Advantage plan. Plus, I am 74 this year. I hate to think how much that supplemental will cost by the time I'm 80. (\$450 - \$500 per month?) I don't have to worry about it."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyL90JITftyVjlvAnt4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! So glad to hear you are happy with your choice :)"

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAg>

↳ @CD-ek3iq (4): "I work with both MA and Supplements. While what you say is mostly accurate the sad fact is many seniors simply cannot afford the high premiums of Supplements AND and a PDP. Add in the monthly cost of dental, vision and hearing, which supps won't cover, and it's easy to be priced out completely. There's nothing wrong with MA. I work with people every day who LOVE their MA plans and wouldn't trade em for the world, lol. (It's my job to try!) Many also have much lower Max Out Of Pockets than mentioned that can end up being as much as the yearly premium you pay with Supps whether you use it or not. 🙌 If you travel, simply get a PPO. Easy. Everybody has different needs and means. Luckily there are multiple options to try and help people with their Heath Care."

"I dropped my supplement , am on medicare. I paid less for care when I just had medicare. After the supplement I paid almost 400 a month th and they only paid for one high cost med which when I did the math I'm better off dropping the i surance and paying myself. I wish we could get the whole cou try to drop their insurance I think things would change pretty quickly....but I do have medicare and people don't realize medicare pays for just about everything anyway"

— r/obamacare · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1vx7zfd/how_can_we_stop_the_administration_from/p5tolxy/

"I dropped my medigap and saved the money I was paying for premiums.. pay the bills myself."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgyDe6at8n3eqBx-G3p4AaABAg>

"MUCH information was left out. This video leads one to believe that a "Supplement" plan is much better. That is NOT necessarily true. I just switched from a Supplement plan to an HMO plan. My Supplement plan "F" was increasing to about \$250 a month, and I am only 72. My new HMO plan is \$0 a month (that's ZERO), and I have an annual MAXIMUM out-of-pocket of \$1,000. I have NEVER had Part D (Rx coverage), so I also have to pay about \$54 a month penalty. I STILL am saving about \$1,500 a year IF I end up getting very sick and have to pay MANY co-pays. If I DON'T get sick, I COULD save as much as \$3,000 for the year. That's worth being restricted to some of their rules, I'd say. Where I live I won't even have to change Primary Care Physician, Hospital, or ER. Something to consider BEFORE choosing or staying with a Supplemental plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Vs. Medicare Supplement - An Unbiased Comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EXNLA6j2x0M&lc=UgxPNOXkf7exS6qx47J4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Touche' it sounds like you've found an Advantage Plan that meets your needs, which is great. And yes, a lot of information is always left out when we try to do a brief and to-the-point informational video like this one. Medicare Advantage Plans can vary GREATLY from one state or one county to another. We work with both Supplement Plans and Advantage Plans and the overview we provide here is meant to be quite general. You should always base your Medicare Plan decision on a thorough and unbiased assessment of your needs. Thank you for watching!"

"Excellent video and you brought up a lot of good and bad of both plans.... I was hoping you could make my decision. Every day I keep changing my mind but I only have a few days to decide.... I have plan N since 2018 and very healthy for now. One question that I am a bit confused. If I switch from plan N to advantage and decide to go back to plan N, will I have to go thru the underwriting if within a year? I live in Florida. Thanks in advance for this video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=Ugwu0HFHcZB5k3_AL3x4AaABAg

"I recently switched from a Plan G supplement plan to an Advantage Plan. I'm concerned as I learn more about these plans that they are more risky. Is there a grace period where I can switch back if I'm not happy? I live in CT."

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=Ugz-ElcZU_DdOqQlgzF4AaABAg

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "You have a 1-year trial right to go back to your previous policy. Once you have that, you can change to any other supplement without underwriting. I prefer the G-HD is CT"

"I dropped my plan N because plan D was expensive and the deductible was too high , No longer affordable 😞."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugw8KLyRSgYktkMCO3B4AaABAg.A7w6RMNZA_UAR_eoo9bRp0t

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

Should have enrolled or planned differently · 54 documents · 20 voices

"This is a real eye opener. Wish I had done more research before I signed up for advantage plan. Thanks so much, you are performing a genuine public service."

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgyUhgmXIXWRyCw81Kt4AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (2): "Thank you for watching and leaving such a kind comment Bill. Appreciate you!"

↳ @rogerdorsey7823 (0): "A REAL EYE OPENER BUT THE PROCESS IS A SET UP TO LULL YOU INTO AN EMERGENCY DENYING TRANSFER OF MEDICAL HISTORY FROM ONE INSTITUTION TO ANOTHER THEN BILLING YOU EXCESSIVELY FOR TEST THAT COST MORE THAN ADVANTAGE IS WILLING TO PAY 😊 "

"I wish I could press the 'thumbs up' 100 times! Not only was this incredibly informative and really did teach me so much about Medicare and Mountain Chickens, using John's special brand of satire, but having "karen" and her real life husband hamming it up at the end was f'ing hysterical! I almost can't wait to turn 65!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgxeBV5dnxzmVYmmaiR4AaABAq>

"Healthcare for profit is a joke. The majority of people that go bankrupt from medical bills have insurance - so it's a worthless joke. The ACA are taxpayer funds funneled to wall-street. Tying health insurance to work is a joke. McDonalds doesn't provide insurance and tax payers have to subsidize these monopolies. Let GOP policies play out and run on healthcare for all 2028. I haven't had health insurance through work since the early 1990s. Paid in for almost 1/4 century and went to the doctors once. Should have gone without. I was paying over \$1,000 per month a decade ago for worthless insurance. So I went the last 10 years without any health insurance, saved over \$120,000 and retired early (58). I'm 66, have Medicare, went to the docs and all is fine."

— YouTube · Expiration of ACA subsidies will have 'ripple effects' in health care and economy · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xOrWISxntkQ&lc=UgkxkDNx8Almb_D8Novh4AaABAq

↳ @bobbear4437 (0): "The insurance you talk about isn't the ACA, it was bankruptcy care that is where we're headed again, you get sick, you go bankrupt, you'll never have anything to leave to your children!"

"Great information. Thank you 🙏 Wish I knew this last year. 2 Medicare benefits consultants never mentioned this even when I asked. They gave wrong information. My husband still works and we were both covered. I switched to Medicare because we thought we would save some money. Not! Now I'm not working - it would be cheaper if I could go back on his insurance. Plus we are selling a house and will be hit hard . Thank you again"

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA 2025 Explained (Are a High Income Earner?) · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ioM2gA1LLtI&lc=UgyzXMoeva8ANCPLGa14AaABAq>

↳ @patriot2510 (0): "We give the irmaa advisement at age 63"

"I wish I had educated myself when I turned 65. I chose to stay with my employers retiree health plan which we pay ourselves. This year the price has jumped dramatically and I am looking at marketplace. It looks like I missed out on medigap because I know I would now be turned down if underwritten. I could stay with my employers plan and if they discontinued it I could get medigap, but leaving voluntarily my only option is advantage. I will save 4000 a year by choosing advantage but fear the authorizations/denial process."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyNq-I5E9DgaRdfDEN4AaABAg>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (2): "As someone told me when I was turning 65. You can pay it now (traditional and supp) or pay it later (advantage) as far as costs. As far as quality of care there is no comparison. Advantage Plans kill seniors prematurely by the hundreds every day in the US. And thats a fact"

↳ @ahemphill44 (0): "@JohnJohn-wr1jo That's the most ignorant statement (of many) that I have read on this old post."

"I didn't get a supplement when I turned 65. I wish I knew then what I know now. My Plan N costs a lot more because I didn't get it three years ago. Big mistake."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgwgcpfzF5NmVMYiJyt4AaABAg>

↳ @loiswells3062 (1): "After 10 years on Advantage, I now have the right to go back to Medicare since Aetna has cancelled my plan. I looked into it and it's just too expensive. You still have to pay the part b \$206 every month plus medigap premium of several hundred plus prescription and dental plans. I envy people who have the extra money, but I am on a shoestring."

↳ @b0borden437 (0): "Wow, it goes up with each yr past 65?"

"I'm age 67 and healthy in NC and received a letter from UHC that my plan N was increasing 35% to \$157 per month. I applied last week for BCBS NC plan G-HD for \$36 premium. I can handle the MOOP of \$2,950 if needed. As you stated, my obligation is 20% of the negotiated medicare assignment contract rates. Wish I had chosen G-HD at age 65."

— YouTube · Everyone's Sick of Medigap Rate Increases...Here's What to Do! · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NQHG_o1vxVU&lc=Ugz8MSKahLypHJ_lhdt4AaABAg

↳ @greyholcombjr.9623 (3): "@really2345 Don't blame ya. Plan HDG is becoming increasingly popular. Most agents don't mentioned it because it pays the lowest commission."

↳ @really2345 (2): "I just started plan N with AARP/UHC in January 2026. I received the Annual Rate Change a few weeks ago and already I am told it will increase 32% starting in January 2027. I am told that BCBS also increased their rates about the same. I am also looking to switch to a HDG soon."

↳ @mjcarp7179 (2): "I'm sorry you had to learn the hard way. HDG is the best kept secret from agents that make low commissions on it. I picked GHD at 65."

"Should have planned better. I'm 66 and still waiting on Social Security until 70. I have Medicare and a supplement plan N. Works great for me."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyAV3tjqqt6CYM6fF4AaABAq.AO0x6RVqTa7AQfwlJkad-A

"I've had a Plan G for two years. It's awesome. It's the medical plan I wish I'd had all my life. At least I've got it now."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzlQ78TKNQTwof0dH14AaABAq>

"I'm under 62, on SSDI, & have a Medicare supplement plan that I'm stuck with until I turn 65 & can't change without underwriting. Feel like i am penalized because of a chronic, permanent disability i suffered from in 2012 that resulted in going on SSDI. The cost of it has doubled over the last several years & my only choice is to change to a Medicare advantage plan until then. I have been through the worst of our health care system through my experiences. I should have gotten dual citizenship in another country years ago when I had the opportunity where I could have gotten the medical care I needed without it financially ruining me."

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=UgwqNyHLjygxlduP51Z4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (3): "Sadly, there is no federal law mandating the availability of Medicare supplement plans to people under 65. Most states do not offer any Medigap plans until a person reaches 65. Other states price under 65 supplement so high, they are not a reasonable solution. It's just the way it is."

↳ @jdenino6022 (2): "@MedigapSeminarsBlame Congress.😞 "

↳ @ctwilk1 (0): "Check with BCBS. They have a Medicare Supplement Plan for ppl that are under 65 and disabled. Good luck!"

"We moved in early 2017 and sold our home in the Bay Area for a significant gain, resulting in a big tax bill that year, despite the \$500K exclusion. Two years later, I got a notification of a large IRMAA charge on our Social Security, but coincidentally, I retired later in 2017, so I was able to fill out the SSA-44 form and successfully reverse the IRMAA penalty due to work stoppage. Pretty simple. If I had retired the year before or after the sale of the house, I would have had to pay the IRMAA charges. I wish I could claim it was part of my master financial plan, but I was just lucky."

— YouTube · 8 Ways to Reduce Medicare IRMAA Payments · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z6yhDpaSO9A&lc=UgwK-bGXhEqpeziHwMJ4AaABAq>

↳ @johnnyjava_ (0): "Because your salary stopped? Your income was below the limit?"

"You are by far the biggest elephant of them all when it comes to explaining Medicare plans! I have been watching lots of videos recently and I have watched more of yours than anyone else, because they are just better! You do such a great job of explaining things in a way that is understandable! Thank you for the great work you do! I wish you could be my agent to help me make my decisions. I am 71 and have always had Advantage Plan, but, now am wanting to switch to Medigap Plan G. I wish I would have understood how difficult it was going to be later on to get a Medigap, due to the Underwriting process. Advantage has worked well for me so far, but, as I get older, I wish I would have gotten a Medigap during my OEP because I could have gotten one - no questions asked. Oh, well, live and learn. I don't think I will pass Underwriting, but, I may give it a shot just to see. If not, I guess I'm stuck with Advantage forever."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx-H2gJtUrzWO7qf014AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch this video and others! Your kind words mean more than you know, and I've never been so honored to be called the biggest elephant :) 🐘 "

"I retired before the ACA, very young. Males in my family don't live long lives, so I shifted "retirement" to occur earlier, before I expect to die. I "retired" before the ACA existed, so it wasn't part of any planning. OTOH, my prior health insurance was \$150/month before the ACA started making it double almost every year. I still had cash savings in the first few years after the ACA was passed, which meant my income/MAGI was below the FPL and full payment for ACA plans was the rule. After a few years of paying \$500, \$600, \$700, then \$800/month for the cheapest ACA Marketplace coverage, finally figured out that my annual income/MAGI needed to appear to be at least the poverty level and had to pick a more expensive plan. After fixing those 2 issues, health insurance became affordable again. The full monthly premium is over \$1200 now, but about \$1150 of that is paid by the Feds, because I control the MAGI. I expect to pay my fair share of taxes, but not 1 penny more. I'm not looking forward to being forced off the ACA and onto Medicare at age 65. Monthly health insurance premiums will raise about 6x, it appears now and that's not counting MediGAP insurance. Definitely need to use the ACA as part of your early retirement plans. Wish I'd realized it a few years earlier before paying tens of thousands to health insurance unnecessarily."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lsxxWGpc_fE&lc=UgyB34wMc6xvo5jGBWJ4AaABAg.ARR7yTlcvr6AUGJypnLdby

"Travel. Good information. There is so much to learn with Medicare in order to make the best choice. Knowing what I heard here, I should have chosen Plan N when I signed up last year and then 2-3 years later switch to HD-G (cheaper) when I expect to be traveling outside the USA most of the time where Medicare isn't available. In Maryland I didn't think I could switch to any other plan in the future after initial sign up without underwriting so I picked the plan (HD-G) that I expect to be on for most of the remainder of my life to kick in if I have a major medical expense that exceeds the HD-G deductible."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugy46HOaPWdRh54THDI4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch! 🙏 Another video went kind of viral so I'm trying to catch up on comments! HD G is popular and if you are healthy, saves quite a bit of money. Make sure to set aside your premium savings to create a little buffer in the event you have a bad year or two to cover the deductible."

"at this time being retired military tricare for life covers eerything that the adantage plan and the supplement plans cover for free for the rest of mine and my wifes lives. but i wish i had a dollar for every med sup and advantage sales letter we have recieved. hell we could go on a trip to anywhere."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgwtOIFioPFSELSi3p4AaABAg>

"I wish I could have kept my previous insurance plan. It was cheaper than what I have to pay with Medicare. I dont like the fact that the government forces us to do this when we turn 65."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=Ugzjrpxz5W1EEed8cVc94AaABAg>

↳ @youngtimer964 (2): "Seems more like the insurance companies doing the forcing. I could be wrong. For me, Medicare is much better/cheaper than my previous group coverage, especially when it comes to deductibles."

↳ @iamanempoweredone (1): "young timer, i am eligible for Obama care. My income determines what I pay. For my wife and I both we pay a total of 214.00 for really good insurance. Now I will pay for her insurance plus Medicare for myself till she turns 65 next year. I would rather keep the insurance that I have than go to Medicare."

↳ @iamanempoweredone (1): "M Detlef, they LIED to me??? Oh No!!!"

"Back when I retired I found selecting a MediCare insurance plan the most complex and confusing project I had ever undertaken! I spent endless hours reading all the info and most often felt that the more I studied the less I understood. Finally in desperation I opted to receive counseling from a volunteer organization. Imagine my horror when the councilor told me that I already knew more than he did about Medicare options! I finally sought help from a Medicare broker like yourself who heartily recommended that my wife and I opt for a Medicare Advantage plan. At that time I suffered from Type 1 diabetes, Rheumatoid Arthritis, Hypothyroidism and several other chronic illnesses. Watching your video today made painfully clear that I was given bad advice and clearly as I am currently 76 years old my future does not look bright on an Advantage plan! Up until now I thought that at the beginning of every year you could switch the type of plan you were on. From what you say in this video given my various ailments I am now stuck forever in my Advantage plan and it will probably cost me a fortune. Is there any way whatever for me to switch over to a traditional Medicare plan? Also my wife is in good health at age 75 should she switch from her Advantage plan before it's too late? Thank you for your wonderful , highly detailed videos...I just wish I'd known about them when I first signed up for Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugwjdi9kKIGbrstxXQ54AaABAq>

↳ @wynetteabc (1): "Call your state's Medicare office. In some states maybe you can switch, at least to the G plan. A guaranteed issue plan. ❤️ "

↳ @annlong1426 (0): "Anytime the government is involved it's going to be expensive, complicated, time-wasting, and frustrating. Wish they'd never taken over medicine, education, money and anything else."

↳ @boatman222345 (0): "@annlong1426 I would amend your statement, any time any large, basically unaccountable organization wants to pull a fast one things get "complicated!" It's helpful to keep in mind that "Advantage" programs are the insurance industry's effort to "attract" those enrolled in the government Medicare insurance over into the "private" corporate world. You can bet your bottom dollar that the legislative process allowing Advantage programs was completely controlled by corporate lobbyists. One big tell is the outrageous commissions given to "independent" insurance brokers who facilitate the move from Medicare to Advantage health coverage. Back when I signed up with an Advantage program I was horrified to discover that the broker who spent 15 minutes signing me up got paid \$300 by the taxpayer for stealing one of their policy holders. Imagine how I felt after watching this video that makes clear the fact that the broker continues to get that \$300 commission every year for 6 years for doing nothing! The first time I ran into insurance difficulties I called the broker only to be told that he had nothing further to do with it and I needed to contact the insurance company directly! Pp"

"From the land of the Loon. You are the BEST! 2 friends turning 65 Dec & Jan Mom 91 just lost her retiree group insurance when Ucare pulled out of MN She has 4 different offerings from school district HOWEVER only one is appealing... That advantage plan is \$272/m With her guaranteed issue rights wish she could apply for a Plan N ... but understand only what we call "Basic" with riders = "G" Minnesota expensive ~\$400/mo+Drugs (then add Dent,vis,hear..) Totally tough choices ... the plan she is losing with Ucare was \$177/m and she has loved it... Wish I had more time to research. Your videos are absolutely the best! even up agent the best of all your 6 mentioned other YouTube ers.... Yet to see you say incorrect information you didn't correct. Love your fact based, unbiased, get help from good sources, use an agent / broker.... AND your presentation.. clear, understandable, good tempo and fantastic throughout coverage of material. FYI im 65 in May"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=Ugz4dlmIOSAkezNccr94AaABAq>

"Why does the government pick on seniors when they want to cut costs? Is it because they think we are all senile and apathetic, so we don't complain? Part D always cost more money than just parts A and B. Now, I'm sure if you want the best of the best part D you're going to pay a whole lot more. Some people can afford it, but most cannot. I wish I didn't have to pay \$2,000. up front in a new year, for ever increasing drug costs. I use GLPs for diabetes. They continue to go up in price, even with more companies making them. It's ruined my Golden years. I always knew prices would go up, but not as much as they have."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=Ugy8U4uO3MyW0Na9_3h4AaABAg

"Tried a high deductible G. Total monthly was well over 400 for both premiums and no drug coverage. Went to Advantage because I require groceries and prescription drugs to survive and United Healthcare even pitches in on that. I wish I could afford a supplement's upfront costs because today, I'm betting on staying healthy. A good plan would cost me over \$600/month not including my home and auto plus house taxes. Got to save a few dollars when you can these days."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgwtypdozQWCAbKrUeV4AaABAg>

Wishing someone had warned them about underwriting and deadlines · 25 documents · 20 voices

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. \[As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).\] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every

policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pqufyv/>

↳ (0): "My recollection was one of the premises of Obamacare was indeed that EVERYONE was required to have health insurance. If you didn't you'd get it on the Exchange at possibly heavily subsidized rates. If you didn't get it, there was a penalty at tax time."

↳ (0): "The mandate was eliminated during Trump Admin v1"

↳ (0): "Didn't some states not increase the range for Medicaid? I seem to remember something.."

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

↳ (0): "It should automatically go down in January, if your income goes back down. We won appeal in 2024 and again in 2026 based on retirement events."

↳ (0): "I just asked Google this question "can you go off medicare to avoid irmaa" You should do the same and read the full reply. (It basically says don't do it and gives options to reduce IRMAA which I am including below.) # Here is what it says about dropping Medicare: **No**, dropping your Medicare coverage to avoid IRMAA (Income-Related Monthly Adjustment Amount) is rarely a good idea. \[1](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenrolling_later_on/)\] If you voluntarily disenroll from Part B and Part D, your IRMAA surcharges may temporarily stop, but you will face severe consequences: \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>)\] **Gaps in Coverage:** You will be left without coverage for basic outpatient care, doctor visits, or prescription drugs. **Permanent Late Enrollment Penalties:** When you try to re-enroll in Medicare later, you will face hefty, permanent late enrollment penalties. **Lack of Guarantee:** You may not be able to simply re-enroll whenever you want; you will have to wait for the General Enrollment Period (January 1–March 31) with coverage beginning the following July. \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [2](<http://www.investmentnews.com/retirement-planning/what-happens-to-medicare-when-you-suspend-social-security-bennies/48121>), [3](<https://thebig65.com/medigap-plans-guide/>), [4](<https://boomerbenefits.com/medicare-enrollment-period/>), [5](<https://www.leonardfinancialsolutions.com/transition-from-employer-insurance-to-medicare/>)\] # These are the ways it suggests for reducing IRMAA: **Better Ways to Reduce or Avoid IRMAA** Instead of dropping your Medicare coverage, consider these legally recognized strategies to lower your MAGI or appeal the surcharge: \[1](<https://www.schwab.com/learn/story/how-higher-income-can-affect-medicare-premiums>), [2](<https://www.medicareresources.org/blog/four-ways-to-avoid-income-related-medicare-surcharges/>), [3](<https://decimawealth.com/planning/avoid-irmaa-surcharges/>)\] **File an Appeal for Life-Changing Events:** If your income dropped due to a qualifying life event (like retirement, work reduction, divorce, or the death of a spouse), you can appeal to the Social Security Administration using [Form SSA-44](<https://www.ssa.gov/forms/ssa-44.pdf>). **Reduce Taxable Income Pre-Retirement:** Maximize pre-tax contributions to employer-sponsored retirement plans (like a 401(k) or 403(b)) before you hit age 65. **Make Qualified Charitable Distributions (QCDs):** If you are 70½ or older, you can donate up to \(\$111,000\) per year directly from your IRA to a charity. This money is not counted as taxable income, thereby lowering your MAGI. **Roth Conversions Early On:** Strategically converting traditional retirement accounts to Roth IRAs *before* you reach Medicare age can reduce your future taxable RMDs (Required Minimum Distributions).\[1](<https://youstaywealthy.com/how-to-avoid-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [3](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/medicare/avoid-the-irmaa-with-a-roth-conversion>), [4](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenrolling_later_on/), [5](<https://medicareagentshub.com/questions/how-can-i-avoid-or-reduce-irmaa-charges-on-my-medicare-premiums/>)\] — Hope this helps. I do Roth conversions which increase my income. IRMAA is triggered. (There is a 2 year look back so the impact of this years conversions cause IRMA 2 years later). If I stopped conversions, iRMAA would stop 2 years later. But I could use some the money I converted to pay the IRMAA if I had to. I don't fully understand your issue, but hopefully this helps you with some options. 🙏 "

↳ (0): "I dropped my part b due to an Irmaa spike and stayed on my wife's insurance for three years, as long as you have creditable coverage it's not issue, you just have to reapply."

"Maybe the GI (guaranteed issue) benefit should be a line on this chart. The presentation is excellent except for minimizing this as an issue. Just because you have no preexisting conditions now does not mean that you will never have any. At 65 I was fit with few medical visits and no prescription drugs. Two years later I have had melanoma and a heart diagnosis. Thankfully I have Plan G."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgyXPwc2Oqa_-aN2gwZ4AaABAq

"You should have mentioned that there's no medical underwriting for supplements only in the first 6 months of eligibility. Without that info, the uneducated might think they're free to switch to a supplement when their health deteriorates—which generally happens with age. (yes, there are exceptions) . And, from experience with my older family members, I think you are downplaying the prior approval disadvantage of advantage plans, which is serious—ask the AMA! I truly believe most should get Plan N medigap if they can possibly afford it Wolverine."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 12 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwoZ8dAIHWMGlpY32l4AaABAq>

↳ @JeanPierreWhite (1): "Totally agree. While we all hope we will have good health we can't depend upon that. Choosing a medicare plan might be a fateful one, one you will need to live with for the rest of your life, quite literally."

↳ @kimwatson5886 (0): "Very useful information even though I have over a year yet to go before I need to make these choices. At that time I also will be sure to have my emotional support cat chosen as well."

"I turned 65 and retired in 2023. I submitted my SSA-44 and successfully lowered my IRMAA to zero. But I learned that I had to resubmit my -44 in 2024 showing my loss of income due to retirement, otherwise I would pay the IRMAA surcharge based on my 2022 pre-retirement income. My 2023 income was low enough that I don't pay IRMAA in 2025."

— YouTube · 8 Ways to Reduce Medicare IRMAA Payments · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z6yhDpaSO9A&lc=UgySNOV2UF9UiPOv4c54AaABAq>

↳ @EJJ-EvArms (0): "This is very helpful to know, thanks for this!"

"Great video. I wish all the Medicare Advantage ads were required to say "Medicare Advantage is not Medicare. It is Privatized Medicare, where the insurance company makes decisions for what treatment you get and who you can get to treat you; just like you have always complained about." This would greatly facilitate discussions with seniors who have gotten a very different perspective from the zillions of ads they have seen. You also make very good points that it isn't easy to switch that need to be required in these ads, because now they all make false statements like "It's easy to switch every year during open enrollment with no side effects." that encourage seniors to ask "Why not try it since it seems a lot cheaper?" Widespread communication that "Obamacare eliminated pre-existing conditions policies in insurance companies." turns out to not actually be true for seniors. A similar video comparing Medicare Part D with Medicare Advantage for drug coverage would be great."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwXD3i0Kqsak5ZsC5p4AaABAq>

"You are by far the biggest elephant of them all when it comes to explaining Medicare plans! I have been watching lots of videos recently and I have watched more of yours than anyone else, because they are just better! You do such a great job of explaining things in a way that is understandable! Thank you for the great work you do! I wish you could be my agent to help me make my decisions. I am 71 and have always had Advantage Plan, but, now am wanting to switch to Medigap Plan G. I wish I would have understood how difficult it was going to be later on to get a Medigap, due to the Underwriting process. Advantage has worked well for me so far, but, as I get older, I wish I would have gotten a Medigap during my OEP because I could have gotten one - no questions asked. Oh, well, live and learn. I don't think I will pass Underwriting, but, I may give it a shot just to see. If not, I guess I'm stuck with Advantage forever."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx-H2gJtUrzWO7qf014AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch this video and others! Your kind words mean more than you know, and I've never been so honored to be called the biggest elephant :) 🐘 "

"IMO - I feel that insurance Medicare agents/brokers who push this scam on clients should be investigated. It's my understanding that the agents are compensated for at a higher rate for enrolling seniors on the Advantage Plan. At the very least customers who enrolled in the Advantage option should be allowed to change back to the traditional one at no penalty to them."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzcjY71Bi2WAeUiyGt4AaABAq.A7yD_2SFDkoA8AiNVaa-oS

"I have a plan N and usually am not charged copay with physician visits. The reason I chose N is because healthier people choose N and so as far as underwriting goes over time that group of people should have lower price increases."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRlOxmSo&lc=Ugx1X9O5BEHK1u2ENmN4AaABAq

"I wish someone had told me that I could skip medical underwriting LAST year when my BCBS plan was dropped in my county - too late now. Being on a \$0 premium Advantage Plan since 2014 has saved me BIG money since I only see a doctor about once a year. Now getting older and on more drugs so I'm tempted to switch to Original. But the premiums for the supplemental plans go up and up outrageously as you get older and more likely to use them. Drug plans keep increasing too. Aren't the supplemental plans thru insurance companies too? So, you are spending more than the Advantage Plans and still dealing with insurance companies..."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxYhuDpMkCxP7b9DZ54AaABAq

"There is a valid reason for the 2 year lookback. IRMAA thresholds for 2026 have already been published. But your specific IRMAA bracket can't be based on your 2026 income, because it isn't known yet. It also can't be based on your 2025 income, because you haven't filed your 2025 return yet. So the best that can be done is to look at your 2024 income. I agree that it's difficult to determine what the IRMAA thresholds will be 2 years from now, but if you use the current thresholds as a guide, you should be fine. It's unlikely that the IRMAA thresholds will go down."

— YouTube · 8 Ways to Reduce Medicare IRMAA Payments · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z6yhDpaSO9A&lc=Ugx-QFffGCewSaF9kON4AaABAq.AL-UbQGNnbyAQnClk-LhXc>

"So, how high do you think IRMAA fees should be? My Medicare premiums are \$714.70 monthly for myself and also for my spouse in addition to \$155.00 and \$137.50, respectively, for our Medicare Supplement premiums. We pay the highest tax rate as well as the highest Medicare premiums."

— r/obamacare · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/obamacare/comments/1lbo2mx/just_throwing_this_question_out_there_how_many_of/mxu8bl0/

"I'm 66 and get harassed by phone calls & mailings daily trying to get me to enroll into more than the Part A & B! Abuse of Power-Penalties should be called Medicare Pushers, that's Blackmail!"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgxaAftiutka2B4aVcB4AaABAq>

"I believe you have given a very balanced summary of the plans, however, I think you may have glossed-over the dollar value of the included options of the Advantage plans. At the very least (sunburn warning) you maybe should have covered the average monthly cost for the Part D drug cards that the government REQUIRES people to purchase or face penalties. With high cost pharmaceuticals on everyone's lips these days, those costs are too important to leave out. The dental, vision, hearing perks are important too but the drug card is a very real benefit."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwqBJtNMtXbk0FahxR4AaABAq>

"I first noticed this covert income tax when I started Medicare. Since then, I have managed my IRA distributions to keep my MAGI within my current IRMAA bracket and allocating my distributions between living expenses and Roth rollovers. This strategy makes it possible to protect me and my wife from the tax ramifications of large future expenditures. A word of caution though. There is an added tax penalty withdrawing Roth conversions before they have aged 5 years. You need to be aware and manage that to avoid an early withdrawal penalty."

— YouTube · IRMAA Explained: The Hidden Medicare Cost That Could Double Your Premiums in Retirement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McRktcoWBG0&lc=Ugw-KZWfK9pel0ID8XN4AaABAg>

↳ @robannmateja5000 (0): "good point about withdrawing Roth conversions before they've aged. I follow the same strategy that you mentioned regarding IRA distributions."

"If they raise rates before the new year, you should be able to change your plan without penalty. Insurance companies must think we don't have any idea that they are not losing money, they want to increase their profits. It has nothing to do with the people or their health. I would go broke if I went on an advantage plan even if I only had to see a dr once a year and forget about having an emergency."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzpWm59ZZrGqWbZuhB4AaABAg>

"Thanks for your informative videos! I have a question regarding Part D and underwriting. Namely, is Part D ever subject to medical underwriting? I'm in the process of getting Medicare and a Medigap N policy. Because I'm on no medications now, I don't need a part D plan. However, my concern is that if I get some disease in the future that requires some expensive medication, I won't be able to get a part D plan at that point because of underwriting and/or because at that point I'll have that disease as a preexisting condition. I realize that for every month I don't sign up for Part D from the time I'm eligible that my premium is higher by 1% (at least as calculated off of some national baseline). I am comfortable taking on that risk. But do I need to be concerned about an underwriting/ preexisting condition risk as well? Assuming this latter risk doesn't exist, eventually, when I do want to sign up for Part D for the first time, can I do so at any time, or can I do so only during certain times of the year?"

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=Ugy.VH2eA0LOKi0ov4qt4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "there is no underwriting, but the risk is not just 1% per month compounded for the rest of your life. If you get sick and need a prescription you cannot get Part D until the Annual enrollment, to start in January. I have witnessed several people go bankrupt by making this poor decision. <https://partdshopper.com/> look at how low the premiums are - it's not worth the risk."

↳ @guitarnuccio (0): "@MedigapSeminars Thanks very much !"

"I signed up for just A & B without understanding the system and need to make a choice now. I have a few two possibly serious issues that I have not been to a doctor about. As someone who is not afraid of the sun or Sunburn and planning to leave the USA for Thailand next year, I have a few questions that are rarely fully covered in videos. What coverage do plans give you, when are out of the country for 2 or 3 months? The whole year? If I leave mid-year, can plans be cancelled? When can you switch from a supplement plan to an Advantage plan? I expect to have to meet underwriting which I should be able to now but maybe not after I see a doctor. Do Advantage plans ask the same questions? I have nothing in over ten years except a cataract lens replacement last year. To be cautious I would select an N or G now mainly because I don't want to have a narrow choice of doctors and an insurance company as my doctor."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugxtc3_Ztfamf6vKwMI4AaABAg

"I think this was an outstanding video and you explained this all very well in a concise manner. I don't understand many of the comments people have made. You explain the taxes which pays for Part A. You explain how they calculate the cost of Part B - in your example it's \$626 Billion with about 65 millions enrollees. Almost \$10K a year per enrollee or \$811.60 per month. So the government wants you to share this cost, the more income, the more your share goes up. This is all straight forward. Maybe the IRMAA cliffs are not ideal but if you have a lot of income, you should be happy you have a lot of income. But I think what really happens is that hardly no one takes the time to learn about Medicare, the costs, and benefits and just whine and complain. If all the fraud was eliminated, which it won't because it's somebody's gravy train, then the cost would be much lower and maybe even eliminated."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=UgxT2rtgDlcQq6i8qf14AaABAg>

"SUNBURN - Great video and presentation I think most people would find it very clear. One thing I thought should be included, but might muck up the point, is when you turn 65 you have the one time 6 month window where you can get the Supplement without medical underwriting. Insurance companies know you want to come back because you have issues, they are not dumb. MANY trying to game the system will think they can save on advantage and switch later back to traditional, which you can but you likely will not get underwritten for a Supplement plan or if you are EXTREMELY expensive. The lessor point being if you try to save on the less expensive Supplement, N plan you can increase in coverage year to you, your locking into the one you started on or lowen G to N or High deductible but not the reverse direction. Thanks"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxlvbH44sxmbLCRpm94AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching! ☺️ We have lots of videos that go over that idea :) This one was focused on comparing costs. Appreciate you watching!"

'This should be illegal': wishing the rules were enforced · 19 documents · 19 voices

"The more my Plan N increases annually, the more I'm inclined (against my better judgement) to start looking at a Part C Advantage Plan instead. I went with Plan N because I believed in the idea of "Pay me now or pay me later", where I protected myself against high deductibles and annual outlays by paying a (reasonable) monthly premium. Sadly, "Pay me now" is becoming "Pay me a LOT more now, and every year until you die." Also, we need better oversight of these insurers. Offering low costs for a year and then inflating prices once you have attracted a bunch of subscribers should be illegal. Or at least a Medicare plan cost should be guaranteed for a reasonable amount of time. I would be much happier paying more when I sign up, knowing that my premium won't increase to shocking levels for years."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 57 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxVyp4MBD-dEhPeZlh4AaABAg>

↳ @chevelleflorida (8): "To me, if one can afford a medigap/supplemental plan, that is the best option. The biggest issue with Advantage plans is the level of care that you will receive. For example, I know someone who had a heart attack and stroke last year and was referred to a SNF/rehab center. The MA plan was calling within 3 days talking about discharging the patient even though they were not ready to go back home. With traditional Medicare, that person likely would have received 100 days. Fortunately, moving to a SNF, creates a qualifying event to change insurance and we were able to move he patient back to traditional Medicare with a supplemental plan that they already had (Tricare for life.) In truth, the broker who signed them up for a MA plan did them a huge disservice. No one with a Supplemental plan should move to a MA plan."

↳ @Farrodee (5): "In two years my plan G went from 1500 to over 1800 per year. I don't even take any meds and rarely see dr!"

↳ @vanguy9780 (0): "@jaygrenham education is a wonderful thing. You should try it"

"I opted out of Medicare Part B since I have spent less than \$600 in ALL of my healthcare in total in 68 years and they want \$210 a month for this plan which is flatly absurd. And why would I reduce my SS by this much which is about 20% of my total. I firmly believe we all should get Medicare with 100% coverage for everything for free minus a small copay with no separate plans and all private insurance should be eliminated. Insurance has ruined healthcare!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwDRTFZcv8WfoYAGwt4AaABAg>

↳ @EdLee-r6k (2): "@Starfish2145 nah, he will just hide any assets, go on medicaid, and get the taxpayers to pay for all of it. pay nothing in, and take all they can. a 1k SS check tells you something about what level of taxes have been paid into the system...not much"

↳ @Starfish2145 (1): "Yeah, that's great until you get cancer or seriously ill. Then you're screwed."

↳ @MikeMbm-l3z (0): "The permanent penalty for not signing up for part B when first eligible is 10% per year. If you choose to sign up today, you won't be paying the 202.90 per month, you will be paying 30% more since you are now 68. Should you sign up now, every year going forward you will be paying 30% more than everyone who signed up when eligible. The penalty never gets waived. Wait another year and it will be 40% more than the going rate. Good luck!"

"The EXACT reason I chose original medicare. It should be illegal to call it medicare advantage, it's only an HMO. Profits, profits, profits."

— YouTube · MORE Medicare Advantage Plans CUT: Millions Will Face Forced Dis-enrollment ❌ · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPLaLyfDZxY&lc=Ugwrey4vqWCESymz2Bp4AaABAq>

↳ @jlm848-h8i (4): "Advantage was always a sweetheart deal and handout for the insurance companies. It was never,ever in the best interests of patients. The premiums and copays "looked good", but the record of denials for truly needed care is criminal!"

↳ @user-sr9bi2uu8w (2): "Not all MA plans (Part C) are HMOs. Many are PPOs."

↳ @cindyrogalski-y2m (1): "@MrWhaatayNo, he is pretty clear about the many DISadvantages of "Advantage" plans."

"Great video. I wish all the Medicare Advantage ads were required to say "Medicare Advantage is not Medicare. It is Privatized Medicare, where the insurance company makes decisions for what treatment you get and who you can get to treat you; just like you have always complained about." This would greatly facilitate discussions with seniors who have gotten a very different perspective from the zillions of ads they have seen. You also make very good points that it isn't easy to switch that need to be required in these ads, because now they all make false statements like "It's easy to switch every year during open enrollment with no side effects." that encourage seniors to ask "Why not try it since it seems a lot cheaper?" Widespread communication that "Obamacare eliminated pre-existing conditions policies in insurance companies." turns out to not actually be true for seniors. A similar video comparing Medicare Part D with Medicare Advantage for drug coverage would be great."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwXD3i0Kqsak5ZsC5p4AaABAq>

"I am currently with BC/BS Advantage Plan. I have had the coverage change mid year...my PCP was dropped. I have had regular Medicare prices change mid year by both Medigap and Part D. This should be illegal! NOTHING IS SAFE FOR THE ENTIRE YEAR...you are wrong!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwYWL0DsUCvKW7V6zt4AaABAq>

↳ @larrydalton2205 (3): "Medigap prices will very often change mid-year because they are based on the day the policy was started rather than a calendar year. The annual adjustment on these policies could only change at the beginning of the year on Medigap policies if they were started on January 1. My Medigap policy started on December 1st a couple of years ago so the premium changes on December 1 each year. Erik isn't wrong on this. His "book" for the family looks good."

↳ @Lookin4u2 (1): "It's going to get worse because these advantage companies know that nobody is going to stop them from this fraudulent behavior. This is serious and if someone doesn't stop these advantage plans , it's going to continue to get worse. Only vote for someone who will completely stop the fraud and cruelty in this country"

"Make sure to ask your insurance company that your radiology centers are in network. Even if the hospitals are in network it doesn't mean the stand alone radiology facilities could be Out of network. They will tell you yes you can go there but they FAIL to TELL you that they are out of network so your copay in my instance was almost tripled Makes no sense to say the hospitals in network but not the stand alone radiology facilities. My Insurance starts with a Hum !! I'm disabled can't drive anymore and they told me the closest place in network is a 50munte drive from my house and they only do 2 of my test. Then I'll have to get a ride in the complete opposite direct in another State which is 55 miles from my house Always get the NPI# to all your doctors,hospitals,radiology centers,etc and then ask your insurance if they're all in network If not in my situation I'll pay almost triple the copay cost. Why would the hospitals be in network with the NPI# but not the exact same NPI for all their stand alone radiology centers??? This should be illegal!!!!!! People don't know to ask if the stand alone radiology is in network. They just ask do they take my insurance. They respond yes but the FAIL to tell you they're out of network so you pay a higher co pay and it's impossible to even find a in network place at least where I live"

— YouTube · 3 Medicare Changes for 2027 - and how to prepare. #medicare · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GxBa9kBx5cY&lc=Ugwc_ITLY_2MzR4qqyN4AaABAg

"(Kick the can.. I listened intently through your video.) Thanks very much for your clear coverage of Part D both past and present. Wish there were news media stations that would cover news as well and honestly as you. Can't tell which political side you stand on, and for that too I am grateful. Subscribed!"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=Ugz42sfUXITCcTHEJnt4AaABAg

"Well here in California plan n is up to 200.00 .and the part b premium up to 206.00 in 2006.,forced into an advantage plan,it's sad what has happened.😞.guess it's because I live in a rich zipcode.not getting that prepaid credit card like I seen on tv,Thoses ads should be outlawed!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwZ1jDO7PJ0YW9MoTh4AaABAg>

"Why is it the governments fault? The advantage care insurance companies are who you should blame. They harass people and try their best to get you to give up your Medicare and go with one of their plans. Then they limit how long you can stay in a hospital and how much they will pay. Advantage plans are not the way to go. Stay with your Medicare. I have plan A, which cost nothing since every person gets at age 65. That is paid for during your working years through a deduction from your pay check . And, I have plan B, which I pay for through a deduction from my SS. Many have wised up concerning the insurance companies selling the advantage plans. When you go that route, you lose your Medicare coverage. You're right, it could be better. Many thought Obamacare was the answer but it doesn't benefit all Americans. Everyone should get coverage with a premium based on income. If you're not disabled, you should be required to work and pay something towards it. In my opinion, there are to many freebies for some and no help for those who at least try to contribute but are told they don't qualify."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugz9JGsRr1k1raXhrDB4AaABAg.AMVRxGkUevwAMXXgp26kaG>

"Healthy 65 yr old and just learned I get to pay \$400+ in Imma tax. This is not a benefit, it is a penalty for being healthy at 65 and still working. Health insurance pricing based on income is a crappy idea, discriminatory and should be illegal."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzMxDZKI9U4RpWz0d94AaABAg>

"I have noted the recent significant increases in Med supp premiums and feel the need to research why as I am also a physician in addition to owning my own health insurance business. Your assessment is very flawed to justify why there has been an annual 17% annualized rate increase from 6.2023 rates-6.2025 UHC new rates (39% overall increase), yes you show a 6% increase from 73%-79% (loss ratio). The previous 10 years (prior to Covid) the loss ratio was similar and below 80%. Nice presentation, but does not honestly justify this other than "future projections" which should not be factored into getting approval from the state as approval for rate increases is based on previous loss ratio's, not anticipated future loss ratios. I have a very high integrity, have practiced medicine (specialist) and assisted clients with health insurance for 20+ years. Covid although a major issue, is not the driving factor as loss ratios were similar prior to Covid for several years and yet Plan G rates only increased approximately 4% annualized for 10+ years prior to Covid. If premium increases are purely based on Medical loss ratios (take into account all aspects, higher payments to physicians, etc then they are still in line with what they were prior to Covid so how do rate increases change from 4% annualized to 10% annualized if loss ratios although increased over 4 years are still tracking under 80% and same as they were previously. I have 99% Plan G clients and in interacting with "salesman brokers" the honest answer why they sell Plan N is so a significant portion of them can then sell the consumer some other product to maximize commissions, not because they are healthy and looking for a lower premium."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=Ugy4YST8-KXC8QH0k054AaABAg>

"The problem is if you didn't sign up for supplemental insurance within the initial six month grace period (when you first turned 65 years old), when you get the guaranteed the lowest rates, they will take all your health problems and hold them against you and charge you a much higher rate for the same supplemental insurance. That's what happened to me. As a result this year I'll be paying almost \$600 a month for my plan G. My initial insurance agent never even explained the different types of health policies. She just pushed the advantage plan and that's the only one she explained. I found out later agents get a higher commission when they write advantage plans for people, so of course they have every incentive to leave out vitally important information you should know. That should be illegal, but even if it was, how would you ever prove they did it? I'm sure there must be some honest insurance agents out there somewhere, but I don't know where and I have no idea how to find one. Of course it's too late for me now, but I warn everybody approaching the age of 65 that I meet. I try to practice the do unto others others, even if others didn't do it unto me. 🙄 "

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugzc_CkfUiS7A8RGWs14AaABAg.AOIHGUuVOyHAPr5k4piC0a

"Don't go with UHP. Profiteers from the pain and suffering of humans. Major lawsuits and denials. It amazes me this country still has not gone to universal healthcare. I'm on the original Medicare ABG&D. G is with Anthem BC. No perks. Simple and easy with my Drs. No issues so far in 13 months. They are profiteers as well, but I think they are less evil than the rest. D plans are stupid. They all have their "formulary" lists and none are the same \$\$ for identical drugs. Tier 1/2/3/4 garbage. But it's better than nothing. I have Wellcare. Not great but cheap. I've heard from friends in the SF bay area that Kaiser advantage is excellent. Of course you have to use them. But they are well established there. I'm in an area where there are hardly any Kaiser facilities. The agents that "help" are paid to drive you to their plans. They make \$\$ on your payments. Agents should be eliminated. It's a parasite business."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ls9lyr/new_to_medicare_this_year_more_confusing_than_i_n1hta1w/

"OMG this was the best source of Medicare info I have seen. I chose and advantage plan for one reason only because after a bad accident I lost 20 years of earning income and could not afford a supplement plan. The good news is it's been great for me because I don't have a lot of medical problems. I only take two prescriptions one for GIRD and one for Thyroid. But if my medical situation changes I now feel better informed about my options. Thank you for this video because I didn't get any of this info when I first got Medicare and I can clearly see that what works for me might not work for a person with more complicated medical issues. Honestly, your video should be mandatory training for insurance providers. Thankyou! 🍌 "

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugyqcp_0CPTviiYx3ol4AaABAg

"@MedigapSeminars One of videos at another channel I was watching a few days ago, they point out that they can make a lot more money selling Medicare Advantage plans than supplements. I am really glad that I started watching videos. I have learned a lot. I decided that I was not going with a Medicare Advantage plan this time. I have gotten both Plan G and Plan D for this next year, and I can't imagine going back to a Medicare Advantage Plan. I think that they should be required to tell the truth about Medicare Advantage Plans. Thank goodness there are people like you and some of the other channels that discuss this that are honest and tell the truth about them."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwGSGQq7L-y5kUO8ot4AaABAg.9Uobzmomv_m9wRWPuadhAn

"You omitted two serious disadvantages of tradition Medicare + supplements: 1) You guessed that supplementary plans would cost maybe \$100/month in premiums. My AARP supplementary plan at my age (76) has \$265/month premiums. Some difference! 2) Medicare Advantage, unlike traditional Medicare, covers some degree of dental care. A friend of mine had some major dental surgery which was partly covered to the tune of \$6,000 by Medicare Advantage. In my case, I need to replace crowns, and was quoted a cost of \$2,300 by a dentist for just one of them. I wish you had discussed this matter more thoroughly and honestly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugy1XkfW8raf1gOM_jV4AaABAg

"My Standard Life and Accident HD F supplement I started in 2014 in NC became a closed pool about 3 years ago. My premium tripled from 2014 \$448 a year, to 2025 \$1355 a year, and is going up 25% in 2026 to \$1693 a year. I can't pass underwriting so am stuck. To make it worse, Standard Life and Accident is now again selling the HD F in NC for \$74 a month at my age of 86, where the same plan from the same company in the closed pool will cost me \$141 a month in 2026. IMO this should be illegal!"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugxult1lqcUVcJ9I7PB4AaABAq>

"Mitch McConnell has been saying for years that original Medicare should be eliminated. And now, Dr. Oz, hostile to original Medicare is selected to lead CMS. That's another reason why I went with Advantage. I wasn't going to spend thousands in my healthy years only to have the rug pulled out from under at the point I could actually use original Medicare."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1gvawaz/doctor_oz_is_gonna_fuck_shit_up/ly0ohb7/

"As I get closer to needing Medicare this makes me sick. So this year A&B is ~\$171.00. I saw online that Plan G is \$204.00. Is that correct? \$375/month. Having employer medical all my life the thought of paying this kind of money for something I will not likely use until my last two years of life makes me nuts!! Advantage Plans should be outlawed!!!"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgyvLUQpYX8IDGGUOhd4AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareSchool (0): "Supplement plans will vary based on where you reside. You can get a good idea of what they cost on Medicare.gov or you can always call our office and we can review costs along with you as well at 1-800-864-8890."

Wishing Medigap could be bought any year, no health questions · 11 documents · 11 voices

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. \[As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).\] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every

policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— r/HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pqufyv/>

↳ (0): "My recollection was one of the premises of Obamacare was indeed that EVERYONE was required to have health insurance. If you didn't you'd get it on the Exchange at possibly heavily subsidized rates. If you didn't get it, there was a penalty at tax time."

↳ (0): "The mandate was eliminated during Trump Admin v1"

↳ (0): "Didn't some states not increase the range for Medicaid? I seem to remember something.."

"As someone who is about to enter the Medicare minefield I truly appreciate your honest evaluations of Medicare Supplement and Advantage plans. As a senior reaching 65 I have learned a lot and had my eyes opened by your informative videos. Keep up the good work. I hope others do their due diligence on their health care post 65. I wish other states other than the four allow seniors to switch back to original supplement plans. That would immensely help."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugy6mXtwm4ahYY_KrNR4AaABAg

↳ @ckstaff (12): "Don't know the truth on it but in those states you can go back to original I have heard to do so you will be paying a hefty premium to do it. Just take the smart rout and do it right the first time. Don't gamble with your health with taking shortcuts."

↳ @ronbaker8007 (5): "Medicare limits the amount that can be charged; Supplements protect the patient from lack of permission from providers, Med ADV controls permissions and choice."

↳ @kathyd7284 (3): "It is so overwhelming and I was a paralegal for over 40 years. We asked older relatives and decided on regular Medicare Plan N through AARP United Healthcare with Part D through WellCare. We have been so happy with these plans. Hardly anything out of pocket after Medicare yearly deductible paid."

"Maybe the GI (guaranteed issue) benefit should be a line on this chart. The presentation is excellent except for minimizing this as an issue. Just because you have no preexisting conditions now does not mean that you will never have any. At 65 I was fit with few medical visits and no prescription drugs. Two years later I have had melanoma and a heart diagnosis. Thankfully I have Plan G."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgyXPwc2Oqa_-aN2gwZ4AaABAg

"Your father will be looking at Medicare at age 65. He can apply 3 months in advance of turning 65. My spouse at age 65 went with traditional Medicare which is Part A (hospital), Part B (doctor visits/medical), Part D (prescriptions), and a Medigap/supplemental plan. Medicare does have costs. We pay (all in) about \$600 per month for all of the above-mentioned parts. I am on an ACA/marketplace/healthcare.gov plan because am younger than 65. Your father's spouse should be able to get a [healthcare.gov](<http://healthcare.gov>) plan because she holds a green card. Pricing is dependent on estimated household income. I will add it's not inexpensive. We spend over \$30,000 per year in premiums/prescriptions. That does not include medical care for me."

— r/HealthInsurance · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wl5g7i/options_after_retirement/paw92in/

"Great video. I wish all the Medicare Advantage ads were required to say "Medicare Advantage is not Medicare. It is Privatized Medicare, where the insurance company makes decisions for what treatment you get and who you can get to treat you; just like you have always complained about." This would greatly facilitate discussions with seniors who have gotten a very different perspective from the zillions of ads they have seen. You also make very good points that it isn't easy to switch that need to be required in these ads, because now they all make false statements like "It's easy to switch every year during open enrollment with no side effects." that encourage seniors to ask "Why not try it since it seems a lot cheaper?" Widespread communication that "Obamacare eliminated pre-existing conditions policies in insurance companies." turns out to not actually be true for seniors. A similar video comparing Medicare Part D with Medicare Advantage for drug coverage would be great."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwXD3i0Kqsak5ZsC5p4AaABAq>

"IMO - I feel that insurance Medicare agents/brokers who push this scam on clients should be investigated. It's my understanding that the agents are compensated for at a higher rate for enrolling seniors on the Advantage Plan. At the very least customers who enrolled in the Advantage option should be allowed to change back to the traditional one at no penalty to them."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzcjY71Bi2WAeUiyGt4AaABAq.A7yD_2SFDkoA8AiNVaa-oS

"Hi. Thank you for your excellent presentation. I am currently on an advantage plan in California. Got my part B since October 2002 but just joined the advantage plan on 10/1/2023 with no penalty on my prescription drug plan as i had continued coverage from employer plan or cobra. Now i need to switch to a good supplement plan. From your video it seems the only option is if I move. (I don't think Aetna will exit the California market). Fortunately I might move to Seattle WA area in / around Feb 2024. So I should be able to switch to a supplement plan, right? But what about part D plan? Will i be able to get a part D as a guaranteed right? Please note that i have a health condition and wont pass underwriting."

— YouTube · It's Not Always Easy to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=djuGel829M4&lc=UgxGFDtufj_jWAAKe3x4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Hello! Thank you for watching and glad it was helpful. Correct, if you move outside your plan's coverage area, you can go to a supplement plan without underwriting. Part D plans don't have underwriting and you can switch those upon a move or during the Annual Election Period (right now) that runs from October 15th - December 7th each year. Does that help?"

↳ @Vigneshswara (0): "Hi. Thank you for your quick response. A correction in my original message, i got part b with effect from 2022 and not 2002 and enrolled in advantage plan wef 10-1-2023. Questions 1. Other than premium, dental, vision, is there any other reason for not switching from advantage to supplement plan? 2. Did I understand correctly that i can get part D as a guaranteed right and cannot be denied or on higher premiums due to switching now? 3. Am i right that since i am now 67, will be 68 in November, have crossed the deadline for switching and my only option to switch from advantage to supplement plan is when I move? 4. California has a birthday month option; in WA State, is there an option to switch from one supplement plan to another in the future? 5. Is there an option to switch from one Part D to another in the future? 6. Am I correct in saying that i cannot take part D until and unless I switch from advantage to supplement plan? 7. Since i will move from CA to WA around Feb 2024, it will be outside the annual open enrollment period and this will be ok, right? What will the process and sequence be for this switch? Is there a way to discuss over a call?"

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "@Vigneshswara replies in YouTube this long are a little tough, but we'll give it a go. You're always welcome to send me an email to erik@90daysfromretirement.com as well. 1) This depends on the person. Some look at other perks of Advantage plans outside the ones you mentioned. Others don't care about them. It's a very individual decision. 2 & 6) Yes, during the Annual Election Period (October 15 - December 7) you can get a Part D plan. There is not underwriting for Part D plans. And 6 - correct, you cannot get a standalone Part D plan without canceling your Advantage plan. 3) Moving or going through underwriting are your options. 4) California and Washington have unique rules. California is the birthday rule where you can switch from one Medigap to another. Washington is year round, you can switch from one Medigap to another. That does not apply with Advantage to Supplement though. 5) There is always an option to switch Part D during the Annual Election Period or due to a Special Election Period - like moving. 7) Yes, moving qualifies as a Special Election Period and you can make changes. Send me an email to the address above and I'll connect you with my partner licensed in those states and they can go over what that will look like for you. Hope that helps!"

"If they raise rates before the new year, you should be able to change your plan without penalty. Insurance companies must think we don't have any idea that they are not losing money, they want to increase their profits. It has nothing todo with the people or their health. I would go broke if i went on an advantage plan even if I only had to see a dr once a year and forget about having an emergency."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzpWm59ZZrGqWbZuhB4AaABAq>

"Great Info, thanks! I know you are speaking specifically about the plans but you mentioned about enrolling. Yes, there is the initial enrollment period for those turning 65 and are going on Medicare but some people who are covered by an employer (with more than 20 employees) healthcare plan have a special enrollment period that works like the initial enrollment period and I believe no medical underwriting is required. I think anyone who falls under this time period can get Plan N and not have to go on Plan G. I may be wrong but that's my understanding. My wife falls under this category (under my coverage) and she should be able to get plan N as if she signed up when she turned 65."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgyF2QHeWokquwaB0UR4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (2): "@vinnyg2619 check out the page I linked. If she is new to Part B then she can get Plan N and any other Medigap Plan without underwriting. But if she is not new to Part B then Plan N is not a guaranteed issue plan option (in most states) when losing employer coverage."

↳ @vinnyg2619 (1): "@AbtInsuranceAgency Thanks, the new to Part B was in my head and not written in my comment. Thanks again!"

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "No, Plan N is not a guaranteed issue plan. Plan G is. <https://www.medicare.gov/health-drug-plans/medigap/ready-to-buy>";

"If we ever implement "medicare for all", I hope it doesn't come with all this stupid complexity. Anyone, citizen or not should be able to get any care at little or no cost for any problem, and no need to sign up for anything."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgwMNLLp2LrdoKcUSE14AaABAg>

"You should be able to get good coverage for under \$20k as a senior pre-Medicare individual. Still exorbitant but better than \$30k."

— YouTube · How Do I Pay For Health Insurance if I Retire Early? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Au4dTIwLBUg&lc=Ugyp9SGvhouyXVgfLUI4AaABAg.APdB7xu8A8qAPdi1FfAjQS>

Wishing dental, vision, hearing and long-term care were covered · 11 documents · 11 voices

"Back in the 80s medical insurance was simple. I had blue cross that the company gave as a benefit. If I went to the Dr, dentist or eye doctor, I never paid for anything and didn't get any paperwork from the Dr or insurance company. Now, I get bills from Dr and the insurance company sends me something at least 3 times per week (I called them to get them to stop sending me the useless information). And my eyes and teeth are part of my body and it SHOULD BE COVERED BY MEDICARE ! "

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · 105 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxHVeiY2LS72yYatvJ4AaABAg>

↳ @StarkeyatRingo (12): "isn't it funny THAT SICKNESS rose with the MANDATORY INSURANCE??? AS IF we couldn't have one without the other - and the PRICES ALL GOT OUT OF WHACK WHEN SICKNESS BECAME BUSINESS"

↳ @johnsonpaul1914 (4): "It was never simple for me. I was self employed for most of my life and rarely had any health ins, but we got by. Have had medicare now for 12 years and covered that with a medicare advantage no premium policy. Quite satisfied with that. But I am now very disillusioned with health care. It is more sick care and very little about actual health"

↳ @portrait1001 (3): "@iamanovercomer3253 the biggest problem was losing a job , for whatever reason and having a child or spouse that had a preexisting condition. Your life would of been consumed with medical bills then"

"As a I licensed agent, I absolutely agree. I understand why mapds exist, because not everyone can afford a supplement, let alone part b premium. I will also like to point out however, that sometimes, especially in areas of Florida, there are great mapd plans out there. The fact of the matter is, most people don't venture out seeking multiple doctors, and rarely seek routine service out of their service area. Heck, most people wouldn't even know what do if they are diagnosed with chronic condition. I am slowly warming up to mapds because those who live in hardships, and have health conditions have no other choice. Original Medicare needs to be increased because besides that part d and part b premium, never mind the ancillary "not covered" services like vision,hearing or dental (what a joke)"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwIBspUINt_ZTfu8bN4AaABAg

↳ @akita96th (0): "You haven't had to shell out the \$7500 out of pocket expenses yet....That will wake you up."

↳ @stuntmasta305 (0): "@akita96th this is pretty much the norm for most private healthcare coverage under 65. Not including Aca, or Medicaid. For those on OM, it goes on forever, unless you have a supplement that you pay anywhere between 100-300 a month, plus a separate part D with no dental, vision or hearing in consideration. There are plans with considerable less MOOPs, not uncommon in populated areas to have moops as low as 800. The ugly side of mapds isn't always the cost, but the utilization management."

↳ @akita96th (0): "Like I said its all fun and games until you really get sick then they put the screw on you. All I am saying is those who say they can't afford a supplement will realize when they get sick that maybe they could have afforded it after all once those out of pocket bills start piling up. It is a shame seniors have to live like that in this rich country thanks to the republican party. Any senior citizen on a fixed income who votes republican deserves all the misery old age can muster. MAGA does not love you back."

"Cadillac ... I had no idea I couldn't switch my agent down the road, if I were to find my agent wasn't being as much help as I need... that is incredibly distressing. 😞 I have a plan N, & so far, have liked my agent, but have wondered about the possibility of needing to switch, were I to find I was no longer getting the help I need. WOW, this seems SO WRONG & the fact that this is the first time I am hearing I have no option to switch, should I wish to do so, is even more distressing! Yikes! [8.3.2026] [Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? - The Retirement Nerds]"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxDIrsrmJubmUe3FZN4AaABAg>

"I agree with this video. But in Florida (where I live), I pay \$450.00 for Medicare original and a supplemental under the G plan per month. That may be cost prohibitive to many Americans on a fixed income. . There should be a cost effective dental plan with supplemental insurance. That is a problem as well. The video was informative"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyOkD9U367nnWGoj8N4AaABAg

"@LarryKelly whenever I go to the ER I don't have to pay any co-pay and I have spent almost three weeks in the hospital I had zero copay I can see any doctor I. Can see any specialist and I do not have a co-pay I do not have to have a doctor referral to see a specialist I haven't had to pay a prescription medication copay since August I won't have to pay another copay in till January I have dental I have vision and if needed hearing aids I don't have a Medicare premium I get up to \$375 a year on eyeglasses I get a additional \$350 every quarter on over-the-counter medication vitamins and supplements I also can buy expensive medical equipment for free blood pressure monitor shower chairs raised toilet seats \$350 worth of product for free the only thing that I have to pay for is when I get my prescriptions filled my prescriptions cost\$3.50 each my plan also will cover x-rays blood work CT scans. MRI scans if I need to have a blood transfusion I don't have to pay anything and it don't matter how many bag of blood that I get I don't have to pay for it since I don't have an automobile I get 48 free trip to my doctors every year and every year I get 10 additional trips my plan also covers dental work Dentures it covers oral surgery it also covers a gym membership Now can your plan beat mine??? I have never had an issue of my Medicare Plan not wanting to cover any medication but yeah you are probably paying about what 200.00 to 300.00 on medigap or several supplements plans My plan also covers Lasik eye surgery About the middle of next year I am having weight loss surgery guess how much that's going to cost😞😞 I give you a hint ((----- -ZERO-----)) NOW TELL ME WHAT YOU PAY AND WHAT ALL GREAT STUFF YOU GET I guarantee you if everything that I own and it's not much that I own that you don't get anything like the stuff I get"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugxi-BJ7WpxJLsFGVvV4AaABAg.9UkMxX2Jeqw9Us8Hqw2AVg>

"I have Medicare and anthem Blue Cross is my Supplementary insurance. My Anthem premium is 268.00 per month. I do not have dental or hearing. I will be 90 on the first of December and I am fearful of jumping around and discovering later I made a mistake. I'm on a fixed income and when I pay all my insurances and credit cards and taxes, there is not much left. I do wish I had some help with dental for dental hygiene, etc. Do you have any suggestions or do you think I'm doing the best I can? STEPHANIE WHAT DO YOU THINK?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzB9wGtjWm2yVNotlI4AaABAg>

↳ @tonyalexa1120 (0): "Hello 🙌 Roberta... How are you doing today? And happy 😊 thanksgiving to you and your family over there! 😊 "

"Great video. I turned 65 in Jan 2026 and got on medicare and a supp plan thru my ex employer here in Oregon. The plan includes Part D, vision, and hearing. No dental. I pay \$349/month. That seems really high, but here's all sorts of perks that I don't use. So, I'm looking to change come open enrollment time. I want to continue with a supp plan and Part D. Vision, hearing, and Dental would be nice add ons. If I can get below the 349/month, then I'll give you a call or set up an appt."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugw_mtUyTboopH5-Fch4AaABAg

"@policyguides Most of us have been on HMOs our whole working lives. None of MAs quirks (like preauths, etc) are new. I wish I could afford a supplement but with adding Part D, Dental, Vision on top of the Supplement, its a fools errand to go that route."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwiHp7iSAC2y-eYfCB4AaABAg_AM8sjxPZkEXAOHL5HIINZ-

"Personal question: I am assuming that dental and vision plans found in Advantage plans would need to be purchased separately. Work: I work with Medicaid eligible individuals, does Medicaid cover Supplemental plans like it does advantage plans?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgzFkmSXIZ88e2FLPW14AaABAg>

"Looking at the two and having dealt with my mom and dad's Medicare Advantage and the hot mess of preauths and rejections and referral needs, etc were overwhelming. I will be doing the full Medicare coverage side and supplement with just a dental plan. Base vision out-of-pocket should be sufficient, especially as I have an HSA, I don't feel like an actual Vision plan is truly worth the premium after all the other co-pays and costs."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxNsJrY-iQPxCY2V8h4AaABAg>

"Do you go to my call me back I tried to talk to them daughter and I don't want it all American people call me tell me a zero down and I'll let up cause either way go you're still gonna have to pay that is that is not her fault for the most weirdo I don't know when you made the state it would've run 48 some meals OK God bless you 148 God bless you now the enemy want to do route canals and crowns and stuff yeah Denist wanted without everything put in place they got a game I don't want to give me your plan is managers would he say I read it wrong I got a good TV I need to tell him the truth to those they do a filling on it OK the feeling don't last so long didn't want to do the crown to pay all the money for a crack baby you know how to dress like it was before I know that you get it it is my day is it no I have not told about the dress like it I'd rather play with no I had to dress like that does all my God where do you mature know when I go get my T4 my dad didn't account but when I go get my T4 I'll take my headphones are used to make my doctor here for me to put all my emails and tell me that he iPhone but I'm not I take my medication I take my headphones The main TV was broke right now all the TVs in there I can't believe it has a yard to pay your bill how do I say what are you doing what did we watch TV and pay the bill in the waiting room no television no magazines no nothing is it all my God help me Jesus that's all I can say I'm gonna take them to magazine I got a treat everybody equally OK God bless you guys lady I'm glad you're teasing I was going on and tell him to about it while green they can order from Walmart every 66663 month when my phone is it me the catalog does my insurance lady know if you are from my telephone I told Medicare I don't play with the phone so they don't need to send me to Walmart catalog on my telephone just send me a catalog and order every order no I got me I got the message or vitamins last time 200 I got vitamin is 200 what I need to help I got a come a cosmetic and tell them we need to get the yeast rice and refried rice diet supplement I have to take them that want me to take them while greenhouse Walmart has them OK God bless you guys presentation I'm proud of you but now I know to dinner Saturday bring over us and being nice as it burns when I sober and I guess I'm doing Tele dentistry"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABA9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku8LpblWhz>

Wishing for one simple Medicare that covers everything · 8 documents · 8 voices

"My husband has an Advantage plan has not had any problems with it. Been on it 5 years. Finding a dentist in our area has been an issue though. What I don't understand is why there are separate Plans (A,B,C,D) and you have to pay for those. Medicare should be one plan and it's all covered as we paid for it from our working wages."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 79 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugzj1Rb6ZQ40dwn_bcl4AaABAg

↳ @muzak-mn3de (9): "There is the real issue, the Federal Government knows Medicare is a drain on the annual expenses, and pass the buck onto Insurance Companies and providers. It's the Federal Governments fault."

↳ @oldwhiteman5860 (4): "@muzak-mn3de Your ignorance is profound. Insurance companies are paid by Medicare for every person that enrolls in an Advantage plan. They are paid based on the perceived health risks of those insured. The insurance companies do everything they can to increase the perceived risk so they can charge Medicare more even if the risk never materializes. Payment to for profit insurance companies to cover Advantage plans costs Medicare billions of dollars a year and is a major factor in Medicare's lack of long-term viability."

↳ @YY4-33 (3): "The problem is that Each Year certain doctors no longer accept the Advantage plan. It's happened to my brother. But he doesn't care if he has to travel another hour or switch to a different cardiologists. He's in southwest Louisiana. I'm up North. He likes the little freebies. I'm a bit younger but I worked in healthcare for over 35 years. I'd stay FAR away from united healthcare & Medicare advantage. For now we purchase on the Market. BCBS ONLY."

"I opted out of Medicare Part B since I have spent less than \$600 in ALL of my healthcare in total in 68 years and they want \$210 a month for this plan which is flatly absurd. And why would I reduce my SS by this much which is about 20% of my total. I firmly believe we all should get Medicare with 100% coverage for everything for free minus a small copay with no separate plans and all private insurance should be eliminated. Insurance has ruined healthcare!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwDRTFZcv8WfoYAGwt4AaABAg>

↳ @EdLee-r6k (2): "@Starfish2145 nah, he will just hide any assets, go on medicaid, and get the taxpayers to pay for all of it. pay nothing in, and take all they can. a 1k SS check tells you something about what level of taxes have been paid into the system...not much"

↳ @Starfish2145 (1): "Yeah, that's great until you get cancer or seriously ill. Then you're screwed."

↳ @MikeMbm-l3z (0): "The permanent penalty for not signing up for part B when first eligible is 10% per year. If you choose to sign up today, you won't be paying the 202.90 per month, you will be paying 30% more since you are now 68. Should you sign up now, every year going forward you will be paying 30% more than everyone who signed up when eligible. The penalty never gets waived. Wait another year and it will be 40% more than the going rate. Good luck!"

"I'm 72 and I pay over \$200/month for the supplement coverage. The bottom line: I CAN'T AFFORD IT! So, I do not participate in these programs, wellness checks ect. We should have 100% coverage! This system is a racket!"

— YouTube · New changes could be coming to Medicare in 2027 · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7cDpJANnu2U&lc=UgyYM5IykNU2Zpo0XCR4AaABAq>

↳ @zrx4me1 (1): "You have a crappy plan."

"All this just tells me we should have Medicare For All."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSl_fc&lc=UgwOxhKPbPKAN29DceV4AaABAq.AZu4bILOPm6AZwTNDYW64a

"Am not retired yet but it appears to me, why retirees are having difficulties with Medicare coverage appears complicated to understand when it should be friendly, simple and easy for them considering retired and being on the age of 70, maybe with deficits. Why it appears to be complicated for the elderly people?"

— YouTube · Up to 3.5 Million May Lose Their Medicare Advantage Plans - Don't Miss This Medigap Right · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XMKSLDipo9o&lc=Ugxv15eFf2C-NxG6RaJ4AaABAq>

"So you pay Medicare your whole life and now you want me to pay "extra" premium for services I get for free now? Oh and I have to be "approved" to be covered. Medicare should be 100% free for seniors! We are already paying \$2100 yr in Medicare A/B . Non citizens get 100% free Medicaid 🙄 "

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyR9WomSON-3IkIwx54AaABAq

"Private insurance was the wrong way to go From the beginning "Single payer plan" was what we should have done from the beginning for Medicare I always had a Medicare Advantage plan"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSl_fc&lc=UgzXD7Nz8dbAwAVoiFN4AaABAq

"If I am a 100% disabled veteran and also have Tricare for life, do I need to be enrolled in Medicare A & B?"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzAJoDj1IqjXvZpUKh4AaABAq>

Wishing for someone unbiased to explain it · 6 documents · 6 voices

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

↳ (0): "It should automatically go down in January, if your income goes back down. We won appeal in 2024 and again in 2026 based on retirement events."

↳ (0): "I just asked Google this question "can you go off medicare to avoid irmaa" You should do the same and read the full reply. (It basically says don't do it and gives options to reduce IRMAA which I am including below.) # Here is what it says about dropping Medicare: **No**, dropping your Medicare coverage to avoid IRMAA (Income-Related Monthly Adjustment Amount) is rarely a good idea. \[1](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenrolling_later_on/)\] If you voluntarily disenroll from Part B and Part D, your IRMAA surcharges may temporarily stop, but you will face severe consequences: \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>)\] **Gaps in Coverage:** You will be left without coverage for basic outpatient care, doctor visits, or prescription drugs. **Permanent Late Enrollment Penalties:** When you try to re-enroll in Medicare later, you will face hefty, permanent late enrollment penalties. **Lack of Guarantee:** You may not be able to simply re-enroll whenever you want; you will have to wait for the General Enrollment Period (January 1–March 31) with coverage beginning the following July. \[1](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [2](<http://www.investmentnews.com/retirement-planning/what-happens-to-medicare-when-you-suspend-social-security-bennies/48121>), [3](<https://thebig65.com/medigap-plans-guide/>), [4](<https://boomerbenefits.com/medicare-enrollment-period/>), [5](<https://www.leonardfinancialsolutions.com/transition-from-employer-insurance-to-medicare/>)\] # These are the ways it suggests for reducing IRMAA: **Better Ways to Reduce or Avoid IRMAA** Instead of dropping your Medicare coverage, consider these legally recognized strategies to lower your MAGI or appeal the surcharge: \[1](<https://www.schwab.com/learn/story/how-higher-income-can-affect-medicare-premiums>), [2](<https://www.medicareresources.org/blog/four-ways-to-avoid-income-related-medicare-surcharges/>), [3](<https://decimawealth.com/planning/avoid-irmaa-surcharges/>)\] **File an Appeal for Life-Changing Events:** If your income dropped due to a qualifying life event (like retirement, work reduction, divorce, or the death of a spouse), you can appeal to the Social Security Administration using [Form SSA-44](<https://www.ssa.gov/forms/ssa-44.pdf>). **Reduce Taxable Income Pre-Retirement:** Maximize pre-tax contributions to employer-sponsored retirement plans (like a 401(k) or 403(b)) before you hit age 65. **Make Qualified Charitable Distributions (QCDs):** If you are 70½ or older, you can donate up to \(\\$111,000\) per year directly from your IRA to a charity. This money is not counted as taxable income, thereby lowering your MAGI. **Roth Conversions Early On:** Strategically converting traditional retirement accounts to Roth IRAs *before* you reach Medicare age can reduce your future taxable RMDs (Required Minimum Distributions).\[1](<https://youstaywealthy.com/how-to-avoid-irmaa/>), [2](<https://www.ssa.gov/medicare/lower-irmaa/>), [3](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/medicare/avoid-the-irmaa-with-a-roth-conversion>), [4](https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jlerg5/disenrolling_from_part_b_and_reenrolling_later_on/), [5](<https://medicareagentshub.com/questions/how-can-i-avoid-or-reduce-irmaa-charges-on-my-medicare-premiums/>)\] — Hope this helps. I do Roth conversions which increase my income. IRMAA is triggered. (There is a 2 year look back so the impact of this years conversions cause IRMA 2 years later). If I stopped conversions, iRMAA would stop 2 years later. But I could use some the money I converted to pay the IRMAA if I had to. I don't fully understand your issue, but hopefully this helps you with some options. 🙏 "

↳ (0): "I dropped my part b due to an Irmaa spike and stayed on my wife's insurance for three years, as long as you have creditable coverage it's not issue, you just have to reapply."

"One thing they never told me when starting Medicare was that if you are basically healthy and pick a cheaper plan you will never be able to switch to a better plan. After you first start Medicare they can deny you based on medical history. I wish someone had told me to go with the most expensive plan I could afford. Thank you for mentioning that risk."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N Compared to Plan G - Which Should You Choose? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3WBOKbvEq9U&lc=Ugy-MHTft3p5p5yT-h14AaABAg>

↳ @carapungo (1): "of course you can change from plans on a yearly basis, specially if you are in good health."

↳ @joycewright5386 (0): "@carapungo yes but what they didn't tell me was if I develop a chronic condition no plan will insure me ever. So I am stuck with whatever plan I picked originally. If I had known that I would have picked a better plan."

↳ @carapungo (0): "@joycewright5386 so which plan do you have now?"

"FINALLY someone to explain the difference!! My brother sold these insurance for years and I still never understood. Could it be the push for advantage plans pays more to the agent??? Hmmm. At 75 I'm in pretty good health but gosh one bad fall or cancer would be break me. Now I can explain to my friends. Thank you from Houston. Edit: I have a question. 2019 I had open heart surgery. My advantage plan paid everything. I don't remember the amt. So they did pay. Will that be held against me in the future pay out? As we age will they refuse treatment? I'm hearing it called disadvantage plan because of this. I thought I understood so can you clarify?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgxTHfn7Z2jStPskQ4t4AaABAg>

↳ @asterixky (2): "MA does pay a large portion of the bills if not all. People saying otherwise have never had MA."

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (1): "Thank You!! (From Austin 😊)"

↳ @kittygriggs4146 (0): "@asterixkyI keep reading & hearing that more & more drs & hospitals are not accepting Advantage plans, seems like they're trying to phase it out. This is all so confusing!!! 🤔"

"I wish someone had told me that I could skip medical underwriting LAST year when my BCBS plan was dropped in my county - too late now. Being on a \$0 premium Advantage Plan since 2014 has saved me BIG money since I only see a doctor about once a year. Now getting older and on more drugs so I'm tempted to switch to Original. But the premiums for the supplemental plans go up and up outrageously as you get older and more likely to use them. Drug plans keep increasing too. Aren't the supplemental plans thru insurance companies too? So, you are spending more than the Advantage Plans and still dealing with insurance companies..."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxYhuDpMkCxP7b9DZ54AaABAg

"@nancybryant4325 Thank you again for your response. I had been told by someone I trusted that I should be on Medicare. I do not have lots of expenses now but I can see that investing before I need it, which most of us definitely will, will give me more security if something major were to happen. I also find most of the so-called benefits of the advantage plan actually not that valuable when I try to use them. And no I don't use referrals because often when I have asked for a specific referral I have either been denied or the payment to the caregiver is denied even though a legitimate referral and I paid a copay. Here I am talking about physical therapy which now I pay out-of-pocket and don't even bother trying to get the referral. I negotiate for a cash price. Many won't take my plan anymore anyhow because of the endless denials, etc. Someone is paying for all those slick commercials bombarding us."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtIF4AaABAq.9TDdw-WtTCC9Tta6FO3qEN>

"I have noted the recent significant increases in Med supp premiums and feel the need to research why as I am also a physician in addition to owning my own health insurance business. Your assessment is very flawed to justify why there has been an annual 17% annualized rate increase from 6.2023 rates-6.2025 UHC new rates (39% overall increase), yes you show a 6% increase from 73%-79% (loss ratio). The previous 10 years (prior to Covid) the loss ratio was similar and below 80%. Nice presentation, but does not honestly justify this other than "future projections" which should not be factored into getting approval from the state as approval for rate increases is based on previous loss ratio's, not anticipated future loss ratios. I have a very high integrity, have practiced medicine (specialist) and assisted clients with health insurance for 20+ years. Covid although a major issue, is not the driving factor as loss ratios were similar prior to Covid for several years and yet Plan G rates only increased approximately 4% annualized for 10+ years prior to Covid. If premium increases are purely based on Medical loss ratios (take into account all aspects, higher payments to physicians, etc then they are still in line with what they were prior to Covid so how do rate increases change from 4% annualized to 10% annualized if loss ratios although increased over 4 years are still tracking under 80% and same as they were previously. I have 99% Plan G clients and in interacting with "salesman brokers" the honest answer why they sell Plan N is so a significant portion of them can then sell the consumer some other product to maximize commissions, not because they are healthy and looking for a lower premium."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=Ugy4YST8-KXC8QH0k054AaABAq>

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

Happy with an Advantage plan · 319 documents · 20 voices

"Medicare Advantage has worked beautifully for me! I'm very happy with the advantage plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 1,591 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwDONw571neI_1vEx4AaABAg

↳ @karenotter3109 (39): "Maam, you WONT HAVE YOUR PLAN in 2026!"

↳ @JoshuaMartins-sr7ez (30): "The news about so many Medicare Advantage plans leaving in 2026 has people rattled—and for good reason. Healthcare is one of the biggest financial variables in retirement."

↳ @NormanWashington_Ir3ri (10): "That's why the most powerful way to think about this isn't just: "Which plan do I pick?" but "How do I restructure my money so healthcare inflation doesn't derail my retirement goals?""

"Medicare Advantage is a Scam: My experience almost a decade in the Healthcare industry I was inspired to go into some detail after an AskReddit post about dirty insider truth that most people won't know. I replied that, as a person who's worked in the medical field for a little over 9 years, saying that Medicare is leagues better than Medicare Advantage and Medicare Advantage is a scam. I've worked in a Home Health Agency, an inpatient rehab (SNF), a doctor's office, and am currently an RN working inpatient rehab. Hopefully, people will find this interesting or helpful \- Admissions for SNF: First medical jobs was admissions primarily to fill short term rehab beds. I had a website of all the people discharging from local hospitals who needed inpatient therapy, I would reach out to the hospitals, say we had a bed available, they would confirm with me, I would get the paperwork, get insurance authorization if needed, and greet the patient once they arrived and sign papers Medicare patients: I was told to try and get as many traditional Medicare patients as possible. I asked my boss why and she said that they pay the most and they always pay. I never once had to get insurance authorizations for traditional Medicare. The people could just come in! It covered the most therapy per day vs any other insurance(an hour a day vs. 30 minutes a day usually), including every Medicare Advantage. It automatically covered the first 20 days, then the next 80 days after that, I think it was like 60%. But if they had a secondary insurance, it would cover 100 days at 100%. Medicare Advantage: First off, once you get a Medicare Advantage plan, it's not traditional Medicare anymore, it's the insurance company now. Of you want to come to our facility, you don't get the grace of just walking in. I'm sure they've streamlined everything now, but we had to call a number, present the diagnosis in certain code numbers, wait for an authorization number, and then we could let you in. From there, you'd maybe get 20 days at 100% with half the daily rehab, then after 20 days, they were done. it covered nothing. Patient was 100% responsible for all costs. \- Home Health Scheduler My 2nd job was scheduling a team of Therapists and Nurses to different homes in my city who needed home health. I'd get a stack of referral papers every morning and was told to get them scheduled. For example, a referral would say "Medicare A: Needs RN and PT services", and then I'd contact my staff and arrange a schedule. I would also work with my staff and the patients that needed anything rescheduled. I was essentially the Guy in the Chair Medicare: Let's say that of my 3 referrals I had that morning 1 was traditional Medicare A, once was a UHC Medicare Advantage, and the other a Humana Medicare Advantage. Once again, I was told, "Staff the Medicare patients first!" And once again, I asked why and was told that Medicare always pays, and it always pays the most. I wasn't working directly with insurance at that job, so I can't comment on authorizations or cost. But Medicare patients generally had more RN and PT visits per week than any Medicare Advantage. Usually 3 days per week for each with Medicare, and 2 days a week for any Medicare Advantage. Also, there are longer sessions with Medicare. usually an hour vs 30 minutes Medicare Advantage: Just less care. Less staffing days and shorter sessions. \- Doctor's office: Next job I had before my RN was in a primary care physicians office. I only worked the front desk, but I worked right next to the referral coordinator, so I knew everything that was happening about that Medicare: From a cashiers perspective, Medicare never had a copay while many Medicare Advantage plan did. From a referral perspective, Medicare was so much easier. I don't think I ever saw Medicare rejected a referral claim. It was always quick, and as long as we filled the paperwork out properly, it was approved. Also, most specialists took Medicare, so usually patients could go where they wanted. Medicare Advantage: There was always an authorization process. it often involved scanning and sending documents, then waiting for approval. Generally it was a longer process that resulted in much more rejections than traditional Medicare. Also, one again, because Medicare Advantage isn't Medicare anymore, it's whatever insurance company has it now, the patients were stuck with whatever doctors they had plans with, and it was always a much smaller list than Tradition Medicare. I've been an RN for about 4 years now, so I am very separated from the insurance side, thank God! DISCLAIMER: Some Medicare Advantage plans are competitive with the benefits of traditional Medicare, but they are often very expensive. Some people are very happy with their Medicare Advantage plans, but I wanted to share my perspective, and my experience. But, this is also why I am greatly in support of expanding Medicare to cover all People in the US. We have the means to give the people proper

Healthcare, we just need to do it"

— r/HealthInsurance · 472 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sl2x0z/>

↳ (0): "Reminder to get a supplemental plan with your traditional Medicare. A medigap plan. Also reminder to get your part D plan. Everything you said is spot on but leaves out those couple things that are very important. Everyone I know turning 65 I tell them get your traditional Medicare A and B and then get your D and Medigap. But that sounds really confusing to people which seems to be why they think it'd be 'easier' to just get a Medicare advantage plan to 'do it all'."

↳ (0): "I did research for 2 month on my spare time when I chose my mom's plan last year. And this sub was so beneficial because of so many people sharing their experiences. I chose her A,B,D an G Extra. I feel really bad they make it sooo complicated. I can't imagine being 65 and having to deal with this nonsense."

↳ (0): "The current administration is pushing MA plans; they want to get out of the Medicare business and just pay the \$\$ to the private insurers instead. I think more people need to be aware of this & put a stop to it. As an elderly person, you don't want a for-profit company making care decisions for you."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorqh/>

↳ (0): "Plan N offers the same coverage as plan G except excess charges (which aren't allowed in my state anyway) and there is a \$20 co-pay for an office visit and \$50 co-pay for an emergency room visit. The savings with N will cover over 20 co-pays per year based on the rates I was quoted. It is also expected that premium

increases with N will be less than G since plan G is the guaranteed issue plan."

↳ (0): "Good point. Even with all of my appointments, I don't think I ever went over 20 in a single year. If I did, it wasn't by much. Plan N is a good option for those just starting Medicare. Unfortunately, I'm in Massachusetts and this plan is not available."

↳ (0): "Agree whole heartedly on the Medicare supplement plan. My husband is currently undergoing cancer treatment at MD Anderson. He has tonsil cancer, which is an uncommon type of cancer. We came to Houston from Oregon because MD Anderson is an NCI cancer center that treats thousands more cases of tonsil cancer than the one NCI hospital we have in Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

"What a great and thorough explanation. Thank you, most sincerely. I, and a friend, are both seniors. She with and Advantage Plan and I chose Supplemental. We both have the exact same diagnosis. Routine testing is required. Her coverage is approved for 1 time per year and has been denied for more frequent testing. My testing is approved for every time my doctor wants to do it (every 3 months). I will be pointing many to your video. Just to make the point: I have another friend, also a senior, that is older than me but very healthy. She's very happy with her no cost Advantage Plan. Thanks so much. Like an elephant, I'll never forget (God willing ☺)"
— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugwuu0qLpz1SPRsjnFd4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much!! 🐘 so glad it was helpful and thank you for sharing your experiences!"

↳ @logicalblueberry (0): "That's what makes choosing so very difficult. My husband and I are healthy and in our early sixties. We would hate to waste money on an expensive health plan that we will hopefully never use. However, two of his siblings have died from cancer so???"

↳ @judysouzaw2293 (0): "Before I retired 8 years ago, my employer paid most of my UnitedHealthcare supplemental plan F after I turned 65. Now I'm 79 and still in good health, thanks to the love and joy I receive from my cats Denny and Donny!! Every year I call UHC to see if there is a cheaper plan and why my plan has no perks at all. I hesitate to switch to an advantage plan and be under covered if I encounter a costly medical event. I pay separately for Plan D and also dental coverage. I can afford all the premiums, but it doesn't seem fair. I know I'm grandfathered into plan F, but should I at least think about switching to plan G? Thank you very much."

"I really like my Advantage plan! Haven't had any problems, never denied coverage never any monthly output, always had complete coverage."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 56 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgzgM7tL9bIQNKyO7ix4AaABAg>

↳ @meditation6054 (5): "I don't know which Advantage plan you have but I'm a physical therapist and every patient that has an advantage plan have consistently been cut short on coverage for services! Every Advantage plan cuts services!"

↳ @mrsatire9475 (1): "Wellcare was not accepted at enough facilities and they refused to cover scripts and diagnostics ordered by Doctors not in their plan"

↳ @akita96th (0): "Have you been really sick yet? The kind of sick that cost over a \$100K I have..Thats when you will hate that advantage plan...Did you buy that advantage plan because Donald Trump and the GOP supports them?"

"I liked when my Advantage plan was terminated at the end of 2025. It was a mistake I made before I knew better. So the opportunity to change to a supplement without underwriting was great! Very nice presentation, Erik. I may be helping my elderly mother with this situation this year. Heartwarming book title! 😊 "

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 54 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwHKfldWxerXwjopCJ4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (6): "Thank you, John! Glad you had the chance to switch!"

↳ @johndooley2305 (1): "It was the Plan G. I valued being able to budget and forecast my medical expenses. No surprises."

↳ @Barbara-k5g (1): "@Theretirementnerds my question to you, is this and hopefully you know the answer if I decide to drop my advantage plan for 2027 do I notify Medicare that I'm doing so and then of course I have to get a Plan D for prescriptions, but that might be the cheaper way to go rather than losing benefits under the advantage plan and the big changes in drug formularies"

"NPR: Older Americans say they feel trapped in Medicare Advantage plans JANUARY 7, 2024 8:10 AM ET HEARD ON WEEKEND EDITION SUNDAY By Sarah Jane Tribble - Kaiser Health News 3-Minute Listen (Story first aired on All Things Considered on January 3, 2023.) UNIDENTIFIED NARRATOR: Right now is the Medicare annual enrollment period. 2024 Medicare Advantage plans are now available, so everyone on Medicare can call to see if a Medicare Advantage plan may be better for you. RASCOE: The plans are private insurance that Americans 65 and older can sign up for instead of traditional Medicare. And lots of Americans are signing up in this open enrollment period through March. Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News reports that some regret signing up and then have trouble getting out. SARAH JANE TRIBBLE: Back in 2016, when Richard Timmins first signed up for Medicare, he went to a free informational seminar with an insurance agent. RICHARD TIMMINS: Basically, he really promoted Medicare Advantage. He just said, well, look, it's less expensive. It's broader in coverage. TRIBBLE: For Timmins, it made economic sense to sign up for Medicare Advantage instead of traditional Medicare, and that worked out great - for a while. Then, he found a small bump on the back of his right ear. TIMMINS: I have a family history of melanoma, so I was kind of tuned into that and thinking about that. TRIBBLE: But it took him a long time to see the right specialist in his Medicare Advantage network, and getting the paperwork in order was confusing. TIMMINS: It was starting to - it started to grow and started to become rather painful. TRIBBLE: By the time Timmins finally saw an oncologist, the lesion had grown to the size of a dime. His right earlobe needed to be removed. He thinks getting care using traditional Medicare would have been faster and easier, and David Meyers at Brown University School of Public Health says he's probably right. DAVID MEYERS: You can see any provider you want. There are many less sort of restrictions on care. You get a lot more freedom with traditional Medicare. TRIBBLE: Timmins wishes he could switch, but there's a catch. TIMMINS: Would I go back to traditional Medicare if it was not cost prohibitive? Absolutely. TRIBBLE: Traditional Medicare premiums average about \$170 a month. And while enrollees on Medicare Advantage plans still pay that premium, the monthly cost can be more affordable. That's because plan enrollees often don't have to pay for extra prescription coverage. They also don't have to buy supplemental insurance, usually called Medigap. That supplemental insurance is needed because, unlike Medicare Advantage plans, traditional Medicare doesn't cap out-of-pocket cost. The thing is, Timmins might not be able to get a Medigap policy anymore. Here's David Lipschutz, associate director of the Center for Medicare Advocacy. DAVID LIPSCHUTZ: Medigap is one of the few types of insurance that can exclude you based upon preexisting conditions unless you enroll during certain designated times. TRIBBLE: That designated time is primarily when you first sign up for Medicare. But since Timmins enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan instead of traditional Medicare and he has a preexisting condition, he could be denied Medigap or charged a lot more for it. While federal law generally prohibits insurers from denying people coverage because of preexisting conditions, Medigap is an exception. Lipschutz again. LIPSCHUTZ: It's a lot easier to get and stay in a Medicare Advantage plan, but a lot harder to get out and pick up a Medigap plan, depending upon where you are. TRIBBLE: Only four states require Medigap insurers to cover applicants regardless of age or health. But Timmins lives in Washington state, which isn't one of them. He wants people to know. TIMMINS: You can get screwed if you're on Medicare Advantage. The advantage kind of disappears once you need them. TRIBBLE: In the meantime, Timmins worries. There's a chance that his cancer could come back, and he'll be trapped on Medicare Advantage if it does. So he's focusing on what he can control. TIMMINS: You know, I'm a vegetarian. I don't drink. I don't smoke. I try to get exercise as much as possible. TRIBBLE: But he knows it might not be enough. RASCOE: That was Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News. Copyright © 2024 NPR. All rights reserved. Visit our website terms of use and permissions pages at www.npr.org for further information."

— r/medicare · 35 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/192eueh/>

↳ (0): "I am so grateful that I happened to get an agent who explained that Medicare with a supplement was better in the long run than Advantage. I knew nothing at the time. I was really lucky."

↳ (0): "My husband became disabled. He worked for a fortune 100 company and had gold plated everything insurance including healthcare through CIGNA. Two years later when he went on Medicare, we picked an advantage plan by CIGNA. They were fantastic. It was seamless. Granted we are in a major city with amazing medical Everything. All his doctors, including an entire transplant team, and every specialist you can think of, Plus Oncology eventually, were available and we did not have any long waits for anything at all. I qualify this year for Medicare and hope there is a CIGNA advantage plan available."

↳ (0): "I think the rub is that you don't know what you'll need further down the line. Common illnesses are one thing. But there's a slew of less common ones and if you get one of those, there's a huge chance you'll be cut off from the doctors that treat them. I wish we had healthcare that was the same for everyone. The way it is now is inefficient and confusing for most."

"I am on an Advantage plan and have absolutely no problem with it."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz6F1eWCHc2CsWMD6t4AaABAg>

↳ @rorystorm4284 (18): "And you're probably pretty healthy. If you get sick and need expensive treatment, Advantage can deny you that treatment. You're taking a big risk."

↳ @Hello-i7m (2): "My terminally ill husband has the advantage plan and it's fabulous!! If your giant hospital monopoly is in the plan and most are it's fantastic!!"

↳ @RiannaStan11 (0): "@rorystorm4284 I'm on an Advantage plan, too. I have a chronic vascular condition that has nearly killed me twice now. Insurance didn't blink for the most expensive option treatments, nor at the ongoing expensive medications. I notice this year the specialist copays went up by \$10/visit. 😞 Also, my periodontist was surprised that my quarterly dental cleanings now have a copay, when in previous years, were just covered as a medical (not dental) expense. 😞 "

"More like Medicare-Disadvantage which is what I've called it for years. My mother-in-law got talked into it by her son in law who sells it. When she got very ill she couldn't go into a nursing home of her choosing and was put in the worst one ever where she passed away from neglect."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 25 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugyf0WuTqzGMI_wJRMZ4AaABAg

↳ @PhotonBeast (0): "Wow... I'm sorry for your loss and the circumstances around her passing really suck. I'm sorry she had to go like that. It shouldn't have been that way."

↳ @Jartran72 (0): "I am so sorry for your loss... Horrifying to hear that.."

"It doesn't have to be complicated. My pcp gives me all the referrals I need in the beginning of the year. All my doctors are in network my premium is \$0. I am keeping it simple. Love mecsre advantage. Everyone's experience is different"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugxl-L7ZgHXSdlqsyxd4AaABAg>

↳ @mapratt (5): "I'm sure it works great ... until you get really sick."

↳ @debbiemoore5945 (1): "Yup- but you have 7500 out of pocket!"

↳ @savannahsmiles1797 (1): "It can work if you have good medical coverage available in your county, unfortunately it isn't across the board the same for all."

"My elderly mom is covered by my late father's Advantage plan through Aetna and Express Scripts as part of his pension. I take her to doctor's visits and manage bills and her costs are not higher than when she was on regular Medicare. Obviously his pension happened to include great coverage and terms and perhaps is atypical. Her primary care doctor sends her to specialists of his choice and she's never been refused any specialist or treatment. To continue to be covered by his pension she had to switch to Medicare Advantage a year ago but it has been no problem."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=Ugzha45ykezoPOalOrp4AaABAg>

↳ @Nobody_Mr_47 (7): "@cherylstade3614 Please don't worry! She's in good hands with good coverage with a reputable carrier. There's nothing wrong with managed care and shared medical expenses. Just differences of opinion, that's all. Your mother won't lose her life savings, as ALL of these plans have an out of pocket maximum. I sell these plans and nearly all of my customers have no complaints and for many years."

↳ @fatimagross1956 (5): "The problem comes when ur diagnose with cancer. You have to pay that 20%co insurance for chemo/radiation and cancer medication, is when it can eat up all your life savings. Medicare Advantage is only good if you don't end up sick with major illnesses!"

↳ @cherylstade3614 (1): "@fatimagross1956 Dear me ! I will have to look into this!"

"I have a Medigap plan F that is community-rated and offers gym membership, 24-hour call a registered nurse service, and discounts on vision and hearing services. I am very happy with my plan and would never even consider changing to a Medicare (Dis)Advantage plan. I don't want a private insurance agency making health care decisions for me or restricting my access to a particular network of doctors. So many doctors and hospitals accept original Medicare without question and then, of course medigap pays its part. As far as medigap costing a little more, I think you have to ask yourself what your priorities are. My priority is "no hassles, no worries" health care. I am willing to drive an older car and make other sacrifices as necessary because my health comes first."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugwc4CVdNbp7cUz8Ox14AaABAg>

↳ @Dbb277-2 (3): "My F is costing \$300 a month. Ouch. I have no health issues."

↳ @kciis (1): "You are echoing my moms thoughts! 😊 - Ann"

↳ @4378200 (0): "@Dbb277-2 That's why I did not enroll...I would have given a company thousands to pay for my co-pays for the last 3 years. My MA has worked perfect for me"

"At 39:53, you say, "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, lean towards Medicare Advantage." I feel the unspoken part of that sentence should be: "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, *AND MUCH MORE LIKELY TO BE DENIED COVERAGE* lean towards Medicare Advantage." With Medigap, your doctor and Medicare determine what procedures you can get. With Medicare Advantage, the Corporate Healthcare Provider determines what procedures you can get. The Advantage Plan Provider's incentive is to maximize profits. How do they do that? Deny coverage for procedures that they don't want to pay for."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwU_3aKoZJXMaRelzl4AaABAg

"I spent three weeks in the hospital with nursing home offered afterwards I had another ct scan after I got home along with two MRIs. I have not been turned down for any procedures and I'm very happy with getting extra money for over the counter drugs, 48 one way transportation to and from medical appointments and hospitals, dental work, eye exams and glasses and even gym membership. My friend has Medicare w a supplement and doesn't get any of the above and pays co-pays. I also don't have co pays Needless to say, I'm very happy with Medicare Advantage Dual healthcare with United."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgyTKgkxTkTMhUiMNFN4AaABAg.9xlaj0ZoZYsA4ohb9f3HXt>

"I've had medicare advantage since I turned 65. I am now 70. I love my plan. I am on 5 different meds and I don't pay a penny. All my doctors accept my insurance. I am happy"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgzNyoIhFY-DlvfLTYN4AaABAg>

↳ @ngutz117 (6): "These two people obviously don't need all their money. I change Advantage plans to the one that is going to save me the most money , I'm not married to any doctor and I have always found good ones. 100 per month for groceries 110 per month for OTC plus 185 subtracted from my Medicare monthly cost, free dental and glasses. I'm sorry but I get great care and save thousands . In my area there are dozens of plans available , I'm on dialysis and it's the same facility with every plan. Plus no monthly premiums. So you can make your own choices but for me it's Medicare Advantage an it has been over 7 years..."

↳ @gin-i9i (4): "You're happy because you do NOT have a catastrophic illness. Repost when you need really expensive care (such as cancer) and are denied."

↳ @DeniseOsinski-pb4hn (3): "@gin-i9i Or their doctors/network are no longer covered.."

"I'm 78, I've always used a Medicare advantage, but I've changed companies many times. I've always been happy with advantage here in NM"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzklisMzHaqlttDEmmN4AaABAg>

↳ @TAM-bv2di (2): "Same in Oregon. Changed companies twice to stay with my primary care physician. Insurance companies are replaceable, good doctors, not so much. I've had referrals to excellent doctors from friends both in the Midwest and here in Oregon, and in all three cases, none of them accepted patients with traditional Medicare. Maybe that tells you something - if you're good, why accept less than you need to?"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "@TAM-bv2di Dream on... Advantage Plans are great for people who remain healthy and die in their sleep. Any deviation from that and you run the risk of inferior care at higher costs. And as taxpayers were paying double for Advantage customers and the Insurance carriers in turn make twice the profit vs a supp plan. Advantage carriers bill the US government over 2K per month per insured. They pocket anything thats not spent that month which is why they push these policies so hard and deny claims at much higher rates than supplemental plans."

"Love my advantage plan. Plans vary by area. So one size doesnt fit all.."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgzTjo-263OlqpgA5IF4AaABAg>

↳ @billwilliams774 (8): "Most Insurance is wonderful as long as you don't use it."

↳ @sueshannon4227 (7): "When hubby needed a hip replacement the scheduler said, "Oh, you have original Medicare, so we don't have to wait for pre-authorization. We can get you in at the next cancellation." And they did. A few weeks later the hip was replaced, otherwise it could have been a few months. We receive so many benefits with original Medicare. Having original Medicare makes us feel like we're getting VIP treatment. 😊 "

↳ @MedigapSeminars (2): "absolutely. It also seems that the further south you go, the better quality the Advantage plans"

"What you say may be true for some, but if you have a Kaiser HMO everything is different. I love Kaiser. I worked at Kaiser for years and I know it from the inside and out. When I hit 65 I opted for Kaiser's Medicare Senior Advantage. Nothing has changed for me except that I have more durable medical equipment options and things extended care and like that. My office visits cost \$5 instead of \$25. I did have to sign up for Plan B which I wouldn't have had to if I just continued Kaiser, but I could see that it could become a big cost saver down the road when I get really old. But who knows what the future will bring? That's the thing with any kind of insurance. It's a crapshoot. And let's face it, with medical care, the less you need it, the better. It's much better to pay into it not use it then not have it when you do need it. And my Kaiser Senior Advantage is always there if I need it, something that as I get older is going to become more important. A lot of people like to bash Kaiser, but it's the best HMO out there. I can tell you that if you need something, you will get it. For-profit insurance plans make money by doling expensive care. Kaiser is a not-for-profit and their goal is to keep you healthy so you don't need the expensive care down the road. But if you do, it is there. My husband needed a heart transplant. He checked into Stanford Hospital and was billed the Kaiser hospital admission co-pay of \$250. He walked out with no more charges. Zero. He had a heart transplant, something that cost anywhere from a \$half million to over \$1 million for \$250. And despite the huge cost of the immunosuppressive drugs, he has only a \$20 co-pay with no cap. Kaiser decided that there's no point in paying for a heart transplant if they won't pay for the drugs that you need to keep yourself alive. Most people can't afford a couple thousand dollars a month for medicines. So we're fans of Kaiser and I'm a fan of Senior Advantage. I kept my original benefits except that they've been expanded now."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyGOoPOpnz833X5Yo54AaABAq>

↳ @MedicareonVideo (5): "Yes - glad you're happy. Unfortunately the vast majority are on plans that don't function very well."

↳ @TrishBenedict (2): "@alysewitt3729 Are we talking Senior Advantage or Kaiser here? I'll just say that anyone can have a bad experience at any hospital with any health plan. It's always the luck of the draw. Because Kaiser is a good deal. You get a lot of value for your money. They don't ration or withhold care. Mistakes can happen and things can be missed. I'm glad you got your problem taken care of."

↳ @tinas4946 (2): "My dad was on that plan and had a lot of health issues. It was the worst plan for him. His out of pocket monthly drug cost was \$500 a month. A ER visit was \$75 per visit. He had 25 ER visits in one year. His doctors had no clue how to help him and instead wasted our time in the ER. He was in assisted living and per the CA law had to call an ambulance in certain situations. It drove me crazy. My take was if you are healthy you'll be fine if not it is harder. I had no idea there was original medicare."

"I have Medicare Advantage and I love it. I had it for ten years now and I did not have any major issues and did not pay more than few dollars at a time. I get free annual exam, and free vision and skin check. The doctors make me come in every few months for a blood check and it is free; I pay like \$20 copay for minor surgeries. This is the best insurance I ever had."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugx5jTx1F3z-R027ntB4AaABAg>

↳ @paul.rainwater (4): "What plan are you on why don't you name the company in the name of the plan so we can all look into it if it's so great?"

↳ @ronvandeusen6580 (3): "@paul.rainwater Naming the company probably won't help in your search, as plans can change by county and state. What someone else has may not work for you, in your area."

↳ @JanoMladonicky (0): "@paul.rainwater Certainly, here you go: Kelsey-Seybolt Clinic, it was a private hospital network in Houston until last year, then it was bought by UnitedHealthcare. Please let me know how it compares."

"Thank you!!! I am 64 and was totally confused on subsidies vs "enhanced" subsidies. I went on the exchange and it seemed like my plan was about the same cost and I couldn't figure out why. Now I know. Renewal done and Medicare coming next year. I can breathe now."

— YouTube · Retiring Before 65? This Is How People Actually Afford Health Insurance · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IsxxWGpc_fE&lc=Ugykvn81-KPpePXT1od4AaABAg

Peace of mind: nothing to worry about · 190 documents · 20 voices

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

↳ @CB-vg1wq (17): "@miriamlandau1207 You pay into both. On a W-2 social security withhold is in box 4. Medicare tax is Box 5."

↳ @ighdesigns (14): "The insurance companies are always just trying to outlast the patients."

↳ @miriamlandau1207 (3): "You are paying into Social Security not into Medicare."

"Glad I did my homework and chose traditional Medicare over Medicare Advantage. I read too many horror stories about people who became catastrophically ill, and had problems seeing specialists, or obtaining certain treatments. I would rather pay for the "peace of mind," and the CHOICE to go where I want, and see the doctor or specialist I need/want."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 264 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbjQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq>

↳ @DankFarrikMe (10): "@LisaKnobel Medicare covers most everything, so unless you have a rare never heard of disease that has holistic/experimental treatment...Medicare/Medigap will cover it."

↳ @aregee7121 (10): "It's way more than just choice or peace of mind. Advantage plans, all insurance co. based, are more like socialized medicine, i.e. less spending per patient. You get restrictive networks, forced diagnosis first with G.P. or P.A! with delayed referral to a specialist, possibly not the one you want. The end result is a delay of the proper treatment. Do you want this as you get older?"

↳ @maryequilter31 (7): "The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

"Retirement and Dealing with Cancer Costs It is not a pleasant subject, but it is important to talk about it. According to WebMD, 30% of seniors aged 65-74, 19% of 75-84, and 8% over 85 get cancer. Within the last 2.5 years, I've had three different cancers, and I retired at the same time. It can be expensive. I thought I would share my experience dealing with the costs. The three cancers I've had to contend with are Mantle Cell Lymphoma (blood cancer), Squamous Cell Carcinoma (skin cancer), and prostate cancer. Mantle Cell Lymphoma is incurable. In my case, my oncologist advised me to delay treatment as long as possible since it always comes back and is harder to treat each subsequent relapse. I was on a "Wait and Watch" monitoring program for over two years with blood tests every 3-months and a scan every 6-months. The monitoring showed it had progressed and required treatment, which I started earlier this month. I'll have 6-months of chemotherapy / immunotherapy followed by 2-years of less intensive "maintenance" therapy. Over the last couple of years, in addition to the chemo treatment, I've had numerous blood tests, PET scans, CT scans, biopsies, and doctor appointments. For the skin cancer, I had a blob of Squamous Cell Carcinoma cut off my face using the "Mohs" procedure, and another much smaller spot shaved off the tip of my nose. I've had multiple visits with the surgeon and other specialists, and I will require skin checks every 6-months because of all of the per-cancerous lesions that keep popping up. The prostate cancer was detected during a PET scan for the lymphoma. However, after a follow-up MRI and biopsy (lot of fun), it was determined that I have the least aggressive form of prostate cancer which does not need immediate treatment and can be managed with "Active Surveillance". I am told it is slow growing and I have about a 50% chance of needing treatment in the next 10 years. I will be monitored with blood tests, MRI scans, and possibly additional biopsies in the years to come. As you can imagine, all of these tests, procedures, and treatments are very expensive. I had always planned on retiring the day I turned 65. However, I was diagnosed with the lymphoma when I was 64 and I decided to work an extra 10 months after I turned 65 (until the end of the year) because: 1) I had already met the out-of-pocket maximum for the year for my work health insurance; 2) my job was very supportive and allowed me to take time off as needed; and 3) my wife would be in a better position financially if things didn't go well for me. I had plenty of time to learn about Medicare, which I started in January 2024 when I officially retired. There are two ways to get Medicare: Original Medicare or a Part C Advantage Plan. With Original Medicare, you really need to also have a Medigap Supplemental Plan and a Part D prescription drug plan. There are several options for a Supplemental Plan. I chose Plan G, which covers everything except an annual deductible. For 2025, the annual deductible was only \$257, which I probably hit within the first 15-minutes of my first appointment in January. Everything else is free for the rest of the year. I should point out that, if I had been on my work group health insurance plan, I would have incurred several thousands of dollars of costs each year until I hit my out-of-pocket maximum. Compared to an Advantage Plan. the premiums are higher with Original Medicare and a Supplemental Plan G, but you don't have any restrictions of which doctors are in your network, and you don't have to worry about insurance company pre-approval. In addition to lower premiums, Advantage plans also include perks such as dental, vision, and maybe even a gym membership. Many people are very happy with their Advantage plan, and may save money with the lower premiums. However, based on my experience, I think Original Medicare with a Supplemental Plan G is preferred if you have a serious illness such as cancer, and you can afford the higher premiums. I pay \$185 for Medicare Part B, \$209 for my Supplemental Plan G, and \$17.50 for my Part D prescription plan. Dental and vision I pay out of pocket. The main benefit of Original Medicare with a Supplemental plan is I've never had to worry about insurance company pre-approvals, or whether my doctor accepted it. In general, I think it is wise to get the best insurance that you can afford."

— r/retirement · 161 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1liorqh/>

↳ (0): "Plan N offers the same coverage as plan G except excess charges (which aren't allowed in my state anyway) and there is a \$20 co-pay for an office visit and \$50 co-pay for an emergency room visit. The savings with N will cover over 20 co-pays per year based on the rates I was quoted. It is also expected that premium

increases with N will be less than G since plan G is the guaranteed issue plan."

↳ (0): "Good point. Even with all of my appointments, I don't think I ever went over 20 in a single year. If I did, it wasn't by much. Plan N is a good option for those just starting Medicare. Unfortunately, I'm in Massachusetts and this plan is not available."

↳ (0): "Agree whole heartedly on the Medicare supplement plan. My husband is currently undergoing cancer treatment at MD Anderson. He has tonsil cancer, which is an uncommon type of cancer. We came to Houston from Oregon because MD Anderson is an NCI cancer center that treats thousands more cases of tonsil cancer than the one NCI hospital we have in Oregon. We wouldn't have been able to do that with an Advantage plan. It may be that our local hospital would have been fine managing his care, but we're much more confident in the care plan and speed of treatment he's been getting at MD Anderson."

"Back in the 80s medical insurance was simple. I had blue cross that the company gave as a benefit. If I went to the Dr, dentist or eye doctor, I never paid for anything and didn't get any paperwork from the Dr or insurance company. Now, I get bills from Dr and the insurance company sends me something at least 3 times per week (I called them to get them to stop sending me the useless information). And my eyes and teeth are part of my body and it SHOULD BE COVERED BY MEDICARE ! "

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙄 · 105 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxHVeIY2LS72yYatvJ4AaABAg>

↳ @StarkeyatRingo (12): "isn't it funny THAT SICKNESS rose with the MANDATORY INSURANCE??? AS IF we couldn't have one without the other - and the PRICES ALL GOT OUT OF WHACK WHEN SICKNESS BECAME BUSINESS"

↳ @johnsonpaul1914 (4): "It was never simple for me. I was self employed for most of my life and rarely had any health ins, but we got by. Have had medicare now for 12 years and covered that with a medicare advantage no premium policy. Quite satisfied with that. But I am now very disillusioned with health care. It is more sick care and very little about actual health"

↳ @portrait1001 (3): "@iamanovercomer3253 the biggest problem was losing a job , for whatever reason and having a child or spouse that had a preexisting condition. Your life would of been consumed with medical bills then"

"You also have to ask yourself " How much does peace of mind mean to me?" For me, it means a great deal. For that reason...and all the points Keith made, I choose original Medicare and Plan G and a drug plan. Thanks, Keith. Awesome explanation."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 103 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxmsAjt88MzwvJ_Zop4AaABAg

↳ @Ron4885 (5): "Couldn't agree more. (I picked Plan N) :)"

↳ @local_treasures815 (0): "How much does that cost you?"

↳ @darlahouston4670 (0): "@local_treasures815 I'd like to know as well."

"Maybe a better title for this video would be "When I Wouldn't Chose Medigap Plan G verses Plan N". I have Plan G and it was \$25 more in premium than Plan N, but I knew with my upcoming health issues I would be seeing many specialists and more often. I went with peace of mind decision."

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 81 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgyZe4YXRtM8AXD_AI4AaABAq

↳ @MedicareonVideo (9): "If you are going to meet that difference in premium paying copayments, it is a great option to go Plan G"

↳ @Cynster777 (2): "Keith I need your help. Who has the best price for Medigap N at this time. My husband has had it for 8 years and they just raised it again \$35.00 more per month. Please let me know where to go to get a lower premium for Medigap N."

↳ @Cynster777 (0): "@B@BarryWeaver-pv6cz. I did. They are all expensive."

"I like traditional medicare and medigap. After my initial \$300 deductible, I can see any doctor and never have to worry about paying a bill. If I have something that bothers me, I never have to think if its worth seeing a doctor, I just go."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 72 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugy8-mL2CmVrjVCpPzl4AaABAq>

↳ @golffanatic1102 (7): "@roncollins1046 🙄🙄 Yep, found the MAGA troll."

↳ @roncollins1046 (5): "Sorry to hear about your doctor-addiction. I haven't seen one of those quacks in years, and mean never to again. They literally make people sick, that's their business model."

↳ @tedlahm5740 (3): "could not be better."

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAq>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"So glad we were advised to take a supplement plan when we started Medicare. A few years later my spouse was diagnosed with cancer and was able to go to a hospital that specialized in that one. We never had to worry about being in plan or getting approvals. Paying more upfront meant we had no bills through the years of treatment. I continue using my supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 61 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwhJu-QYROdQEUKL_h4AaABAq

↳ @jimarnold7561 (3): "Can't speak of other advantage plans but I couldn't be happier with my Kaiser senior advantage plan. Low cost, good doctors, modern hospitals, etc."

↳ @txladywolf01 (1): "Same here. Straight Medicare and Medigap plan N...no issues and I travel USA"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (0): "@jimarnold7561 Dream on Jim. The data doesnt support your statement. When you need it most you will discover the mistake you made."

"I've had a Medicare plan and a Medicare supplement plan for about 8 years. And the supplement plan pays whatever Medicare doesn't. Minus whatever deductible you choose. Monthly premium has gone up over the years. In some years I may have paid more for the plan than I got in services, but there have been years when it's literally saved me thousands of dollars. So over the time frame I've had it. It's definitely paid for itself not only financially but in not having to worry about having a procedure done. And not needing a pre-authorization. If my doctor says go I go I can go to any doctor. I want anywhere in the nation. Medicare advantage plans are basically private insurance. High deductibles, high rejection of coverage. Pre-qualifications. Looks cheaper on the front end but you're going to lose on the back end. So listen to this man"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 60 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=Ugxfb9YPgrZZhd4mdaR4AaABAg>

↳ @samuelbutterworth4303 (10): "NEVER take advice from someone that makes money from the choices they recommend, like this guy. I have a degree in Economics specializing in social insurance, and an MBA. I've had Supplemental and Advantage insurance plans. I prefer Advantage plans in my area. Zero premium, zero cost family doctor, every medical profession in my city are in network, I've never had any surgery or treatment turned down, my medications are all free except for one high cost brand and that costs me \$45 per month, free dental care, free eye exams and glasses, free hearing and discounted hearing aids. They have a national network of doctors."

↳ @patriciayohn6136 (7): "Absolutely agree with you and my Husband and I did the same thing and not sorry, we went with Supplement G plan. I had to have an emergency major surgery three years ago, spent seven days in hospital and I only had to cover about \$200.00 dollars!!!"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (3): "Don't forget the bigger concern with chronic conditions and surgical needs. Quality of care. This is overlooked by almost everyone that signs up for Advantage Plans. They love the cost vs a supp plan until they need care. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these Advantage Plans."

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>;
— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/>

↳ (0): "In terms of coverage, traditional Medicare and a supplement is going to offer more choices and flexibility than a Medicare Advantage plan. Whether or not it's affordable for everyone is another story. The unfortunate truth is that more and more of our senior population is living on poverty wages and simply can't afford a Medicare supplement. Also, most retirees have been covered by managed care plans for a good portion of their working careers, so dealing with provider networks and utilization management is not a novel concept. With annual max of pocket costs under \$4000 for PPOs in my area, many of these individuals are choosing a zero premium MAPD option and paying for the care they use as they use it. Are MAPDs right for everyone? Of course not. But, the market has spoken on Medicare Advantage plans. More than half of the 65 million Americans on Medicare are currently enrolled in Medicare Advantage plans. They aren't going anywhere. It's important to discuss the potential risks of MAPDs, but it's not inherently the wrong choice. **Edited for auto cor-wrecks"

↳ (0): "I get several calls a day from foreign call centers regarding Medicare. They are frequently aggressive and sometimes vulgar. My latest weapon - your insurance license number... I ask: if you sell Medicare related products in my state you must be licensed, what is your number? The next sound is a click."

↳ (0): "This is correct!!! OP is very uneducated in Medicare... clearly!!!! and can be proven by going to Medicare.gov!!!! I hope this post was satire. But please y'all do not listen this this is not correct."

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1iten4m/>

↳ (0): "I have also found the Medicare experience like a breath of fresh air. It is so nice not having to worry about it."

↳ (0): "I feel the same way. I am a somewhat insecure person (lol), and probably some of my fears of not having health insurance go back to growing up and watching my father lose his job at 58 years old. He worked for his company for over 35 years and they cut him loose when his health began deteriorating. (He was a commercial artist and his hand wore out from repetitive stress injury. I remember his fear that he would lose the house and everything else.) Plus, a few surgeries that I had and the astronomical bills didn't help to put my mind to rest regarding the loss of insurance. Plus, my employer was not hesitant in eliminating people/departments at a moments notice. In short, Medicare has given me great peace of mind. It's not perfect and I know others may have completely opposite opinions, but I am so grateful to have it, I've seen what happens when you don't. Take care. :)"

↳ (0): "Thanks, OP. My spouse is turning 65 in April, and we really need to get on this. You mentioned YouTube videos. Do you have any particular channel that you found most helpful?"

"YouTube algorithm showed me your video. Best explanation I have EVER seen (and no, I am not 'blind as a bat!') on this topic. So I have liked and subscribed. When I turned 65, I chose a Supplemental Plan G at the beginning as it did provide me with the peace of mind that are covered in the last three categories. I have also been one to try to persuade people away from Advantage plans because of some of the uncertainty you reference. However, rather than doing that going forward, I think I would be better to just share your video and channel with them. EXCELLENT! Thank You!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwliC-CtrJLNTVU49I4AaABAg>

"I live in Queens NYC. My UHC advantage plan is being discontinued for the second year in a row. I'm looking into supplements plans for peace of mind. I'm 76 years old and in good health. It's really stressful to have to do this every year. In addition I have a 97 year old mother who is in the same situation and I have to help her with choosing a plan also. These videos are very helpful. Thank you."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwNrKv-eoUWgAMGFzF4AaABAg>

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (0): "Good luck switching to supplement plans, your health better be good or you are never switching"

"I like/need Plan G. It gives me a peace of mind."

— YouTube · Don't Buy Medigap Plan G Before Watching This ! · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tughWPQP08&lc=UgxG30kbKTqmFwajjF14AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (9): "I purchased a Plan G for the same reason."

"I'm so sorry to hear about your husband's diagnosis. I'm glad Plan G has given you both peace of mind—that's exactly what a good supplement is meant to do, so you don't have to worry about bills on top of everything else. Wishing you and your husband strength and comfort during this time."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 27 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwgXbzqmZRcY_3kYNV4AaABAg.ANkFJcLXDfBANKOQb7mq_f

"Turquoise!!! Your vids are awesome. I just turned 65; my role as a fed contractor is ending May 31 (role being eliminated). Surprise! I was planning on retiring end of this year, but things happen. So although I went on Part A this March, I just signed up for Part B and an N plan effective June 1. I could NOT have done this confidently without your channel/content. Even if my company offers me a new FT role on a different contract (highly likely), I think I am going to turn them down and see if they have any PT or contract gigs I can do that will keep me below the SS max income levels. I am blessed to have healthy SS income and can live off that and short-term savings for the rest of this year - probably even longer - and not touch a dime of my retirement yet. NO worries - I will like and stay subscribed forever - the algorithm is with you!"

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 24 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgyfTu5GD_kHcqEsZ3p4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (3): "Appreciate you so much 🙏 So glad to know we have been helpful and thank you for sharing your experience! 💎 - closest to turquoise I could find 😊 "

"I have a Medigap plan F that is community-rated and offers gym membership, 24-hour call a registered nurse service, and discounts on vision and hearing services. I am very happy with my plan and would never even consider changing to a Medicare (Dis)Advantage plan. I don't want a private insurance agency making health care decisions for me or restricting my access to a particular network of doctors. So many doctors and hospitals accept original Medicare without question and then, of course medigap pays its part. As far as medigap costing a little more, I think you have to ask yourself what your priorities are. My priority is "no hassles, no worries" health care. I am willing to drive an older car and make other sacrifices as necessary because my health comes first."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugwc4CVdNbp7cUz8Ox14AaABAg>

↳ @Dbb277-2 (3): "My F is costing \$300 a month. Ouch. I have no health issues."

↳ @kciis (1): "You are echoing my moms thoughts! 😊 - Ann"

↳ @4378200 (0): "@Dbb277-2 That's why I did not enroll...I would have given a company thousands to pay for my co-pays for the last 3 years. My MA has worked perfect for me"

"I have the Cadillac plan G and have been grateful for the savings in costs for procedures or ER visits. My husbands cataract surgery was almost completely covered. We don't appreciate the increases in premiums, but the peace of mind for limiting unexpected medical bills is worth it for us."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 20 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=Ugyb_OJ-wFwMp0NIItKF4AaABAg

"I remember at age 19 driving by the Social Security Office seeing an elderly person going in the building. I smiled and thought "It will be a long time before I have to do that" Fast forward almost 47 years later and I am not smiling anymore. Still working because I want to, not collecting Social Security yet, and started in the company's 401k plan at age 21 because my manager sat me down and talked me into it. That was 1980. He is retired now, but everyday at some point during the day I thank him for it. None of us think about Medicare when we are 19 years old. In all honesty I always thought at 65 we all just went on the same insurance, but it doesn't work like that. Not sure why, just seems like there should be one policy that has it all and we pay the same amount. Ya'll had a similar video like this one a year or so ago and I remember weighing both sides and my thoughts on it. I am half like Ann's mom and half like Kai's mom so it made it harder for me to decide. My thought process was that I felt like my whole life while working I have had an Advantage plan. Never had any major health issues. Pros and Cons on both sides. For me it basically comes down to the Peace of Mind with a Medigap plan. I will be paying as I go so if something major happens there is little out of pocket. It's like having home owners insurance. I don't need it as I have no mortgage but I have it just in case something happens. I don't need a Medigap plan because I am healthy but we all are healthy until we are not. So if something happens I have it covered. Then I am hearing some companies with Advantage plans are pulling out of areas that are not profitable. When I was younger I always thought things would get easier as we aged. I think it was because my grandparents always talked about the golden years. But the reality is there is nothing golden about growing old. Great Video. "The Cajun Ninja's Dad""

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap | Your TRUE Cost · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cganxQ&lc=Ugy4gdYNPKoHbdtrxA14AaABAg>

↳ @kciis (1): "It's interesting how our perspectives change over the years! Planning for the future is definitely important, and it's great to hear you made wise choices early on and took the good advice from others. Thanks for sharing your thoughts, very much appreciated 😊 "

↳ @nevergoquietly-v4y (1): "We have a new administration that can't wait to cut social security and raise the age to start collecting social security from 62, to 70. Good luck! 🙄😂😂😂😂 " "

Money saved, in their numbers · 175 documents · 20 voices

"I came off a supplement to an advantage plan about 5 years ago for two reasons affordability and our good health. We enrolled into a HMO-POS plan for 2026. Of course before the switch we verified all of our providers were still in the plan. Zero premium and \$4800.00 MOP. Which is thousands less than the previous plan. I've saved in premiums over the 5 years over 18K. And wer still healthy."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 888 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgyH9WWhhAjCLi7lrkMt4AaABAq>.

↳ @Johnsonadam_6652 (1): "Exactly.It's a calculated risk. I did the same, but a major health event last year showed me the holes in my "cheap" plan. The out-of-pocket max became a real number fast. That \$18k in savings vanished in medical bills."

↳ @AmirKazan-n2l (1): "What professional looks at healthcare and investments together?Most treat them separately."

↳ @ReeceCook-r7o (0): "Smart move saving on premiums.That \$18k can compound. The risk is the plan's network stability. A provider leaving or a new diagnosis can change the math overnight. You're betting on continued health."

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now

ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

"Wellcare wanted \$110 for one generic prescription — Cost Plus Drugs was \$16.85 delivered I wanted to share this because Medicare drug pricing has gotten ridiculous enough that it really pays to check cash prices instead of automatically using your Part D insurance. I have Wellcare for my Medicare prescription coverage. My PCP recently sent in a 90-day prescription for generic aripiprazole (Abilify), 2 mg tablets. My copay through Wellcare was going to be **\$110**. I checked Mark Cuban Cost Plus Drug Company instead. Their price for the same 90-day prescription was: * Medication: **\$10.90** * Shipping: **\$5.95** * Total: **\$16.85** So I saved about **\$93** by simply not using my Medicare drug insurance. This isn't the first time I've run into this. Wellcare also recently dropped the main pharmacy in my town as a **preferred pharmacy**, which makes things even more inconvenient. I had another experience at Safeway where I was picking up **two generic medications**. Using my Wellcare insurance, Safeway wanted about **\$75**. The pharmacy employee checked another option, bypassed my insurance, and used a prescription discount code instead. The price dropped to **\$23**. That really opened my eyes. We're told Medicare Part D is supposed to help lower prescription costs, but in some cases I'm finding that the cash price or a discount program is dramatically cheaper than using the insurance I'm already paying for. My takeaway is simple: **Before paying your Medicare prescription copay, ask the pharmacy what the cash price is and check places like Cost Plus Drugs or prescription discount programs.** Especially with generics, the difference can apparently be huge. I'm not saying Wellcare is always more expensive, and obviously everyone's plan and medications are different. But after seeing \$110 become \$16.85, and \$75 become \$23, I'm going to compare prices every time from now on. Hopefully this saves somebody else a few bucks — or in my case, nearly a hundred."

— r/medicare · 129 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1w5n6j8/>

↳ (0): "Yes, many times other avenues can be cheaper than what the insurance price is. Be aware that any cost paid through other avenues do not count toward the plan deductible, and do not count toward the annual \$2,100 cap."

↳ (0): "I think this is the explanation. <https://www.drugpatentwatch.com/blog/the-pbm-endgame-what-mark-cuban-got-right-and-pharma-is-still-ignoring/> >Mark Cuban launched Cost Plus Drugs in January 2022 with a simple premise: buy generic drugs at manufacturer cost, add a fixed 15% markup, charge a \$3 dispensing fee, and sell directly to patients. The prices were so low they shocked people. Imatinib, a generic cancer drug, went from \$9,657 per month at many retail pharmacies to \$47 at Cost Plus. Clonazepam, a common seizure and anxiety drug, dropped to pennies per pill. Cuban had not invented a new drug. He had not built a better supply chain. *He had simply cut out the pharmacy benefit manager*. This PBM business probably has something to do with high prices. Maybe we all need PBM-free prescriptions."

↳ (0): "Yep, in fact check around at the WellCare in network non preferred pharmacies too. I found that a script priced at \$140 at a WellCare preferred pharmacy was actually the same lower price as Costplus at a WellCare in network non preferred pharmacy."

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

↳ @policyguides (19): "Thanks for sharing your experience. You're not alone — I've seen a lot of people face those same big increases on Plan G. Plan N usually ends up being the smarter long-term choice because of the lower premiums, and for most people the extra cost-sharing is pretty minimal compared to what they save each year. With how fast rates are climbing, especially going into 2026, your switch makes a lot of sense."

↳ @christinestephenson1742 (11): "I have Mutual of Omaha supplement since 2019. It's maybe 130 a month and has just gone up a bit each year."

↳ @jayes8191 (6): "@policyguides Could Plan N's extra cost sharing increase significantly if Medicare reimbursements decrease in 2026?"

"My Medigap High-Deductible Plan G Analysis *[Edit: The official 2026 HD deductible is* **\$2,950. That's a 2.8% annual increase, which seems pretty much in line with inflation.]*** In case this is useful to others... I ran the numbers on switching to Medigap High-Deductible G (HD-G) for 2026, assuming the HD-G deductible will increase to \$3,000. The numbers would vary by age and ZIP code, but here's a way to run the math: 1. Premiums for my available Plans * **Plan G: \$250/month * HD-G: \$50/month** 2. Maximum Savings (Best Case Scenario) **If I have a healthy year and don't need care beyond what Medicare Part B already covers at no cost: * Plan G annual premium: $250 \times 12 = \$3,000$ * HD-G annual premium: $50 \times 12 = \$600$ * Savings = \$2,400/year** This is my "very healthy year" scenario. 3. Maximum Extra Cost (Worst Case Scenario) **If I have a major medical year and hit the full HD-G deductible: * Out-of-pocket under HD-G = \$3,000 * Minus the \$2,400 in premium savings * Net worst-case cost = \$600 more than if I'd had Plan G** So the most I can lose relative to Plan G is \$600/year. 4. Net Risk This is what makes HD-G attractive to me: *** One healthy year (+\$2,400) * Pays for up to four worst-case years (-\$600 each)** I obviously can't predict my future medical needs, but on average my net cost will fall somewhere between +\$2,400 and -\$600. With two people in our household: *** Max savings: \$4,800/year * Max risk: \$1,200/year** The odds of both of us consistently having worst-case years feels pretty low, so that's a very asymmetric risk profile where the upside heavily outweighs the downside. 5. How HD-G actually works **Many people misunderstand how the HD-G deductible actually works: * After you meet the Part B deductible, Medicare starts paying 80%, just like it normally does. * Because you're only paying 20%, you don't actually hit the HD deductible until and unless you require roughly \$13,000 in total Medicare-approved charges for your annual medical care. One way to look at it: * The HD-G "deductible" is actually a maximum out-of-pocket (MOOP) for Part A + B services. Another way to look at it: * HD-G = You have Original Medicare (A + B) and your premium buys you a \$3,000 MOOP * Plan G = Same coverage but your higher premium buys you a lower MOOP, equal to the Part B deductible (There is no official MOOP for Plan N because you can't accurately predict copays, but it's probably not a big issue for most.)** 6. Bottom Line** For me — with a \$200/month premium difference — HD-G is a no-brainer." — r/medicare · 87 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1owx5kn/>

↳ (0): "Yeah, this is an excellent analysis. I came to the same conclusion but didn't go through as much mathematics. The bit of cash saved monthly could also possibly be invested. Anyway you slice it, GHD is also better than any employer plan I've had"

↳ (0): "Because you're only paying 20%, you don't actually hit the HD deductible until and unless you require roughly \$13,000 in total Medicare-approved charges for your annual medical care." The other thing to emphasize here is that \$13k is Medicare approved charges. I had a procedure recently that was billed at \$1124. But the Medicare approved amount was \$43. Some eye tests by a specialist? Billed at \$763 but Medicare rate? \$197. The point is that \$13,000 in Medicare approved charges is a LOT of care"

↳ (0): "Plus when you pay for services (doctors etc) as part of your deductible, you can pay with your HSA account if you have one. The G plan with no deductible at \$250 per month cant be paid with an HSA. Only medical services, not insurance premiums."

"At the time I was preparing to retire at age 66, I became ill with covid. I was still covered by my employer insurance. When I returned to work after covid, I became ill again. Due to being off so long my insurance lapsed. I officially retired and signed up for SSI and Medicare plan B. I had signed up for plan A as soon as it was available at age 65. The second illness was kidney cancer that was discovered while I was in my open enrollment period. I quickly selected a Supplemental plan, and was I ever happy! It covered everything including an additional year of follow up immunotherapy with Katruda. I saved thousands of dollars every 90 days of follow up therapy! My Supplemental plan cost me about \$95 a month! So don't gamble with your health or finances!"

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 64 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgykxBns009Os0UTIEp4AaABAg>

↳ @sbee985 (7): "Wow! Someone upstairs was watching over for you! Glad you are doing well!"

↳ @kellegraff6626 (4): "I had moved from another state and develop some serious health problems after a lifetime a perfect health. When I signed up for Medicare I was not aware that I had to get medigap within the first 6 months. Needless to say, every year when I try to sign up for medigap, I am denied or will pay an outrageous monthly bill. If a person has had a heart stent within the last year, they are automatically denied. It needs to be very clear that a medigap program is absolutely needed, even if you don't completely need it. When you decide that you do, you are made to pay for pre-existing conditions or denied."

↳ @dewboy910 (3): "Jesus Christ! My mom is paying \$342 per month for B plus \$102 for part D! I have to admit that they have covered pretty much everything since I've been responsible for her, but I often wonder whether or not she needs so much insurance. She has the highest standard coverage available (not catastrophic). Too bad she doesn't have catastrophic insurance because has has dementia."

"I guess Part D is a good thing for people on costly drugs. Before I was 65, I could get my generic prescriptions for \$10 for an 90 day supply with a GoodRx coupon. On Part D, 2 have a zero copay, one has a \$9 co-pay. I laugh every time I get that notice about how Medicare is "saving" me \$57...because I used to pay only \$10. Now I get to pay the part D premium which is 10 times what I used to pay for all my drugs combined."

— YouTube · The \$9.8 Billion Medicare Subsidy Just Ended — Here's What Really Happens to Part D · 47 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pfLylplem30&lc=UgzR-4WgnmzhcrDR4mV4AaABAg>

↳ @jasonjames4254 (20): "The true crime being committed in all of this is that everybody pays a different price for the same damn thing!"

↳ @jamesallen8107 (6): "@duanehorton4680 I like proper spelling and grammar as much as anyone, but commenting about a missing hyphen is important because ... and it adds value to the comments, due to ... the readers will not understand what was communicated without the hyphen? Should have been "a" rather than "an" as well, correct?"

↳ @duanehorton4680 (0): "90-day should be hyphenated."

"I am considering Medigap in lieu of Advantage. An in-depth analysis says that will cost me \$1,000 per year. But. If I look at OuT of Pocket and assume I have a serious health issue then Medigap makes more sense. Over a 10 year span if I get seriously sick my maximum exposure is \$45,000 less for medigap for a net \$5100 increased cost of Medigap premiums over ten years"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Vs. Medicare Supplement - An Unbiased Comparison · 37 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EXNLA6j2x0M&lc=Ugz_k049FgFb_I9Lqad4AaABAq

↳ @ChloeMitchell-j3u4h (0): "Don't forget about travel. With a Medigap plan, you can see any doctor in the U.S. that accepts Medicare. If you travel a lot or live in multiple states, that's a huge benefit you don't get with most Medicare Advantage plans"

↳ @George-s6w4x (0): "but how are you supposed to project your future health costs? I'm healthy now at 67, but what if that changes? A Medicare Advantage plan has a yearly out-of-pocket max, but a Medigap plan has a higher monthly premium. I'm paralyzed trying to do this math with my \$75k fixed income."

↳ @HenryColyn (0): "I was in the same spot. I was so overwhelmed by the long-term risk of choosing wrong. A family friend finally convinced me to get a Pro Advisor we found on the web. Norman Barry Berman. He helped me model the lifetime costs based on my health history. It gave me a clear path forward."

"This is, hands down, the best video I have ever seen about Medicare insurance plans!! Fantastic job, and thank you! And I hope you recover quickly from your sunburn! BUT... I want to introduce a dimension that I was surprised you did not mention! That is, taking care of yourself! By that, I mean taking nutrition seriously for decades, maintaining an ideal weight, and working out regularly at a gym in old age so you never neglect your body's conditioning!! Now in our mid 70s, my wife and I have been "nutritarian" for 15 years. Nutritarian is a diet developed by Dr. Joel Fuhrman based on a 100% plant-based diet, only far more emphasis on nutrient-density at every meal. No added sugar, no animal products, no dairy, no alcohol, no bread, no added oil, no added salt. Just whatever comes naturally in the fruit, vegetables, nuts, grains, mushrooms, seeds, and sprouts (microgreens) that we eat at every meal. We go to our gym for a vigorous 60 to 80 minute resistance workout every 3 days (plus a 60-minute treadmill cardio workout on some off-days). We maintain ideal weight, take no medications, and my local doctor told me that I have the blood pressure of a healthy 18-year-old. MY POINT is that your own discipline over your peak nutrition and physical conditioning will have an enormous impact over your long-term health! We have a guy at our gym at age 95 still working out!! As Dr. Fuhrman says: "Your genes load the gun. But your diet and lifestyle pull the trigger!" As part of our Advantage plan, our gym enrollment is covered. That is \$100 a month savings for both my wife and myself. We do have a local insurance agent, but if we did not I would reach out to this agent with The Retirement Nerds! What an excellent explanation of all the insurance options! So, don't eat junk! Don't sit around in an easy chair drinking beer! Make peak nutrition your most serious hobby. Grow your own sprouts and microgreens like I do. Don't eat canned beans - instead eat beans you cook yourself from dry beans. We eat 18 kinds of beans I cook weekly in a pressure cooker. I plan to make it to 100+ unless I get hit by a truck! (And if that happens, insurance won't matter.) Best wishes!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzq9b4ySEEjBX1HcUh4AaABAg>

↳ @norsemythos1438 (4): "Interesting story. I tend to agree with the concept...but in practice... eating only rabbit food and living to 100? I wonder if im better off enjoying the simple things and dying at 88."

↳ @flyshacker (3): "@norsemythos1438 Your choice! Remember, nearly all the things people call "old age" are really just neglect. Get your cremation and other final expenses paid for, and you're all set! I'll keep exercising, living longer, and I'll collect the gov't benefits you would have received. Fine with me!"

↳ @frankhodge7654 (1): "@flyshacker No matter what you eat, old age effects are very real. We were born with a guarantee of death. No one can live forever except in fantasies. We don't usually know our end date, but we all have one. Rabbit food for life is not a very enjoyable option."

"I went with the HDG plan, my agent who is a friend wasn't offering it but agreed it was the best fit for my wife and I and he contacted the insurer and handled it for us. We are 3 years in without any health issues and have saved about 6K in G premiums so moving forward we could have several years with large medical expenses and still be ahead of the game."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=Ugzs_Ta08W530jcH1VI4AaABAg

↳ @billjones4986 (5): "As a senior your in good health until your not, things could change quickly."

↳ @bugsy2902 (1): "@billjones4986 Looking at the increase of premiums of G or N over the years and being trapped by medical underwriting this seems the only solution for many seniors on a fixed income. I know that I can't pay hundreds of dollars a month for a medigap plan plus another couple hundred for Medicare plus potentially 2K plus Part D drugs on a fixed income. And I don't want to be in a Disadvantage plan with MOOP of \$9K while they delay and deny care! I was so looking forward to Medicare and not having to fight for care till I saw how outrageously expensive it is. How many times I've had to fight calling the state Ins Commissioner and Dept of Labor to get my bills paid even HR! And I know many others don't bother and just pay what they shouldn't have to or let it go to collections because of the corrupt insurance mafia in America! I'm on Obamacare and had my first preventative colonoscopy 100% free but Anthem tried to stick me with \$6K from the hospital! After a month of fighting to finally get a resolution billing rep in US she finally fixes the hospital bill but tries to leave me to pay \$2k out of network anesthesia bill! She only fixed it when I threatened to file a complaint with Senator Tammy Baldwin and also the No Surprises Website! I never expected to have to fight like that for what is federal mandated as FREE!"

↳ @paulmarc-aurele5508 (0): "@billjones4986 I you are certainly right but with HDG your maximum deductible would be \$2400 more than a G plan other than that the same.. in our first 3 trouble free years we have save about 7K in premiums."

"Thanks for the video Erik. I've been on Plan N for almost 2 1/2 years. I like the lower monthly premium compared to Plan G (in Texas where I live it's about \$30/month less). So that's about \$360/year savings. For the copays, after the \$283 deductible, my co-pays have ranged from \$0 to the max of \$20 during those 2 1/2 years. (Most times it's in between \$0 and \$20. I had an \$11 one and a \$16 one.). I also always check that any doctor accepts Medicare assignment on the Medicare website before I see them and I've never come across one who hasn't so I've never had any excess charges. My sister in PA has Plan N as well. It's a no brainer there. I hope my comment wasn't "excess" -ive."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgwKZZvFZNoj2o0GYwh4AaABAg>

↳ @JAB-q3e (3): "When I ask a doctors office if they take Medicare assignment most do not even know what that means. Many think it means " do you take Medicare "."

↳ @tomm7505 (3): "@Theretirementnerds Thanks Erik. FYI, with my doctor appointments for 2026, I just met my deductible. I also got my first Plan N copay for the year: \$2.28."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "I always live your comments, Tom! Thank you! 😊 "

"My 2027 S.S. may increase \$105 /month . Then minus \$7 /month increase Federal Tax , Minus \$ 7 month increase Medicare pt B , Minus \$161 / month increase Medigap plan (confirmed) and minus \$15 month increase Prescription plan leaves me \$85 / month net less than 2026 with . S.S. yearly adjustments are NOT keeping up with inflation and things like food prices , gasoline and energy costs & health insurance should be considered when adjusting yearly S.S. benefits."

— YouTube · 2027 Social Security & Medicare ALERT: What You'll Actually Keep · 28 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RIP9Ickspiw&lc=UgwbPDVT1v0P_OtZGyh4AaABAg

↳ @MichaelD-md4fh (6): "Your SS benefit of \$2900/month is well above average. Consider those average folks trying to get by on 2/3 of that."

↳ @kjFL1 (4): "@MichaelD-md4fh why should he have to consider that. He's just expressing what actually pertains to him. It's horrible for everyone, but we can't be responsible for that."

↳ @kevin9742-o9g (1): "@ronb493 I didn't have to pay \$800 / month for health insurance , included as part of the benefit package . Although your right some year's raises were small...."

"Medigap Plan G High-Deductible I'm switching from Advantage to Medigap for 2025, but I'm on the fence about whether to go with Plan G or G-HD. Here's my thinking: **Medigap Premium** * Plan G-HD: \$564/year (United American) * Plan G: \$2,292/year (Cigna) * Plan G-HD is **\$1,728** less expensive **All-in cost (premiums plus deductibles)** * Plan G-HD: Part B premium (\$2,088) + Plan G-HD premium (\$564) + Plan G-HD deductible (\$2,800) = \$5,452 * Plan G: Part B premium (\$2,088) + Plan G premium (\$2,292) + Part B deductible (\$240) = \$4,620 * Plan G-HD is **\$823** more expensive However, G-HD costs will vary depending on actual medical expenses, which creates a big opportunity for savings. \$3,538 is effectively the worst case scenario because the Plan G-HD deductible is really an out-of-pocket maximum. Best case is that I don't incur any Part A or Part B costs and I pay as little as \$738 in total premiums, resulting in \$1,728 in relative savings. The spread between the best and worst case scenario is therefore \$2,251/year. Plan G is the clear winner if I'm ever hospitalized, because the \$1,632 Part A deductible, alone, would offset potential savings. G-HD is a clear winner if I stay relatively healthy and incur less than \$1,728/year in out-of-pocket costs. Due to the Part B 80/20 split, I'd need to rack up well over \$8,000 in medicare-approved expenses before my 20% share is \$1,728, which is a lot of medical care. (In fact, it's more than 5 times this year's spending.) I used my 2024 claims history as a way to predict what I might expect going forward, assuming I stay relatively healthy. My current plan has paid out about \$1,500 in Medicare-approved costs so far this year. Assuming I had had G-HD this year, my Part B coinsurance would have been 20% of that, or \$300. If I assume this represents my ongoing average use of medical services, Plan G-HD will save me around \$1,500/year. The choice ultimately boils down to my risk tolerance and budget priorities, but here's what I'm thinking: * Plan G-HD is a very good bet if I assume I can stay healthy most years. Major risks are covered and I save a substantial amount of money. * With G-HD, the savings during one healthy year (\$1,500) offsets the extra cost of having two unhealthy years (\$800/year). In that case, I pretty much break even. * Therefore, it appears Plan G only makes sense if I assume I'm going to have consistently high medical expenses. Any thoughts? Am I missing anything?"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1fxhqz9/>

↳ (0): "Husband and I did G-HD for many of the same reasons you listed. We visit the doctor twice a year for labs. Husband had a few other specialist visits but the total costs were much less than paying plan G premiums. We pay \$48/month each and are in WA. Husband switched from MA plan to this G-HD last year because he wanted more options for doctors and hospitals if things got bad. Medical underwriting was easy as they are looking at serious medical conditions."

↳ (0): "Don't you need to multiply your Part B premium by 12 to get an annual amount?"

↳ (0): "one thing to factor in: increase in Plan G vs G-HD on both the premium and deductible sides of things. even if the percentage increase on G and G-HD is the same, the premium dollars on regular G will be significantly higher than G-HD if you look at it 5 or 10 years down the line. At a 7% increase, in 10 years that regular G is 4213/yr and G-HD is 1037/yr."

"I started with Medigap and after a year switched to Advantage. For me now at 70 it has been very good. I figure the savings of over \$2000 per year for 10 to 15 years will more than pay for a few years of maximum deductibles. My plan has dental, eye, gym. and \$100 per quarter for OTC medical expenses."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 27 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzEOYj_w2F1X2rR9AZ4AaABAg

↳ @clinlashway9147 (15): "While it is possible, if not likely that someone will spend less over their lives with an Advantage plan, you're giving up flexibility to not just select healthcare providers, but perhaps to get the healthcare at all. Your Advantage plan insurer still must approve tests and procedures and can decided not to. On a gap plan, virtually all healthcare covered Medicare is available to you without anyone having to approve what your doctors says you need. No bean counter trying to tell you and your doctor what your healthcare needs are."

"I'm starting Medicare in a couple of months and have been researching options and prices for a while. And yes, Plan G premiums and rate increases in my area (Central Oregon) seem pretty steep. Lowest Plan G and N premiums for a 65 year old male non-smoker here are \$217 and \$157, respectively. High deductible Plan G (GHD) comes in at ~\$50 per month. Annual GHD premium savings are \$2,004 and \$1,285 compared to G and N, respectively. It only takes 1.5 to 2.5 years of these premium savings to "pay for" the GHD deductible during a catastrophic medical year. I'm heavily leaning towards a GHD Supplemental with Original Medicare."

— YouTube · Everyone's Sick of Medigap Rate Increases...Here's What to Do! · 26 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NQHG_o1vxVU&lc=UgxdaN0DI5O-z9y3vMR4AaABAg

↳ @mjcarp7179 (3): "New York is a guaranteed issue state, anyone with any health condition can enroll without underwriting. The premiums are the highest in the whole country. GHD is the only way to go in New York."

↳ @debgossett (2): "You are looking at it in exactly the right way! Also, consider getting a Hospital Indemnity Plan to help cover HD costs. They cost about \$35 a month and pretty much pay for themselves over the years. And remember that the HD limit wil increase every year, so a good HIP will help you keep up with medical inflation. It's great peace of mind."

↳ @Bluewatervoyage (1): "I'm in Central Oregon and am going the same route. HD-G. Which company are you,going with?"

"I was working with an employer but I covered by my wife's insurance where she worked. It got so expensive like about \$600 a month at 66 I signed up for A & B and a G Plan as well and saved \$300 a month switching to Medicare for myself. I worked till 69 to get the most money of SS. I was not penalized for anything! It was best decision for us."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgyR73hvpzWy4668p-B4AaABAg>

↳ @SimaSaysBeWholeVideos (0): "I like the way this sounds!"

"I have saved almost \$20,000 in premiums in 10 years by switching to Medicare Advantage from other Medicare supplements. And each year, it seems Medicare Advantage offers more benefits at no charge. My Medicare Advantage medical only policy costs nothing. This year, dental coverage was added, and I also got a card with which I can purchase \$400 in medical supplies, drugs, etc., again at no cost to me."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 19 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyZK63nR-xAGzMql_J4AaABAq

↳ @wisheduknew294 (4): "Yes my mother has one too and it has saved her a lot of money over the last 3+ years. I guess this guy talking can pay his 20% coinsurance of traditional Medicare if he wants to. To each their own or whatever floats your boat I guess is the saying goes? Because my mother's plan has dental, vision, even has OTC built into it or she can go to CVS and get \$360 worth of merchandise every quarter. That comes in handy. I don't know what he's talking about. She had a surgery done all she paid was her co-pay."

↳ @wisheduknew294 (4): "And he is saying that they're all HMOs which is totally not true they do have PPOs and it takes you off of original Medicare which is not true you always have your original Medicare it's just that it is idol in the background and your Medicare advantage plan pays instead of Medicare but you still keep your Medicare. I sell Medicare advantage plans that's how I know this by the way"

↳ @johnruckman2320 (1): "Which MA are you on? Some responses seem to indicate that their MA's are an extreme disadvantage and costly.. Even with Medicare no dentist here will take it. And the vision/eyeglass place dropped Medicare."

"My wife is turning 65 in October and she filed an IRMAA appeal due to me retiring in 2024 with high income that came significantly down in 2025 and staying below the threshold going forward. She made an appointment with the local SSA branch, had them review the form, and within a week or two they approved her appeal and she'll be paying the much lower premiums. 🎉 We saved \$530 monthly by filing this appeal ... if you qualify, it's easy to appeal assuming you can provide documented proof."

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA: What Most Retirees Get Wrong About Their Premiums · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w1PM7D2XD84&lc=UgxOg_VhTv5e8Dd_aw54AaABAq

↳ @mr88cet (2): "I had a kinda-sorta similar IRMAA appeal, and it appears to have succeeded. I say, "appears to have," because afterward, you have to send them your 2025 (in this case) tax return to confirm to them that you calculated the income drop correctly. In my particular case, I was not able to find all of the relevant information when I filed the appeal. In particular, dividends and capital gains on investments can change on the last day of the year, outside of your control. In my particular case, my calculation on my original IRMAA appeal was in fact off a bit. It was _still way below_ the IRMAA threshold, but did require amendment. Best I interpret the letters I've received from them, yes, I appear to have avoided the cliff this time!"

↳ @JohnJeffrey-oz9tw (2): "Yes, I retired after 65 and would have had an IRRMA but appealed. I had a standard letter from my employer as evidence. Pretty straight forward but you do have to send in the applicable year's tax return when completed."

↳ @BostonGirl2024 (0): "Yes, but that only lasts for one year."

"I have been on a UHC Advantage HMO plan for 7 years. It has paid for all of my big treatments including a detached retina and a knee replacement. They both cost me about \$250. I pay 0 premium. I have saved over 26K in premiums. I exercise everyday. I have never smoked and don't have any chronic problems yet. I think I'm kind of stuck with it as I will pay a hefty price for a Supplement plan at my current age."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugyk3is4VtZ_KBbfd94AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for sharing your experience!"

"Wife and I both passed underwriting to go back to Original Medicare and chose Plan G. Plan G was a no brainer for the wife. After shopping Plan N in my locale, I would have saved about \$360 a year going with Plan N. I needed peace of mind coming out of Medicare Disadvantage and knew that as healthy as I've been blessed throughout my life, life can turn on a dime. After comparing I've found that Plan G in my area is considerably less expensive than the National Average. In addition to that, since 2025 began, I find myself having already seen 3 specialist - much to my surprise, then there are follow ups to do. In short, Plan G or Plan N are great plans to have in your hip pocket, affordability is the only key factor."

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgyUuJ6PFRgJBAQyCzZ4AaABAg

↳ @MedicareonVideo (1): "Yes both are great options. That is great that your area has considerably lower cost for Plan G. The affordability is a huge factor."

↳ @TheJetstream10 (0): "How did you get the underwriting done to switch? Was it hard?"

Care that just worked, no hassle · 163 documents · 20 voices

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now

ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

"7 years on a Med Advantage plan (for several years was on United Healthcare, but have since switched to Aetna), and I've had virtually no problems, with perhaps the one exception of sometimes having to wait a bit extra for an appointment with my PCP. No problems at all when having to visit specialists. Super and I mean super low cost - in fact, virtually no cost to Advantage. Not arguing with this gentleman, but I'm fine with my plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 76 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwzVa7DMisnauv3TWV4AaABAq>

↳ @JoyofRVing (6): "When you're younger it's OK, but when you need to get post Acute services they suck. They denied Acute rehab for a patient of mine who had a hip fracture. They also denied skilled nursing for her. She ended up going home with home PT twice a week."

↳ @MerkinMuffly (2): "Sure, Medicare Advantage employee, but I think I'll pass."

↳ @lesleyheller2271 (1): "There are differences between the regulated Medicare supplement plans which can make a difference in what's covered and what is not. While I plan to use original Medicare and Plan F, what about people who choose Plan N? You need to clarify that, in an otherwise informative video."

"Clover Health is defying expectations in the BEST way possible I just wanted to brag a little. I've had very little reason to do so in regards to anything health insurance related...ever. I've been a Clover health, first time on Medicare, patient for 1 month a 5 days. I have special needs (14 hrs/day IV infusions in the home for past 2.5 years) which prior to having Medicare were met by commercial insurance without a problem. Apparently infusions in the home are very rarely a covered thing under medicare. They are although covered in Hospice and the Hospital. Obviously I don't want to live in either. I am in my 30s. Clover Health quickly recognized that this is a complex situation that requires delicacy. A small specialty pharmacy might not agree to a drawn out process to get meds covered for this one patient on Medicare after all...and others aren't taking new patients in my area due to IV fluids still being somewhat impacted (shortage) from last year's hurricane. Anyway, Clover Health assigns a team on this that calls me every night. Also, gets me the most tenacious, amazing nurse advocate and they all begin a 2 week long talk with my pharmacy culminating in a single patient agreement going forward. I am relieved and grateful to say the least."

— r/medicare · 73 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1opyfpd/>

↳ (0): "What wonderful news for you! This is how *all of them* should do it--patient first centered care. Do what's right by your patient! The good will you will spread for them is invaluable. As it should be."

↳ (0): "I agree we need a lot more of this. Faith and good will can really use restoring!"

↳ (0): "Post this on X under Dr. Oz , AOC and RFK. Maybe they will get the picture of how an insurance company should behave. Happy for you!"

"I have a Medigap plan N and would not consider an Advantage plan unless I could not afford one financially. My main reasons are because I do not want to hand over my medical decisions to a for profit insurance company (Advantage plan) which will dictate what medical care I will be able to receive and where I will receive it. These plans can, and routinely do, deny care. I want any medical decisions on my care to be made by me and my doctor, not an insurance company who is beholden to shareholders and is only concerned about their own profits. If a specific treatment or procedure is determined by my doctor to be medically necessary, Medicare will cover it and my Medigap plan will pay, no questions asked. However, that is not the case with an Advantage plan, who can refuse to pay, forcing treatment delays or an outright denial for the patient receiving the care they need. The patient is then left in the unfortunate situation of having to go through the appeals process in an effort to get the care they need, or paying for their treatment out of their own pocket."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 71 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugw5RQFbE3SDniC5Hb14AaABAq>

↳ @kciis (9): "You make some excellent points about the importance of having control over your own healthcare decisions. Medigap plans certainly provide a level of security and peace of mind for many people. Kai & Ann Chung"

↳ @buggy5 (3): "You appear to be somewhat confused. The companies that offer Medigap coverage are also in business to make a profit for their shareholders - they are not non-profit. According to a study by CMS - the advantage plans are costing the taxpayer much more than Medigap plans. This is because the government pays the advantage plans a certain amount of money every month - regardless of whether the policy holder receives any medical care or not. The advantage plans are currently making many billions of dollars in profits every year. They have essentially zero incentive to pay out on a claim - unlike Medigap plans, whom must pay if Medicare pays."

↳ @MaryBethMcCoy (2): "@alfonso1781 You are welcome, and I am so sorry you are having to deal with a denial. My advice to you in this situation is to make the extra effort and appeal the decision, since I think that over 70% of the time, you can win if you stay persistent, assuming you and your doctor are in agreement that your procedure is medically necessary and covered by Medicare."

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

↳ @nsatutor635 (12): "I've heard that Advantage is a POS and as scammers, they shouldn't be in business. They're like the roach motel. Once you get in, you're not only stuck but will die. Sorry for your loss. These for profit companies don't give a F about anyone but their bottom line."

↳ @ZipaDeeDooDahDays (10): "This doesn't make sense to me honestly. I have gone through all of this and my understanding is you can SWITCH plans every year depending on your healthcare needs. You are NOT stuck in one plan or the other. You always look at your health situation each September and make the proper choice in October for what you will need Healthcare Advantage is EXCELLENT for people that doesn't have health issues and also are on a limited budget. I have the GIVEBACK program and get my monthly Part B paid back to me, this means I only pay \$17 moth for Plan B coverage through my Advantage plan. I also get \$100 every quarter in FREE OTC needs, which is awesome for hundreds. Of things I usually paid for myself, like compression socks, Ibuprofen, Band Aids, Crutches, Food supplements, Vitamins, and a ton of other high end expensive things I can't afford. That's \$400 a year in FREE OTC stuff. Also, I don't need approval from my PCP as I can go anywhere there is an in-network member. For Eye care I go to an Optometrist in the network who happens to also be the best in my area, so it works out. I'm also very healthy, have no health issues, no chronic disease, no prescriptions, and I love the getting the FREE silver sneakers FREE gym memberships and free recreation access for pickle ball and the pool and weight room stuff. 4th Stage Pancreatic Cancer is a result of a metabolic problem and is not genetic or something you can't control. Meaning, what you put into your body dictates if you get control if you get a diagnosis it can be reversed by immediately FASTING for 1 week, and changing your diet immediately, and exercise. You have to get radical to save your life. We all can prevent cancer easily by changing our diet. Stop drinking alcohol, beer and wine. Stop all seed oils, only eat Olive oil, coconut oil and avocado oil. Stop eating sugars and carbs, stop eating processed foods, start drinking only water, eat healthy salts like Arctic or Celtic salt with high minerals. Exercise every day, don't be sedentary, get moving, plenty of easy things we can do even seated that increase O2 intake and help blood flow. We all have been conned that we need to depend on Medicare and the medical profession and big pharma to keep us alive. This has killed many people for no reason at all. It's time we make America healthy again and stop listening to the quacks and start eating like our food is healthcare, then we don't need healthcare!"

↳ @AnthonyLindsay-c4m (2): "You are 100 right 👍 in what you wrote! The real truth about MA plan verses a supplement plan in real life. Supplement plans are better but you pay more per month but it's worth it in the longterm when you really need a lot of medical care down the road. I am going with a supplement plan G high deductible because I have VA , not going to use it much but I am locked in for life as long as I pay the premium every month."

"I had an advantage plan for 8 years. It worked great for the first 6 years until 2 of my doctors quit taking my insurance. My premiums were \$0 and I had gym and vision benefits. Things got tricky when I had an emergency and the closest hospital didn't take my insurance. I was in ICU for 5 days. Follow up visits with specialists and physical therapy were now a regular thing. Lots of copays. The next year I was diagnosed with cancer. I needed an oncologist for my type of cancer. I didn't get a choice of doctors. I went to the only one in my network. Again, lots of scans and copays. Last fall my insurance company notified me they weren't staying in business for 2025. It was a blessing! I was now guaranteed acceptance to get original Medicare with supplemental plan F (because of the date of part B start) without underwriting. Getting medical care this year is so much easier without networks, prior approvals and copays. You can go where you want to whatever doctor. If you can afford the premiums I recommend it. I've had both and there is no hassle anymore."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 66 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg.AODI8bYIzmOAOEfNIKwEGC>

"I have plan G. Had a hip replacement earlier this year. Had a small complication when they tried to do surgery the first time so had a few additional dr visits before they could reschedule the surgery a second time. In total start to finish cost was just over \$100,000. Everything was covered 100% except for my Medicare deductible cost. No issue getting appointments or getting them paid for. Everything went smoothly between Medicare and m6 supplemental plan. Can't recommend plan G enough!"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgwmYSkdOxcccZwNvYB4AaABAg>

↳ @g0989 (7): "\$100K for a hip replacement would have to be the provider's retail list price. The Medicare allowable charge would be much, much lower than that. And if the provider accepts Medicare assignment, they can't accept more than what Medicare allows."

↳ @leonawilcox4821 (0): "@g0989 let me elaborate a bit. During the start of my first surgery I had an a fib incident which stopped surgery and landed me a night in the hospital. We got all that under control which then gave me the ability to finally have the surgery 6 weeks later. I checked my EOBs and here are the exact numbers: amount billed = \$140,074.73 Medicare paid = \$112,316.44 Plan G paid = \$4285.53 So well over \$100,000 was paid between traditional Medicare and plan G. Very glad I don't have an advantage plan. Oh and I still need to have the other side done in a few months"

↳ @DobeMom (0): "@g0989 \$100,000 covered the cost of 2 hip replacement surgeries. I have Plan G...it is the BEST."

"I have plan G. I was diagnosed with cancer while living in a small community. I had some of my care locally for convenience. Then I opted to drive 2 hours for a special targeted radiation. In every case my insurance paid it all. I paid my annual deductible, and everything thing else was covered by plan G. I have real security knowing I have excellent coverage, and can go whenever I think care is most appropriate."

— YouTube · Don't Buy Medigap Plan G Before Watching This ! · 63 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tughWPQP08&lc=Ugwr8t6QJL-dV67U3PR4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (4): "@rebeccam6128 thank you for sharing this with us. The peace of mind knowing everything is paid for and that when you need it, you can drive two hours or two days away to find the healthcare you need, priceless."

↳ @PoppaPicky (0): "I wish you strength and a positive outcome..."

"OK. Now I am just turning 65 and I have some things to add. My wife was 71 when I had to retire to take care of her. When I did so, I lost my health insurance. I enrolled in COBRA and it was damned expensive. Had I known then what I know now, I may have chose differently. Both insurances together were 1600 a month, which is a horrible price to pay, but it was an approved plan so she slid onto part B with no problem. Here's the thing. She went to the hospital and the finance people were telling me that BCBS was the primary and Medicare was the secondary, this is just information. COBRA through your former employer is the secondary payer and Medicare is primary payer. Hope this helps when choosing what to do. It doesn't matter now. RIP Linda B. 07/16/23 I miss ya baby. Thanks for 45 years. It was worth everything we went through. (I made a couple of edits because I made some mistakes on the post. Thanks to youtube for allowing me to edit. 🙏 "

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🙏 · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgzLz7ljSVYL8z78XYJ4AaABAg>

↳ @zebragiraffe1 (10): "You must have been a great husband. Sorry for your loss."

↳ @MedicareSchool (2): "My team would be happy to assist you. Give us a call at 800-864-8890 or schedule an appointment at www.medicareschool.com"

↳ @djmydlack (1): "Hi. Thanks so much for posting. Could you say what you'd done differently? My wife is dying of ALS and I may be forced to retire to care for her. Thank you."

"I really like my Advantage plan! Haven't had any problems, never denied coverage never any monthly output, always had complete coverage."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 56 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgzgM7tL9bIQNKyO7ix4AaABAg>

↳ @meditation6054 (5): "I don't know which Advantage plan you have but I'm a physical therapist and every patient that has an advantage plan have consistently been cut short on coverage for services! Every Advantage plan cuts services!"

↳ @mrsatire9475 (1): "Wellcare was not accepted at enough facilities and they refused to cover scripts and diagnostics ordered by Doctors not in their plan"

↳ @akita96th (0): "Have you been really sick yet? The kind of sick that cost over a \$100K I have..Thats when you will hate that advantage plan...Did you buy that advantage plan because Donald Trump and the GOP supports them?"

"Best thing I ever did! Yes, it cost money every month. Bout at 72, I ended up in two hospitals ICU's costing a fortune. Then I was moved to Hospital #2, where I had a surgery that was \$100,000. My medigap paid for everything!!!! Oh my gosh! Can you imagine how much it would have been on an advantage plan!!!"

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 52 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgzKvAt-4KJi--ReaU94AaABAg>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (14): "An Advantage Plan could have cost you your life. Seniors die every day because of sub par standards and outdated care with Advantage. Delays caused by denials and limited specialists with long waits also kill seniors. My sister in law dropped her medigap coverage after her husband passed. She couldn't afford it any longer. That one decision contributed greatly to her premature death. She suffered a stroke and her Advantage plan denied her an acute rehab and would only pay for regular rehab. Her doctors and the regular rehab both went on the record that she needed acute care vs regular. Sadly, after the family filed a challenge to the denial she choked on her own vomit and became brain dead. She spent months in a coma and finally passed. Her Advantage bill for the coma care was over 500 thousand. We as taxpayers were responsible for the insurance carriers greed. Administrator at the rehab told the family it happens multiple times every day in America."

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (10): "@katherinepll Read the fineprint. The out of pocket maximum with most Advantage Plans is for "in network covered services". If you have no choice and have to go out of network for care or your specialist orders services that aren't covered your liable for those costs or worse the facilities won't perform the services. Many healthcare facilities would work with patients but more and more are treating with outdated protocols not even offering the standard treatments since the Advantage Plans don't cover. It's the main reason why many health care groups no longer accept Advantage patients. The subpar care my sister in law recieved from her Advantage Dr's led to her early death. The Advanyage Plans are by far the biggest fraud dumped on our senior citizens."

↳ @Avajane1801 (5): "Mine would have cost \$2700 total. That is my annual out-of-pocket maximum. No premiums. How much were your premiums? Unless you have a major surgery every year, my plan is much cheaper. And they do pay!"

"You are 100% correct. I have plan F, which I chose because I had a serious illness shortly before I became Medicare eligible. It was an easy decision because I knew I was going to be seeing specialists, having tests, procedures etc. and did not want to be in a network. Also, the benefits for each Medicare supplements are clearly spelled out, while the Advantage plans are murky. I have had tons of imaging, bloodwork, see lots of specialists (who I did not have to get a referral to see), have had surgeries and have NEVER got a bill. I know that not everything is covered, and eventually I might need something Medicare does not fully cover. But I ALWAYS ask if it's covered by Medicare, and so far have never found anything a doctor ordered to not be covered. So, the supplement picks up the rest. Plan F is excellent."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwurRgkwXclXrOQrGV4AaABAg>

↳ @neilwhiteaker53 (1): "@debhelms4106 Plan F and Plan G have no office visit or ER fees at all. Ever. Make sure of what you are signing up for. You want a Medigap Supplement, not Medicare Advantage."

↳ @debhelms4106 (0): "I'm going on plan F he said I would have copays every time I go to the dr!! Wonder why you don't have copayments?"

↳ @maytrang671 (0): "@debhelms4106 You need to check your plan. Plan F cover all deductible copay."

"I am on an Advantage plan and have absolutely no problem with it."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugz6F1eWCHc2CsWMD6t4AaABAg>

↳ @rorystorm4284 (18): "And you're probably pretty healthy. If you get sick and need expensive treatment, Advantage can deny you that treatment. You're taking a big risk."

↳ @Hello-i7m (2): "My terminally ill husband has the advantage plan and it's fabulous!! If your giant hospital monopoly is in the plan and most are it's fantastic!!"

↳ @RiannaStan11 (0): "@rorystorm4284 I'm on an Advantage plan, too. I have a chronic vascular condition that has nearly killed me twice now. Insurance didn't blink for the most expensive option treatments, nor at the ongoing expensive medications. I notice this year the specialist copays went up by \$10/visit. 🙄 Also, my periodontist was surprised that my quarterly dental cleanings now have a copay, when in previous years, were just covered as a medical (not dental) expense. 😞 "

"My spouse and I are both covered with a Plan G Supplement. We love that we can see any doctor, hospital, or clinic that accepts Medicare. We also love that our doctor has the final say so for procedures rather than a pre-authorization where the insurance company gets to decide if my procedure is needed, i.e. a knee replacement. My doc said I needed both knees done, it is a Medicare covered procedure, so no questions asked. Procedure was done. No insurance company needing to give me a pre-authorization. We're both sold on Medigap and will stay right where we are."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plan Reviews ★ (from real people) · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nw14VxxHrmM&lc=UgywO3hzHzcYQztKGDN4AaABAg>

↳ @stephanieabt4114 (5): "Love that! Plan G + traditional Medicare is a great place to be if you have a pending surgery or procedure."

↳ @larrybaumann (2): "They use bait and switch. Sneaky."

↳ @ChuckKarges (0): "Me to stayed in traditional ay gap plan and low meds prices no on in my pocket except doctor only I need a transplant lungs the valve didn't work I had cv+ but there glue trails coming up same people as valves it could help they fixed the cv+ to - thank u Mr church and your staff for helping me find this"

"My husband and I chose a supplement plan N when we went on Medicare a few years ago. We travel with our RV all over the country and wanted something that was almost seamless. They've really complicated Medicare and I'm concerned older people will not be able to understand how to manage their Medicare insurance. I'm college educated and sometimes it's confusing for me. We will be able to afford the increases but I know many will not. The whole system is becoming unsustainable and not just from a cost perspective."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgzuzarTcidnirUDgmd4AaABAg>

↳ @anitifischer9714 (7): "It's good to choose plan n when you first go on Medicare. To change after the fact, entails a medical exam and if you have any chronic condition your apt to be denied the new plan. I experienced that with UHC going from plan G to plan N. Gotta watch the way doctors diagnose you even though the insurance companies will not tell you what the diagnosis is. I found that I had two chronic conditions that I never even was treated for because of the way the doctors diagnosed it when they sent the claim in for billing. After having to send all my medical records to prove my point that I did not have these conditions then United healthcare approved my change of plan. But it took months for me to get all these records together to prove doctors were billing fraudulently basically.. . AND getting away with it"

"My elderly mom is covered by my late father's Advantage plan through Aetna and Express Scripts as part of his pension. I take her to doctor's visits and manage bills and her costs are not higher than when she was on regular Medicare. Obviously his pension happened to include great coverage and terms and perhaps is atypical. Her primary care doctor sends her to specialists of his choice and she's never been refused any specialist or treatment. To continue to be covered by his pension she had to switch to Medicare Advantage a year ago but it has been no problem."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugzha45ykezoPOalOrp4AaABAg>

↳ @Nobody_Mr_47 (7): "@cherylstade3614 Please don't worry! She's in good hands with good coverage with a reputable carrier. There's nothing wrong with managed care and shared medical expenses. Just differences of opinion, that's all. Your mother won't lose her life savings, as ALL of these plans have an out of pocket maximum. I sell these plans and nearly all of my customers have no complaints and for many years."

↳ @fatimagross1956 (5): "The problem comes when ur diagnose with cancer. You have to pay that 20%co insurance for chemo/radiation and cancer medication, is when it can eat up all your life savings.Medicare Advantage is only good if you don't end up sick with major illnesses!"

↳ @cherylstade3614 (1): "@fatimagross1956 Dear me ! I will have to look into this!"

"Great review of the topic, Erin. I started with Medicare Advantage for several years after I turned 65, enjoying the zero cost and dental and vision benefits. I'm healthy and have no extra medical expenses beyond routine care. However, Advantage plans have been dropping out of my low/aging population state, and starting in 2026, only 5 of the 14 counties in my state have access to an Advantage plan (my county not included). As a result, I exercised my Guaranty Issue right and purchased Medigap and Part D plans, with total annual premiums of about \$2,100 for these plans. I'm not mad about it. While I'm healthy for now, that can change at any time. The annual cost of the new plans is not a burden on me (which I know is not the case for everybody). I have the assurance that, if I get sick or injured and require a lot of medical care, I won't have to worry about high medical costs. I've watched others who have Medigap plans and had major medical expenses get good care with no problem and not have to take on a financial burden to meet their care needs, or go through a lot of bureaucratic rigamarole to get care and have bills get paid. While my insurance choices got molded by market forces outside my control, I do feel I am now covered better than ever, and that is reassuring. My suggestion is this: If the costs associated with a Medicare and separate Rx. plan fit comfortably in your budget, make that your choice."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgyE_Alm8EugoAtW-Ax4AaABAg

↳ @dennmillsch (4): "" If the costs associated with a Medicare and separate Rx. plan fit comfortably in your budget.." -- and if you choose MedAdv, make sure you have enough income to pay the Max Out of Pocket if big issues come up. Depending on how many years you have higher medical needs, either plan can be cost winner. But you don't know. The most conservative approach is Medigap."

↳ @francesw.6774 (0): "@robnunurbiznezz7618 I hope you make it to Medicare eligibility without any problems. Without Medicare, I'm assuming that huge numbers of retired seniors would have to go without insurance and care. Do keep in mind that the \$2,100/year I'm paying only covers Rx insurance and the 20% gap not covered by Medicare (as you probably know, Medicare only covers 80% of medical care expenses). Also, Medicare recipients have to pay a monthly fee for basic Medicare insurance (\$203 in my case - it's taken out of my Social Security). So basically, I'm paying about \$4,500 per year for very strong insurance coverage, with low deductibles."

↳ @dennmillsch (0): "@robnunurbiznezz7618 -- Yep, Obamacare only helps a bit if you are below 4x poverty level, which is something like \$70K for married-filing-joint-nondependents. Then your health care for one person can be below \$4K per year. But if you earn above that 4x poverty threshold, Obamacare doesn't help much."

"I have a Medigap plan F that is community-rated and offers gym membership, 24-hour call a registered nurse service, and discounts on vision and hearing services. I am very happy with my plan and would never even consider changing to a Medicare (Dis)Advantage plan. I don't want a private insurance agency making health care decisions for me or restricting my access to a particular network of doctors. So many doctors and hospitals accept original Medicare without question and then, of course medigap pays its part. As far as medigap costing a little more, I think you have to ask yourself what your priorities are. My priority is "no hassles, no worries" health care. I am willing to drive an older car and make other sacrifices as necessary because my health comes first."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap | Your TRUE Cost · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=Ugwc4CVdNbp7cUz8Ox14AaABAg>

↳ @Dbb277-2 (3): "My F is costing \$300 a month. Ouch. I have no health issues."

↳ @kciis (1): "You are echoing my moms thoughts! 😊 - Ann"

↳ @4378200 (0): "@Dbb277-2 That's why I did not enroll...I would have given a company thousands to pay for my co-pays for the last 3 years. My MA has worked perfect for me"

"Thank you for sharing your experience — I'm really glad to hear you're doing well and that Plan N worked so smoothly for you. Having the freedom to choose your doctors and hospitals is a huge benefit of Original Medicare with a Medigap plan. Your story is a great reminder of why so many people value that flexibility and peace of mind."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwvfURn5XXCLWCAGlp4AaABAg.ANujzeHTM6tANvD_575klI

"I retired at 72 signed up for Medicare supplemental plan F because I was able to get that it's a little expensive but it has more than paid for itself over the years over the years my wife and I have had medical bills almost \$1 million no problem. Our expense of the insurance is well worth the peace of mind."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwWy0wpmcfMRfARwiR4AaABAg>

↳ @aregee7121 (4): "Ditto. What's more precious than your health?"

↳ @Lynartist (3): "We have been so thankful for my husband's Medicare supplemental plan F! He is much older than I am and over the years it has paid for many hospital stays including a week in ICU. We have never had to pay out for anything. When it came time for me to retire I signed right up! Yes it's expensive but how can you put a price on peace of mind!"

↳ @lou2632-i5x (3): "Now you see why the government cancelled plan F beginning in 2020 for new enrollees 😊"

Got out of Advantage and onto a supplement · 57 documents · 20 voices

"I had switched from Advantage to Plan G because I'm totally risk-averse. Good thing I did. Out of the blue, I got neurological symptoms that made it impossible to type, write, knit, hike, or even walk my dog. (Fast forward several months--turns out they were caused by the neurosurgeon who treated me 15 years ago). Because I live in a part of the country with very poor medical coverage, my PCP referred me to a university medical center in another state. I got first class care--surgery, hospitalization, home health all were billed to Medicare at over \$350K. I paid nothing. If I had been on Advantage, I most likely would have been limited to the surgeon who caused my problem in the first place. And next week I'll go hiking with my dog for the first time in over a year."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 270 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCXf6P2_bAdYu1Q_l4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "Thank you for sharing your experience 🙏 Glad to hear you'll be able to walk your dog again soon! Hope recovery is going okay!"

↳ @elizabethb.1693 (4): "That's awesome! 🙌👏"

↳ @clairemckayhart1109 (3): "Thank you for the elephant advice, coming up on 65 and retirement."

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>;
— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/>

↳ (0): "In terms of coverage, traditional Medicare and a supplement is going to offer more choices and flexibility than a Medicare Advantage plan. Whether or not it's affordable for everyone is another story. The unfortunate truth is that more and more of our senior population is living on poverty wages and simply can't afford a Medicare supplement. Also, most retirees have been covered by managed care plans for a good portion of their working careers, so dealing with provider networks and utilization management is not a novel concept. With annual max of pocket costs under \$4000 for PPOs in my area, many of these individuals are choosing a zero premium MAPD option and paying for the care they use as they use it. Are MAPDs right for everyone? Of course not. But, the market has spoken on Medicare Advantage plans. More than half of the 65 million Americans on Medicare are currently enrolled in Medicare Advantage plans. They aren't going anywhere. It's important to discuss the potential risks of MAPDs, but it's not inherently the wrong choice. **Edited for auto cor-wrecks"

↳ (0): "I get several calls a day from foreign call centers regarding Medicare. They are frequently aggressive and sometimes vulgar. My latest weapon - your insurance license number... I ask: if you sell Medicare related products in my state you must be licensed, what is your number? The next sound is a click."

↳ (0): "This is correct!!! OP is very uneducated in Medicare... clearly!!!! and can be proven by going to Medicare.gov!!!! I hope this post was satire. But please y'all do not listen this this is not correct."

"Another negative for Advantage plans is that hospitals in my area are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans. So if you have a doctor you like and he works out of a certain hospital you could find yourself looking for another doctor and hospital. I was on an Advantage plan but was able to get on Plan G because the hospital I use stopped accepting the Advantage plan I was on. I didn't have to get approved or pass any medical tests to go on Plan G since it wasn't my fault that my Advantage plan was no longer valid. Best thing that could have happened to me."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx4MOWZuO_w_2-SLoV4AaABAg

↳ @tracyjohnson5023 (1): "Same here. The hospital still accepts advantage, but many doctors do not"

"Medigap Plan G High-Deductible I'm switching from Advantage to Medigap for 2025, but I'm on the fence about whether to go with Plan G or G-HD. Here's my thinking: **Medigap Premium** * Plan G-HD: \$564/year (United American) * Plan G: \$2,292/year (Cigna) * Plan G-HD is **\$1,728** less expensive **All-in cost (premiums plus deductibles)** * Plan G-HD: Part B premium (\$2,088) + Plan G-HD premium (\$564) + Plan G-HD deductible (\$2,800) = \$5,452 * Plan G: Part B premium (\$2,088) + Plan G premium (\$2,292) + Part B deductible (\$240) = \$4,620 * Plan G-HD is **\$823** more expensive However, G-HD costs will vary depending on actual medical expenses, which creates a big opportunity for savings. \$3,538 is effectively the worst case scenario because the Plan G-HD deductible is really an out-of-pocket maximum. Best case is that I don't incur any Part A or Part B costs and I pay as little as \$738 in total premiums, resulting in \$1,728 in relative savings. The spread between the best and worst case scenario is therefore \$2,251/year. Plan G is the clear winner if I'm ever hospitalized, because the \$1,632 Part A deductible, alone, would offset potential savings. G-HD is a clear winner if I stay relatively healthy and incur less than \$1,728/year in out-of-pocket costs. Due to the Part B 80/20 split, I'd need to rack up well over \$8,000 in medicare-approved expenses before my 20% share is \$1,728, which is a lot of medical care. (In fact, it's more than 5 times this year's spending.) I used my 2024 claims history as a way to predict what I might expect going forward, assuming I stay relatively healthy. My current plan has paid out about \$1,500 in Medicare-approved costs so far this year. Assuming I had had G-HD this year, my Part B coinsurance would have been 20% of that, or \$300. If I assume this represents my ongoing average use of medical services, Plan G-HD will save me around \$1,500/year. The choice ultimately boils down to my risk tolerance and budget priorities, but here's what I'm thinking: * Plan G-HD is a very good bet if I assume I can stay healthy most years. Major risks are covered and I save a substantial amount of money. * With G-HD, the savings during one healthy year (\$1,500) offsets the extra cost of having two unhealthy years (\$800/year). In that case, I pretty much break even. * Therefore, it appears Plan G only makes sense if I assume I'm going to have consistently high medical expenses. Any thoughts? Am I missing anything?"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1fxhqz9/>

↳ (0): "Husband and I did G-HD for many of the same reasons you listed. We visit the doctor twice a year for labs. Husband had a few other specialist visits but the total costs were much less than paying plan G premiums. We pay \$48/month each and are in WA. Husband switched from MA plan to this G-HD last year because he wanted more options for doctors and hospitals if things got bad. Medical underwriting was easy as they are looking at serious medical conditions."

↳ (0): "Don't you need to multiply your Part B premium by 12 to get an annual amount?"

↳ (0): "one thing to factor in: increase in Plan G vs G-HD on both the premium and deductible sides of things. even if the percentage increase on G and G-HD is the same, the premium dollars on regular G will be significantly higher than G-HD if you look at it 5 or 10 years down the line. At a 7% increase, in 10 years that regular G is 4213/yr and G-HD is 1037/yr."

"I think it depends on where you live if you live in an urban environment, most likely the advantage plans will be beneficial to you, but if you live in rural America, then the advantage plans most likely won't be very good for you because there's not a lot of choices for you. I live in New York, and there are so many choices for us. Also New York has a different rule that allows you to switch from an advantage plan to a Medigap plan."

— YouTube · 2026 Medicare Advantage vs Medigap I Your TRUE Cost · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=09mB2cqanxQ&lc=UgxYvYZ_S3uasxyvxol4AaABAg

↳ @CynthiaMemeBrooklyn (1): "@ if you live 2 miles from a big city, you don't live in a rural neighborhood you live in suburbs rural is somewhere very far from a big city like you living on the farm in the Midwest or somewhere in the deep deep south. But I'm glad you seem to enjoy your advantage care plan."

↳ @windycityliz7711 (0): "@CynthiaMemeBrooklyn You may want to heck your reading skills - "hours" and "miles" are not the same thing. One does not usually find cows, horses and soybean fields - all within 1/4 mile of my home- in the suburbs."

↳ @CynthiaMemeBrooklyn (0): "@ you are totally correct, but I'm still right you live in the suburbs figure it out"

"I was one who switched from Advantage to Medigap within first 5 years. I was lucky my Advantage Plan went out of business so I was given opportunity for Medigap without underwriting. Medigap premiums are more than copays I paid under Advantage, but I feel more comfortable with the "insurance" provided with Medigap. My Medigap also includes dental, vision and gym membership like Advantage Plans."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugxok-KsWXvobskLJtt4AaABAg>

↳ @jeffs3627 (20): "What supplement plan includes dental and vision? Never heard of that."

↳ @YinDebElliottSlowey (5): "Yes. Please tell me. Thanks"

↳ @MedigapSeminars (2): "Minnesota is one of three states that opted out of Standardized medicare supplement plans and have their own similar, but in some ways better, plans."

"Just went through this process about a year ago. I decided on a supplement plan (plan G) for as long as I could afford it. It is fairly 'easy' to switch to an advantage plan at a later time. Moving from an advantage plan to a supplement plan MAY require medical underwriting and may not be possible. I prefer the freedom of choice the supplement plans offer."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzGOqWQSwRxqmXlzZd4AaABAg>

"I recently retired and now have a part-time job tracking all of my Medicare activities (referrals/deductibles/copays/premiums/reimbursements). Your information on switching from Advantage to Supplemental is invaluable!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gqTv-u6Polc&lc=Ugx1vo64LQgb_rCASUx4AaABAg

"I switched from Advantage to the supplement plan at age 72. It was not an issue. I also got the Medigap."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxlp1NR8QlwYKq-pH94AaABAg>

"Just a caution about switching from an Advantage Plan to A supplement. Make sure your advantage plan is explicitly cancelled or you may end up with both a supplement plan and an advantage plan and no drug plan. This happened to me. United Health automatically enrolled me after I was enrolled in a supplement. But when I tried to enroll in a drug plan, I was denied on the last day of the enrollment period. By the. It was too late to fix. A quirk of the system. Ended up having to get ugly about cancelling the MA plan in January, pay for a month of it and start my drug plan Feb 1. I even had chat records where United Healthcare's reps, 3 of them, told me my MA plan was cancelled. Even had a screenshot one of them shared with me that showed it was cancelled. But come January 1, I was welcomed to a United Healthcare MA plan. I was livid. But there were no options to undo United Healthcare's actions."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgyEXYhFKfZjy5FJf2F4AaABAg>

↳ @afrocraft1 (0): "Sorry about your experience. What did your annual notice of change (ANOC) say? That's the document that matters, not chat logs."

↳ @techadsr (0): "@afrocraft1 The ANOC was received before the enrollment period and before I started enrollment into a Supplement plan away from the Advantage Plan. Why would that matter?"

↳ @lyndayoung8761 (0): "The letter from the Carrier that states they are pulling out of MA in your area is your Golden Ticket to medigap without underwriting. Other changes are business as usual as they morph and jockey about with Extra Benefits and copay costs to get your attention PICK ME, PICK ME"

"The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAg.AXFFtsLMytJAZXHpUtXFuU>

"This information is terrific, my question is can a person on Medicare change from an advantage plan to a supplemental plan during the yearly open enrollment?"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plans Explained · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3OQPdBOUt2M&lc=UgwyzldrRrBNV5mpyIJ4AaABAg>

↳ @barreloffun10 (0): "If they are healthy enough to get an underwritten medigap plan, yes."

"Let's get our facts straight: If I decide that after a time that I want to change from a Medicare Advantage plan to something else, I have two choices: I can return to original Medicare Parts A & B or I can, given insurability, apply for a Medicare Supplemental plan. I have not "signed away my rights to original Medicare" by choosing a Medicare Advantage plan. Apparently, you haven't seen many of "90 Days from Retirement" videos where they take actual hospital stay cases and compare the coverages of private insurance, original Medicare, Medicare Advantage, and Medicare Supplemental plans. It's surprising how different scenarios give different results depending on the plan you have. There is no clear "winner". During my entire business career, I have been covered by some type of HMO health insurance by the various companies I've worked for. I've been very well-versed in how to get referrals and work within a network. And it's been quite affordable. I'm still working and have chosen a Medicare Advantage plan for my health care coverage. I could easily afford a Medicare Supplemental plan but choose, instead, to save a ton of money for my coverage. There is no "this is better, this is worse" when it comes to choosing. You pick the type of plan that meets your goals. If you want the privilege of choosing your doctor and want to pay for that privilege, then by all means go Supplemental. If you're comfortable with getting referrals and working within a network, then choose Advantage. For me living in Florida, I choose a Medicare Advantage plan. I paid a total out of pocket of less than \$200 for my medical coverage in 2022 and for 2023. Yes, I had some co-pays and the like, but it amounted to significantly less than what I would have paid if I'd had a Medicare Supplemental plan. Essentially, for my Medicare Advantage plan here in Florida, I have a "give back" on my premium that covers all but \$10/month of the Part B premium. I have no deductible, \$0 copay for seeing my primary care physician, and a \$10 copay for specialists. I have a \$60 copay for outpatient surgery and a \$75/night for days 1-5 if I have a hospital stay. \$0 copay for nights after the 1st 5 nights. I have prescription, dental, and vision coverage as well. There are perks such as 48 trips per year to/from doctor appts, a meal plan for two weeks after a hospital stay, and many, many more. I believe many people choose these advantage plans not for as you say, "these are for people with low monthly retirement incomes", but they choose them for using their money wisely."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgwTsL3DpxecL9X-mph4AaABAg.9wePF3EAQZI9xjrZGMO-x>

"Thanks for the update! Regarding switching from Medicare Advantage to regular Medicare + Medigap, there's the matter of pre-existing conditions. I've read that a Medigap plan might require a waiting period before covering costs for a pre-existing condition, but I've also read that if you have uninterrupted Medicare Advantage coverage previous to switching, then the waiting period is waived. Is this correct? Can you kindly clarify? Thanks!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugxlp9uBohq8PaAu1CV4AaABAg>

"ANECDOTE ... I just switched from a Advantage Plan during Open Enrollment to a G Plan with the same Insurance co. They accepted the change without Underwriting... Fast and Easy. I would like to continue to review my options. Thank You."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgwYqbSkpcHnJJG5JBI4AaABAg>

"Besides affordability, standard Medicare was just so complicated for me to figure out. But Medicare Advantage plans were so simple plus affordable. However at the time I didn't know how difficult it would be to switch from an Advantage plan to a supplement plan. That's why Advantage plans can be a trap. And Advantage plans can and will deny treatments that are covered by Medicare. These days supplement plans underwriters will deny you if you are just getting injections into joints because they assume they are going to have to pay for joint replacements in the future. You have to be perfectly healthy and not even have painful arthritis to qualify for a supplement plan now. But is it true that if you move to a different state and your current Advantage plan isn't available in the new state, you can obtain a supplement plan without going through underwriting?"

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgyBo5ACeX1itt10HaZ4AaABAg>

↳ @lindag9975 (1): "@misterjagNo problem if you sign up originally. I was referring to trying to change later. Most people don't know that it's a trap if you try to go with a supplement plan later."

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "If you have an Advantage Plan and move out of the plan service area you have the ability to get select (some) supplement plans as Guaranteed Issue for a short period of time."

↳ @bazzatruly (1): ""But is it true that if you move to a different state and your current Advantage plan isn't available in the new state, you can obtain a supplement plan without going through underwriting?" Yes, that's generally true."

"I thought that when you are new to Medicare there is a trial right where you can change from Advantage to Medigap without underwriting In this video I heard 6 months ? Please clarify"

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=Ugzregb6rVGq8k5V7iZ4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "The trial right you are referring to is IF you purchased a Medicare Advantage Plan during your initial enrollment period when you turned 65, you have a 1-year trial right to switch. Otherwise, your Medicare supplement initial enrollment period is the first 180-days on Part B."

"I believe that it would have been helpful to discuss the ramifications of switching from an Advantage plan to a Supplement plan like the old elephant once told me."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxDljgH8r8GX-lfW2B4AaABAg.A1x0c7c3FM-AO7LIRnyUnx>

"Great video. But one question: what are the rules regarding pre-existing conditions if I am switching from an Advantage plan to a Supplement? I am in the process of moving to a United Healthcare Plan N. I received a document from them today that has (2) paragraphs that almost seem contradictory: "State regulations provide that in applying a preexisting condition limitation, a Medicare supplement issuer must credit the time the applicant was previously covered under creditable coverage (including Medicare supplement insurance, Medicare select coverage and MA plans) if the previous creditable coverage was continuous to a date not more than 63 days prior to the enrollment date of the new policy or certificate." Further on it reads "If you are replacing your current health insurance coverage the following exclusion will not apply: I understand the plan will not pay benefits for stays beginning or medical expenses incurred during the first 6 months of coverage if they are due to conditions for which medical advice was given or treatment recommended by or received from a physician within 6 months prior to the insurance effective date." If I want to have an atrial fibrillation issue that I have had for several years addressed in the first quarter of next year (2023) will I have coverage??"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugw8qYR0R39IjeOY7n54AaABAg>

"Really valuable information, especially the warning about switching from Medicare Advantage to Original Medicare without first checking Medigap eligibility. The advice to review your Annual Notice of Change, ask about a Special Enrollment Period, and speak with a SHIP counselor before making a move is something every Medicare beneficiary should know. I think these Medicare changes deserve much more attention because one wrong decision can affect both your healthcare choices and your retirement budget. I've been following this topic closely as well, and there are so many details seniors can easily miss. Great job bringing these issues to light.



— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugy9wtxtn8T_gQRYHcl4AaABAg

Never saw a bill after a major illness · 38 documents · 20 voices

"As a retired Fed, I kept my Federal Employee Health Care plan to supplement Medicare for my wife and me. We are in our early 70s and we spend about \$1000.00 a month for Medicare, health, prescriptions and dental coverage which is pricey. However, we see the best doctors we can find and make our own health care decisions. We have had 3 major back surgeries, a shoulder replacement surgery, a hip replacement surgery, 2 Carpal tunnel surgeries, cataract surgery, and a heart attack scare all with zero additional out of pocket expenses. I will pay whatever it takes to not be in "managed" care."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwpYf9xGADzU9o1T654AaABAg>

↳ @martygraw9708 (2): "I'm also on FEHB and another big advantage is not having to worry about IRMAA"

↳ @TAM-bv2di (0): "@martygraw9708 Good for you both, and you're welcome! As a regular payer of IRMAA, I'm glad you're enjoying the benefit of that rip-off that regular payees into the system - not the special endowments that you and politicians receive, have to go endure. I don't begrudge you your self-congratulations, since I'm certain I've achieved much greater wealth than you working for actual value-added enterprises during my life!"

↳ @BrendaKennedy-I5q (0): "@martygraw9708 why is that? Curious because i am older, but I may be getting a fed job and would give up my state employment insurance (which would turn into an advantage plan at 65)."

"We have a Medigap part G plan and so glad we do. I had triple bypass surgery in February and our plans paid 100% and we never received a bill of any kind. I also get eye injections in my right eye every 8 weeks that costs \$2,700 each and again it's paid 100%."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgyIWDqIB_c5_0HxCu14AaABAg

↳ @howdy2496 (2): "Down where I live the bypass would have cost \$325 with an advantage plans and no monthly premium."

↳ @skatefan9495 (0): "As if Medicare would pay \$2,700 for weekly eye injections. Doctors don't like to take Medicare because it reimburses at such a low level."

↳ @jamesford7781 (0): "@skatefan9495many MA plans pay their in network doctors less than what Medicare does."

"I'm 85, which in dog years is quite old. I have Medicare and a supplement plan. I've had various surgeries, and since retirement I've never paid a dime for healthcare. I take three medications, which total \$18 for a three month supply. This system works for me."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxAQjUbBUWngAmwFxR4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching 🙏 and sharing your experience!"

↳ @beatrizcontreras7973 (0): "Thank you verymuch ❤️❤️❤️❤️❤️❤️❤️"

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"My SCAN Venture Medicare Advantage Plan in Orange County California has \$0 premium, \$1,000 MOOP, \$0 copays to see specialists, \$0 deductibles, and includes the following with no extra premiums or deductibles: Part D drug plan, Delta Dental dental plan, vision allowance and more. In the 10 years that I've been on Medicare, I've always had a Medicare Advantage plan. I've saved nearly \$30,000 by NOT paying Medigap premiums. I've never been denied coverage. The \$80k surgery and hospitalization I had 3 years ago cost me \$0."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=Ugz9iYBAa-W0r8LHK354AaABAq>

↳ @merlenealt4233 (1): "You can't be telling the whole truth. Medicare Advantage plans have deductibles and limits of what you can do and who you can see. If you're healthy and don't see doctors they are great but as you get older many things can happen. My ex husband just got canceled from his Medicare Advantage plan because he has prostate cancer. Lucky for him he can go to Original Medicare with a Medigap Plan and not have to do underwriting. Hope you stay healthy."

↳ @Sparrow0514 (1): "I think SCAN is a medi medi plan meaning that she has MediCal/Medicaid so the state Medi-Cal insurance for those who meet the low income eligibility covers all the deductibles and anything that Medicare does not pay."

↳ @herrickinman9303 (0): "@merlenealt4233Your story doesn't ring true. A Medicare Advantage plan contracts with Medicare to provide the same services that would be covered under Medicare but at the same or lower cost. (Renewal of the plan depends on renewal of the contract.) Since prostate cancer is covered under Medicare, it has to be covered under Medicare Advantage. In other words, you can't be cancelled for having prostate cancer. My SCAN Venture Medicare Advantage plan has no deductibles. And like I said, the MOOP (for Part A and Part B services) is \$1000. In 2026, there will be a \$250 annual deductible for Part D drugs in Tiers 3 and higher. FYI, SCAN Health is a not-for-profit Medicare Advantage provider."

"My husband was thinking ahead and enrolled us in a Medigap part G plan just before he retired. 15 days in 2023 after our plan went into effect he was sent by Ambulance to the ER where he was diagnosed with AFIB and had 3 heart procedures in as many months. I had triple bypass surgery in February 2024 and we never received one single bill for any of it. Best decision we ever made."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplements (Which is Better?) · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=T3GhVv480m8&lc=UgxXoKsOS_Z8jwxpe4V4AaABAq

"I had same problem the past four years, plans kept going up,Started at 40 went to 98 and then 125 so I left that plan. We go online and research cost per medicine versus premium ,My other family member goes to their township building and they sit down with you bring meds or list of meds They will compare cost for premium and medication cost to you ,They tell you how much you save ,I do it my self online ,Well last 2 years for 2025 and 2026 Humana For Part D has been a zero premium and a big savings for me and my other family members Township told them same plan that I had picked ,So I compared ,My premium and theirs are Zero per month and I pay zero for 5 of my meds and the other 2 meds area both under 5 dollars each.and no premium ,Check and see if you have that plan in NJ."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=Ugyq-43B-8M-fR9msVh4AaABAq.Aahpm7MLiO5AahwUb5TzOg>

"You are absolutely correct....I'm an 83 year old CPA ret and selected Advantageeven with copays I'm aheadmy wife has a few things going on plus two back surgeries and we are ahead (biggest cost is shopping after appointment at Cleveland Clinic 😊) ...have never gotten close on max out of pocket....Rx is part of package"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwOz0U2FwkURjmYwMd4AaABAg.9XtnPfPWGsB9XvpY3XKSD8>

"Well let's see what I have I have United Healthcare Advantage plan I have zero monthly premium I have dental insurance I have vision insurance later on in life if I need hearing aids they are covered my drug plan also known as part d is covered at zero cost my monthly premium is zero cost I get up to a maximum benefit of \$375 toward any eyeglasses I get a additional \$350 every quarter on over the counter medication including medical equipment blood pressure monitor shower chairs raised toilet seat vitamins I paid 0 I can go to any doctor in and out of network without a doctor referral I have zero specialist 0 doctor copay if I go to the emergency room I pay 0 if I am admitted into any Hospital I pay zero my drugs are 3.50 prescription I have not had to pay any medication co-pays since August because at August my prescription drug costs so far was 25.000 bucks I also get free transportation to and from my doctor I get a free pair of diabetic shoes every year now you tell me what Medicare Plan can beat that??? I'll be waiting"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugxi-BJ7WpxJLsFGVvV4AaABAg.9UkMxX2Jeqw9Uqalsm6dR9>

"Is she happily paying those huge Medigap premiums that get bigger as she gets older, on top of premiums for a Part D drug plan and a dental plan? In over 11 years on my Medicare Advantage plan, the plan premium is still \$0, my MOOP for Part A and B services is still \$1000, I have no deductibles for Part A and B services, I pay \$0 to see any doctor, \$0 for labs, and get a \$55 Part B premium discount every month. The plan includes a \$0 premium Part D drug plan and a \$0 premium Delta USA dental plan. I see specialists 4 or 5 times a year for \$0. The \$600+ lab work for each visit costs me \$0. An \$80K hospital surgery cost me \$0. A \$15K outpatient surgery cost me \$0. A \$10K ER visit cost me \$85. A \$2K CT scan cost me \$0. The only copays I've had in 11 years were \$85 for the ER visit and about \$300 for Tier 3 (preferred brand) drugs. I've never had any issue getting authorization for anything my doctor deemed necessary. I've saved over \$30,000 by not having to pay Medigap premiums."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugw5dC0g1BZMxjki_R54AaABAg.AXCcpco9qRzAZVIDMmezHE

"Actually I just turned 65 and went with AARP United healthcare PPO. I like having dental coverage (plus \$750 towards cavities, caps, etc.) Most drugs are covered free, eye exams (\$150 towards eyeglasses, contacts), \$50 every quarter for vitamins, health products, etc, free gym membership, all for \$0 per month. My doctor and dentist were on the list. \$0 to visit primary doctor, \$30 for specialist. Doubt I'll ever hit the \$5,000 out of pocket limit unless I have cancer or something bad, but I definitely know I'll be putting out \$240 a month for gap insurance and \$1,000 a year for dental and \$40 a month for part d, if I go with traditional Medicare insurance."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyskpeYCd9tiUGclPt4AaABAg>

"I have supplemental plan F. I do not mind the increased premiums. This year with breast cancer my plan has paid 100% of all bills to date six six more chemo months to go. Over \$500,000 paid in full. What do I care if supplement price increase double digits. My suggestion to everyone is to buy the most expensive supplement plan offered. This video does us a disservice. But the one with highest premiums!"

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=Ugzamt44Birdf6dHuEt4AaABAg

↳ @1ladybug558 (2): "I disagree. Your viewpoint is unrealistic if you look at national average of social security income for retirees is roughly 25,000 per year with no additional income. yes many may have additional sources but most cant afford anything other than medicare advantage. I personally started with A B and plan G but realistically can not do that for very long. You obviously speak from a platform of you can afford it, you do not make the choice each month between rent, groceries etc. This is an informational video for those who can not imagine or thinks to do this depth of planning or even know that the costs need to be thought out to this degree. He is giving the info that one needs to begin thinking for themselves with real life scenarios to imagine the possibilities. You could take 2 people and do an anaylisis in 20 years with all the same coverage , one possible could have gone the cheaper? route and the other the most expensive and both have been wrong on their choices. I LOVE these videos and real life applications."

↳ @2023Red (0): "@1ladybug558 Yes. People without additional income to social security cannot afford to eat or pay rent many times. So advantage is their only choice. I get that. I do not know the stats to which you refer. But I do know there is a consequence to choice. In my world, you get what you earned. Good luck to you."

"Physical therapy was a joke and waste of time. Went to one session and went back to work where I got more therapy from the physical exercise of doing my job. Just a money grab. Had a heart attack and stents similar to his story and my advantage plan didn't cost anywhere near what is shown. My advantage plan costs \$0, he's not including in this the high monthly cost of plan G."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgzwcGeGPfflrlu1sbR4AaABAg>

"I combined my Federal retiree health insurance with Medicare and I do pay monthly for both. My Federal plan call it an Advantage Plan, I haven't had any problems. The plan actually kicks \$75 a month back to the Medicare premium, covers all deductibles and copays. Just had arthritis surgery on both wrists, zero out of my pocket."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypOamgls&lc=Ugwi25CDDz9SpwLcmMh4AaABAg>

↳ @BoomerBenefits (0): "That is great to hear!"

↳ @lovingjesus5184 (0): "Where do you live and what's the company and plan called?"

↳ @johnkowalkowski4269 (0): "@lovingjesus5184I was able to enroll in the Foreign Service Benefit Plan on the Federal Employees Health Benefit program. They contract with Aetna to manage it. The coverage is worldwide. I can live anywhere. The normal coverage is 10% copay in network and outside the US, 30% copay out of network in the US. Yearly deductible has been \$300, premiums are around \$500 monthly self&family. Once on Medicare, Medicare becomes 1st payer, the Federal insurance becomes 2nd payer. If I opt to combine them, which I did, Aetna waives both the deductible and the copays & knocks \$75 off the current \$185 for Medicare. If I travel out of the US, then the original plan coverage kicks in if I need it. I am still paying the normal \$500 a month premium to FSBP/Aetna to get this option, it is not a "\$0" Advantage Plan. I do not know how the other Federal Employees plans operate for retirees on Medicare."

"When I retired in 2003 I asked my drs billing clerk what is the best plan she told me AARP I picked plan F I've had two knee replacements with rehab for a week following in a beautiful facility no bill had foot surgery no bill recently week in hospital and week of in house rehab again no bill including ambulances in between all normal dr visits x rays etc I make my payment once a month and yes it goes up every year but as you get older you need the security of your plan. I also use their drug plan optim x same good service shipped next day delivery no bills unless you get 3rd tier or higher drugs my plan isn't available anymore so go for plan G"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugz9u00vrfogLYM9Hph4AaABAg>

"Great video explanations. We have great agent but still did not fully understand, even though she steered us to the Supplemental. I hardly ever get a bill and hit our deductibles fairly early in the year. Recovery from full knee replacement as i write and still no bills or hassles. A big question maybe you could answer, we spend 5-6 months in mexico. Why does medicare advantsg cover things down ghere bug regular medicare with supplemental does not. It is definitely a worry for us to have some sort of catastolhic insurance"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugz9u00vrfogLYM9Hph4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "If you have the right supplement it will have a \$50,000 of emergency care when traveling out of the country. there are, get this, 3998 different Medicare advantage plans for 2023. Of those only a handful has any international coverage and those that do are limited to urgent care, emergency care etc. I know of no advantage plan that has full service outside of the US. I have seen some ex-pats make videos say suggesting that the advantage plan has more care but they are absolutely wrong and don't understand that if an advantage plan finds that you are living outside the US they will simply cancel on you. Then you have nothing"

"I have the "part C" plan. I had a procedure recently that ran \$94,552.87 for the Hospital & \$2,972.00 for the Doctor to perform the procedure. I was in & out the same day. After negotiations, my cost was \$275.00 for the Hospital & \$0.00 for the Doctor. I have medications that run \$4,600.00 that my cost is \$0.00. My monthly premium is \$34.00 on top of my \$185.00 for Medicare. Next year it increases to \$44.00 per month, and ???? for Medicare. I understand the increase to be about 11%."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=Ugxxc_EDZdFYiXBM0Ep4AaABAq

"Wow, I must be extremely lucky with my Medicare Advantage plan. The only co-pay I've ever paid was for urgent care. I've had cancer three times and paid zero out of pocket for all related specialists, diagnostics, office visits, medication, surgeries. I did not have to pay for any physical therapy. My husband spent three days in the hospital and did not pay for anything. We have limited vision and dental coverage. Our premium is zero dollars."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxqrqBrSYlkgfaWQyDJ4AaABAq>

"My wife had a triple bypass and a valve put in her heart and with her supplemental insurance costing about \$250 a month we didn't pay anything."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgX65nxPaiJQphVwZh4AaABAq>

"Lady, you don't know what you're talking about. Medicare Advantage plans are in fact Medicare plans defined under Medicare Part C. Medicare Part C plans are plans offered by carriers that contract with Medicare to deliver Medicare coverage. Your Medigap supplement plan is in fact a PRIVATE secondary insurance plan, which means that if Medicare denies the claim, your Medigap plan won't pay a dime. You have a hard need to justify to yourself the high and ever-increasing premiums you pay for your Medigap plan, on top of your Medicare Part B premium, your Medicare Part D premium, and your dental plan premium. I have chronic conditions, yet in 11+ years on the same Medicare Advantage plan, I've never hit the plan's \$1,000 out-of-pocket maximum for Part A and B services, the plan premium is still \$0, I still have no deductibles for Part A and B services, I still pay \$0 to see any doctor, I still pay \$0 for labs, and I get a \$55 discount every month on Part B premium. The plan includes a \$0 premium Part D drug plan, a \$0 premium Delta USA dental plan, and free gym membership. My plan's network is huge, and I've been seeing the same doctors for 11+ years. I see specialists 4 or 5 times a year for \$0. The \$600+ lab work for each visit costs me \$0. An \$80K hospital surgery cost me \$0. A \$15K outpatient surgery cost me \$0. A \$10K ER visit cost me \$85. A \$2K CT scan cost me \$0. The only copays I've had to pay in 11+ years on the same Medicare Advantage were \$85 for the ER visit and about \$300 for Tier 3 (preferred brand) drugs. I've never had any issue getting authorization for anything my doctors deemed necessary. Apart for those copays, my only cost under my Medicare Advantage plan has been the Medicare Part B premium on which I receive a \$55 monthly discount. My Medicare Advantage provider is a non-profit with high customer satisfaction ratings and high Medicare ratings. When I first became eligible for Medicare 11+ years ago, the health insurance agents tried to steer me into a Medigap plan. I am so glad I did my own research and decided to choose Medicare Advantage. I've saved over \$30,000 by not having to pay high Medigap premiums that you love to pay to greedy for-profit private insurance carriers."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwKOLeUCqWShzOSNot4AaABAq.AZXbelrMiW9AZXzHvscAHo>

Covered anywhere they travel · 35 documents · 20 voices

"I've had a Medicare plan and a Medicare supplement plan for about 8 years. And the supplement plan pays whatever Medicare doesn't. Minus whatever deductible you choose. Monthly premium has gone up over the years. In some years I may have paid more for the plan than I got in services, but there have been years when it's literally saved me thousands of dollars. So over the time frame I've had it. It's definitely paid for itself not only financially but in not having to worry about having a procedure done. And not needing a pre-authorization. If my doctor says go I go I can go to any doctor. I want anywhere in the nation. Medicare advantage plans are basically private insurance. High deductibles, high rejection of coverage. Pre-qualifications. Looks cheaper on the front end but you're going to lose on the back end. So listen to this man"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 60 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=Ugxfb9YPgrZZhd4mdaR4AaABAq>

↳ @samuelbutterworth4303 (10): "NEVER take advice from someone that makes money from the choices they recommend, like this guy. I have a degree in Economics specializing in social insurance, and an MBA. I've had Supplemental and Advantage insurance plans. I prefer Advantage plans in my area. Zero premium, zero cost family doctor, every medical profession in my city are in network, I've never had any surgery or treatment turned down, my medications are all free except for one high cost brand and that costs me \$45 per month, free dental care, free eye exams and glasses, free hearing and discounted hearing aids. They have a national network of doctors."

↳ @patriciayohn6136 (7): "Absolutely agree with you and my Husband and I did the same thing and not sorry, we went with Supplement G plan. I had to have an emergency major surgery three years ago, spent seven days in hospital and I only had to cover about \$200.00 dollars!!!"

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (3): "Don't forget the bigger concern with chronic conditions and surgical needs. Quality of care. This is overlooked by almost everyone that signs up for Advantage Plans. They love the cost vs a supp plan until they need care. Seniors are dying prematurely every day because of these Advantage Plans."

"I was on Medicare advantage for 15 years because I'm disabled and I was too young to get a supplement plan. I turned 65 last year and switched to original Medicare with a Humana plan G supplement plan. I'm thrilled with this. I did have to buy a separate dental plan. But I know I can travel anywhere in the United States and I have the same coverage. And I don't get nickel and dimed to death. And I don't have to get approval for tests and surgeries. And I'm not going to be dumped. FYI, it doesn't matter what insurance company you choose for your supplement plan. They pay exactly the same. So don't spend a lot of money getting a Blue Cross plan when you can get a Humana plan that pays exactly the same and is a lot less expensive. But I do recommend plan G."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 60 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyaUtMfHKYB03d_PGZ4AaABAq

↳ @pursuehealth940 (15): "@georgebronson9486 they can't cancel plan G. They can stop accepting all insurance from one company, or all Advantage plans from all companies, but they can't stop accepting Medicare insurance or supplements. It's federally mandated."

↳ @georgebronson9486 (4): "How do you know hospitals won't start cancelling plan G? And then what?"

↳ @sarahdee374 (3): "could you share appr what your supp plan monthly premiums are? I've been on an Advantage plan for years, and happy with it, and pretty healthy too. But now I'm scared, but also don't want a high premium to pay ongoing. Thank you for sharing your experience."

"One Month Stays in Cities Across the United States My (60M) and my partner (66M) have recently retired. We have plenty of income and savings and no debt. I have private PPO medical insurance through my old job that will allow me to use doctors anywhere in the United States; we both have medical and dental insurance through the same source that is supported nationwide. As I understand it, my partner could choose original Medicare and have the same nationwide network that I do (he has an Advantage plan now through AARP). For a long time, we have wanted to sell our house and travel but not in an RV. Instead, we would like to use Airbnb to stay one month in interesting cities in the US and really get to know them and the areas near each. For instance, we could rent a condo in Nashville, Tennessee for about \$4,000 a month and get to know that city, as well as Memphis, the Great Smoky Mountains National Park, and Dollywood. Then, we could pack up and rent a place in Boston for a month; after that, maybe Washington, D.C. We will be traveling with our dog (outside of cost, this is another reason for the Airbnb instead of a hotel). Has anyone else done this? What problems did you not anticipate, from storage of household furnishings while traveling to restrictions on leaving your dog alone in the Airbnb to medical insurance difficulties?"

— r/retirement · 58 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/16a2089/>

↳ (0): "FYI For all married people in community property states like CA that own real estate you can get a 100% step up in basis on the death of a spouse but the property must be held a certain way. I'm a happily divorced guy so consult with your tax advisor. [In community property states, when a spouse dies, the total fair market value of the community property, including the part that belongs to the surviving spouse, generally becomes the basis of the entire property](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/estate-planning/605227/how-community-property-trusts-can-benefit-married-couples>)[1](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/estate-planning/605227/how-community-property-trusts-can-benefit-married-couples>)[2](<https://www.irs.gov/publications/p555>). However, there are some exceptions to this rule. For example, assets held jointly at death only receive a step-up in basis on half the property. And the assets in the surviving spouse's sole name are not stepped-up. [One way to avoid this is to have each spouse give the other a general power of appointment over his/her property using a "joint exempt step-up trust" or "JEST"](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/estate-planning/605227/how-community-property-trusts-can-benefit-married-couples>)[1](<https://www.kiplinger.com/retirement/estate-planning/605227/how-community-property-trusts-can-benefit-married-couples>).";

↳ (0): "Oh my gosh! This is exactly what my wife and I are planning to do! I (F59) just retired, and my wife (F52) is retiring at the end of this school year. We live in Charlotte, NC right now, and we plan to keep our house here but spend months at a time in more walkable places and really get the feel for them. Maybe we should meet up somewhere at some point! Our first place on our wish list will probably be the most expensive, NYC. We're looking at Brooklyn Heights. (We have dogs, too...of course we do, we're lesbians) so apartments will be the way to go over hotels. I second the advice about Whole Foods. Also Starbucks and Trader Joe's. Have you looked at the Blueground website? They have furnished apartments in major cities. Some pretty affordable. NY has a few other furnished apartment services that run a bit cheaper. Want to get in touch and talk about our similar plans? Send me a message if so!"

↳ (0): "I will definitely be getting in touch! New York City was my first choice, too, but I think I'd want to spend extended time there in either Spring or Fall...probably Spring. Walkability is always at the top of my list of needs for places I live. You know, even though San Francisco is getting a bad rap right now in the media, it's still a great place to visit: very walkable, with good public transit and LOTS to do within the transit zone (which extends two counties south, two north, and two to the east)."

"I had a friend that turned 65. Her local senior center would have Medicare Advantage "seminars". They weren't seminars! They were sales shows by companies to try and get seniors on their Medicare advantage plans! One year when she was traveling out of area and got sick, she found out the insurance wouldn't pay any doctors there. So she had to pay out of pocket. The next year she got someone to help her go through the Medigap plans and change her plan. The purveyors of Medicare Advantage are crooked and mislead people at a time in their life when they might not understand all of the ramifications. 🤔 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 55 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyMzVgrW_FZt4tuOmZ4AaABAg

↳ @randomgirlxrulz (0): "Sounds like those timeshare seminars at hotels that lure in tourists. Both massive scams"

↳ @carolkennedy8086 (0): "They were sales pitches!! AVOID ADVANTAGE PLANS !!"

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>;
— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/>

↳ (0): "In terms of coverage, traditional Medicare and a supplement is going to offer more choices and flexibility than a Medicare Advantage plan. Whether or not it's affordable for everyone is another story. The unfortunate truth is that more and more of our senior population is living on poverty wages and simply can't afford a Medicare supplement. Also, most retirees have been covered by managed care plans for a good portion of their working careers, so dealing with provider networks and utilization management is not a novel concept. With annual max of pocket costs under \$4000 for PPOs in my area, many of these individuals are choosing a zero premium MAPD option and paying for the care they use as they use it. Are MAPDs right for everyone? Of course not. But, the market has spoken on Medicare Advantage plans. More than half of the 65 million Americans on Medicare are currently enrolled in Medicare Advantage plans. They aren't going anywhere. It's important to discuss the potential risks of MAPDs, but it's not inherently the wrong choice. **Edited for auto cor-wrecks"

↳ (0): "I get several calls a day from foreign call centers regarding Medicare. They are frequently aggressive and sometimes vulgar. My latest weapon - your insurance license number... I ask: if you sell Medicare related products in my state you must be licensed, what is your number? The next sound is a click."

↳ (0): "This is correct!!! OP is very uneducated in Medicare... clearly!!!! and can be proven by going to Medicare.gov!!!! I hope this post was satire. But please y'all do not listen this this is not correct."

"I begged my ex-husband to get Plan G. He refused to even listen. A month ago, he face-planted on the cement steps and had to have emergency surgery for a broken neck. He's learning to feed himself, week 4. He will not walk for 6+ months, maybe never. His medical bills will be huge. He only has Medicare Part A and B. That's it. Sad, so sad. Plan G for me. I travel worldwide and it is the plan that covers me when out of the USA."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxI4OpWHL9YeqXAogZ4AaABAg>

↳ @vancebeazer458 (10): "It maxes out at 50k out of country. (Lifetime I think) get a travel supplement."

↳ @jacqueandrew1033 (6): "Medicare will not cover much out of country. You can try bcbs global. There are several other plans, but Medicare won't cover much."

↳ @barbararinger3529 (5): "My husband tripped and fell and had a tiny cut on his elbow.... Cleaned up a lil bandaid ... A month later he had a full blown bone infection.....easily over a million dollars worth of surgeries, etc"

"I have Medicare Advantage and love it. The premiums are low and the deductible is only \$150 with a \$1200 annual out of pocket including the deductible. That is the most I can spend on medical care in a year. I have a very long history of heart trouble with multiple surgeries and catheterization procedures not to mention the very sophisticated constant testing that goes along with it. I have never been refused anything recommended by my doctors. This past January I burned through the \$1200 in the first week. I have paid nothing for medical care since. I have no group nor preferred providers, I see any doctor I want and use any hospital. The coverage is good anywhere in the U.S. Emergency care and required procedures *anywhere in the world* are covered. I don't think it gets any better than this."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgyRPeulc_b6w8Q55up4AaABAg

↳ @kevinm-py1nt (1): "And what is the name of this miracle plan?"

↳ @jamesthompson3099 (1): "@kevinm-py1nt Aetna Medicare Advantage. It was arranged by my employer as a retirement option."

↳ @kevinm-py1nt (0): "Cool, thanks!@jamesthompson3099"

"I'm on a Medicare Advantage Plan and I've NEVER waited a month or longer for a pre-authorization. When choosing a plan I always verify my doctors accept such plan and that my medications are included. So far the only downside is when traveling one must seek care through the ER to be covered. Of course if relocating then one can immediately change back to original Medicare and pay for a Supplemental Plan (if one's available based on one's pre-existing conditions or can afford such) or simply select another Advantage Plan. I'm 100% covered, absolutely no out-of-pocket expenses as I'm on a Humana Gold Special Needs Plan due to a chronic condition. I'm thankfully blessed for such coverage as I seem to recall a Supplemental Plan would not be available to me under original Medicare due to a pre-existing condition."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugxy5ygsjGUNTl2sthZ4AaABAg>

↳ @lindagolden9892 (0): "@maryg1338 - I was born in NY, family throughout NY."

"I was fortunate to retire at a time when Plan F was still available, and will stay with it till the end. It gives me the security of knowing that I can travel this entire country and go to any doctor I choose without referral, urgent care, ER or hospital - my "sunburn" will be treated and my Daughter won't have to deal with the financial aftermath. That was an excellent comparison of plans, and I hope people will take the time to learn and understand how this critical choice can and will affect their retirement and future finances."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzrG9-ZUIH5ahvuiup4AaABAq>

↳ @hikerJohn (0): "@Theretirementnerds That's not much of a response. What's the point of the sunburn if there's no real interaction."

"I'm in a medigap plan, and it has been good so far. The monthly plan costs go up a little more than inflation for my plan each year. Because I travel a lot, I like being able to use a doctor anywhere in the US and even have some limited coverage overseas."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplements (Which is Better?) · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=T3GhVv480m8&lc=Ugz8Y5JQyCyLlKtdbLJ4AaABAq>

"I have an advantage plan and love it! never denied care or been delayed. I have had it 5 years. and it is a ppo. I can go to any doctor I want anywhere in the United States and I don't need any referrals."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRlOxmSo&lc=UgxaLqomxKqFNno0H0R4AaABAq.A1wcNx6624wA2OL5RyPEkl

"If you travel internationally, I believe Medicare Advantage won't cover you if something happens."

— YouTube · Medicare Parts A B C D Explained - Everything you need to know! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wci4BBmjXfo&lc=UgyNTpW6WkHBGlwM5AF4AaABAq>

↳ @PopsMdub (0): "Curious to know why @AbtinsuranceAgency is not replying to this statement. They should know the answer and either confirm or deny it."

"Thank you for saving me from making a horrendous mistake!! I am 66 -1/2 years old (3 months prior to my Full Retirement Age) and was about to sign up for the United Healthcare Advantage Plan this coming June 23rd (as suggested to me by my Landlady who retired last Sept. and said it was "great"!!), when my Broker will be calling me for the 2nd time. I just retired from Boeing on June 1st and have been setting up my Soc. Sec. Payments, my Boeing Pension and my Medicare which is to start on Aug. 1st as Boeing's Blue Shield Medical still covers me until July 31st. I sent this Video to my Broker asking him to please watch it prior to our appointment call. I am also moving from WA to TX the end of this Sept. so I especially loved your part about "going anywhere in the nation". Funny, I was only watching cat videos when your Medicare Videos caught my eye, and thought I should watch some of them to get "educated". I am so thankful for appearing just in time prior to making a decision!! Thank you so much!!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwYXfm2WEn37M14QTp4AaABAq>

"I have A&B and a high-deductible Medigap Plan F in Texas. Premiums are \$516/year. Deductible is \$2490. The most I will ever have to pay is \$3006. I'm 71, in good health, never go to the doctor, and mind my own healthcare. Should I need medical care, I can go anywhere I want. If I move out of state I'm still covered by Medicare. We are so fortunate to have the internet. The information is out there at your fingertips. Exercise and stop eating carbs and sugar."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgywUknBjsO1ExbmA6d4AaABAg>

↳ @g0989 (1): "Just an FYI- The High-Deductible Plan F deductible amount for 2024 increases to \$2800. So your maximum cost exposure increases to \$3316 next year, assuming no increase in your Supplement premium."

"I live in New York. If I enroll in Medigap Plan N with no coverage for excess charges and am traveling in another U.S. state such as Florida and get extremely ill or critically injured require hospital procedures in Florida, if there is excess charges by the Florida hospital or doctors, would I be responsible for those charges? And if I was on Plan G and traveling within US territories, am I covered?"

— YouTube · Best Medicare Supplement Plans - What's Changed for 2026 · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qQtzKellvypk&lc=UgzRoTM2z1eyC-w1qqx4AaABAg>

"Medicare Advantage plans are not reliable. They may be cheap to pay for but that is it. Subject to changes year to year. They are networked within a geographical area. When I turned 65 years old was recommended to buy a Medicare supplement plan G used along with regular Medicare Part B. A Medicare plan G is accepted anywhere in the US that accepts Medicare."

— YouTube · MGB Health Plan removes Dana-Farber Cancer Institute from Medicare Advantage network · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pbmX_8WIZs8&lc=UgwNhGdwQ-VPw9r012N4AaABAg

"Brian, great video. I might be wrong but it is hardly ever mentioned that with supplement plans can be used anywhere in the USA, but Advantage plans can only be used in your area, not good for traveling. Is this true, and if so why is this mentioned by all the companies that help you with insurance."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgyPiRiCuxyop_alO1J4AaABAg

↳ @medicare365 (1): "That's a good point."

↳ @ednaepperson6577 (0): "Why are you not discussing Medicare Advantage plans that have POS, which is Point of Service? @medicare365"

"In upstate NY for the "supplement/medigap/traditional I will pay \$305 at minimum...max is nearly 500, but I'm healthy ..and I'm gonna start out on the "no stress if I get sick" or the no stress if I go out of network or move anywhere in the USA plan Traditional with medigap, ahhhhh peace of mind"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement easy cost comparison. · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cz7BrmU1Guk&lc=UgxYFKVK59MQ0Y5ZrQ94AaABAg.AHqODvklhBhAHwQHSUfb5m>

"@Saratoga1972 I have an Advantage plan (Intervalley - in So Cal); it is a great plan since my wife and I have little to no medical issues. Our out of pocket expenses have almost exclusively been Dr. office visit co-pays. However, what he is saying has great truth to it for many seniors; especially if one has medical issues, and or travels a lot. Our network is very small geographically, so if the wife and I travel or are visiting relatives elsewhere, only an emergency visit is covered. We really like our plan for us as it stands, and as we currently use it... I would not presume to apply our situation and plan as the end all, neither would I use our experience to decry the information put forth on this site. When and if we move, I will strongly take into account the good info I received on this site. YMMV."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugx1dm-lamj-wu1PvoV4AaABA9_9ZCILW366mm9ZEaH0G6kE2

"Can changes to an advantage plan occur a few months into starting the plan? We shopped around in late 2024 for a new advantage plan for 2025 and I thought I found a perfect plan for her as she has a super fixed income and is widowed. The plan looked to cover all of the doctors and specialists she sees and the area she lived in. Then, in February of 2025, I believe, she received a letter from the advantage plan that she was no longer in a coverage area. She didn't received the letter until she received her first unexpected bill from labs or medical testing. We will be shopping again during this period, but what happened seemed so wrong, when I specifically made sure she was going to be covered, otherwise we would not have went with the plan in the first place. And if this does occasionally seem to happen, was there something we should have done so that she wouldn't have to travel for coverage or to change plans after the first of the year had already started?"

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=UgzKrJYkTgFDOXLjsPN4AaABA9>

Extras that actually paid: dental, gym, OTC, giveback · 32 documents · 20 voices

"Our Medicare Advantage Experience I have no affiliation with any health insurance companies and no particular ax to grind. I just want to share our experience because I see a lot of scary information out there about Medicare Advantage. We live in Florida and my wife has been on Medicare for 11 years and 9 years for me. The first few years we were on traditional Medicare with a Plan F HD supplement, then we switched to MA, first with Aetna and now Humana. We travel a lot so we needed PPO plans for all this time. We signed up for MA because it seemed like such a better deal than Medicare plus a supplement, and that has worked out well for us. We paid no premiums (other than the Medicare B premiums everyone pays) on Aetna and on Humana we actually get a \$175/month rebate towards the B premium. We have watched the co-pays for specialists go up frequently and now pay \$50 per specialist visit. Primary care visits have always been free. In spite of the bad reports on MA, we were very healthy and thought it would be a risk we could take. Five years ago my wife was diagnosed with a faulty mitral valve in her heart. The cardiologist checked it every year and this year he decided it was severe enough to require fixing. Fast forward several months and my wife is now recovering from open heart surgery, which was successful. She spent six days in the hospital and is getting twice a week home care from a nurse, a physical therapist and an occupational therapist. There were two tests that required procedures in an outpatient heart center at the hospital before her surgery. The total out of pocket for all this was about \$3,000. The hospital and physician charges billed to Humana were in the neighborhood of \$300K. We never had to deal with any refusals of coverage, balance billing or any other surprises. So our experience with a major medical issue was outstanding. For the 8 years we have been on MA, we've paid no premiums, had reimbursements for dental work and eyewear of at least \$20K and had no issues with finding good doctors and facilities in-network. Bottom line, who knows what surprises might await us as we get older and less healthy, but I have no complaints about our experience with MA so far. UPDATE: Thanks to everyone who contributed to this thread! It's clear that MA can be anywhere from great to awful, depending on the plans in your area and your individual health situation. I think the comments brought up great issues to explore before choosing MA or traditional Medicare with a supplement. I know we are risking challenges in MA if we move or networks change for the worse. But I calculate that we've saved roughly \$57k in supplement premiums (for 2 people) and received roughly \$20k in dental benefits over 8 years, so the risk was certainly worth it so far."

— r/medicare · 139 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tp8qt5/>

↳ (0): "I've had the same positive experience with my MA plan for 10 years. I'll go ahead and upvote you in preparation for the Reddit MA-Hating Mafia that will surely show up and tell you why we are stupid and shower us both with down votes."

↳ (0): "I had no opinion about this until I began taking my mother to medical appointments in NYC. It was astonishing to me how often the medical personnel would tell me it's a good thing my mom has original Medicare because they were able to refer us immediately to superior facilities for treatment. When she had to go to rehab, they took both of us for free (not a small thing in NY) directly from the hospital in a hospital car to a beautiful place that gave her great care (and fantastic meals I got to share). So now I am definitely biased. My mother would've had to wait a long time in pain and then accept lower quality care inside bargain basement places. For me, it made a huge impression to keep getting unsolicited opinions from hospital and medical office personnel that it was great my mom had original Medicare because the Medicare advantage plans had much tighter restrictions on referrals and many times we would've been sol. I trust the people who have to deal with getting patients treatment. We are Americans so we are being screwed either way, but a bit less screwed without for profit insurance companies. Good luck to us all who aren't emigrating for better health care."

↳ (0): "If you are in an area with a lot of providers and all your doctors are in network, MA can be fine. But now

ask most folks in rural areas about their experience. Also, in many places you can't get a MA PPO, which can be a dealbreaker. Everyone needs to do their own homework, of course."

"This is, hands down, the best video I have ever seen about Medicare insurance plans!! Fantastic job, and thank you! And I hope you recover quickly from your sunburn! BUT... I want to introduce a dimension that I was surprised you did not mention! That is, taking care of yourself! By that, I mean taking nutrition seriously for decades, maintaining an ideal weight, and working out regularly at a gym in old age so you never neglect your body's conditioning!! Now in our mid 70s, my wife and I have been "nutritarian" for 15 years. Nutritarian is a diet developed by Dr. Joel Fuhrman based on a 100% plant-based diet, only far more emphasis on nutrient-density at every meal. No added sugar, no animal products, no dairy, no alcohol, no bread, no added oil, no added salt. Just whatever comes naturally in the fruit, vegetables, nuts, grains, mushrooms, seeds, and sprouts (microgreens) that we eat at every meal. We go to our gym for a vigorous 60 to 80 minute resistance workout every 3 days (plus a 60-minute treadmill cardio workout on some off-days). We maintain ideal weight, take no medications, and my local doctor told me that I have the blood pressure of a healthy 18-year-old. MY POINT is that your own discipline over your peak nutrition and physical conditioning will have an enormous impact over your long-term health! We have a guy at our gym at age 95 still working out!! As Dr. Fuhrman says: "Your genes load the gun. But your diet and lifestyle pull the trigger!" As part of our Advantage plan, our gym enrollment is covered. That is \$100 a month savings for both my wife and myself. We do have a local insurance agent, but if we did not I would reach out to this agent with The Retirement Nerds! What an excellent explanation of all the insurance options! So, don't eat junk! Don't sit around in an easy chair drinking beer! Make peak nutrition your most serious hobby. Grow your own sprouts and microgreens like I do. Don't eat canned beans - instead eat beans you cook yourself from dry beans. We eat 18 kinds of beans I cook weekly in a pressure cooker. I plan to make it to 100+ unless I get hit by a truck! (And if that happens, insurance won't matter.) Best wishes!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 36 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugzq9b4ySEEjBX1HcUh4AaABAg>

↳ @norsemythos1438 (4): "Interesting story. I tend to agree with the concept...but in practice... eating only rabbit food and living to 100? I wonder if im better off enjoying the simple things and dying at 88."

↳ @flyshacker (3): "@norsemythos1438 Your choice! Remember, nearly all the things people call "old age" are really just neglect. Get your cremation and other final expenses paid for, and you're all set! I'll keep exercising, living longer, and I'll collect the gov't benefits you would have received. Fine with me!"

↳ @frankhodge7654 (1): "@flyshacker No matter what you eat, old age effects are very real. We were born with a guarantee of death. No one can live forever except in fantasies. We don't usually know our end date, but we all have one. Rabbit food for life is not a very enjoyable option."

"I have traditional Medicare along with my supplement plan. I love knowing exactly what I am responsible for each year, and I really love that I can get the treatment my doctor recommends without worrying about some greedy insurance company denying my care. Yes, I have to pay my monthly premium, plus separate policies for dental, vision, and prescriptions, but it's worth it to me."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=Ugzg_E5Vh8nOezLYz6V4AaABAg

"I was just telling my chickens how happy I have been with my medicare advantage plan for the past 11 years here in St Louis. But it was interesting to listen to you review the pros and cons of each, and reaffirm that I am where I want to be. I applaud you for taking the high road and not pushing a plan because of higher commissions. Very good content. One thing I am impressed with on my plan is that it seems to keep adding valuable perks: health fitness reimbursement and hearing aids are now covered. I feel very fortunate!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugwqh2TU8Gbd8W4gbY54AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for watching and sharing your experience!"

"Matthew, you have covered pretty much all the basics about Advantage vs Supplement plans as well as Part D for prescriptions. I don't know if you have any insight or suggestions in the area of vision and dental supplements not included in the basic plans. The plans I have seen cover the basics but significant dental work remains only partially covered and the annual limits are not all that high. I figured that saving the \$500-600 annual premiums for mostly just 6 month checkups and cleanings is worth the risk unless I knew that I would need some expensive work done in the future."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgxXC--saJ0G-03fnXZ4AaABAg.9Uk7K6gb2Su9UkDTiQjTJE>

"I love my advantage plan, i have not had anything denied, I've had two knee replacements, 3 back surgeries, trigger finger fixed all fingers on both hands and i have a monthly infusion that is 20,000 every 4 weeks. Absolutely nothing has been denied. MA for the win. Also i use the hell out of dental and vision i also love the 70.00 A month spending card."

— YouTube · MORE Medicare Advantage Plans CUT: Millions Will Face Forced Dis-enrollment ❌ · 7 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPLaLyfDZxY&lc=UgwRfwxGoyyoZ6A7iHJ4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicareSchool (3): "That's fantastic to hear, especially with a treatment history like that — a plan that's handled everything from major surgeries to a \$20,000 monthly infusion without denials is genuinely a strong track record, not something everyone experiences. And getting real use out of the dental, vision, and spending card on top of that is exactly how those extra perks are supposed to work. MAPD plans tend to work especially well for people who also have Medicaid or other government benefits layered on top, since that combination often minimizes the cost side of the equation. It's worth noting MAPD plans are still required to cover everything Original Medicare covers — the prior authorization process some people run into is real and does trip some people up, but clearly hasn't been the case for you. Thanks for sharing your experience — it's a good reminder there are real success stories alongside the more difficult ones people sometimes hear about."

↳ @ikestevens (2): "I'm curious, if you wouldn't mind, to know what plan you're on.. ? Thx :)"

↳ @matthewtaylor6564 (0): "What kind of plan are you on in Massachusetts?"

"I have to agree with you. I have a MA plan and have never paid anything for it for the past 6 years. Have not encountered any deductible or copay issues. I receive dental benefits and vision benefits worth thousands of dollars and I receive a quarterly \$60 benefit to cover non-prescription related medical expenses such as OTC meds, bandages, etc. I also received a silver sneakers gym membership at no cost."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyX3i-SNVhtfygRmJl4AaABAq.AO4bopsxi6yAP1F5geKxkM

"I'm on Medicare Advantage with United Healthcare. I've been on it for 5 years. It's been getting progressively worse every year. Scans that were covered are now \$197.00, dental xrays that were covered are now \$40.00, and on and on. I don't have serious medical issues, yet. I also don't have \$100,000 sitting in an account for when they do arise. My plan is, when things get rough, I'll have a blender, tequila. margarita mix, an Allman brothers album, a handgun and one bullet. Meanwhile, they'll be eating Maine lobster in the Whitehouse."

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=Ugw7ZdFw5bxkM66Dhvd4AaABAq>

↳ @Ofty5118 (1): "I'm sorry my Original Medical plan isn't covering everything for the ones on a Medical Advantage Plan, I know how you feel with my \$\$ increase also"

↳ @mariarella2021 (0): "Original Medicare doesn't include dental, vision or hearing Advantage plan do to entice now the medical reimbursement is low from CMS you are seeing those extra benefits reduced"

"Yes my mother has one too and it has saved her a lot of money over the last 3+ years. I guess this guy talking can pay his 20% coinsurance of traditional Medicare if he wants to. To each their own or whatever floats your boat I guess is the saying goes? Because my mother's plan has dental, vision, even has OTC built into it or she can go to CVS and get \$360 worth of merchandise every quarter. That comes in handy. I don't know what he's talking about. She had a surgery done all she paid was her co-pay."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgyZK63nR-xAGzMqI_J4AaABAq.9ZMHOjWarwt9c38MRY2HYY

"Well let's see what I have I have United Healthcare Advantage plan I have zero monthly premium I have dental insurance I have vision insurance later on in life if I need hearing aids they are covered my drug plan also known as part d is covered at zero cost my monthly premium is zero cost I get up to a maximum benefit of \$375 toward any eyeglasses I get a additional \$350 every quarter on over the counter medication including medical equipment blood pressure monitor shower chairs raised toilet seat vitamins I paid 0 I can go to any doctor in and out of network without a doctor referral I have zero specialist 0 doctor copay if I go to the emergency room I pay 0 if I am admitted into any Hospital I pay zero my drugs are 3.50 prescription I have not had to pay any medication co-pays since August because at August my prescription drug costs so far was 25.000 bucks I also get free transportation to and from my doctor I get a free pair of diabetic shoes every year now you tell me what Medicare Plan can beat that??? I'll be waiting"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugxi-BJ7WpxJLsFGVvV4AaABAq.9UkMxX2Jeqw9Uqalsm6dR9>

"My sprit animal is lioness. I just filtered through all the plans in my area. When I printed out details of my Advantage plan options - almost everything on the coverage lists require prior authorization now. 🤔 guess everyone needs to learn how to do appeals!! I'm going with a giveback plan because it's the most predictable expense. I've been through a code denial and learned a lot!! Higher out of pocket total but I only use doc & bloodwork little. I know we will all get sicker in the future but ... meanwhile, affordable plan matters most. Health is unpredictable. Thank you so much for your helpful analysis!!!! 🙌🙌🙌 YOU're the best!!!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgyC6CE6gK1MZieFULF4AaABAq>

↳ @douglasjensen8986 (2): "In a recent video, he demonstrates that most appeals are successful. (Moo! hahaha raised on a dairy farm!)"

"I would like add something also on cost. I have been on Medicare Advantage for 9 years now and it's been great, no big surprises yet. I am a Masters Swimmer and the gym membership with Advantage Plans have saved me about \$700-\$1,500 per year by being able to work out at Lifetime, LA Fitness, 24 Hour, the YMCA etc. To stay in shape and protect my health. It's a very overlooked benefit"

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRlOxmSo&lc=UgxN60BrjDQjghUSUxF4AaABAq_A2h-8ZSB3rCA2hDRACeDk8

"I have Aetna MA... I really like the PPO dental it includes and the \$50 OTC and \$60 healthy food quarterly coverage, but do not love the healthcare part... Grrrr"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=Ugwknt37IWCrWNNv_d4AaABAq

"Your video is misleading at best. First, you talk about the MA max out of pocket. You are right, that is the max allowed by law, and since I don't know everything about everywhere, I can't say what percent of plans come close to that but in my area, there are 34 plans available. Of those 15 have in-network max out of pockets under \$5,000. As far as give backs of the part B premium, 17 offer givebacks over \$10; two available to everyone offer more than \$100/month give back. and 3 offer \$1.00 per month give backs. Those "limited" dental benefits--you'll find limited benefits with any dental insurance, but most MA plans pay for your check-ups and cleanings and give you something toward major work. Changing plans as an indication of dissatisfaction? Maybe, or maybe it is a sign that another plan better suits your needs this year--a doctor you want to see is in-network, a drug you are on has better coverage, you need major dental work and that policy has more dental benefits, or you moved an another hospital is closer so you want it in-network--or maybe you dug around and found that another plan costs a lot less. Compare my MA plan to a \$50/month Plan G-HD, in a year with no major expenses and we save \$40/month on the give back, \$20+ per month on Part D, \$300/year for dental cleaning and check up, \$200/year on glasses, \$200/year on non-RX drugs etc, and \$50/month on the gym membership (which we use, and which we get coupons worth another \$50 for using) and we save close to \$2700. The max out of pocket on the plan is \$2900, and give the low costs at point of service, it is tough to reach. Yes, we accept that we are limited to in-network docs but we picked the plan because it is affiliated with the system all out doctors work for. If you want to talk access to doctors across the country or lack of prior authorization as the pluses for supplements go ahead, but when it comes to cost, MA wins hands down."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgzNyPI010dHfhQ7f_d4AaABAq

"@sealevel14.7 I have a Plan N Medigap and am very pleased with that. If you are not constantly seeing a doctor, Plan N is usually the better deal than Plan G, as you will save on the monthly premium. Plan N does have \$20 co-pays when you see a doctor, but the premium difference (between Plan N and G) more than compensates. Sadly, not everyone can afford both a Medicare and a Medigap premium. Dental is not covered by Medicare+Medigap, so I pay \$50 per month for a separate plan with Delta Dental, which has good/comprehensive dental coverage. Medicare Advantage plans are deceiving ... and designed that way, on purpose with lots of cheap "trinkets" in lieu of solid/comprehensive coverage! There is an illusion of coverage in all areas, but it's somewhat for basic stuff only. With Medigap, you do pay up front/every month, but then most medical procedures, including major/chronic stuff (excluding dental, vision) are covered at 100% ... 80% by Medicare and 20% by Medigap. With Advantage, there is an initial low cost, but there are expensive co-pays, networks, denials of coverage, etc. As seniors age and start to have more chronic health problems, they often try to switch back to traditional Medicare+Medigap to cut costs, but they cannot pass underwriting ... so are now trapped in an Advantage plan for the rest of their life. Many healthcare providers have stopped taking Advantage, due to problems with being reimbursed by insurers. If you can guarantee you will never have any serious/chronic health problems for the rest of your life, then Advantage is a good deal. With Advantage, the insurance company controls your health care, but with Medicare+Medigap, your doctors control your healthcare" — YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugzc_CkfUiS7A8RGWs14AaABAg.AOIHGUuVOyHAPaO2DPNnLn

"I worked in a billing office for a large hospital in our area for many years and agree with everything you have said here, and it always amazed how often the patient would enroll in one of these Advantage plans think they had both Medicare and the Medicare Advantage plans. Not sure where but recently I heard if you enroll in an Advantage plan then during the next open enrollment period you wanted to return to the traditional Medicare plan you would first have to get permission from the Advantage plan to leave. As to the Advantage plans offering Hearing, Dental and other non-covered by Medicare benefits very often many providers offer an uninsured rate that is equal to or better than what is being offered by the Advantage plans. Could you please address questions, I am sure there are those who would benefit in knowing before they enroll."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzcnnrKLfrHjJ-MKx4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "You do not need to request permission to leave your Advantage Plan, you can always drop an Advantage Plan and return to Original Medicare between Oct 15th - Dec. 7th, or Between Jan 1st - March 31st annually. I hope this helps!"

↳ @commonsense6967 (0): "Good luck finding an "uninsured" rate for dental, vision or hearing that is less than what the insured rate is. (I know my dental insured rates are considerably less than what my dentist charges for uninsured.)"

"@jacqueandrew1033my advantage plan's dental, vision and hearing were great. It covered 2 cleanings, X-rays, bitewings, fillings and extractions, a reduced price for crowns and root canals. \$2k for hearing aids, free vision tests + \$200 towards glasses each year. Also got \$80 on plan debit card every quarter to pay for anything in the OTC pharmacy section and a free gym membership. Plus, a free dental plan. Lasted 2 years but they're not offering it next year (I wondered how they could offer all that! Ha, I guess they weren't making enough money)! Also never needed prior approval and had an extremely extensive network. Because they won't be offering that plan anymore, I can choose to go over to original Medicare with no medical underwriting."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxYpmmH1xA2l5U2i_p4AaABAg.AOy68sh-D6wAPA7r6aLdKg

"Great content (Giraffe)! I'm on SSDI and have know idea what to choose, but decided on an Advantage plan. Although I'm not sure that is the best. I'm a Veteran and love using the VA for hearing, because the Advantage hearing benefit sucks! It's even getting to where the once 50 dollar quarterly amount given to enrollees for over the counter meds has now decrease to 25 a quarter. This next year I'm looking to possible change to regular Medicare and get the supplemental G. It's a shame that billing places will not give you their opinions on which is the best. I do however dislike paying for something that is not used and the gym membership and over the counter meds seems worthless to me even though in the beginning were used."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgzIEwQpJPoGkzpp6lh4AaABAg>

"Their number one goal is to make profits. But then doctors are contributing to the problem. On two occasions in my instance. Once it was - I was recommended "ablation" that after I watched severla videos on youtube I found out that I should not be a candidate for ablation because I had only on incident and it was caused by the botched dental procedure, but Medicare pays for ablation so cardiologist referred me for that procedure - I did not go with his recommendation - it was 6 years ago and I still did not have a second incident (I'm now 78). The other one was surgon who recomended that I go to cut out thyroid node. After seeing me just once. ."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgyXo5Dmx9zksfFeC3l4AaABAg.AZxE23MQfAxAaTf0bZAFK1>

"You omitted two serious disadvantages of tradition Medicare + supplements: 1) You guessed that supplementary plans would cost maybe \$100/month in premiums. My AARP supplementary plan at my age (76) has \$265/month premiums. Some difference! 2) Medicare Advantage, unlike traditional Medicare, covers some degree of dental care. A friend of mine had some major dental surgery which was partly covered to the tune of \$6,000 by Medicare Advantage. In my case, I need to replace crowns, and was quoted a cost of \$2,300 by a dentist for just one of them. I wish you had discussed this matter more thoroughly and honestly."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugy1XkfW8raf1gOM_jV4AaABAg

Found an agent or broker they trust · 27 documents · 20 voices

↳ @francesb6758 (7): "You made the right choice; don't listen to the others. MA Advantage might look tempting and cheaper, but wait until they're a bit older and their health deteriorates. If they need physical therapy, for example after a surgery, they'll be on the hook for a co-pay for EVERY PT visit. Or for repeated eye injections for retinal problems -- each repeat visit hits them with another co-pay. A friend used to work for a retinal specialist; she had to deliver the bad news about MA co-pays every day. Remember the old saying: Cheap is expensive in the long run."

↳ @sheila7814 (1): "Thank you. I have cancer and am just now making these decisions because I turn 65 soon."

"I went with the HDG plan, my agent who is a friend wasn't offering it but agreed it was the best fit for my wife and I and he contacted the insurer and handled it for us. We are 3 years in without any health issues and have saved about 6K in G premiums so moving forward we could have several years with large medical expenses and still be ahead of the game."

— YouTube · High Deductible Medicare Plan G: The "Secret" They Don't Tell You About! · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFEb0FiEpB4&lc=Ugzs_Ta08W530jcH1VI4AaABAg

↳ @billjones4986 (5): "As a senior your in good health until your not,things could change quickly."

↳ @bugsy2902 (1): "@billjones4986 Looking at the increase of premiums of G or N over the years and being trapped by medical underwriting this seems the only solution for many seniors on a fixed income. I know that I can't pay hundreds of dollars a month for a medigap plan plus another couple hundred for Medicare plus potentially 2K plus Part D drugs on a fixed income. And I don't want to be in a Disadvantage plan with MOOP of \$9K while they delay and deny care! I was so looking forward to Medicare and not having to fight for care till I saw how outrageously expensive it is. How many times I've had to fight calling the state Ins Commissioner and Dept of Labor to get my bills paid even HR! And I know many others don't bother and just pay what they shouldn't have to or let it go to collections because of the corrupt insurance mafia in America! I'm on Obamacare and had my first preventative colonoscopy 100% free but Anthem tried to stick me with \$6K from the hospital! After a month of fighting to finally get a resolution billing rep in US she finally fixes the hospital bill but tries to leave me to pay \$2k out of network anesthesia bill! She only fixed it when I threatened to file a complaint with Senator Tammy Baldwin and also the No Surprises Website! I never expected to have to fight like that for what is federal mandated as FREE!"

↳ @paulmarc-aurele5508 (0): "@billjones4986I you are certainly right but with HDG your maximum deductible would be \$2400 more than a G plan other than that the same.. in our first 3 trouble free years we have save about 7K in premiums."

"I have just signed up for Medicare and went with the advantage plan. My agent went through everything with me including the fact that I rarely go to doctors. He suggested that the advantage plan seemed to be the best fit for me. He also warned me that if I change my mind next year and want a supplement plan instead then it may have to go through underwriting before I am approved for it. If I had unlimited funds, I would have gone with a supplement but unfortunately when you go on social security, your income goes down not up. I did also take an extra cancer plan that would cover any out-of-pocket expenses for the current year that I use it. I think the agent I had did a great job explaining everything to me. He even read and explained every line of the plan I was signing up for before I signed anything. I think the best thing and most important thing you can do is to have a good agent to help you. Btw, I think your videos are the best I've ever seen! Here's the animal, I watched everything! 🦒 "

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 24 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxCOrHIJenu2qzwdXZ4AaABAg>

↳ @JohnJohn-wr1jo (11): "Flo, unfortunately your agent was looking out for his best interests since there is no "advantage" to the agent when you sign up for Medicare. Advantage Plans are back end loaded. U save initially because let's face it, why would anyone pay the same for an inferior product. The advantage plans costs will catch up with you later in life when you can least afford it. Even more alarming will be the quality of care provided later in life with the Advantage plans. Managed Healthcare is ignoring elderly seniors needs and literally allowing thousands to die every year in the US. I've witnessed it first hand with elderly family members and friends who can't get appointments with specialists and necessary tests and care in a timely manner. Stay healthy and you will be fine and save money. Very few of us are able to do it. The odds aren't in our favor."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (9): "@kimdiedrich9712 correct. Premiums for supplement plan carriers are in addition to Medicare Part B premiums, and with a Plan G, you still have the Medicare Part B deductible (\$240 in 2024). However, with a supplement plan G, you don't need to pay the Part A deductible. The supplement plan takes care of that."

↳ @Theretirementnerds (4): "Sounds like your agent did a great job, which makes us so happy! Thank you for sharing your experience and watching (especially to the end) 😊 "

"Within 24 hours, someone reached out to me and was able to answer my questions about Medicare. Your agent, Jaqueline, was excellent. Thank you for what you do!"

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 22 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgyBqisgvyC2Ent55oR4AaABAg>

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (2): "Thank you for giving us a call!"

↳ @blondeevan4731 (2): "@KadenMaguire-jj4py You are highjacking this video! Stop!"

↳ @KadenMaguire-jj4py (0): "@AbtInsuranceAgency Jesus loves you ❤️"

"I am 74 years old and still I'm working part-time. I no longer have my sweet little half yorkie/half dachshund, so no issues there! Haha! I currently have plan N and pay about \$180 a month. I live in a rural area, but often I am in a larger city since my wife works there. So far, so good with the plan N. I do not plan to change, but only recently, the advantage plan became available in our county. I have a good agent who has given me seasoned advice, and I appreciate him. I've never watched a YouTube video on this in my life, so I appreciate yours. Well done!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugz4CHLm_QdyfGoysT14AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "So glad you found us. Appreciate you sharing your experience! Sorry to hear your dog is no longer with you"

"My wife enrolled in Medicare last year and I enrolled just this year. We worked with a wonderful agent (versed in both Traditional Medicare, Medicare supplements and Medicare Advantage). I was diagnosed with prostate cancer three years ago and subsequently had a radical robotic prostatectomy and was just recently diagnosed with coronary heart disease. Thankfully, our household income is such that we could afford to go with the Cadillac option - Plan G. I feel confident in our decision and the advice we were given by our agent."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=Ugw7PGKFf2w5Q8aIK0h4AaABAg>

↳ @sharondoty45 (0): "@TimMcLarty-q5p How did you handle your own insurance after your wife went on Medicare? Were you on the unaffordable care act marketplace? We'll be facing this, and I'm thinking plan G won't seem so bad after the ACA rigamole. Also, you had no problem getting approved?"

"My agent of 8 years was surprised when I told him my plan was ending and I was now eligible to buy a medigap plan. He said he would send me some plans to review, but he never did, and did not return my messages. Also, I called an agent I found online and he was so very helpful and nice, but when I explained I had been on Advantage for 8 years, he said oh, in that case, agents won't work with you, they won't get paid. He said I have to call each company to purchase the plan myself. Very strange...it sounds as if the companies are being compensated to take on "Advantage Returners" with the commission normally paid to agents..."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxCOhpK38o-_jmdIJN4AaABAg.AOs_MoBrGwvAPdBK7fuYgn

"Erik, first time Medicare 8/1/26 in PA. I have been educating myself for 6 months with your videos which are the CADILLAC of education! Your agent Kelli has been amazing and we are finalizing things next week. I fit Plan G perfectly except I am healthy and want Plan G because I know those big bills and sickness will come one day. I am willing to pay for peace of mind all day long! Thanks!! Keep up the great work and honesty!"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgxjVUUJ6-aL8oMLjEN4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much, Lisa! You are awesome and so glad you got to meet with Kelli! 😊"

"My wife is on the group plan for retirees with Medicare which mimics my retiree plan without Medicare. We met with an advisor and yes the original plan with a part D may have been cheaper we decided to stay on our large group retiree plan. As we were leaving the advisor did say a group plan is a great way to go."

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgxMpGQzqopwW1qr39x4AaABAq.9xB53XTV_4oAA-QLHZoZhH

"I am 77 years old and currently in a Medicare advantage nightmare. At first I had original Medicare with a supplement. I was looking for a way to cut my costs but still have decent health insurance. So a friend of mine said there was a lady who worked at Walmart that you could walk in and talk to and she was a good broker. Taking my friends advice, I did that, got into a Medicare advantage plan, which I've had for two years. I am really feeling stupid for not doing more research but Medicare and capitalism have made this process so complicated, that one must do extensive due diligence before deciding on a plan. I was diagnosed with rheumatoid arthritis about five or six years ago. As my symptoms are advancing, my RA doctor recommended some better but higher price drugs. I started looking into it and found that Medicare advantage will not pay for these drugs. Out-of-pocket cost run at least around \$5000 per year. Also, since I have RA, it is almost impossible for me to get back to original Medicare. I am devastated and not sure what I'm going to do. I have been talking to your Medicare seminar agents and am seeing if there are any possibilities left. It does not look promising."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgxSutev5rw74ep6rTx4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "All Part D plans, including those bundled with an Advantage Plan, must cover at least two prescriptions from every category of prescription. In addition, there are six categories of drugs that the insurance company must cover substantially all drugs available. Autimmune disease is one of those categories. If you can't get a drug it is for a reason other than "not available"."

"Great video explanations. We have great agent but still did not fully understand, even though she steered us to the Supplemental. I hardly ever get a bill and hit our deductibles fairly early in the year. Recovery from full knee replacement as i write and still no bills or hassles. A big question maybe you could answer, we spend 5-6 months in mexico. Why does medicare advantage cover things down here but regular medicare with supplemental does not. It is definitely a worry for us to have some sort of catastrophic insurance"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgzbdO8nBjNnKb22chV4AaABAq>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "If you have the right supplement it will have a \$50,000 of emergency care when traveling out of the country. there are, get this, 3998 different Medicare advantage plans for 2023. Of those only a handful has any international coverage and those that do are limited to urgent care, emergency care etc. I know of no advantage plan that has full service outside of the US. I have seen some ex-pats make videos say suggesting that the advantage plan has more care but they are absolutely wrong and don't understand that if an advantage plan finds that you are living outside the US they will simply cancel on you. Then you have nothing"

"I need help, PLEASE. need to pick an insurance plan for my mom soon, and have no idea what is going on. Please tell me where to start? Is there an honest broker, company to get information and/or sign up with? I REALLY, really appreciate your help as I am so lost in this complicated world of Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgwhhfoQ20O14O0XKNR4AaABAq.A9chL9PXI99AB4DnNECKNs>

"Eric thank you, thank you for your plain informative talk!! My husband & I are both on advantage plans because it is what we can afford. We list our broker and are in CT and don't have a clue how to find a new trustworthy agent/broker 😊 ("Love and Other Ways of Dying" by Micheal Paterniti)"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gqTv-u6Polc&lc=UgzL2KojwG02aRq1U754AaABAq>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching (to the end)! The tricky part is that the only way to get a new independent agent to officially be your Agent of Record is to switch insurance companies. If you like your advantage plan and that company, we wouldn't want you to switch out of that."

↳ @kathleenarcand3728 (0): "@Theretirementnerdsgotcha. I also see ads that Medicare.gov can be helpful as well... Drs also can be in network at one location but not another:"

"I'm going on Medicare this October, I have a broker but have not had much good guidance, your video was very helpful and I'm starting to understand it better. My cat also watched with me! 🐱 "

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzDqQUhP37HWZ825DF4AaABAq>

"Advantage plans(most are zero cost, some have monthly premiums) you have to stay in network - especially with HMOs. You can go out of network but that doctor has to accept the plan terms. Has copays, sometimes deductibles. Usually has dental/vision/hearing and other "perks" Includes part d (medications) Medigap (has a monthly premium)(premium goes up over time) - goto any doctor that accepts Medicare. Does include part d(medications) Separate part d plan (also monthly premium) General rules(vary by state) Medigap - no underwriting when first eligible(6 months from medicare start date) If he starts with an advantage plan.(12 months to switch to a medigap plan with no underwriting). If he starts with a medigap plan and switches to an advantage plan at any point (12 months trial period to switch back to his medigap plan)(once in his lifetime) Some areas do not have a great network with advantage plans(typically more rural areas) Say he purchased a medigap plan g for 145/m and part d for 50/m. He total per month would be 195 195 x 12 = \$2340 for the year medigap/part d (will go up as he ages). Advantage plans have max out of pockets. Depends on your location. Where I live they range from 4900 to 8000 a year max out of pocket(most you will pay for the year) Can offset these max out of pockets with a hospital indemnity plan.(A plan that basically pays you when you get sick)(More complicated) You want to look at the now and into the future. Your access to doctors in your area. Medigap plans are a lot easier to use. Advantage plans require a bit more attention to what you are doing. Depending on his financial situation (if he qualifies for any extra help/Medicaid.) or will in the future it all really depends on a lot of factors.). Medicare.gov for resources. Find a good broker that knows what they are doing. Don't take the first guy that calls you on the phone. (They do not charge) Also check with wherever he retired from (federal?teacher? state?) they may have programs for healthcare into retirement as well."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ep6jo4/why_do_people_say_never_get_an_advantage_plan/lhip37b/

"Blue Cross terminated my Medicare Advantage coverage at the end of 2025, along with millions of other people! I immediately signed up for a Medicare Medigap plan for 2026; however, they couldn't start my coverage until February, 2026! In the meantime, I became very ill in January, and had no Medigap coverage, so the hospital wouldn't treat me until I paid in cash, the amount that a Medigap plan would pay! I had to pay thousands of dollars in Medical care for the month of January! So, your viewers need to know about this! I had to go in debt, in order to pay the hospital! Blue Cross did NOT give me much notice about being terminated! Also, one needs to have a good agent, to advocate!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwVWftzhPuyHrtkUGB4AaABAg>

"As long as you're covered by group health (20+ employees), you cannot enroll in Medicare. The good news is you can retain all the benefits of a first-time enrollee to Medicare until employment or group health coverage ends, EVEN IF you're past the traditional enrollment period for Medicare (the three months before and the three months after the month you turn 65)! A lot can change in 7 years. I'd wait til then to analyze plans. A good broker can help you, as well as the govt website for Medicare. As for me, I'm getting off my husband's insurance when I turn 65 because Medicare is cheaper than dependent coverage."

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=Ugz36AeAPvIQdF50QoN4AaABAg.A1tczjNQYTtA4a4wMHdORa>

"I oversee my brother's care. We found him a great Medical Advantage plan last year through a broker. A good broker will find a great plan. My brother's plan is an HMO which is annoying, BUT he has \$0 copay's and his plan pays him \$250 a month for groceries and medical expenses. He qualified for this plan because he has a dual diagnosis — mental illness and diabetes. I am wondering how long this plan will be so good, but it's great right now."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1vj5rq/cant_use_medicare/p2nb8a9/

"@CLOLopez-fo8tu , I am sure you are correct. That's why having an honest broker like Medicare School is so important. I live in Connecticut and do all I can to inform and educate my friends and acquaintances. Having retired from the insurance industry I know how difficult it can be to navigate and staying informed about the options we have. Oh, and my choice was traditional Medicare plus a Supplemental plan G."

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgzMcYUJix61shxqoz54AaABAg.A77gU6Exj18A78KB3nDS03>

"I am very fortunate that I dont sunburn and I love the sunshine. Great video..found your channel by the algorithm suggestions. Great info. I do use a broker who is amazing. My husband 77 and myself 66 both have Advantage plans in AZ and have been so happy with our choice. We are both very healthy and work to keep our health and be active."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzN6c6nNTJtWfy79wF4AaABAg>

Glad they kept Original Medicare (or got out in time) · 22 documents · 20 voices

"I thought about getting one of these plans but found out the doctor I'd had for many years was not in the network. I worked in the Scheduling department in a hospital and We dealt with these insurance plans and some of them thought they knew more than the doctors. I'm glad I chose original Medicare and a supplement. I want my doctor and I to make the decisions."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Be bQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtIF4AaABAq>

↳ @nancybryant4325 (3): "@paul2019monte my neighbor has an advantage plan and is pleased with it. I don't think she pays for it. I pay \$144 a month for my supplement but it gives me some peace of mind that I will have good coverage if I become really sick. No matter how healthy we think we are, as we age things can happen to our bodies. I am not wealthy but I know a couple ladies who live on less than \$1000 a month and paying that premium might be hard or impossible for them."

↳ @paul2019monte (2): "@nancybryant4325 Thank you again for your response. I had been told by someone I trusted that I should be on Medicare. I do not have lots of expenses now but I can see that investing before I need it, which most of us definitely will, will give me more security if something major were to happen. I also find most of the so-called benefits of the advantage plan actually not that valuable when I try to use them. And no I don't use referrals because often when I have asked for a specific referral I have either been denied or the payment to the caregiver is denied even though a legitimate referral and I paid a copay. Here I am talking about physical therapy which now I pay out-of-pocket and don't even bother trying to get the referral. I negotiate for a cash price. Many won't take my plan anymore anyhow because of the endless denials, etc. Someone is paying for all those slick commercials bombarding us."

↳ @takearight. (2): "@paul2019monte indirectly being paid by....you guessed it... We do through our ins premiums..."

"@ckstaff Glad we have original Medicare."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAq.9y9FObqFd7m9y9eDCbfzRy>

"The thought of fighting to get approved for a procedure alone makes me glad we did not choose the advantage plan. It's so nice not to worry about it. I wanted to bring up Good RX, a prescription app. We pay for the cheapest part D drug plan. We hardly ever use it. We have our pharmacist compare prices with our Part D and with Good RX. Most often Good RX is cheaper, by a lot!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkb QjBtBsw&lc=Ugz-YE5bCMBTd4HKVoF4AaABAq>

↳ @themedicarelife4939 (0): "You may to look up GlickRx as well."

↳ @craigharris702 (0): "Hello 🙋 Victoria how are you doing today?"

"i am glad i went with Medicare part a part b plan N and VA health care and a tiny part d"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=Ugz7aAfpnSHwj3_Ga3Z4AaABAq

"The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAg.AXFFtsLMytJAZXHpuUtXFuU>

"I am so glad I knew enough to totally steer clear of Disadvantage plans."

— YouTube · MORE Medicare Advantage Plans CUT: Millions Will Face Forced Dis-enrollment ❌ · 7 likes · http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CPLaLyfDZxY&lc=Ugz7roYLZl1u_IsR9U14AaABAg

↳ @lindastewart6537 (2): "They really want you to die when you can't earn your own way. It is a bad world for the elderly."

↳ @lindastewart6537 (1): "I did that the first few years but it got too expensive for me so I had no choice but to switch to advantage. I only get social security now. Was forced to retire at 67 because of three shoulder surgeries in one year. 77 now and still have problems with my shoulders."

"I'm so glad I didn't get sucked into any plans and just stuck with regular medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgxNQQjGln8eKueEwrp4AaABAg>

↳ @m.w.420 (1): "@MorgueMaid Me too! That's probably why those money cards were issued with those who already had part A and B. They qualified for the cards to help with their food bills, electric, medical bills etc.. I told them no thank you."

↳ @patditella1852 (1): "@MorgueMaid - The regular Medicare is what he's talking about in this video. Your supplement plans are what continue to skyrocket in costs. Add that cost to your part D supplement (Drug plans) and only the more affluent can afford them. Advantage Plans are much less expensive. I'm on original Medicare as well, but now I may be reconsidering and switching to an Advantage plan."

↳ @Dano-MX5 (0): "I love my Medicare Advantage Plan. \$0 monthly payment, low co pays on major surgeries (knee replacement, heart stent) all my prescriptions are free (6) except my Brilinta and ED Rx. They cost \$118 (insurance pays \$1200) and \$16 every 90 days. All the hand wringing about Advantage plans is unwarranted in my opinion. It has its issues but I trust the private sector with minimal government oversight wayyyy more than the 100% federal government department to manage our healthcare."

"Get the best you can. Because I had always been healthy and then when I turned 65 I had uterus cancer, then breast cancer. Then, I had reconstruction surgery for that. Then, I had a gallbladder surgery. Then I had the reconstruction taken out because it didn't work. Thank God I had plan G.. Now since the last five years, I have been healthy. Thank you Jesus! You never know about your health, so get what you can afford... Don't try to save that money. Because you might not be able to spend it. And like they say, you either pay upfront or pay as you go... And believe me, you will pay as you go!"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugzlbn1QC_q9sUAExZh4AaABAg.AOC9gE6UZgkAPcNzGL9o1T

"So glad I listened to friends who told me not to get an advantage plan when I turned 65. So glad."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugwsqy61fcc1W4xCgp4AaABAg>

↳ @nealkshah (0): "yes! I tell everyone i know the same thing!"

"This information just reconfirmed what I had been reading from several sources, except you explained it much better. I've had friends tell me since I'm in good health I should go with Medicare Advantage, which is what many of them have. I'm so glad I chose plan G last year and plan to stay with it."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgzAfS3InlpMsiUe_rd4AaABAg

↳ @MedigapSeminars (1): "I am glad you made the extra effort to research for yourself. It will pay off big over the long-run."

"I had back surgery a few years back, I had an LT Gage titanium put in my lower lumbar and thank God I had Original Medicare and a Supplement plan. The bill for the Hospital, therapy, surgery Doctors etc. was around \$160 thousand. My portion was -0-."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgzAkX3kmNoz1NKjIVZ4AaABAg>

"we thought we would go to the plan N plan as well then both my husband and i were recently diagnosed with different cancers and then i needed PT for other issues. glad we stayed with plan G. we couldn't have made the copays."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgytYRkjsbSkSKBI2gJ4AaABAg.9uXFipHsb0JA9DFtQdTK2k>

"Gloria O ,thanku for ur insight. It's very helpful to me as u back this gentleman's explanation. I was fortunate To come across this verrrry informative video after 20yrs of muddling through it all almost never getting nearly as much clarity as this video gave! Thank God i have always felt this way towards the whole mystery of it all and kept with org.medicare even with my dads persuasion to go with a plan. Thnx again"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugz3kz-clhcicSwjHxV4AaABAg.9XIYJPcosRw9YAoXe9F6Zn>

"Great info! I'm so glad I chose a supplement vs advantage. I'd never pass a medical review. I'm bracing for the news from UHC and praying that I'm not in a Deadpool! The one good thing about Medicare is it can TRAVEL with you on vacation."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgwxbjQAWBgVBdy6lt4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "So glad you are happy with your choice! Thank you for watching! 🇺🇸"

"Matthew, thank you for explaining these differences. I have been on original Medicare with a supplement policy for about 5 years. I was often concerned about paying the premiums for my supplement policy and not ever needing it. However, this past year changed my thinking. I was diagnosed with prostate cancer and decided on a radiation therapy treatment. The provider charges for tests and treatments was over \$120K. Medicare approved about 50% of costs of those charges and paid about \$26K. My supplement plan (\$2K in premiums) paid another \$4K and my out-of-pocket was less than \$500.00. My prognosis is excellent and I am glad I chose to have supplement plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgwMeXwWqe748UZV2gd4AaABAg>

"Wonderful information Dr. Shah. I'm so glad I never took the bait and stayed with original Medicare. I've been tempted to get an Advantage plan to get dental, vision and a free gym membership. Last year my husband needed to go to a rehab hospital and thank goodness he still had original Medicare, otherwise we could not have afforded it. The co-pays were about \$300 a day, zero for Medicare. Thankfully, we have Tricare as well which picks up the 20%."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzZtV_dml5MKb_cu5J4AaABAg

"Thank you for your detailed explanation. And nice remodel. I am just glad we have Medicare. Hopefully the party in charge in DC is not in charge much longer. They have done so much damage to Americans ability to obtain and afford health insurance and some of them are constantly trying to find ways to make damaging changes to Medicare also."

— YouTube · The Medicare Math Nobody Shows You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LJ3P5gL1JFw&lc=UgyZljg9W8C7ILf-zlR4AaABAg>

"Just because your healthy doesn't mean you will be next week. Healthy then colon cancer and the esophageal cancer for me, glad I have traditional plan F and have no out of pocket or co pays and go to any doctor I want without referrals. I will keep it and sacrifice anything I need to to keep it that way. No health= no life!"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgyZoocucOX58PhVONB4AaABAg>

"Holy crow- I learned a ton listening. And I'm glad I learned about no more HSA after signing up for Medicare! I'm glad I did not sign up for any Medicare yet! I've got about 45k in an HSA."

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgxRDusvrst-Ghp7NkF4AaABAg>

"I thought I was paying a lot more to keep my choices. Turns out Im not. Glad I have original with a supplement."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyYefsHe_JeyQj4QUx4AaABAg

Tab 9 — Typical Day

Calls, mail and ads every day · 25 documents · 20 voices

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

↳ @RolandHolubec (0): "Nobody knows anything; You need to create your process, manage risk, and stick to the plan, through thick or thin, While also continuously learning from mistakes and improving..."

↳ @KristýnaKalová-t8q (0): "Appreciate that. I just looked her up and she seems highly regarded. I've been meaning to fine-tune my drawdown strategy, so this might be the right time. Thanks for pointing me in a solid direction!"

"i have been researching Medicare supplement plans versus Advantage plans and discovered so many negatives with Advantage plans. Your video confirms for me that supplemental plans are the way to go. I hope more people will educate themselves and not be suckered in by the has-been celebrities who are touting Advantage plans in non-stop commercials. Thanks for the very informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 66 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugxi-BJ7WpxJLsFGVvV4AaABAg>

↳ @LarryKelly (7): "I doubt the celebrity hawkers for Medicare Advantage plans really have one themselves. I bet Joe Namath, William Shatner, and the dynamite guy all have supplemental plans. The only reason not to is if you can't afford the premiums and these guys can."

↳ @eugeneallison7457 (3): "Well let's see what I have I have United Healthcare Advantage plan I have zero monthly premium I have dental insurance I have vision insurance later on in life if I need hearing aids they are covered my drug plan also known as part d is covered at zero cost my monthly premium is zero cost I get up to a maximum benefit of \$375 toward any eyeglasses I get a additional \$350 every quarter on over the counter medication including medical equipment blood pressure monitor shower chairs raised toilet seat vitamins I paid 0 I can go to any doctor in and out of network without a doctor referral I have zero specialist 0 doctor copay if I go to the emergency room I' pay 0 if I am admitted into any Hospital I pay zero my drugs are 3.50 prescription I have not had to pay any medication co-pays since August because at August my prescription drug costs so far was 25.000 bucks I also get free transportation to and from my doctor I get a free pair of diabetic shoes every year now you tell me what Medicare Plan can beat that??? I'll be waiting"

↳ @LarryKelly (2): "@eugeneallison7457 just don't get sick or injured"

"New Medicare sales tactic It must be the season when unscrupulous Medicare brokers can make big money switching people to Medicare Advantage plans. I'm getting multiple spam calls a day trying to get me to switch. Today I got an especially sleazy one that called himself a "Medicare Adviser" and started by demanding my Medicare number to "verify" what new benefits I would get. At first he denied he was signing people up for Medicare Advantage but later let that slip when I asked how all the new benefits were paid. Reminiscent of old-time phone service slamming when phone companies would try to switch your long distance carrier without your knowledge. Sleazy tactics. Beware."

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1f2wg20/>

↳ (0): "These days, I just have my iphone forward all calls from someone not on my contact list directly to voice mail. If it's a call that's not important enough to leave a voice mail, it's a call not important enough to answer."

↳ (0): "I block any such calls without a voice mail."

↳ (0): ">called himself a "Medicare Adviser" That's actually illegal. Report his info to CMS."

"I am 76 and my phone has been ringing all day since last Thanksgiving with different people from different states trying to sell me Medicare Advantage. I am happy to hear what you've said."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 32 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgztAt-OUHVW8yJkjot4AaABA9.9XPA5Vuw7so9Xdr2wiKa82>

"I received a notice in the mail yesterday from my insurance company. My Part D drug coverage premium is going from \$40 per month to \$140 per month!"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgzQjK2uaBRaZJ-tFd94AaABA9>

↳ @foodpimp55 (2): "We renamed a lake though"

↳ @DebFry0507 (0): "@foodpimp55for sure!😭"

↳ @YolandaVasquez-r5y (0): "Sorry to hear that mine went up from \$25 dollars to 50.00 dollars now it's going up to 95.00 x2 so we will see my husband injection for his cholesterol is 334.00 every 2 months"

"Thursday 07/04/2024 and I got 13 Medicare phone calls today."

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=UgyO8Om_k0XJ4HUzy1d4AaABA9

"That's funny because I watch MeTV all day and I think it's produced by Medicare because that's really the only commercial they show.....Joe Namath; George Forman; Jimmy "JJ" Walker; James T. Kirk (lol) another football player I can't think of his name and a number of different women so I hear it everyday. I have Medicare but I also have military insurance that covers anything left over. cheers :)"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgxhR8P6yv5aiENqPRV4AaABA9.9To7SfJdfYb9TrnyvclKpp>

"Yet I received 5 emails this morning for Advantage Plans 🙄 "

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgyUHy-jfo_KHbzDQBB4AaABAq

↳ @JBoy340a (0): "And likely your mailbox is full of their fancy flyers."

"As a healthcare provider, there is only a certain number of evil things in America that have been created. Medicare Advantage is one of those. There is a reason why providers call it, "Medicare DISAdvantage." I constantly get requests from 3rd parties that represent Aetna, UHC, Blue Cross to continue to provide medical records to capture more diagnoses that get them more money from the government. Its a fucking nuisance."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugwod8f4qX3-x7Pcydl4AaABAq>

"I'm getting these same calls all day long asking me if I have Medicare part A & B and telling me that I am qualified for additional benefits so I tell them yepp I sure do have part AB&C and looking for DE&F like stop already 🙄🙄🙄 "

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=UgwmmcBWB6-DpNm0kzN4AaABAq>

"Thanks for the video I just got a letter last night that my insurance company is dropping my Medicare advantage plan and your video came in just a time so me and my cats and my dog listen to the whole thing 😊 "

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzZ8hpwFBxID_NDrzF4AaABAq

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "So glad you were able to find this video! I'm making an updated version once 2026 numbers are released :)"

"I have had my Plan G policy and prescription drug policy for over six years. I was just notified of an \$85 a month increase in my prescription drug policy. Also I understand that my deductible goes up along with the premium increase. So it is the government that is the source of the increase, not the insurance agency. I should know this. I keep blaming the insurance company for the price increase. Although the type of prescription drug policy varies as well as premiums in addition to the core cost of prescription drug coverage. Finally I called the Abt Insurance Agency today. The representative was cordial and knowledgeable. Very pleased!"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=Ugyfg64gSFFfxoaYSCR4AaABAq>

"What why how Went on Medicare advantage (Aetna) in June 2024. Want to change plans mostly because I'm looking for specific types of doctors that I'm hoping are in other plans. I worked with someone originally but don't remember and have no contact information for her. As of today I have not heard from Aetna (I will double check my mail) about canceling my plan. So as of now I'm just looking to switch plans only if I can find specific doctors. So I would need help finding the better plan for me and my husband. He went on at the same time and has the same plan."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgzLlqy5GR_R67gU_NF4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you so much for taking the time to watch! Happy to help where we can. My email is erik@theretirementnerds.com and just let me know what state you are in."

"i cant count the number of medicare spam calls i get everyday i get so many im sick of my phone constantly ringing. i dont answer the phone to numbers i dont recognize anymore. i dont have an answering machine either. i signed up with the national do not call registry but it doesnt seem to be working."

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=Ugzs6_W5Zi17RfBOflJ4AaABAg

"I know the first time I ever had a UTI and pull anything I want to go to the jazz festival down in Houston that afternoon when I first became a nurse and I knew this medical student he was going to school to be a dentist and he put it he told me a pull my name up I want to be out for a weekend he told me I need my full wisdom tooth so he pulled them off all went down there today and I have a knack with you but now I said now OK and the universe is yours that I called his people they tell me insurance for the agents to Shema started to say 123 pool OK now but I have I will get Medicare thing and she told me theylt's nice that they told me they give me \$500 OK name and I'll go for the x-rays so yeah the 400 wouldn't want to eat she won't tell me what I did he wanted something he doesn't know kind of programs out there I got all the phone number babe relieve me a call around then as soon as I am afraid is calling that Medicaid they call it a boom boom boom boom boom they get everything they won't know they got my money or if I want my money from the time I was 55 on American you tell him you're my baby enough to pay the dentist do you think I need to get a lawyer that will leave you alone it was amazing that we are the same batch as governor they told me the governor's fault but now that my money roll over and I'll kind of stuff I had to put my foot down baby what is your name Stephanie know that I want to call me to clean with clean Mathis a possibility kind of stuff I told Medicare I'm at La Quinta marina Tato next week I don't know what I want to get real time ago that's why 3NNJEJ OK God bless you she's not sure she tried to go to"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku7qE4D49X>

"I've been on Medicare for 3 years now and am very lucky to have 2 different previous employers supplement the cost of my supplemental coverage. I never understood the difference between supplemental and advantage until viewing your video. I knew advantage was cheaper but did not realize that by signing up for it, you are ending your regular Medicare A and B coverage and putting your trust and health care into the hands of an insurance company who's goal is to maximize profit. Terrifying. My plan F is through Anthem and it goes up significantly each year. It went from \$130 the first year to \$235 per month for 2022. I expect it to continue at that rate but still feel fortunate that I lucked out into picking a coverage that works for me, even though it costs more so far. Your clear explanation of the difference between the types of coverage made me realize why the companies run their non-stop commercials this time of year for their most profitable products."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgzSV2VfWlvEN64bO6F4AaABAq>

↳ @jodyhahn825 (0): "William Lackner you can save a lot of money by switching to Plan G. It is identical to Plan F except with Plan G, you will have to pay the \$233 deductible. After that, it's identical to Plan F. My plan G is with Blue Cross/Blue Shield in MO I am 69 and in 2022 my monthly premium will go up \$6.79 to \$155.68. I'm under the impression that all plans increase as we age so that's why I included my age"

"OK I am on the federal do not call list, our state does not have one. I get 20 to 30 scam calls every day. I am in the service industry so have to answer the calls. Every thing from Alpha lab telling me that medicare will pay for 8 covid tests (I dont have medicare) to my free medic alert system or will pay off all my credit card dept (dont have a credit card). Oh yes I have won a free paypal reward (dont use paypal) abusively no card. You are cute but the info is worthless, sorry I have reported the calls (with phone numbers) (spoofed ofcourse) to the FCC for the last 6 weeks this has not helped ether. Surely in this day and time the technology exists to keep this from happening and who would develop it or is it already here? The government has there hands tied, so we need to look to private enterprise, Phone company's maybe? If one of them did that would be a great selling point"

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=Ugz1xSpdalWCICEjV1x4AaABAq>

↳ @TheMedicareFamily (0): "We hate those robo- and scam-calls just like you, Eric! Too many folks get taken, and it makes it seem like honest agents in my industry are part of the problem."

"Yesterday I got 48 calls from medicare scammers. I answer, hang up and block. I've ignored them and let it ring. I just switched carriers and caller ID shows the majority of the calls come from towns in Oklahoma (where I live) or from a Senator, government offices that have no reason to contact me, like the federal farm bureau. I know these are all spoofed numbers... but DAMN! I'm leary of changing my number since there's no way to tell if it'll be just as bad or worse. I'm disabled and I've got enough going on. lol When you tell them, " I appreciate the call, but I'm already receiving all of the benefits I qualify for. Please, take me off your call list... Some hang up on me, some say okay, but they all lie. I'm going insane."

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=UgysvRadke3cEkOgAkx4AaABAq>

"@MedicarePlanFiteven in the US, they're probably not going to face fines or jail time. Besides annoying calls for Medicare Advantage, I get daily calls regarding Auto insurance (because AAA sold my info when I asked for a quote), Solar Panels, Internet companies, etc. If I answer the call, I ask what state they're calling from and tell them about the Senate Bill and get hung up on. I've reported Spam calls for years to the DNC and FCC yet nothing works. Like most issues, I have absolutely no faith in this ever ending."

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=UgxSNv7Bh3cN-w6_ScF4AaABAq.ASVHD19HdSsASVowdakMTf

"Thanks for sharing your perspective! Medicare has evolved significantly since it was created, and today coverage generally extends to medically necessary treatments that meet Medicare's coverage rules, including procedures like joint replacement and, in some cases, certain GLP-1 uses. I think the bigger policy question is where Medicare should draw the line between "basic" care and newer treatments that can prevent or reduce more serious health problems later. What do you think!"

— YouTube · 6 BIGGEST Medicare Changes in 2027!! IMPORTANT 📢 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1a0lVireAKg&lc=UgySrWB8AyLRcjDxZtZ4AaABAq.AbYmaEOAAgnAbZas1FyvpL>

Appointments, prescriptions and pharmacy runs · 19 documents · 19 voices

"Humana screwed me over I have a heart condition and have been waiting three months to have an echocardiogram. Recently, Humana changed my PCP from someone I've been seeing for years and years to a stranger and didn't let me know if they changed it. My doctor reached out to let me know and I called and had him changed back but then they sent a new card that didn't list my doctor's name and I had to request it again from them. Then I showed up from my appointment yesterday and they still hadn't adjusted their records. Now they decided they needed prior approval for something that was already approved and I had already received a co-pay notification. Then the hospital, which is supposed to care for people and is another point of how the US healthcare system is fucked up, turned me away. They turned away a heart patient because the insurance was being difficult. They're supposed to take care of patients, but if money isn't forthcoming, they turn them away, even if they're at risk of dying. I'm sorry I just needed a place to express this and I hope others will agree with me that Medicare and the health system in general need a major overhaul."

— r/medicare · 87 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1puvefe/>

↳ (0): "Anyone who has enough money to pay for regular Medicare and a supplement should definitely do so."

↳ (0): "You are completely right I've seen personally firsthand and heard of Medicare advantage being disliked by doctors offices in hospitals."

↳ (0): "Yes! Exactly why I went with original Medicare A and B and then added Medigap. I'm so sorry that you had to go through that."

"I am sticking with plan g as long as I can afford it purely because of the peace of mind. I'm in physical therapy twice a week but never have to deal with any bills or even the associated paperwork. If something awful happens, I want to concentrate on getting well, not admin."

— YouTube · Should You Switch from Medicare Plan G to Plan N? Here's the Real Tradeoff · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xsEZJVMwY8E&lc=Ugxyg0sLIBh9bF-rUSd4AaABAg>

↳ @resoluteprotectorhonoringg2877 (0): "I have a question for You. Do You experience copays for therapy under Your plan G?"

↳ @RibbitResist (0): "@resoluteprotectorhonoringg2877not under my plan g, they are all covered."

"I am turning 65 shortly and am as healthy as a powerful rhino. I work out daily and have never taken a prescription drug in my life. Not even an antibiotic, nor aspirin! I have been watching a LOT of videos, and prior to yours, thought I was going to be taking the Supplement Plan N. Because of your breakdown at the end, I realize I am a wise elephant because I check all the boxes you explained that would motivate someone to choose an Advantage plan, so thank you."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugx3XQcuy_hT1U1Jskd4AaABAg

↳ @RichardSalayer-i6y (0): "We saved a ton of money not paying premiums from age 74-79 on a \$0.00 Premium, Medicare Premium PPO from UHC in San Antonio, TX. Just like us; 1.) Know yourselves and your health situations, 3.) Do you research - then buy. Prior to that we had UHC as a HMO and were only marginally happy with it. Love the PPO - like night and day, even though same company. With an HMO, they can keep trying things to save money, putting off the treatment, that you need for 2--3 months. But, unfortunately a PPO in a big Metropolitan can cost a lot of money per month of NON existant - like in So. California."

"The only thing that I wish is that they would remove is the 1% per month penalty for not signing up. I can buy the medications for about \$30/Qtr and the minimum part D plan today is 25/Mth. A 1% penalty per month is ridiculous and almost criminal."

— YouTube · UPDATE: Medicare Part D Subsidy Program ENDS - What Happens Next? · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7l_bhhxH9w&lc=Ugw-9xbeggmH8D4CzpR4AaABAg

"At 65 and on Medicare and a supplemental I feel like there were no choices that apply to individuals that are very healthy as I amI run 4 miles daily and eat very healthy and take 1 medication for my thyroid....getting old just means paying more 😞 "

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgyAF2_lkgcnQ-UeR6Z4AaABAg

↳ @cindybailey6765 (5): "The thing is, one can never assume that just because they lead a healthy lifestyle they are protected from disease. I never thought I'd be diagnosed with two different expensive diseases two years in a row, leaving me to pay max out of pocket two years in a row. Now I'm on Medicare and very happy to have a \$240 deductible. I have always eaten healthy, exercised my entire life and also only had a thyroid issue. My diseases are both caused by genetics, which I had no control over. I will never be able to quit a medigap plan."

↳ @steveludwig4200 (1): "Then pass on a Supplemental insurance plan.....Cost will be \$0.....until you have a medical issue. Good luck with that."

↳ @barreloffun10 (1): "Look at High Deductible Plan G. It will be cheap."

"Wow! Thanks for such a great explanation! I have my appointment today to chose my plan. After reviewing this video I believe N is a good plan for me !!!"

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=UgwLuWssznjJNgIhoJ4AaABAg>

"Talked to a Medicare broker yesterday. The Part D out of pocket cap is going from \$2100 to \$2400 in '27. I currently take 10 meds daily and only one of them will cost anything monthly(\$3). However a med I need but can't afford will max out my Part D annual maximum. Found out the same med under a particular advantage plan will only cost me \$10 a month! So I really have no choice but to get the advantage plan. I'm 64 and start Medicare in January."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Advantage Plan Cost YOU \$1,000s in 2027!? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JemKIOUrpM&lc=UgxvgKkkHSQGEs6qQKJ4AaABAg.Ab4jzY9tCcvAb4vK22H_01

"Why don't you include Medicare part D and the fact that all of the Advantage plans include part D coverage. The typical person age 65 is taking 2-3 daily pills to maintain chronic conditions, if they are diabetic and or have a serious condition they can easily have medications that add up to over \$3000 per month at retail prices. In my case I have been taking maintenance medication for multiple chronic conditions for over 20 years, which includes the entire time that I have been Medicare eligible. Only in the last 8 years has the monthly retail cost of my medications dropped to below \$5000; while at its peak the monthly cost was over \$12,000 for a period of 5 years."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgxENSSGxh_RC_Ir9xh4AaABAg

↳ @Theretirementnerds (0): "Thank you for watching! We have right around 83 videos on our channel. 25 of them discuss Part D and the standalone route vs the included-in-an-Advantage plan route. You just happened to catch one of the videos that wasn't made to dive into that topic. But it is an important one!"

"I look at my EOBs every month and I still didn't realize until today that my Medicare drug plan isn't paying anything for my medication. It all comes from my co-pays and this subsidy I guess. It's bizarre I don't know what I'm paying them \$80 a month for they pay nothing."

— YouTube · Trump Administration to End Medicare Drug Plan Subsidy. #medication #medicare #doctor · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BrOgvbQKs-A&lc=Ugw_aY_Cxd5JBHBV0S94AaABAq.AZp4Twiv2WbAZr8gXrLWtQ

"Love love love this information! Even without knowing it previously, I always felt there was something fishy going on. They call me constantly wanting to "help" me set up a doctor's appointment for a wellness screening. I am a very blessed, active, healthy 68 yo female. Im not on any medication and get really mad that they won't leave me alone! Well, anyway, here's my question: When I was planning for a total knee replacement in 2019, I was on plain old Medicare A and B. I was advised by a friend to get on an Advantage plan to greatly reduce my out of pocket cost for the surgery. I made many calls to Medicare to confirm this information. The amount they told me I would be responsible for was thousands. Two different reps, two different calls at different times. I then spoke with the Advantage plan people and was assured that I would only be responsible for \$275 after meeting my deductible (\$250 I think?). So, I took the Advantage plan, which I still have, and yes indeed, that was all I had to pay. Lock, stock, and barrel. I believe what you're saying but, in my case, why was the Advantage plan a decided "advantage"?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwFXhp6HLxl9GRaZAB4AaABAq>

"Hi Stephanie, I have a question. Currently I have Medicare part A, B,C and D. I have Medicaid too. I am enrolled in Medicare Supplement Plan F. Talking to insurance agents, their suggestions and advice are confusing to me. One said I can not have Medicaid and Plan F. When I have big ailment the claim would be denied both medicare, Medicaid and the insurance company. One saying to contact the other since I have Medicare, Medicaid and plan F. Some say to surrender Medicaid. If I surrender Medicaid I will have to pay plan B premium and proscription plan D premium. All this is confusing to me. Today I am paying plan F premium (\$ 220.90) and proscription copay/deductible (\$ 3.95 for all proscription and about \$ 9.00 for B-12 injections). Rest is taken care by Medicaid I suppose. Should I continue with Plan F and have Medicaid too. Your explanation will highly be appreciated. Thank you."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgxcnNmW_xPtKee1XS14AaABAq

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "It depends on your budget. Most Medigap carriers will not approve your application is you have full Mediciad benefits."

"Love my advantage plan. I just had major spinal surgery, 9 days in a hospital, 9 in a skilled nursing facility and 3 weeks home physical therapy twice a week. My cost, \$1,200 bucks and \$770 of that is for a bone fusion healing device I wear 30 minutes a day and will for 6 months. I get 13 medications per month and I pay \$10.00 every 90 days for one of them. The other 12, zip. I live in a small town, all of the doctors in town are in my network and so are the doctors in the town 30 minutes away where the hospital and surgeon were located, love my plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxoO4jNwPftPNwNq6l4AaABAq>

↳ @DCotting-i4b (0): "Can I ask what the name of your Medicare Advantage plans name? TY"

"I've been trying soooo hard, with a broker, w/SSDI, Medicare A and B, with the buy in, paid fully with MA Health-, my medicaid, full, my secondary insurance. I get all benefits. I'm moving and I'm only eligible for medicaid, for Medicare B premium paid and I believe, as told today, qualify for Prescription drugs extra help. I'm so confused about the terms, as I'm on SSDI & was told not to get Medigap, bc of the premium. To get an advantage plan. This is moving from MA to NC. I'm terrified 😨."

— YouTube · What is Medigap? (Medicare Supplement Insurance Explained) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RnXi0LJRVY&lc=UgzWkGzt9hAbKM1wIDh4AaABAg>

"As an example, I have a Medicare Advantage plan as part of my retirement package. I have an annual \$250 deductible, \$1200 out of pocket max. including the deductible, no co-pay and drugs that, over the years, have come down sharply, some by 90%. They are all very affordable now. I take 8 different meds daily so that's important. The premium is \$393/mo split between the insurer and Medicare. I find that fits nicely. For others, not so much perhaps. You do need to investigate."

— YouTube · The \$9.8 Billion Medicare Subsidy Just Ended — Here's What Really Happens to Part D · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pfLyIplem30&lc=UgyRbKBVF37nfv1C09J4AaABAg>

"Sure, but you haven't had a major illness. An Advantage plan is fine until you get sick and have a copay for everything. Those can very quickly add up to \$200 a month. I'd rather know that I'm making a monthly payment for Plan G and never have additional bills. I go to PT twice a week, that alone is \$200 in copays if they are \$25 a visit. It's very rare to age and never face an illness, but good on you if you haven't."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1mm1tbf/part_d_and_supplemental_can_save_you_hundreds_of/n7vbw2e/

"Puzzle. I turned 65 in February 2027. I have quite a few medication medications that I take daily. What is likely the best part plan for me? I plan to get a supplement as well. Thank you."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Drug Plans: Two Things You NEED to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANgeD3oOJ40&lc=UgyJbPGZD86t9YUU4fx4AaABAg>

↳ @gindie1 (0): "You can do some "pre" research in exactly the same manner as those of us who are already on Medicare. The only difference is that you can't enroll yet. Stay tuned for Erik's October 15 video, and you will follow the same procedures when you are ready to enroll!"

"Then why do I constantly hear from my doctors that my original Medicare will not cover what I need, and my prescriptions are not covered???"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxgdS4dt1vIMwhuv9N4AaABAg>

"Do you go to my call me back I tried to talk to them daughter and I don't want it all American people call me tell me a zero down and I'll let up cause either way go you're still gonna have to pay that is that is not her fault for the most weirdo I don't know when you made the state it would've run 48 some meals OK God bless you 148 God bless you now the enemy want to do route canals and crowns and stuff yeah Denist wanted without everything put in place they got a game I don't want to give me your plan is managers would he say I read it wrong I got a good TV I need to tell him the truth to those they do a filling on it OK the feeling don't last so long didn't want to do the crown to pay all the money for a crack baby you know how to dress like it was before I know that you get it it is my day is it no I have not told about the dress like it I'd rather play with no I had to dress like that does all my God where do you mature know when I go get my T4 my dad didn't account but when I go get my T4 I'll take my headphones are used to make my doctor here for me to put all my emails and tell me that he iPhone but I'm not I take my medication I take my headphones The main TV was broke right now all the TVs in there I can't believe it has a yard to pay your bill how do I say what are you doing what did we watch TV and pay the bill in the waiting room no television no magazines no nothing is it all my God help me Jesus that's all I can say I'm gonna take them to magazine I got a treat everybody equally OK God bless you guys lady I'm glad you're teasing I was going on and tell him to about it while green they can order from Walmart every 66663 month when my phone is it me the catalog does my insurance lady know if you are from my telephone I told Medicare I don't play with the phone so they don't need to send me to Walmart catalog on my telephone just send me a catalog and order every order no I got me I got the message or vitamins last time 200 I got vitamin is 200 what I need to help I got a come a cosmetic and tell them we need to get the yeast rice and refried rice diet supplement I have to take them that want me to take them while greenhouse Walmart has them OK God bless you guys presentation I'm proud of you but now I know to dinner Saturday bring over us and being nice as it burns when I sober and I guess I'm doing Tele dentistry"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyQrshWrvA0cD7P19x4AaABAg.9Ku5wluRIVB9Ku8LpblWhz>

"Thank you Matthew for this informative video and for explaining the history behind Medicare. My family and I came here as refugees 30 years ago and now I'm seeing how my father after working all these years and paying into Medicare is struggling with not having enough medical coverage through the Medicare advantage plan he was placed into along with my mother without explaining to them that there is an \$8000 out of pocket deductible. Now I'm the one trying to help them find out why they are receiving medical bills for thousands of dollars that they cannot afford to pay 😞 . The insurance agent that placed them into the advantage plan never explained to my parents anything about the requirement to have prior authorization before having medical care done. My parents have an appointment with that same agent today to go over enrollment for 2025, and I'm wondering if they can reject enrollment in the advantage plan for 2025 and go back to original Medicare and add a supplemental plan? Thank you for your time 🙏 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIjZes9o&lc=UgzNjCA-qC1YDYCowTp4AaABAg>

Hours of research and re-shopping every fall · 15 documents · 15 voices

"The Medicare Plan Shuffle: Why NOT Shopping Part D Annually Could Cost Thousands Let's face it—when it comes to Medicare Part D drug plans, there are two types of people: those who compare their options each year... and those who don't. The first group might sleep easy knowing they're not overpaying for their medications. The second? Well, they could be unknowingly flushing hundreds—or even thousands—down the drain every year. We're not trying to scare you... Okay, maybe we are. A little. # The \$0 Trap: It Sounds Good, But... A \$0 monthly premium sounds amazing, right? Like free pie. But what they don't tell you is that the crust costs extra, and the whipped cream? Outrageously priced. That "free" drug plan might not cover your medications—or might do so at sky-high copays. Drugs like **Eliquis**, **Zepbound**, **Wegovy**, **Ozempic**, and **Mounjaro** aren't just pricey—they're plan landmines. Some plans cover them. Some don't. Some charge you your left arm, others your right. We've even seen plans list one of these drugs at over \$1,000 a month while another plan had it at just \$35. Same drug. Different nightmare. # The Annual Game of "Gotcha" Here's the kicker: every year, plans change. They change their premiums. They change their copays. They change what drugs they cover and what tier they're on. That \$10-a-month generic from last year? Surprise! It's now \$85 and mysteriously moved up a tier. Imagine showing up at the pharmacy in January thinking your plan still loves you, only to find out it ghosted your medications over the holidays. # Why This Year is Different (And Maybe Worse) Whispers from Washington are raising eyebrows. With big changes coming to how Medicare negotiates drug prices and funds subsidies starting in 2026, we could be on the edge of a "musical chairs" situation—except instead of chairs, it's coverage for your heart medication, and when the music stops... well, you get the picture. If you're banking on "the government will fix it," remember: these are the same folks who brought you the DMV experience. # The True Villains? The Middlemen & the Markups Let's not forget the real fun part: drug manufacturers and pharmacy benefit managers (PBMs)—the shadowy middlemen who get rich while seniors juggle pills and price tags. They're the ones who make your life-saving medication more expensive in the U.S. than a luxury vacation in Mexico (where, ironically, the same drugs often cost 80% less). So yes, it's not just about "shopping" your plan. It's about taking a stand against a broken system. One click, one form, one chat with your agent could save you thousands. # Moral of the Story? Don't Be That Guy. Every year, we talk to someone who didn't bother to compare plans. They "liked what they had" and "didn't want to mess with it." By February, they're calling us in a panic because their meds are costing more than their rent. Don't be that guy. Reprinted from Lisaknowsmedicare.com. blog posts"

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1kyujg6/>

↳ (0): "Basically what I tell all my clients every year. Read your ANOC (Annual Notice of Change) carefully for changes to how your prescriptions are covered, copay changes, etc. Part D plans are super easy to compare on Medicare.gov. Be aware that most PDPs no longer pay broker commissions, so a broker might not be eager to spend valuable time helping you shop around unless you are already a client."

↳ (0): "This right here. I still did reviews for all my existing clients, despite the fact that Aetna, Centene, Cigna, etc. all said no commissions for brokers. I love my clients but this year I'll probably be directing most of them to [Medicare.gov](<http://Medicare.gov>) for Part D reviews and changes."

↳ (0): "Keep in mind that as a broker, sending them to Medicare.gov to enroll proves the carriers point that brokers are not needed. Have them call the carrier to enroll in a plan. Make the carriers pay someone to do the work they won't pay brokers to do."

"I am a retired OBGYN so sounds like a stork to me. WOW your complete analysis and perfect explanation was spot on. I loved when you said representatives like you should do what is best and not worry about commissions. So true people know when you have their best interests and they tell others. In the long run this is best for you and your clients. Same story in the practice of medicine. I watch this video realizing that what I have already chosen what works best for me, but every year I do complete review of my medical conditions, potential new conditions, medications, possible new medications, hospital and healthcare providers, I live in two states and also travel in an RV. I look at specific plan formularies and potential changes. I enjoyed this presentation, You and your connected representatives do this to help people find what is best for them now and as life changes. You should be proud of the service you provide. This is very difficult to analyze for most of us especially in a demographic that is aging, and cognitive abilities are slipping. You have found a wonderful calling,"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgwhAynbxhE4s71VKrR4AaABAg>

↳ @marlajestice2785 (1): "Bless your ❤️ I'm new to all of this trying to comprehend it all, good start for those like me"

↳ @marlajestice2785 (0): "Thank You Daviddrake8742 🙏 "

"Finally someone covers this topic. Although your explanations are a bit scattered, confusing and rushed. My wife and i spent our 40yr career in the healthcare field. We can tell you without question, never go cheap on healthcare. One bad diagnosis like cancer can bankrupt or severely hamper your retirement plans in a heartbeat. Also, we live in FL. Healthcare is very expensive because of the number of retired people who live here. With all our number crunching it will never pay to do roth conversions while on ACA. I have 2 yrs left on ACA, my wife is on Medicare and SS. People must remember that you are PREDICTING you income for the year ahead of time. If you go over, you will pay more. If you are under, ACA gives you a refund(credit) on taxes. The system is very confusing for seniors and i have spent many hours researching all the ACA rules and how it applies to taxes, income and roth conversions."

— YouTube · Healthcare Before 65: In-Depth ACA vs. Roth Conversion Analysis · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gUjrNm-VLF8&lc=UgwDMADRL27zUJcPdc14AaABAg>

↳ @Wayneman50 (1): "@ No. For example, when you sign up for coverage in Nov 2025 for the year 2026. You have to guess your income for that year(2026). Your subsidy is based on the income you are predicting for the year 2026."

↳ @andre-l3j (1): "@larryjones9773I think you're thinking of IRMAA income rather than ACA income prediction."

↳ @gdb5843 (0): "I totally agree with you on "never go cheap on healthcare" but I wish I did larger Roth Conversion when I was on ACA."

"This is informative but really just touches on some of what you need help with. You never mentioned talking to an independent agent. SHIP is a decent starting point but they usually have volunteers that have very minimal training and have seen many times where they have hurt people. I have been doing Medicare for 17 years and was a "captive" agent in the beginning and saw the need for being not tied to an individual company. Medicare supplements can be good but you never mentioned some of the benefits that Medicare Advantage company have, such as dental, hearing aids, vision coverage, health club membership, and even OTC benefits. Another thing is you can have a Medicare Advantage plan with a Hospital Indemnity plan that can cover major costs such as cancer and hospital stays and have premiums at less than half of a Medicare supplement and you can have the extra benefits of the MA plan and lower out of pocket costs. Another thing is that if you live in an area that has zero plan premiums for Medicare Advantage your prescription cost 95% of the time will be lower than if you have a stand-alone RX plan. Bottom line you can spend hours and hours going through all the plans and learning about options and be overwhelmed and still not know what to do. Again the SHIP department can help but they do not go through the extensive training an independent agent has to do every year and they don't have the experience or even the responsibility if they steer you the wrong way. I can sit with a client for a couple of hours and truly walk someone through their options and narrow down what would be in their best interest now and the future. 2 or 3 hours of your time is nothing to spend on something that over a 10 year period may save you literally thousands. It's your choice but if you think talking with your doctors' office or SHIP office is going to be the best resource you will regret it. Talk to an INDEPENDENT agent with 5 years or more and you will be able to make a MUCH better-informed decision. I (WE) do this at no cost to you and do get paid by the company you sign up for and it makes no difference which company you sign up with....Medicare made it so there is no incentive to steer you to a company that pays more so we truly give you an unbiased opinion of what's best for you! Sorry for going on but I really felt this needed to be covered. You need to know to use a local agent. I am in NW Arkansas, NE OK, and SW MO and know the plans in this area extensively but if you asked me about what to do in Florida, Wisconsin or any other area I would not be able to help other than tell you to find a Local agent. Good luck :)"

— YouTube · Avoiding Costly Medicare Mistakes · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M_lw87U6Moo&lc=Ugyq0OC917TwMii_n9x4AaABAq

↳ @scottfreedom2012 (1): "@lisad2701 Absolutely. I have clients down to Hot Springs and Mena. I am located in Bentonville. I have a website that you can contact me through when the time comes. nwamedicareplans dot com I also have a facebook page that I post good info year-round. If you are on facebook at all use @nwamedicareplans to find me."

↳ @lisad2701 (0): "Scott Widen...I'm south of you in Polk County - could I still contact you when my "Medicare" time comes?"

"Back when I retired I found selecting a MediCare insurance plan the most complex and confusing project I had ever undertaken! I spent endless hours reading all the info and most often felt that the more I studied the less I understood. Finally in desperation I opted to receive counseling from a volunteer organization. Imagine my horror when the councilor told me that I already knew more than he did about Medicare options! I finally sought help from a Medicare broker like yourself who heartily recommended that my wife and I opt for a Medicare Advantage plan. At that time I suffered from Type 1 diabetes, Rheumatoid Arthritis, Hypothyroidism and several other chronic illnesses. Watching your video today made painfully clear that I was given bad advice and clearly as I am currently 76 years old my future does not look bright on an Advantage plan! Up until now I thought that at the beginning of every year you could switch the type of plan you were on. From what you say in this video given my various ailments I am now stuck forever in my Advantage plan and it will probably cost me a fortune. Is there any way whatever for me to switch over to a traditional Medicare plan? Also my wife is in good health at age 75 should she switch from her Advantage plan before it's too late? Thank you for your wonderful , highly detailed videos...I just wish I'd known about them when I first signed up for Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=Ugwjdi9kKIGbrstxXQ54AaABAq>

↳ @wynetteabc (1): "Call your state's Medicare office. In some states maybe you can switch, at least to the G plan. A guaranteed issue plan. ❤️ "

↳ @annlong1426 (0): "Anytime the government is involved it's going to be expensive, complicated, time-wasting, and frustrating. Wish they'd never taken over medicine, education, money and anything else."

↳ @boatman222345 (0): "@annlong1426 I would amend your statement, any time any large, basically unaccountable organization wants to pull a fast one things get "complicated!" It's helpful to keep in mind that "Advantage" programs are the insurance industry's effort to "attract" those enrolled in the government Medicare insurance over into the "private" corporate world. You can bet your bottom dollar that the legislative process allowing Advantage programs was completely controlled by corporate lobbyists. One big tell is the outrageous commissions given to "independent" insurance brokers who facilitate the move from Medicare to Advantage health coverage. Back when I signed up with an Advantage program I was horrified to discover that the broker who spent 15 minutes signing me up got paid \$300 by the taxpayer for stealing one of their policy holders. Imagine how I felt after watching this video that makes clear the fact that the broker continues to get that \$300 commission every year for 6 years for doing nothing! The first time I ran into insurance difficulties I called the broker only to be told that he had nothing further to do with it and I needed to contact the insurance company directly! Pp"

"I turn 65 in about 20 minutes or so, and I don't have employer insurance because it's a temp agency and they OFFER it but don't pay for any of it, no PTO, no holiday pay, anyway so this video is good-to-know but doesn't apply to me (I think). I have spent the last 2 months researching the Part C or not dilemma and yesterday I just threw a dart, paid my Part B premium and will take a microscope to the EOC when I get it. There are so many details to this process that will just ruin your day, like community or issued age vs attained age for Medigap, or Part C with \$0 copay for dental but a \$1500 max benefit/year but is hidden 6 pages deep on the company website. I know you'll laugh but all this should be on the first page, AND Medicare will explain all this IF you ask but ok end of rant. Great video. Maybe dim that ball in the background a bit."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgyDKzIzEqTI8HrSI1h4AaABAq>

"I've been on Plan G for years and every year I call around and research which company has the least expensive Plan G. Yes, increases every year just like with auto insurance premiums taking a hike this past year."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=Ugw_s7eAh6J_rTqe-aZ4AaABAg

↳ @-myal-8691 (0): "Are you healthy? Will you be required to unwriting to switch your G Plan?"

"Wow, I've watched two of your videos and I have learned soooo much. My husband enrolled in Medicare advantage a couple years ago and I had no idea that he'd have to go through underwriting if he wanted to switch to a supplement plan. I mistakenly thought it was like regular insurance that you could switch from year to year. Heads up for me in the future! Like someone else said, I spent weeks scouring the difference between the different plans and thought I made a good decision, now I'm not so sure. THANK YOU to you and the soda family!"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugyx-nwJumZG94qGUNx4AaABAg>

↳ @Theretirementnerds (1): "Thank you so much for watching! So happy it has been helpful. 🙏 "

"I've spent hours listening to your different videos re Medicare Advantage to Medicare plus the G plan. Simplified, you make everything so clear to understand and I cannot thank you enough! Still, I'm going to call you for advice/suggestions. It's 11/14/2022. I will speak to you very soon 😊 ."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=Ugyv81amFxBI2X_ilpZ4AaABAg

↳ @AbtInsuranceAgency (0): "Looking forward to hearing from you!"

"Calling you folks today. :) After watching hours of videos on this topic I'm still not exactly sure which way I'm going...keeping my wife's health insurance from her company, or dropping that coverage and signing up for Medicare"

— YouTube · Working Past 65? Medicare Mistakes You Can't Afford To Make! 🤖 · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4GtRppYTHho&lc=UgywyWCuFGbBzfBrAYJ4AaABAg>

"Anecdotally that's great and it works for you. But be advised that this decision is costing you thousands of dollars a year. Maybe you can afford that, and you think this is a small price to pay not to have to get preapprovals for elective procedures (as emergencies don't need prior approvals). If so, I'm happy for you, and it's obviously the best choice for your situation. However, we are living off of meager SS income and any extra money we spent to avoid this pre-approval system (which may also help us avoid any unwarranted and unnecessary surgeries that only serve to line the pockets of unethical physicians) will mean less food we get to eat - impacting our health up front. We have a Medicare giveback in our Advantage plan that pays us \$130 a month that Medicare overcharges us, in addition to our Advantage plan having no monthly premium. There are other advantages of our advantage plan as well, such as a \$400 a year allowance for drug store items, such as OTC medications, vitamins, feminine products, etc. We also get Teledoc and free health club memberships as well as other things we don't use, but others might. We do like the included drug coverage. Most of my wife's meds are free, (I don't take any) but I think she paid \$5 for antibiotics once. We realize that if we had to go into the hospital for a major medical event, it will probably cost us a little more, than Medicare with a plan G supplement will, but for all the years we have the plan and are healthy (like we have been so far) this puts us far ahead financially, saving us over \$6,000 a year, every year, compared to basic Medicare with a plan G supplement in our home state. Of course, this varies by plan and state. There are some poor Advantage plans out there, which should be avoided, but there some good ones too. If considering an Advantage plan, I suggest you shop wisely or get an advisor who can recommend a good plan for you. But if you're in decent health like we are (I'm 68, haven't seen a doctor in 6 years and am on no meds) I'm sure you will find one that will save you money. This is why most people choose them. If, however, you are in poor health and see a doctor often for chronic medical conditions, you will probably be better served by Medicare with a Part G supplement and good drug coverage. But we're all like snowflakes, everyone unique..."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=UgyhEyEGlpmFRi4hq8d4AaABAg.A8bdgNCUQZgA98eu1BSFWn>

"I did heavy research into Medicare, MAP and supplements 6 months before I was eligible. When I went to a Medicare Agent, who's fees are paid for by Medicare, not you, they recommend what I had concluded on my own with 100 hours reading on the net. After I got A/B and a supplement I then decided not to retire and continue now working 3 years after I signed onto Medicare B and Supplement. Had I known I'd continue working I'd waited as I've had to make those premiums all these years and still have employers insurance. Oh well, I thought I was going to retire in 2019. I think I'll cut back to part time so have my plan in place but still need to get Medicare D"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzjaNqiKFHMfVoVJNJ4AaABAg.9Zo3s7y1X2U9cf780kcRdg>

"Without a doubt! I previously spent 4-5 hours reading the Govt Medicare Handbook, Social Security website, and various mailed flyers, still feeling uneasy as to the answers to my questions, but in this 14 minute video got all of my questions and concerns answered and addressed with full confidence! Thank you Stephanie!"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYl75xJnKg&lc=UgzjsFPCKo2AUTl6CUt4AaABAg.A00bj1bkctcHA06eNdueAb5>

"Tell me about it. My PPO WAS CANCELLED And I spent hours and hours to find my doctor who isn't for some reason listed as a Medicare provider. They threw me in a plan cities away. Took forever to straighten it out. Individual Medicare medigap plans are extremely expensive."

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXyWC4myaw&lc=Ugz2wS5g7x7kSduJw3R4AaABAg>

"Question for other Medicare agents about RX plans? We've always sold them, but I'm considering dropping future sales. I run an insurance and investment/financial planning practice. It's a 3rd generation practice and we've all done things a bit differently. My grandfather started selling insurance before fax machines were used in business, so we've seen a lot of changes and I feel we are at a crossroads with helping our customers with Rx plans now. For anyone who is doing this, wtf? Scope of appointments, recording phone calls and saving conversations for 10 fucking years? These shit plans don't even pay decent commissions, and the ones that do, the premium is \$40 so how much is my time worth?? I will continue to help my top clients who have other lines of business with me, but we have so many customers who are only Medicare that call every year to help them shop their Rx plans. I'm ready to just have my assistant tell all these customers who already have their plan f/g, that we are no longer appointed with companies to sell rx plans but they can go to Medicare.gov, put the info in and shop for the plans because that's all we're going to do anyways if you come in". Regulations have made this service unprofitable/unsustainable and if they want they can email a typed list of their meds to us and to come into the office for a 15 minute meeting, or they can diy. I have gotten very little cross sell business from these people so far. Medicare has always been a value add for the best clients and a prospecting tool, but my dad got a ton of his Medicare referrals from other life insurance agents and financial advisors who keep the profitable relationship and ditch us with high-need service work at a critical time of our year with year end financial planning and group health renewals. I still want to write supplements and will discuss advantage plans in-person or over the phone with people who can be tech savvy enough to sign a damn soa electronically, but it's time we cut RX plans from our offerings. Question for the sub; am I being short-sighted? Am I missing something that makes working for free(at a loss) worth doing? I started buying my dad out a few years ago and I finally have the opportunity to just drop rx plans due to the complicated compliance bs we have to do and he's finally used to not working so the BS is something he's willing to just fold on. I love my dad but since covid he has not learned anything new about our business, maybe even longer than that. He hasn't trained a staff person for as long as I've been here, but probably ever. At the end of the day, I feel like rx plans cost us money to offer and I think it's time we let them go."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 2 upvotes · family member helping · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1fu74gk/question_for_other_medicare_agents_about_rx_plans/

↳ noexcuses14 (4): "Maybe you could find a Medicare agent in your area to partner with and turn that part of the business over to them. I work with several financial planners who don't want to take the time to do all of the trainings each year or meet with clients so they send all their clients to me. Its a win for everyone. I focus just on health insurance and they get to focus on the financial side."

↳ foremma_foreverago (2): "You're not wrong about any of it, AEP is a hemorrhage on payroll considering how little we get paid. The main thing that keeps me going is wanting to take care of my clients...and if I stop doing that, someone else will. 🤔 it sucks."

↳ Pubsubforpresident (2): "I understand your feelings but I also feel like I have customers and clients. Clients are engaged and I have multiple lines of business. Customers, I am a commodity to them and I likely don't have cross sell opportunities for different reasons, they are needy, and I don't make money from them. Just spend money and time to help them do what they could for themselves. What risks do I have? If they already have a plan F or G, and someone talks them into an advantage plan I lose their renewal. But is that going to happen often? I think we can just tell them what to do and invite them to come into the office for a 15-30 minute consultation before we have to start charging for time."

Bills, statements and paperwork · 9 documents · 9 voices

"That's just what things cost..." Usually, I get my EOB (explanation of benefits), do a quick review that I actually received the service and thank Medicare and my Part G for saving me the bill. However, yesterday I got an EOB that really ticked me off. After hip surgery, I was prescribed "cryo therapy" (for the uninitiated, it's known as an ice pack.) What arrived at my door in April was a piece of padded fabric with some Velcro attachments - 1) to fit the wrap to my waist and hip and 2) to attach a frozen gel pack. In my wildest imagination, I couldn't see this thing being worth more than \$100. And here's where the insanity begins. The vendor charged Medicare **\$3417.96** 🤔 Of that amount, Medicare paid **\$1095.74**. Nearly \$1100 for padded fabric and an ice pack. Nice work if you can get it. Some of you may say, "That's the system" and that's basically what 2 Medicare reps told me when I called to tell them they were ripped off. "Nothing we can do, that's just what things cost." And we wonder why healthcare is in its current state. Apparently, the same people who value screwdrivers at \$1500 for the defense dept. are doing double duty. I know I shouldn't be amazed but color me gobsmacked. Now if you'll excuse me, I'm off to find a glass and some scotch aka "aroma therapy."

— r/medicare · 109 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1v3wccf/>

↳ (0): "Can you return it? If not can you report it to Medicare's Senior Medicare Patrol or ask SHIP for a resource. When you get a prescription it is out of your hands. You HAVE to take it?! Can you show it to your prescribing physician or the PT company you used? That is utterly ridiculous. Send it to your US Congress person and ask what should /could be done to recover these funds. There must have been an error coding that tag instead of a cryo machine. Can you look at MSN and get the code to see what they billed for? Now I'm needing some aroma therapy just reading about it."

↳ (0): "It was coded as a miscellaneous brace which clearly it was not. The vendor was chosen for me so... The attitude at Medicare of "Ho hum, oh well, stuff happens" was beyond frustrating. My doctor will probably throw up his hands and try to sympathize. I guess I can always escalate with a tersely worded missive to Dr. Oz..."

↳ (0): "I invite you to write a letter to your 2 Senators and your 2 Representatives in Congress. When the debate over single payer healthcare begins again, and it surely will, they will remember your \$1,000 ice pack. "If you see something, say something." To members of Congress. Do not imagine they know the details of \$1,000 ice packs. They do not."

"Anyone else receive their 2025 Annual Notice of Change from Aetna today? I have the HMO plan, and the biggest shock is the maximum out of pocket will go from \$4800 in 2024 to \$9350 in 2025. All the 'extra benefits' are getting reduced as well."

— r/medicare · 27 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1f93bec/>

↳ (0): "It's a regressive year for sure.. the 2k cap for pdp is a big reason for it."

↳ (0): "I have united healthcare advantage dual plan, my plan decreased in 2025, dental, vision, OTC, looks like my going have to visit dental regardless once a year, on my vision, hell where to go to get yearly vision testing, and new glasses that's not going to go over 350, that's going to be impossible, the OTC amount from 187, to 160 for food, hope snap program increases, but I doubt it, that's government, well what can u do, can't fight the government"

↳ (0): "Some big factors for these changes are the Medicare reimbursement rates are lowering slightly, the \$2000 cap on Part D medications and insurance companies being more responsible for the costs versus the big pharma companies, and since COVID, insurance utilization has been at record highs. You're going to see every part of Medicare affected. Med Supp rates are already going up like crazy, premiums for Part D plans will be much higher, with higher copays on meds and Medicare Advantage plans will have less "extra benefits" like dental, vision, hearing, and for more you will probably need to pay an added premium. All in all it's adjustment. In my opinion, insurance companies were giving way too much on those MAPD plans and weren't making enough on the back in due to utilization being so high, it was bound to break somewhere"

"In a blazing panic! Okay, I'm in panic mode. On 9/15/2025 I turned 65, and I did what I was supposed to do. I signed up for Medicare, online. That was easy enough. At the end of the application, before I signed, there was a space to write any questions or concerns I have, especially for the Part B premiums. I explained I have been out of work since June 2025, and I'm currently receiving unemployment benefits. Unemployment I get barely scratches my rent. I had to work for, and was approved for SNAP. So at least I won't go hungry. But that leaves nothing for power bill my car ins and my phone. I got my Medicare card, but there was no info in the letter addressing what happens if you cannot meet the Part B premium. Today I get a bill for \$740, which will cover until January 2026, and it says pay in full, not each month, (which I can't even do that), but to pay in full by 10/25/25! I'm freaking out! No job, I get \$378 week from unemployment, (the amount I was approved for was \$419. They take taxes out so it brings it to \$378). Thank goodness the management company has been and letting my rent go one extra week, with only an added \$5 late fee. My monthly rent takes every penny of the unemployment. What will I do? I can't find any concrete information to find where to get help. This is one of the most frightening things I can remember going through. If I can't find help I'm going to have no choice but to just check out. What else can I do? How ridiculous will it be to be homeless, list everything I ever worked for and all to pay Medicare part b? Which I told them in that little note they all you to write for any questions or concerns I have? I think I'm gonna be done on this earth soon. All my life I've been working hard, became a widow suddenly at 46 but I have been taking care of myself, raised a daughter, and asking nobody for help...with nothing to show for it, then to just be out in the street? Jesus, Joseph and Mary!"

— r/medicare · 26 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o1zqfs/>

↳ (0): "See if you can qualify for Medicare savings program. Info [here](<https://www.medicare.gov/basics/costs/help/medicare-savings-programs>).";

↳ (0): "You may want to also apply for Medicaid through your state."

↳ (0): "I'm assuming that you are not redy to *retire* yet and start drawing from your Social Security benefits? I realize just how much of a penalty you'll have for starting at the earliest possible age, but it's better than nothing, assuming that you don't qualify for Medicaid (for some reason)."

"I received a notice in the mail yesterday from my insurance company. My Part D drug coverage premium is going from \$40 per month to \$140 per month!"

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgzQjK2uaBRaZJ-tFd94AaABAg>

↳ @foodpimp55 (2): "We renamed a lake though"

↳ @DebFry0507 (0): "@foodpimp55for sure!😭"

↳ @YolandaVasquez-r5y (0): "Sorry to hear that mine went up from \$25 dollars to 50.00 dollars now it's going up to 95..00 x2 so we will see my husband injection for his cholesterol is 334.00 every 2 months"

"I am 71 and have Plan G with Mutual of Omaha. With regard to my health, I am in stage 3b of Chronic Kidney Disease and have Ankylosing Spondylitis. Today I received a notice of annual premium increase from MoO informing me that my premium for 2027 will go up 22%. Unbelievable! And now I worry what it will cost at 81 years old. Sounds like it will cost me tens of thousands of dollars each year to continue coverage with Mutual of Omaha."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement 2026: Full Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5Qc8YvvLjGE&lc=UgyubXlqzVFKc-61s3J4AaABAg>

↳ @MedicarePlanFit (2): "I am so sorry to hear that! Unfortunately, we continue to see high rate increases for Medicare supplements, and this is happening to people everywhere. 🙄 "

"I look at my EOBs every month and I still didn't realize until today that my Medicare drug plan isn't paying anything for my medication. It all comes from my co-pays and this subsidy I guess. It's bizarre I don't know what I'm paying them \$80 a month for they pay nothing."

— YouTube · Trump Administration to End Medicare Drug Plan Subsidy. #medication #medicare #doctor · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BrOgvbQKs-A&lc=Ugw_aY_Cxd5JBHBV0S94AaABAg.AZp4Twiv2WbAZr8gXrLWtQ

"@ronharrington8659 I go to two doctors that charge more than copayment and They are specialist: my lung doctor and my heart doctor, not matter what they send me bills to complete their fees that is not covered by nobody, on top of my annual deduction of \$226.00, really there is not insurance that cover all, except funeral expenses insurance 🙄 , so I am checking every detail to offset the extra premium, that in my case will be \$35.00, as my quote said, my plan N is \$80.00, the plan G will be \$115.00, annually it will be \$420.00, actually I got bills for exactly that amount or little more, only from these two doctors and my primary care also sent bills for \$18.00 for every visit every 3 months because I need thyroid blood test constantly because I am hormone dependent, that is an additional \$72.00, plus the \$420=492 yearly +226 deductible totalling \$718.00 yearly to pay + premium \$115x12=1380.00, adding the \$718.00 I have an expense of \$1,380+718=2,098.00 yearly., the only good thing will be that if really I got sick and I need hospital care or rehab care facilities I hope all will be covered. At almost 70 years old I better get the best I can afford now while they cannot deny me coverage. With plan N now it cost me \$960.00 yearly the premium alone,"

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=Ugy_CasH76SFioSyRjZ4AaABAg.9hPSQtk5pGQ9hS1-NaSs-W

"This morning I looked at the medicare part D EOB for June that has the totals for the 1st 6 months of 2026. My part D plan paid \$0 for my meds in 2026 so far. It was all my copays and the rest paid by "extra help". I also get something like \$20 off my monthly premiums because of "extra help" yet I still pay more than \$80 a month to Aetna/Silver scripts and they pay NOTHING to the pharmacy. Is this the subsidy you're talking about? Why is "extra help" paying everything for my meds that isn't my copays? Why does Aetna get to pay NOTHING while collect a monthly premium from me and some from "extra help"??"

— YouTube · Trump Administration to End Medicare Drug Plan Subsidy. #medication #medicare #doctor · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BrOgvbQKs-A&lc=UgzpGSISqJRdv35iTI14AaABAg>

"Up just \$10 a month because of losing the subsidy. Ha! Just got notice in the mail today that my drug insurance goes from payment of \$63/month to \$123/month in 2027. I spend \$8 a month on meds. The insurance will cost 8 times more than my medicine."

— YouTube · BIG Medicare Changes Coming in 2027 — What You Need to Know · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nXXywC4myaw&lc=UgyTGYiSdoLWanFHvKJ4AaABAg>

On hold or on the phone with the plan, Medicare or Social Security · 7 documents · 7 voices

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAg>

↳ @logicalblueberry (3): "That's awesome. \$158 per month seems very affordable. I was worried that it would cost several hundred per month. Seems like an easier choice than I was expecting then."

↳ @maido9434 (2): "Totally agreed with you . We had same problem. My husband has Parkinson's and had to pay a lot out of pockets after his 2 hospitalization . He had to pay \$250/ day for 7 days first and other co insurance fees . I luckily was able to change to Medicare supplement thus year after underwent medical underwriting process . I was very happy to be able to switch . However , I heard that Dr Oz will make Medicare advantage mandatory because the insurance can make more money . I hope this wasn't true . This video is on you tube ffrom one of the Dr !"

↳ @maido9434 (0): "Will you share with me what company did you go with for dental / drugs/ eyes insurances ! I do not like Cigna and United healthcare that I currently have now . Thanks in advance"

"One Dr I saw last year they didn't know much about coding. Took me a year to get the collection agency to stop harassing me and the Dr office to finally figure out the code. I spent probably 80 hours on phone calls. I should have just paid the thousand dollar cost but I didn't want to pay for tests that I have insurance for. My biggest surprise was how expensive Medicare is. And all the add ons; copays, prescription drugs, the 20% Medicare does not cover which you have to buy separate insurance for. And then no dental. Of course our senators and congress have gold star insurance for life, so what do they care."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwWGMlS3ApOviVsEI4AaABAg.ATc5JacW6QoA_Njx7EYDzt

"While medicare advantage plans may be worth it elsewhere, I wouldn't recommend it from Blue Cross Blue Shield. Florida Blue has been a repeated trial of my patience. As an example, in May my doctor ordered a mobility scooter. In June since I had heard from no one, I called BCBS. They were sitting on the order; why I don't know. Once I got them to move on the order, they sent it to their equipt provider. When I hadn't heard from them after a few weeks, I called BCBS and them again. The provider had not acted on the order, (seems to be a theme here). They called the next day to try and get me to take a scooter that did not come anywhere near the item the doctor ordered. When I called them all again to get this fixed, BCBS/care centrix moved the order to yet another provider. When I hadn't heard from these folks, I called them this morning. They looked up the order and the only answer they provided was "we don't provide scooters to stroke patients". I'm starting to wonder if this entire medicare advantage plan isn't just a scheme. I'm looking forward to the end of the year when I can get a different plan. Bottom line? If you want adequate health coverage and piece of mind - GO ANYHWEHRE EXCEPT BLUE CROSS BLUE SHIELD."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plan Reviews ★ (from real people) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nw14VxxHrmM&lc=UgzZbm79IZ4kJdRnP1Z4AaABAg>

"@erosmyersWhile I agree Advantage plans are not a good deal. I feel it's rather harsh to refer to Stephanie as a pusher of those policies. In my experience they didn't appear to have any agenda. I knew from doing some homework that medigap was the way to go. And Carter, the agent I worked with, did not try to steer me in any direction really. I felt he was sincerely looking out for my best interest. I mean it sounds like I'm a fan, and I am, because in today's world good customer service can be a rare thing. I appreciate company who still have an understanding of of what good customer service means."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgxSAj3YtQY5wYQ5qDF4AaABAg.AOJgvpOu7WQAP_KU5DLfA2

"Medicare Advantage is great for healthy people. Medicare Supplements are great for sick people. My wife recently racked up 200 grand in medical bills, multiple hospitals and specialists. Multiple ambulance trips between hospitals. Then nursing care and back into acute care, then rehab and months of in home PT, durable medical equipment etc. We have original Medicare and G supplement. Our total cost (after the Part B deductible of 200.00 bucks) ZERO, NADA, NOTHING! There was one piece of equipment that wasn't covered, but Medicare told us that since the provider didn't tell us that it wouldn't be covered, because they didn't take Medicare assignment, we didn't have to pay for it! And they contacted us and told us before we ever knew it wasn't covered!! Our case manager kept telling us how fortunate we were to have original Medicare and a supplement. She said people with Advantage Plans are constantly on the phone fighting for coverage, arguing with insurance. We were never on the phone arguing with anyone once. All we had to worry about was my wife getting better. The doctors ordered it, Medicare paid for it. Period."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgyYD0Su0JT2-8sO63d4AaABAg.9VelwLFh7JA9e9hFhr1dEM>

"I started with an advantage plan and when the info came for the next year, they had cut the gym and OTC , which was all we used really. The copays and deductibles went thru the roof. I was still in the "effective date" 6 mo to get supplemental without underwriting. So my agent suggested Humana plan N. Over the next 4 months, we all spent hours on the phone trying to get answers. They would send incomprehensible emails with abbreviations and letters. I did not know what, "need eff date of med adv pln. meant. I finally just gave up, because they had stalled until the date passed and I would have had to start over and do underwriting. 🙄 I think they did that on purpose. So I decided to save the \$1000 premium and use the money for things to keep me healthy like gym membership, healthier foods, supplements etc."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugw_0OLKTWZV_kA-fKh4AaABAg

"Not that easy. Had mandatory age 65 retirement last July. Income is now reduced by 75-80%. Sent in all documents via registered mail to the Naples, FL office Dec 7, received in office Dec.9. Have proof of delivery (green receipt- but not signed). Haven't heard a word. Finally got Social Security on the phone today. (After 3hours and 20 minutes on hold). No record of receiving my documents, nothing scanned in the system. What about my return receipt on registered mail I asked? Doesn't matter, nothing they can do. Said I needed to start all over again and re-send everything. Great, wonderful. I'm paying the max IRMAA when I shouldn't be paying anything."

— YouTube · Medicare IRMAA (Everything You Need To Know) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WUaV8Eh6pKQ&lc=Ugx4t5faPLoF3D8UvpB4AaABAg>

↳ @MedigapSeminars (0): "@tomsnelling4603 I have heard similar stories from several people. In addition, sometimes talking to Medicare is like talking to the IRS, every conversation yields a different answer. Two things I suggest one is an in person meeting at a Social Security office. Second, if that cannot happen then call the one 800 Medicare number after hours. After regular business hours East Coast time. That way you get the West Coast office, I believe it's in Texas or Kansas and a higher quality service."

Private Worries

Can't afford premiums, Part B, drugs or dental · 297 documents

"My wife and I signed up for Medicare plus the G supplement plus Medicare D. At First it was fine, but after 3- 4 years it was costing us 700 dollars a MONTH. We kept it when we were traveling. It did pay claims, but we did have to pay some stuff. It just became too expensive to keep. So, we changed to the Advantage type after moving to a higher population area. Referrals are not a problem most of the time. Now our max out-of-pocket is 700 dollars a YEAR. My drug copays were 25 bucks for the YEAR, no deductible. True, we have to stay within the provider groups, but we have quite a few to pick from. Original Medicare is great, if you're rich or can go to wherever you have the money to afford to seek out expensive care. Not so much if you live in a backward state or a medical wasteland. Either way you go, you're screwed. Insurance companies, PBMs, hospitals, medical groups, drug companies, crooks who cheat Medicare at every turn are what we Americans are stuck with at this point. The ruling rich overlords will never change it. Congress and the courts have been bought, and YOU AND I have been stuck with the bill."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 722 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgxAXzFMBaU_-X7O2GZ4AaABAg

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAq>

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— medicare · 88 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1op2r5b/>

"I'm a dentist and I just dropped my Medicare Advantage in network participation. They decided to offer reimbursement rates lower than the numbers from 2017. Sorry I can't afford to pay to see Medicare Advantage patients."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=Ugxon36nbcDg9yeXQCp4AaABAq>

"Unfortunately, many of us can't afford anything else. We have had a Medicare Advantage plan for the last 10 years and it has delivered excellent care for us. It all depends on which plan you choose. Do some research and compare the different companies for their customer satisfaction ratings, and get input from friends who have these plans."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 63 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwLWpl68A_Gul46akN4AaABAq

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tbdbvh/>

"COLA INCREASE GONE. Huge jump in Medicare has my mom/dad receiving less than before. I'm in Florida. My parents recently made a series of bad decisions this year. They sold their home, instead of filing bankruptcy, got 10k, and are now broke. They moved 3 states in as many months, until I said to come back here. It's easier to help them when they're down the street. The problem is, they're flat broke. They live in a nasty 2/1 trailer for 850/month they could barely cover before. They've been there 2 months. They got a shock this month when their SS checks were less. IDK how much less my mom's was, but my dad's was 170 less. I thought they were getting an increase. Either way, they already couldn't afford anything. They can't afford their meds. They can't afford their Medicare, and I had to come out of pocket \$500 to cover some basic needs of theirs. Is there a way to apply for Medicaid? Food stamps? My mother had to get inhaler samples from her doctor because she couldn't pay the \$30 to get them from the pharmacy. I gave her \$50, but by the time I got to their house, they'd gotten the samples free. That was before this loss of SS. They'll be short on rent and literally everything every single month. They have no money for food, expenses, healthcare, prescriptions... gas, insurance, you name it. What are their options? I'm sad I didn't get involved last year when they started making their bad financial decisions. I should have taken over. In less than 6 months they went from stable to unstable and broke living in a rather shifty mon to mon tenancy agreement. I want them to be stable. I can't afford to pay these monthly shortfalls, but they'll be short. I'm also not understanding why their checks are so much less, and they don't know why, either."

— medicare · 57 upvotes · family member helping · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1pbkgxm/>

"I understand your point about averages. I chose HD-G when I turned 65 and started on original Medicare. Out of pocket expenses have been manageable and in line with my expectations. I'm 70 now. My biggest challenge is the annual premium increases. You showed 2-4% as an average for HD-G. My premium increases the past 3 years were 14%, 20%, and 21%. Combined, the increase was 59% higher than the premium from 3 years ago. I can still pass underwriting and switched companies, which helped some. My overall worry is these type of increases aren't "sustainable" over 15-20 years..."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 54 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzxVpDFzqjIW527Aop4AaABAg>

"Anyone else not having fun anymore? I work at/partially own a smaller independent agency here in the Midwest with my dad and brother. I've been doing this for 14 years now and boy, the past 12 months has sucked. We only have 4 agents but I think the last time I checked our total written premium we were at \$9m so we're doing alright. We're pretty evenly split between personal and commercial and are really lucky to have a big selection of companies. * Travelers, Progressive, Nat Gen, Safeco, Hartford AARP, Auto Owners, Cincinnati, Philly, Nationwide, Openly, Stillwater, and probably a dozen specialty and mutual companies. I'm sure I'm forgetting a couple. I'm fully aware we got it better than most. Even still, this isn't really fun anymore. Especially on the personal side of things. I know we're not FL or TX but my god is it getting tough to shop people around. That's kinda our whole thing. We've always prided ourselves on being honest, upfront, actually answering the phones when folks call in, and trying to do what's best for the customer even if that means less commission. Us agents do all our own quoting and 90% of the servicing. I know we do it differently than most agencies. By doing that we've done pretty well for ourselves and really don't need to advertise or worry about finding leads. We run solely off referrals and call ins and are too busy to keep up. That's the good thing about right now. 10 years ago, we were desperate for business and would have to take anyone who walked in the door. Nowadays, I bet we have to turn away 30% of new customers for misc reasons. Oh your roof is 11 years old, tough. Your house is \$212k and 100 years old, sorry. A single water claim in the last 5 years, nope. You bought both of your daughters Kias?? I can't tell you how many call ins I've sent to Farm Bureau. 2-3 a week at least. We just had a big regional meeting with our parent company last week and boy it was grim. It was the most depressing company round up I've ever been to. Record losses, more companies tightening guidelines, don't expect profit payouts again anytime soon. I was sitting with some of our peer agency (comparable # of employees and companies) and man, they sure seemed like they were struggling. A couple of them said they were closing 3-4 customers a week and he seemed proud of it. Like for the whole agency. I didn't tell him that I myself did 6 that week. I'm not complaining about the money. I made \$25k more this past year than the year before it. I'll probably match that again this year given what renewals are rolling in at. I'm just getting real tired of quoting a perfectly normal 2,700 sqft 2 story with a perfectly fine 12 year old roof and not being able to do anything. I quote 9 different companies and only one offers me a price and it's \$1200 more than what they paid last year. There's a good chance I'll get that sale but the customer already doesn't like me. I'm tired of having to justify the 79% rate increase I saw this morning on a Nationwide home (no claim). I'm tired of every single elderly person telling me "I'm on a fixed income" whenever their policy goes up \$27. I'm tired of roofing companies rolling our customer's wind/hail deductible into the amount they're billing the insurance company to win over their business. And then I'm tired when that same customer bitches to me next Summer when their home goes up \$1800 on renewal. I'm tired of not being able to talk to an underwriter anymore without first going through India and having them pretend to know what's going on only to transfer me to a misc underwriter 10 minutes later. I'm not saying this job was all sunshine and daisy's but it's crazy how much less stressful it was just 2-3 years ago. My dad's been an agent for 40 years (25 with Farmers) and he said this is the worst market he's ever seen. He predominantly does commercial and habitational and that's become a nightmare as well. He's had to turn away \$250k premium accounts recently because there's literally not a single other market for it. Please tell me we're not alone. Please tell me this is temporary and it won't suck to come into work in 2 years. We've never ever listened to a single buyout offer but man, I get why some folks do it these days."

— InsuranceAgent · 51 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cswcw9/anyone_else_not_having_fun_anymore/

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAg

"IF you can afford it! We have a supplement, but I can see it pricing us right out and into Advantage just because we can't afford the monthly cost! A neighbor friend was just forced into an Advantage plan because her supplement cost was over \$400 monthly!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 36 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzozvb_m6d2TPJIXMV4AaABAg

"What the hell? Last year when I was looking at this, you couldn't stop praising plan G. Now I'm stuck with a plan, G, and you're saying it's not the best plan. I hate that I'm spending so much for the plan and Medicare Part B, but it really covered my butt on medical expenses this year. I'm just praying the premium doesn't skyrocket on renewal because then I'll be forced to switch if I can (because I'm on a fixed income). Gah! Insurance in this country makes me crazy."

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgwxNoP2S99tFzGKrQ94AaABAg

"I studied and researched the daylights out of it before choosing my first supplement. I never could have anticipated a 45% premium increase in just 18 months. That's why I switched mine."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgyXsAHIKfAIUhHa5P94AaABAg>

"Since I don't have to see the doctor all of the time, only once a year for my Medicare Wellness Visit I will be checking into Plan N because Plan G is getting too expensive for me. You did such a thorough job of explaining everything that even a lay person can understand and showing us a chart comparing Plans. I learned a lot."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=Ugzr6RNU102QVW7Rwv14AaABAg>

"I was working with an employer but I covered by my wife's insurance where she worked. It got so expensive like about \$600 a month at 66 I signed up for A & B and a G Plan as well and saved \$300 a month switching to Medicare for myself. I worked till 69 to get the most money of SS. I was not penalized for anything! It was best decision for us."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgyR73hvpzWy4668p-B4AaABAg>

"I realize that your target audience is folks new to Medicare. But investigating how this will play out in the future is significant. My own experience has been that the growth rate of the Plan G HD deductible and premium is far slower than the Plan G premium. Now that I'm 74 I can see that Plan G HD would have been a far better choice as the Plan G premium increase just about covers the current deductible. That means in a low usage year I save money and have the assurance that in a high usage year the risk is limited. I'm sure you have access to more data about rate increase and deductible increase available to you to make reasonable projections."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plans I Plan G vs High Deductible Plan G vs Plan N I Which one is right · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LmpaQdZxyI4&lc=UgxuMQ5KeMpVUIubZq54AaABAg>

"What you say may be true for some, but if you have a Kaiser HMO everything is different. I love Kaiser. I worked at Kaiser for years and I know it from the inside and out. When I hit 65 I opted for Kaiser's Medicare Senior Advantage. Nothing has changed for me except that I have more durable medical equipment options and things extended care and like that. My office visits cost \$5 instead of \$25. I did have to sign up for Plan B which I wouldn't have had to if I just continued Kaiser, but I could see that it could become a big cost saver down the road when I get really old. But who knows what the future will bring? That's the thing with any kind of insurance. It's a crapshoot. And let's face it, with medical care, the less you need it, the better. It's much better to pay into it not use it then not have it when you do need it. And my Kaiser Senior Advantage is always there if I need it, something that as I get older is going to become more important. A lot of people like to bash Kaiser, but it's the best HMO out there. I can tell you that if you need something, you will get it. For-profit insurance plans make money by doling expensive care. Kaiser is a not-for-profit and their goal is to keep you healthy so you don't need the expensive care down the road. But if you do, it is there. My husband needed a heart transplant. He checked into Stanford Hospital and was billed the Kaiser hospital admission co-pay of \$250. He walked out with no more charges. Zero. He had a heart transplant, something that cost anywhere from a \$half million to over \$1 million for \$250. And despite the huge cost of the immunosuppressive drugs, he has only a \$20 co-pay with no cap. Kaiser decided that there's no point in paying for a heart transplant if they won't pay for the drugs that you need to keep yourself alive. Most people can't afford a couple thousand dollars a month for medicines. So we're fans of Kaiser and I'm a fan of Senior Advantage. I kept my original benefits except that they've been expanded now."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyGOoPOpnz833X5Yo54AaABAg>

"Your numbers worked great for you and the analysis is spot on. I went with G (could have chosen F) due to lower premiums that more than offset the deductible. I was the once a year doctor visit personuntil I was diagnosed with an advanced cancer about 18 months later. I honestly can't even answer what would have counted as a "doctor visit." I know that the doc came in during each chemo appointment and charged a visit. There were weekly doc visits during radiology as well as extra visits when complications popped up, so no doubt I used well more than my share of doc visits during treatment. Now, with an official status of "no evidence of disease," I'm still seeing at least a surgical oncologist and a medical oncologist every 3-6 months (depending on lab and imaging results), as well as any odd things that come up--that silly lesion that sent me to a dermatologist, the orthopedic visit when I injured my wrist.....Like you I'm a numbers nerd. In my case, the "break even point" between G and N is slightly less than 5 years. For that 4.8 years G was cheaper. Yes going forward, the higher premium increase with G bothers me. On the other hand, I don't know what my health status will look like in the future, and one serious diagnosis could totally change the analysis. I can't change it now, so it is all a "numbers game." Bottom line though--I retired earlier than some, so had to buy private insurance. Thanks to the "Unaffordable Care Act," my premiums went from \$236 when I retired to \$984 the year I qualified for Medicare, and I had increased the deductible to keep the cost lower. Plan G with supplement and drug plan is still far less than private insurance. Again, I've wondered long term as we have all paid into Medicare all those many high earning years, but those are gone now. I'd delighted to be paying less for Medicare than any sort of private coverage. Ultimately, you make your best guess and take your chances,"

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgyIsx0M0F6ktwn1RzB4AaABAq>

"I'm 73, had plan g since the beginning, been healthy, disappointed that my premium went up to 268 a month, thinking of switching to advantage plan. And I'm disappointed that my agent didn't help me understand about Medicare part D, which I did not sign up for, and now I have to pay penalties from now on. I am in Texas, and I hope I have a memory like an ELEPHANT for all that you have explained."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=Ugx1SAL00qKcb-uYy2t4AaABAq>

Stuck in Advantage: can't get a Medigap later · 258 documents

"The ACA in a death spiral? Everyone seems to forget: the original ACA had (1) a requirement that everyone had to participate or they would pay a tax penalty, and (2) states had to opt into expanded ~Medicare~ Medicaid . These two provisions were later removed, and thus began the spiraling death of the ACA. As predicted. Once you understand that universal health care is essential if you want to control costs while making sure everyone is covered (including people with pre-existing conditions), its obvious it only works if either (a) everyone must pay into it, regardless of their current needs, or (b) if you don't pay into it, you are not eligible for the benefit. Look, it is INSURANCE, similar to car insurance: you pay your car insurance monthly hoping you never get into an accident which requires you to use it. You pay more, or less, according to your risk factors. Health insurance is similar. You hope YOU are not that 30 year old who gets cancer that costs \$1m to treat (or that 60 year old who has a massive heart attack) but if you are, you are glad you are covered. But if it is optional, people play the odds game against insurance: I am healthy right now, I don't think I personally will get back what I am paying in so I am NOT buying insurance. Leaving mostly unhealthy 30 or 60 year olds in their rate group, requiring prices to rise because unhealthy people cost more because they consume more (doctor care, emergency visits, medicines, therapy, etc.) Spiral, spiral and spiral. And what are we, as a nation, willing to do with people without means of obtaining medical care? Lock the emergency room door when someone bleeding approaches without insurance or money? Well, this will soon be the case anyway, as emergency departments already see the writing on the wall and are shuttering before they go bankrupt. If you truly believe in the American trickle down theory (wherein rich business people, getting huge tax breaks, provide people with good paying jobs with health insurance), great! Let's see when that starts happening! I guess you are saying we just need to ignore wealth inequality (even though a small number of the wealthiest billionaires combined hold more wealth than the bottom 50% of the entire U.S. population.) I, for one, will be voting for the next person running for president (from whatever party) who runs on implementing true health care reform in the form of universal health care. I don't care what we call it: Gold Health Plans, Medicare for All, ACA v 2.0, whatever. Why can't WE get it done, just like every other civilized country has figured out how to accomplish? Help me understand."

— HealthInsurance · 804 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1q27xss/>

"Universal coverage is simple, but the facts are unpalatable to many **Background premises:** I'll start with the premise that, in the USA, a citizen who gets a curable cancer should not die for want of care. (You may agree with that premise or not, but I'm doing a thought experiment about universal coverage and this premise is the basic justification for universal coverage.) (I'm leaving out non-citizens not because I don't care about them, but because I want to avoid side issues and make clear how brutally limited our choices are to meet the goal of "curable cancer shouldn't kill you.") I have an opinion about the best way to solve the problem, but I won't express it now. I will just list the logical possibilities. There aren't many. **Option 1:** If you get cancer, go to the ED. This is pretty much the system now. You will probably get care, although it will likely be delayed and suboptimal. Guess who pays for this? Ultimately the government/populace. Doctors and hospitals cannot provide free care for everyone who has no insurance, without ultimately going bankrupt. So ultimately the government/populace pays for this. The mechanisms are weird and varied - various subsidies, overcharging private insurers, "safety net" hospitals which are subsidized by the government, etc. But let's not kid ourselves. Someone pays for it - and that someone is us. And if the mechanisms of payment are weird and varied, they are probably inefficient and wasteful. And of course, if people actually could get preventive care, maybe fewer people would get cancer and maybe that would be better for all of us in the long run (ya think?). **Option 2:** The government covers everyone. The easiest way to do this is by making people over 60 eligible for Medicare, then next year adding people under 18 and people over 55. In a few years, we have Medicare for all. To cushion the economic change for insurance companies, you can drag this out over 10 years or so if you wish. Government-run systems in other countries have lots of problems, and people in those countries are often unhappy with them, but they do cover everyone, and developed nations with universal health care - without exception - spend much less and get better global outcomes than we do. Yes, you may have to wait a year or longer for your hip replacement in Canada. But overall, you will live longer and healthier. Which are you gonna choose? And yes, it's really a choice: If a country devotes all its resources to making sure the fraction of the population who need a hip replacement get it within 3 weeks, a lot of resources have to be diverted from preventative and primary care. You have to decide at the beginning if immediate availability of elective care is more important, or if overall health and longevity of the population is more important. \[As an aside, if the government covered everyone we would collect something like \$600M more in taxes annually, because employers wouldn't provide health insurance plans, and the money previously used for employer-provided plans would be taxable (either on the company side or the employee side).\] **Option 3:** A market based plan. Here the choices are much starker than most people realize. It basically means everyone gets some kind of private insurance so that when you get a curable cancer you don't die. Almost all Americans, in polls, agree that you should be able to get insurance even if you have a pre-existing condition. If you are guaranteed coverage for pre-existing conditions, most people will be better off not getting insurance until they get cancer. The people who will buy insurance right away are those with expensive chronic conditions. Someone who has an autoimmune disorder and needs \$30K worth of biological meds annually will buy insurance. Someone who is healthy will not buy insurance and pay for basic care out of pocket. If the healthy person gets cancer, they'll just buy insurance at that point. I hope it's clear to all that under this system no insurance company will stay in business for more than a year or two. Nobody will buy insurance until the insurance payouts they get are larger than their premium. Meaning the insurance companies will lose money on every policy they sell. So, if you are going to have a market based plan that meets the goal of "people don't die of a curable cancer," you have to persuade or require healthy people to join now. Health insurance (whether provided by Medicare, Medicaid or private companies) is a mechanism of spreading risk. We can afford to care for a child with cancer ONLY because a lot of people are paying insurance premiums (or taxes) when they don't need expensive services. Hence the Affordable Care Act. There are many things to like or dislike about the ACA, but it's shocking how many don't seem to grasp the basic premise. **You cannot provide coverage for pre-existing conditions unless healthy people pay premiums.** This is not an opinion. It's mathematics. I am not a huge fan of insurance companies, but if they spend more than they take in on every

policy they will fail - and thus a system that relies on insurance companies will fail. **Conclusions** I submit that there is basically no way to meet the goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care" except the 3 I have outlined. If anyone can propose another, I'd love to hear about it. Any plan that doesn't adopt one of these three premises fails to meet the basic goal of "A US citizen with a curable cancer shouldn't die for want of care." Health savings plans, tax breaks, malpractice reforms, etc, nibble around the edges of the problem, and may make some significant improvements here or there. But to meet the really important goal, you need a comprehensive approach, and the only mathematical possibilities are (1) The government/ populace pays for it indirectly, (2) The government/ populace pays for it directly, or (3) Healthy people have to be required to buy insurance so that sick people can get care that would otherwise be beyond their means. My two cents. I welcome all of your opinions about this."

— HealthInsurance · 404 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1pqufyv/>

"GREAT job, Erin! I'm a retired physician and I think you hit this out of the park. My wife and I started with an MC Advantage Plan but the unpredictability of out-of-network coverage, rapidly increasing max. out of pocket limits, increasing daily hospital copays, and pretty inadequate rehab coverage really began to make me rethink our decision. When our MC Advantage plan wasn't available in our area for 2026 we were so happy to be able to switch to a Medigap plan with guaranteed issue during a Special Enrollment Period (SEP). It's one of the few ways to be able to switch in that direction without underwriting. Yes the premiums are significant but the predictability of healthcare expenses, portability, and freedom of choice where to receive care made it worth it to us - priceless, in fact. I'm 67 and my wife is 72. Thank you for helping so many future decision-makers have such clarity."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 156 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugwn9ICoa-Qw7KmDdUp4AaABAq>

"What decisions as you near retirement are "time-sensitive"? As you near retirement (say, 65) what decisions are "time-sensitive"? We had a close call with almost being unable to get a Medicare supplement (Medigap). Was not aware you get a *one-time* 6 month window when you first get Medicare that insurance/supplement companies are *required* to allow you to enroll and cannot deny you (or charge a higher rate). Individual here was pressured to take Medicare Advantage and lost their guaranteed issue timeframe and had to go through medical underwriting and was initially denied and had to appeal to get approved. This makes me wonder, what other decisions regarding retirement are "time-sensitive" or something individuals may not think about and/or realize before it's too late?"

— retirement · 121 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1n0pjc2/>

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

"I'm 75 and have been Medicare covered for 10 years. I started out the first year with Plan C (Advantage). But I got lucky, my carrier cancelled the plan in my area of Minnesota which triggered a "Special Enrollment Period" during which time I was able to move to a MediGap plan just like it was day one of my eligibility. Guaranteed issue, no MIB etc. Due to cardiac bypass surgery and hip replacements in my medical history I would probably not have been able to switch to a Supplement without the SEP kicking in. Six months ago with \$70K of unexpected Mayo radiation treatments I am relieved that my Advantage carrier decided to leave the area 9 years ago. You didn't cover Special Enrollment Periods but that's what saved me from being trapped in a Part C plan. Nice job explaining how this all works in an objective fashion."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 88 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwO03YTuvFEg34QrmF4AaABAg>

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

"Thank you. One of the most professional and knowledgeable presentations that I have heard about the pros and cons of Advantage Plans vs. Supplement Plans. Medical underwriting was explained to me using an airport analogy: I've gotten off the plane and I'm free to walk around the airport, go to the news stand, get a cup of coffee, etc. When I leave that secure area (like leaving my original, one-time-only enrollment period), I walk through doors with signs that say "exit only, no returning through these doors". If I want to go back into the airport, I have to go through security (i.e. underwriting) again. It's a time-consuming hassle for folks who take that route. And there's no guarantee that a person will get through medical underwriting successfully."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 59 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxclzjxWRhhykzbdwp4AaABAg

"You are the GIRAFFE of all the YouTubers guiding seniors on Medicare, meaning you stick out and have a greater vista above the rest. Very grateful to you. My spouse and I were on his employer's Group Medicare Advantage for years, and this large (well-known) employer decided to unload all their retirees beginning Jan 1, 2026. Beginning the first of next calendar year, the only Medicare Advantage in our area (this time the individual, not Group as that is no longer available through the mentioned employer) were dumped by most of our trusted doctors as well as the local hospitals 😞. In short, we had no choice but to go on a supplement plan. Because of said "dumping," we have guaranteed issue, (though we likely would have passed medical assignment being in good health) so we are about to find out how much we like being on a supplement plan starting the first of next year. Medicare Group Advantage has served us nicely for four years, but we had to change. So much "dumping" is happening out there on the Advantage side."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 49 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgzbA2EY3Kzx6LQjVqJ4AaABAg>

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>";

— medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/>

"Doctors Or Medical People Ever since I went on Medicare, my doctor seems to think I'm on the verge of total collapse. I went in for a routine physical. I felt fine. I still feel fine. But now I have appointments for: • A cardiologist, even though I've never had heart issues. • A CT scan of my lungs because I used to smoke — 15 years ago. • A breast sonogram because the mammogram showed a "slight deviation," which last time turned out to be nothing at all. • A liver scan, in case the fatty liver I had a decade ago has staged a dramatic comeback. When I had commercial insurance at 64, none of this came up. At 65, on Medicare, I apparently became a collection of pre-existing conditions waiting to happen. Is this standard? Do they think I'm fragile now? Or is the system just trying to squeeze every possible test out of me because Medicare pays less?"

— medicare · 41 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ld3w1o/>

"Hi Dr Ed! My mom is 82 and had dropped her Medicare Supplement in Illinois because her partner wanted Medicare Advantage plans with an OTC benefit! Moving in with me created an SEP so we called Chapter her first day here! Mom just passed medical underwriting and has a Plan F effective June 1st! You rock and I so appreciate the education provided in your videos ! Thank you thank you thank you! Cheers, Michael Albuquerque NM USA"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 39 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugz1hp93qJO8o52NhrR4AaABAg>

"NPR: Older Americans say they feel trapped in Medicare Advantage plans JANUARY 7, 2024 8:10 AM ET HEARD ON WEEKEND EDITION SUNDAY By Sarah Jane Tribble - Kaiser Health News 3-Minute Listen (Story first aired on All Things Considered on January 3, 2023.) UNIDENTIFIED NARRATOR: Right now is the Medicare annual enrollment period. 2024 Medicare Advantage plans are now available, so everyone on Medicare can call to see if a Medicare Advantage plan may be better for you. RASCOE: The plans are private insurance that Americans 65 and older can sign up for instead of traditional Medicare. And lots of Americans are signing up in this open enrollment period through March. Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News reports that some regret signing up and then have trouble getting out. SARAH JANE TRIBBLE: Back in 2016, when Richard Timmins first signed up for Medicare, he went to a free informational seminar with an insurance agent. RICHARD TIMMINS: Basically, he really promoted Medicare Advantage. He just said, well, look, it's less expensive. It's broader in coverage. TRIBBLE: For Timmins, it made economic sense to sign up for Medicare Advantage instead of traditional Medicare, and that worked out great - for a while. Then, he found a small bump on the back of his right ear. TIMMINS: I have a family history of melanoma, so I was kind of tuned into that and thinking about that. TRIBBLE: But it took him a long time to see the right specialist in his Medicare Advantage network, and getting the paperwork in order was confusing. TIMMINS: It was starting to - it started to grow and started to become rather painful. TRIBBLE: By the time Timmins finally saw an oncologist, the lesion had grown to the size of a dime. His right earlobe needed to be removed. He thinks getting care using traditional Medicare would have been faster and easier, and David Meyers at Brown University School of Public Health says he's probably right. DAVID MEYERS: You can see any provider you want. There are many less sort of restrictions on care. You get a lot more freedom with traditional Medicare. TRIBBLE: Timmins wishes he could switch, but there's a catch. TIMMINS: Would I go back to traditional Medicare if it was not cost prohibitive? Absolutely. TRIBBLE: Traditional Medicare premiums average about \$170 a month. And while enrollees on Medicare Advantage plans still pay that premium, the monthly cost can be more affordable. That's because plan enrollees often don't have to pay for extra prescription coverage. They also don't have to buy supplemental insurance, usually called Medigap. That supplemental insurance is needed because, unlike Medicare Advantage plans, traditional Medicare doesn't cap out-of-pocket cost. The thing is, Timmins might not be able to get a Medigap policy anymore. Here's David Lipschutz, associate director of the Center for Medicare Advocacy. DAVID LIPSCHUTZ: Medigap is one of the few types of insurance that can exclude you based upon preexisting conditions unless you enroll during certain designated times. TRIBBLE: That designated time is primarily when you first sign up for Medicare. But since Timmins enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan instead of traditional Medicare and he has a preexisting condition, he could be denied Medigap or charged a lot more for it. While federal law generally prohibits insurers from denying people coverage because of preexisting conditions, Medigap is an exception. Lipschutz again. LIPSCHUTZ: It's a lot easier to get and stay in a Medicare Advantage plan, but a lot harder to get out and pick up a Medigap plan, depending upon where you are. TRIBBLE: Only four states require Medigap insurers to cover applicants regardless of age or health. But Timmins lives in Washington state, which isn't one of them. He wants people to know. TIMMINS: You can get screwed if you're on Medicare Advantage. The advantage kind of disappears once you need them. TRIBBLE: In the meantime, Timmins worries. There's a chance that his cancer could come back, and he'll be trapped on Medicare Advantage if it does. So he's focusing on what he can control. TIMMINS: You know, I'm a vegetarian. I don't drink. I don't smoke. I try to get exercise as much as possible. TRIBBLE: But he knows it might not be enough. RASCOE: That was Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News. Copyright © 2024 NPR. All rights reserved. Visit our website terms of use and permissions pages at www.npr.org for further information."

— medicare · 35 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/192eueh/>

"I was a very healthy 76 year old until I was diagnosed with stomach cancer. Thankfully I am on traditional Medicare and a Medigap plan N. If I was on Medicare Advantage I would have several thousand dollars out of pocket every year and would not be able to switch to a Medigap plan because I would not pass Medical Underwriting to switch to a Medigap Plan."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugy_7hvcAC7i4wDbjQJ4AaABAg

"Thank you. I was directed to Medicare Advantage by my doctor when I retired. Fortunately I live in Washington State and I do not have a pre existing condition so I was able (after jumping through a million hoops) to get on traditional medicare Phew. I wish I had heard this video before."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwGNIGpqxvVGJJqZDZ4AaABAg>

"Maybe the GI (guaranteed issue) benefit should be a line on this chart. The presentation is excellent except for minimizing this as an issue. Just because you have no preexisting conditions now does not mean that you will never have any. At 65 I was fit with few medical visits and no prescription drugs. Two years later I have had melanoma and a heart diagnosis. Thankfully I have Plan G."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgyXPwc2Oqa_-aN2gwZ4AaABAg

"First, I'd suggest that those complaining about their Medicare Advantage plans ask for the plan's explanation of benefits and explanation of coverage before they sign up. A lot of what's being stated here is not true, and I've been on Advantage plans for more than 12 years. Also, this site is largely for Californians. Medicare Advantage plan coverage can change dramatically by state. In short, do your homework and don't ever use a broker. They receive compensation from a provider and may recommend a plan that only benefits the broker. Lastly, understand the Medicare Supplement rules. Once you leave a Supplement plan, preexisting conditions are not covered. With Advantage plans, they are."

— YouTube · 6 BIGGEST Medicare Changes in 2027!! IMPORTANT 🔊 · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1a0IVireAKg&lc=UgzVS2h2Np-DpkSvixB4AaABAg>

Denied care, prior authorization, narrow networks · 197 documents

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Being a Utilization management RN for a Florida based hospital for over 15 years, I totally agree with you. So often patients experience medical emergencies while on vacation and are limited to choices for care while away from home and "out of network." I advise my friends and family to always invest in supplements and keep Medicare, steering them away from advantage or replacement plans. I think it's a crime when I have to argue with advantage plans to authorize physician directed care after the acute health emergency has been addressed. Most folks don't realize that once a patient is determined to be stable, their care is limited to what their advantage plan will allow, even while they remain hospitalized. Often their choices decrease significantly when they are discharged. Those who require home health or rehabilitation services post-hospitalization can be severely restricted and are usually required to return home to their local area for coverage. You are providing a great service with your videos. Keep it up!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 513 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyQPwewvEHaPILi_Qd4AaABAg

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAg>

"As an Oncology provider for over 40 years I will tell you that there are other issues to consider which in my opinion make a G plan even more helpful. One of these issues is that G plans allow you to seek expert care outside of an Advantage plan PPO list of providers and institutions. I practice in a rural community and often send my patient to larger Comprehensive Cancer Centers around the country where they can get the best care for their unique situation. As I understand it, some Advantage plans may not pay as well in these situations. The other issue is prior approvals. If I order a diagnostic study such as a PET scan or MRI, or an IV chemotherapy medication agent, with a G plan there is no authorization process and these items will be paid for (assuming I am practicing within accepted guidelines). An Advantage plan may require a prior authorization before the test or medication can be ordered. These prior authorizations are a huge burden to providers and staff. Indeed, at many large institutions they will not spend any time on these and that means a less than ideal test or drug may need to be substituted."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 164 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=Ugyjp1bQgNodSTf4TMd4AaABAg>

"My husband was given the sales pitch about how great an advantage plan was. So he switched to Humana and the first two years were good. He was never sick. Then Covid came and he was diagnosed with cancer. We live in NH and the ER put him in an ambulance to go to Dana Farber in Boston (an hour away). Well guess what, the ambulance and hospital was out of network. Ambulance was \$5000. After he was diagnosed he passed away 72 days later. He was laying in the hospital bed stressed out about how I was going to pay all the medical bills when he dies. Sucks pretty bad when you're on your death bed and the only thing you think about is how your surviving spouse is going to pay the medical bills! Needless to say, when I signed up for Medicare I took a supplement plan."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 92 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgztwikgUWWxR35VyLN4AaABAq>

"Why does John Oliver hate Medicare Advantage so much? I'm huge fan of Last Week Tonight with John Oliver ([his show on MA.])(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc>) He is amazing at taking a topic, going in depth, and if need be, skewering it. But I think he was way off base on his Medicare Advantage rant. So, it costs the government--when has that ever bothered him (or me)? And yes, it's not the same as Original Medicare, but more like regular insurance. I know, I have it. Like all insurance are there instances of denial? Sure (although he was really reaching for it on some of his examples). But here's the thing. For me to switch to Part D and a Medigap plan it would cost me about \$3000 a year. I've had MA for 8 years, and I've never spent more than \$200 or \$300 in a given year on copays and coinsurance. And that's not counting the thousands I get in dental, eyewear, hearing, and OTC benefits (although granted some of those are being reduced or cut this year). And with my PPO plan, I can see any doctor or specialist I want without a referral, in or out of network (nearly every provider in my medium-size midwest city is in network). So, sure I could just go back to Original Medicare and pay the 20% it doesn't cover myself. Or I could get the drug and gap insurance (which you have to buy from private companies, by the way). But I can't afford either of those options. But I can afford my MA plan. And I wish rich people would stop telling me what to do with money I don't have."

— medicare · 88 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1op2r5b/>

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

"Prior authorization for Medicare Beginning in January 2026 people on traditional Medicare (not Medicare Advantage) in 6 states-Arizona, New Jersey, Oklahoma, Ohio, Washington state and Texas-will have to prior authorizations for spine surgery and some other types of care. This is a 6 year pilot program. They will use an AI algorithm. This seems dangerous to me when you consider the disruption in healthcare by insurance companies who already use AI algorithms to ration healthcare. There is a lot of incentive for AI companies to deny care. The AI companies will share in "savings" they create."

— medicare · 80 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1n5f4zw/>

"Watching my uncle struggle actually made me appreciate Medicare more He's 68 and chose a \$0 Medicare Advantage plan last year because, honestly, it looked amazing on paper. Then real life showed up. His longtime doctor was suddenly out of network, a medication he's been on for years jumped in price, and the copays started adding up. Even traveling out of state became a headache he didn't expect. What really stood out to me wasn't that Medicare "failed" him. It was that the choices within Medicare matter more than people realize. Medicare itself gives you options, but the details of those options can seriously shape your experience. Watching this play out actually made me appreciate how Medicare is structured. You're not locked in forever. You can review your coverage, make changes during enrollment, and pivot to something that better fits your doctors, prescriptions, and lifestyle as things change. That flexibility is huge, especially as health needs evolve. It's not perfect, but having options, protections, and the ability to adjust over time is something I didn't know I'd value this much. Anyone else learn the ins and outs of Medicare the hard way? :))"

— medicare · 79 upvotes · family member helping · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1qe8s33/>

"After working in healthcare (I'm a psychologist) through the heyday of managed care, and knowing how important it is to me to be able to choose my own doctor (they aren't all the same!), I went straight to Traditional Medicare. I know that there are some great Medicare Advantage plans that people really like. But people often love their plan until they get very sick. Then the claims start getting denied. My best friend and I were seeing the same physical therapist. I could get as many sessions as my doctor would recommend. She had to beg for more sessions, haggle for a reasonable cost due to confusing payments from her Medicare Advantage plan, and end PT before she was better. It was appalling! You may believe you are saving money with a MA plan. But if you have to pay for physical therapy or some other service that isn't covered, you'll end up spending more. And God forbid you need prior authorization for something before getting much-needed treatment! There are horror stories of people who have died waiting for that prior authorization. Ever notice how many ads there are for MA plans? Guess where they get that money? It comes out of the premiums they collect. That's money that won't go to healthcare. This is just wrong."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 70 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwEXrTu6t2HmVp_to14AaABAq

"My brother-in-law jumped onto Medicare Advantage despite my advice against it. Early on he bragged about the "stuff" he was getting from his insurance plan. He eventually was diagnosed with fourth stage pancreatic cancer. He fought the cancer for two years and fought his Advantage insurance provider for those two years through waiting for authorizations and thousands in out-of-pocket expenses when he consulted an out of network renowned cancer center. He survived one week following that visit. His widow had to fork over the money to the cancer center. My wife and I are on original Medicare with a supplemental plan I carried with my employer at retirement. She was diagnosed with Breast cancer. Her surgery, radiation therapy and a year of chemo pulled her through it. We had no issues with approvals and not a penny of out-of-pocket expenses. The advice to stick to original Medicare came straight from Medicare representatives during a pre-retirement seminar I attended fifteen years ago."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 68 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=Ugwz7ggeVWwtwy1nUs14AaABAq>

"Recently retired from a Health Insurance Company, got a really good look behind the curtain. NO WAY I'm going to trust them with my Medicare for the remainder of my life. Prior Auth's alone are enough to make me say HELL NO to one of their Medicare Advantage plans. I prefer to let the Dr's make my medical decisions, not the Insurance Companies."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 67 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyLUAA0M5nVQVpgFd14AaABAg

"I really like my Advantage plan! Haven't had any problems, never denied coverage never any monthly output, always had complete coverage."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 56 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgzgM7tL9bIQNKyO7ix4AaABAg>

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>;

— medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/>

"My wife and I have been on Medicare advantage for many years now. The money we've saved in not paying premiums for supplemental way more than offsets, even a maximum out-of-pocket in a given year for major surgery or hospitalization. If you were generally healthy but say every four or five years you might have to have surgery or something unexpected you're probably better off with advantage you'll save tens of thousands and you can go out of network for an additional thousand dollar out-of-pocket so the network issue has not bothered us"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 40 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyHu02Kqwc4UAErMmp4AaABAg

"I changed from an Advantage plan three years ago, even though it had some "perks," because I was moving around the country and didn't want to be out of network if I needed to go to a doctor. For me, original Medicare just made sense."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 34 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyVJryCEy987oe5uYR4AaABAg.AOn7k8cHtlhAOnIQDgzl7b>

"I started on an advantage plan as a person on disability age 60. Well so much was out of network and one lab visit has a bill out of reach. The hospital it was under closed and thankfully they are canceling my plan the end of 25. I was told wrong initially that I couldn't get a plan G, but I can. I'm happier and less stressed now."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · 25 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlG&lc=UgwecgdAuvPKmqHUMyV4AaABAg>

"His advice is predicated entirely on the need for expensive supplement insurance, which assumes that you're going to have a pricey hospitalization every year if the insurance is going to pay for itself. I have a relative who paid (5 yrs ago) over 10,000 a year in various premiums for him and his wife. They're wealthy so afford the 20% for rare illness so it's a stupid decision in my opinion. We switched to an Advantage plan because it provided a maximum out of pocket for protection in the event of a expensive illness. He also said out of network doctors can charge whatever they want because there's no negotiated price but that's not true in practice. There are usual and customary charges (a range) that doctors charge. I don't agree with most of what he says."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgySokilkUmuGTmizjR4AaABAg.9ZiM-DHINrO9ZI_5iJrDtw

"At 39:53, you say, "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, lean towards Medicare Advantage." I feel the unspoken part of that sentence should be: "If you're fine dealing with networks and getting referrals, *AND MUCH MORE LIKELY TO BE DENIED COVERAGE* lean towards Medicare Advantage." With Medigap, your doctor and Medicare determine what procedures you can get. With Medicare Advantage, the Corporate Healthcare Provider determines what procedures you can get. The Advantage Plan Provider's incentive is to maximize profits. How do they do that? Deny coverage for procedures that they don't want to pay for."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwU_3aKoZJXMaRelzl4AaABAg

"I have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D drug plan. I just had my second cataract surgery and Medicare and my Plan N covered completely my Medicare approved costs except for the eye drops which Part D covered. I did have to purchase a set of various eye drops for each cataract surgery using Part D. My copay for each set was \$35. Prior to getting the surgeries, I had conversations with two different people at different times and both were seeking cataract surgery but their insurance companies denied the coverage. Those answers told me that they each had a (Dis)Advantage Plan. When I was turning 65, I chose original Medicare because I wanted to insure against the extreme costs for hospital procedures and stays while avoiding medical debt. That strategy is working well for me by providing healthcare freedom by allowing my physicians and me to determine when surgery is necessary- not an insurance company."

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxlG&lc=UgzZqekiWnVh-O9gfmJ4AaABAg>

Flooded with Medicare calls and texts · 24 documents

"Happened to me, I have Medicare advanced plan they denied my tooth implant after so many calls with no help to me end Paying over a \$1000 to have y implant. Thank you for this information 🙌 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxuCsVVsEwv17QPSop4AaABAg.9hFaZEgdHjE9hvWYk3W0ct>

"Fired from my medicare advantage job After getting my 215 license I started working at an agency that sells mapd, supplement, and hospital indemnity plans. Things were going great compared to fast food jobs I started making 1k+ a week and I wasn't even closing yet. Things started going down hill when I started closing my own deals after the agency bought me a few states. Aep was over and during oep I noticed the callers became increasingly hard to deal with. Most of them were only calling about a flex card, some of them didn't want to switch providers, while others stayed on the line just to curse me out and ask to be under the do not call list. I tried my best to close more deals and had no idea how other agents were even managing 5 deals a day compared to the calls I was receiving. Eventually I got called in the office and they decided to let me go. My question is where should I go from here? This is the first job I got fired from and I still have my license so I should be able to find a new job but now my confidence is at an all time low. What if I get fired again? Idk"

— InsuranceAgent · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1j8srq5/fired_from_my_medicare_advantage_job/

"I am only 40. I don't qualify for Medicare. I am in the national do not call registry. These Medicare scammers are harassing me to an insane degree. I got 78 calls just yesterday."

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=UgwLJ9RMyrtjCPV6U7B4AaABAg>

"I have been registered with the national do not call list since 2005. I get at least 10 Medicare scam calls a day."

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=Ugzi5pgdvPvbcnZgh9l4AaABAg>

"@71suns that is all I have. Plan A and plan B which I pay for plan B. Plan A is regular Medicare that covers hospital stays. I get bombarded with phone calls and text from insurance companies wanting me to get an advantage plan. I block them because I do not trust them. I am 75 years old and I am scared of the medical system. I don't trust hospitals or doctors. They're only there for the money these days."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgxrrFVha096OaNtoNd4AaABAg.AMUWC5cfeMZAMXWPB_jarG

"They do not call registries do not work on the national or state level. I've tried multiple times and still continue to get unsolicited Medicare calls. They never stop."

— YouTube · How to Stop Unsolicited Medicare Calls! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ijs8JUzUlwQ&lc=UgzKm6eWqDh9RYjc8MI4AaABAg>

"I get 20+ calls a day. I have the same name as my deceased father so they think I'm over 65. I'm not. The numbers are spoofed local numbers from out of the country. If you try to call them back the number does not exist. There is no way to stop the calls. The phone apps don't even work. They do not abide by the do not call registry. This is a huge problem targeting seniors. I may have to change my number."

— YouTube · How to Stop Unsolicited Medicare Calls! · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ijs8JUzUlwQ&lc=UgyE8IVVSeNHMol0gDd4AaABAg>

"When i watch these kind of videos and the first piece of advice is the do not call registry I'm immediately done. These offshore call centers dont give a damn about dnc. Im not even old enough to qualify for medicare and i get more than a hundred calls a day every day."

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=UgxXRlr7F4TKXAwqurB4AaABAg>

"If you've been a Medicare agent in 17 states for over a decade, you would know exactly what I'm talking about. You are well aware of the changes our industry is facing, so please do not call this an unfair, fear-based claim. And you're right—I forgot to provide proof and evidence—so here they are. Feel free to look up any of these news outlets to see exactly what I'm referring to if you're not aware of that. Medicare Advantage – The Hidden Risks (2024 Sources) Insurers Dropping Members Millions at risk as carriers pull back—over 1 million patients had to shop for new health plans as insurers and hospitals dropped MA coverage (Stateline, Oct 2024). Hospitals Dropping Contracts 15 health systems ended MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., Aultman, Scripps, WellSpan, etc.) due to denials and slow payments (TheStreet, 2024). 32 health systems dropped or declined to renew MA contracts in 2024 (e.g., CommonSpirit, Vanderbilt Health, Avera Health, etc.) (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). 17 health systems across multiple states did the same—citing administrative burdens—in a Becker's list updated August 2024 (Strategic Healthcare, 2024). HealthPartners left UnitedHealthcare MA network, citing denial rates up to 10x higher than with other insurers (Center for Medicare Advocacy, 2024). Hospitals are dropping MA plans "left and right"—Scripps Health terminated MA contracts affecting 30k seniors; many more followed suit across the country (Becker's Hospital Review, 2024). JustCare lists 2024 cancellations (e.g., ECU Health, Comanche Regional, Genesis, Brookings, Memorial Hermann, etc.) (JustCare USA, 2024)."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgyfN02DFY0-5fva9L94AaABAg.AMAJEJokT6yAMAm2VxdHH8

"They get really angry when you flip the script right after they say their name I'll go hi — — the reason for my call is to let you know you may qualify for additional benefits through Medicare . I get so many calls I know the script like the back of my hand. 😂 "

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4lY&lc=UgwxVn9-ZErkXNZeRfx4AaABAg>

"The scammer say that my doctor, they say my doctors name asked them to call in her behalf asking me about a new program. They always leave their name because I never answer the phone. They leave a message to call, I do not call."

— YouTube · Messing with Medicare Scammers to See How They Operate · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JPvSJab6kzM&lc=UgywjK4YnpgOTjNUN1Z4AaABAg>

"My number is on the do not call list and it doesn't stop the calls. This is not from my Advantage plan."

— YouTube · How to Stop Unsolicited Medicare Calls! · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ijs8JUzUlwQ&lc=UgzR49iOnPMDgV6QEfZ4AaABAg>

"i am way under 64. I am on do not call list. I am receiving calls every 10 mins or so. I don't want to change my phone number because I had it for years. It is a real problem for me."

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gIGw&lc=UgzwRYaIW2voqr2dtlt4AaABAg>

"i cant count the number of medicare spam calls i get everyday i get so many im sick of my phone constantly ringing. i dont answer the phone to numbers i dont recognize anymore. i dont have an answering machine either. i signed up with the national do not call registry but it doesnt seem to be working."

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=Ugzs6_W5Zi17RfBOflJ4AaABAq

"Good one! I've been getting alot of these calls from Medicare scammers. Most are robocalls and they hang up either just after I say hello or after they ask whether I have Part A and Part B. Usually these days I don't get a live person."

— YouTube · Messing with Medicare Scammers to See How They Operate · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JPvSJab6kzM&lc=UgyCz4MCrtpAFQDsJ6h4AaABAq>

"I have been on the do not call registry for over a decade. It does not appear to make any impact on the number of solicitation calls I get for automobile warranty, Medicare, etc. (an average of 4/day). So, this video is of no help. Luckily, I still have a "home" phone number I use for filling out any online forms. So, I can just unplug it. I also have several bogus gmail email accounts for the same purpose. This is the best solution I can advise."

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gIGw&lc=UgxYINxp84iR4imG76R4AaABAq>

"I've often received the Medicare scam call. Once I wade through the robocall preliminary and get to a real person, they always ask, "You currently have Medicare parts A and B, correct?" That is when I try to sound confused and respond, "Well, I seem to have Medicare Parts F and U. Do you understand?" This is always followed by either a hang up or lots of cussing. The longer I keep them on the line before I give them the "F&U" response, the more likely it is that they'll cuss. It's very entertaining."

— YouTube · Medicare Scam Call AGAIN! This is how I handle them. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hIDJ4XfKHJE&lc=UgxFLU10541Ulfmadnd4AaABAq>

"It's shocking to me how this whole Medicare Advantage environment operates. IMO it is elder abuse plain and simple. Constant phone calls, agents making one plan sound better than another when they are damn near identical. Doing enrollments with dubious 'special enrollment periods'. Health insurance should not exist. Get all these people doing jobs that matter. Myself included."

— medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o36cqd/psa_avoid_calls_with_new_iphone_feature/nit1tdd/

"I have gotten two prices for Plan G from Blue Cross and Mutual of Omaha. there is a \$30 price difference per month. I am in Idaho. I get endless calls I do not know if scam or not. how do I get prices from all Idaho providers? without being placed on hold or calling lists?"

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=UgzucdwZmITYRiq9x9x4AaABAq>

"@CloudZeroVII7 - I've been getting these calls for a decade now. I'm not even Medicare age. I sought info for my mother years ago. It wasn't even insurance info. Anyway, I've registered for Do not Call --- repeatedly. I even submit complaints to do not call. Which is a full time job if I submitted every call and every number they spoof. I have answered the calls and requested to be removed by pressing #9 and talking to a human. I have sent the calls to voicemail. I have ignored the calls. When I ignore them they call back immediately. The calls may slow sometimes. From say 1 or 2 per day down from 10 a day, but they never stop."

— YouTube · How to Stop Unsolicited Medicare Calls! · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ijs8JUzUlwQ&lc=Ugy9G1CedAGW93M4wv54AaABAg.A-FoMkd8E4CAIdcTXgmKgH>

Can I trust the agent? Commissions and bias · 87 documents

"I won't be 65 until June 2024, but have been doing a lot of research about this topic. I have watched several videos by others that explained the difference between the 2 ways to go, but had yet to find one that I felt comfortable passing on to my other 64 year old friends. My search has ended. Yours is the most even-handed, non-emotional one out there. You aren't just parroting the biased views of others."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 485 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgzEumJESs7gZho7ZUR4AaABAg>

"I'm 67 and still working but planing to retire at 70. I've watched countless of your competitor videos on YT and through this process educated myself about the choices of Medicare. But your video was the BEST, most comprehensive and unbiased I've ever seen and your youthful looks belie your wise old owl wisdom."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 178 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugzce3UIINwJWth1qP14AaABAg>

"This is the ONLY unbiased YouTube on both options. This gentleman is an agent and that's very rare. I can name two, no three agencies that do nothing but flood this site with constant negative videos about Medicare Advantage Plans. The one guy always has a thumbnail with his eyes wide open and his hand over his mouth. Scare tactic, nothing more. Supplements are great, but millions of Americans have advantage plans that do what they are designed to do without issue. I personally have experience using both for more than a decade. Original Medicare should be requiring more pre-authorizations and in the coming years this will happen. The government has been getting ripped off for decades. Oh, we like cats!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 171 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxT0a_1CgP1_SKsFld4AaABAg

"Medicare vs Medicare Advantage. My findings as I enter retirement. A few things I have found out since I have been researching the original Medicare vs. Medicare Advantage. I'm in no way saying that Medicare Advantage is bad. Some people prefer the Medicare Advantage plan over the original Medicare. 1. Medicare Advantage is a private insurance. When you sign up for Medicare Advantage, you are walking away from the original Medicare. 2. If you sign up for Medicare Advantage, and you are under 65, when you turn 65, you will be able to get back on the original Medicare with a medigap supplement. If you are 65 and older and you are on Medicare Advantage, that's when it gets difficult to enroll in a medigap supplement plan with the original Medicare. You will have to go through underwriting, and if you have anything preexisting, you more than likely won't be able to get that G supplement on the original Medicare. Plan G covers everything that Medicare Part A and B cover at 100% except for the Part B deductible of \$226. This means that you won't pay anything out of pocket for covered services and treatments after you pay the deductible. 3. When you enroll in a Medicare Advantage Plan you are essentially selling your traditional Medicare coverage to a private insurance company. 4. If someone tries to sell you "Medicare," ask them if it is Medicare Advantage Plan. 5. Insurance brokers make a commission of \$600. to enroll new members in the Advantage plan. They make \$300. To enroll you in the original Medicare. I was just informed that insurance brokers do not get commission when they enroll members in the original Medicare. 6. With an Advantage plan, you could have a yearly out of pocket as high as \$5,000 to \$10,000. With the original Medicare with a G supplement your out of pocket is \$226. a year, plus your monthly premium payment, depending on what plan you choose. 7. If you enroll in Medicare Advantage, you still pay the Part B premium amount, which is \$164.90. The \$164.9 is automatically taken out of your Social Security check. 8. If you are enrolling in Medicare Advantage, ask your agent/broker what happens if you travel out of state, and you need to seek medical attention outside of your network. With original Medicare, there is no network, and you have coverage in all 50 states. 9. With Medicare, you don't need prior authorization for a given service. Your doctor makes that decision. (I think you may need authorization with ambulance services though.) With Medicare Advantage, you need prior authorization to receive a service, and the insurance company makes the decision whether to approve or deny the service, not the doctor. 10. When you see a table set up at Walmart with a sign that says, "Sign up for Medicare here." That is Medicare Advantage. Medicare does not do that. The original Medicare will never call you to sell you anything and they will never visit you at your home. The calls and spam mail are from Medicare Advantage. TV ads with Joe Namath and J.J. Walker aren't from Medicare. That's a private insurance called Medicare Advantage. 11. If you see anything referring to a Medicare Part C plan, that is a Medicare Advantage Plan. That is not the original Medicare. 12. Read the fine print on Medicare Advantage's vision and dental plans. Vision and dental are not included in all Medicare Advantage Plans. 13. If you have the original Medicare, you don't need to renew it every year. Medicare Advantage will also renew automatically each year unless Medicare cancels its contract with the plan, or your insurance company stops offering the plan. On YouTube, subscribe to Medicare School, Christopher Westfall and Medicare on Video. Watch their Medicare vs Medicare Advantage videos. These videos are extremely informative to keep you informed while entering the retirement phase. Anyone, feel free to correct me if I've misstated anything or if you have anything to add to this post. I'm still learning and trying to gain knowledge to educate myself on this complicated subject."

— medicare · 81 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/141m9ym/>

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

"You're a tiger in this video. I bought a plan G supplement as a perfectly healthy person taking no meds. I liked the predictability of the out of pocket maximums. The next year, I hurt my wrist and developed prostate cancer that required treatment. I was able to get scans and radiation and visit specialists that I wanted without ever worrying about the costs. I am very happy with the choice I made. This video is very fair and unbiased and accurate. Well done."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 30 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxPjKemu-lqNJsIszV4AaABAg>

"I have Humana part D and pay \$9.90/month. For the two prescriptions I filled since I joined Medicare a while ago, I paid \$3 each. I was surprised how inexpensive part D was compared to anything else. My part G supplement increased \$40 between the time I signed up and the time the plan took effect. I built added inflation and premium increases into future budget since everything is always going up. Thanks for your unbiased information."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSIfc&lc=UgxQeLHWlxNE6h3TPTx4AaABAg>

"Very good, informative video on this horribly complicated subject of deciding on a Medicare Plan. I have watched a few Medicare videos and really liked your unbiased explanations! Now, I can go back to my cat nap after all this thinking!"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugyn_GEAgMY12VJu2kl4AaABAg

"We've been on Plan N through your team, for the last 2 yrs. \$20 per Dr visit is nothing. I'm looking at premium increases 15-20 years down the road. Plan N is and will always be lower than plan G. I know far too many people who went for Plan G and were priced out of their premiums in 5-10 yrs, having to settle for a Medicare Disadvantage Plan. Thank you again, for your unbiased advice!!!!"

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan N vs Plan G - What Are The Hidden Costs? · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RcX-i3uZLj0&lc=UgwpcdP5z3PtxlJSK2t4AaABAg>

"Thank you for standing tall and providing the truth, unbiased and not filtered through the lens of politics. I'm 79 and rely on original Medicare A and B, but use the VA for primary care. As far as haters, well they're part of the problem, and they refuse to listen to the truth if it upsets their agenda and political leaning."

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=Ugw2lnx3YAa3DUtu4Fd4AaABAq

"Good video ! However, it points out the disgrace of our health care system. For one it is not health care it is health insurance driven by a profit motive. This is morally wrong. A company that tries to optimize how much money they make off from sick people is just wrong. I have so much anxiety about going on Medicare because there are thousands of diagnosis, lab tests, medications, procedures, etc that I just don't know whether they will be covered or not. If I ever have to go to the hospital I will question every medication they try to give me, every test they want to do, and try to get discharged as quickly as possible to avoid being financially devastated. The whole name Medigap shows how broken Medicare is. If you have parts A and B and have to go to the hospital from a car accident you will be wiped out unless you get Medigap or an Advantage plan so you are forced to do it. Why don't they fix part A and B to cover you ?? This would mean an increase in premiums deducted from your social security check but it would be a far simpler system. Also, there is no coverage for dental, vision, or hearing even with Medigap. When you are older is when you need dental, vision, and hearing the most. And that points out something else. This country doesn't care about their elderly citizens and everything is biased towards younger people. In most Asian cultures the elderly live with their children who take care of them. Here, you will be lucky if they put you in a nursing home. My cousin's husband had kidney cancer and no hospital would take him because he was over 75 and he died. If he would have been a Russian citizen he would have lived. Simply disgraceful."

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=UgypE6d5xS9qF1JCX1x4AaABAq>

"Check a few of this influencer's videos. Hmmm, wonder who is sponsoring him! Don't think he is unbiased at all. Incomplete information can cause you to choose wrongly. Careful folks!! Supplemental policy for me and ever so grateful. As long as you don't need much an Advantage plan is great. I have frequently felt very sorry for folks that chose Advantage. Be sure you understand the risks of that choice!!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement 2026: Full Comparison · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5Qc8YvvLjGE&lc=Ugxo3heKON0gG-zOnDV4AaABAq>

"I am 77 years old and I love animals, especially Rhinos. I really appreciated your unbiased evaluations of supplements vs advantage plans. I have had a supplement because I am a retired Tennessee state employee. I have had two cancers and paid very little for great service."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugy2yEhvwfZGAYp1K_p4AaABAq

"I really like your video and feel it's the unbiased one I have watched. My dog sits with me as I watch videos. My husband has had 2 outpatient procedures this year along with a 5 day hospital stay. I don't love his premiums on the supplemental plan but have been grateful for the coverage he has had. I find it peace of mind having the supplemental plan. I do have an agent I trust but always feel the need to understand Medicare coverage. Thank you for your help."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugxf3T2UxQEzrFGrafV4AaABAq>

"Just turned 65. My broker tried to present all options and easy to understand. Very confusing. I appreciate your videos especially when I just watched one of those portraying this business as a DOG eat dog world. Having said that I hope my agent and I made the best choice. I really hate the whole thing. But thnx again for your unbiased presentation"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgycU_NhzSwAnS6aKMI4AaABAq

"Your channel is awesome and is the most unbiased healthcare channel I've come across so far. I've seen so many channels just bashing the Advantage Plan but not everyone can afford supplement plans. Also just original Medicare is not the safest option."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgwusLtigJ0Pig0uPN94AaABAq>

"Your video are very informative and unbiased..and I listened till the end.. than you. I am on advantage plan and I been doing my own research on plans, deductibles, out of pocket etc and my plan still the best for me.. I am just worried about news that doctors and facilities are signing out of adv plans,, hopefully not in my plan 🐶"

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxC0rHIJenu2qzwdXZ4AaABAq.9wSVEy-xFcQ9wTyTcBarS7>

"Very biased presentation. Many of us are going to be very strapped financially when we retire, since we don't have a pension and we were not very highly paid when working. I'm retiring at 74 and a plan G will cost me \$3204 a year plus \$1980 for plan B. Plan N is \$2532. I've been on Blue Cross HMOs all my life, like probably most people and have had zero problems. You act like an extra \$3k is irrelevant because you only sell supplements. You should be ashamed of your one sided presentation, deceiving people to benefit yourself 15:22. I'm planning on joining a Blue Cross advantage plan with a great network for 0 premium."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgzE8b2F6cQrJ2qNHmp4AaABAq>

"Erik - MAHALO (thanks) for providing a comprehensive and unbiased comparison/explanation between Advantage and Supplement plans, including the pros and cons. After my brother was declined a cardiac procedure pre-authorization, even after his doctor appealed the decline, he switched to a Supplement Plan. Subsequently, he had triple by-pass surgery. Because I don't want to be subject to stricter pre-authorizations, I will opt to select a Supplement Plan. Thankfully, I can afford this option. I was planning to use a local Medicare consultant/insurance broker, I'm now leaning toward using your firm simply because of your unbiased and trusted education."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhIXrMrc5s&lc=UgwhNRa14NsfQk0KePZ4AaABAq>

"Good advice. I will be 67 this year and have been on Medicare for a couple of years. We found an independent broker who was very helpful. I had a major surgery or two 5 years before so we asked the broker what coverage would we have if that event happened under the various plans we looked at. I have been on advantage plan but it pays to keep up year to year as coverage varies from year to year. Follow the money"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1pLq6moM&lc=UgyXq1_X5jcvfx6wDwZ4AaABAq

'Extra benefits' ads: flex cards, giveback, grocery money · 428 documents

"I am 64 and received my medicare card. As a senior citizen trying to go through the maze of medicare plans is enough stress to kill anyone. One must ask themselves why is medicare so hard to navigate that private insurers send out their so called medicare advisors to steal our money? I have decided to decline Part B and I will definitely not sign up for the Advantage Plan that I know all too well it will kill you in the end. I will cancel my Federal blue Cross Blue Shield insurance that is almost \$400 a month now that I have only used on four occasions in 21 years. I'd rather die than give one more cent to a broken health care system. When property insurance, health care insurance and auto insurance takes over 50% of a retired citizen income, I call that a crime. The only reason we are the wealthiest country in the world is due to the fact that private companies have been stealing money from the hard working middle class folks and became richer with the money they stole from us because the law makers got their kick back money and we got kicked in the back."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 811 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwoFkaXMEaOiRM1oYh4AaABAg>

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Medicare Advantage is a Scam: My experience almost a decade in the Healthcare industry I was inspired to go into some detail after an AskReddit post about dirty insider truth that most people won't know. I replied that, as a person who's worked in the medical field for a little over 9 years, saying that Medicare is leagues better than Medicare Advantage and Medicare Advantage is a scam. I've worked in a Home Health Agency, an inpatient rehab (SNF), a doctor's office, and am currently an RN working inpatient rehab. Hopefully, people will find this interesting or helpful \- Admissions for SNF: First medical jobs was admissions primarily to fill short term rehab beds. I had a website of all the people discharging from local hospitals who needed inpatient therapy, I would reach out to the hospitals, say we had a bed available, they would confirm with me, I would get the paperwork, get insurance authorization if needed, and greet the patient once they arrived and sign papers Medicare patients: I was told to try and get as many traditional Medicare patients as possible. I asked my boss why and she said that they pay the most and they always pay. I never once had to get insurance authorizations for traditional Medicare. The people could just come in! It covered the most therapy per day vs any other insurance(an hour a day vs. 30 minutes a day usually), including every Medicare Advantage. It automatically covered the first 20 days, then the next 80 days after that, I think it was like 60%. But if they had a secondary insurance, it would cover 100 days at 100%. Medicare Advantage: First off, once you get a Medicare Advantage plan, it's not traditional Medicare anymore, it's the insurance company now. Of you want to come to our facility, you don't get the grace of just walking in. I'm sure they've streamlined everything now, but we had to call a number, present the diagnosis in certain code numbers, wait for an authorization number, and then we could let you in. From there, you'd maybe get 20 days at 100% with half the daily rehab, then after 20 days, they were done. it covered nothing. Patient was 100% responsible for all costs. \- Home Health Scheduler My 2nd job was scheduling a team of Therapists and Nurses to different homes in my city who needed home health. I'd get a stack of referral papers every morning and was told to get them scheduled. For example, a referral would say "Medicare A: Needs RN and PT services", and then I'd contact my staff and arrange a schedule. I would also work with my staff and the patients that needed anything rescheduled. I was essentially the Guy in the Chair Medicare: Let's say that of my 3 referrals I had that morning 1 was traditional Medicare A, once was a UHC Medicare Advantage, and the other a Humana Medicare Advantage. Once again, I was told, "Staff the Medicare patients first!" And once again, I asked why and was told that Medicare always pays, and it always pays the most. I wasn't working directly with insurance at that job, so I can't comment on authorizations or cost. But Medicare patients generally had more RN and PT visits per week than any Medicare Advantage. Usually 3 days per week for each with Medicare, and 2 days a week for any Medicare Advantage. Also, there are longer sessions with Medicare. usually an hour vs 30 minutes Medicare Advantage: Just less care. Less staffing days and shorter sessions. \- Doctor's office: Next job I had before my RN was in a primary care physicians office. I only worked the front desk, but I worked right next to the referral coordinator, so I knew everything that was happening about that Medicare: From a cashiers perspective, Medicare never had a copay while many Medicare Advantage plan did. From a referral perspective, Medicare was so much easier. I don't think I ever saw Medicare rejected a referral claim. It was always quick, and as long as we filled the paperwork out properly, it was approved. Also, most specialists took Medicare, so usually patients could go where they wanted. Medicare Advantage: There was always an authorization process. it often involved scanning and sending documents, then waiting for approval. Generally it was a longer process that resulted in much more rejections than traditional Medicare. Also, one again, because Medicare Advantage isn't Medicare anymore, it's whatever insurance company has it now, the patients were stuck with whatever doctors they had plans with, and it was always a much smaller list than Tradition Medicare. I've been an RN for about 4 years now, so I am very separated from the insurance side, thank God! DISCLAIMER: Some Medicare Advantage plans are competitive with the benefits of traditional Medicare, but they are often very expensive. Some people are very happy with their Medicare Advantage plans, but I wanted to share my perspective, and my experience. But, this is also why I am greatly in support of expanding Medicare to cover all People in the US. We have the means to give the people proper

Healthcare, we just need to do it"

— HealthInsurance · 472 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1sl2x0z/>

"I live in Ohio . I am on plan N with the wife . I pay \$91 a month at 69. I had stage 3 cancer last year and paid very little out of my pocket .Very happy as I could pick my doctors and hospitals I wanted ! Every bill was paid fast !! No denying services too !! Original medicare works like a charm !!!! Dont fall into the Medicare Advange trap !!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 194 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwvfURn5XXCLWCAGlp4AaABAq

"I retired from health insurance processing about 50% because of this scam. I did not have a single person who had a "Medicare Advantage", who had any advantage. The only ones getting an advantage here is the insurance companies, and the feds."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 177 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugz5qyDIIBnU7-nFzc14AaABAq>

"I was paying \$235 a month for my medicare supplement. I am relatively healthy, take no prescription drugs, pay out of pocket for dental and eye care. I just cancelled my supplement and signed on to a highly rated medicare advantage program. I think this was a good move for me."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 173 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw9Bpq7gL9tXCMBZa4AaABAq>

"I have the AARP UHC Supplemental Plan plus a Prescription Plan. I pay just over \$100 a month for my prescription plan. Purely by accident I discovered I pay double for my prescriptions using my insurance vs being uninsured. My CVS charge for my 90 day prescriptions was about \$45 but using a Good Rx card which I pay just over \$20 for the same prescription."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 120 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgwIJVVWWtbq6lZbBBJ4AaABAq>

"My dad washes paper plates to save money, but Medicare finally got him to see a doctor My dad is the cheapest man alive. He avoided doctors for 40 years because he was convinced they were all "scammers" trying to steal his hard-earned cash. When he turned 65, I basically dragged him to the computer to sign up. He grumbled the whole time about the premiums for his Part B and the Supplement plan we picked. I thought it was a waste of breath. Then he took a nasty spill in the garage last month. He needed a partial hip replacement. He was literally sweating in the hospital bed. It wasn't from the pain. It was because he was mentally calculating the bill. When the statement finally came, he went quiet. The surgery, the anesthesia, and the hospital stay were all covered after he met a small deductible. He didn't lose his life savings."

— medicare · 102 upvotes · family member helping · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1qdc0r0/>

"Last July, I spent one week in the hospital which included two ambulance rides, specialists, many tests, etc. The bill was \$30,000 and going up. I paid ZERO dollars because I have a good plan. If you buy cheap, you will end up paying for it. I have original Medicare A & B with an AARP United Health Care supplement plan for \$410 a month. Just one trip to the hospital is worth the cost. I'm 80 and just getting by financially by the grace of God."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 102 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzHw03ErdB2Dq8ZcXI4AaABAq>

"I can't believe how much more I will have to pay going on Medicare. I was on an Obamacare plan paying \$175 a month with no drug copays and occasional \$20 doctor visit copays. So maybe \$2,200 a year. On Medicare I will pay \$202 a month for the basic coverage, around \$150 for a plan N supplement, around \$100 for plan D drug coverage and \$100 for the few current drugs I'm taking now. So about \$6,600 a year. That is triple the cost. Is this normal? Isn't part D just a discount plan?"

— medicare · 95 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1q0gcln/>

"My mother is in her 90s and has dementia...along with many health issues.. my mother has a medical advantage plan with one of the largest insurance companies...I would never recommend it a Medicare advantage plan especially if you have a lot of medical issues.i have been taking care of my mother for the past 10 years.. the insurance companies fight you every step of the way..they send you used equipment... they limit you to 5 days of physical therapy ..2 of the 5 days are for evaluation purposes...so you only get 3 days of physical therapy.. you always get rejected if you appeal for more therapy..the doctors in network are very bad and very few choices... or they leave network because of low reimbursement . If you are a healthy person medical advantage plans are good...but if you need medical therapies such as PT.. forget it... I am 65 am based on my experience with my mother..I will never sign up for an advantage plan....its a bait and switch game that the insurance companies play... advantage plans are a scam!!"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 90 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzpRDIIAYWVYI35q2x4AaABAg>

"Do not leave the original Medicare for any advantage replacement policy With Medicare open enrollment upon us. I don't know who needs to hear this, but if you're out searching for Medicare plans for yourself or your parents and it's getting confusing as it does for everybody. I want to provide you with a cautionary word of advise from our failed experience. First off never leave the original Medicare. Just don't. When my mom became Medicare age, we did not know which plan to put her on and we blindly trusted a very close family friend who sold insurance to pick that plan for her, not knowing any different. I didn't find out until later that my mom was put on a Medicare "replacement" plan through United, which is not actually Medicare. If you're helping someone pick a Medicare plan, just add a "supplement" to their plan. Do not make any changes to their original Medicare plan and never ever switch over to any of the advantage plans where they try to lure you into their insurance plans by giving you extra cash / groceries / gym memberships / benefits because it's not the real original Medicare. Does replacements work, yes, and they are great until they aren't. The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. That's when the real issues can rise up to the top. I personally call it a scam bc I think few are told what is actually occurring when you sign up for a advantage replacement. If you already left the original Medicare, you have 1 year to go back to it otherwise you have to take a medical examination to be approved. If you have real health issues, your rates will likely skyrocket and make it impossible to return. Keep the original bc the cost stays the same for the most part and it's protected far more than any other insurance policy out there. Disclosure: I can only speak from our personal experience. On a side note: insurance agents make more money on the replacement plans than they do on a supplement plan. So take it for what it's worth. *The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. I am ultimately making this post to help, but also to see if anyone else has any ideas on how I could get my mom back on the original Medicare, it looks hopeless but I thought its worth pushing it out to Reddit and pray someone has had a way of reversing this mess Thank you."

— medicare · 89 upvotes · family member helping · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1gs3yfb/>

"My husband bought plan N this Feb. he did knee replacement. We pay \$250 medicare deductible for xray and visiting surgeon consultation. We pay \$20 cardiologist and \$20 primary for clearance before surgery. We pay 0 for surgery and 0 for physical therapy for 2 month (3 times a week). It is also \$0 for numerous follow up appointments with surgeon and his nurses. I am very please how plan N work for us"

— YouTube · 2 New Devastating Medicare Advantage Stories · 72 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Plzy4A7HxHg&lc=UgzLql0tefyhBzM6rPp4AaABAq>

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=Ugxmqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAq

"My husband and I were paying over \$700 a month for premiums alone with Medicare and a Supplement plan, so we changed to Medicare advantage plan Preferred Care with UHC and here in Miami it works fairly well. We never had any issues to go to specialists. Even though my husband takes a lot of medications, at the end of the year we end up saving money."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 67 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwRHs4R8-hbL8liv_R4AaABAq

"At the time I was preparing to retire at age 66, I became ill with covid. I was still covered by my employer insurance. When I returned to work after covid, I became ill again. Due to being off so long my insurance lapsed. I officially retired and signed up for SSI and Medicare plan B. I had signed up for plan A as soon as it was available at age 65. The second illness was kidney cancer that was discovered while I was in my open enrollment period. I quickly selected a Supplemental plan, and was I ever happy! It covered everything including an additional year of follow up immunotherapy with Katruda. I saved thousands of dollars every 90 days of follow up therapy! My Supplemental plan cost me about \$95 a month! So don't gamble with your health or finances!"

— YouTube · Do I need a Medicare Supplement Plan? · 64 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=O-WxyTurD3c&lc=UgykxBns009Os0UTIEp4AaABAq>

"I turn 65 this August. I work in IT my brain is super sharp I do 500 situps a day 20 minutes olyptical a day don't drink don't smoke and I'm still fin lost!!! So now I'm supposed to find some financial shark who just might steal me blind. And I'm one of the sharp ones! What about the poor old people that are scammed and taken advantage of every day? What has society come to? This is an outrage! I've watched video after video and I'm still not certain of my best path. And I'm certainly not going to pay for someone who may or may not help me."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=Ugz2DNxO1qpi1X0xEkF4AaABAq>

"I started Medicare in 2018 at age 65. Every single year I have had rate increases that far exceeded 5-8%. I left United plan G in 2024 as their rate increase jumped drastically and sent my premium well above \$200 a month. I switched to plan N through, you guessed it, Ace. The rate started at \$113 a month and in 2025 increased to \$126 and for 2026 just went up this month to \$154. These high percentage rate increases are wearing thin. Texas resident."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 52 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgyL5MEueBzKhmgghgJ94AaABAq>

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

"My mother didn't want to hear it when I told her Medicare (Dis)Advantage was a scam. Then she broke her leg and needed 6 weeks inpatient rehab and the insurance company booted her in less than 2 weeks. Now she agrees with me. And my brother and I are getting TRADITIONAL MEDICARE!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 45 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=Ugxpn0JGpHTMbEgSZ2V4AaABAq>

Confused, afraid of choosing wrong or missing a deadline · 461 documents

"Erin, this is your best video ever! I'm coming up on age 65 and until now, I was feeling overwhelmed. Thank you, thank you, thank you🙏"

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 234 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZjptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hwvh4AaABAq>

"This video is by far the best explanation on the difference between original Medicare and Medicare Advantage without being confusing. Thank you so much for this. I will be 65 in 2026 and my employer is dropping my health coverage because he says I will be on Medicare. I have been bombarded with SOOOO much information. It's difficult to understand this whole thing. You have cleared up a lot of it for me in one video! So THANK YOU!!!"

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 146 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxLckexGeBnELXhfKZ4AaABAq

"As someone turning 65 next month this type of information is very helpful. The way they have set everything up could not be more confusing and inefficient."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 129 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgwddBLZOMhdw-fYFsl4AaABAq>

"I am a retiree already on Medicare. When I saw that this video was available, I wanted to take a look. And I want to say, this is one of the best videos I've seen for those not yet on Medicare. The speaker, Stephanie, is very well spoken on the matter. She speaks clearly on what you need to know but does not confuse you with more info than you need or with casual comments. (If this were available back when I was applying, it would have been an excellent resource)."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 116 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgxH8Oqj9qk1Muh4VMt4AaABAg>

"Do not leave the original Medicare for any advantage replacement policy With Medicare open enrollment upon us. I don't know who needs to hear this, but if you're out searching for Medicare plans for yourself or your parents and it's getting confusing as it does for everybody. I want to provide you with a cautionary word of advise from our failed experience. First off never leave the original Medicare. Just don't. When my mom became Medicare age, we did not know which plan to put her on and we blindly trusted a very close family friend who sold insurance to pick that plan for her, not knowing any different. I didn't find out until later that my mom was put on a Medicare "replacement" plan through United, which is not actually Medicare. If you're helping someone pick a Medicare plan, just add a "supplement" to their plan. Do not make any changes to their original Medicare plan and never ever switch over to any of the advantage plans where they try to lure you into their insurance plans by giving you extra cash / groceries / gym memberships / benefits because it's not the real original Medicare. Does replacements work, yes, and they are great until they aren't. The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. That's when the real issues can rise up to the top. I personally call it a scam bc I think few are told what is actually occurring when you sign up for a advantage replacement. If you already left the original Medicare, you have 1 year to go back to it otherwise you have to take a medical examination to be approved. If you have real health issues, your rates will likely skyrocket and make it impossible to return. Keep the original bc the cost stays the same for the most part and it's protected far more than any other insurance policy out there. Disclosure: I can only speak from our personal experience. On a side note: insurance agents make more money on the replacement plans than they do on a supplement plan. So take it for what it's worth. **The advantage replacement plans mostly affects hospitalization. I am ultimately making this post to help, but also to see if anyone else has any ideas on how I could get my mom back on the original Medicare, it looks hopeless but I thought its worth pushing it out to Reddit and pray someone has had a way of reversing this mess Thank you."

— medicare · 89 upvotes · family member helping · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1gs3yfb/>

"My husband has an Advantage plan has not had any problems with it. Been on it 5 years. Finding a dentist in our area has been an issue though. What I don't understand is why there are separate Plans (A,B,C,D) and you have to pay for those. Medicare should be one plan and it's all covered as we paid for it from our working wages."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 79 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugzj1Rb6ZQ40dwn_bcl4AaABAg

"Good info! I'm on Plan G. I do see a doctor more that 2 times a month. Medicare is so darn confusing & frustrating!"

— YouTube · Medigap Plan G vs Plan N Two Years Later · 76 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GRLgcxTEKs4&lc=UgyIBq27pyMHhCEeUp14AaABAg>

"I don't understand why there is not just one medicare plan for everyone instead of this mess. This indicates what a sad state our government is in."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · 75 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgxTJeKHAJFXuDjtgt4AaABAq>

"GLP-1 Bridge Program Info As someone that works in a doctors office and submits PAs, I want to clear up some confusion about the GLP-1 bridge program. I want to start by saying I appreciate that this program will get these meds to many people that need it, but it leaves a lot of Medicare beneficiaries behind. If you have type 2 diabetes, moderate to severe obstructive sleep apnea, or MASH you do NOT qualify to use the program. You have to get a GLP-1 medication approved for those conditions through your Part D plan. Even if the Part D copay is astronomical, you still can't use the bridge program if you have any of those 3 diagnoses. It doesn't matter if the provider doesn't even use those diagnoses and only submits the PA for obesity, you still don't qualify. When we submit the PA, the provider has to attest that you do NOT have those conditions. If the provider selects that you DO have any of them, the system automatically denies it and kicks it back saying it has to go through Part D. You can't get around this if you have these conditions because that would be committing Medicare fraud. I submitted multiple of these PAs today and confirmed this is exactly how it's being processed. You do still qualify if you have mild obstructive sleep apnea and meet the other criteria, because mild OSA isn't covered under Part D, only moderate to severe. This is directly from the CMS website info for prescribers and the PA form that I've linked below. I recommend looking over these because this is exactly the guideline providers are following when submitting these PAs. <https://www.cms.gov/glp-1-bridge.pdf> <https://www.cms.gov/files/document/glp-1-prescribers-c-1.pdf> I hope this information is helpful."

— medicare · 74 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1ulaona/>

"After working in healthcare (I'm a psychologist) through the heyday of managed care, and knowing how important it is to me to be able to choose my own doctor (they aren't all the same!), I went straight to Traditional Medicare. I know that there are some great Medicare Advantage plans that people really like. But people often love their plan until they get very sick. Then the claims start getting denied. My best friend and I were seeing the same physical therapist. I could get as many sessions as my doctor would recommend. She had to beg for more sessions, haggle for a reasonable cost due to confusing payments from her Medicare Advantage plan, and end PT before she was better. It was appalling! You may believe you are saving money with a MA plan. But if you have to pay for physical therapy or some other service that isn't covered, you'll end up spending more. And God forbid you need prior authorization for something before getting much-needed treatment! There are horror stories of people who have died waiting for that prior authorization. Ever notice how many ads there are for MA plans? Guess where they get that money? It comes out of the premiums they collect. That's money that won't go to healthcare. This is just wrong."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 70 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwEXrTu6t2HmVp_to14AaABAq

"I am a former Computer Programmer and think very logically. I agree, the entire American Medical Industry is 100% criminal along with medical insurance companies. After I was eligible for Medicare I thought my med insurance problems were over. I found out EVERYTHING is so confusing and unnecessarily complicated it is a complete nightmare. It started with the governments little rule about if you are born on the 1st of the month your initial enrollment period is different. Then it went to you have 12 months to avoid part B (in some specific instances LOL) and not get the lifetime penalty. It is very strange and not by accident that you have to pay the government for medical insurance and THEN need go out to buy more medical insurance."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 69 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgxVVOM4Fb2X-xO5SGJ4AaABAq>

"Turning 65 next year and Medicare enrollment is way more confusing than I expected assumed I'd just sign up and be done. then found out about Parts A, B, C, D, Medigap, and enrollment windows with actual penalties if you miss them biggest surprise: the enrollment window isn't just your birthday month, it's seven months — and missing it can mean a permanent premium penalty. a free broker consultation helped untangle Advantage vs Supplement plans more than searching on my own."

— medicare · 62 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1wksnot/>

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/>

"I'm 72 and still employed. I used to be confused, but not after what I just saw! I'm thinking I better hang onto this job for as long as the company keeps paying for my health insurance!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 57 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyxhtddcBDj_le3bfF4AaABAq

"My wife turned 65 a few years ago and I thought I was a wise man with the ability to think and understand things. NOT WITH MEDICARE. It is so confusing to the average American"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 55 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1IpLq6moM&lc=UgxwSooBO1Y9mfd2BV94AaABAq>

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAg

"What are the most common Medicare mistakes people make when turning 65? I work with people who are turning 65, and I've noticed some recurring Medicare pitfalls — like enrolling late, overpaying for the wrong plan, or thinking Medigap and Advantage are the same. I've been pulling together a checklist of the most common questions and confusion points people have when starting Medicare. Just wondering what others here think are the most common or costly mistakes you've seen? Would love to hear from other agents, advisors, or anyone who's helped a parent or client through it."

— medicare · 44 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1jujn7m/>

"Thank you SOOOO much. You have answered questions for me that I have been asking for years! You made the information about choice of doctors and coverage area simple to understand without double talk that confused me. After listening to you I now understand the difference and I will always stay with Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 38 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgxUgNQdZ9jImq_CnhR4AaABAg

"All I can say is wow! I'm 66 and past the age of choosing. I went with good old Medicare and medigap, thank goodness. But the research required to make good decisions was overwhelming. I'm happy that moving forward people will have access to your complete and well explained tutorial on this most important decision as we approach retirement. You have provided an incredible service, Erin, and I'm sure your dad is very proud of his daughter."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 38 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugzrq2ND9UayBnM6cKx4AaABAg>

"I've already accepted that at some point I'll need to make a choice between food and medigap insurance."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 38 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=Ugy4xdpPIBKfbsGCBFt4AaABAg>

Lead Sources

An independent agent or broker · 101 documents

"As a 79 years old person, I have worked with my Medicare Broker 10 years. I cherish and trust him as much as my Tax accountant, Investment Broker, Insurance agent, Veterinarian, Physician, car repairman, Apple Help line. How could I survive if not for their guidance? Yes, they make money off of me, but the mistakes I have made in the past were disasters. No more stressful nights nearly in tears because I did not understand the ins and outs of this complex world."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 120 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=Ugw3E0Y7_DI2bpu859V4AaABAg

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/>

"When I first picked a supplement plan a few years ago and was deciding between Plan G and Plan N, the difference in premiums would pay for about 20 doctor visit copays per year. I usually see a doctor 2-3 times per year maximum. I live in Ohio which doesn't allow excess charges so I chose Plan N with the help of an experienced broker."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 50 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=Ugz5OJseywWR-Ps1bVV4AaABAg>

"Chartreuse. 67 and looking to retire that end of next year if they don't put me out to pasture before then. Been on part A since 65, with company health plans that change every year. The agent at my local SS office went above and beyond to explain everything to me when I signed up. He was extremely helpful."

— YouTube · Reasons to DELAY Medicare Past 65 That Will Save You Thousands and Avoid ALL Penalties · 46 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L2goGwp4Co8&lc=UgzNY_JjDH7DleQpHbp4AaABAg

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMp4AaABAg>

YouTube channels and seminars · 75 documents

"Maybe a better title for this video would be "When I Wouldn't Chose Medigap Plan G verses Plan N". I have Plan G and it was \$25 more in premium than Plan N, but I knew with my upcoming health issues I would be seeing many specialists and more often. I went with peace of mind decision."

— YouTube · Why I Would Never Choose Medigap Plan G? · 81 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b1-xkGFxm_g&lc=UgyZe4YXRtM8AXD_AI4AaABAg

"Do I really need an agent to buy a medigap plan? Im a little confused. I will be moving to Original Medicare during open enrollment. Using the Medicare website it was easy to create a list of plans available to me. Then I contacted each company to get a quote for both Part G and Part N, which i am considering. Now my phone is blowing up with agents who leave me messages all day long. I guess I just dont understand. Why do I need agent? The process seems very straightforward. I was on the ACA for a couple of years before I went on Medicare and I managed to navigate the ACA without a "navigator". And when i sighed up for a MAP,i picked the plan and signed up on my own.Why would I suddenly need to turn to an agent for a medigap plan? What am I missing? ETA: I think it need to clarify the question, because im getting a bit of snark. My question is an i REQUIRED to use an agent to purchase a medigap policy, because the messages im getting in my voicemail are quite pushy about me needing one. I use an agent for my homeowners and car insurance, not even sure if i could buy without. Just wondering if its the same way. ETA: Well this has been interesting. I asked a question about medigap without an agent and while I got many helpful responses, I also got people thinking I advocate for practicing law without a license to replacing a car engine by watching YouTube videos. And being told that because I have decided to move off MA because my late husband got cancer and we were faced with max out of pocket abd high co-pays and I didnt want to deal with that in my life ever again, that I must have huge financial problems caused by not adequately funding my retirement. OK then. Its the internet, hopefully others have found some of the responses useful. I really dont understand the hostility. Whatever."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1o4myrw/>

"Outstanding video! I have participated in several Medicare seminars, and I will tell you that no one compared Plans G and N like you just did. Very helpful!"

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · 35 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=UgyY1VZUNOmbsPWsrud4AaABAg>

"My wife just went on Plan G, and after listening to your video, I feel more confident about that decision."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N Compared to Plan G - Which Should You Choose? · 16 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3WBOKbvEq9U&lc=UgyHHjDulr5OFGeyBS54AaABAg>

"I am 6 months out from starting Medicare in 2024 and have been researching G vs N plans. I found one video where the long term costs of G and N plans are discussed, not just their initial cost and the smaller difference at inception. This was eye opening because the long term cost of the N plan became much lower, \$100 or more per month less than G plan for people in their later 70s early 80s. In NJ where I live, the G plan starts out about \$42 per month more. I really wish this channel would do a long term cost comparison of G vs. N plans as I'd like to hear more about this. \$30 a month more seems like a no brainer to get the G plan coverage, but if in 10 years it is \$130 month more, that is a different story. Especially since many (most?) people can never change plans due to medical rating."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N Vs Plan G? Which Should YOU Choose? 🤔 · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H8IVf79gAV8&lc=Ugzua1Hv5qRudEmInQ94AaABAg>

"I was enrolled very briefly in an advantage plan. I was in between an emergency appendectomy and a scheduled cataract surgery. I was advised by the doctors and medical staff that an advantage plan would make it harder to get services covered and I would have to pay more out of pocket. I dropped the advantage plan like a hot potato! I was in no position to pay out extra cash as I'm on disability. I'm glad I found a couple of videos on this matter. Makes me feel more confident in my Medicare and Medicaid programs. Thank you for posting this!

🙏 "

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgwpJ9tT2yIndb6B0sV4AaABAg>

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TmP4AaABAg>

"You told us in this video very much what our agent told us when we enrolled in A+B+Supplement, we pay a monthly fee for the supplement but beyond that the only thing we have paid is the once yearly \$230 Medicare deductible and last year I had 3 overnight hospital stays for a total out of pocket cost of \$0.00. I am trying to spread the word, that if you have the choice and the funds, stick with a supplement. Medicare Advantage or should we say Medicare Dis-Advantage is great as long as you never get sick."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyOgJSaunBIQfkQN1I4AaABAg>

"I've been researching Medicare for the past few months as I am getting ready to have to make some decisions.. I found this video very helpful and informative... I have been so stressed as I don't want to make the wrong decision. This was a great overview and just helped calm my mind a bit. Nothing is easy or straight forward for sure...Thank You!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2I1lpLq6moM&lc=UgzdEe01DRkZ7syX6od4AaABAg>

"Every video that I watch, insurance agents/brokers personally chose Plan G and I don't believe it's just a selling point. I planned for Medicare increases so I am good with Plan G during my lifetime. Also, I don't want to be chasing around co-pays in my dementia years."

— YouTube · Medicare Broker Reveals 3 Reasons He Chose Supplemental Plan G · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D-ub2E2kShQ&lc=UgyqTbHjZvj75_QgO4h4AaABAg

"Thank you for these videos! I have been so confused about Medicare and Advantage plans. You have helped me decide to sign up for a G plan and not an advantage plan. Keep up the great videos and I am so happy that I found you."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=Ugy1qvBvhCKjvGT8nZd4AaABAg>

"Thank you for the fantastic and super helpful video! I'm currently in my initial enrollment for Medicare and I have had multiple conversations regarding Advantage vs Supplemental. You really helped me understand that 1) Advantage isn't a villain or a wild boar ;-) and 2) there are pluses and minuses to both. Your delivery is succinct, on point, and appreciated. I'm so glad I found your channel and look forward to more of your insightful videos."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugxmdeaj3vmGOtzfbFd4AaABAg>

Employer or retiree plan / HR · 43 documents

"Anecdote: I switched from my employer insurance plan to medicare advantage plan from the same insurer when I turned 65 15 years ago. My bills have been small until this year. My primary detected that I had a heart murmur. The results is an echo to verify the murmur, and angiogram to tell if I could have a TAVR. Followed by a TAVR procedure. I was in the 30% of patients that needed a pacemaker. 2 more echos and 2 CT scans. 9 days in the hospital, 5 for the TAVR mostly because my platelets "crashed". After release, my pulse rate dropped so it was to the ER with what turned out to be a Heart Block necessitating the pacemaker. 4 more days in the hospital with an accompanying ambulance from the ER to the Cardiac unit. I still have 11 days of zero cost in the hospital this year. After 20 days, it will be \$100 / day for an additional 80 days. I have zero copays for doctors and specialists. Also zero for labs and x-rays. I just got my August statement for the year. The hospital billed approx \$300,000 and the insurer agreed to a little more than \$100,000. My costs were \$30 copay for the 2 CT scans. I did have to pay for parking for my wife. My meds accounting will come in a few days but most of my meds are zero copay with a few \$5 copays. In addition to the medicare premium, I pay zero premium for the advantage plan. I guess my non-profit HMO is a bargain. I must emphasize that it's a NON-PROFIT."

— YouTube · Here's How Much We Paid With Medicare I Medicare Supplement vs Advantage · 25 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ykvrrd8VxIY&lc=Ugxwqe13wFaaz_XOged4AaABAg

"I am still working for a large company but chose to sign up for traditional Medicare during open enrollment as I get much better coverage than my 80/20 employer PPO plan for the same price. I don't have the health insurance deduction pre-tax so while I did see an increase in my paycheck, I am also paying a slightly higher amount in tax."

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgzXSahV7erUznWYmlN4AaABAg>

"Happy with my Medicare advantage. Better than the insurance I got from my past employer."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypOamgls&lc=UgxOhl7cfQzkV8LnPRZ4AaABAg>

"Thank you for this video. For others watching, this is a very important video. I worked past 65, had large employer coverage until I retired at 67. My wife(she is 59) and I had planned on paying for our premiums to my employer ad infinitum through what we thought was an "emeritus" type program and then found out that if one is not employed, one is mandated to sign up for Part B. Therefore, when I had to come off of my employer's plan, she could no longer be covered. It was a very concerning situation that she was not covered (except now on Cobra). That only gets 18 months of coverage. Finding her individual coverage is a big challenge to make sure it is the proper and creditable insurance until she is 65. This is a huge gap in our insurance coverage system. The ACA is a terrible system that was perpetrated on the American people. People be aware of age discrepancies with your spouse. This was probably all my fault, but just to let people know, be informed and don't get caught with your pants down."

— YouTube · 7 MEDICARE ERRORS to Avoid When You Work Past Age 65 · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2RD7fyvVse8&lc=UgyqKYZL8rvQm1CM7B54AaABAg>

"What, Why & How - Thank you for a very informative video. I have had a Medicare Advantage plan for 3 years and have learned a lot from your video. After having health insurance through an employer my whole life, I found Medicare and everything surrounding it to be overwhelming due to the different scenarios to choose from. I did work with a broker that was very good, but I always worried if I was making the right choice - we don't have crystal balls. I am very satisfied with my Medicare Advantage plan, and I am concerned about changes that may occur in 2026. Thank you again for a very informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwltgkKJea68YVkyWN4AaABAg>

"I wish I had educated myself when I turned 65. I chose to stay with my employers retiree health plan which we pay ourselves. This year the price has jumped dramatically and I am looking at marketplace. It looks like I missed out on medigap because I know I would now be turned down if underwritten. I could stay with my employers plan and if they discontinued it I could get medigap, but leaving voluntarily my only option is advantage. I will save 4000 a year by choosing advantage but fear the authorizations/denial process."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgyNq-I5E9DgaRdfDEN4AaABAg>

"This helped tremendously! I'll turn 65 later this year, just started a new job. I've looked over the new employers Ins and have decided it'll be in my best interest to go on Medicare rather than the employers benefits. After watching your video I've decided that the Medicare A & B with a supplemental. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Parts A B C D Explained - Everything you need to know! · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wci4BBmjXfo&lc=UgysjPuEZJPQBfACCp4AaABAg>

"Very good advise. I recently switched from a supplemental plan to a medicare advantage plan sponsored by my previous employer. The reasons I switched are simple, the company sponsored Advantage plan was cheaper, it is a PPO and not an HMO and the prescription drug part of the advantage plan is almost identical to the AARP supplemental drug plan I was on. So far I have been very pleased with my PPO Advantage plan. I can still see all my doctors without pre-approval and it pays without dispute, so far. Thank you!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw2Pq8vQjgQGGJVF7h4AaABAg>

"We were on COBRA when George turned 65 and he had t sign up at 65, a few months after he got a permanent job. I didn't sign up when I turned 65, when I found out I could be penalized for not signing up at 65, I called the SSA told the the SS worker why I didn't sign up for Medicare, she told me what form I needed and to have George's HR Department fill out their part. I liked having dual medical coverage, no co-pay for prescriptions and Dr.' the most we paid while on medical from work and Medicare was 8 cents for a prescription to get ready for a test."

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=UgyqlQkmWCg0hfEdEiV4AaABAg>

"Thank you, Stephanie. Last September I turned 65, had no idea where to start, and your videos helped me a lot. I don't collect social security yet, have health insurance from my wife's employer and applied for Medicare part "A" only. When my wife retires we both will need help to make a wise decision. My guess is that you can help with that regardless of the state we live in. Is it correct?"

— YouTube · Working past 65? Avoid these HUGE Medicare mistakes. · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=evYI75xJnKg&lc=UgzPyjkNGMyxYcNMzcl4AaABAg>

"The last 5 years I worked before actually retiring I had to provide my own health insurance the first year where I worked. I used the subsidies like you and paid approximately what you are. In my case it was 180 dollars per month since I'm single. I was earning 15 dollars an hour. I was working 2 jobs. I also had really cheap places to live. We were unionized too thank goodness. When the year was up I got the union healthcare for \$5 a week plus I was on part a of Medicare. The employer had a huge amount of employees so you can do what I'm talking about. I am a retired paralegal and nurse. In addition I have vision problems that caused me to have cataract issues. I had to have them removed from both eyes in my late 50s. I also went completely blind in both eyes for 6 weeks. Some vision came back in 1 eye. I was disqualified from disability because 1 eye functions pretty well. At any rate my vision problems are considered a medical condition. The good news is my doctor tells me my condition has stabilized and I now qualify for low vision benefits. Most of those I would have to pay for out of pocket so I just go along the best I can with what I have. I'm allowed to drive and restrict myself to daytime driving. I go to discount eyeglass providers and pay about 50% less than I would if I went to my doctor for eyeglasses. When I retired I went from health insurance plus pt A Medicare to Medicare and a high deductible medigap plan. I was able to keep health insurance plus pt A Medicare until 67 because my store had a huge amount of employees and had somewhat decent health insurance thru the union. Because of this loophole I was entitled to keep my \$5 dollar a week health insurance until I retired at 67. I am now 73. My retirement age was 66. I eventually added dental insurance I figure if I need implants I can be a dental tourist and get them done abroad if I need to. So far my blood pressure has come down into the normal range now that I'm not working as well. And I've not had to take any medication for my blood pressure. Yay! I'm just taking care of myself. Now mind you this is also because I'm exceptionally frugal. I live on 21k and save 5k a year. Furthermore at the age of 72 I came into a nestegg of 325k from 2 individuals in my life and my own savings. My family left me the 325k. I've not had to touch a nickel of it. And since the 21k is technically my only source of income I owe zero dollars in taxes. Bonus for me 😊😊 . I pay 825 dollars a month in rent and have a small 20 pound dog. My best friend bought my house outright and rents it to me. It is 850 sq ft of heaven. I live in a home built in 1950 that is constantly undergoing renovations. And I live a very simple modest lifestyle. My neighborhood is a working class neighborhood in a downtown area. I live in a wealthy county outside a large metropolitan city. My city has a population of 100k approximately. It is peaceful and quiet. Yes when you are pricing out your healthcare check out both federal and state laws."

— YouTube · How We Get ACA Health Insurance Before Age 65? · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xVHorMHIYeM&lc=Ugz860t4k73bl5uGt_x4AaABAg_AazTRSBtvmuAazs91Tvqjh

"Unknowingly Had Other Health Insurance For One Month I feel like I'm in a bit of a pickle. Full story here, tl;dr at end: Last year I aged out of my parents' insurance (TRICARE) and began to pay out of pocket for a separate "Young Adult" plan they offer. I have been using this insurance regularly to help diagnose and treat a few different issues, and up until now there hasn't been much issue. A few weeks ago one of my providers urgently reached out to me because TRICARE began denying claims and trying to recoup payments with the belief that I had an undeclared OHI. After some conflicting phone calls, I found out they thought I had Aetna - which my Father (same name and address) has under his employer, but which I am NOT covered under - so I asked TRICARE to remove it and they said "sure thing, everything should be cleaned up after ten business days" (paraphrasing of course). The bad coverage showed up in the portal, but it was lacking an expiration date while saying it was expired, *and* some of the phone agents couldn't see it, so it looked like a bug or an erroneous record they'd need to clean up. Problem solved. In the meantime, my various providers kept receiving letters about recoupment and thus kept reaching out to me, and I'd tell them it was taken care of already and that I just needed to wait those ten days. Well... one of those providers dug deeper and reached out to Aetna directly, who told them that I had coverage from January to end of June (!). I discovered that my Dad had accidentally enrolled the family in Aetna in January when he had meant to enroll one family member in a dental plan; when he got billed for it in February, he realized his mistake and canceled the plan. I seem to have been automatically included in that plan because I am under 26, and Aetna seemingly didn't officially end my coverage until end of June. So now I have no idea how to navigate this. I don't know the terms of the Aetna coverage, who I would talk to on their end, or if they'll accept the claims, *or* if they'll try to bill my Dad for March-June if I DO try to file with them. And now that I do know I technically had Aetna, I don't know if TRICARE will honor the claims from that period, which is particularly frustrating to potentially have to pay for a mistake that I did not make and did not know about until a few weeks ago (if the roles were reversed, TRICARE almost assuredly would not refund me for the months I paid them). If neither plan pays, then by my estimate I might owe one provider almost \$2600 for service from March-June. If Aetna is able to correct their date to match end of coverage with my Dad terminating the plan it would be *very* convenient, but I have no idea if this is possible or who I would talk to. Any ideas? Am I overthinking it? tl;dr Dad accidentally enrolled me in one month of his work insurance, which did not officially end for six months, and now my primary insurance wants to recoup as many claims as possible"

— r/HealthInsurance · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HealthInsurance/comments/1wm5b4u/unknowingly_had_other_health_insurance_for_one/

AARP · 26 documents

"Don't just verify your doctors are in network. Check with each doctor to make sure they will accept your new advantage insurance. Two dentists in my network refused to accept my new insurance when I turned 65 and switched from AARP dental insurance to Medicare advantage. Turns out they don't have to take your insurance, even though they're "in network". Also, if you get a part d after turning 65 you'll get hit with a penalty premium based on age that never ends. What the government is doing to Medicare is horrible. The people who have worked all their adult lives and now need it the most are the ones suffering."

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 573 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=UgyHNddHO9eG9zZ5XTh4AaABAg>

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdlWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

"I had to learn all of this in my late 20s and early 30s. My parents were in their 60's when I was in my late 20s. I am also a CPA, and turned to me for advice. I knew nothing about this. Also, Medicare Advantage programs were almost nonexistent. I got my parents enrolled in AARP Medicare Supplement. As Medicare Advantage programs became more prevalent and my parents would get invited to a free lunch or early dinner, I would get asked for advice. I did research, and I told stay with the Supplement. Financially they could handle the premium. They never had a medical bill and went to a specialist when they needed to. There was never an issue with any medical bill. My parents passed away at 93. I was glad they stayed with the Supplement. I am now retired, at 62, and will do the same."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 77 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgxKUc1bXwM24WrrWiR4AaABAg>

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1iten4m/>

"Thanks, think I've completed everything and will be on medicare on wednesday I signed up for trad Medicare A + B . I signed up AARP/UHC for part D because all my drugs are covered in their formulary. I signed up State Farm for Medigap because I didn't need a fitness pass. I cancelled my marketplace insurance effective Sept 30 with all the above plans going into effect Oct 1. I spoke to my pharmacist and picked up enough refills to last through the next month in case of any hiccup. I confirmed all my doctors will take Medicare and electronically upload my Medicare card into their patient portals. I will need to sign up for part D plan (or stay with AARP/UHC) for Jan 2026. I am in CA and can switch part G providers without underwriting on my birthday month next year. This has all been a huge amount of anxiety, hope I did everything right, and sincerely have no idea how I would have done without all your advice."

— r/medicare · 47 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1nrj552/>

"We went with original Medicare + Medigap Plan "N" + Part "D" Prescription + AARP Delta Dental PPO. No regrets, whatsoever.... Thank you Stephanie & your team!"

— YouTube · If I Were Turning 65...Here's EXACTLY What I'd Do · 14 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2l1lpLq6moM&lc=UgxRN81uNI8NB_BZ0f14AaABAg

"When we signed up for medigap insurance UHC through AARP was the winner in premium cost, but the devil is in the details! UHC had a big discount that diminished the longer you're with them. Add in the year by year increase and we were seeing double digit increases each year. Fortunately we were able to switch to another plan from a well rated company and pass medical review. So we're now saving about 1500 this year. The new company has a track record of manageable yearly increases. Time will tell..."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxMVz0BI22UXcj0L6x4AaABAg>

"I met with an insurance broker before I retired. I also went to a separate seminar about Medicare. I analyzed both Advantage and Medicare supplement options and I chose my AARP supplement. It's the best decision I've ever made. I gladly pay my supplement premium every month."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgwLhAvePI9yFRG8TMp4AaABAg>

"I am so very happy I went with AARP UHC Advantage Plan. Most of my drugs are completely free, zero cost to see my PCP, free Y membership, vision and dental coverage. Going with a supplement Plan or straight Medicare would cost my wife and I so much more than \$19 a month."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbQjBtBsw&lc=UgyW90LDk8lyNz2tgB14AaABAg>

"I only just turned 65 last October and got diagnosed with breast cancer in January. Fortunately i signed up for AARP UHC plan G so I've been very thankful for it. My plan started out at 152/ month but will go up to 172 in July. Still worth it. I'm in Texas."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgywBebQzCuYTIkNkO94AaABAg>

"Not sure where you are but I got a letter that my Medicare Advantage - AARP thru UHC is not going to be available next year so good luck. I had to switch to a regular supplement plan costing 5x as much for not as much coverage plus I still have to buy Rx, Dental & Vision."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzhW03ErdB2Dq8ZcXI4AaABAg.AOMNMdPETqAOQeXC3efoG>

The carrier directly (Humana, UHC, Aetna...) · 10 documents

"I just called United Health Care and my plan is not being eliminated. I am SO grateful for that! I have a better health care plan in retirement then I ever had when I was working!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UzBbU&lc=UgzRaFMR4KpltyAkbol4AaABAg>

"I called United Healthcare and they didn't have a price for 2026 for my Supplement G plan. The cost increase was was 7.43% from 2024 to 2025."

— YouTube · Medicare Supplement Plan (Medigap) Premium Hikes and What You Can Do · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7rHuyAmCtHY&lc=UgycxgAKS3b7YPfrfA94AaABAg>

"What How,Why ? Now I know why my agent wouldn't entertain any other plan for me last yr. When I asked to change. He's not g Getting paid.Can I switch agents ? Also will I lose my plan because I called the insurance company and complained about their OTC plan? It's a rip off."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgzskV46oy9WHJzZmGF4AaABAg>

"I signed up for Humana dental for 2026.... I signed up for Humana dental for 2026 and have regretted it ever since. When signing up in marketplace it seemed like it was the best option. They had my current dentist in-network(with no locations listed). First dentist appointment was in February, the submitted a claim and I then received a bill for almost the full amount minus \$19 and change, for an out-of-network dentist. I went to Humana's website and Dr.Lockney is still listed as in network. They have him listed in 4 locations, 3 being in network and 1 being out. Fact: Dr.Lockney only works at ONE family owned practice, he does NOT work or has ever worked at any other practice or location . I called Humana with my findings.They informed me that my information is correct and his location is out of network, no solution. As I explained again my situation they informed me they actually do not have any in network dentists in my city. They said I should file an appeal which I had already done and was denied. Customer service said they would contact Dr.Lockney to see if he would like to join their network, I ask if they would back date my claims if he did, she said "I don't know". I explained again that this is not user error and they are at fault and my claims should be paid. She again stated I should file an appeal and they will fix the misinformation on their website. By this time (August 2026) I have seen Dr.Lockney twice and my daughter once with a cost of \$840.80. I have paid Humana \$566.37 with an outstanding bill of \$161.82 = \$728.19 total YTD. So basically I will have paid \$1,568.99 for dental YTD. Humana is a total scam. They basically make up the "in network" doctors list. And never pay any of your claims with the excuse of "location". The outcome I would like to see is a full refund for all the money I have given them to be insured, pay for the dentist for my troubles and cancel. I'd like to mention I have proof of all of this. Lockney Dental (704) 324-8521 Kelley Burren 7047013087 Concord, NC Claim# 202602116380321"

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a873579330d94cb96c65de3>

"I currently have United Healthcare. For years I have used 2 medications that I was told didn't have generic. They are very expensive. I just got on a program with Indiana University Healthcare that will cover prescription costs on medications that United Healthcare have copays . Upon starting the program Indiana University found there were actually generics for my two very expensive drugs. United Healthcare doesnt cover the generic they said in letters I was sent. I called United Healthcare and nope they wont cover generic. Its a scam!!! They wont accept a generic drug to save money??? I also can look at it as maybe United Healthcare doesnt want to pay it at all since Indiana University Healthcare is helping me they will just let IU pay it all. Worst of all the lady I was talking to at United Healthcare bursts out "thats the big beautiful bill for you." I spoke my mind back. I was supposed to get a survey after the call which I wanted and the rep wouldn't disconnect the line. She didn't want me to get that survey. She should have NEVER brought politics into it. I guess I'll be moving my insurance coverage from United Healthcare."

— YouTube · The Truth About United Healthcare's Claim Denials and Dr. Oz's Plan to Force Medicare Adva · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LhIMMntQaY0&lc=Ugy2Mq0sGEHgOnpiFCp4AaABAg>

"@reneeblack8940 Sorry that person didn't respond to your question. Everyone I know has AARP United supplement Health Plan including myself and I'm very happy with it. My mother was stubborn and joined Humana HC which is really Medicare Advantage. Leery I called Humana to find out if they were legit medicare. They hid that they were medicare advantage plan. She had to pay co-pays, and paid huge amounts to radiology for scans. She was on a fixed income and her medical costs kept rising. To the day she died she was hounded by the radiology place to pay her bill. She was so stressed, they demanded a cc and they pulled money from her card. With a supplement you pay premiums. Whatever medicare doesn't pay, the supplement pays the rest. After my mom passed the radiology place called me many times despite telling them she passed and had no estate. I helped supplement her so she could have food. The radiology place had to eat the cost. That's what they deserve for treating an elderly person that way."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · family member helping · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugx5CVy8MAo_bxfGmzd4AaABAg.AMXLcgwE_I_ANBIXLBQ7tK

"I have United Health Care Advantage plan. They have not paid for providers saying they are out of network when the clinic said they were before they made the appointment. Also I need a Psychiatrist after calling United and asking for a list of Psychiatrist in my area. After exhausting list after list they gave me even out of my area.. I called United I said you find me a Psychiatrist to go to anywhere in Austin, Tx.. After 3 weeks they called with two names.. I called one said they did not take United. And the other said they did not accept new patients.. After United said that I had been accepted.. Needless to say. I am off of any Psychiatrist drugs.. Hopefully I will not committ suicide. I have tried before 3 times.. Don't get on a Advantage plan."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgwEkJd25Ga0kseISWB4AaABAg>

"I also had trouble finding a dentist to accept my MA plan. Then I called Aetna and asked them to find a dentist in my area that would accept my plan, and they called the dentist to explain how it works. My benefit was for a fixed amount of money, around \$2000 per year. The first year, I had to pay cash to the dentist, then file a claim. Aetna always paid it. But after that the dentist billed directly. Paid all for exams, cleanings, even deep cleanings and fillings. But then I discovered there was a tier system, so for more complicated work like crowns they would only pay a percentage of the cost, even though I had money left in my benefit amount."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgwPZFcv6WpB3KEM1cl4AaABAg.AOXzQff4AvqAPd9eo0qQ5P>

"I was shocked to see my Plan F go to \$5k Ann. I called United & was told they will call back & do an application for plan G. If it's going to be the same after copay I might have to go to Humana. will be 85 (F)2/25. Aside from knee pain I don't go to the Dr. HIP replacement @ this age is not an option for me. I tried calling your # no avail.

😞 "

— YouTube · Don't Buy Medigap Plan G Before Watching This ! · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tughWPQP_o08&lc=Ugzd7C61NqVgnCXEzBF4AaABAg

"How do you know if the hospitals and clinics your doctors use, are covered by an advantage plan? An advisor said Humana giveback was a good one for me - when I called Humana, they said my doctors are covered, but NOT the hospitals and clinics. WTH?????"

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=Ugzehrod1va7br6SvQ14AaABAg>

Friends, family, neighbors · 10 documents

"I am 66 and when I first retired I went with an Advantage plan and was happy with it until I needed it. I needed a Cat Scan for lung issues I was having and needed prior approval for the Cat Scan. The Advantage plan denied it and I spent three days on the phone back and forth talking to numerous people each day and never talking to the same person twice. After three days they said ok and I asked why they approved the Cat Scan and the person said they didn't know why but it was approved. The next renewal period I went with regular Medicare and Plan G. This year I was in the hospital intensive care for four days and needed no approvals and my only cost was my \$240. Deductible. My cost for the Plan G supplemental plan is \$158. a month and boy is it worth it for the peace of mind of not worrying about a big medical bill and pre approvals."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 65 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxdvpDxXszYorK4pCx4AaABAq>

"The person at our local senior center who helped with info when we signed up for Medicare over 5 years ago warned us about not being guaranteed to move from an advantage to a Medigap/supplemental plan. So very glad we chose a supplemental plan. The advantage plans are a horror of denials, referrals etc."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=UgxefqUbJQyLYRyCYv54AaABAq.AXFFtsLMytJAZXHpuUxTFuU>

"I am beginning to wonder about my BCBS advantage plan. When I got medicare I had no health issues and the sales person said this would be the best for me so I got it. On the second year of having the plan I got stage 1 breast cancer. They pretty much covered everything except they disagreed with my doctor on the number of radiation treatments. They said for my stage of breast cancer I only needed 4 instead of 5 or 6 treatments. So I got the 4. Turns out so far they paid all but 6000+ of my treatment. When I had to have another biopsy done they only covered \$208. of the procedure. They are both still pending and I'm worried I am going to be stuck with the bill totalling over \$10,000."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugynw5nW7W69BUVLQqV4AaABAq>

"I got my letter saying my M A premier HMO POS is being discontinued and I need to get new insurance by Dec 31, 2025. My husband has same plan as me and when I called my insurance since he got no cancellation letter, I called, they told me he is not cancelled. Red flag here! If doing away with my plan, why is my husband still being covered by this plan. He got no notice and also got no ANOC. I told them to send me proof he is covered. My second call to my insurance company, the person I spoke with said I still had coverage. I told her that is not what this letter I got on Oct 2, 2025 says. It plainly says you are cancelled, you plan is being discontinued. My other thing is in back of Medicare book, it still shows plan available in 2026. If I go back to original Medicare, I pay my \$185.00 premium that is deducted from my SS check monthly. I also will pay a monthly premium to the plan I choose, plus higher copays for hospital and specialist doctors and primary Dr. It is all about insurance companies making and keeping their profits. Makes no difference I paid into Medicare my entire life Seems someone is lying to me."

— YouTube · Big Medicare Advantage changes for 2026. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=73mR9YGZHSM&lc=UgxLcRkWalF-oiHHVgJ4AaABAq.ANmidDT4xvkANuE5XrS6-x>

"So my husband is on Social Security disability, and when I applied for his Medicare, the person told me he had to have an advantage plan, the advantage plan sent me a bill which I had to pay. I thought Social Security Medicare pays for that ? 🤔 "

— YouTube · Is Your Doctor OR Hospital Ditching Medicare Advantage? (Do This Now) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yGsP4y9yhdM&lc=UgyuYLunchHkm2MK8HC54AaABAg>

"That's all a lied I live in brockton Massachusetts and I spoke to Medicare a year ago and they said I couldn't get the allowance card to buy groceries pay bills well today it's october 23 spoke to 4 people and they transfer me to an agent I told each one all I want to know if where I live gives out allowance card the last one said they have it but it's only 35 dollars so I git mad and told him why waste my time again just hear that I don't qualify for 350 dollars allowance card I cursed them out because the 4 person I spoke to I told him all I want to know is about the allowance card he said let me look into this and what happened I can't get allowance I told him I wasted my time I knew it you all liars waste peoples time I said please put in the computer that in brockton Massachusetts they don't get allowance card and I hanged I feel bad for people that are 70 80s and they call im so pist off right now it was ridiculous and he kept saying let me see what I can do all that for nothing why do Medicare agents waste people's time im 59 yrs old"

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgzN9aXOwEERuMQimIB4AaABAg>

"My brother in law just had nine fusions in his back. He has Medicare advantage through CIGNA I think it's called CIGNA preferred my sister said all they have had to pay for his surgery which included five days in intensive care and a total of 13 days in the hospital, is \$113. They have no deductible no monthly premium and \$113 is all they had to pay for his surgery I am very confused can you explain how this works? Thank you for your time."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgykzZjKz6ivau3jJnI4AaABAg>

"I check for visits and what was billed. Got charged for a few hundred catheters last time. Never needed one, called Medicare because I wasn't sure if that was a billing error or not. Person I talked to said it is fraud and they have been receiving a lot of these."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1t16245/most_people_throw_away_their_medicare_summary/ojf8oad/

"I was planning to get medicap I have Medicare my husband said when you get extra insurance to cover a and b over here I got Medicare I like to try to medigap and see if it's any good I'm Gwen Ammons from Ohio"

— YouTube · What is Medigap? (Medicare Supplement Insurance Explained) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RnXi0LJRVY&lc=Ugzy8M9BJp3Y_wcpkkl4AaABAg

"I have Medicare A&B and I have Tricare for life I actually spoke to an honest Medicare Advantage salesperson and he told me to stay with what I had and never change it"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=Ugw8rxnCeiyAUN4TMkt4AaABAg>

TV ads and people who called them · 9 documents

"16:58 Yep, this happened to me. I was seeing an endocrinologist who was about 30 minutes away, and as I can't drive I was getting transport from my advantage plan, only one day the insurance decided that while the doctor was still in-network, the building his *office* was in wasn't anymore so I couldn't get rides to that office anymore. Well, I switched over to doing telehealth with them and that was fine, but then one day a month before my next appointment my insurance called me up to tell me the doctor was no longer in-network either. The next closest in-network endocrinologist (it turns out it's really hard to find ones that do telehealth) is an hour and a half away. Mind you, there are 3 endocrinologists in the town I live in, less than 3 miles from me, but none of them are in-network so I'd have to see them out of pocket, which you might imagine isn't practical for a disabled person on medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgyeCcGV9213jttCkZ4AaABAg>

"Looks like WellCare Value Script is the cheapest plan and best option for me in Northern California for 2027. Its formulary covers all my medications. I think agents are an important part of this puzzle called Medicare."

— YouTube · 2027 Medicare Drug Plans: Two Things You NEED to Know · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ANgeD3oOJ40&lc=UgwwLXgS52FsCFiEeG14AaABAg>

"I thought it was obvious it was called medicare advantage because it takes advantage of you"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugx4mqxmjKsNbzkXwMN4AaABAg>

"Do you ever work with a non-traditional gap plan company? My wife and I went on a Christian share plan in 2016 called Medi-Share for our health coverage. They pay their claims well. So, since I am going on Medicare in October 2026, I am going to convert over to their Medi-Share 65+. The monthly cost is \$99 per month, but does have a \$500 annual household portion to be met. But, even with that it is cheaper than a traditional G plan. The monthly share amount stays at \$99 per month until I reach 75 then goes to \$150 per month for life. It will pay just like a plan G. I was just wondering if you have ever checked into this before?"

— YouTube · When To NOT Call A Medicare Broker · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zEYptYsaMGY&lc=UgxMU6ClnO9gL_0AbhN4AaABAg

"I don't know what number you called because I called and made a reservation for a call back to register and when they called me back they never even mentioned advantage plans. They just verified that I was eligible and signed me up for Part A and B and I got them to set up automatic billing. It sounds like you didn't call the actual Medicare number."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgwspuuSLr0lwSAb2np4AaABAg.AOTq8utKNuzAQfxw-oc20k

"I am 65 years old and I'm kind of surprised i am still alive. I am going to change my Part D as they won't cover certain medications but I am happy with my Medicare and Plan G. I have three dogs and a pet centipede. He loves spiders 🕷️ he thinks they're delicious 😊 I was in the process of moving from Michigan to West Virginia. I got a "cold call" from an agent whilst I was heavily involved in the hassle of moving and packing. I attempted to blow her off but she gave me great advice. Unfortunately I didn't accurately get her name and number, but I am happy."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=Ugw_sXiwcunmlpNfLd4AaABAg

"My husband is seeing a VA doctor but when he got sick and went to the hospital the VA didnt pay for any of it even tho the VA doctor told him to go to the hospital. I checked on the VA website. VA said if you have an Advantage or other health plan then they wont pay anything. The VA hospital is over 2 hours away so couldnt go there in an emergency and they wouldnt transport him. I am considering just turning off his advantage plan so the VA covers his next hospital stay, when I called Medicare and said this they thot that was a terrible idea."

— YouTube · "Free" Medicare Advantage? The Truth Behind \$0 Medicare Advantage Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nMEU6IEkf7Y&lc=Ugy89EFB3r9Q4KlqEop4AaABAg.9OE1a3Ewvrh9V7laB3szCy>

"I want to let everyone know that I called Medicare to see if they have that allowance where you can get toothpaste shampoo etc she said Aetna does so I said wow ok could you believe she said the allowance Aetna has is 20 dollars every 3 months are yiu kidding me so I hanged up and before I did I told her they can keep that money from Massachusetts"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement - NEW cost comparison · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t7XBSZaPx5E&lc=UgwLz7XcCsleXo-Nm9l4AaABAg>

"I just got my Medicare quarterly and Sunshine Senior Solutions made 4 claims on my Medicare amounting to \$26,997. I called Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgzA4BJyqjFk8w1J8Rp4AaABAg>

SHIP counselors · 8 documents

"My Experience With Medicare So Far Hi, I started Medicare in November 2024 and I just wanted to share my initial experience so far. A little background: I visited this forum many times and posted many questions in the six months or so before my 65th bday. I found out about ship help early on and enlisted their support by talking with a counselor online (who spent at least 30 minutes with me and was very knowledgeable), plus I signed up for a "Roadmap to Medicare" group meeting that they offered to the community (I live in Orange County, California). It certainly helped me to invest all of the time that I did because it helped me to really narrow down the path I elected to take. For anyone approaching this transition to Medicare I can only say that both Medicare.gov and places like ship help and this forum are invaluable. YouTube videos are plentiful and it is also a resource. I also enlisted a broker who I trusted and she proved invaluable in getting prepared as well as helping me with the application and follow-up questions. For me, I decided to go with traditional Medicare and a medigap supplement "G" and part D for prescriptions initially. My choice was primarily driven by the experience I had through my employer's insurance (I'm retired). They put me through hell for anything I needed. To be fair, my partner chose SCAN and been super happy with it. I'll say that I've been impressed with how quickly SCAN has been with appointments and referrals for their healthcare needs. I chose United Healthcare/AARP for both my medigap and part D portions. Their part G rates seemed reasonable for my zip code (with the discount), and the prescription plan covers all of my meds, which is a big plus. I have been able to get my meds delivered by mail (yes!!) and going to the doctor now is sooo easy. They get my Medicare info and the rest is taken care of. I check both Medicare.gov as well as UHC websites very regularly and I have to say that navigating both is a breeze for someone technologically inept like myself (lol). In summary, I would advise those approaching enrollment in Medicare to learn as much as possible as early as possible. For most people, I don't think there is any reason to not invest in this significant milestone. There is no shortage of resources to assist with this, in my opinion. Ship help, this forum, videos, and a broker will prove invaluable. Again, I am so happy with my experience so far, and part of that I'll concede is how miserable I was with my employer provided health insurance. FWIW I worked in healthcare for forty years and the coverage just got worse and worse. Plus, I have peace of mind for the first time since starting adulthood, in that I know that I will have health insurance and not be dependent upon my employer providing it. This has been my experience so far and I hope that it continues. Thank you to everyone who has answered my questions here in the past, you've been a part of helping me to make these choices. Take care of yourself and choose a good plan, no one else will do it for you !! (I tried to break my post into paragraphs and I apologize for not understanding how to do it, I know it would have been easier to read. I'm not good with technology, or much of anything anymore.)"

— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1iten4m/>

"@AbtInsuranceAgency thank you for such an easy to understand video of the difference. I called SHIP and was still so confused until I watched this. Is it true I have to get supplemental through a private carrier such as Aetna or Humana?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Vs. Medicare Supplement - An Unbiased Comparison · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EXNLA6j2x0M&lc=UgwicP9BcYgC0OAwdUh4AaABAg.92TeakBOy1O92i9Qcbw8D>

"Yes, I am aware of that, thank you. And thank you for your videos. My state allows me to switch to any other plan except Plan A (no longer sold?) and Plan F (don't qualify for that one due to my age) , so I can switch to a Plan N later, if that makes more sense. Right now, this is the path that works best for me. I have done extensive research and also discussed and got assistance from my SHIP representative. I had to get some Medigap plan within the bounds of my SEP (because, although my state - not NY btw- has better guaranteed issue rights than many others, I am still bound by the SEP timing or I lose guaranteed issue. HD-G premiums in my state are lower than Plan N, I am healthy right now (thank God!) and have few doctor's visits, so this seemed like a good choice for me. Am I taking advantage of the system, well, just doing what is right for me. I wish everyone the best. This is much more convoluted than it should be, and as I mentioned, your videos are very helpful in finding the way through the maze."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyYhExgJdVDH1dnNpp4AaABAg.9yNfosgcxRg9zWuaSDKqCd>

"I have medicare/ share of cost medicaid. I was told I can still switch to a supplement. Im am 70. I have medicare/ full medicaid. But when my x died and I received his ss my income increase. Im not sure if I should switch to a supplement. I have only B.P and high cholesterol. Nothing else. I spoke to a person from SHIP. They said I can get a supplement for about 100\$ month. My share of cost is my whole ss check and it is a monthly deductible. Im not sure what's best for me. I recently went in ER and my 14,000 bill i had to pay only 400\$. If you can give me any guidance please help. And I also wonder in I can get a supplement can I switch back to share of cost medicaid"

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=Ugw_Y7vr57pPEQItN0R4AaABAg

"I contacted my Ship Counselor supposedly head lady I explain that my 2025 PPO plan merged with a different new PPO plan in 2026 but the coverage is totally different. So I couldn't get that guarantee issue right letter even though my plan ended. The head guy from advantage went line by line in the annual notice change and he agreed the plans pay completely different. Then he said we merged them in case someone didn't make a switch then the would have no covered. WTH. Ship lady says nothing she could do since they're merged. I said so you're going to allow this behavior. She said nothing she can do about it. WTH"

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=Ugx7ya7JPIAvkVSAMO14AaABAg.A_Ryk3k9t9UA_S5apGlzfO

"Well im on disability need a lung transplant do was on Medicaid w va im be 65 in this April i applied for to see if i could get both so i applied for ship program i make 1395 minus the 175 the state put me in a d plan though the state thou the plan with united healthcare 0 cost but like 11buck a script at200a yr is that deductible,4(waiting on the states decision i like to stay in original medcare dont need eye teeth gym a letter said from ssi i qualify csu help me plesse likw yo keep advantage plans tout of my needs"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgxY_xmBnl6pYdpht054AaABAg

"Your right i got on a ship program pays my 175 got a plan d 4.50 to 11.dollars like 200 a yr my medgap is 125 but they take part b out regardless so its like less than the 175 and im in reg original medcare with the best benefits"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgyoIKt33N2vq3KppCR4AaABAg>

"I just got my Medicare quarterly and Sunshine Senior Solutions made 4 claims on my Medicare amounting to \$26,997. I called Medicare."

— YouTube · Medicare Part A B C D Explained (and made simple!) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sshK1P7qkoc&lc=UgzA4BJyqjFk8w1J8Rp4AaABAg>

Doctor's office · 4 documents

"It's not that black and white. I have Medicare advantage with Kaiser and considering my options (over 65, have Multiple Sclerosis) it is quite good. There are two things I especially like: 1) No administrative take backs on procedures. When I first got MS I had a PPO and my doctor said to get expensive tests like MRIs. I would and then some a-hole bureaucrat would refuse it. For the only time in my life I was looking like a credit risk because I had unpaid bills for tens of thousands of dollars. God that was hell. Besides dealing the the trauma of no longer being able to walk normally, I had to deal with all the anxiety caused by administrative a-holes. 2) The doctors are in general quite good. Not just in that they know what they're doing but they actually talk to me and listen rather than just putting me into a box based on a 5 minute overview of the way I filled out some form. In my experience that's unfortunately very rare in the US because a for profit system pushes doctors to be more like efficient factory workers than empathic care givers. Luckily some doctors care enough to still listen to patients. Just to be clear: I agree that the whole for profit system is BS and Medicare Advantage is an example of that. Just saying given the broken system we have, Medicare advantage can provide decent options for some people in some locations."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCc&lc=UgyfsluT2u6E9J_AQDt4AaABAg_APD2vBaWjr3A_3BpsHg1zW

"@g0989 At the time I didn't know anything about anything. I just knew that I was mad as hell because it was just a bait and switch. After what the lady at the doctor's office told me I switched her back to medicare. Her meds were not very expensive so we just paid for them. The PA did put her on a \$300 once a day insulin that did not control her diabetes. We started using Walmart insulin in two doses and it controlled her diabetes. In Georgia you can get insulin over the counter and Walmart sells their own brand. It's made by the same company as the name brand. It was \$25 back then. It worked great for her and is probably a lifesaver for many others. I would never get a Medicare Disadvantage plan. I am totally against the privatization of medicare. They're trying to do it to institutions that have served us very well. Look at the Postal Service. It won't stop unless we stop it. I lost my sister to covid in January of 21 while a crooked coward secretly got the vaccine."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤯 · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugx4L8LUGpEt1CSGoBx4AaABAg.9yUchLrsiyx9yb2fnNH-fu>

"I chose traditional medicare A&B and I also have no cost (secondary) supplemental health care coverage with my retirement which covers prescriptions and office visits. My health is very good. My doctor said I chose the right choice. She also added that if you opt to take an advantage plan, you can (never) go back to traditional medicare but if you take traditional, you can always change to an advantage plan. I personally don't want an ins company to decide what I need or don't need in my health needs based on their bottom line profits. Do you have any further advice for me or do you also think I chose correctly?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement I Most Get This Wrong · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4xXIJZes9o&lc=UgzPqy5KeKMW0npxgW54AaABAg>

"My mother cancelled Parts B and D and then got a heart attack. I was asked to pay for her doctors office bills and medications. There was a drug she needed that was \$350/month. So I called every pharmacy to see what they charged for it. Costco charged \$30 for it while all of the rest were in the hundreds of dollars. So I joined Costco and bought it there for her until she was able to get back on Part D."

— r/medicare · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1m9w1fe/rant_just_found_out_my_95_year_old_father_doesnt/n5ajgyb/

Medicare.gov / Plan Finder / 1-800-MEDICARE · 3 documents

"My Aetna Advantage plan is not going to be offered in 2025 and have a letter from Aetna stating I have the right to buy another Advantage or Medigap plan. I went online to Medicare.gov and selected another Advantage plan for 2025. I've watched your videos and think I have made a huge mistake! Have I lost the chance to select a Medigap plan now? Even at 75, I'm positive I can get through the underwriting process."

— YouTube · Can You Pass Medicare Underwriting? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c29jkM5-6bw&lc=UgwqNyHLjygxlduP51Z4AaABAg.9xHVjVSv9EzAAvCgt44mLZ>

"I agree. I found my Humana part D plan right off medicare.gov and mine is \$0 a month and (lucky for me) my generic drugs are free"

— YouTube · Trump Administration Ends Medicare Part D Subsidies - Here's What It Means · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OGuOGZSI_fc&lc=UgxQeLHWlxNE6h3TPTx4AaABAg.AZtfdQEFQBZAuP6Wfv2Oz

"@GiardiniMedicare I got mine free signing up directly through the Medicare.gov website"

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=Ugzo-bdpKAJeWgKkj_54AaABAg.AC3mOsvFhreACOnTfVOH-I

Dislikes

Denied care, prior authorization, rehab cut short

"Physical Therapist here. Absolutely keep your traditional Medicare with Plan N/G while you can. Medicare with a plan G is a Golden plan. Dr.'s and hospital love traditional Medicare. They won't be denied and you won't be denied care. Plus you can choose any specialist/provider you want and also go to the top notch hospitals in the whole country including Mayo, Johns Hopkins, Cleveland Clinic etc, etc, etc. In the end if you get really sick it's well worth it. I pay around \$450 a month including Part A and B premium. I worked all my life in healthcare to afford to access the best healthcare in our country."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 595 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxcFFuqvyczX0JtB0J4AaABAg>

"Sunburn. My mother chose an advantage plan. She found they can deny anything they want to deny for any of no reason. They "delayed" her dental coverage until she was to frail to have the dental work done. She had colon cancer that could be treated with laparoscopic surgery my sister had to fight the insurance company to provide after care. They denied colon cancer screening after that because "she would likely die of something else first". She got another tumor that couldn't be treated with laparoscopic surgery. After the surgery the "hospitalist" repeated 8 or 9 times that because she was over 80 going forward she would only receive "palliative" care for such a major event. My brother was wisely recording the conversation and told the "hospitalist" if he mentioned "palliative" care one more time he would sue him for elder abuse. During her after care she had sores in her mouth and could barely eat. The only thing insurance would allow was a test for thrush, which came up negative so no further action. Her surgery wound wasn't healing for lack of her eating enough protein due to the sores in her mouth. She quickly ended up in hospice and I flew down and became aware of the whole situation. I asked the hospice nurse if there was a medicated mouthwash that might solve the problem and could she get me a script for it. She said yes and I went out and bought it. In one day she was eating normally. Her wound started to heal and her 30 days after care was up, insurance wouldn't pay for more even with her still unhealed surgical wound. We kids chipped in and paid. She lived on for several years. My point is with advantage care you give up all your rights under part A and B and put them in the hands of the insurance company. That is the biggest risk of all. Your experience could be great or deadly, and there's no way of knowing beforehand."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 333 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyrQ0RNoaOb4etaX-54AaABAg>

"Almost fell into that trap until I was warned by a person who's family member eventually died because of care that was denied to them because Medicare Advantage declined to pay for treatment because it was too expensive despite the recommendation of a specialist. While in the appeals process, the family member passed away. After doing some research on my own, I found that this had occurred multiple times with people on Medicare Advantage. Also, that many healthcare providers were now refusing to accept Medicare Advantage. Needless to say, I chose traditional Medicare. The gap premiums aren't cheap, but I have the "peace of mind" of knowing that I can receive the care/treatment recommended by my doctor. This shouldn't be happening to seniors who PAID into Medicare their entire working lives."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 270 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgwTr1OgGdvCFu3U5Fp4AaABAg>

"I spent the last half of my career working in the billing office for a medical specialist group. I dealt with everything from private insurance, worker's compensation, medicare, medicaid, etc. By a large margin, the problems I encountered with payment denials came from Medicare Advantage plans. And most of those happened because people did not understand the rules of their plans. Thanks for the informative video."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: What They Don't Tell You · 232 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hrkbOjBtBsw&lc=UgwMop0zRDK1CKkLhJ14AaABAg>

"United Healthcare denied my mother healthcare. I made my decision to not select a Medicare Advantage plan based on the poor care my mother received from United healthcare. Do not purchase insurance from them. They actively work to deny patient care."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 213 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgytHQMNgQ3ZiB6A5Wp4AaABAg>

"My wife had been complaining of shortness of breath for about six months before finally talking to her doctor in late August. The doctor had an EKG done, which was normal, and then ordered a CT scan of her heart. In September she was diagnosed with severe aortic stenosis, (bad aortic valve), which has a 50% mortality rate within two years. She then had a cardiac catheterization done to see if her heart was healthy or if she needed bypass surgery. Her arteries were clear and an appointment was made for an open heart valve replacement. The open heart surgery with valve replacement was done in the first week of November. The total cost of everything was \$207,000. Our out-of-pocket cost was \$280, part of which was the part B deductible. We have original Medicare with Plan N and a Part D prescription plan. I believe if we had an MA plan we would still be waiting on prior authorization if she survived long enough."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 212 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzevbXaSuoWX4WCW814AaABAg>

"Medicare advantage is shit. In the long run, I don't know if it would've made a difference, but my uncle was 65 and on an advantage plan covered by his union, which he felt was the best option at the time because it was essentially free and he hadn't run into any problems, even with his cancer treatment. Advantage denied him a kind of Hail Mary chemo drug. He went thru appeals, was denied, and eventually got it through a manufacturer program. But all that back and forth took like, 6 months. He is no longer with us, and maybe it wouldn't have worked regardless, but there's always that, what if? As someone who works in insurance, I tried to help and encourage him to switch to regular Medicare, because this wouldn't have been a problem if he had regular Medicare. But they sell people so hard on these advantage plans, and it's absolute BS."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 203 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=UgwyEdLvHJXglO4cteJ4AaABAg>

"This is the ONLY unbiased YouTube on both options. This gentleman is an agent and that's very rare. I can name two, no three agencies that do nothing but flood this site with constant negative videos about Medicare Advantage Plans. The one guy always has a thumbnail with his eyes wide open and his hand over his mouth. Scare tactic, nothing more. Supplements are great, but millions of Americans have advantage plans that do what they are designed to do without issue. I personally have experience using both for more than a decade. Original Medicare should be requiring more pre-authorizations and in the coming years this will happen. The government has been getting ripped off for decades. Oh, we like cats!"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Supplement Plans (2026 Update) – Full Comparison · 171 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cxhlXrMrc5s&lc=UgxT0a_1CgP1_SKsFld4AaABAg

"As an Oncology provider for over 40 years I will tell you that there are other issues to consider which in my opinion make a G plan even more helpful. One of these issues is that G plans allow you to seek expert care outside of an Advantage plan PPO list of providers and institutions. I practice in a rural community and often send my patient to larger Comprehensive Cancer Centers around the country where they can get the best care for their unique situation. As I understand it, some Advantage plans may not pay as well in these situations. The other issue is prior approvals. If I order a diagnostic study such as a PET scan or MRI, or an IV chemotherapy medication agent, with a G plan there is no authorization process and these items will be paid for (assuming I am practicing within accepted guidelines). An Advantage plan may require a prior authorization before the test or medication can be ordered. These prior authorizations are a huge burden to providers and staff. Indeed, at many large institutions they will not spend any time on these and that means a less than ideal test or drug may need to be substituted."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 164 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCl8m0OI18&lc=Ugyjp1bQqNodSTf4TMd4AaABAg>

"I have plan G-----I had a heart valve replaced and then a series of health problems, plan G made sense to me. My old workplace health plan was a PPO and I got tired of having to wait for pre authorization, and sometimes got turned down. If I need a cat scan or Mri, there is no pre-authorization. So far, plan G has been good for me"

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · 134 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=Uggr0umEPhaqKRmCcjl4AaABAg>

"What decisions as you near retirement are "time-sensitive"? As you near retirement (say, 65) what decisions are "time-sensitive"? We had a close call with almost being unable to get a Medicare supplement (Medigap). Was not aware you get a *one-time* 6 month window when you first get Medicare that insurance/supplement companies are *required* to allow you to enroll and cannot deny you (or charge a higher rate). Individual here was pressured to take Medicare Advantage and lost their guaranteed issue timeframe and had to go through medical unwriting and was initially denied and had to appeal to get approved. This makes me wonder, what other decisions regarding retirement are "time-sensitive" or something individuals may not think about and/or realize before it's too late?"

— r/retirement · 121 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1n0pjc2/>

"This video was so informative. My late husband was blessed to have a Supplement Plan G. Prior to beginning Medicare he began having neurological problems and was diagnosed with ALS. Thankfully we were able to receive the treatments he needed without the stress of co-pays, referrals, or pre authorizations. Instead of the healthcare process being a bear to deal with, it seemed more like leading a lamb."

— YouTube · The Differences are Bigger Than You Think I Medicare Advantage vs Supplement · 98 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eOP76hMPiDs&lc=UgxnPLA_JdSH8Od-IRF4AaABAg

"Careless eHealth employees. Took an Advantage plan with eHealth Simply in 2024. Canceled via phone call (at least 4 verified calls, Nov through Dec) to update to a Cigna Medicare Plan N. Have been paying on this plan for 6 months and was denied Cataract surgery because Medicare still lists eHealth Simply Advantage as my insurance. They failed to remove me from Medicare. Their negligence has cost me 6 months of payments to Cigna and will again need to reapply in Oct. Surgery canceled. Medicare needs a serious reform and eHealth should be penalized. Once again, seniors are at harm."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/686039989bd2e83a6d370986>

"Hate mongrel company. Hate mongrel company. Denied a job because of my Jewish last name. Not a surprise. scammy woke Cali company. Tell these bozos to take a hike if they call you!"

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6621a171d7ba26b5e33ef431>

"I spoke with an agent on 12/01/2020.... I spoke with an agent on 12/01/2020 inquiring about replacing my current Medicare Supplement Plan N, I gave her my medical history, explained my current coverage, & we completed my application online. She advised me that based on all the information available I should be able to qualify for an AARP Plan N, even though I had CML. Three days later I received an email advising me that my application had been denied without an explanation, I'm assuming that I was declined because of the CML even though that was discussed at the time of my original application, so I am being denied due to a pre-existing condition!!! Ron Canniff"

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5fcea53c755dc1076896fa2a>

"We've filled out the questionnaire. We've filled out the questionnaire, talked to the guy for almost an hour on the phone and did another questionnaire and still haven't heard from anyone. At least tell us if coverage was denied also the amount you said we could get was half for double the price. And my husband is a healthy man."

— TrustPilot · SelectQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a7788dce23e62cc3ada21b9>

"Warning, do not use Boomer Benefits . Boomer Benefits signed me up for supplement plans without my authority. This was an obvious way to get their commission. Jan 2024, I signed up through Boomer for my Wife and I to start us each on plan G, part D and Dental. I gave them my bank account for payments. So, January there was a first charge to open my accounts. Soon after, my retirement was delayed, I emailed my Boomer rep, Kate to let her know I was delaying signing up for Medicare so I would also delay starting my supplements. Around August, my retirement was delayed again so I let Boomer know I would let them know when I would need the supplements to start, most likely in early 2026. A couple months later, checking my bank account, I found a total of 5 months of charges totaling approximately \$1,600 gone from my account. I immediately emailed Boomer requesting refunds. It has taken 3 months, many emails back and forth and over 30 hours of phone conversations with Cigna to finally receive refunds on our plan G. But, Cigna will not refund the \$500 for dental plans. When i requested that refund from Boomer, since this was their fault, they denied the request. Boomer also claims they tried to help me get all refunds but Cigna never received any request from Boomer for my refunds. So all they did was steal my money. They took my money before they had my approval to do so, and before I was on Medicare. They are responsible for me losing \$500 and all my lost time. This is a warning. Find another Medicare broker. Do not use Boomer Benefits."

— TrustPilot · Boomer Benefits · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/697bcd76fd8e6be8eaa1ef9>

"I tried to get a policy for 2020.. I tried to get a policy for 2020.. uploaded all the required documents and also sent them to you by certified mail...then after several weeks I call and get told that I was denied coverage because I didn't submit documents by the required date even though I hade a return receipt proving I did... representative told me in a very rude manner that I was basically SOL.... nothing I could do... I called the agent and he said that my experience wasn't abnormal and there was no use in filing a appeal as I was just 4 weeks from the 2021 policy being active... have you people have no understanding of the term "customer service" ? As a 2 time cancer survivor knowing that it can come back at a moments notice it is quite unnerving living without health insurance due to incompetence... I find this irresponsible Obama program to be completely ridiculous and unfair... I have submitted the required information and documents for 2021 so let's see if y'all want to play games with that... I'm told I'm not alone with this battle and I do know where Kentucky is.... get it together people..."

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5fceaaa7755dc105f02d0564>

"CS very hard to understand. CS very hard to understand. Authorization process is set to delay care. Care delayed is care denied"

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aab0c816f8d8b97207c424f>

"Demand to See the Ultra Fine Print. I have a Humana Medicare Advantage plan. The plan I was sold specifically states that an annual dental allowance of \$1000 is included. This year, I needed a crown. Denied. When I asked why, they directed me to a website that had hundreds of pages of fine print. Somewhere on this site, it stated that everything else in Dental was included, EXCEPT CROWNS. I appealed, asking what the difference was and why a measly \$1000 could not be used on any preventative dental care. They took four months to 'process my appeal', then sent an email that said nothing more than Appeal Denied. No explanation and no way to contact anyone who was part of the process. Do not trust this company."

— TrustPilot · Humana · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aa2ccb091801eedb07a8e07>

Stuck: can't switch back to a Medigap

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAg

"my best friend who is older than me was sold an advantage plan when she retired and didn't even know it. She thought she had "Medicare" After educating herself she was denied supplemental due to a medical condition. However, her advantage plan got canceled and she became eligible for no underwriting supplemental, she is happily on a medigap plan now."

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 65 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugw5dC0g1BZMxjki_R54AaABAg

"Thank you. One of the most professional and knowledgeable presentations that I have heard about the pros and cons of Advantage Plans vs. Supplement Plans. Medical underwriting was explained to me using an airport analogy: I've gotten off the plane and I'm free to walk around the airport, go to the news stand, get a cup of coffee, etc. When I leave that secure area (like leaving my original, one-time-only enrollment period), I walk through doors with signs that say "exit only, no returning through these doors". If I want to go back into the airport, I have to go through security (i.e. underwriting) again. It's a time-consuming hassle for folks who take that route. And there's no guarantee that a person will get through medical underwriting successfully."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 59 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxclzjxWRhhykzbdwp4AaABAg

"The Hidden Dangers of Medicare Advantage Plans for Social Security Recipients It's open enrollment time for Medicare eligibles. All those TV ads and direct mail pieces, some of which come from hospitals, urging you to switch to a Medicare Advantage Plan from the traditional Medicare Part A and B. Medicare Advantage plans, also known as Medicare Part C, have gained popularity recently as an alternative to traditional Medicare. These plans offer enticing benefits such as low premiums and additional coverage, making them seem like an excellent choice for Social Security recipients. However, beneath the surface, hidden dangers and drawbacks may make Medicare Advantage plans a bad choice for those relying on Social Security benefits. As a retired healthcare executive, if you are considering enrolling for the first time or switching from traditional Medicare, don't do it. It is a shell game that gives providers some reimbursement certainty and cost control for CMS. But, as the healthcare consumer, you still pay the deductibles and co-pays just like traditional Medicare Part A and B. While it sounds great that you get all these additional services on Medicare Advantage, are you financially prepared to spend thousands of dollars out of pocket for what Medicare Advantage does not pay? Did they tell you you can't have a Medigap plan under Medicare Advantage to cover your deductibles and co-pays? Well, you can't. There are some severe disadvantages for Medicare eligibles to enroll in Medicare Advantage. Medicare Advantage is an HMO. Providers and insurance companies are paid a per member per month fee, also known as capitation. From the monthly payment as well as your out-of-pocket expenses like deductibles and co-pays, they provide the care you "need." Limiting care is the only way for them to make money off of you. Besides that 800-pound elephant in the room, what follows are the eight primary reasons why you should run as far away as possible from enrolling in a Medicare Advantage plan.

1. Limited Network of Providers One of the most significant drawbacks of Medicare Advantage plans is the restricted network of healthcare providers. These plans often have a narrower network of doctors, specialists, and hospitals than traditional Medicare. Social Security recipients may have complex medical needs and may find that their preferred healthcare providers are not part of the plan's network. This limitation can be frustrating, as it may force beneficiaries to switch doctors or travel long distances to receive the care they need.
2. Lack of Out-of-Network Coverage Traditional Medicare allows beneficiaries to see any Medicare-approved provider anywhere in the country. On the other hand, Medicare Advantage plans typically do not cover out-of-network care except in emergencies. For Social Security recipients who may want to see specialists or receive treatment from a particular healthcare facility, the lack of out-of-network coverage can be a significant disadvantage.
3. Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements Medicare Advantage plans often require beneficiaries to obtain prior authorization for certain medical procedures, tests, or treatments. They may also require referrals to see specialists. These administrative hurdles can lead to delays in receiving necessary care and add complexity to an already complicated healthcare system. Social Security recipients, who may be dealing with health issues that require timely attention, might find these requirements burdensome.
4. Changes in Plan Offerings Medicare Advantage plans can change their benefits, formularies, and network providers from year to year. While all insurance plans can change, this uncertainty can be especially challenging for Social Security recipients who rely on stable and predictable healthcare coverage. Beneficiaries may find that the plan they selected one year no longer meets their needs in the next, leading to potential disruptions in their care.
5. Potential for Higher Out-of-Pocket Costs While Medicare Advantage plans often advertise low or zero monthly premiums, they may have higher out-of-pocket costs in the form of copayments, coinsurance, and deductibles. Social Security recipients living on fixed incomes may find it challenging to budget for these unexpected costs. Moreover, traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap (Medicare Supplement) policy, can offer more predictability in healthcare expenses.
6. Limited Coverage Outside the United States Medicare Advantage plans usually provide limited or no coverage for medical services received outside the United States. For Social Security recipients who may want to travel or spend time abroad during retirement, this can be a significant drawback. Traditional Medicare offers coverage for emergency care while traveling internationally, which can provide peace of mind to beneficiaries who enjoy exploring the world.
7. One-Size-Fits-All Approach Medicare Advantage plans often adopt a one-size-fits-all approach, offering all

enrollees a standardized set of benefits. This can be problematic for Social Security recipients with unique medical needs or preferences. Traditional Medicare and a Medigap policy allow beneficiaries to customize their coverage to better suit their health circumstances. 8. Potential for Disenrollment Penalties If a Social Security recipient decides to switch from a Medicare Advantage plan to traditional Medicare and add a Medigap policy, they may face financial penalties. Under certain circumstances, beneficiaries can be subject to medical underwriting when applying for a Medigap policy, potentially resulting in higher premiums or even denial of coverage. This can be a significant deterrent for those who initially choose a Medicare Advantage plan without fully understanding the long-term consequences. Think twice and carefully. Medicare Advantage plans may be a good choice for some Medicare beneficiaries. Still, for Social Security recipients they come with a set of hidden dangers and drawbacks that deserve careful consideration. The limited network of providers, lack of out-of-network coverage, prior authorization and referral requirements, changes in plan offerings, potential for higher out-of-pocket costs, and other disadvantages may not align with the healthcare needs and preferences of this particular group. Before making a decision, Social Security recipients should thoroughly research and compare their options, considering their unique health circumstances, financial situation, and long-term goals. Traditional Medicare, coupled with a Medigap policy, offers more flexibility and predictability, ensuring that beneficiaries can access the care they need when and where they need it. I am a retired healthcare executive, and it will be a cold day in hell before I ever switch from traditional Medicare to a Medicare Advantage plan. <https://www.msn.com/en-us/money/retirement/the-hidden-dangers-of-medicare-advantage-plans-for-social-security-recipients/ar-AA1jl4ko?ocid=msedgdhp&pc=U531&cvid=bc348797770942dabb40e02380e1d59a&ei=28>;
— r/medicare · 48 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/17n5yr3/>

"Hi Dr Ed! My mom is 82 and had dropped her Medicare Supplement in Illinois because her partner wanted Medicare Advantage plans with an OTC benefit! Moving in with me created an SEP so we called Chapter her first day here! Mom just passed medical underwriting and has a Plan F effective June 1st! You rock and I so appreciate the education provided in your videos ! Thank you thank you thank you! Cheers, Michael Albuquerque NM USA"

— YouTube · The \$600/Month Medicare Mistake Most 65-Year-Olds Make · 39 likes · family member helping · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HsfNTRmt3Pw&lc=Ugz1hp93qJO8o52NhrR4AaABAg>

"NPR: Older Americans say they feel trapped in Medicare Advantage plans JANUARY 7, 2024 8:10 AM ET HEARD ON WEEKEND EDITION SUNDAY By Sarah Jane Tribble - Kaiser Health News 3-Minute Listen (Story first aired on All Things Considered on January 3, 2023.) UNIDENTIFIED NARRATOR: Right now is the Medicare annual enrollment period. 2024 Medicare Advantage plans are now available, so everyone on Medicare can call to see if a Medicare Advantage plan may be better for you. RASCOE: The plans are private insurance that Americans 65 and older can sign up for instead of traditional Medicare. And lots of Americans are signing up in this open enrollment period through March. Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News reports that some regret signing up and then have trouble getting out. SARAH JANE TRIBBLE: Back in 2016, when Richard Timmins first signed up for Medicare, he went to a free informational seminar with an insurance agent. RICHARD TIMMINS: Basically, he really promoted Medicare Advantage. He just said, well, look, it's less expensive. It's broader in coverage. TRIBBLE: For Timmins, it made economic sense to sign up for Medicare Advantage instead of traditional Medicare, and that worked out great - for a while. Then, he found a small bump on the back of his right ear. TIMMINS: I have a family history of melanoma, so I was kind of tuned into that and thinking about that. TRIBBLE: But it took him a long time to see the right specialist in his Medicare Advantage network, and getting the paperwork in order was confusing. TIMMINS: It was starting to - it started to grow and started to become rather painful. TRIBBLE: By the time Timmins finally saw an oncologist, the lesion had grown to the size of a dime. His right earlobe needed to be removed. He thinks getting care using traditional Medicare would have been faster and easier, and David Meyers at Brown University School of Public Health says he's probably right. DAVID MEYERS: You can see any provider you want. There are many less sort of restrictions on care. You get a lot more freedom with traditional Medicare. TRIBBLE: Timmins wishes he could switch, but there's a catch. TIMMINS: Would I go back to traditional Medicare if it was not cost prohibitive? Absolutely. TRIBBLE: Traditional Medicare premiums average about \$170 a month. And while enrollees on Medicare Advantage plans still pay that premium, the monthly cost can be more affordable. That's because plan enrollees often don't have to pay for extra prescription coverage. They also don't have to buy supplemental insurance, usually called Medigap. That supplemental insurance is needed because, unlike Medicare Advantage plans, traditional Medicare doesn't cap out-of-pocket cost. The thing is, Timmins might not be able to get a Medigap policy anymore. Here's David Lipschutz, associate director of the Center for Medicare Advocacy. DAVID LIPSCHUTZ: Medigap is one of the few types of insurance that can exclude you based upon preexisting conditions unless you enroll during certain designated times. TRIBBLE: That designated time is primarily when you first sign up for Medicare. But since Timmins enrolled in a Medicare Advantage plan instead of traditional Medicare and he has a preexisting condition, he could be denied Medigap or charged a lot more for it. While federal law generally prohibits insurers from denying people coverage because of preexisting conditions, Medigap is an exception. Lipschutz again. LIPSCHUTZ: It's a lot easier to get and stay in a Medicare Advantage plan, but a lot harder to get out and pick up a Medigap plan, depending upon where you are. TRIBBLE: Only four states require Medigap insurers to cover applicants regardless of age or health. But Timmins lives in Washington state, which isn't one of them. He wants people to know. TIMMINS: You can get screwed if you're on Medicare Advantage. The advantage kind of disappears once you need them. TRIBBLE: In the meantime, Timmins worries. There's a chance that his cancer could come back, and he'll be trapped on Medicare Advantage if it does. So he's focusing on what he can control. TIMMINS: You know, I'm a vegetarian. I don't drink. I don't smoke. I try to get exercise as much as possible. TRIBBLE: But he knows it might not be enough. RASCOE: That was Sarah Jane Tribble with our partner KFF Health News. Copyright © 2024 NPR. All rights reserved. Visit our website terms of use and permissions pages at www.npr.org for further information."

— r/medicare · 35 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/192eueh/>

"I have had OM with Plan F for 9 years. At 65 I was very healthy with just hypertension and high cholesterol. Today at 73.5 I use between \$50,000 and \$75,000 of medical services every year mostly due to immune system issues. I am eternally grateful I chose a supplement plan with Medicare rather than an MA plan. I almost qualified time wise for employer paid health insurance at 65, but guess what? About 5 years ago they converted all retirees to an MA plan. I would have been stuck in an MA plan while dealing with the ever increasing costs of my medical care as I age. I would never pass medical underwriting today. I can manage the premiums of Plan F going forward but I will not have to deal with insurance companies dictating my care."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgyIYjtXy7l6rid092t4AaABAg>

"I was a very healthy 76 year old until I was diagnosed with stomach cancer. Thankfully I am on traditional Medicare and a Medigap plan N. If I was on Medicare Advantage I would have several thousand dollars out of pocket every year and would not be able to switch to a Medigap plan because I would not pass Medical Underwriting to switch to a Medigap Plan."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=Ugy_7hvcAC7i4wDbjQJ4AaABAg

"I LOVE books so much! I picked an advantage plan because I'm not rich and I couldn't afford a supplement plan. I'm happy with my choice. The plan I chose, Network Health, gets good reviews. I'm in Wisconsin. My cousin tried to convince me to get a supplement plan but when I looked at the price, I opted to keep my money. I hate going to doctors so I haven't had any problems."

— YouTube · The Medicare Advantage Plans Being Eliminated in 2027 — 1,100,000+ Seniors Impacted · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qpTv-u6Polc&lc=UgwccFI0ErZH2JwKEt4AaABAg>

"I cant afford a supplement plan."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 15 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxNGiKqY0j5kl2nE0B4AaABAg

"My wife and I chose a Medigap Plan N plan four years ago. Literally 2 months after beginning my Medicare journey I had a really bad accident that required the trauma unit, two surgeries and a blood clot issue. My total bill for all that and two weeks in hospital was \$86 after meeting the Part B deductible. I could have argued \$50 off that amount because they charged me that amount for the ambulance even though I was admitted. It wasn't worth going through the hassle. My wife is a cancer survivor so our broker strongly advised her to stay away from an Advantage plan. If you do go that route and then have medical issues and expenses get out of hand then you will have to go through medical underwriting and probably will not be able to switch to Medigap. Keep that in mind."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=Ugz25KzjRIqEu63hwhv4AaABAg.ATSYgYfhd1hATYml_KtCEw

"Just went through this process about a year ago. I decided on a supplement plan (plan G) for as long as I could afford it. It is fairly 'easy' to switch to an advantage plan at a later time. Moving from an advantage plan to a supplement plan MAY require medical underwriting and may not be possible. I prefer the freedom of choice the supplement plans offer."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 13 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgzGOqWQSwRxqmXlzZd4AaABAq>

"Both customer and medical experience with United Healthcare. I am a customer of United Healthcare as well as a Medical Biller and they are the worst scam company out there. I work for a Doctors office and have been a Medical Biller for over 20 years. I have been trying to get the Doctor to drop them, but he is a good, caring Dr and doesn't want it all about the money, because he is not getting paid from United Healthcare as he should. He states that would cause many patients to not get the Medical care they need as he is a Specialist, he doesn't want to do that to them. I wish everyone would get together and get a class action lawsuit against them. Since money is all they care about, hit them where it hurts. I have AARP supplement and it's the only good thing about United except every year it goes up, I am now paying \$250.00 a month for an insurance that only pays 20% after Medicare. I can't switch because the other supplements won't take me due to my heart issues. But all of the other United Healthcare plans that are primary plans as well as the Medicare Advantage Plans are HORRIBLE. I have been dealing with them for all of my 20 years experience, since 2022 at the office I currently work for. Just spent the entire day so far trying to get payment for services rendered to patients."

— TrustPilot · UnitedHealthcare · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a7ca94fdb6fa88ddd249877>

Premium increases

"I started on Medicare with a supplement plan G in 2018. I switched insurers three times due to never ending and very high-rate increases. Each time I switched I had to do medical underwriting. In 2024 my AARP United G plan went way up, and I switched to plan N and saved myself \$99 alone in monthly premiums. If I had to go back, I would have just opted for plan N from the start."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 119 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=UgxHdldWf7qxfUU5hD94AaABAq

"I just received the 2027 'MEDICARE & YOU' booklet in the mail. And of course I already know that I am not touching my AARP GAP plan, so I go straight to the back of the book to see the PART D plans for NJ. And DARN if the BCBSNJ monthly premium didn't go and DOUBLE in price for the 2nd year in a row!!! Last year it went from \$22 to \$78. and for 2027 it goes to \$130. HOW???? So unfair. Are there cheaper plans, yes. Wellcare has a monthly plan as low as \$5.30. but wellcare only covered 2 of my 7 mRX's last year. BCBS was the only one that covered all 7."

— YouTube · Why Medicare Will Cost DOUBLE for Over 3 Million People 🤔 · 74 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sCdAfk-zQFU&lc=Ugyq-43B-8M-fR9msVh4AaABAq>

"I work with Medicare plans, C, D and medigap. Advantage plans are very similar to employer coverage, but the population is much more vulnerable. Medigap plan premiums increase every year, some people pay \$800 a month for them. Plus you pay \$200 a month just to have part B. Also Medicare penalizes you if you go without drug coverage, which some people do if they don't take prescriptions. None of these plans in general are the problem, greed is. The government needs to regulate what these companies do if they have a contract with CMS. It doesn't matter what the options are if both the government and private sector use it to squeeze every last penny out of people. The government needs to do its job and serve the people. I look forward to the day I have to go back to being a CNA because healthcare is treated as a right, not a privilege. Until then, I will continue to try my best helping people navigate through a broken system."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 68 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yfLVCc&lc=Ugxmqe1MtXC6NQ_2EUN4AaABAg

"Medigap getting too expensive When I was eligible for Medicare in 2019, I picked a plan G policy because at the time I was getting at least 4 MRI's a year, seeing my oncologist 4 times a year, and doing physical/occupational therapy. My premium was around \$180/month with a projected rate increase of about 6% a year. It was manageable until my premium shot up to \$327/month in 2024. Last year it jumped up to \$459/month. The cost increase I'm facing in August is terrifying. I'm not entirely sure what to do at this point. I just know I can't keep this up, I'm sure the next increase will take more than half my SSDI."

— r/medicare · 60 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tbdbvh/>

"The more my Plan N increases annually, the more I'm inclined (against my better judgement) to start looking at a Part C Advantage Plan instead. I went with Plan N because I believed in the idea of "Pay me now or pay me later", where I protected myself against high deductibles and annual outlays by paying a (reasonable) monthly premium. Sadly, "Pay me now" is becoming "Pay me a LOT more now, and every year until you die." Also, we need better oversight of these insurers. Offering low costs for a year and then inflating prices once you have attracted a bunch of subscribers should be illegal. Or at least a Medicare plan cost should be guaranteed for a reasonable amount of time. I would be much happier paying more when I sign up, knowing that my premium won't increase to shocking levels for years."

— YouTube · Your Medicare Supplement Premium Just Went Up... Here's What to Do. · 57 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CDMzMoErP-w&lc=UgxVyp4MBD-dEhPeZlh4AaABAg>

"I understand your point about averages. I chose HD-G when I turned 65 and started on original Medicare. Out of pocket expenses have been manageable and in line with my expectations. I'm 70 now. My biggest challenge is the annual premium increases. You showed 2-4% as an average for HD-G. My premium increases the past 3 years were 14%, 20%, and 21%. Combined, the increase was 59% higher than the premium from 3 years ago. I can still pass underwriting and switched companies, which helped some. My overall worry is these type of increases aren't "sustainable" over 15-20 years..."

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan N? · 54 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Csmi1YgxGrY&lc=UgzxVpDFzqjIW527Aop4AaABAg>

"I started Medicare in 2018 at age 65. Every single year I have had rate increases that far exceeded 5-8%. I left United plan G in 2024 as their rate increase jumped drastically and sent my premium well above \$200 a month. I switched to plan N through, you guessed it, Ace. The rate started at \$113 a month and in 2025 increased to \$126 and for 2026 just went up this month to \$154. These high percentage rate increases are wearing thin. Texas resident."

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 52 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=UgyL5MEueBzKhmgghgJ94AaABAg>

"Anyone else not having fun anymore? I work at/partially own a smaller independent agency here in the Midwest with my dad and brother. I've been doing this for 14 years now and boy, the past 12 months has sucked. We only have 4 agents but I think the last time I checked our total written premium we were at \$9m so we're doing alright. We're pretty evenly split between personal and commercial and are really lucky to have a big selection of companies. * Travelers, Progressive, Nat Gen, Safeco, Hartford AARP, Auto Owners, Cincinnati, Philly, Nationwide, Openly, Stillwater, and probably a dozen specialty and mutual companies. I'm sure I'm forgetting a couple. I'm fully aware we got it better than most. Even still, this isn't really fun anymore. Especially on the personal side of things. I know we're not FL or TX but my god is it getting tough to shop people around. That's kinda our whole thing. We've always prided ourselves on being honest, upfront, actually answering the phones when folks call in, and trying to do what's best for the customer even if that means less commission. Us agents do all our own quoting and 90% of the servicing. I know we do it differently than most agencies. By doing that we've done pretty well for ourselves and really don't need to advertise or worry about finding leads. We run solely off referrals and call ins and are too busy to keep up. That's the good thing about right now. 10 years ago, we were desperate for business and would have to take anyone who walked in the door. Nowadays, I bet we have to turn away 30% of new customers for misc reasons. Oh your roof is 11 years old, tough. Your house is \$212k and 100 years old, sorry. A single water claim in the last 5 years, nope. You bought both of your daughters Kias?? I can't tell you how many call ins I've sent to Farm Bureau. 2-3 a week at least. We just had a big regional meeting with our parent company last week and boy it was grim. It was the most depressing company round up I've ever been to. Record losses, more companies tightening guidelines, don't expect profit payouts again anytime soon. I was sitting with some of our peer agency (comparable # of employees and companies) and man, they sure seemed like they were struggling. A couple of them said they were closing 3-4 customers a week and he seemed proud of it. Like for the whole agency. I didn't tell him that I myself did 6 that week. I'm not complaining about the money. I made \$25k more this past year than the year before it. I'll probably match that again this year given what renewals are rolling in at. I'm just getting real tired of quoting a perfectly normal 2,700 sqft 2 story with a perfectly fine 12 year old roof and not being able to do anything. I quote 9 different companies and only one offers me a price and it's \$1200 more than what they paid last year. There's a good chance I'll get that sale but the customer already doesn't like me. I'm tired of having to justify the 79% rate increase I saw this morning on a Nationwide home (no claim). I'm tired of every single elderly person telling me "I'm on a fixed income" whenever their policy goes up \$27. I'm tired of roofing companies rolling our customer's wind/hail deductible into the amount they're billing the insurance company to win over their business. And then I'm tired when that same customer bitches to me next Summer when their home goes up \$1800 on renewal. I'm tired of not being able to talk to an underwriter anymore without first going through India and having them pretend to know what's going on only to transfer me to a misc underwriter 10 minutes later. I'm not saying this job was all sunshine and daisy's but it's crazy how much less stressful it was just 2-3 years ago. My dad's been an agent for 40 years (25 with Farmers) and he said this is the worst market he's ever seen. He predominantly does commercial and habitational and that's become a nightmare as well. He's had to turn away \$250k premium accounts recently because there's literally not a single other market for it. Please tell me we're not alone. Please tell me this is temporary and it won't suck to come into work in 2 years. We've never ever listened to a single buyout offer but man, I get why some folks do it these days."

— r/InsuranceAgent · 51 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/InsuranceAgent/comments/1cswcw9/anyone_else_not_having_fun_anymore/

"Can't afford Medicare premium This. Went on Medicare when I turned 65. Everything was fine and then Medicare reassessed salary based on some taxable pension that I took out of my retirement account. I used all that money for my house and , my premium went up by a few hundred dollars between Medicare premium and my part C it's about \$800 a month that I cannot afford as a single person on a teachers salary. I appealed appeal was denied so I'm going back on my employers insurance as soon as I can! what a mess I wish somebody at my work had told me about IRMAA when I applied for Medicare. I wonder if anybody else has been in the situation?"

— r/medicare · 51 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1tm895k/>

"Im going to go traditional medicare with a supplement BUT as soon as the rate increase is beyond what I can afford to live, I am dropping the supplements. This will probably happen one year after I turn 65. They have us over a barrel and there are NO GOOD options if you are a few dollars over the poverty line. I just wont go to a doctor. I will do as my son did. He failed to get help with his heart issues because he couldn't afford insurance. He went into cardiac arrest at home and died. He was 29. No one cares about any of us living. Its ALL about money and anyone who thinks differently is in denial."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 51 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzEXojHIE666CH1xrJ4AaABAg>

"I went on to the retirement court with Plan G. No major complaints with the exception of the recent premium increase and the truly impossible task of finding my cost share prior to treatment. My bigger complaint with this whole racket is the development (or lack there of) a system structured for intentional confusion. One should not need PhDs in multiple disciplines to understand their health insurance. No luv in this game."

— YouTube · The REAL Cost of Medicare Supplement vs Advantage over 20 Years? I G vs N vs HD G vs Advan · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Yf_LRloXmSo&lc=UgyV6bKd_Qtj9cUgC4x4AaABAg

"I am a 78 yr old male. The Illinois Department of Insurance approved a 40% rate increase for Mutual of Omaha in 2025. My supplement plan G is costing me \$357.63 per month and will continue to go up every year. This is why people switch to medicare advantage plans even if they are not as good."

— YouTube · After 15 Years in Medicare, Here's the Plan I'd Pick Now · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dca1_SFCZkg&lc=Ugzuyd4qcwbDPIJZq6V4AaABAg

"Absolute spam. Absolute spam. I wanted to compare prices online after my rates went up. What I got was was non stop phone calls and texts from Everquote. At no point did I want to talk to any of these people much less get harassed by spoofed numbers. There is nothing I have good to say about these spammers. I am just bracing myself for all the calls I will get from whoever they sold my information to."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6530065e56de2f6b6dd6e449>

"Caution. I've had a few quotes through SelectQuote over the years. What I've come to realize is that the first quote they give you is highly optimistic. They often promise no-health-exam options. But despite being pretty high up on the health ladder, that has never proven true. Inevitably, they will find something that raises the rates. In my case, the rate doubled over a pretty minor change. SelectQuote is easier than calling each of The insurers individually, but take their quotes and promises with a grain of salt. Be prepared for your rate to increase during the process..."

— TrustPilot · SelectQuote · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/673f88d32eed2b72c99cee0f>

Doctors and hospitals that drop the plan

"You are definitely speaking the truth. I used to have Humana advantage program all of my doctors and all of my hospitals where I lived sent me letters telling they no longer accepted it. That was actually a blessing in disguise because I went ahead and went with original Medicare and then I got AARP United Healthcare is my supplement to my medicare. Everything is been covered 100% I haven't had to pay anything except the course the deductible at the beginning of the year which continually goes up higher and higher. My social security check what little bit you do get doesn't even cover how much it goes up. The price of the United Healthcare continues to go higher every year also. So yeah America is really screwing people big time but what do you expect for 40 trillion dollars in debt and nobody even gives a crap anymore"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 210 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgycBY5V27_Utvq5bkd4AaABAg

"Another negative for Advantage plans is that hospitals in my area are refusing to accept certain Advantage plans. So if you have a doctor you like and he works out of a certain hospital you could find yourself looking for another doctor and hospital. I was on an Advantage plan but was able to get on Plan G because the hospital I use stopped accepting the Advantage plan I was on. I didn't have to get approved or pass any medical tests to go on Plan G since it wasn't my fault that my Advantage plan was no longer valid. Best thing that could have happened to me."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=Ugx4MOWZuO_w_2-SLoV4AaABAg

"The only hospital within 100 miles of me has stopped accepting Humana advantage plans as in-network due to claim denials and long waits for pre-approvals. Switching to plan N while I can pass underwriting."

— YouTube · The REAL Difference Between Medicare Plan G, Plan N, and Advantage · 31 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SDD903qXaHg&lc=UgxNqF0wOHim1a8HT3J4AaABAg>

"My brother chose Medicare Advantage when it was relatively new. Years later, he needed a very specialized surgery that no hospital in his network could do. After months of fighting with insurance, they finally agreed to cover it at KU Med Center. On the 4 hr drive on the morning of his surgery, he received a call from the hospital saying that they had just dropped his Medicare Advantage company and couldn't do his surgery. He never found another way to get that surgery and he died. If this scenario happens often, Medicare Advantage saves a lot of money by not having to pay for life saving surgeries."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgyQFMPprBbPsPUB1Q14AaABAg>

"I was warned by everyone not to take Medicare Advantage-so glad I listened. It's next to impossible to switch back-I would encourage anyone just about to enter-don't do it. The premiums are very attractive to rope you in but like they say-lots of exceptions, some doctors won't accept the plan etc"

— YouTube · I Tried to Switch from Medicare Advantage to Medicare Supplement — Here's What Happened · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uscl75VAZWc&lc=Ugxxi6snmCvpHtHoLXp4AaABAg>

"I wanted expert advice before I went on Medicare. So I hired a consultant. She call Medicare Advantage Medicare Disadvantage and told me to stay away from it. Why? Because it isn't real Medicare. It's private insurance that can end up making you go bankrupt. So I went with traditional Medicare with Part G supplement. I've never spent a dime out of pocket. Im glad I rejected Advantage. Rye largest hospital in my area announce last year that they were dropping out of Advantage. So have more than half of the areas physicians. This has left a lot of people without good healthcare choices. And I don't live in podunk. I live in a major metropolitan area with a population of over 6 million."

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=Ugy-HagNdaMnA1ecAZ14AaABAg>

"Sunburn. Great job on this video. I love your chart, as well. I am 71, and have had \$0.00 Premium Advantage Plans so far. I had to change to a different company a couple years ago because my Primary Doctor dropped my plan, because he was tired of arguing with them on proper care for his patients. Both of my Advantage Plan companies have worked out well for me so far. However, I am now leaning towards switching to a Supplement Plan after I saw how wonderful they worked for both of my parents, who each had a lot of issues through their lives, and they never had to pay for anything, other than their monthly premiums. As I get older, I think it might give me a bit more peace of mind to have a Supplement that has more complete coverage and I will have more control over which doctors I see. Your video was very helpful as I do my research to make my decision for 2026. Thanks again!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 6 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgzJ0S3dtITngj28Ghl4AaABAg>

"Can't disagree with the wonderful presentation in a difficult climate to find relevance in the system. According to insight of original Medicare, the coverage to doctors has dropped 25% since 2002. Can a doctor be found in view of this deficit? Very appreciative for bringing the worsening of hmo system to light. I'd only add that the break on prices for free OTC medicines and gives an opportunity for seniors (while ignoring the practicing medical treatment as implied) to walk out of a store with free stuff is a recipe for, and has led to inflated prices people under 65 are being charged. So we expect these youths to suffer weeks on end because Sudafed or the like has gone up 400%. A pet peeve, doubt, and/or concern."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage: Last Week Tonight with John Oliver (HBO) · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ejoi9yflVCC&lc=UgyPolrJbduu2sx09W94AaABAg.AOu_egArbCnAOxdw6d36G2

"A Medicare Advantage plan + Cancer policy might be the *least expensive* total cost, but I am seeing in other videos that many hospitals are no longer accepting Advantage plans coverage due to their burdensome pre-authorization processes and higher incidences of fraud. So that might not be the *best* option. An Original Medicare plan is accepted everywhere, and bundled with a good Supplement plan, appears to be a close second in terms of cheapest overall cost."

— YouTube · The Battle of Cancer Coverage: Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YCI8m0OI18&lc=UgyCX_t3mhh0eD7T-7V4AaABAg

"I am 70 years old I had a group plan through my union, then they decided it was coasting too much so they changed it to a group plan Medicare advantage plan within one year the plan dropped all my doctors who were treating my prostate cancer. It took 8 months for me to get the union to change my plan back to Medicare traditional with a medigap plan. The reason why my doctors were dropped was because they were owned by united healthcare and didn't want another medical insurance company competing against them, even though i had a out of network benefit."

— YouTube · Who REALLY Chooses Medicare Advantage vs Medigap (And Who Regrets It) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=suy-7L-LYaM&lc=UgyB2GsySEVNY_hJvt54AaABAg

"if you have a generic pre existing condition, if you go with advantage you might not to get to see you specialist you might need. Also Mayo clinics no longer accept advantage plans. I have and will skesys gave original medicare. If you are healthy and garentee you will never have any mefucal conditions then advantage might work. But if you have cancer or other catastrophic events you best have Original Mefucare and a supplemental insurance"

— YouTube · Is Medicare Supplement Plan G Worth It in 2026? (Full Breakdown) · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wBOASILFxIg&lc=UgyNVVw8bhXx45TEgRB4AaABAg>

"Do not, I repeat NOT use United Health Care on the Advantage plan. UHC is a sunburn of a nightmare - a mess and my hospital dropped them. I signed up with the Advantage plan at the hospital. All went smooth until they sent a letter that said Advantage is going away in Oregon? :("

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugys1pC3NFzodwwwYlh4AaABAg_AKdMkH291hCANZVXQWelul

"Simply Awful. Since enrolling this past year, I have had 2 primary care doctors dropped from the plan. The first time I was forced to switch was early June and the second time was today. Twice in a little over 2 months!! The sole reason for switching to United Health was that my previous plan was discontinued and I wanted to keep my doctor. The customer support is abysmal. The entire experience is bad."

— TrustPilot · UnitedHealthcare · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a7e5deb516c46b17065eb68>

"DO NOT USE OSCAR. DO NOT USE OSCAR. I had a numberof issues with OSCAR: mainly the list of providers on the website is FALSE (do not exist at that location or do not accept OSCAR; which is FRAUD). I was told by cust service messaging that I am the one who needs to verify the accuracy of what is posted..!!!!.The last time I tried to enroll, my regular doctor had stopped accepting OSCAR because: 'they are so difficult to deal with and get paid'. Looking for nother provider in my area (I live in a dense urban center, 3 subway stops fro the World Trade Center, with 3 large medical centers at walking or one stop distance and many doctor's office).

OSCAR could not find a MD as primary care provider for me in my area accepting them: only a PA or a Nurse.....!!!! I switched as soon as enrollement period aloowed and kept my currant MD."

— TrustPilot · Oscar Health · 1 ★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a8d2ac24614691023f80a0c>

Calls, mail and ads that won't stop

"Sunburn. Thank you. During my working years I had a Co pay for my HMO high deductible insurance. When I retired I learned about plan G and found it less than what I paying at work. Since my retirement my wife had open heart surgery and knee replace to and a broken arm. I have prostate cancer and ulcerative colitis. If I would have had an advantage plan it would have financial devastated us. When I bought plan G I bought it not for how I felt at the time, but for when I was sick. Advantage plans come in my mail every day trying to switch me over. Never get mail for plan G. That should tell you something in itself."

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · 249 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=UgyPSeGJnpazbrQ0VB94AaABAg>

"I won't ever enroll in a Medicare Advantage plan just for those annoying commercials they bombard us with every year"

— YouTube · Why Medicare Advantage Plans are Bad (or Are They?) · 27 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SM3ypOamgls&lc=UgwdnumgTKxINntbPp14AaABAg>

"When i watch these kind of videos and the first piece of advice is the do not call registry I'm immediately done. These offshore call centers dont give a damn about dnc. Im not even old enough to qualify for medicare and i get more than a hundred calls a day every day."

— YouTube · How to STOP "Medicare" Phone Calls, Texts, Emails, and Letters · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQh6ldSh6uc&lc=UgxXRlr7F4TKXAwqurB4AaABAg>

"@nancybryant4325 Thank you again for your response. I had been told by someone I trusted that I should be on Medicare. I do not have lots of expenses now but I can see that investing before I need it, which most of us definitely will, will give me more security if something major were to happen. I also find most of the so-called benefits of the advantage plan actually not that valuable when I try to use them. And no I don't use referrals because often when I have asked for a specific referral I have either been denied or the payment to the caregiver is denied even though a legitimate referral and I paid a copay. Here I am talking about physical therapy which now I pay out-of-pocket and don't even bother trying to get the referral. I negotiate for a cash price. Many won't take my plan anymore anyhow because of the endless denials, etc. Someone is paying for all those slick commercials bombarding us."

— YouTube · Top Disadvantages of Medicare Advantage Plans · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BebQ04cKzJc&lc=UgzMVDXyviom5xLUtIF4AaABAg.9TDdw-WtTCC9Tta6FO3qEN>

"I've often received the Medicare scam call. Once I wade through the robocall preliminary and get to a real person, they always ask, "You currently have Medicare parts A and B, correct?" That is when I try to sound confused and respond, "Well, I seem to have Medicare Parts F and U. Do you understand?" This is always followed by either a hang up or lots of cussing. The longer I keep them on the line before I give them the "F&U" response, the more likely it is that they'll cuss. It's very entertaining."

— YouTube · Medicare Scam Call AGAIN! This is how I handle them. · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hlDJ4XfKHJE&lc=UgxFLU10541Ulfmadnd4AaABAg>

"I am soon to be 65. I have not signed up. I may not. Too confusing. Somehow my husband phone number was spread far and wide and he gets 30+ phone calls almost every day. They know his name and address. This is the only way all of that was in one package was through his health care one way or another. If I do sign up there will be no phone number!"

— YouTube · The Medicare Mistake You Can't Undo (Legal in 46 States) · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ixq9ld0w9OA&lc=UgzRNZ0EF4QHfWoinJ4AaABAq>

"i cant count the number of medicare spam calls i get everyday i get so many im sick of my phone constantly ringing. i dont answer the phone to numbers i dont recognize anymore. i dont have an answering machine either. i signed up with the national do not call registry but it doesnt seem to be working."

— YouTube · IT'S A SCAM! A DAY IN THE LIFE! How Many Medicare Scam Calls Can I Get In One Day... HA! · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=32GR2F0y4IY&lc=Ugzs6_W5Zi17RfBOflJ4AaABAq

"Good one! I've been getting alot of these calls from Medicare scammers. Most are robocalls and they hang up either just after I say hello or after they ask whether I have Part A and Part B. Usually these days I don't get a live person."

— YouTube · Messing with Medicare Scammers to See How They Operate · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JPvSJab6kzM&lc=UgyCz4MCrtpAFQDsJ6h4AaABAq>

"Love love love this information! Even without knowing it previously, I always felt there was something fishy going on. They call me constantly wanting to "help" me set up a doctor's appointment for a wellness screening. I am a very blessed, active, healthy 68 yo female. Im not on any medication and get really mad that they won't leave me alone! Well, anyway, here's my question: When I was planning for a total knee replacement in 2019, I was on plain old Medicare A and B. I was advised by a friend to get on an Advantage plan to greatly reduce my out of pocket cost for the surgery. I made many calls to Medicare to confirm this information. The amount they told me I would be responsible for was thousands. Two different reps, two different calls at different times. I then spoke with the Advantage plan people and was assured that I would only be responsible for \$275 after meeting my deductible (\$250 I think?). So, I took the Advantage plan, which I still have, and yes indeed, that was all I had to pay. Lock, stock, and barrel. I believe what you're saying but, in my case, why was the Advantage plan a decided "advantage"?"

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage vs Medicare Supplement Plans · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xw7EiH-5iik&lc=UgwFXhp6HLxl9GRaZAB4AaABAq>

"★★★★★ . ★★★★★ I want to thank Kevin Barron at Boomer Benefits for his amazing help with my Medicare supplemental plan. It took almost two weeks of calls because I had so many questions, and Kevin never got tired or rushed me even once. He patiently explained everything about doctors, hospitals, and deductibles so I could really understand my options. Most people going on Medicare, like me, have no idea what to look for or which plan is right for them. Kevin took the time to walk me through it all and gave me space to think before deciding, instead of pushing me to rush. He truly cared about finding the best plan for my needs, not just making a sale. Thanks to Kevin, I finally feel confident and at ease about my Medicare choice. Boomer Benefits is lucky to have someone so knowledgeable and patient on their team. I highly recommend Kevin and Boomer Benefits to anyone who needs help navigating Medicare!"

— TrustPilot · Boomer Benefits · 5★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6aa9c022c41de81af19f1736>

"OK I am on the federal do not call list, our state does not have one. I get 20 to 30 scam calls every day. I am in the service industry so have to answer the calls. Every thing from Alpha lab telling me that medicare will pay for 8 covid tests (I dont have medicare) to my free medic alert system or will pay off all my credit card dept (dont have a credit card). Oh yes I have won a free paypal reward (dont use paypal) abusively no card. You are cute but the info is worthless, sorry I have reported the calls (with phone numbers) (spoofed ofcourse) to the FCC for the last 6 weeks this has not helped ether. Surely in this day and time the technology exists to keep this from happening and who would develop it or is it already here? The government has there hands tied, so we need to look to private enterprise, Phone company's maybe? If one of them did that would be a great selling point"

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=Ugz1xSpdaIWCIcejV1x4AaABAg>

"I'm too young for Medicare and I still get TONS of Medicare robo calls and I'm on the DO NOT CALL list (does Nothing!) 🙄 "

— YouTube · How To Stop Unwanted Medicare Calls · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K6XCXO5gTGw&lc=UgwwQ0wED1wO-kciqZF4AaABAg>

"paying for "exclusive" leads that are.... paying for "exclusive" leads that are already marked as dnc in our system, since they have been sold to my agency a few months prior. Calling "exclusive" leads that complain about bombardment, so how exclusive are they? This isn't one or two leads, this is a problem with most if not all of the leads purchased lately. A few years back, exclusive meant exclusive, but not anymore. Prices are up, productivity is down."

— TrustPilot · NextGen Leads · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d670590f0186907ac964abe>

"Non stop robo calls and AI texts. Non stop robo calls and AI texts. They keep changing numbers so even after blocking a number they keep slamming me with more robo calls and AI texts."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a6237062f8d7d604d15e6f7>

"They are spammers. These guys keep calling from various spoofed local exchange phone numbers about a free insurance quote that I never requested. If they were a legitimate business, why would they be robo calling 5-10 times a day from different, spoofed numbers?"

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69d6d1a79813e5fa834bc852>

"Harassing me endlessly. Annoying. . Calling nonstop for two days. Leave me alone."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6997403d94d8d4db41bbe3f5>

"ZERO STARS!!! HASTLE and MORE DIFFICULT Experience . I tried to inquire about auto insurance quotes while at work and of course they call me NONSTOP and ask all the same information I entered online. They harass you. I should've known better but what an abomination of a business. They make searching for auto insurance MORE difficult."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/66a00f045759534894a7576c>

"Everquote keeps calling me non-stop.... Everquote keeps calling me non-stop even after being taken off of their call list several times. I've blocked countless numbers, including the one that comes up as "Everquote", but it keeps coming through. I've never talked to them about insurance, and I have no idea who sold them my info."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6696bb0977f004b29ce87f2d>

"Don't waste your time. An AI lead generator.. I was specifically asked whether I wanted to search for car insurance online or thru an agent. I strictly said "online." Soon thereafter - I was robo-called 4 times and texted. I had to block 4 numbers. This isn't an insurance company, nothing more than a lead generation machine using AI. Pathetic."

— TrustPilot · EverQuote · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/654d5803ff760aa9e53bc6dc>

"They knowingly use off-shore scammers.... They knowingly use off-shore scammers for marketing lead generation. How can you trust a company who does this? I receive calls from scammers constantly who are in violation of DNC laws and caller ID spoofing laws who are attempting to "connect" me with someone who can get me a quote. Guess who it is - QuoteWizard. So they pay for inbound leads?"

— TrustPilot · QuoteWizard · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69b45f733099d5a23856d2c1>

Agents who pushed Advantage or misled

"My agent pushed an Advantage plan from the start, but I wanted to stick with original Medicare with a Supplemental policy. A couple of years ago, I relented and said okay, go ahead and put my wife and I on an Advantage plan since he said 95% of his clients were on the plan. It must be good, right? Having 43 years in the property & casualty insurance business before retiring, I actually read the 200+ pages of the contract. I immediately called my agent and told him to rescind the Advantage plan and get me back on what I had. I later learned that after 7 years he no longer gets a commission from Medicare but would have continued indefinitely to receive commissions from the Advantage plan. My 7 years was up last year, and guess what, I haven't heard from him since. I would recommend that everyone stay with original Medicare, unless there is some compelling reason not to do so."

— YouTube · MASSIVE: Hospitals Are DROPPING Medicare Advantage Plans 🤖 · 81 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vn2k1W-JzB8&lc=UgzHCpaN2Z99tywzREh4AaABAg>

"One of the better explanations of the difference. I noticed several agents here push Plan G very heavily. My wife and I see a doctor twice a year, so co-pays don't bother us. We would have to have three doctor appointments a month to make up the difference in plan prices. Good job."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan G vs Plan N (New Info!) · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SP2JABN8RL8&lc=UgwpXUF5t2zyH94bLlx4AaABAg>

"IMO - I feel that insurance Medicare agents/brokers who push this scam on clients should be investigated. It's my understanding that the agents are compensated for at a higher rate for enrolling seniors on the Advantage Plan. At the very least customers who enrolled in the Advantage option should be allowed to change back to the traditional one at no penalty to them."

— YouTube · HUGE Medicare Supplement Rate Increases (and what to do about them) · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ah1bzQtPBRQ&lc=UgzCjY71Bi2WAeUiyGt4AaABAg_A7yD_2SFDkoA8AiNVaa-oS

"@RickeyReynolds Yes----I called several companies before signing up and they all sounded like used car salesmen with high pressure, then I got sucked into Medicare School and spoke to a low key guy and he told me how great Ace was-----I think he pushed Ace because they were paying a higher bonus. After Ace closed their books I called to get information buy was told I would have to make an appointment about a week out to speak to someone-----I finally spoke to someone and they had no information and had to ask other people there. With a closed book of business, you would think the cost would be spread out to all the states-----go on line and find the map that shows which states are in Ace and the other half INA. I interpret that the closed book of business for Ace is in, WA, MT, ID, CA, UT, NM, NE, MN, MO, IL, IN, KY, PA VT, PA NJ, DE, MD ,VA,AL, FL, AK-----all the other states are listed as INA"

— YouTube · Top Medicare Supplement Companies Review - Winners and Losers! · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HYfsEbghGR8&lc=Ugzl1NfBfQeBIzOMdbB4AaABAg.AWhpZS1r1SkAWi_7MQnsfQ

"I've been on disability w/Medicare A&B since Jan 2001. Living in Texas, I have the unusually Texas unique situation I'm a partial dual eligible (QI-1). I've tried advantage plans briefly only to find it's not for me. Fortunately Medicare Part D and the fact I'm a QI-1 I can switch anytime (upto3 times a year). I've been on A, B and D until this past September when I turned 65 last Sept. Though I was born in 1957 and due to my having had PART B since Jan 2001, I was able to get a plan F. Using the SPEND DOWN of the monthly premium, I'm able to recover \$128 p/m of that premium via section 8 housing voucher. Others might recover some or all via SNAP. Realizing that Spend Down with other programs may make the higher premium plans more affordable than Plan N. Love your videos education is important. Wish I'd found you earlier. I had to use my past experience as a PART D and medication assistance program activist/advocate. When I was discussing with an agent he was pushing Plan G over Plan F. I educated him on what and how Spend Down regarding other assistance programs worked. I realize my situation is rather unique, but then again everyone's situation is unique."

— YouTube · Medicare Plan N vs Plan G! Choose WISELY! · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tYXvKvMPbpl&lc=Ugxj8rtCZvjduLzFv54AaABAg>

"Thank you Erin for so well explained these healthcare confusions! I wish this video would have came out a year ago. I'm 66 and I was confused by all these last year when I needed to enroll. My broker only pushed me to enroll in Medicare Advantage and it seems to be a better choice due to the lower cause. As you said, I'm lucky that I'm still healthy now but choosing Medigap may be a better choice down the road."

— YouTube · Choose Wrong at 65 and You May NOT Be Able to Undo It: Medicare Advantage vs Medigap · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KZJptHP78wg&lc=UgwZrnBS3BHQIMpP7-x4AaABAg>

"I have UHC plan N, my premium is going up to \$172 in next month and then \$180 in December. In 2 years it's gone from \$117 to \$172, I called my broker and applied with Cigna, hopefully I'll get approved. I get why Luigi whacked the CEO of UHC now....."

— YouTube · Can You Change Your Medicare Supplement Anytime? · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p2hlpMKoQZU&lc=Ugyxx0cmV7Ks-y0VAup4AaABAg.AEv-SCQghNfAIF-ms_g3jp

"He is very good at explaining but I am still confused. I have a supplement plan that an agent recommended when I had a special enrollment period due to job retirement and he just said I like "this company", they are great. Plan G, good rate etc, yet this supplement plan has been a nightmare, acting like an advantage plan. Refusing to cover, putting time limits on Dr ordered physical therapy etc. It says G on my card but someone told me this company was pushed on me because this company also owns a large advantage plan and the incentive to be harrasive is to make me say forget plan G I will just go to an advantage plan, and voila, here is my Plan G company right there to offer an advantage plan (their own). I feel very duped. I don't know if it was the agent pulling a fast one on me because he got some sort of commission from supp company to aggressively push me in their direction so when I get frustrated agent will push me to plan g company's advantage and he will get a kickback or something. My agent said this company a half a second after I said I wanted original Medicare and never offered me anything else. New and very green to the insurance monsters I didn't know any better even though I thought I understood it all. Now I can lateral move to a different plan g company but only with underwriting. I could probably pass underwriting. I just lost all trust in this agent and people tell me I can't change agents. Ugh! What, how and WHY?? It shouldn't be this complicated to stay on original Medicare because one agent didn't offer me an insurance company choice!!! Beware people, not all insurance reps are thinking of your best interests! (Not the man that posted this video, he is awesome and speaks clearly so you understand 😊). I truly thought original Medicare was the way to go given the nightmare stories advantage plan people post about. I wasn't in open enrollment period, so agent had lots of time to help me, it was in the middle of the year when Medicare mania wasn't in full swing."

— YouTube · Medicare Advantage Plans Leaving in 2026 - 2,600,000 Seniors Impacted · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8Pq6H7UZBbU&lc=UgwISnQQsx1IQjxDEhN4AaABAq_AMRqYild_gEAMS-liEeFa

"As agents push people to Plan N who would normally choose Plan G, the premiums for Plan N will become more like Plan G because the utilization between the two groups will become more similar. As that happens, the 'natural G plan' patients will pay higher premiums than expected at sign-up AND the differential Plan N costs. From the consumer side, a person who anticipates low utilization will want a plan that does not include high utilization participants since there is intra-group subsidy going on. The high deductible plan (HDG) has the highest barrier to entry. This can be seen in the plan's relatively low COL increases over time, which I expect to continue to be true. Who are natural HDG participants ? Not those in 'average' health at age 65. Only those in excellent health, and who specifically do not have lifestyle risk factors. This is a small group, but it is nice for them that a plan exists that matches their cost to the plan to the premium."

— YouTube · Why you MUST Consider Medicare Supplement Plan N (Plan N vs. Plan G) · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=S29PdLxpUi0&lc=Ugz_F-TigLCKBleeaL14AaABAq

"Thank you so much for your expert advice. I have Medicare agent from the Texas. I am 73 years old in Colorado first year 7/01/ 2024 with All State Health Solution medigap G \$1477.12 with 10% discount paid one time, second year \$1717.40 and 2026 7/01/2026 🙄. This year I tried switch with other insurance down grade to medigapN but denied. Not always guaranteed with agent I had difficult time to found agent willing to help me for medigap plan. The agent wanted push for advanced plan. I found out All State Health Solution is dead pool now. When deal pool mean next year my premium will go same rate? What do I have to do or switch to advanced plan? Please let me know what your advice will be 🙏 "

— YouTube · Can We Talk Openly About Medicare Supplement Plan G? · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YbzNHT67jnc&lc=UgwwwRYSVHDYWz7KWGN4AaABAq>

"Karen, I'm an independent insurance adviser. Any time I hear that someone has TRICARE For Life (TFL), I give them a high-five and say that they have the "Cadillac of Health Insurance." You are correct - you do NOT need additional Medicare supplement coverage. Also, some ignorant / less than-ethical agents might try to enroll you in a "Medicare Advantage" plan by pushing " free dental, vision, and hearing" benefits, or a "free gym membership." People with TFL should NOT get on "Advantage" plans. They will greatly complicate your coverage situation. Hope this helps."

— YouTube · Avoiding Costly Medicare Mistakes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M_lw87U6Moo&lc=UgxehnzAxp-hYI3e1Dd4AaABAq.904LpIzhFlq91eH0Sgk9c6

"Thank you for this. I found it informative & helpful. I've been on regular Medicare plus a Supplemental (not Advantage) for the past few years. My agent has never tried to push me onto Advantage (even though he would get paid a commission for that), nor has he pushed Medicare-only (even though my expense have been thankfully minimal). I may choose the "HD" plan for next year after seeing your video... but will consider all options carefully. Thanks for shedding some SUNBURN... I mean, sunlight--- on these issues!"

— YouTube · Original Medicare, Medicare Advantage or Medicare Supplement? Here's How to Know Which One · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nwFTgl2GD0&lc=Ugwz6sk-OCmNb4s28VR4AaABAq>

"If I could do 0 stars I would. If I could do 0 stars I would - Their support agents try to be helpful - but the reality is, their ads are misleading - more calls about a free 40000 or 25000, and prospects think the government or social security is going to give them that money for free. If more than one person thinks its free, dont you think you should change your ads?"

— TrustPilot · Allcalls.io · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69fdf2f85a3e11011e7843b1>

"This company is a scam! They just want a sale!. This company is all about sales. I made the 3-way call with my brother and overheard a supervisor come in on his line. His supervisor was berating him for being on the phone 37 minutes with us, not using a "opening statement" & not getting him (my brother) into a plan. When the agent came back on the phone, he pushed for us to "go ahead and get coverage" not knowing we already knew this was a scam! EHealth has their supervisors listening in on all of our calls. That means everything you gave your SSN and Medicare number, it is being recorded and used God knows how. EHealth just want your money. They don't care about helping us old people. They sit around teaching people how to sell & berate them if we don't get scammed because they paid for us to call. EHealth does not give flex card, those are for people with food stamps already! These ads are scams and we will be taking that recorded call straight to 1800 Medicare and suing. EHealth probably makes billions off the suffering of senior citizens. DO NOT GET INTO A PLAN WITH EHEALTH!"

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6852b9dce2cb0fb78ee41b2b>

"Very unimpressed with service. Very unimpressed with service. Called for help with part D plan. Agent just wanted to push an advantage plan in which I had no interest. Really pressed " advantages " but would not consider any possible disadvantages. Especially as these plans are very good for " low income people like you " I still need to research part d plans. Was a waste of time phone call."

— TrustPilot · eHealth Insurance · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6712ee03331a61a8c0d70d37>

"The agent lied to me.. The agent lied to me."

— TrustPilot · GoHealth · 2★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/61b24e730b7cbbcbfe071065>

"Run away from HealthMarkets. Do not fill out any applications. I filled out one while searching for a new health insurance plan and highly regret it. The day after I submitted my application, I received 76 calls from different agents, starting as early as 6:10 am and continuing until 5 pm PT (California). Honestly, I became overwhelmed with such 'service.' The next day, I received 28 calls. Four days later, I am still receiving calls. In conclusion, I haven't chosen a new plan. Agents are pressuring you to buy a new plan right away, but I need a plan to cover 2024. I don't want to pay extra for two months. Their goal is just to sell a plan, whether it fits my needs or not. I feel like I'm surrounded by aggressive sellers, similar to the experience with pushy sellers in Eastern Europe. I contacted HealthMarkets and requested to remove my application, but unfortunately, they had already sold my data to third parties, and it's impossible to stop it. So, think twice before sharing your data with HealthMarkets. If you need a health insurance plan, just find a few local agents and work with them. Do not work with Health Markets!!!"

— TrustPilot · HealthMarkets · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/654d53b75923eedf083fa7e0>

"Please do yourself a HUGE favor and run.... Please do yourself a HUGE favor and run from this company. An agent Hunter Vail lied to me numerous times assuring me that I qualified for an extra \$200 a month & my Medicaid insurance would not be changed whatsoever. At least 12-15 times. No exaggeration. Three days later I receive my new insurance packet & new card. I called them back & I told them that I did not approve this insurance change & Hunter would not return my call. That never happened. I called them back and was told that Hunter had left the company! They then proceeded to cancel the new insurance or so they said. My insurance was changed supposedly & 2 weeks later I'm still trying to clear this up & without being able to get my medication. For someone who has Medicaid this was a huge deal with no support that was helpful or truthful. They transferred me 4 times my last call and every agent said the exact same thing to me. They are NOT BBB approved. UNTRUTHFUL & VERY DISHONEST."

— TrustPilot · HealthInsurance.com · 1★ · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/67ee0b0cbc3bfde7e2234f5e>